1. As of 2026, consider the following statements regarding the RBI's draft directions on the Term Money Market:

1. **All India Financial Institutions (AIFIs) and eligible NBFCs/HFCs will be permitted to participate as both borrowers and lenders.**
2. **Companies will be allowed to participate only as lenders.**
3. **The borrowing limit for NBFCs and HFCs has been capped at 200% of their Net Owned Funds (NOF).**

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

A.1 only

B.1 and 2 only

C.2 and 3 only

D.All are correct

E.1 and 3 only

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** has released **draft directions** to broaden participation in the **Term Money Market** by allowing **All India Financial Institutions (AIFIs), eligible Non-Banking Financial Companies (NBFCs), Housing Finance Companies (HFCs), and companies** to participate.

The draft directions aim to **deepen liquidity, strengthen the short-term funding market, and improve the efficiency** of India's money market.

Under the proposed framework, **AIFIs and eligible NBFCs/HFCs** will be permitted to participate as **both borrowers and lenders** in the Term Money Market.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** has released **draft directions** to broaden participation in the **Term Money Market** by allowing **All India Financial Institutions (AIFIs), eligible Non-Banking Financial Companies (NBFCs), Housing Finance Companies (HFCs), and companies** to participate.

The draft directions aim to **deepen liquidity, strengthen the short-term funding market, and improve the efficiency** of India's money market.

Under the proposed framework, **AIFIs and eligible NBFCs/HFCs** will be permitted to participate as **both borrowers and lenders** in the Term Money Market.

Companies will be allowed to participate **only as lenders**, thereby expanding the availability of funds in the short-term money market.

The RBI has proposed **wider (Bharat-wide) participation** to improve **monetary policy transmission** and strengthen the linkage between the overnight money market and longer-term interest rates.

The **borrowing limit for NBFCs and HFCs** has been capped at **200% of their Net Owned Funds (NOF)**.

Standalone Primary Dealers (SPDs) will be permitted to borrow up to **400% of their Net Owned Funds (NOF)** through Term Money and Inter-Corporate Deposits (ICDs).

2. As of 2026, under the RBI's draft framework for secondary market transactions in Government Securities (G-Secs), what is the proposed minimum transaction size for retail investors?

A.₹1,000
B.₹5,000
C.₹10,000
D.₹25,000
E.₹50,000

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) has issued **draft directions** to simplify and consolidate regulations governing **secondary market transactions in Government Securities (G-Secs)**, including **'When Issued' (WI) trading, short selling, and Government Securities Lending (GSL)** under a **single regulatory framework**.

To promote **retail investor participation**, RBI has proposed allowing **individual investors** to buy and sell Government Securities through their **demat accounts** using the **NDS-OM (Negotiated Dealing System–Order Matching) platform** or the **Stock Broker Connect facility**.

The **minimum transaction size** for retail investors under the proposed framework will be **₹10,000**.

Detailed Explanation:

The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) has issued **draft directions** to simplify and consolidate regulations governing **secondary market transactions in Government Securities (G-Secs)**, including **'When Issued' (WI) trading, short selling, and Government Securities Lending (GSL)** under a **single regulatory framework**.

The draft framework aims to **enhance transparency, improve market liquidity, strengthen price discovery, and increase retail participation** in the Government Securities (G-Secs) market.

To promote **retail investor participation**, RBI has proposed allowing **individual investors** to buy and sell Government Securities through their **demat accounts** using the **NDS-OM (Negotiated Dealing System–Order Matching) platform** or the **Stock Broker Connect facility**.

The **minimum transaction size** for retail investors under the proposed framework will be **₹10,000**.

The draft directions integrate the **Government Securities Lending (GSL) Framework**, allowing eligible participants to **borrow Government Securities** to meet delivery obligations arising from **short sale transactions**, thereby improving market liquidity.

The framework continues to permit **'When Issued' (WI) trading**, enabling eligible participants to trade Government Securities **after their announcement but**

before their actual issuance, thereby facilitating efficient **price discovery**.
Scheduled Commercial Banks (SCBs) and Standalone Primary Dealers (SPDs) are permitted to take **both long and short positions up to 25% of the notified auction amount** in a specific Government Security.
Other eligible participants are allowed to hold **only long positions up to 10% of the notified auction amount** in a specific Government Security.

3. As of 2026, following the Union Cabinet's approval of an additional ₹30,000 crore investment, the Government of India's total commitment to the National Investment and Infrastructure Fund (NIIF) has increased to_____

A.₹30,000 crore
B.₹40,000 crore
C.₹50,000 crore
D.₹60,000 crore
E.₹70,000 crore
Answer: D
Short Explanation:
The Union Cabinet, chaired by Prime Minister Narendra Modi, approved an **additional Government investment of ₹30,000 crore** in the **National Investment and Infrastructure Fund (NIIF)** to strengthen investments in infrastructure and other nationally important sectors.
With this approval, the **Government of India's total commitment to NIIF** has increased from **₹30,000 crore to ₹60,000 crore**.
The **Private Markets Fund** invests through **Alternative Investment Funds (AIFs)** in sectors such as **climate, affordable housing, affordable healthcare, venture capital (VC), and technology**.
Detailed Explanation:
The Union Cabinet, chaired by Prime Minister Narendra Modi, approved an **additional Government investment of ₹30,000 crore** in the **National Investment and Infrastructure Fund (NIIF)** to strengthen investments in infrastructure and other nationally important sectors.
With this approval, the **Government of India's total commitment to NIIF** has increased from **₹30,000 crore to ₹60,000 crore**.
National Investment and Infrastructure Fund (NIIF) is **India's Sovereign Anchored Fund**, professionally managed by **National Investment and Infrastructure Fund Limited (NIIFL)**.
The **Government of India (GoI)** holds a **49% shareholding in NIIF**, while the remaining investment comes from domestic and global institutional investors.
NIIF currently manages **capital commitments of approximately ₹40,000 crore** across its various funds and investment strategies.
NIIF has established a strong investment track record by **returning nearly ₹12,000 crore to investors** through major portfolio exits.

4. As of 2026, under the Bharat Taxi cooperative-based mobility platform, vehicle operators are referred to as_____

A.Sevaks

B.Mitras

C.Sahayaks

D.Yatris

E.Sarathis

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

Union Minister for Home Affairs and Minister of Cooperation Amit Shah launched **Bharat Taxi** in **Gandhinagar, Gujarat**.

Bharat Taxi is a **cooperative-based mobility platform** developed under the **Ministry of Cooperation** with the vision of **"Sahakar Se Samriddhi" (Prosperity through Cooperation)**.

The platform enables vehicle operators, known as **"Sarathis"**, to become **shareholders** of the cooperative, ensuring **ownership, financial security, and better earnings**.

Detailed Explanation:

Union Minister for Home Affairs and Minister of Cooperation Amit Shah launched **Bharat Taxi** in **Gandhinagar, Gujarat**.

Bharat Taxi is a **cooperative-based mobility platform** developed under the **Ministry of Cooperation** with the vision of **"Sahakar Se Samriddhi" (Prosperity through Cooperation)**.

The platform enables vehicle operators, known as **"Sarathis"**, to become **shareholders** of the cooperative, ensuring **ownership, financial security, and better earnings**.

Bharat Taxi provides services through **two-wheelers, auto-rickshaws, and four-wheel taxis**, offering reliable and affordable transport services.

The platform aims to provide **transparent payments**, **institutional support**, **insurance**, **loan facilities**, and **reduced commission burden** for Sarathis.

More than **7 lakh Sarathis** have already joined the platform, while around **37 lakh customers** have used its services.

The service has commenced operations across **Gujarat**, including **Ahmedabad, Surat, Rajkot**, and other major cities.

Bharat Taxi plans to expand to **seven major Indian cities** by **31 July 2026** and to **more than 500 cities and towns** over the next **two years**.

5. In 2026, the Prime Minister Family Care Tracker (PM-FCT), launched as a pilot project by Union Home Minister Amit Shah, is designed to track beneficiaries for government welfare services from which stage up to what age?

A.From pregnancy to 18 years of age

B.From birth to 14 years of age

C.From conception to 21 years of age

D.From birth to 5 years of age

E.From pregnancy to 10 years of age

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

Union Minister for Home Affairs and Cooperation Amit Shah launched the pilot project of the **Prime Minister Family Care Tracker (PM-FCT)** in **Gandhinagar, Gujarat**.

The **Prime Minister Family Care Tracker (PM-FCT)** is an integrated digital platform designed to ensure that **pregnant women, mothers, and children** receive all eligible **government welfare benefits** through continuous monitoring.

The platform tracks beneficiaries from **pregnancy to 18 years of age**, covering **health, nutrition, education, and social welfare** services.

Detailed Explanation:

Union Minister for Home Affairs and Cooperation Amit Shah launched the pilot project of the **Prime Minister Family Care Tracker (PM-FCT)** in **Gandhinagar, Gujarat**.

The **Prime Minister Family Care Tracker (PM-FCT)** is an integrated digital platform designed to ensure that **pregnant women, mothers, and children** receive all eligible **government welfare benefits** through continuous monitoring.

The platform tracks beneficiaries from **pregnancy to 18 years of age**, covering **health, nutrition, education, and social welfare** services.

Each beneficiary is assigned a **unique digital identity** linked to the **Birth Registration Number** or **Ayushman Bharat Health Account (ABHA) ID** for seamless tracking.

The platform generates **real-time alerts** for missed services such as **immunisation, high-risk pregnancies, malnutrition, school dropouts, and health check-ups**, enabling timely intervention.

6. As of 2026, Prime Minister Narendra Modi became the first recipient of which Presidential Honour conferred by the Republic of Seychelles?

A.Order of the Golden Ocean

B.Guardian of the Blue Horizon

C.Order of the Indian Ocean

D.Blue Planet Leadership Award

E.Ocean Sustainability Medal

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Prime Minister Narendra Modi was conferred the **'Guardian of the Blue Horizon' Presidential Honour** by **President Dr. Patrick Herminie** of **Seychelles**.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi became the **first recipient** of this prestigious civilian honour instituted by the **Republic of Seychelles**.

The award recognises exceptional leadership in **climate action**, **environmental conservation**, **Blue Economy**, **sustainable ocean governance**, and support for **Small Island Developing States (SIDS)**.

Detailed Explanation:

Prime Minister Narendra Modi was conferred the **'Guardian of the Blue Horizon' Presidential Honour** by **President Dr. Patrick Herminie** of **Seychelles**.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi became the **first recipient** of this prestigious civilian

honour instituted by the **Republic of Seychelles**.

The award recognises exceptional leadership in **climate action**, **environmental conservation**, **Blue Economy**, **sustainable ocean governance**, and support for **Small Island Developing States (SIDS)**.

The honour acknowledges India's contribution to promoting **sustainable development**, **marine ecosystem conservation**, and **international cooperation** on environmental issues.

The recognition highlights India's global environmental initiatives, including the **International Solar Alliance (ISA)**, **Mission LiFE (Lifestyle for Environment)**, **Ek Ped Maa Ke Naam**, and the **International Big Cat Alliance (IBCA)**.

While accepting the honour, **Prime Minister Narendra Modi** dedicated the award to all countries committed to **environmental protection** and **combating climate change**.

7. In 2026, India launched Operation Amistad as a Humanitarian Assistance and Disaster Relief (HADR) mission to assist which country after devastating earthquakes?

A.Chile

B.Peru

C.Venezuela

D.Ecuador

E.Colombia

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

India launched **Operation Amistad**, a **Humanitarian Assistance and Disaster Relief (HADR)** mission, to assist **Venezuela** after devastating magnitude **7.2 and 7.5 earthquakes** caused heavy loss of life, injuries, and widespread destruction.

Operation Amistad reflects India's solidarity with the Government and people of Venezuela and highlights India's commitment to providing **humanitarian assistance** during natural disasters.

Detailed Explanation:

India launched **Operation Amistad**, a **Humanitarian Assistance and Disaster Relief (HADR)** mission, to assist **Venezuela** after devastating magnitude **7.2 and 7.5 earthquakes** caused heavy loss of life, injuries, and widespread destruction.

Operation Amistad reflects India's solidarity with the Government and people of Venezuela and highlights India's commitment to providing **humanitarian assistance** during natural disasters.

The term **"Amistad"** is a Spanish word meaning **"Friendship"**, symbolizing India's support and cooperation with Venezuela during the crisis.

As part of the mission, **two Indian Air Force (IAF) C-17 Globemaster aircraft** were deployed to transport humanitarian relief and rescue teams to the affected areas.

The operation included a **41-member rescue and medical team** comprising experienced search and rescue personnel and medical professionals to support relief operations.

8. In 2026, the 5th edition of the Capstone Seminar marked the successful culmination of which programme?

A.Defence Technology Leadership Programme (DTLP)

B.National Security Strategy Course (NSSC)

C.Joint Services War Studies Programme (JSWSP)

D.Air Power Leadership Programme (APLP)

E.Warfare & Aerospace Strategy Programme (WASP)

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

The **5th edition of the Capstone Seminar**, marking the successful culmination of the **Warfare & Aerospace Strategy Programme (WASP)**, was held on **29 June 2026**.

The seminar was graced by **Chief of the Air Staff (CAS) Air Chief Marshal A.P. Singh** as the Chief Guest.

The event was attended by **former Chief of Defence Staff (CDS) General Anil Chauhan (Retd.)**, former Chiefs of the Air Staff, and distinguished defence veterans, highlighting the programme's strategic significance.

Detailed Explanation:

The **5th edition of the Capstone Seminar**, marking the successful culmination of the **Warfare & Aerospace Strategy Programme (WASP)**, was held on **29 June 2026**.

The seminar was graced by **Chief of the Air Staff (CAS) Air Chief Marshal A.P. Singh** as the Chief Guest.

The event was attended by **former Chief of Defence Staff (CDS) General Anil Chauhan (Retd.)**, former Chiefs of the Air Staff, and distinguished defence veterans, highlighting the programme's strategic significance.

The **Capstone Seminar** is the concluding event of the **six-month Warfare & Aerospace Strategy Programme (WASP)**.

WASP is jointly conducted by the **Centre for Aerospace Power and Strategic Studies (CAPSS), New Delhi**, and the **College of Air Warfare (CAW), Hyderabad**.

9. In 2026, the SC120 Semi-Cryogenic Stage being developed by ISRO is intended to replace which existing stage of the Launch Vehicle Mark-III (LVM3)?

A.L110 Core Stage

B.S200 Solid Rocket Booster

C.PSLV PS4 Stage

D.GSLV Mk-II GS2 Stage

E.C25 Cryogenic Upper Stage

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) successfully conducted a **hot test** of the **Semi-Cryogenic Engine Power Head Test**

Article (PHTA) at the **ISRO Propulsion Complex (IPC), Mahendragiri, Tamil Nadu**.

The hot test achieved **88% of the target thrust**, generating **175 tonnes of thrust**, marking a major milestone in the development of India's next-generation rocket propulsion system.

The test was the **8th hot test in the PHTA test series**, following earlier successful tests at **47% (94 tonnes) and 60% (120 tonnes)** of full thrust.

The successful **175-tonne test** has provided ISRO with confidence to proceed towards the **full-thrust demonstration of 200 tonnes**.

The **SC120 propulsion stage** is being developed to replace the existing **L110 core stage of the Launch Vehicle Mark-III (LVM3)** rocket.

Detailed Explanation:

Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) successfully conducted a **hot test** of the **Semi-Cryogenic Engine Power Head Test Article (PHTA)** at the **ISRO Propulsion Complex (IPC), Mahendragiri, Tamil Nadu**.

The hot test achieved **88% of the target thrust**, generating **175 tonnes of thrust**, marking a major milestone in the development of India's next-generation rocket propulsion system.

The test was the **8th hot test in the PHTA test series**, following earlier successful tests at **47% (94 tonnes) and 60% (120 tonnes)** of full thrust.

The successful **175-tonne test** has provided ISRO with confidence to proceed towards the **full-thrust demonstration of 200 tonnes**.

The **SE2000 Semi-Cryogenic Engine** is designed to produce **2,000 kilonewtons (kN) of thrust** and will power the **SC120 (Semi-Cryogenic Stage)**.

The **SC120 propulsion stage** is being developed to replace the existing **L110 core stage of the Launch Vehicle Mark-III (LVM3)** rocket.

The upgraded **SC120 stage** is expected to increase the **Geostationary Transfer Orbit (GTO) payload capacity of LVM3 from 4 tonnes to 5 tonnes**.

The **Low Earth Orbit (LEO) payload capacity of LVM3** is also expected to increase from **8 tonnes to 10 tonnes** after the induction of the SC120 stage.

The SE2000 engine uses **Liquid Oxygen (LOX) as the oxidiser and Kerosene as the fuel**, operating on an **Oxidiser-Rich Staged Combustion Cycle**.

10. In 2026, Mission ShakthiSAT, supported by Gautam Buddha University, Space Kidz India, and IN-SPACe, is recognised as the world's first_____

A.All-women Mars mission

B.Student-led space station mission

C.International solar observation mission

D.Commercial lunar exploration mission

E.All-girls international lunar mission

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

Gautam Buddha University (GBU) has entered into a strategic partnership with **Space Kidz India** and the **Indian National Space Promotion and Authorisation Centre (IN-**

SPACe) to support **Mission ShakthiSAT**, the world's first all-girls international lunar mission. **Mission ShakthiSAT** aims to advance space technology, promote **STEM (Science, Technology, Engineering and Mathematics) education**, and encourage **women-led leadership** in the space sector.

Detailed Explanation:

Gautam Buddha University (GBU) has entered into a strategic partnership with **Space Kidz India** and the **Indian National Space Promotion and Authorisation Centre (IN-SPACe)** to support **Mission ShakthiSAT**, the world's first all-girls international lunar mission. **Mission ShakthiSAT** aims to advance space technology, promote **STEM (Science, Technology, Engineering and Mathematics) education**, and encourage **women-led leadership** in the space sector.

The mission is an **international student space initiative** designed to empower **12,000 young girls from 108 countries** through hands-on experience in **satellite development, space technology, research, and innovation**.

A major objective of Mission ShakthiSAT is to foster **global scientific collaboration, interdisciplinary learning**, and inspire greater **female participation** in the global space ecosystem.

As a key academic and institutional partner, **Gautam Buddha University (GBU)** will support the mission through **research, innovation, scientific engagement, and interdisciplinary education**.

The **Greater Noida Industrial Development Authority (GNIDA)** will provide **institutional support** for the successful implementation of Mission ShakthiSAT.

11. As of 2026, which Indian institution partnered with Sorbonne University, France, to launch joint MSc in Biological Science and PhD programmes?

A.Indian Institute of Science (IISc), Bengaluru

B.IIT Delhi

C.IIT Madras

D.Jawaharlal Nehru University (JNU)

E.IIT Bombay

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Indian Institute of Technology Delhi (IIT Delhi) and Sorbonne University, France have expanded their strategic partnership by launching a joint **Master of Science (MSc) in Biological Science (Biol. Sci) and Doctor of Philosophy (PhD)** programmes from **2026**.

The collaboration is anchored by the **Franco-Indian Integrated Health Campus**, established to integrate **engineering, medicine, life sciences, social sciences, and digital technologies**.

Detailed Explanation:

Indian Institute of Technology Delhi (IIT Delhi) and Sorbonne University, France have expanded their strategic partnership by launching a joint **Master of Science (MSc) in Biological Science (Biol. Sci) and Doctor of Philosophy (PhD)** programmes from **2026**.

The collaboration is anchored by the **Franco-Indian Integrated Health Campus**, established to integrate **engineering, medicine, life sciences, social sciences, and digital technologies**.

The partnership extends beyond healthcare to promote **research, education, and innovation** in **Artificial Intelligence (AI), robotics, and materials science**.

The Franco-Indian Integrated Health Campus programmes are coordinated by **IIT Delhi**, following the visit of an IIT Delhi delegation led by **Professor Rangan Banerjee** to Sorbonne University.

The collaboration has already facilitated **joint research projects, two-way student mobility** between India and France, **faculty and student exchange programmes, internships, co-supervised doctoral research, scientific workshops**, and research with societal and technological relevance.

12. In 2026, the "Fresh Application Module" launched on the Notary Portal enables eligible legal practitioners to apply online for appointment as:

A.Public Prosecutor

B.Judicial Magistrate

C.Legal Advisor

D.Advocate General

E.Notary Public

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

Union Minister of State (Independent Charge) for Law & Justice, Arjun Ram Meghwal, launched the **"Fresh Application Module"** on the **Notary Portal** for online applications for appointment as **Notary Public**.

The module has been launched under the provisions of the **Notaries Act, 1952** and the **Notaries Rules, 1956** to simplify the appointment process for Notaries.

Detailed Explanation:

Union Minister of State (Independent Charge) for Law & Justice, Arjun Ram Meghwal, launched the **"Fresh Application Module"** on the **Notary Portal** for online applications for appointment as **Notary Public**.

The module has been launched under the provisions of the **Notaries Act, 1952** and the **Notaries Rules, 1956** to simplify the appointment process for Notaries.

The **Fresh Application Module** enables eligible **legal practitioners and advocates** to submit their Notary Public applications **online through the Notary Portal**.

The module has been developed by the **Department of Legal Affairs** in collaboration with the **National Informatics Centre (NIC)** to ensure a **transparent, efficient, and citizen-friendly** application process.

The **Fresh Application Module** has been integrated with the **existing Notary Portal**, which already provides various online services related to the appointment of Notaries.

13. In 2026, Aarogya Setu 2.0 was formally transferred from which Ministry to the

National Health Authority (NHA) for integration into India's digital health ecosystem?

A.Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY)

B.Ministry of Health and Family Welfare (MoHFW)

C.Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA)

D.Ministry of Science and Technology

E.Ministry of Communication

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

Union Minister of Health and Family Welfare, Jagat Prakash Nadda, launched **Aarogya Setu 2.0**, transforming the application into a **Personal Health Record (PHR)** and citizen-facing digital health platform under the **Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission (ABDM)**.

Aarogya Setu was originally developed by the Government of India during the **COVID-19 pandemic** as a national digital public good for **contact tracing, risk awareness, and citizen engagement**.

After fulfilling its pandemic-related role, the **Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY)** formally transferred Aarogya Setu to the **National Health Authority (NHA)** for its long-term integration into India's digital health ecosystem.

Detailed Explanation:

Union Minister of Health and Family Welfare, Jagat Prakash Nadda, launched **Aarogya Setu 2.0**, transforming the application into a **Personal Health Record (PHR)** and citizen-facing digital health platform under the **Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission (ABDM)**.

Aarogya Setu was originally developed by the Government of India during the **COVID-19 pandemic** as a national digital public good for **contact tracing, risk awareness, and citizen engagement**.

After fulfilling its pandemic-related role, the **Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY)** formally transferred Aarogya Setu to the **National Health Authority (NHA)** for its long-term integration into India's digital health ecosystem.

Aarogya Setu 2.0 aligns with the vision of the **Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission (ABDM)** and serves as a **single digital gateway** for accessing ABDM-enabled healthcare services.

The revamped platform acts as a trusted **Personal Health Record (PHR)**, enabling citizens and families to **securely manage and access** their digital health records. With a user base of nearly **20 crore downloads**, Aarogya Setu 2.0 is expected to **accelerate the adoption of digital health services** across India.

The application provides **ABDM-enabled services**, including **ABHA (Ayushman Bharat Health Account) creation**, health record management, and **Scan & Register** for seamless hospital registration.

14. In 2026, India's first Centre of Excellence (CoE) dedicated to Plant Cell Fermentation

Technology was launched through a collaboration between IIT Madras and which organisation?

A.Biocon Limited

B.CSIR–Indian Institute of Chemical Technology

C.Herbalife International India Private Limited

D.Serum Institute of India

E.Dabur India Ltd

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

Herbalife International India Private Limited and the **Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) Madras** launched **India's first Centre of Excellence (CoE)** dedicated to **Plant Cell Fermentation Technology**.

The **Centre of Excellence (CoE)** aims to promote **research in sustainable biomanufacturing** and develop **next-generation plant-based health and wellness products**.

Detailed Explanation:

Herbalife International India Private Limited and the **Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) Madras** launched **India's first Centre of Excellence (CoE)** dedicated to **Plant Cell Fermentation Technology**.

The **Centre of Excellence (CoE)** aims to promote **research in sustainable biomanufacturing** and develop **next-generation plant-based health and wellness products**.

It will serve as a collaborative platform for **researchers, students, entrepreneurs, industry experts**, and **start-ups** to transform scientific research into commercial applications.

The Centre will focus on the sustainable production of **herbal biomass**, **enriched herbal extracts**, and **high-value plant compounds** using **plant cell fermentation technology**.

It is equipped with **customised plant cell bioreactors**, **advanced analytical platforms**, **metabolomics facilities**, and **pilot-scale processing units**.

The initiative supports **technology transfer**, **skill development**, **industry-academia collaboration**, **entrepreneurship**, and **start-up incubation** in the field of plant biotechnology.

15. In 2026, how many agreements and initiatives were signed between India and Seychelles during Prime Minister Narendra Modi's three-day visit?

A.15

B.17

C.19

D.21

E.23

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

India and **Seychelles** signed **19 agreements and initiatives** during **Prime Minister Narendra Modi's three-day visit** to **Seychelles**.

The agreements were announced after bilateral talks between **Prime Minister Narendra**

Modi and **President Dr. Patrick Herminie** in **Victoria**, the capital of **Seychelles**.

The initiatives cover **maritime security, defence, digital payments, healthcare, education, agriculture, infrastructure, space cooperation, and financial assistance**.

Detailed Explanation:

India and **Seychelles** signed **19 agreements and initiatives** during **Prime Minister Narendra Modi's three-day visit** to **Seychelles**.

The agreements were announced after bilateral talks between **Prime Minister Narendra Modi** and **President Dr. Patrick Herminie** in **Victoria**, the capital of **Seychelles**.

The initiatives cover **maritime security, defence, digital payments, healthcare, education, agriculture, infrastructure, space cooperation, and financial assistance**.

India reaffirmed its commitment to the **MAHASAGAR (Mutual and Holistic Advancement for Security and Growth Across Regions)** initiative to strengthen **maritime security**, **Blue Economy**, **disaster preparedness**, and **regional stability** in the **Indian Ocean Region (IOR)**.

India announced defence assistance, including an **indigenously built Fast Patrol Vessel**, **10 utility vehicles**, **five Laser Radial sailing boats**, the **refit of PS Zoroaster**, and the **upgrade of the Dornier maritime surveillance aircraft** of the **Seychelles Coast Guard**.

16. As of 2026, GST Day in India is observed every year on which date to commemorate the implementation of the Goods and Services Tax regime?

A.30 June

B.1 July

C.15 August

D.26 January

E.2 October

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Goods and Services Tax (GST) Day is observed every year in **India** on **1 July** to commemorate the implementation of the **Goods and Services Tax (GST)**.

1 July 2026 marks the **9th anniversary** of the launch of the **GST** regime in India.

GST was implemented on **1 July 2017**, replacing multiple indirect taxes with a **single, unified indirect tax system** across the country.

The introduction of **GST** is considered one of India's most significant **economic and tax reforms**, creating the concept of **"One Nation, One Tax."**

The idea of introducing **GST** was first recommended by the **Kelkar Task Force on Indirect Taxes** in **2003**.

Detailed Explanation:

Goods and Services Tax (GST) Day is observed every year in **India** on **1 July** to commemorate the implementation of the **Goods and Services Tax (GST)**.

1 July 2026 marks the **9th anniversary** of the launch of the **GST** regime in India.

GST was implemented on **1 July 2017**, replacing multiple indirect taxes with a **single, unified indirect tax system** across the country.
The introduction of **GST** is considered one of India's most significant **economic and tax reforms**, creating the concept of **"One Nation, One Tax."**
The idea of introducing **GST** was first recommended by the **Kelkar Task Force on Indirect Taxes** in **2003**.
The primary objectives of **GST** are to **simplify the indirect tax structure**, **eliminate the cascading effect of taxes**, **promote ease of doing business**, and **create a unified national market**.
GST is levied on the **supply of goods and services** and is administered jointly by the **Central Government** and **State Governments**.
The observance recognises the role of **GST** in improving **tax compliance**, **enhancing transparency**, and **strengthening India's economic integration**.

17. As of 2026, Chartered Accountants Day in India is observed every year on which date to commemorate the establishment of ICAI?
A.1 June
B.30 June
C.2 July
D.1 July
E.15 July
Answer: D

Chartered Accountants Day is observed every year in **India** on **1 July** to commemorate the establishment of the **Institute of Chartered Accountants of India (ICAI)**.
1 July 2026 marks the **77th Chartered Accountants Day**.
The **Institute of Chartered Accountants of India (ICAI)** was established on **1 July 1949** as a statutory body under the **Chartered Accountants Act, 1949**, enacted by the **Parliament of India**.

18. In 2026, National Doctors' Day in India has been observed annually on July 1, since which year?
A.1985
B.1988
C.1990
D.1991
E.2000
Answer: D
Short Explanation:
National Doctors' Day is observed every year in **India** on **1 July** to honour the contributions of doctors and healthcare professionals.
The day commemorates the **birth and death anniversary** of **Dr. Bidhan Chandra Roy**, a renowned physician, educationist, and the **second Chief Minister of West Bengal**.
National Doctors' Day has been observed annually since **1991**.
Detailed Explanation:

National Doctors' Day is observed every year in **India** on **1 July** to honour the contributions of doctors and healthcare professionals.

The day commemorates the **birth and death anniversary** of **Dr. Bidhan Chandra Roy**, a renowned physician, educationist, and the **second Chief Minister of West Bengal**.

National Doctors' Day has been observed annually since **1991**.

The day is organised by the **Indian Medical Association (IMA)** to recognise the dedication and service of the medical fraternity.

Dr. Bidhan Chandra Roy was born on **1 July 1882** in **Patna**, then part of the **Bengal Presidency, British India**.

19. In 2026, the Institute of Chartered Accountants of India (ICAI) was established in which year under the Chartered Accountants Act?

A.1947

B.1948

C.1951

D.1950

E.1949

Answer: E

About Institute of Chartered Accountants of India (ICAI)

Established: 1 July 1949

Established Under: Chartered Accountants Act, 1949

Headquarters: New Delhi

President: CA. Prasanna Kumar D

20. In 2026, the Prime Minister Family Care Tracker (PM-FCT) pilot project was launched by which state government?

A.Government of Gujarat

B.Government of Maharashtra

C.Government of Uttar Pradesh

D.Government of Madhya Pradesh

E.Government of Rajasthan

Answer: A

About Prime Minister Family Care Tracker (PM-FCT)

Launched By: Government of Gujarat (Pilot Project)

Launch Venue: Gandhinagar, Gujarat

Objective: To provide **integrated digital tracking** of maternal and child health, nutrition, education, and welfare benefits from **pregnancy to 18 years of age**.

Unique Identification: Birth Registration Number or **Ayushman Bharat Health Account (ABHA) ID**.

Key Feature: Real-time beneficiary tracking with **automated alerts** for missed services and welfare benefits.

21. In 2026, Union Finance Minister Smt. Nirmala Sitharaman co-chaired the India–France Economic & Financial Dialogue (EFD) with which French Minister?

A.Jean-Noël Barrot, Minister for Europe and Foreign Affairs

B.Roland Lescure, Minister of Economy, Finance and Industrial and Energy Sovereignty

C.Sébastien Lecornu, Minister of the Armed Forces

D.Bruno Retailleau, Minister of the Interior

E.Éric Lombard, Minister of Public Accounts

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Union Minister for Finance and Corporate Affairs, Smt. Nirmala Sitharaman, embarked on an official visit to France to strengthen the **India–France Strategic Partnership** and promote economic cooperation, investment, technology collaboration, and innovation.

A key engagement of the visit is the **India–France Economic & Financial Dialogue (EFD)**, which will be co-chaired by Smt. Nirmala Sitharaman and **Roland Lescure**, Minister of Economy, Finance and Industrial and Energy Sovereignty of France, at **Aix-en-Provence**.

Detailed Explanation:

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A key engagement of the visit is the **India–France Economic & Financial Dialogue (EFD)**, which will be co-chaired by Smt. Nirmala Sitharaman and **Roland Lescure**, Minister of Economy, Finance and Industrial and Energy Sovereignty of France, at **Aix-en-Provence**.

During the Economic & Financial Dialogue (EFD), India and France will discuss greater bilateral cooperation across various sectors and further strengthen economic relations between the two countries.

Smt. Nirmala Sitharaman will hold **one-to-one meetings with global CEOs** and participate in a roundtable with leading business executives to highlight India's strong macroeconomic fundamentals, structural reforms, investment opportunities, and long-term growth prospects.

The Finance Minister will participate in a panel discussion on the theme **"How to Promote the Growth of a New Middle Class"** at **Les Rencontres Économiques d'Aix-en-Provence**, one of Europe's leading annual forums on global economic and public policy issues.

22. In 2026, which India-based cross-border payments platform launched Google Pay Card Payments on its International Payment Gateway to simplify global digital payments for Indian merchants?

A.Razorpay

B.Cashfree Payments

C.PayU

D.CCAvenue

E.PayGlocal

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

PayGlocal, an India-based cross-border payments platform, launched **Google Pay Card Payments** on its International Payment Gateway to simplify global digital payments for Indian merchants.

The integration enables Indian merchants to access over **1 billion customers** across more than **90 countries** through a single integration. The initiative aims to facilitate seamless cross-border transactions, **increase merchant activations by 40%**, and improve the efficiency of cross-border e-commerce.

Detailed Explanation:

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The integration enables Indian merchants to access over **1 billion customers** across more than **90 countries** through a single integration. The initiative aims to facilitate seamless cross-border transactions, **increase merchant activations by 40%**, and improve the efficiency of cross-border e-commerce.

The Google Pay integration offers **secure, tokenized, and biometrically authenticated** payment transactions for enhanced safety and convenience.

Apple Pay is already live on the PayGlocal International Payment Gateway, complementing the newly launched Google Pay Card Payments. The platform features an **intelligent routing system** and **fraud prevention layer** to ensure smooth, secure, and reliable global checkout experiences.

23. In 2026, Kakinada Cooperative Town Bank secured Tier-III status under RBI norms after its total deposits crossed which of the following thresholds?

A.₹500 crore

B.₹1,000 crore

C.₹1,500 crore

D.₹2,000 crore

E.₹2,500 crore

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

Kakinada Cooperative Town Bank, an Urban Cooperative Bank (UCB) in Andhra Pradesh (AP), secured **Tier-III status** under Reserve Bank of India (RBI) norms after its total deposits crossed **₹2,000 crore**.

The bank achieved Tier-III classification with **zero Net Non-Performing Assets (NPAs)**, reflecting its strong financial health.

Following this achievement, Kakinada Cooperative Town Bank became the **2nd-largest Urban Cooperative Bank (UCB)** among the 46 UCBs in Andhra Pradesh.

Detailed Explanation:

Kakinada Cooperative Town Bank, an Urban Cooperative Bank (UCB) in Andhra Pradesh (AP), secured **Tier-III status** under Reserve Bank of India (RBI) norms after its total deposits crossed **₹2,000 crore**.

The bank achieved Tier-III classification with **zero Net Non-Performing Assets (NPAs)**, reflecting its strong financial health.

Following this achievement, Kakinada Cooperative Town Bank became the **2nd-largest Urban Cooperative Bank (UCB)** among the 46 UCBs in Andhra Pradesh.

The bank's total business has **exceeded ₹2,040 crore**, marking a significant growth milestone.
Established **46 years ago**, the bank serves customers across East Godavari, Kakinada, Konaseema, and Visakhapatnam districts.
The bank currently operates **18 branches and 8 Automated Teller Machines (ATMs)**, with plans to establish a Cash Deposit Machine (CDM), a 2,000-locker plaza, and new branches at Samalkot and Pithapuram.
As of 31 March 2026, the bank reported **advances of ₹804.12 crore**, investments of ₹552.14 crore, 55,605 members, share capital of ₹28.63 crore, and own funds of ₹198.20 crore.

24. In 2026, the Youth Co:Lab National Innovation Challenge was co-led by UNDP India and which organisation?

A.World Bank
B.Bill & Melinda Gates Foundation
C.Citi Foundation
D.UNICEF
E.Asian Development Bank

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The **8th edition of the Youth Co:Lab National Innovation Challenge 2026** concluded with the selection of **six youth-led startups** for developing **scalable and high-impact solutions** to address sustainability challenges.
The initiative is **co-led** by the **United Nations Development Programme (UNDP) India** and the **Citi Foundation**, in partnership with the **Atal Innovation Mission (AIM), National Institution for Transforming India (NITI) Aayog**, and implemented by the **T-Hub Foundation**.
The challenge received **more than 350 applications** from youth-led startups across **28 States**.

Detailed Explanation:

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The challenge received **more than 350 applications** from youth-led startups across **28 States**.
The competition was organised under three themes:
Sustainable Textiles and Fashion
Circular Economy Innovations
Sustainable Food Systems and Water Conservation
Following a rigorous selection process, **50 high-potential startups** were selected for the **National Springboard Programme**, a **three-month virtual capacity-building programme**.
The selected startups pitched their ideas before a distinguished jury at the **National Innovation Dialogue** held on **4 June 2026**.

The **top 20 startups** advanced to the **five-day Regional Immersion Bootcamp**, organised at **T-Hub, Hyderabad**, from **15 to 19 June 2026**.

25. In 2026, the launch of AIR SUVIDHA 2.0 was prompted by the Ebola/Bundibugyo Virus Disease (BVD) outbreak declared by the WHO as a Public Health Emergency of International Concern (PHEIC) in which countries?

A.Kenya and Tanzania

B.Democratic Republic of the Congo (DRC) and Uganda

C.Nigeria and Ghana

D.Rwanda and Burundi

E.Ethiopia and South Sudan

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The **Ministry of Civil Aviation (MoCA)** and **Delhi International Airport Limited (DIAL)** launched **AIR SUVIDHA 2.0**, an upgraded **contactless Passenger Health Self-Declaration Portal**, to strengthen **public health surveillance** at points of entry.

The portal has been launched in response to the ongoing **Ebola/Bundibugyo Virus Disease (BVD)** outbreak.

The launch follows the **World Health Organization (WHO)** declaration of the Ebola/Bundibugyo Virus Disease outbreak in the **Democratic Republic of the Congo (DRC)** and **Uganda** as a **Public Health Emergency of International Concern (PHEIC)** on **17 May 2026** under the **International Health Regulations (IHR), 2005**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Ministry of Civil Aviation (MoCA)** and **Delhi International Airport Limited (DIAL)** launched **AIR SUVIDHA 2.0**, an upgraded **contactless Passenger Health Self-Declaration Portal**, to strengthen **public health surveillance** at points of entry.

The portal has been launched in response to the ongoing **Ebola/Bundibugyo Virus Disease (BVD)** outbreak.

The launch follows the **World Health Organization (WHO)** declaration of the Ebola/Bundibugyo Virus Disease outbreak in the **Democratic Republic of the Congo (DRC)** and **Uganda** as a **Public Health Emergency of International Concern (PHEIC)** on **17 May 2026** under the **International Health Regulations (IHR), 2005**.

According to the **WHO**, the current outbreak has been confirmed as **Bundibugyo Virus Disease (BVD)**.

Countries bordering the **Democratic Republic of the Congo (DRC)** and **Uganda**, including **South Sudan**, have been assessed as **high-risk** for disease transmission.

The portal was developed in collaboration with the **Directorate General of Health Services (DGHS)** under the **Ministry of Health and Family Welfare (MoHFW)**.

AIR SUVIDHA 2.0 enables international arriving passengers to submit a **mandatory online Health Self-Declaration Form (SDF)** before immigration clearance.

The declaration includes the passenger's **21-day travel history**, **exposure history**, and **related symptoms**, if any.

The **Self-Declaration Form (SDF)** can be completed **up to 24 hours before arrival in India**.

26. In 2026, India's first offshore airport was proposed to be developed off the coast of which district in Maharashtra?

A.Palghar

B.Ratnagiri

C.Sindhudurg

D.Raigad

E.Thane

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

Maharashtra has approved the development of **India's first offshore airport**, marking a major milestone in the country's aviation infrastructure.

The project received **in-principle approval** from **Chief Minister Devendra Fadnavis** following a proposal by the **Maharashtra Airport Development Company (MADC)**.

The proposed airport will be developed **off the coast of Palghar district** to enhance air connectivity in the **Mumbai Metropolitan Region (MMR)**.

An **offshore airport** is built over the sea on an **artificial island** or **offshore platform**, helping overcome land constraints in densely populated coastal cities.

Detailed Explanation:

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The project received **in-principle approval** from **Chief Minister Devendra Fadnavis** following a proposal by the **Maharashtra Airport Development Company (MADC)**.

The proposed airport will be developed **off the coast of Palghar district** to enhance air connectivity in the **Mumbai Metropolitan Region (MMR)**.

An **offshore airport** is built over the sea on an **artificial island** or **offshore platform**, helping overcome land constraints in densely populated coastal cities.

The airport will be located about **4.75 kilometres from the proposed Uttan–Virar Sea Link**, with plans to provide direct connectivity in the future.

The project aims to address the growing demand for aviation infrastructure while reducing dependence on land acquisition.

It will feature **modern passenger and cargo facilities**, integration with Mumbai's transport network, and scope for future expansion.

27. In 2026, the Samagra Shishu Bal Swasthya Karyakram (SSBSK) integrates which two existing child health programmes into a single framework?

A.POSHAN Abhiyaan and Mission Indradhanush

B.Rashtriya Bal Swasthya Karyakram (RBSK) and Janani Suraksha Yojana (JSY)

C.Home-Based Newborn Care (HBNC) and Home-Based Care for Young Child (HBYC)

D.Pradhan Mantri Matru Vandana Yojana (PMMVY) and HBNC

E.Ayushman Bharat and HBYC

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

Union Minister of Health and Family Welfare Jagat Prakash Nadda launched the **Samagra Shishu Bal Swasthya Karyakram (SSBSK)** during the **16th Central Council of Health and Family Welfare (CCHFW) Meeting**.

SSBSK is a **national child health initiative** that provides a **unified framework for home- and community-based care** for children from **birth to 36 months**.

The programme integrates the **Home-Based Newborn Care (HBNC)** and **Home-Based Care for Young Child (HBYC)** programmes into a single framework.

Detailed Explanation:

Union Minister of Health and Family Welfare Jagat Prakash Nadda launched the **Samagra Shishu Bal Swasthya Karyakram (SSBSK)** during the **16th Central Council of Health and Family Welfare (CCHFW) Meeting**.

SSBSK is a **national child health initiative** that provides a **unified framework for home- and community-based care** for children from **birth to 36 months**.

The programme integrates the **Home-Based Newborn Care (HBNC)** and **Home-Based Care for Young Child (HBYC)** programmes into a single framework.

Guided by the vision **"पहले तीन साल सम्पूर्ण देखभाल" (Comprehensive Care During the First Three Years)**, it focuses on improving child survival, nutrition, growth, and early childhood development.

The programme follows a **risk-stratified approach**, providing additional monitoring for **at-risk children**, including those with:

Low birth weight

Premature birth

Delayed breastfeeding initiation

Discharge from newborn care units

Malnutrition

Recurrent illnesses

Developmental delays

At-risk newborns will receive **up to 9 home visits** during the first **42 days**, while **at-risk children** will receive **up to 8 additional visits** until **36 months** of age.

The initiative strengthens coordination among **Accredited Social Health Activists (ASHAs)**, **Auxiliary Nurse Midwives (ANMs)**, **Community Health Officers (CHOs)**, and **Anganwadi Workers (AWWs)**.

28. In 2026, which organisation developed Ayushman Sarathi, the official WhatsApp chatbot for Ayushman Bharat Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya Yojana (AB PM-JAY)?

A.National Health Authority (NHA)

B.Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY)

C.National Informatics Centre (NIC)

D.National Medical Commission (NMC)

E.Centre for Development of Advanced Computing (C-DAC)

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

Union Minister for Health and Family Welfare Jagat Prakash Nadda launched **Ayushman Sarathi**, the official **WhatsApp chatbot** for the **Ayushman Bharat Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya Yojana (AB PM-JAY)**.

The chatbot has been developed by the **National Health Authority (NHA)** to provide **secure, real-time, and 24×7 access** to **PM-JAY** services through **WhatsApp**.

Ayushman Sarathi enables beneficiaries to **check eligibility**, **apply for**, **download**, and **manage** their **Ayushman Card** using secure **Application Programming Interface (API)** integration.

Detailed Explanation:

Union Minister for Health and Family Welfare Jagat Prakash Nadda launched **Ayushman Sarathi**, the official **WhatsApp chatbot** for the **Ayushman Bharat Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya Yojana (AB PM-JAY)**.

The chatbot has been developed by the **National Health Authority (NHA)** to provide **secure, real-time, and 24×7 access** to **PM-JAY** services through **WhatsApp**.

Ayushman Sarathi enables beneficiaries to **check eligibility**, **apply for**, **download**, and **manage** their **Ayushman Card** using secure **Application Programming Interface (API)** integration.

Beneficiaries can complete **electronic Know Your Customer (e-KYC)**, **link Aadhaar**, **lock or unlock their Ayushman Card**, and apply for the **Ayushman Vaya Vandana Card** for senior citizens aged **70 years and above**.

The chatbot also allows users to **check wallet balance**, **view treatment history**, **search nearby empanelled hospitals**, **register and track grievances**, **request support callbacks**, and **submit discharge feedback**.

The initiative reduces the need to visit **Common Service Centres (CSCs)** or government offices for routine PM-JAY services, making healthcare services more accessible.

29. In 2026, who was appointed to serve as the Director General of the Bureau of Port Security (BoPS) during its transition period?

A.T.K. Ramachandran

B.Shyam Jagannathan

C.Rajesh Unni

D.Vivek Johri

E.Sanjay Bandopadhyay

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The **Government of India** has established the **Bureau of Port Security (BoPS)** under the **Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways** to strengthen maritime security.
BoPS will serve as the **apex regulatory authority** for the security of **ships, ports, and port infrastructure**, including protection against **cyber threats**.
The Bureau has been constituted through an **Official Gazette notification** and is modelled on the **Bureau of Civil Aviation Security (BCAS)**.
During the transition period, **Shyam Jagannathan**, **Director General of Maritime Administration (DGMA)**, will serve as the **Director General of BoPS**.
Detailed Explanation:
The **Government of India** has established the **Bureau of Port Security (BoPS)** under the **Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways** to strengthen maritime security.
BoPS will serve as the **apex regulatory authority** for the security of **ships, ports, and port infrastructure**, including protection against **cyber threats**.
The Bureau has been constituted through an **Official Gazette notification** and is modelled on the **Bureau of Civil Aviation Security (BCAS)**.
Initially, **BoPS** will function under the **Directorate General of Shipping**, which is being renamed as the **Directorate General of Maritime Administration (DGMA)**.
During the transition period, **Shyam Jagannathan**, **Director General of Maritime Administration (DGMA)**, will serve as the **Director General of BoPS**.
The Bureau will formulate **maritime security standards**, conduct **security inspections and audits**, monitor compliance with national and international regulations, and coordinate security-related information sharing.
A dedicated **Cyber Security Division** will safeguard **port information technology infrastructure**, prevent cyberattacks, and strengthen the cyber resilience of India's maritime sector.

30. In 2026, the inaugural trial run of the UAE's first Etihad Rail passenger train was conducted between which two locations?
A.Dubai and Sharjah
B.Abu Dhabi and Al Ain
C.Fujairah and Mohamed bin Zayed City Station, Abu Dhabi
D.Ras Al Khaimah and Dubai
E.Abu Dhabi and Ajman
Answer: C
Short Explanation:
The **United Arab Emirates (UAE)** successfully completed the inaugural trial run of the first **Etihad Rail passenger train** from **Fujairah to Mohamed bin Zayed City Station, Abu Dhabi**, marking a major milestone in the country's transport infrastructure.
The Etihad Rail passenger service represents the **UAE's first inter-emirate passenger**

railway network, designed to provide seamless rail connectivity across the emirates.

The trial run marks the beginning of final testing operations before the start of commercial passenger services.

Detailed Explanation:

The **United Arab Emirates (UAE)** successfully completed the inaugural trial run of the first **Etihad Rail passenger train** from **Fujairah to Mohamed bin Zayed City Station, Abu Dhabi**, marking a major milestone in the country's transport infrastructure.

The Etihad Rail passenger service represents the **UAE's first inter-emirate passenger railway network**, designed to provide seamless rail connectivity across the emirates.

The trial run marks the beginning of final testing operations before the start of commercial passenger services.

Regular passenger services on the Etihad Rail network will commence on **30 September 2026**, connecting **Abu Dhabi, Dubai, Al Dhaid, and Fujairah**.

The railway network will be expanded in phases, reaching the **Al Dhafra Region by December 2026** and **Sharjah by March 2027**.

The Etihad Rail project aims to strengthen the UAE's **integrated and sustainable transport system**, while reducing travel time and providing an efficient alternative to road transport.

Passengers during the trial journey reported smooth travel, modern amenities, comfortable services, and reliable performance, confirming the system's **operational readiness**

31. In 2026, along with the India–UK Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement (CETA), which agreement was scheduled to come into force on 15 July 2026?

A.Bilateral Investment Treaty (BIT)

B.Double Taxation Avoidance Agreement (DTAA)

C.Social Security Cooperation Agreement (SSCA)

D.Comprehensive Migration and Mobility Partnership (CMMP)

E.Double Contribution Convention (DCC)

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

Union Minister Piyush Goyal, Ministry of Commerce and Industry (MoCI), undertook a **3-day official visit to London, United Kingdom (UK)** from **25–27 June 2026**.

The visit was held ahead of the implementation of the **India–UK Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement (CETA)** and the **Double Contribution Convention (DCC)**, both scheduled to come into force on **15 July 2026**.

During the visit, Piyush Goyal held a high-level bilateral meeting with **Peter Kyle, UK Secretary of State for Business and Trade**, to discuss regulatory alignment, customs coordination, and the implementation of the India–UK CETA and DCC.

Detailed Explanation:

Union Minister Piyush Goyal, Ministry of Commerce and Industry (MoCI), undertook a **3-**

day official visit to London, United Kingdom (UK) from **25–27 June 2026**.

The visit was held ahead of the implementation of the **India–UK Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement (CETA)** and the **Double Contribution Convention (DCC)**, both scheduled to come into force on **15 July 2026**.

During the visit, Piyush Goyal held a high-level bilateral meeting with **Peter Kyle, UK Secretary of State for Business and Trade**, to discuss regulatory alignment, customs coordination, and the implementation of the India–UK CETA and DCC.

Piyush Goyal was honoured with the **Special Award for Exceptional Leadership in Elevating India–UK Relations** during the 10th anniversary of the **India Global Forum (IGF) UK-India Awards 2026** ceremony held in London.

During the visit, Piyush Goyal launched the **"UK–India CETA Business Utilisation Manual"**, a practical activation guide designed to help Indian and UK businesses effectively utilise the benefits of the India–UK CETA.

32. In 2026, who assumed charge as the Chief of Integrated Defence Staff to the Chairman Chiefs of Staff Committee (CISC)?

A.Air Marshal Ashutosh Dixit

B.Air Marshal Narmdeshwar Tiwari

C.Air Marshal Tejinder Singh

D.Air Marshal Jeetendra Mishra

E.Air Chief Marshal Amar Preet Singh

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

Air Marshal Tejinder Singh assumed charge as the **Chief of Integrated Defence Staff to the Chairman Chiefs of Staff Committee (CISC)** on **1 July 2026**.

He was commissioned into the **Fighter Stream of the Indian Air Force (IAF)** on **13 June 1987**.

He is a **Category 'A' Qualified Flying Instructor** with over **4,500 hours of flying experience**.

He has commanded a **Fighter Squadron**, a **Radar Station**, a premier **Fighter Base**, and served as **Air Officer Commanding (AOC), Jammu & Kashmir**.

Detailed Explanation:

Air Marshal Tejinder Singh assumed charge as the **Chief of Integrated Defence Staff to the Chairman Chiefs of Staff Committee (CISC)** on **1 July 2026**.

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He is a **Category 'A' Qualified Flying Instructor** with over **4,500 hours of flying experience**.

He has commanded a **Fighter Squadron**, a **Radar Station**, a premier **Fighter Base**, and served as **Air Officer Commanding (AOC), Jammu & Kashmir**.

Before becoming CISC, he served as the **Air Officer Commanding-in-Chief (AOC-in-C), South Western Air Command**.

His important staff appointments include Operational Staff at Command Headquarters, Air Commodore (Personnel Officers-1) at Air

Headquarters, Deputy Assistant Chief of Integrated Defence Staff, Financial (Planning) at HQ IDS, Air Commodore (Aerospace Safety), **Assistant Chief of Air Staff Operations (Offensive)**, Assistant Chief of Air Staff Operations (Strategy), Senior Air Staff Officer, Eastern Air Command, **Deputy Chief of the Air Staff**, and **AOC-in-C, Training Command**.

33. In 2026, who assumed the appointment of Vice Chief of the Army Staff (VCOAS)?

A.Lt Gen Pushpendra Singh

B.Lt Gen NS Raja Subramani

C.Lt Gen MV Suchindra Kumar

D.Lt Gen Sandeep Jain

E.Lt Gen Anindya Sengupta

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

Lt Gen Sandeep Jain, AVSM, SM assumed the appointment of **Vice Chief of the Army Staff (VCOAS)**.

Lt Gen Sandeep Jain is an alumnus of the **National Defence Academy (NDA)** and was commissioned into the **MAHAR Regiment** in **June 1988**.

Detailed Explanation:

Lt Gen Sandeep Jain, AVSM, SM assumed the appointment of **Vice Chief of the Army Staff (VCOAS)**.

Lt Gen Sandeep Jain is an alumnus of the **National Defence Academy (NDA)** and was commissioned into the **MAHAR Regiment** in **June 1988**.

He has nearly **four decades of distinguished military service**, holding numerous command and staff appointments across diverse operational environments.

He has commanded an **Infantry Battalion** in semi-desert terrain and also during the **United Nations Mission in South Sudan (UNMISS)**.

His command appointments include an **Infantry Brigade in a Strike Corps**, a **Counter Insurgency Force**, and a **Pivot Corps in Northern Command**.

34. In 2026, the Appointments Committee of the Cabinet (ACC) reappointed whom as the Chairman of the Central Board of Direct Taxes (CBDT) on a six-month contract basis?

A.Nitin Gupta

B.Ravi Agrawal

C.Tuhin Kanta Pandey

D.Sanjay Malhotra

E.Rajiv Kumar

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The **Appointments Committee of the Cabinet (ACC)** has reappointed **Ravi Agrawal** as the Chairman of the **Central Board of Direct Taxes (CBDT)** on a contract basis for six months, from **1 July 2026 to 31 December 2026**, or until further orders, whichever is earlier.

Ravi Agrawal was first appointed as CBDT Chairman in **June 2024**, succeeding **Nitin Gupta**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Appointments Committee of the Cabinet (ACC)** has reappointed **Ravi Agrawal** as the Chairman of the **Central Board of Direct Taxes (CBDT)** on a contract basis for six months, from **1 July 2026 to 31 December 2026**, or until further orders, whichever is earlier.

Ravi Agrawal was first appointed as CBDT Chairman in **June 2024**, succeeding **Nitin Gupta**.

His initial one-year tenure was extended by another year in **June 2025**, and has now been extended again through a **six-month contractual reappointment**.

The reappointment will be governed by the usual terms and conditions applicable to **re-employed Central Government officers**.

For this reappointment, the Government of India relaxed the relevant **Recruitment Rules**.

35. In 2026, who assumed charge as the Vice Chief of the Air Staff (VCAS) of the Indian Air Force on 1 July 2026?

A.Air Marshal Tejinder Singh

B.Air Marshal Nagesh Kapoor

C.Air Marshal Ashutosh Dixit

D.Air Chief Marshal Amar Preet Singh

E.Air Marshal Jeetendra Mishra

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

Air Marshal Ashutosh Dixit, PVSM, AVSM, VM, VSM assumed charge as the **Vice Chief of the Air Staff (VCAS), Indian Air Force (IAF)** on **1 July 2026**.

He succeeded **Air Marshal Nagesh Kapoor, SYSM, PVSM, AVSM, VM**, who superannuated on 30 June 2026 after 40 years of distinguished service.

Air Marshal Ashutosh Dixit was commissioned into the **Fighter Stream of the Indian Air Force** on **6 December 1986**.

Detailed Explanation:

Air Marshal Ashutosh Dixit, PVSM, AVSM, VM, VSM assumed charge as the **Vice Chief of the Air Staff (VCAS), Indian Air Force (IAF)** on **1 July 2026**.

He succeeded **Air Marshal Nagesh Kapoor, SYSM, PVSM, AVSM, VM**, who superannuated on 30 June 2026 after 40 years of distinguished service.

Air Marshal Ashutosh Dixit was commissioned into the **Fighter Stream of the Indian Air Force** on **6 December 1986**.

He is an alumnus of the **National Defence Academy (NDA)**, Defence Services Staff College (Bangladesh), and the **National Defence College (NDC)**.

He has over **3,500 hours of flying experience** and is an **Experimental Test Pilot** as well as a **Qualified Flying Instructor**.

He has flown several aircraft including **Mirage-2000, MiG variants, HPT-32, An-32, Avro, Kiran, Jaguar, IL-78, Hawk, and Tejas**.

During his nearly four decades of service, he actively participated in **Operation Safed Sagar, Operation Rakshak, Cope India, and Operation Sindoor**.

36. In 2026, what was the theme of the 30th edition of the Rim of the Pacific (RIMPAC) multinational maritime warfare exercise?

A.Partners: Integrated and Prepared

B.Strength Through Unity

C.Secure Seas, Shared Future

D.One Ocean, One Mission

E.Maritime Security for Peace

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

Indian Navy (IN) participated in the **30th edition of Rim of the Pacific (RIMPAC) 2026**, the world's largest multinational maritime warfare exercise, hosted by the **United States (US) Navy** under the U.S. Pacific Fleet at **Joint Base Pearl Harbor-Hickam (JBPHH)**, Hawaii,United States of America(USA).

RIMPAC 2026 is being conducted from **24 June to 31 July 2026** as a five-week biennial multinational maritime warfare exercise in and around the Hawaiian Islands.

The theme of RIMPAC 2026 is **"Partners: Integrated and Prepared"**, highlighting collective defence readiness, interoperability, and a shared commitment to a free, open and inclusive Indo-Pacific.

Detailed Explanation:

Indian Navy (IN) participated in the **30th edition of Rim of the Pacific (RIMPAC) 2026**, the world's largest multinational maritime warfare exercise, hosted by the **United States (US) Navy** under the U.S. Pacific Fleet at **Joint Base Pearl Harbor-Hickam (JBPHH)**, Hawaii,United States of America(USA).

RIMPAC 2026 is being conducted from **24 June to 31 July 2026** as a five-week biennial multinational maritime warfare exercise in and around the Hawaiian Islands.

The theme of RIMPAC 2026 is **"Partners: Integrated and Prepared"**, highlighting collective defence readiness, interoperability, and a shared commitment to a free, open and inclusive Indo-Pacific.

RIMPAC stands for Rim of the Pacific and is a **biennial maritime exercise** led by the United States Pacific Fleet, involving naval, air, and land forces from multiple countries.

RIMPAC 2026 witnessed participation from **30 nations**, with over **30 surface warships, 5 submarines, 15 national land forces, more than 206 aircraft, and over 30,000 military personnel**.

37. In 2026, the FCRA 2.0 Portal launched by Union Home Minister Amit Shah is hosted on which platform to enhance data security?

A.MeghRaj (National Government Cloud)

B.BharatNet

C.DigiLocker

D.UMANG Platform

E.National Knowledge Network (NKN)

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

Union Home Minister Amit Shah launched the **FCRA 2.0 Portal and e-OCI Card** in New Delhi to enhance digital governance, transparency, citizen convenience, and national security.

The initiatives align with **Prime Minister Narendra Modi's** vision of **"Minimum Government, Maximum Governance"** by promoting technology-driven, transparent, and efficient governance.

The FCRA 2.0 Portal is hosted on the **MeghRaj (National Government Cloud)**, significantly reducing the risk of data theft and improving data security.

Detailed Explanation:

Union Home Minister Amit Shah launched the **FCRA 2.0 Portal and e-OCI Card** in New Delhi to enhance digital governance, transparency, citizen convenience, and national security.

The initiatives align with **Prime Minister Narendra Modi's** vision of **"Minimum Government, Maximum Governance"** by promoting technology-driven, transparent, and efficient governance.

The FCRA 2.0 Portal has been developed to simplify compliance under the **Foreign Contribution (Regulation) Act (FCRA)** and strengthen the monitoring and enforcement of foreign contributions.

The new portal provides **end-to-end digital services** for FCRA registration, renewals, annual returns, and other applications, eliminating the need for physical document submission.

Around **14,500 active FCRA organisations** operate in India, while the portal handles approximately **15,000–20,000 applications and 17,000 annual returns** every year.

The FCRA 2.0 Portal is hosted on the **MeghRaj (National Government Cloud)**, significantly reducing the risk of data theft and improving data security.

38. In 2026, Union Minister Dr. Jitendra Singh inaugurated four Advanced R&D facilities and laid the foundation stone of a ₹44.46 crore hostel complex at which CSIR institute?

A.CSIR–National Chemical Laboratory (CSIR-NCL), Pune

B.CSIR–Central Drug Research Institute (CSIR-CDRI), Lucknow

C.CSIR–Indian Institute of Chemical Technology (CSIR-IICT), Hyderabad

D.CSIR–Central Leather Research Institute (CSIR-CLRI), Chennai

E.CSIR–National Environmental Engineering Research Institute (CSIR-NEERI), Nagpur

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

Union Minister Dr. Jitendra Singh inaugurated **four Advanced R&D facilities** and laid the foundation stone of a **₹44.46 crore, 200-student hostel complex** at **CSIR–Indian Institute of Chemical Technology (CSIR-IICT), Hyderabad**.

The four facilities inaugurated include the **Advanced R&D Facility for Fluorochemicals**, **Continuous Processing Platform for Industrial**

Chemicals, **Sustainable Engineering Complex (SustEC)**, and the **500 KLD Decentralized Effluent Treatment Plant for the Siripuram Handloom Cluster**.

The **₹44.46 crore hostel complex** will strengthen residential infrastructure for young researchers and promote a better research ecosystem.

Detailed Explanation:

Union Minister Dr. Jitendra Singh inaugurated **four Advanced R&D facilities** and laid the foundation stone of a **₹44.46 crore, 200-student hostel complex** at **CSIR–Indian Institute of Chemical Technology (CSIR-IICT), Hyderabad**.

The four facilities inaugurated include the **Advanced R&D Facility for Fluorochemicals**, **Continuous Processing Platform for Industrial Chemicals**, **Sustainable Engineering Complex (SustEC)**, and the **500 KLD Decentralized Effluent Treatment Plant for the Siripuram Handloom Cluster**.

The **₹44.46 crore hostel complex** will strengthen residential infrastructure for young researchers and promote a better research ecosystem.

The programme witnessed participation from scientists, industry representatives, startups, technology partners, research scholars, and students, highlighting the focus on **industry-academia collaboration**.

He highlighted CSIR's role in developing technologies such as **Compressed Biogas (CBG)** from food and agricultural waste and conversion of captured **Carbon Dioxide (CO_2)** into **Dimethyl Ether (DME)** to promote the circular economy and clean energy.

The **Advanced R&D Facility for Fluorochemicals** will strengthen India's indigenous fluorination technologies for pharmaceuticals, agrochemicals, specialty chemicals, refrigerants, electronic chemicals, and advanced materials.

39. In 2026, the Technology Development Board (TDB) provided financial assistance to M/s Puretronics India Private Limited for the commercialization of which indigenous technology?

A.Smart Industrial Robotics Platform

B.LMO – Load Magnetic Overload Sensor

C.AI-based Predictive Maintenance System

D.Indigenous LiDAR Sensor for Drones

E.High-Precision Optical Pressure Sensor

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The **Technology Development Board (TDB)** under the **Department of Science & Technology (DST)** has provided financial assistance to **M/s Puretronics India Private Limited, Mumbai** for the project **"LMO – Load Measurement Overload Sensor (India's First Fully Contactless Programmable Load Measurement System)"**.

The project aims to commercialize **India's first indigenous fully contactless programmable load measurement system**, bridging a critical

technology gap in India's industrial automation ecosystem.

The **LMO (Load Magnetic Overload Sensor)** is designed for elevators, material handling systems, cable machinery, industrial automation, cranes, hoists, and other safety-critical applications.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Technology Development Board (TDB)** under the **Department of Science & Technology (DST)** has provided financial assistance to **M/s Puretronics India Private Limited, Mumbai** for the project **"LMO – Load Measurement Overload Sensor (India's First Fully Contactless Programmable Load Measurement System)"**.

The project aims to commercialize **India's first indigenous fully contactless programmable load measurement system**, bridging a critical technology gap in India's industrial automation ecosystem.

The **LMO (Load Magnetic Overload Sensor)** is designed for elevators, material handling systems, cable machinery, industrial automation, cranes, hoists, and other safety-critical applications.

The technology addresses the limitations of conventional strain-gauge load cells and imported sensing solutions by providing accurate, maintenance-friendly, **vibration-resistant, and reliable load monitoring**.

The project supports the vision of **Aatmanirbhar Bharat** by strengthening India's indigenous capabilities in advanced industrial electronics and sensor technology.

The project will establish **commercial-scale manufacturing capabilities** for the LMO Load Magnetic Overload Sensor in India.

The LMO replaces mechanical stress-based sensing with an innovative **non-contact magnetic measurement principle**, improving efficiency and reliability.

40. In 2026, the Competition Commission of India (CCI) approved the all-cash acquisition of Royal Challengers Sports Pvt. Ltd. (RCSPL) for what amount?

A.₹12,500 crore

B.₹14,800 crore

C.₹15,250 crore

D.₹16,660 crore

E.₹18,000 crore

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The **Competition Commission of India (CCI)** has approved the **₹16,660 crore all-cash acquisition** of **Royal Challengers Sports Pvt. Ltd. (RCSPL)**, the owner of the **Royal Challengers Bengaluru (RCB)** franchises in both the Indian Premier League (IPL) and the Women's Premier League (WPL).

The acquiring consortium is led by the **Aditya Birla Group** and includes **The Times of India Group** (Times Internet Ltd. and Times Cricket), **Bolt Ventures**, Blackstone-backed **Asia Investment Topco II**, and **ICONIQ Group**.

Detailed Explanation:

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The acquiring consortium is led by the **Aditya Birla Group** and includes **The Times of India Group** (Times Internet Ltd. and Times Cricket), **Bolt Ventures**, Blackstone-backed **Asia Investment Topco II**, and **ICONIQ Group**.

The ₹16,660 crore transaction values RCB at approximately **USD 1.78 billion**, making it one of the **largest acquisitions of an IPL franchise**.

The acquisition reflects the **rapidly growing commercial value** of sports franchises and rising investor interest in India's sports ecosystem.

41. In 2026, under the Yamuna Water Project agreement, Rajasthan will receive approximately how much Yamuna River water as per the 1994 Upper Yamuna Basin MoU?

A.420 Million Cubic Metres (MCM)

B.500 Million Cubic Metres (MCM)

C.580 Million Cubic Metres (MCM)

D.650 Million Cubic Metres (MCM)

E.720 Million Cubic Metres (MCM)

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The **Governments of Rajasthan and Haryana** signed an agreement for the **Yamuna Water Project** in **New Delhi**.

Rajasthan will receive **about 580 Million Cubic Metres (MCM)** of water as per the **1994 Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) on the Sharing of the Utilisable Surface Waters of the Upper Yamuna Basin**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Governments of Rajasthan and Haryana** signed an agreement for the **Yamuna Water Project** in **New Delhi**.

The agreement was signed in the presence of **Union Minister for Home Affairs and Minister of Cooperation Amit Shah** to resolve the **nearly 30-year-old Yamuna water dispute** between the two states.

The project aims to supply **Rajasthan's allocated share of Yamuna River water** through an **underground pipeline network** from the **Western Yamuna Canal**.

The agreement provides a framework for **water allocation**, **infrastructure development**, **cost sharing**, **water release protocols**, **operation and maintenance**, **monitoring**, and **dispute resolution**.

42. In 2026, the Global Skills Challenge (GSC), where India won five medals, was held in which country?

A.Germany

B.Japan

C.Singapore

D.France

E.Australia

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

India won **five medals** at the **Global Skills Challenge (GSC) Australia 2026**, securing **three gold**, **one silver**, and **one bronze** medal.

The competition was held in **Australia**, with participation from **16 WorldSkills member countries**.

The **Global Skills Challenge (GSC)** is an international skill competition conducted as a **simulation of the WorldSkills Competition**, enabling participants to compete under global standards.

Detailed Explanation:

India won **five medals** at the **Global Skills Challenge (GSC) Australia 2026**, securing **three gold**, **one silver**, and **one bronze** medal.

The competition was held in **Australia**, with participation from **16 WorldSkills member countries**.

The **Global Skills Challenge (GSC)** is an international skill competition conducted as a **simulation of the WorldSkills Competition**, enabling participants to compete under global standards.

Nearly **600 competitors, experts, translators, and officials** participated in the event.

India's medal winners are:

Pavan Bhadravati Suresha (Karnataka) – **Gold** in **Additive Manufacturing**

Mausam Kumar Giri (Bihar) – **Gold** in **Cloud Computing**

Vishnupriya Sunil (Delhi) – **Gold** in **Health and Social Care**

Harsh Ramesh Pawar (Maharashtra) – **Silver** in **3D Digital Game Art**

Muskan (Haryana) – **Bronze** in **Painting and Decorating**

The Indian contingent comprised **30 members**, including **15 competitors** and **15 experts**, who participated in **15 skill categories**.

43. In 2026, World Sports Journalists Day is observed every year on which date?

A.1 July

B.2 July

C.5 July

D.7 July

E.10 July

Answer: B

World Sports Journalists Day is observed every year on **2 July** to recognise the contribution of **sports journalists** in promoting sports and delivering accurate sports coverage to the public.

The day was established in **1994** by the **International Sports Press Association (AIPS)** to commemorate the **70th anniversary** of the organisation.

The **International Sports Press Association (AIPS)** was founded on **2 July 1924** in **Paris, France**, during the **1924 Summer Olympics**.

44. In 2026, World UFO Day is observed annually on 2 July to raise awareness about which of the following?

A.Unmanned Flight Operations

B.Universal Flight Observations

C.United Federation of Observers

D.Unidentified Flying Objects

E.Unknown Foreign Operations

Answer: D

World UFO Day is observed every year on **2 July** to raise awareness about **Unidentified Flying Objects (UFOs)**, encourage scientific discussion on unexplained aerial phenomena, and promote the search for extraterrestrial life.

The day commemorates the **Roswell Incident** of **July 1947**, when debris recovered near **Roswell, New Mexico (United States)** was believed by many to be from a UFO, although the **United States Air Force** later stated it was part of a classified military project.

The term **UFO (Unidentified Flying Object)** was coined by **Edward J. Ruppelt**, a **United States Air Force** officer, in **1952**.

45. In 2026, the International Sports Press Association (AIPS), which established World Sports Journalists Day, is headquartered in which city?

A.Lausanne, Switzerland

B.Geneva, Switzerland

C.Paris, France

D.Zurich, Switzerland

E.Brussels, Belgium

Answer: A

About International Sports Press Association (AIPS)

Full Form: International Sports Press Association (AIPS)

Founded: 2 July 1924

Headquarters: Lausanne, Switzerland

46. In 2026, according to the Reserve Bank of India's Financial Stability Report (FSR), what was the Gross Non-Performing Asset (GNPA) ratio of Scheduled Commercial Banks (SCBs) in March 2026?

A.1.8%

B.2.4%

C.3.1%

D.3.8%

E.4.1%

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** released its **Financial Stability Report (FSR)**, highlighting **geopolitical fragmentation** and the rapid growth of **Artificial Intelligence (AI)** as major **emerging risks** to the global economy and financial system.

RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra stated that the **Indian economy remains resilient** despite global uncertainties, supported by strong economic growth, low inflation, healthy financial institution balance sheets, and **robust macroeconomic fundamentals**.

The **Gross Non-Performing Asset (GNPA) ratio** of Scheduled Commercial Banks

(SCBs) **declined to a multi-decade low of 1.8% in March 2026**, reflecting significant improvement in banking sector **asset quality**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** released its **Financial Stability Report (FSR)**, highlighting **geopolitical fragmentation** and the rapid growth of **Artificial Intelligence (AI)** as major **emerging risks** to the global economy and financial system.

RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra stated that the **Indian economy remains resilient** despite global uncertainties, supported by strong economic growth, low inflation, healthy financial institution balance sheets, and **robust macroeconomic fundamentals**.

The **Gross Non-Performing Asset (GNPA) ratio** of Scheduled Commercial Banks (SCBs) **declined to a multi-decade low of 1.8% in March 2026**, reflecting significant improvement in banking sector **asset quality**.

According to the **RBI stress tests**, the aggregate GNPA ratio of 46 major banks is **projected to increase marginally to 1.9% by March 2028 under the baseline scenario**.

Under **adverse stress scenarios**, the aggregate GNPA ratio of major banks could **rise to 3.8%–4.1% by March 2028**, indicating the banking system's **resilience even under severe stress conditions**.

47. In 2026, the Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (IRDAI) announced that BIMA Sugam, India's unified digital insurance marketplace, is expected to be launched by when?

A.June 2026

B.September 2026

C.December 2026

D.March 2027

E.January 2027

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (IRDAI) Chairman Ajay Seth announced that the **IRDAI** has approved **two new general insurance licences** following the Government of India's decision to allow **100% Foreign Direct Investment (FDI)** in the insurance sector.

IRDAI announced that **BIMA Sugam**, India's **unified digital insurance marketplace**, is expected to be launched by the **end of September 2026**.

Detailed Explanation:

The Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (IRDAI) Chairman Ajay Seth announced that the **IRDAI** has approved **two new general insurance licences** following the Government of India's decision to allow **100% Foreign Direct Investment (FDI)** in the insurance sector.

The **FDI limit** in the insurance sector was **increased from 74% to 100% under the automatic route** in the **Union Budget 2026–27**, encouraging greater foreign investment.

The enhanced **100% FDI policy** has attracted strong interest from **global insurance**

companies, enabling **foreign promoters to hold full ownership** in Indian insurance companies.

IRDAI has already approved **one proposal** allowing a foreign promoter to **significantly increase its stake** in an Indian insurer, while **another proposal is currently under regulatory examination**.

The increasing number of proposals reflects **rising confidence of foreign investors** in India's insurance sector.

IRDAI announced that **BIMA Sugam**, India's **unified digital insurance marketplace**, is expected to be launched by the **end of September 2026**.

In its **initial phase**, **BIMA Sugam** will offer **motor insurance, health insurance, and term insurance products**.

48. In 2026, Bank of Baroda signed a strategic partnership agreement with which foreign bank to strengthen cooperation in M&A financing, structured lending, and cross-border financing?

A.Sumitomo Mitsui Banking Corporation

B.Mitsubishi UFJ Bank

C.Mizuho Bank

D.DBS Bank

E.HSBC Bank

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

Bank of Baroda (BoB) and Japan's **Mizuho Bank** signed a **strategic partnership agreement** to strengthen cooperation in **Merger & Acquisition (M&A) financing**, **structured lending**, **cross-border financing**, and **corporate & investment banking services**.

The partnership was announced in **Mumbai on 30 June 2026**, marking a significant step towards enhancing **India–Japan banking collaboration**.

The collaboration combines **Mizuho Bank's global network, cross-border expertise, and structured finance capabilities** with **Bank of Baroda's strong domestic presence and deep corporate relationships** in India.

Detailed Explanation:

Bank of Baroda (BoB) and Japan's **Mizuho Bank** signed a **strategic partnership agreement** to strengthen cooperation in **Merger & Acquisition (M&A) financing**, **structured lending**, **cross-border financing**, and **corporate & investment banking services**.

The partnership was announced in **Mumbai on 30 June 2026**, marking a significant step towards enhancing **India–Japan banking collaboration**.

The collaboration combines **Mizuho Bank's global network, cross-border expertise, and structured finance capabilities** with **Bank of Baroda's strong domestic presence and deep corporate relationships** in India.

Under the agreement, both banks will **jointly originate, structure, co-underwrite, and syndicate acquisition financing** for both domestic and cross-border M&A transactions.

The partnership also includes **knowledge-sharing and capacity-building initiatives** in areas such as acquisition finance underwriting, transaction structuring, and inter-creditor arrangements.

Mizuho Financial Group is one of **Japan's largest financial institutions**, with operations across multiple international markets.

49. As of 2026, who has been appointed as the Chairperson of SEBI's Expert Working Group (EWG) constituted to review the regulatory framework governing Debenture Trustees?

A.Rajnish Kumar

B.Ananta Barua

C.Tuhin Kanta Pandey

D.Madhabi Puri Buch

E.Ajay Seth

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) constituted an **Expert Working Group (EWG)** at **New Delhi, Delhi** to review the regulatory framework governing **Debenture Trustees**.

The Expert Working Group (EWG) is **chaired by Ananta Barua**, Former SEBI Whole-Time Member (WTM), with **Rajnish Kumar**, Former Chairman of State Bank of India (SBI), serving as **Co-Chairperson**.

The committee will comprehensively review the **SEBI (Debenture Trustees) Regulations, 1993** in view of the evolving Indian debt market and increasing investor participation.

Detailed Explanation:

The Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) constituted an **Expert Working Group (EWG)** at **New Delhi, Delhi** to review the regulatory framework governing **Debenture Trustees**.

The Expert Working Group (EWG) is **chaired by Ananta Barua**, Former SEBI Whole-Time Member (WTM), with **Rajnish Kumar**, Former Chairman of State Bank of India (SBI), serving as **Co-Chairperson**.

The committee will comprehensively review the **SEBI (Debenture Trustees) Regulations, 1993** in view of the evolving Indian debt market and increasing investor participation.

The EWG will examine stakeholder representations, **review net-worth norms**, and recommend measures to **simplify, rationalise, and strengthen** the regulatory framework.

The review aims to align regulations with evolving debt market developments, **enhance investor protection**, and strengthen the **role, accountability, and functions of Debenture Trustees**.

SEBI stated that the review has become necessary due to major reforms such as the **Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code (IBC), 2016** and the rapid growth of India's **corporate bond market**.

50. In 2026, GST Day was observed by CGST Delhi South Commissionerate under which theme?

A.One Nation, One Tax, One Market

B.Transparent Taxation, Strong Economy

C.Simple Tax System, Strong Nation

D.Digital Tax System, Developed India

E.Tax Reforms, Prosperous India

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

CGST Delhi South Commissionerate observed **GST Day 2026** under the theme **"सुगम कर व्यवस्था, सशक्त राष्ट्र" (Simple Tax System, Strong Nation)**. The celebrations were organised as part of **GST Pakhwada 2026**, reaffirming the Commissionerate's commitment to **taxpayer facilitation** and **participative governance**. **Outreach programmes** were conducted by divisions including **Okhla, Connaught Place, and Vasant Kunj** to engage taxpayers and tax professionals, promote **GST awareness**, address concerns, and encourage **voluntary tax compliance**.

Detailed Explanation:

CGST Delhi South Commissionerate observed **GST Day 2026** under the theme **"सुगम कर व्यवस्था, सशक्त राष्ट्र" (Simple Tax System, Strong Nation)**. The celebrations were organised as part of **GST Pakhwada 2026**, reaffirming the Commissionerate's commitment to **taxpayer facilitation** and **participative governance**. **Outreach programmes** were conducted by divisions including **Okhla, Connaught Place, and Vasant Kunj** to engage taxpayers and tax professionals, promote **GST awareness**, address concerns, and encourage **voluntary tax compliance**.

The Commissionerate organised **'Samvad'**, an **Open Dialogue and Grievance-Redressal Session**, chaired by the **Commissioner, CGST Delhi South**, with participation from Additional, Deputy, and Assistant Commissioners.

The **'Samvad' session** was attended by representatives from the **Embassies of Iraq and Singapore**, trade associations, and stakeholders from the **hotel, aviation, transport, and construction sectors**.

During the programme, the Commissioner described taxpayers as **partners in financial nation-building**, while officers addressed the issues and suggestions raised by participants.

As part of the GST Day 2026 celebrations, **Certificates of Commendation** were awarded to **20 officers** across various ranks for their **exemplary service, professionalism**, and contribution to a transparent, robust, and **citizen-centric tax administration**.

51. In 2026, IRDAI granted a Certificate of Registration to Prudential HCL Health Insurance Limited to operate as which type of insurance company in India?

A.General Insurance Company

B.Life Insurance Company

C.Reinsurance Company

D.Standalone Health Insurance (SAHI) Company

E.Micro Insurance Company

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

IRDAI (Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India) granted a **Certificate of Registration** to **Prudential HCL Health Insurance Limited** to operate as a **Standalone Health Insurance (SAHI) Company** in India.

The approval was granted during the **136th Authority Meeting of IRDAI** held on **29 June 2026**.

Prudential HCL Health Insurance Limited is a **joint venture** between the UK-based **Prudential Group (70% stake)** and India's **HCL Group (30% stake)**.

The company combines **Prudential's global insurance expertise** with **HCL Group's domestic market presence** to strengthen India's health insurance sector.

Detailed Explanation:

IRDAI (Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India) granted a **Certificate of Registration** to **Prudential HCL Health Insurance Limited** to operate as a **Standalone Health Insurance (SAHI) Company** in India.

The approval was granted during the **136th Authority Meeting of IRDAI** held on **29 June 2026**.

Prudential HCL Health Insurance Limited is a **joint venture** between the UK-based **Prudential Group (70% stake)** and India's **HCL Group (30% stake)**.

The company combines **Prudential's global insurance expertise** with **HCL Group's domestic market presence** to strengthen India's health insurance sector.

With this approval, the **total number of Standalone Health Insurance (SAHI) Companies** operating in India has **increased to 8**.

This is the **third insurance licence** granted by IRDAI during the **calendar year 2026**, reflecting the regulator's focus on expanding the insurance industry.

The approval supports the Government's objective of **increasing insurance penetration**, **enhancing consumer choice**, and **promoting greater competition** in the health insurance market.

The registration follows the Government of India's decision to allow **100% Foreign Direct Investment (FDI)** in the insurance sector to attract global capital and expand insurance coverage.

52. In 2026, Punjab & Sind Bank launched which specialised savings account for Central and State Government employees during its 119th Foundation Day celebrations?

A.PSB Bharat Connect Account

B.PSB Salary Plus Account

C.PSB Employee Smart Account

D.PSB Governance Savings Account

E.PSB Samriddhi Account

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

Punjab & Sind Bank (PSB) celebrated its **119th Foundation Day** by launching **customer-centric digital banking initiatives**, a **new Vision & Mission Statement**, and **technology-driven banking solutions** at **New Delhi, Delhi**.

PSB Bharat Connect Account, a **specialised savings account** for **Central and State Government employees**, was launched with **customised banking benefits** and **digital banking services**.

Detailed Explanation:

Punjab & Sind Bank (PSB) celebrated its **119th Foundation Day** by launching **customer-centric digital banking initiatives**, a **new Vision & Mission Statement**, and **technology-driven banking solutions** at **New Delhi, Delhi**.

The event was attended by **Debashish Prusty** and **Hari Har Mishra** (Additional Secretaries, Department of Financial Services – DFS), **Ashish Madhorao** (Joint Secretary, DFS), and representatives from **National Housing Bank (NHB)**, **Industrial Finance Corporation of India (IFCI)**, **Life Insurance Corporation (LIC)**, and **Coal India Limited (CIL)**.

PSB unveiled a **new Vision & Mission Statement** to reinforce its commitment to **customer-centric banking**, **innovation**, **sustainable growth**, and **operational excellence**.

Navjyoti Mobile App, an **in-house Human Resources (HR) application**, was launched to streamline employee services, improve internal communication, and enhance workforce efficiency.

PSB Bharat Connect Account, a **specialised savings account** for **Central and State Government employees**, was launched with **customised banking benefits** and **digital banking services**.

53. In 2026, SBI Life Insurance signed an MoU with which institution to establish the "Bharat AI & Cyber Innovation Hub for Insurance"?

A.IIT Delhi

B.IIT Ahmedabad

C.IIT Madras

D.IIT Bombay

E.IISc Bengaluru

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

SBI Life Insurance Company Limited signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** with the **Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) Bombay**, Mumbai, Maharashtra, to establish the **"Bharat AI & Cyber Innovation Hub for Insurance."**

The **Bharat AI & Cyber Innovation Hub for Insurance** is a **joint research and innovation centre** aimed at developing **indigenous AI-**

powered cyber defence systems and **deep-technology solutions** for the insurance sector.
The MoU was signed by **Prof. S.V. Kulkarni** (Dean – Research & Development, IIT Bombay) and **Vishal Bhati** (Chief Information and Digital Officer, SBI Life Insurance).
Detailed Explanation:
SBI Life Insurance Company Limited signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** with the **Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) Bombay**, Mumbai, Maharashtra, to establish the **"Bharat AI & Cyber Innovation Hub for Insurance."**
The **Bharat AI & Cyber Innovation Hub for Insurance** is a **joint research and innovation centre** aimed at developing **indigenous AI-powered cyber defence systems** and **deep-technology solutions** for the insurance sector.
The MoU was signed by **Prof. S.V. Kulkarni** (Dean – Research & Development, IIT Bombay) and **Vishal Bhati** (Chief Information and Digital Officer, SBI Life Insurance).
The innovation hub will undertake joint research in **Artificial Intelligence (AI), Cyber Security, Quantum Technologies**, and **digital/next-generation insurance systems**.
The collaboration will focus on **executive education, talent development, strategic consulting, innovation incubation**, and **collaborative research** between academia and industry.
The initiative aims to build India's **indigenous deep-technology cyber defence capabilities**, reduce dependence on imported security frameworks, and **strengthen the protection of customer data** in the insurance sector.
The project supports the vision of **Atmanirbhar Bharat** by enhancing India's **institutional capacity to tackle emerging digital threats** in the financial and insurance sectors.

54. In 2026, consider the following statements regarding the Viksit Bharat – Guarantee for Rozgar and Ajeevika Mission (Gramin) [VB-G RAM G] Act, 2025:

1. **It came into force across India from 1 July 2026.**
2. **The Act increased the statutory wage employment guarantee from 100 days to 125 days for every eligible rural household.**
3. **The Act gives priority to water conservation, natural resource management, agriculture, and allied activities.**

Which of the above statements are correct?

A.1 only
B.2 and 3 only
C.1 and 3 only
D.All are correct
E.1 and 2 only

Answer: D

Short Explanation:
The **Viksit Bharat – Guarantee for Rozgar and Ajeevika Mission (Gramin) (VB-G RAM G) Act, 2025** comes into force across India from **1 July 2026**.

The Act strengthens the rural employment framework by increasing the **statutory wage employment guarantee from 100 days to 125 days** for every eligible rural household.

Priority to **water conservation**, **natural resource management**, **agriculture**, and **allied activities**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Viksit Bharat – Guarantee for Rozgar and Ajeevika Mission (Gramin) (VB-G RAM G) Act, 2025** comes into force across India from **1 July 2026**.

The Act strengthens the rural employment framework by increasing the **statutory wage employment guarantee from 100 days to 125 days** for every eligible rural household.

Ahead of the nationwide rollout, **Union Minister for Agriculture and Farmers Welfare and Rural Development Shivraj Singh Chouhan** stated that no eligible rural worker should remain without employment even for a single day.

The Act aims to enhance **livelihood security**, create **durable community assets**, strengthen **village economies**, and promote **sustainable rural development** under the vision of **Viksit Bharat @2047**.

Key features of the Act include:

Increase in guaranteed wage employment from **100 days to 125 days**.

Greater focus on **durable community asset creation**.

Priority to **water conservation**, **natural resource management**, **agriculture**, and **allied activities**.

Strengthening of **rural infrastructure** and village development.

Enhanced participation of **Self-Help Groups** to promote women's empowerment.

Technology-enabled implementation for greater transparency and accountability.

Increased convergence with other flagship rural development programmes.

The **Central Government** has made an **interim allocation of ₹95,692.31 crore** to **States and Union Territories** for implementation.

55. In 2025, consider the following statements regarding India's unemployment rate as reported by the National Statistics Office (NSO):

1. **India's unemployment rate declined to 3.1% in 2025, the lowest level in the last eight years.**
2. **Arunachal Pradesh recorded the highest urban female unemployment rate in 2025.**
3. **Bihar's urban female unemployment rate declined from 16.8% in 2017–18 to 6.2% in 2025.**

Which of the above statements are correct?

A.1 and 2 only

B.2 and 3 only

C.1 and 3 only

D.1, 2 and 3

E.1 only

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

India's unemployment rate declined to **3.1% in 2025**, the **lowest level in the last eight years**, according to the **National Statistics Office (NSO)**.

States with the highest urban female unemployment (2025):

Arunachal Pradesh: 18.4%

Himachal Pradesh: 18.3%

Bihar recorded one of the sharpest increases in urban female unemployment, rising from **6.2%** to **16.8%**, despite a decline in its overall unemployment rate.

Detailed Explanation:

India's unemployment rate declined to **3.1% in 2025**, the **lowest level in the last eight years**, according to the **National Statistics Office (NSO)**.

The unemployment rate has steadily declined since **2017–18**, reflecting improvements in **employment generation**, **economic recovery**, and **labour market participation**.

The decline supports India's commitment to achieving **full and productive employment by 2030** under the **Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs)**.

However, employment outcomes continue to vary across **states** and **demographic groups**, particularly among **urban women**.

India's **urban female unemployment rate** declined from **10.8% in 2017–18** to **6.4% in 2025**, though several states continue to record high female unemployment.

States with the highest urban female unemployment (2025):

Arunachal Pradesh: 18.4%

Himachal Pradesh: 18.3%

Bihar: 16.8%

Nagaland: 15.7%

Rajasthan: 14.6%

Bihar recorded one of the sharpest increases in urban female unemployment, rising from **6.2%** to **16.8%**, despite a decline in its overall unemployment rate.

56. In 2026, the Government of India directed Meta to temporarily pause the rollout of which WhatsApp feature in India?

A.WhatsApp Channels

B.WhatsApp Username feature

C.WhatsApp Pay

D.WhatsApp Communities

E.WhatsApp AI Assistant

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The **Government of India** has directed **Meta** to **temporarily pause the rollout of the WhatsApp Username feature** in India.

The Centre has asked Meta to submit a **detailed explanation within three days** regarding the feature's functioning, privacy safeguards, security measures, and regulatory compliance.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Government of India** has directed **Meta** to **temporarily pause the rollout of the WhatsApp Username feature** in India.

The Centre has asked Meta to submit a **detailed explanation within three days** regarding the feature's functioning, privacy safeguards, security measures, and regulatory compliance.

Until consultations are completed, **Meta has been instructed not to introduce the feature in India**.

The proposed **WhatsApp Username feature** will allow users to connect **without sharing their mobile phone numbers**, using **unique usernames** instead.

The feature aims to **enhance user privacy**, reduce the need to share personal phone numbers, and provide an alternative way to discover and contact users.

57. In 2026, what was the net worth of MECON Limited as on 31 March 2026, which supported its grant of Miniratna Category-I status?

A.₹425.18 crore

B.₹725.30 crore

C.₹612.75 crore

D.₹480.90 crore

E.₹535.42 crore

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

The **Ministry of Steel** has granted **Miniratna Category-I** status to **MECON Limited**, marking a significant milestone for one of India's leading engineering and consultancy **Central Public Sector Enterprises (CPSEs)**.

The recognition highlights MECON's **consistent financial performance**, including **continuous profitability during the last three financial years** and a **net worth of ₹535.42 crore** as on **31 March 2026**.

The **Ministry of Steel** approved the grant of **Miniratna Category-I** status on **1 July 2026**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Ministry of Steel** has granted **Miniratna Category-I** status to **MECON Limited**, marking a significant milestone for one of India's leading engineering and consultancy **Central Public Sector Enterprises (CPSEs)**.

The recognition highlights MECON's **consistent financial performance**, including **continuous profitability during the last three financial years** and a **net worth of ₹535.42 crore** as on **31 March 2026**.

The **Ministry of Steel** approved the grant of **Miniratna Category-I** status on **1 July 2026**.

MECON Limited is a **Schedule 'A' Central Public Sector Enterprise (CPSE)** under the administrative control of the **Ministry of Steel**.

It was established in **1959** and is headquartered in **Ranchi, Jharkhand**.

MECON is one of India's premier organisations in:

Engineering

Consultancy

Project Management

Contracting

The company was initially established to support the development of India's **steel industry** and has since diversified into several strategic sectors.

The **Department of Public Enterprises (DPE)** grants **Miniratna** status to eligible **Central Public Sector Enterprises (CPSEs)** based on their financial performance and operational efficiency.

58. In 2026, what is Swar Prerna Veethika, launched by Akashvani as part of its 90th anniversary celebrations?

A.A national music competition for young artists

B.A permanent photo gallery dedicated to India's legendary musicians

C.A digital radio archive of classical performances

D.A scholarship scheme for music students

E.A new Akashvani music channel

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

As **Akashvani** completes **90 years of public service broadcasting**, it has launched **Swar Prerna Veethika**, a **permanent photo gallery** dedicated to India's legendary musicians.

The initiative was inaugurated by **Padma Vibhushan Pandit Hariprasad Chaurasia** at the **Akashvani Rang Bhavan Auditorium, New Delhi**.

The gallery celebrates **Akashvani's contribution to preserving and promoting Indian music** and forms part of its **year-long 90th anniversary celebrations**.

The initiative also marks the beginning of preparations for the **centenary of radio broadcasting in India in 2027**.

Detailed Explanation:

As **Akashvani** completes **90 years of public service broadcasting**, it has launched **Swar Prerna Veethika**, a **permanent photo gallery** dedicated to India's legendary musicians.

The initiative was inaugurated by **Padma Vibhushan Pandit Hariprasad Chaurasia** at the **Akashvani Rang Bhavan Auditorium, New Delhi**.

The gallery celebrates **Akashvani's contribution to preserving and promoting Indian music** and forms part of its **year-long 90th anniversary celebrations**.

The initiative also marks the beginning of preparations for the **centenary of radio broadcasting in India in 2027**.

Swar Prerna Veethika is a specially curated photo gallery established to honour legendary musicians who have enriched India's musical heritage through their association with **Akashvani**.

It pays tribute to artists who have been closely associated with the broadcaster and have received some of **India's highest civilian honours**.

The gallery aims to inspire **aspiring musicians, researchers, music enthusiasts, and future generations** by preserving their legacy.

During the inauguration, **Pandit Hariprasad Chaurasia** described the occasion as a **"homecoming"**.

59. In 2026, Sunil Bharti Mittal received the Leadership Award from which organisation?

A.US-India Strategic Partnership Forum (USISPF)

B.US-India Business Council (USIBC)

C.Confederation of Indian Industry (CII)

D.World Economic Forum (WEF)

E.Federation of Indian Chambers of Commerce and Industry (FICCI)

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

Sunil Bharti Mittal, Founder and Chairman of **Bharti Enterprises**, received the **2026 Leadership Award** from the **US-India Strategic Partnership Forum (USISPF)**.

He was honoured for his **outstanding contribution to strengthening economic and commercial ties between India and North America**.

The award was presented during the **9th US-India Strategic Partnership Forum (USISPF) Annual Leadership Summit** held in **Washington, D.C., United States**.

Detailed Explanation:

Sunil Bharti Mittal, Founder and Chairman of **Bharti Enterprises**, received the **2026 Leadership Award** from the **US-India Strategic Partnership Forum (USISPF)**.

He was honoured for his **outstanding contribution to strengthening economic and commercial ties between India and North America**.

The award was presented during the **9th US-India Strategic Partnership Forum (USISPF) Annual Leadership Summit** held in **Washington, D.C., United States**.

The summit brought together senior government officials, policymakers, business leaders, and industry representatives from India and the United States.

The event also marked the growing **India-United States commercial partnership** ahead of the **250th Independence Day of the United States**.

The **US-India Strategic Partnership Forum (USISPF) Leadership Award** recognises individuals who have made exceptional contributions to strengthening **economic, commercial, and strategic relations between India and the United States**.

60. In 2026, who assumed charge as the Chairman and Managing Director (CMD) of Hindustan Copper Limited (HCL)?

A.Sanjiv Kumar Singh

B.Rajesh Verma

C.Pankaj Kumar

D.Arun Kumar Shukla

E.Anupam Misra

Answer: E

Anupam Misra assumed charge as the **Chairman and Managing Director (CMD)** of **Hindustan Copper Limited (HCL)**.

Anupam Misra succeeded **Sanjiv Kumar Singh**, who **superannuated on 30 June 2026**.

He holds a **B.Tech. (Hons.) in Civil Engineering from IIT Kharagpur**, a **PGDM from IIM Lucknow**, and has

completed **Executive Programmes at IIM Ahmedabad and IIM Calcutta**.

Anupam Misra is a management professional with over **33 years of experience** in **marketing, international trade, and business development**.

61. In 2026, Mediterranean Shipping Company (MSC) Group announced the acquisition of what percentage stake in Adani Vizhinjam Port Pvt. Ltd. (AVPPL)?

A.26%

B.39%

C.49%

D.51%

E.74%

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

Switzerland-based **Mediterranean Shipping Company (MSC) Group**, the **world's largest container shipping company**, will acquire a **49% stake** in **Adani Vizhinjam Port Pvt. Ltd. (AVPPL)** for **US$1.397 billion (around ₹13,220 crore)**, subject to regulatory approvals.

The investment will be made through **Terminal Investment Ltd. (TiL)**, the **port operating and investment arm** of the MSC Group.

The transaction values **Adani Vizhinjam Port Pvt. Ltd. (AVPPL)** at approximately **US$2.85 billion (around ₹26,960 crore)**, making it one of the **largest foreign investments** in India's port sector.

Detailed Explanation:

Switzerland-based **Mediterranean Shipping Company (MSC) Group**, the **world's largest container shipping company**, will acquire a **49% stake** in **Adani Vizhinjam Port Pvt. Ltd. (AVPPL)** for **US$1.397 billion (around ₹13,220 crore)**, subject to regulatory approvals.

The investment will be made through **Terminal Investment Ltd. (TiL)**, the **port operating and investment arm** of the MSC Group.

The transaction values **Adani Vizhinjam Port Pvt. Ltd. (AVPPL)** at approximately **US$2.85 billion (around ₹26,960 crore)**, making it one of the **largest foreign investments** in India's port sector.

The deal is regarded as the **largest foreign private investment** in India's domestic port infrastructure.

Adani Ports and Special Economic Zone Limited (APSEZ) and **TiL** have signed the agreement to strengthen **Vizhinjam International Seaport** as a major **transshipment gateway** in the **Indian Ocean Region**.

Vizhinjam International Seaport, located in **Kerala**, is strategically situated just **10 nautical miles** from the **East–West international shipping route**, providing a significant geographical advantage.

62. In 2026, the Competition Commission of India (CCI) approved the acquisition of how many Special Purpose Vehicles (SPVs) by Anantam Highways Trust (InvIT)?

A.5

B.6

C.7

D.8

E.9

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The Competition Commission of India (CCI) approved the proposed combination involving the **acquisition of seven Special Purpose Vehicles (SPVs)** by **Anantam Highways Trust (InvIT)** and the **issuance of InvIT units** to **Build India Infrastructure Fund (BIIF)**, **Dilip Buildcon Limited (DBL)**, and **DBL Infraventures Pvt. Ltd. (DIPL)**.

Detailed Explanation:

The Competition Commission of India (CCI) approved the proposed combination involving the **acquisition of seven Special Purpose Vehicles (SPVs)** by **Anantam Highways Trust (InvIT)** and the **issuance of InvIT units** to **Build India Infrastructure Fund (BIIF)**, **Dilip Buildcon Limited (DBL)**, and **DBL Infraventures Pvt. Ltd. (DIPL)**.

The **seven SPVs** involved in the transaction are **DAK Package I Expressway Pvt. Ltd.**, **Bethamangala Expressway Pvt. Ltd.**, **Katra Expressway Pvt. Ltd.**, **Raipur-Visakhapatnam-CG-2 Highways Ltd.**, **Bangarupalem Gudipala Highways Ltd.**, **Poondiyankuppam Highways Ltd.**, and **Mehgama-Hansdiha Highways Ltd.**

The proposed combination includes

(a) **acquisition of the shareholding of seven SPVs by Anantam Highways Trust (InvIT)** and

(b) **issuance of InvIT units to BIIF, DBL, and DIPL**.

63. In 2026, India's first Satellite-Based Landing System (SLS) approach on a commercial jet aircraft was demonstrated at which airport?

A.Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel International Airport, Ahmedabad

B.Maharana Pratap Airport, Udaipur

C.Jaipur International Airport, Jaipur

D.Devi Ahilya Bai Holkar Airport, Indore

E.Kushok Bakula Rimpochee Airport, Leh

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The **Directorate General of Civil Aviation (DGCA)** under the **Ministry of Civil Aviation (MoCA)** successfully conducted **India's first Satellite-Based Landing System (SLS) approach** on a commercial jet aircraft using an **IndiGo Airbus A320** at **Maharana Pratap Airport, Udaipur, Rajasthan**.

The demonstration used **GAGAN (GPS Aided GEO Augmented Navigation)**, India's **indigenous Satellite-Based Augmentation System (SBAS)**, marking a major milestone in satellite-guided precision landings in India.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Directorate General of Civil Aviation (DGCA)** under the **Ministry of Civil Aviation (MoCA)** successfully conducted **India's first Satellite-Based Landing System (SLS) approach** on a commercial jet aircraft using

an **IndiGo Airbus A320** at **Maharana Pratap Airport, Udaipur, Rajasthan**.

The demonstration used **GAGAN (GPS Aided GEO Augmented Navigation)**, India's **indigenous Satellite-Based Augmentation System (SBAS)**, marking a major milestone in satellite-guided precision landings in India.

The approach was carried out using **Localiser Performance with Vertical Guidance (LPV) technology**, which provides both **lateral (left-right) and vertical (up-down) guidance** to the runway.

LPV offers landing precision comparable to an **Instrument Landing System (ILS)** but **does not require specialised ground-based equipment** to be installed at the airport.

At present, **23 LPV approaches have been published** across India, and the number is **expected to exceed 40 by the end of the year**.

64. In 2026, the Ministry of Tourism signed an MoU with which company to enhance the digital visibility of India's tourism destinations?

A.Google

B.Microsoft

C.Meta

D.Amazon

E.Infosys

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

The **Ministry of Tourism** signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** with **Google India Private Limited** in **New Delhi** to enhance the **digital visibility of India's tourism destinations**.

The MoU was signed in the presence of **Union Minister of Tourism and Culture Gajendra Singh Shekhawat**.

The partnership aims to leverage **Artificial Intelligence (AI)**, **digital technologies**, **data-driven insights**, and **capacity building** to attract more **domestic and international tourists**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Ministry of Tourism** signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** with **Google India Private Limited** in **New Delhi** to enhance the **digital visibility of India's tourism destinations**.

The MoU was signed in the presence of **Union Minister of Tourism and Culture Gajendra Singh Shekhawat**.

The partnership aims to leverage **Artificial Intelligence (AI)**, **digital technologies**, **data-driven insights**, and **capacity building** to attract more **domestic and international tourists**.

The collaboration seeks to promote India's **cultural, historical, spiritual, and natural attractions** through Google's digital ecosystem.

The MoU focuses on improving the **online discoverability** of tourism destinations and

enhancing **visitor engagement** through innovative digital solutions.

The partnership is **non-commercial**, **non-binding**, **non-exclusive**, and involves **no financial commitment** from either party.

65. As of 2026, International Plastic Bag Free Day is observed every year on 3 July. Which country became the first in the world to ban thin single-use plastic bags?

A.Sweden

B.Bangladesh

C.Germany

D.Japan

E.South Africa

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

International Plastic Bag Free Day is observed every year on **3 July** to encourage people to reduce the use of **single-use plastic bags** and help eliminate **plastic pollution**.

In **2015**, the **European Union** adopted directives to reduce the consumption of **single-use plastic bags**.

Bangladesh became the **first country to ban thin single-use plastic bags**.

Detailed Explanation:

International Plastic Bag Free Day is observed every year on **3 July** to encourage people to reduce the use of **single-use plastic bags** and help eliminate **plastic pollution**.

The day spreads awareness that a **plastic bag-free world is possible** by promoting sustainable and environmentally friendly alternatives.

The initiative was established by the **Bag Free World** organisation, which launched campaigns promoting a plastic-free world.

The **first International Plastic Bag Free Day** was observed on **3 July 2008**, initiated by **Rezero**, a member of **Zero Waste Europe**.

In **2015**, the **European Union** adopted directives to reduce the consumption of **single-use plastic bags**.

Bangladesh became the **first country to ban thin single-use plastic bags**.

66. In July 2026, which bank partnered with NPCI and JP Morgan Payments to provide real-time Foreign Exchange (FX) rates for cross-border UPI transactions?

A.ICICI Bank

B.HSBC India

C.Axis Bank

D.Standard Chartered Bank

E.HDFC Bank

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI) partnered with **HSBC India** and **JP Morgan Payments** to enable **real-time Foreign Exchange (FX) settlement** for **cross-border Unified Payments Interface (UPI)** transactions.

The initiative aims to improve the **international payment experience** by providing **greater transparency, faster settlement**, and **real-time currency conversion** for Indian users.

Under the partnership, **HSBC India** will serve as the **banking partner**, providing **real-time Foreign Exchange (FX) rates** through direct **Application Programming Interface (API)** integration.

HSBC India's global banking network will support secure, **24×7 cross-border transactions**, making overseas UPI payments faster and more efficient.

JP Morgan Payments will facilitate **real-time FX conversion** and **multi-currency settlement**, enhancing the efficiency of international digital payments.

Detailed Explanation:

National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI) partnered with **HSBC India** and **JP Morgan Payments** to enable **real-time Foreign Exchange (FX) settlement** for **cross-border Unified Payments Interface (UPI)** transactions.

The initiative aims to improve the **international payment experience** by providing **greater transparency, faster settlement**, and **real-time currency conversion** for Indian users.

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HSBC India's global banking network will support secure, **24×7 cross-border transactions**, making overseas UPI payments faster and more efficient.

JP Morgan Payments will facilitate **real-time FX conversion** and **multi-currency settlement**, enhancing the efficiency of international digital payments.

The collaboration combines **UPI's expanding global acceptance** with **JP Morgan's foreign exchange expertise** to simplify international payment settlements.

Indian users making payments abroad will be able to view the **exact payment amount in Indian Rupees (INR)** before confirming the transaction.

Overseas merchants will continue to receive payments in their **local currencies**, while Indian customers pay directly from their **Indian bank accounts**.

The initiative eliminates the need to rely solely on cash or international credit/debit cards for payments abroad.

UPI is currently accepted in 9 countries: Singapore, United Arab Emirates (UAE), Nepal, Bhutan, Mauritius, France, Sri Lanka, Qatar, and **Cambodia**.

NPCI International Payments Limited (NIPL) recently partnered with **ACLEDA Bank Plc** to launch **UPI acceptance in Cambodia**.

UPI is further expanding its international presence to countries such as **Japan, Maldives, and Greece** through **NPCI International (NIPL)**.

67. As of 2026, the concluding National Awareness Programme of 'Nasha Mukt Bharat Saptah' was held at which institution in Haridwar, Uttarakhand, under the leadership of Union Minister Dr. Virendra Kumar?

A.Gurukula Kangri Vishwavidyalaya
B.Dev Sanskriti Vishwavidyalaya (DSVV)
C.IIT Roorkee
D.Hemvati Nandan Bahuguna Garhwal University
E.Uttarakhand Ayurved University
Answer: B
Short Explanation:
Union Minister for Social Justice and Empowerment Dr. Virendra Kumar led the concluding **National Awareness Programme** of **'Nasha Mukt Bharat Saptah'**, held at **Dev Sanskriti Vishwavidyalaya (DSVV), Haridwar, Uttarakhand**.
The programme was organised to commemorate the **International Day Against Drug Abuse and Illicit Trafficking**, observed annually on **26 June**.
The week-long campaign was conducted under the theme **"Nasha Mukt Bharat Abhiyaan – Viksit Bharat Ki Pehchaan."**
Detailed Explanation:
Union Minister for Social Justice and Empowerment Dr. Virendra Kumar led the concluding **National Awareness Programme** of **'Nasha Mukt Bharat Saptah'**, held at **Dev Sanskriti Vishwavidyalaya (DSVV), Haridwar, Uttarakhand**.
The programme was organised to commemorate the **International Day Against Drug Abuse and Illicit Trafficking**, observed annually on **26 June**.
The week-long campaign was conducted under the theme **"Nasha Mukt Bharat Abhiyaan – Viksit Bharat Ki Pehchaan."**
At the Haridwar event, **Dr. Virendra Kumar** led a **'Nasha Mukt Rally'** with the participation of nearly **4,000 citizens**.
He also administered the **'Pledge Against Drug Abuse'** and the **'Ageing with Dignity Pledge'**.
A key highlight of the programme was the signing of **Memorandums of Understanding (MoUs)** between the **Department of Social Justice and Empowerment** and the **All World Gayatri Pariwar**.

68. Under the newly notified Employees' Provident Fund (EPF) Scheme, 2026, what minimum balance must an EPFO member retain in the EPF account before making a partial withdrawal?
A.10% of the EPF balance
B.20% of the EPF balance
C.25% of the EPF balance
D.30% of the EPF balance
E.50% of the EPF balance
Answer: C
Short Explanation:
The **Central Government** has notified the **Employees' Provident Fund (EPF) Scheme, 2026**, introducing significant changes to the **partial withdrawal rules** for members of the **Employees' Provident Fund Organisation (EPFO)**.
The revised scheme came into effect on **29 June 2026**.

The scheme introduces a **minimum balance requirement**, expands the list of **eligible purposes for partial withdrawals**, and supports the Government's **digital transformation** initiatives.

Under the new rules, EPFO members must retain at least **25% of the balance** in their **Employees' Provident Fund (EPF)** account before making any partial withdrawal.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Central Government** has notified the **Employees' Provident Fund (EPF) Scheme, 2026**, introducing significant changes to the **partial withdrawal rules** for members of the **Employees' Provident Fund Organisation (EPFO)**.

The revised scheme came into effect on **29 June 2026**.

The scheme introduces a **minimum balance requirement**, expands the list of **eligible purposes for partial withdrawals**, and supports the Government's **digital transformation** initiatives.

Under the new rules, EPFO members must retain at least **25% of the balance** in their **Employees' Provident Fund (EPF)** account before making any partial withdrawal.

The minimum balance requirement applies to both **employee contributions** and **employer contributions**.

For example, if the eligible EPF balance is **₹1 lakh**, the member must retain **₹25,000**, while up to **₹75,000** can be withdrawn, subject to the prescribed conditions.

69. Under the Viksit Bharat – Guarantee for Rozgar and Ajeevika Mission (Gramin) Act, 2025, which came into force from 1 July 2026, the statutory wage employment guarantee for every eligible rural household has been increased to how many days?

A.115 days

B.110 days

C.120 days

D.125 days

E.150 days

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

Union Minister for Agriculture and Farmers Welfare and Rural Development Shivraj Singh Chouhan launched the **Viksit Bharat – Guarantee for Rozgar and Ajeevika Mission (Gramin) [VB-G RAM (G)]** from **Mukkavaripalli village, Tirupati district, Andhra Pradesh**.

The mission is being implemented under the **Viksit Bharat – Guarantee for Rozgar and Ajeevika Mission (Gramin) Act, 2025**, which came into force from **1 July 2026**.

The Act increases the **statutory wage employment guarantee from 100 days to 125 days** per financial year for every eligible rural household.

Detailed Explanation:

Union Minister for Agriculture and Farmers Welfare and Rural Development Shivraj Singh Chouhan launched the **Viksit Bharat –**

Guarantee for Rozgar and Ajeevika Mission (Gramin) [VB-G RAM (G)] from **Mukkavaripalli village, Tirupati district, Andhra Pradesh**.

The launch event was attended by **Andhra Pradesh Chief Minister N. Chandrababu Naidu** and **Deputy Chief Minister Pawan Kalyan**.

The mission is being implemented under the **Viksit Bharat – Guarantee for Rozgar and Ajeevika Mission (Gramin) Act, 2025**, which came into force from **1 July 2026**.

The Act increases the **statutory wage employment guarantee from 100 days to 125 days** per financial year for every eligible rural household.

Employment will be provided to adults willing to undertake **unskilled manual work**, and workers will continue to receive **unemployment allowance** if employment is not provided within the prescribed time.

The scheme replaces the earlier framework of the **Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act (MGNREGA)** with an expanded rural employment and livelihood programme.

70. In July 2026, which police force launched 'Operation Surakshit Cyberspace' to strengthen cyber safety for women and children?

A.Maharashtra Police

B.Gujarat Police

C.Rajasthan Police

D.Uttar Pradesh Police

E.Madhya Pradesh Police

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Gujarat Police launched **'Operation Surakshit Cyberspace'**, a **28-day statewide campaign**, from **1 July to 28 July 2026** to strengthen cyber safety for **women and children**.

The campaign combines **technology-driven policing**, **cyber awareness programmes**, **victim outreach**, and **coordinated enforcement** to prevent cybercrimes.

The initiative is being implemented under the guidance of **Director General of Police G.S. Malik** and coordinated by the **Criminal Investigation Department (CID) Crime–Women Cell**.

Detailed Explanation:

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The campaign combines **technology-driven policing**, **cyber awareness programmes**, **victim outreach**, and **coordinated enforcement** to prevent cybercrimes.

The initiative is being implemented under the guidance of **Director General of Police G.S. Malik** and coordinated by the **Criminal Investigation Department (CID) Crime–Women Cell**.

The campaign aims to prevent cybercrimes such as **cyberstalking**, **online harassment**, **online**

exploitation, **identity theft**, **financial fraud**, and **digital privacy violations**.

According to **Additional Director General of Police (Criminal Investigation Department Crime–Women Cell) Ajay Choudhary**, the initiative seeks to identify vulnerable individuals, prevent financial losses, improve cyber awareness, and ensure timely police intervention.

Gujarat Police is collaborating with **banks**, **telecommunication service providers**, **educational institutions**, **Resident Welfare Associations (RWAs)**, **Non-Governmental Organisations (NGOs)**, and **community leaders** to strengthen public awareness.

71. From 2027, the International Booker Prize will be officially renamed as the_____

A.Bukhman International Booker Prize

B.Global Booker Literature Prize

C.Playrix International Booker Prize

D.Translated Literature Booker Prize

E.Bukhman World Literary Prize

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

The **International Booker Prize** will be officially renamed the **Bukhman International Booker Prize** from **2027** following a **10-year funding agreement (2027–2036)** with **Bukhman Philanthropies**.

The annual **prize money will increase from £50,000 to £100,000**, making it one of the world's richest international literary awards.

Detailed Explanation:

The **International Booker Prize** will be officially renamed the **Bukhman International Booker Prize** from **2027** following a **10-year funding agreement (2027–2036)** with **Bukhman Philanthropies**.

The annual **prize money will increase from £50,000 to £100,000**, making it one of the world's richest international literary awards.

The prize money will continue to be **shared equally between the author and the translator**, recognising the important contribution of translators.

Each shortlisted book will continue to receive **£5,000**, shared equally between the author and translator(s).

The partnership aims to strengthen support for **translated literature**, promote **cross-cultural understanding**, and encourage **global storytelling**.

Bukhman Philanthropies was founded by **Daria Bukhman** and **Dmitri Bukhman**.

Dmitri Bukhman is the **co-founder of Playrix**, a global mobile gaming company.

72. As per the recent news, Dr. A. Jayathilak, who retired on 30 June 2026, was succeeded as the Chief Secretary of Kerala by_____

A.Biswanath Sinha

B.V. Venu

C.T.K. Jose

D.Santhi Kumari

E.Rajesh Kumar Sinha

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

Biswanath Sinha, a **1992-batch Indian Administrative Service (IAS) officer** of the **Kerala cadre**, assumed charge as the **Chief Secretary (CS) of Kerala**.

Biswanath Sinha's tenure as Chief Secretary of Kerala will **continue until September 2028**.

He succeeded **Dr. A. Jayathilak**, a 1991-batch IAS officer, who **retired on 30 June 2026**.

Detailed Explanation:

Biswanath Sinha, a **1992-batch Indian Administrative Service (IAS) officer** of the **Kerala cadre**, assumed charge as the **Chief Secretary (CS) of Kerala**.

Biswanath Sinha's tenure as Chief Secretary of Kerala will **continue until September 2028**.

He succeeded **Dr. A. Jayathilak**, a 1991-batch IAS officer, who **retired on 30 June 2026**.

Biswanath Sinha has over **three decades of administrative experience** in **internal security, police administration, vigilance, and disaster management**.

He has served as **District Collector** of **Kottayam, Wayanad, and Kozhikode**.

He also served as the **Chief Executive Officer (CEO)** of the **Rebuild Kerala Initiative**.

His key administrative assignments include the **Finance, Planning & Economic Affairs**, and **Store Purchase Departments**, along with serving as **Joint Secretary** in the **Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change (MoEFCC)**, Government of India.

73. In news, Former ISRO scientist Mylswamy Annadurai has been appointed by the Government of Tamil Nadu as the Chairman of which committee for School Education?

A.School Education Reform Committee

B.Tamil Nadu Academic Planning Council

C.State Education Advisory Board

D.Digital Learning Mission Committee

E.Curriculum Design Committee (CDC)

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

Government of Tamil Nadu (TN) appointed former Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) scientist **Mylswamy Annadurai** as the **Chairman of the Curriculum Design Committee (CDC)** for School Education for a **3-year tenure**.

The **Curriculum Design Committee (CDC)** will lead **curriculum modernization** for around **1.3 crore students** across Tamil Nadu.

Detailed Explanation:

Government of Tamil Nadu (TN) appointed former Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) scientist **Mylswamy Annadurai** as the **Chairman of the Curriculum Design Committee (CDC)** for School Education for a **3-year tenure**.

The **Curriculum Design Committee (CDC)** will lead **curriculum modernization** for around **1.3 crore students** across Tamil Nadu.

The primary objective is to strengthen **Science, Technology, Artificial Intelligence (AI),**

critical thinking skills, and bridge the gap between teaching and learning systems.

Mylswamy Annadurai served as a scientist at **Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO)** from **1982 to 2018**.

He is popularly known as the **"Moon Man of India"** for his significant contributions to India's space programme.

74. As per the news, the Defence Acquisition Council (DAC) on 3 July 2026 accorded Acceptance of Necessity (AoN) to multiple defence acquisition proposals worth approximately_____

A.₹32,000 crore

B.₹40,000 crore

C.₹52,000 crore

D.₹60,000 crore

E.₹75,000 crore

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The **Defence Acquisition Council (DAC)**, chaired by Raksha Mantri **Rajnath Singh**, accorded **Acceptance of Necessity (AoN)** to multiple defence acquisition proposals on **3 July 2026**.

The **total value of the AoN approvals is approximately ₹52,000 crore**.

Acceptance of Necessity (AoN) is the in-principle administrative approval required before the procurement of defence equipment.

For the **Indian Army**, DAC approved the procurement of **AKASH TARANG Anti-Unmanned Aerial Vehicles (UAV) Electronic Warfare System**, **Man Portable Anti-Tank Guided Missile (MPATGM) Systems**, **Medium Range Surface-to-Air Missile (MRSAM) Weapon System**, **Very Short Range Air Defence System (V-SHORADS)**, **Active Protection System (APS) for Tanks**, and **Jet-Based Kamikaze Drone System**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Defence Acquisition Council (DAC)**, chaired by Raksha Mantri **Rajnath Singh**, accorded **Acceptance of Necessity (AoN)** to multiple defence acquisition proposals on **3 July 2026**.

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AKASH TARANG will provide effective **anti-UAV protection** to Indian Army formations.

The **Man Portable Anti-Tank Guided Missile (MPATGM)** will enhance the Infantry's capability to counter enemy mechanised threats.

The **Medium Range Surface-to-Air Missile (MRSAM)** system will provide medium-range air defence against various stand-off aerial threats.
The **Very Short Range Air Defence System (V-SHORADS)**, equipped with **multi-spectral sensing**, will improve counter-measure resilience and enhance the air defence capability of the Indian Army.
The **Active Protection System (APS)** will improve the defence mechanism and **survivability of tanks**.
The **Jet-Based Kamikaze Drone System** will enhance **Electronic Warfare (EW) capability** while providing greater lethality, survivability, and cost-effectiveness.

75. As per the news, the Competition Commission of India (CCI) approved the acquisition of 100% shareholding in Royal Challengers Sports Private Limited (RCSPL) by an Aditya Birla Group-led consortium from which company?

A.Diageo India Limited
B.United Breweries Limited
C.Royal Challengers Bengaluru Holdings Limited
D.United Spirits Limited
E.Aditya Birla Capital Limited

Answer: D

Short Explanation:
The **Competition Commission of India (CCI)**, under the **Ministry of Corporate Affairs (MCA)**, approved **two major acquisition proposals** under the provisions of the **Competition Act, 2002**.
The **DWS Group–NIAIF transaction** is valued at approximately **₹733 crore**.
Approval 2: An **Aditya Birla Group-led consortium** received approval to acquire **100% shareholding** in **Royal Challengers Sports Private Limited (RCSPL)** from **United Spirits Limited (USL)**.

Detailed Explanation:
The **Competition Commission of India (CCI)**, under the **Ministry of Corporate Affairs (MCA)**, approved **two major acquisition proposals** under the provisions of the **Competition Act, 2002**.
Approval 1: Germany-based **DWS Group GmbH & Co. KGaA (DWS Group)** received approval to acquire a **40% stake** in **Nippon Life India Alternative Investment Fund (AIF) Management Limited (NIAIF)**.
The **DWS Group–NIAIF transaction** is valued at approximately **₹733 crore**.
Approval 2: An **Aditya Birla Group-led consortium** received approval to acquire **100% shareholding** in **Royal Challengers Sports Private Limited (RCSPL)** from **United Spirits Limited (USL)**.
RCSPL owns the **Royal Challengers Bengaluru (RCB) franchises** in both the **Indian Premier League (IPL)** and the **Women's Premier League (WPL)**.
The **RCB acquisition** was completed through an **all-cash deal worth ₹16,660 crore** (approximately **USD 1.78 billion**), making

it one of the **largest sports franchise acquisitions globally**.

76. As per the news, Bharat Petroleum Corporation Limited (BPCL) signed a Share Purchase Agreement to acquire a 40% equity stake in Tiki Tar and Shell India Private Limited (TTSIPL) from which company?

A.Shell India Markets Private Limited

B.Shell Overseas Investments B.V

C.Shell Lubricants India Private Limited

D.Shell Energy India Private Limited

E.Shell Global Solutions India Private Limited

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Bharat Petroleum Corporation Limited (BPCL), a **'Maharatna' Public Sector Undertaking (PSU)** under the **Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas (MoPNG)**, signed a **Share Purchase Agreement (SPA)** to acquire a **40% equity stake** in **Tiki Tar and Shell India Private Limited (TTSIPL)**.

The **acquisition value is ₹85 crore**, aimed at strengthening BPCL's presence in the **bitumen and road infrastructure materials** segment.

Detailed Explanation:

Bharat Petroleum Corporation Limited (BPCL), a **'Maharatna' Public Sector Undertaking (PSU)** under the **Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas (MoPNG)**, signed a **Share Purchase Agreement (SPA)** to acquire a **40% equity stake** in **Tiki Tar and Shell India Private Limited (TTSIPL)**.

The **acquisition value is ₹85 crore**, aimed at strengthening BPCL's presence in the **bitumen and road infrastructure materials** segment.

The acquisition has been approved by the **Department of Investment and Public Asset Management (DIPAM)** under the **Ministry of Finance (MoF)**.

The transaction is expected to be **completed within 90 days**.

Under the agreement, BPCL will acquire the **40% stake** in TTSIPL from **Shell Overseas Investments B.V.**

After completion of the transaction, BPCL will become an equal **Joint Venture (JV) partner** in TTSIPL alongside the existing shareholder.

77. As per the news, Kotak Mahindra Bank Limited (KMBL) announced the acquisition of Deutsche Bank India's Retail Banking, Private Banking, and Wealth Management business for:

A.₹181.7 crore

B.₹231.7 crore

C.₹281.7 crore

D.₹381.7 crore

E.₹481.7 crore

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

Kotak Mahindra Bank Limited (KMBL), a private sector bank, announced the **acquisition of Deutsche Bank India's Retail Banking, Private Banking, and Wealth Management business** for **₹281.7 crore**.

The acquisition is subject to regulatory approvals, including approval from the **Competition Commission of India (CCI)**.
The transaction is expected to be **completed by September 2027**.
The acquired business portfolio includes approximately **₹29,000 crore in loans**, **₹16,000 crore in deposits**, and **₹10,500 crore in Assets Under Management (AUM)**.
Detailed Explanation:
Kotak Mahindra Bank Limited (KMBL), a private sector bank, announced the **acquisition of Deutsche Bank India's Retail Banking, Private Banking, and Wealth Management business** for **₹281.7 crore**.
The acquisition is subject to regulatory approvals, including approval from the **Competition Commission of India (CCI)**.
The transaction is expected to be **completed by September 2027**.
The acquired business portfolio includes approximately **₹29,000 crore in loans**, **₹16,000 crore in deposits**, and **₹10,500 crore in Assets Under Management (AUM)**.
The business serves around **1.5 lakh customers** and has **nearly 1,000 employees**.
The acquisition will strengthen **Kotak Mahindra Bank's presence** in the **affluent banking, private banking, wealth management, and Small and Medium Enterprise (SME)** segments.
Kotak Mahindra Bank and **Deutsche Bank India** will work together to ensure uninterrupted customer services during the transition period.

78. As per the news, the 4th Animal Taxonomy Summit (ATS 4.0) was organised in Kolkata, West Bengal to commemorate the 111th Foundation Day of which institution?
A.Botanical Survey of India (BSI)
B.Wildlife Institute of India (WII)
C.Zoological Survey of India (ZSI)
D.National Biodiversity Authority (NBA)
E.Forest Survey of India (FSI)
Answer: C
Short Explanation:
Union Minister Bhupender Yadav, Ministry of **Environment, Forest and Climate Change (MoEFCC)**, inaugurated the **4th Animal Taxonomy Summit (ATS 4.0)** in **Kolkata, West Bengal**.
ATS 4.0 was held from **30 June to 2 July 2026** to commemorate the **111th Foundation Day of the Zoological Survey of India (ZSI)**.
The summit highlighted India's **biodiversity research**, promoted **wildlife conservation**, and documented **709 new faunal records**.
Detailed Explanation:
Union Minister Bhupender Yadav, Ministry of **Environment, Forest and Climate Change (MoEFCC)**, inaugurated the **4th Animal Taxonomy Summit (ATS 4.0)** in **Kolkata, West Bengal**.
ATS 4.0 was held from **30 June to 2 July 2026** to commemorate the **111th Foundation Day of the Zoological Survey of India (ZSI)**.

The summit highlighted India's **biodiversity research**, promoted **wildlife conservation**, and documented **709 new faunal records**.

During the summit, the annual publications **Animal Discoveries–2025** and **Plant Discoveries–2025** were officially released.

A nationwide **111-Hours Hackathon on Traditional Knowledge for Biodiversity** was organised as one of the key events of the summit.

The summit also featured **16 regional competitions**, **national semi-finals at Dehradun**, and the **grand finale at Kolkata**.

Two important digital platforms, **Fauna of India Checklist Version 3.0** and the **PaleoIndia Portal**, were launched during the event.

79. As per the news, the newly renovated State-of-the-Art Skill Development Center at CSIR–National Chemical Laboratory (CSIR-NCL), Pune was inaugurated by whom?

A.Dr. Vinay Kumar

B.Dr. Ashish Lele

C.Dr. Rajesh Gonnade

D.Mrs. Kanika Goel

E.Dr. Jitendra Singh

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

CSIR–National Chemical Laboratory (CSIR-NCL), Pune inaugurated its newly renovated **State-of-the-Art Skill Development Center** to strengthen scientific and technical skill development.

The **Skill Development Center** was inaugurated by **Dr. Ashish Lele, Director, CSIR-NCL**.

Chief Guest: **Dr. Vinay Kumar**, Nodal Scientist for the **CSIR-Integrated Skill Initiative (CSIR-HRDC), Ghaziabad**.

Detailed Explanation:

CSIR–National Chemical Laboratory (CSIR-NCL), Pune inaugurated its newly renovated **State-of-the-Art Skill Development Center** to strengthen scientific and technical skill development.

The **Skill Development Center** was inaugurated by **Dr. Ashish Lele, Director, CSIR-NCL**.

Chief Guest: **Dr. Vinay Kumar**, Nodal Scientist for the **CSIR-Integrated Skill Initiative (CSIR-HRDC), Ghaziabad**.

The **modernization of the facility** was sponsored by **Envalior** under its **Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR)** initiative.

Other dignitaries present included **Dr. Rajesh Gonnade (NCL Skill Nodal Officer)** and **Mrs. Kanika Goel (Controller of Administration – COA, CSIR-NCL)**.

The **CSIR Skill Development Program (SDP)** functions under the **CSIR-Integrated Skill Initiative (CSIR-ISI)**.

80. As per the news, SHE-LEAPS was launched on which date during the Rashtriya Gramin Vikas Sammelan held in New Delhi?

A.26 June 2026

B.27 June 2026

C.28 June 2026

D.29 June 2026

E.30 June 2026

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

SHE-LEAPS stands for **Self-Help Entrepreneur–Livelihoods and Enterprise Application for Prosperity and Sustainability**.

SHE-LEAPS is a **digital platform** designed to **empower women** associated with **Self-Help Groups (SHGs)** across rural India.

The platform provides a **unified system** for **enterprise creation, performance tracking, livelihood generation, enterprise growth**, and **financial inclusion**.

SHE-LEAPS was launched on **29 June 2026** during the **Rashtriya Gramin Vikas Sammelan** held in **New Delhi**.

Detailed Explanation:

SHE-LEAPS stands for **Self-Help Entrepreneur–Livelihoods and Enterprise Application for Prosperity and Sustainability**.

SHE-LEAPS is a **digital platform** designed to **empower women** associated with **Self-Help Groups (SHGs)** across rural India.

The platform provides a **unified system** for **enterprise creation, performance tracking, livelihood generation, enterprise growth**, and **financial inclusion**.

SHE-LEAPS supports both **farm and non-farm rural enterprises**, helping build a stronger and sustainable rural economy.

The **SHE-LEAPS mobile application** has been developed by the **Digital India Corporation** and implemented under the **LokOS platform**.

LokOS is a digital platform that captures the activities of **Community-Based Organizations (CBOs)**, including **Self-Help Groups (SHGs), Village Organizations (VOs)**, and **Cluster Level Federations (CLFs)**.

LokOS digitizes member records, financial transactions, livelihood records, and convergence initiatives of rural institutions.

SHE-LEAPS was launched on **29 June 2026** during the **Rashtriya Gramin Vikas Sammelan** held in **New Delhi**.

The theme of the Rashtriya Gramin Vikas Sammelan 2026 was **"Gramodaya Se Rashtrodaya"**.

81. As per the news, consider the following statements about the National Narcotics Helpline MANAS:

1. **MANAS stands for Madak Padarth Nishedh Asoochna Kendra.**
2. **It was launched on 18 July 2024 under the aegis of the Narcotics Control Bureau (NCB), Ministry of Home Affairs.**
3. **Calls related to counselling under MANAS are transferred to the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment's De-addiction Helpline – 14446.**

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

A.1 only

B.2 and 3 only

C.1 and 3 only

D.All are correct

E.2 only

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

National Narcotics Helpline MANAS stands for **Madak Padarth Nishedh Asoochna Kendra**.

MANAS was launched on **18 July 2024** under the aegis of the **Narcotics Control Bureau (NCB)**, **Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA)**, in collaboration with the **Digital India Corporation (DIC)**.

Calls related to counselling are transferred to the **Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment's De-addiction Helpline – 14446**.

MANAS provides **24×7 nationwide services**, ensuring uninterrupted access across India.

Detailed Explanation:

National Narcotics Helpline MANAS stands for **Madak Padarth Nishedh Asoochna Kendra**.

MANAS was launched on **18 July 2024** under the aegis of the **Narcotics Control Bureau (NCB)**, **Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA)**, in collaboration with the **Digital India Corporation (DIC)**.

Objective of MANAS: To provide a secure, confidential, technology-driven platform for **reporting drug trafficking**, substance abuse, and providing **counselling and rehabilitation support**.

MANAS integrates the vision of **Digital India** with the mission of **Nasha Mukt Bharat**.

The platform is accessible through the **National Helpline Number – 1933**, Official Web Portal, Email, and the **UMANG App**.

MANAS enables citizens to **confidentially report drug trafficking**, drug peddling, illegal cultivation of narcotic substances, and other drug-related activities **without revealing their identity**.

People affected by drug addiction can access professional **counselling and rehabilitation support** through **MANAS**.

Calls related to counselling are transferred to the **Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment's De-addiction Helpline – 14446**.

MANAS provides **24×7 nationwide services**, ensuring uninterrupted access across India.

82. As per the news, Harshavardhan G.B. recently became India's 97th Chess Grandmaster (GM). He belongs to which city?

A.Bengaluru

B.Chennai

C.Hyderabad

D.Pune

E.Kolkata

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Harshavardhan G.B., a **22-year-old** chess player from **Chennai, Tamil Nadu**,

became **India's 97th Chess Grandmaster (GM)**.

He secured his **third and final Grandmaster norm** at the **2nd Chola Chess Grandmaster Norm Round Robin Tournament** held in **Chennai**.

Detailed Explanation:

Harshavardhan G.B., a **22-year-old** chess player from **Chennai, Tamil Nadu**, became **India's 97th Chess Grandmaster (GM)**.

He secured his **third and final Grandmaster norm** at the **2nd Chola Chess Grandmaster Norm Round Robin Tournament** held in **Chennai**.

Harshavardhan remained **unbeaten throughout the tournament**, scoring **6.5 out of 9 points**.

He also crossed the **2500 live Fédération Internationale des Échecs (FIDE) rating** required to earn the **Grandmaster** title.

He achieved the milestone after drawing his final-round game against **Grandmaster Mihail Nikitenko**.

83. As per the news, India finished first in the medal standings at the 5th ISSF Junior World Championship 2026 held in Suhl, Germany, with a total of_____

A.20 medals

B.22 medals

C.24 medals

D.26 medals

E.28 medals

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

India finished **first** in the medal standings at the **5th International Shooting Sport Federation (ISSF) Junior World Championship 2026 (Rifle/Pistol/Shotgun)** held in **Suhl, Germany**.

The championship featured **over 800 shooters** from **70 national federations**, with **India fielding an 84-member contingent**.

India won a total of **24 medals**:

7 Gold

8 Silver

9 Bronze

This marked **India's second consecutive ISSF Junior World Championship medal tally title**, after topping the **2024 edition held in Lima, Peru**.

Detailed Explanation:

India finished **first** in the medal standings at the **5th International Shooting Sport Federation (ISSF) Junior World Championship 2026 (Rifle/Pistol/Shotgun)** held in **Suhl, Germany**.

The championship featured **over 800 shooters** from **70 national federations**, with **India fielding an 84-member contingent**.

India won a total of **24 medals**:

7 Gold

8 Silver

9 Bronze

This marked **India's second consecutive ISSF Junior World Championship medal tally title**, after topping the **2024 edition held in Lima, Peru**.

India's Gold Medal Winners:

Sejal Kamble – 10m Air Pistol Women Junior (Individual)

Sejal Kamble, Vanshika Choudhary and Navya Bishnoi – 10m Air Pistol Women Junior Team

Sameer – 25m Rapid Fire Pistol Men Junior

Rohit Kanyan – 50m Rifle 3 Positions Men Junior

Pritam Kendre – 10m Air Rifle Men Junior

Abhinav Deshwal – 25m Standard Pistol Men Junior

Shambhavi Shravan Kshirsagar and Abhinav Shaw – 10m Air Rifle Mixed Team Junior

Notable silver medal winners included **Shiva Narwal** (10m Air Pistol Men Junior), **Prachi Gaikwad** (50m Rifle 3 Positions Women Junior), and **Aishwarya Ravichandra Balehosur** (50m Pistol Women Junior).

Anvii Rathod won the **bronze medal** in the **10m Air Rifle Women Junior**, while Indian teams also secured several bronze medals in rifle and pistol events.

National Rifle Association of India (NRAI) President Kalikesh Narayan Singh Deo described India's second consecutive World Championship medal tally victory as a **"phenomenal achievement."**

Pawankumar Singh is the **Secretary General** of the **National Rifle Association of India (NRAI)**.

84. As per the news, Cristiano Ronaldo became the oldest player to score in a men's FIFA World Cup knockout match after scoring against which team in the Round of 32?

A.Spain

B.Argentina

C.Netherlands

D.Morocco

E.Croatia

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

Portugal captain **Cristiano Ronaldo** became the **oldest player to score in a men's Fédération Internationale de Football Association (FIFA) World Cup knockout match** after converting a penalty against **Croatia** in the **Round of 32**.

At the age of **41 years and 147 days**, Ronaldo scored the equaliser as **Portugal defeated Croatia 2–1** to qualify for the **Round of 16**.

Portugal will now face **Spain**, the **2010 FIFA World Cup champions**, in the Round of 16.

Detailed Explanation:

Portugal captain **Cristiano Ronaldo** became the **oldest player to score in a men's Fédération Internationale de Football Association (FIFA) World Cup knockout match** after converting a penalty against **Croatia** in the **Round of 32**.

At the age of **41 years and 147 days**, Ronaldo scored the equaliser as **Portugal defeated Croatia 2–1** to qualify for the **Round of 16**.

Portugal will now face **Spain**, the **2010 FIFA World Cup champions**, in the Round of 16.

Ronaldo surpassed the previous record held by **Lionel Messi** to become the oldest goalscorer in a FIFA World Cup knockout-stage match.

He also became the **second-oldest goalscorer in FIFA World Cup history**, behind **Roger Milla (Cameroon)**, who scored at **42 years and 39 days** during the **1994 FIFA World Cup**.

85. As per the news, noted Tamil poet, translator, screenwriter, and actor Puviyarasu, who recently passed away, had the original name_____

A.Subramanian

B.Jagannathan

C.Ramasamy

D.Krishnamurthy

E.Balasubramanian

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Renowned Tamil poet, translator, screenwriter, and actor **Puviyarasu** passed away at the age of **96** in **Coimbatore, Tamil Nadu**.

Puviyarasu was born in **1930** at **Lingamanayakkan Puthur, Udumalpet, Coimbatore district, Tamil Nadu**.

His original name was **Jagannathan**, and he later adopted the pen name **Puviyarasu**.

He worked as a **Tamil teacher** and began publishing poetry in **1952**.

Detailed Explanation:

Renowned Tamil poet, translator, screenwriter, and actor **Puviyarasu** passed away at the age of **96** in **Coimbatore, Tamil Nadu**.

Puviyarasu was born in **1930** at **Lingamanayakkan Puthur, Udumalpet, Coimbatore district, Tamil Nadu**.

His original name was **Jagannathan**, and he later adopted the pen name **Puviyarasu**.

He worked as a **Tamil teacher** and began publishing poetry in **1952**.

Puviyarasu was a **two-time Sahitya Akademi Award recipient**.

He received the **Sahitya Akademi Award (2007)** for **"Puratchikaran"**, the Tamil translation of Kazi Nazrul Islam's work "The Revolutionary".

He won the **Sahitya Akademi Award (2010)** for **"Kaiyoppam (Signature)"**.

Puviyarasu was widely recognised for his outstanding contributions to **Tamil poetry, literary translation, and modern Tamil literature**.

86. As per the news, Lieutenant General (Retired) M.M. Lakhera, who recently passed away, served as the 8th Governor of which state?

A.Mizoram

B.Nagaland

C.Manipur

D.Tripura

E.Meghalaya

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

Lieutenant General (Retired) Madan Mohan (M.M.) Lakhera, former **Governor of Mizoram** and former **Lieutenant Governor (Lt**

Gov) of Puducherry, passed away at the age of **88** in **Dehradun, Uttarakhand**.
M.M. Lakhera was born on **21 October 1937** in **Jakhand, United Provinces, British India (present-day Uttarakhand)**.
M.M. Lakhera served as the **8th Governor of Mizoram** from **25 July 2006 to 2 September 2011**.

Detailed Explanation:
Lieutenant General (Retired) Madan Mohan (M.M.) Lakhera, former **Governor of Mizoram** and former **Lieutenant Governor (Lt Gov) of Puducherry**, passed away at the age of **88** in **Dehradun, Uttarakhand**.
M.M. Lakhera was born on **21 October 1937** in **Jakhand, United Provinces, British India (present-day Uttarakhand)**.
He was commissioned into the **Indian Army (IA)** from the **Indian Military Academy (IMA), Dehradun**, in **June 1958**.
M.M. Lakhera served as the **8th Governor of Mizoram** from **25 July 2006 to 2 September 2011**.

87. As per the news, Vijaya Mehta, who recently passed away and was popularly known as "Bai," was primarily associated with which field?

A.Classical music
B.Indian painting
C.Hindi journalism
D.Experimental Marathi theatre
E.Kathak dance

Answer: D

Short Explanation:
Vijaya Mehta, popularly known as **"Bai,"** passed away at the age of **92** in **Mumbai, Maharashtra**.
She was born in **1934** in **Vadodara,**Gujarat.
Vijaya Mehta was one of the **founder-members of the Rangayan theatre group**, along with **Vijay Tendulkar, Arvind Deshpande, and Shreeram Lagoo**, playing a pioneering role in the growth of **experimental Marathi theatre**.

Detailed Explanation:
Vijaya Mehta, popularly known as **"Bai,"** passed away at the age of **92** in **Mumbai, Maharashtra**.
She was born in **1934** in **Vadodara,**Gujarat.
Vijaya Mehta was one of the **founder-members of the Rangayan theatre group**, along with **Vijay Tendulkar, Arvind Deshpande, and Shreeram Lagoo**, playing a pioneering role in the growth of **experimental Marathi theatre**.
She authored the acclaimed autobiography **Zimma: A Memoir**, which chronicles her journey in theatre and cinema.
The **Government of India (GoI)** honoured **Vijaya Mehta** with the **Padma Shri in 1987**, India's fourth-highest civilian award, for her outstanding contribution to **Art (Theatre and Cinema)**.

88. As per the news, Dilip Asbe is the Chief Executive Officer (CEO) of which organisation?

A.Reserve Bank of India (RBI

B.National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI)

C.National Bank for Agriculture and Rural Development (NABARD)

D.Bharat Bill Payment System (BBPS)

E.National Stock Exchange (NSE)

Answer: B

About NPCI:

Headquarters: Mumbai, Maharashtra, India

Founded: 2008

CEO: Dilip Asbe

Key Initiatives: Unified Payments Interface (UPI), Immediate Payment Service (IMPS), RuPay (domestic card payment network), Bharat Bill Payment System (BBPS), Aadhaar Enabled Payment System (AePS)

89. As per the news, in which year was the International Booker Prize reintroduced as an annual award for a single translated work of fiction?

A.2005

B.2010

C.2016

D.2018

E.2027

Answer: C

The **International Booker Prize** will be officially renamed the **Bukhman International Booker Prize** from **2027** following a **10-year funding agreement (2027–2036)** with **Bukhman Philanthropies**.

The annual **prize money will increase from £50,000 to £100,000**, making it one of the world's richest international literary awards.

Evolution of the Prize:

2005: Launched as the **Man Booker International Prize** (biennial).

2016: Reintroduced as an **annual award** for a single translated work of fiction.

2019: Renamed the **International Booker Prize**.

2027: To be renamed the **Bukhman International Booker Prize**.

90. As per the news, the Defence Acquisition Council (DAC), the highest decision-making body of the Ministry of Defence for defence procurement in India, was established in which year?

A.1998

B.1999

C.2000

D.2001

E.2005

Answer: D

Defence Acquisition Council (DAC) is the **highest decision-making body** of the **Ministry of Defence (MoD)** for **defence procurement** in India.

The **DAC** was **established in 2001**.

It was constituted following the recommendations of the **Group of Ministers (GoM)** on **"Reforming the National Security System"**.

The **formation of the DAC** was a major reform undertaken after the **Kargil War (1999)**.
The **Chairman** of the **Defence Acquisition Council (DAC)** is the **Union Defence Minister**.
Current Chairman: Rajnath Singh.

91. In 2026, the India-France Economic and Financial Dialogue (EFD) held in Aix-en-Provence was aimed at strengthening which partnership between India and France?

A.Blue Economy Partnership
B.Digital Innovation Partnership
C.Special Global Strategic Partnership
D.Indo-Pacific Maritime Partnership
E.Civil Nuclear Cooperation Framework

Answer: C

Short Explanation:
Union Finance Minister **Nirmala Sitharaman** and France's Minister of Economy, Finance, Industrial, Energy, and Digital Sovereignty **Roland Lescure** co-chaired the **India-France Economic and Financial Dialogue (EFD)** in **Aix-en-Provence, France**.
The **India-France Economic and Financial Dialogue (EFD)** was held to strengthen the **India–France Special Global Strategic Partnership** through high-level discussions on economic, financial, investment, trade, and technological cooperation.
The dialogue was held following the commitment made by Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** and French President **Emmanuel Macron** during the latter's **February 2026 visit to India**.
India and France discussed greater coordination in **multilateral economic forums**, including the **G20** and the **Paris Club**, in the context of India's association with the **French G7 Presidency**.

Detailed Explanation:
Union Finance Minister **Nirmala Sitharaman** and France's Minister of Economy, Finance, Industrial, Energy, and Digital Sovereignty **Roland Lescure** co-chaired the **India-France Economic and Financial Dialogue (EFD)** in **Aix-en-Provence, France**.
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India and France discussed greater coordination in **multilateral economic forums**, including the **G20** and the **Paris Club**, in the context of India's association with the **French G7 Presidency**.
Both Ministers exchanged views on the **global economic outlook** and explored ways to strengthen **bilateral economic cooperation**.
A key area of discussion was India-France cooperation on **Critical Minerals**, aimed at enhancing **economic sovereignty** and **strategic security**.

Both countries also discussed measures to increase **cross-border investments** and expand **bilateral investment opportunities**.
The dialogue explored new opportunities in the **high-speed railway sector**, following the signing of the **Declaration of Intent on Railways**.
India and France discussed proposals to **strengthen connectivity** between their **financial industries** and deepen **financial sector cooperation**.
Both Ministers appreciated the contribution of the **French Development Agency (AFD)** towards India's economic development and welcomed future **collaborative projects**.

92. In 2026, Razorpay partnered with NPCI Bharat BillPay Limited (NBBL) to launch which mobile-first NetBanking solution aimed at enabling unified multi-bank integration and QR-based payment flows?

A.Bharat Gateway
B.Banking Connect
C.NetPay Link
D.BillPay Unified
E.UPI Banking Hub

Answer: B

Short Explanation:
Razorpay, in partnership with **NPCI Bharat BillPay Limited (NBBL)**, a wholly-owned subsidiary of the **National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI)**, launched **Banking Connect**, a **mobile-first NetBanking solution**, in **Mumbai, Maharashtra**.
Banking Connect modernises **NetBanking** by offering **unified multi-bank integration**, along with **QR-based and intent-driven payment flows**, improving payment efficiency and customer experience.

Detailed Explanation:
Razorpay, in partnership with **NPCI Bharat BillPay Limited (NBBL)**, a wholly-owned subsidiary of the **National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI)**, launched **Banking Connect**, a **mobile-first NetBanking solution**, in **Mumbai, Maharashtra**.
Banking Connect modernises **NetBanking** by offering **unified multi-bank integration**, along with **QR-based and intent-driven payment flows**, improving payment efficiency and customer experience.
The platform replaces **multiple bank-specific integrations** and complex reconciliation processes with a **single integration layer** connecting merchants to multiple participating banks.
The primary objective of Banking Connect is to enable **intent-based and QR-enabled mobile payments** through a **unified framework** for payment routing, settlement, reconciliation, and refunds.
The solution is designed to **improve transaction success rates** and deliver a seamless payment experience, particularly

for **high-value transactions** across various sectors.

93. In 2026, the Asian Development Bank (ADB) approved a USD 182.89 million loan to strengthen the public school system of which state under the Strengthening Karnataka Public Schools Program?

A.Tamil Nadu

B.Kerala

C.Telangana

D.Andhra Pradesh

E.Karnataka

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

The **Asian Development Bank (ADB)** has approved a **USD 182.89 million** (Japanese Yen equivalent) loan for **Karnataka** to strengthen the public school system under the **Strengthening Karnataka Public Schools Program**.

The programme aims to establish **500 Integrated Karnataka Public School Clusters**, providing seamless education from **pre-primary to secondary level**.

The initiative is expected to benefit **over 1 million students**, including female students and disadvantaged learners, by expanding access to **high-quality education** and improving academic performance.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Asian Development Bank (ADB)** has approved a **USD 182.89 million** (Japanese Yen equivalent) loan for **Karnataka** to strengthen the public school system under the **Strengthening Karnataka Public Schools Program**.

The programme aims to establish **500 Integrated Karnataka Public School Clusters**, providing seamless education from **pre-primary to secondary level**.

The initiative is expected to benefit **over 1 million students**, including female students and disadvantaged learners, by expanding access to **high-quality education** and improving academic performance.

The programme is financed through ADB's **Results-Based Lending (RBL)** mechanism and is aligned with the Government of Karnataka's education reforms and the **National Education Policy (NEP) 2020**.

It is ADB's **first large-scale support** for public school transformation in India through the **Results-Based Lending modality**.

The programme will strengthen **teacher competencies, curriculum, assessment systems, school governance**, and **school management systems**.

It will promote **Science, Technology, Engineering, Arts and Mathematics (STEAM) learning** and introduce **industry-aligned skill modules** to improve students' employability.

94. In 2026, the Government of India launched which digital facility to allow eligible Overseas Citizen of India (OCI) cardholders to carry a secure digital version of their OCI card on smartphones?

A.e-Visa OCI Pass
B.Digital OCI Wallet
C.e-OCI Card
D.OCI Smart Travel Pass
E.Bharat OCI Connect
Answer: C
Short Explanation:
The **Government of India** has launched the **Electronic Overseas Citizen of India (e-OCI) Card**, enabling eligible **Overseas Citizen of India (OCI)** cardholders to carry a **secure digital version** of their **Overseas Citizen of India (OCI)** card on their smartphones.
The **Electronic Overseas Citizen of India (e-OCI) Card** can be generated and downloaded through the **Official Overseas Citizen of India Services Portal** by existing **Overseas Citizen of India (OCI)** cardholders.
The digital card can be presented to **immigration authorities, airline staff, and other authorised officials** as proof of **Overseas Citizen of India (OCI)** status during travel.
Detailed Explanation:
The **Government of India** has launched the **Electronic Overseas Citizen of India (e-OCI) Card**, enabling eligible **Overseas Citizen of India (OCI)** cardholders to carry a **secure digital version** of their **Overseas Citizen of India (OCI)** card on their smartphones.
The **Electronic Overseas Citizen of India (e-OCI) Card** can be generated and downloaded through the **Official Overseas Citizen of India Services Portal** by existing **Overseas Citizen of India (OCI)** cardholders.
The digital card can be presented to **immigration authorities, airline staff, and other authorised officials** as proof of **Overseas Citizen of India (OCI)** status during travel.
The initiative eliminates the need to carry the **physical Overseas Citizen of India (OCI) booklet** on every journey, offering greater convenience for frequent travellers.
The **Government of India** has clarified that the **physical Overseas Citizen of India (OCI) booklet remains fully valid**, and the **Electronic Overseas Citizen of India (e-OCI) Card** has been introduced as an **optional digital facility**.
The initiative is part of the Government's efforts to **digitise citizen services** and improve service delivery for the **Indian diaspora**.

95. In 2026, under Uttar Pradesh's Rashtriya Parivarik Labh Yojana implemented through the National Family Benefit Scheme (NFBS), eligible BPL families receive a one-time financial assistance of how much after the death of the primary earning member?
A.₹20,000
B.₹25,000
C.₹30,000
D.₹40,000
E.₹50,000
Answer: C
Short Explanation:

The **Uttar Pradesh Rashtriya Parivarik Labh Yojana**, implemented under the **National Family Benefit Scheme (NFBS)**, provides **one-time financial assistance of ₹30,000** to **Below Poverty Line (BPL)** families following the death of their primary earning member.

The scheme aims to provide immediate financial support to economically weaker families facing hardship due to the loss of their sole breadwinner.

The financial assistance is transferred **directly to the Aadhaar-linked bank account** of the eligible beneficiary through the **Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT)** mechanism.

Applications under the scheme are accepted **only through the online portal**, enabling eligible families across Uttar Pradesh to apply digitally.

To be eligible, the deceased breadwinner must have been **18–60 years of age**, and the applicant must be a **permanent resident of Uttar Pradesh** belonging to a **Below Poverty Line (BPL)** family.

The annual family income should not exceed **₹56,450 in urban areas** and **₹46,080 in rural areas**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Uttar Pradesh Rashtriya Parivarik Labh Yojana**, implemented under the **National Family Benefit Scheme (NFBS)**, provides **one-time financial assistance of ₹30,000** to **Below Poverty Line (BPL)** families following the death of their primary earning member.

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The annual family income should not exceed **₹56,450 in urban areas** and **₹46,080 in rural areas**.

Required documents include the **death certificate**, **Below Poverty Line (BPL) ration card**, **Aadhaar card**, **Aadhaar-linked bank account details**, **domicile certificate**, **age proof**, **passport-size photograph**, and **registered mobile number**.

Applications are verified by the **District Social Welfare Officer**, who scrutinises the submitted documents and may conduct field verification before approving the financial assistance.

96. In 2026, which state received Geographical Indication (GI) registration for Chandannagar's Jalbhara Sandesh, Janai's

Manohara, and Balagarh's Traditional Wooden Boats?

A.Odisha

B.Bihar

C.Assam

D.West Bengal

E.Jharkhand

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

West Bengal has received **Geographical Indication (GI)** registration for **three traditional products** from **Hooghly district—Chandannagar's Jalbhara Sandesh**, **Janai's Manohara**, and **Balagarh's Traditional Wooden Boats (Dingi Boats)**.

The **Geographical Indication (GI)** tags were granted by the **Government of India**, providing legal protection and promoting the unique identity of these products in domestic and international markets.

Jalbhara Sandesh, one of Bengal's iconic sweets, was created in the **19th century** by renowned confectioner **Surya Modak** and is popularly known as **"Jamai Thokano Mishti"**.

Detailed Explanation:

West Bengal has received **Geographical Indication (GI)** registration for **three traditional products** from **Hooghly district—Chandannagar's Jalbhara Sandesh**, **Janai's Manohara**, and **Balagarh's Traditional Wooden Boats (Dingi Boats)**.

The **Geographical Indication (GI)** tags were granted by the **Government of India**, providing legal protection and promoting the unique identity of these products in domestic and international markets.

Jalbhara Sandesh, one of Bengal's iconic sweets, was created in the **19th century** by renowned confectioner **Surya Modak** and is popularly known as **"Jamai Thokano Mishti"**. The sweet is distinguished by its **liquid rose-flavoured syrup filling**, enclosed within a sandesh resembling an **ice apple kernel**, giving it the name **"Jalbhara"**, meaning **"filled with liquid."**

Janai's Manohara is a traditional Bengali sweet known for its **sugar-coated outer layer** and **soft chhena (cottage cheese) filling**, prepared using a unique regional recipe.

Balagarh's Traditional Wooden Boats (Dingi Boats) represent a **500-year-old boat-building tradition** associated with the historic **Saptagram Port** and have long been used for **trade, fishing, transportation, and river navigation**.

97. In 2026, which state received Geographical Indication (GI) registration for eight traditional products including Spiti Seabuckthorn, Kinnauri Topi, and Chamba Metal Art?

A.Uttarakhand

B.Himachal Pradesh

C.Jammu & Kashmir

D.Sikkim

E.Arunachal Pradesh

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Himachal Pradesh has received **Geographical Indication (GI)** registration for **eight traditional products**, taking the total number of **GI-tagged products in the state to 17**.

The newly registered **Geographical Indication (GI)** products are:

Spiti Seabuckthorn (Chharma)

Salooni Safed Makka (White Maize)

Chamba Metal Art

Sirmauri Loiya (traditional woollen garment)

Kinnauri Topi

Sepuvadi of Mandi

Kinnauri Apple

Kinnauri Jewellery

The **Geographical Indication (GI)** tags recognise the unique agricultural, cultural, and artisanal heritage of Himachal Pradesh and provide legal protection against unauthorised imitation.

Detailed Explanation:

Himachal Pradesh has received **Geographical Indication (GI)** registration for **eight traditional products**, taking the total number of **GI-tagged products in the state to 17**.

The newly registered **Geographical Indication (GI)** products are:

Spiti Seabuckthorn (Chharma)

Salooni Safed Makka (White Maize)

Chamba Metal Art

Sirmauri Loiya (traditional woollen garment)

Kinnauri Topi

Sepuvadi of Mandi

Kinnauri Apple

Kinnauri Jewellery

The **Geographical Indication (GI)** tags recognise the unique agricultural, cultural, and artisanal heritage of Himachal Pradesh and provide legal protection against unauthorised imitation.

Geographical Indication (GI) registration is granted to products whose quality, reputation, or characteristics are linked to a specific geographical region.

In India, **Geographical Indication (GI)** registration is governed by the **Geographical Indications of Goods (Registration and Protection) Act, 1999**.

98. In 2026, the growth in India–Mali bilateral trade was supported by India's which scheme that provides preferential market access to Least Developed Countries (LDCs), including Mali?

A.Market Access Initiative (MAI) Scheme

B.Export Promotion Capital Goods (EPCG) Scheme

C.Duty-Free Tariff Preference (DFTP) Scheme

D.Remission of Duties and Taxes on Exported Products (RoDTEP) Scheme

E.Merchandise Exports from India Scheme (MEIS)

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

India and **Mali** jointly launched the **India-Mali Forum for the Promotion of Exports** in **Bamako**, marking the **first institutionalised bilateral platform** to

strengthen trade and commercial cooperation between the two countries.

The **two-day forum** was organised under the theme **"Reinforcing Trade and Strategic Partnerships"** to promote collaboration in **trade, investment, manufacturing, infrastructure, and strategic sectors**.

The growth in bilateral trade has been supported by **India's Duty-Free Tariff Preference (DFTP) Scheme**, which provides preferential market access to **Least Developed Countries (LDCs)**, including Mali.

Detailed Explanation:

India and **Mali** jointly launched the **India-Mali Forum for the Promotion of Exports** in **Bamako**, marking the **first institutionalised bilateral platform** to strengthen trade and commercial cooperation between the two countries.

The **two-day forum** was organised under the theme **"Reinforcing Trade and Strategic Partnerships"** to promote collaboration in **trade, investment, manufacturing, infrastructure, and strategic sectors**.

The forum was jointly organised by the **Ministry of Industry and Trade of Mali**, the **Embassy of India in Bamako**, and the **Malian Agency for the Promotion of Exports (APEX-Mali)**.

The Indian delegation was led by **Amit Kumar, Joint Secretary (Foreign Trade–Africa), Department of Commerce**, and **Dr. N. Nandakumar, Ambassador of India to Mali**.

The event was presided over by **Major General Abdoulaye Maïga**, Prime Minister of Mali's Transition Government, and witnessed the participation of **around 30 Indian business leaders**.

India-Mali bilateral trade reached **US$326.61 million** during **Financial Year (FY) 2025–26**, registering a **55% year-on-year growth** over the previous financial year.

The growth in bilateral trade has been supported by **India's Duty-Free Tariff Preference (DFTP) Scheme**, which provides preferential market access to **Least Developed Countries (LDCs)**, including Mali.

99. In 2026, the National Commission for Women (NCW) launched which 24×7 toll-free Women Helpline to provide immediate assistance and grievance redressal for women in distress?

A.14490

B.181

C.1091

D.112

E.1930

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

The **National Commission for Women (NCW)** has launched a **24×7 toll-free Women Helpline (14490)** to provide **immediate assistance, complaint registration, psychological counselling, and grievance redressal** for women in distress.

The helpline has been introduced as part of the **Digital India** initiative to improve access to

institutional support through a technology-enabled platform.

Detailed Explanation:

The **National Commission for Women (NCW)** has launched a **24×7 toll-free Women Helpline (14490)** to provide **immediate assistance, complaint registration, psychological counselling, and grievance redressal** for women in distress.

The helpline has been introduced as part of the **Digital India** initiative to improve access to institutional support through a technology-enabled platform.

Women and girls aged 18 years and above can use the helpline to report cases related to **domestic violence, harassment, workplace exploitation, dowry-related issues, abuse, and other forms of gender-based violence**.

The new helpline **14490** is integrated with the **existing National Commission for Women (NCW) helpline number 7827170170**, providing a simple and easily accessible contact point.

100. In 2026, the Unique Identification Authority of India (UIDAI) launched a digital facility through the Aadhaar App to enable Aadhaar holders to add or update which detail without visiting an Aadhaar centre?

A.Date of birth

B.Biometric data

C.Email ID

D.Parent's name

E.Marital status

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The **Unique Identification Authority of India (UIDAI)** has launched a new digital facility enabling **Aadhaar holders to add or update their email ID through the official Aadhaar App**, eliminating the need to visit an Aadhaar Seva Kendra or enrolment centre.

The facility became available from **1 July 2026** and will be **free of cost for six months**.

The initiative aims to promote **self-service Aadhaar updates** and encourage residents to keep their Aadhaar details up to date.

According to the **Unique Identification Authority of India (UIDAI)**, **over 2.5 lakh residents** updated their email IDs within the **first two days** of the launch, indicating strong public adoption.

The **Aadhaar App** also allows users to update their **mobile number, address**, and other eligible Aadhaar-related services digitally.

Since its rollout, **more than 40 lakh users** have updated their **mobile numbers**, while around **10 lakh residents** have updated their **addresses** through the Aadhaar App.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Unique Identification Authority of India (UIDAI)** has launched a new digital facility enabling **Aadhaar holders to add or update their email ID through the official Aadhaar App**, eliminating the need to visit an Aadhaar Seva Kendra or enrolment centre.

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The **Aadhaar App** also allows users to update their **mobile number, address**, and other eligible Aadhaar-related services digitally.

Since its rollout, **more than 40 lakh users** have updated their **mobile numbers**, while around **10 lakh residents** have updated their **addresses** through the Aadhaar App.

The initiative supports the Government of India's vision of delivering **citizen-centric, paperless, and digital public services** by reducing physical visits to Aadhaar centres.

101. In 2026, Ravi Shankar was appointed as Executive Director (ED) of the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) to oversee which department?

A.Department of Supervision

B.Department of Statistics and Information Management

C.Department of Regulation

D.Financial Markets Operations Department

E.Consumer Education and Protection Department

Answer: B

The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** appointed **Ravi Shankar** as **Executive Director (ED)** with effect from **1 July 2026**.

As Executive Director, Ravi Shankar will oversee the **Department of Statistics and Information Management (DSIM)**.

Before his promotion, Ravi Shankar was serving as **Adviser-In-Charge** of the **Department of Statistics and Information Management (DSIM)**.

Ravi Shankar is a central banker and statistician with **over three decades of experience** at the Reserve Bank of India (RBI).

102. In 2026, who assumed additional charge as Chairman and Managing Director (CMD) of Indian Renewable Energy Development Agency Limited (IREDA) with effect from 1 July 2026?

A.Pradip Kumar Das**C**.Ajay Bhushan Pandey

D.Bijay Kumar Mohanty

E.Ramesh Chand

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

Bijay Kumar Mohanty, currently serving as **Director (Finance)** and **Chief Financial Officer (CFO)** of **Indian Renewable Energy Development Agency Limited (IREDA)**, has assumed **additional charge** as **Chairman and Managing Director (CMD)** of IREDA.

His appointment is effective from **1 July 2026** for a period of **three months**, following the **superannuation of Pradip Kumar Das** on **30 June 2026**.

Detailed Explanation:

Bijay Kumar Mohanty, currently serving as **Director (Finance)** and **Chief Financial**

Officer (CFO) of **Indian Renewable Energy Development Agency Limited (IREDA)**, has assumed **additional charge** as **Chairman and Managing Director (CMD)** of IREDA.
His appointment is effective from **1 July 2026** for a period of **three months**, following the **superannuation of Pradip Kumar Das** on **30 June 2026**.
Bijay Kumar Mohanty also serves on the Board of **IREDA Global Green Energy Finance IFSC Limited**, a wholly-owned subsidiary of IREDA.
He has over **27 years of experience** in India's **power and renewable energy sector**.

103. In 2026, who was appointed as the Part-Time Chairman of HDFC Bank for a period of 3 years, subject to RBI approval?
A.Keki Mistry
B.Atanu Chakraborty
C.Sanjiv Chadha
D.Shaktikanta Das
E.Rajiv Kumar
Answer: E
Short Explanation:
HDFC Bank Limited appointed **Rajiv Kumar**, former **Chief Election Commissioner (CEC)** of India, as its **Part-Time Chairman** for a period of **3 years**, effective from the date of approval by the **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)**.
Rajiv Kumar has also been appointed as an **Additional Independent Director** on the Board of HDFC Bank for a **4-year term**, effective from **30 June 2026**.
Detailed Explanation:
HDFC Bank Limited appointed **Rajiv Kumar**, former **Chief Election Commissioner (CEC)** of India, as its **Part-Time Chairman** for a period of **3 years**, effective from the date of approval by the **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)**.
Rajiv Kumar has also been appointed as an **Additional Independent Director** on the Board of HDFC Bank for a **4-year term**, effective from **30 June 2026**.
He will succeed **Keki Mistry**, who was serving as the **Interim Chairman** of HDFC Bank.
Keki Mistry was appointed as Interim Chairman after **Atanu Chakraborty** voluntarily stepped down in **March 2026**, citing ethical concerns and issues inconsistent with his personal values.
Rajiv Kumar's appointment is subject to the **approval of the Reserve Bank of India (RBI)**.

104. In 2026, Bharat Petroleum Corporation Limited (BPCL), through BPRL Ventures BV, acquired the remaining 34.6% stake in IBV Brazil Petroleo Limitada from which company?
A.ONGC Videsh Brazil Limited
B.Videocon Energy Brazil Limited
C.Reliance Brazil Energy Limited
D.Cairn Brazil Offshore Limited
E.Petrobras India Ventures Limited
Answer: B
Short Explanation:
Bharat Petroleum Corporation Limited (BPCL), through its overseas subsidiary **BPRL Ventures BV** (Bharat PetroResources Limited Ventures BV), acquired the remaining **34.6%**

stake of **Videocon Energy Brazil Limited (VEBL)** in **IBV Brazil Petroleo Limitada**.

With this acquisition, BPCL's shareholding in IBV Brazil Petroleo Limitada increased from **65.40% to 100%**, making it a **wholly owned subsidiary** of BPRL Ventures BV.

Detailed Explanation:

Bharat Petroleum Corporation Limited (BPCL), through its overseas subsidiary **BPRL Ventures BV** (Bharat PetroResources Limited Ventures BV), acquired the remaining **34.6% stake** of **Videocon Energy Brazil Limited (VEBL)** in **IBV Brazil Petroleo Limitada**.

With this acquisition, BPCL's shareholding in IBV Brazil Petroleo Limitada increased from **65.40% to 100%**, making it a **wholly owned subsidiary** of BPRL Ventures BV.

The acquisition was completed through a deal valued at **₹2,312 crore**.

The transaction was executed under the **Corporate Insolvency Resolution Process (CIRP)** of **VOVL Limited**.

The acquisition received approvals from the **Government of India (GoI)** and is subject to final registration by the **Brazilian authorities**, in accordance with the **National Company Law Tribunal (NCLT)** order.

IBV Brazil Petroleo Limitada holds participating interests in **Brazilian oil and gas assets**, including the strategically important **BM-SEAL-11 concession**, which is currently under development.

105. In 2026, which institution, in collaboration with DRDO and a domestic startup, developed India's first indigenous tactical aerostat?

A.IIT Bombay

B.IIT Madras

C.IIT Kanpur

D.IIT Delhi

E.IISc Bengaluru

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The **Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) Delhi**, in collaboration with the **Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO)** and a domestic startup, developed **India's first indigenous tactical aerostat**.

The indigenous tactical aerostat is a **low-cost, high-altitude, balloon-based platform** capable of carrying **surveillance and communication payloads** with an operational coverage of **up to 20 km**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) Delhi**, in collaboration with the **Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO)** and a domestic startup, developed **India's first indigenous tactical aerostat**.

The indigenous tactical aerostat is a **low-cost, high-altitude, balloon-based platform** capable of carrying **surveillance and communication payloads** with an operational coverage of **up to 20 km**.

The platform is equipped with **Electro-optical (EO) cameras, Infrared (IR) sensors**,

and **communication relay systems** for persistent aerial surveillance and communication support.

Compared to drones, the tactical aerostat offers **higher endurance, greater payload capacity, persistent surveillance**, and **extended communication support**.

The system is primarily designed for **defence surveillance** and has future applications in **border security, disaster response, emergency communication**, and civilian connectivity.

106. In 2026, the Ministry of Civil Aviation approved India's first Private Point-in-Space (PinS) Instrument Approach Procedure for helicopter operations at which heliport?

A.Begumpet Heliport, Hyderabad

B.Undavalli Heliport, Amaravati

C.Juhu Heliport, Mumbai

D.HAL Heliport, Bengaluru

E.Pawan Hans Heliport, New Delhi

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The **Ministry of Civil Aviation (MoCA)** approved **India's first Private Point-in-Space (PinS) Instrument Approach Procedure** for helicopter operations at **Undavalli Heliport, Amaravati, Andhra Pradesh**.

The **PinS Instrument Approach Procedure** was developed by the **Airports Authority of India (AAI)** and approved by the **Directorate General of Civil Aviation (DGCA)**.

The procedure has been developed in accordance with DGCA regulations and the **International Civil Aviation Organization (ICAO)** Standards and Recommended Practices (SARPs).

Detailed Explanation:

The **Ministry of Civil Aviation (MoCA)** approved **India's first Private Point-in-Space (PinS) Instrument Approach Procedure** for helicopter operations at **Undavalli Heliport, Amaravati, Andhra Pradesh**.

The **PinS Instrument Approach Procedure** was developed by the **Airports Authority of India (AAI)** and approved by the **Directorate General of Civil Aviation (DGCA)**.

The procedure has been developed in accordance with DGCA regulations and the **International Civil Aviation Organization (ICAO)** Standards and Recommended Practices (SARPs).

Point-in-Space (PinS) is a **satellite-guided instrument approach procedure** designed specifically for helicopter operations.

The system is based on **Performance-Based Navigation (PBN)** using the **Global Navigation Satellite System (GNSS)** together with India's **GAGAN (GPS Aided GEO Augmented Navigation)** system.

The PinS procedure enables helicopters to perform **safe and precise approaches to**

heliports without depending on ground-based radar or **Instrument Landing System (ILS)** infrastructure.

107. In 2026, which statutory body operates the 24×7 Women Helpline 14490 to provide complaint registration, counselling, and support to women in distress?

A.National Commission for Women
B.Ministry of Women and Child Development
C.National Human Rights Commission
D.National Legal Services Authority
E.Central Social Welfare Board

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

National Commission for Women (NCW) is the **apex statutory body** established to protect, promote, and safeguard the **rights and interests of women** in India.

NCW works on issues such as **dowry, domestic violence, equal employment opportunities, labour exploitation**, and women's welfare and empowerment.

To support women in distress, NCW operates the **24×7 Women Helpline – 14490**, providing a **Digital Complaint Registration System** for women affected by violence and abuse.

Detailed Explanation:

National Commission for Women (NCW) is the **apex statutory body** established to protect, promote, and safeguard the **rights and interests of women** in India.

NCW works on issues such as **dowry, domestic violence, equal employment opportunities, labour exploitation**, and women's welfare and empowerment.

To support women in distress, NCW operates the **24×7 Women Helpline – 14490**, providing a **Digital Complaint Registration System** for women affected by violence and abuse.

The **Women Helpline – 14490** is a **toll-free**, easy-to-remember short code linked to the existing **NCW Helpline – 7827170170**.

Women and girls **aged 18 years and above** can contact the 14490 Helpline to **register complaints, seek immediate assistance**, and receive **psychological counselling**.

The helpline is staffed by **trained psychological counsellors** from leading mental health and counselling institutions, ensuring professional, confidential, and compassionate support.

108. In 2026, LokOS was developed under which Government of India programme for the end-to-end digitization of Self-Help Groups (SHGs) and their federations?

A.Deendayal Antyodaya Yojana–National Rural Livelihoods Mission
B.Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana
C.National Urban Livelihoods Mission
D.Digital India Programme
E.Startup India Mission

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

LokOS (Lok = People, OS = Operating System) is a web and mobile digital platform developed under the **Deendayal Antyodaya**

Yojana–National Rural Livelihoods Mission (DAY-NRLM) for the **end-to-end digitization of Self-Help Groups (SHGs)** and their federations.
DAY-NRLM is the Government of India's flagship **rural poverty alleviation programme**, promoting self-employment, skilled jobs, and sustainable livelihoods for poor rural households.
LokOS digitizes the functioning of Self-Help Groups (SHGs) and Community-Based Organizations (CBOs) by maintaining member records, profiles, savings, loans, repayments, financial transactions, livelihood records, and government scheme convergence.
Detailed Explanation:
LokOS (Lok = People, OS = Operating System) is a web and mobile digital platform developed under the **Deendayal Antyodaya Yojana–National Rural Livelihoods Mission (DAY-NRLM)** for the **end-to-end digitization of Self-Help Groups (SHGs)** and their federations.
DAY-NRLM is the Government of India's flagship **rural poverty alleviation programme**, promoting self-employment, skilled jobs, and sustainable livelihoods for poor rural households.
LokOS digitizes the functioning of Self-Help Groups (SHGs) and Community-Based Organizations (CBOs) by maintaining member records, profiles, savings, loans, repayments, financial transactions, livelihood records, and government scheme convergence.
The platform reduces manual record-keeping, enables **real-time transaction tracking**, enhances transparency, accountability, and operational efficiency, and digitally captures nearly **₹2 lakh crore worth of SHG financial transactions annually**.
The **LokOS Web Application** is designed for administrators, E-bookkeepers, and transaction approvers to create, manage, and approve SHGs, **Village Organizations (VOs)**, **Cluster Level Federations (CLFs)**, and their members.
The **LokOS Mobile Application** enables **field-level recording and management** of Community-Based Organization (CBO) activities, ensuring efficient data collection and monitoring.
SHE-LEAPS (Self-Help Entrepreneur–Livelihoods and Enterprise Application for Prosperity and Sustainability) was launched on **29 June 2026** and is implemented under the LokOS platform to **empower rural women entrepreneurs** associated with SHGs.

109. In 2026, ACME Group signed a long-term agreement with Mitsubishi Gas Chemical (MGC), Japan, to supply 100,000 tonnes of green methanol annually from its upcoming facility located in which state?

A.Gujarat
B.Andhra Pradesh
C.Maharashtra
D.Tamil Nadu
E.Odisha

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

ACME Group has signed a **binding long-term agreement** worth nearly **US$1 billion** with **Mitsubishi Gas Chemical (MGC), Japan**, to supply **100,000 tonnes of green methanol annually** from its upcoming production facility at **Paradip, Odisha**.

The agreement was announced during the **16th India-Japan Annual Summit** and strengthens **India-Japan cooperation in clean energy, sustainable industrial development, and resilient supply chains**.

The green methanol produced by **ACME Group** will primarily be used as **marine fuel in Japan**, supporting the shipping industry's efforts to reduce greenhouse gas emissions and meet global environmental standards.

Detailed Explanation:

ACME Group has signed a **binding long-term agreement** worth nearly **US$1 billion** with **Mitsubishi Gas Chemical (MGC), Japan**, to supply **100,000 tonnes of green methanol annually** from its upcoming production facility at **Paradip, Odisha**.

The agreement was announced during the **16th India-Japan Annual Summit** and strengthens **India-Japan cooperation in clean energy, sustainable industrial development, and resilient supply chains**.

The green methanol produced by **ACME Group** will primarily be used as **marine fuel in Japan**, supporting the shipping industry's efforts to reduce greenhouse gas emissions and meet global environmental standards.

The project is one of **India's largest commercial green fuel export initiatives** and provides a long-term overseas market for Indian-produced green methanol.

Green methanol is produced by combining **green hydrogen**, generated using renewable energy, with **captured carbon dioxide (CO_2)**, making it a low-carbon alternative to conventional fuels.

110. In 2026, World Zoonoses Day is observed annually on which date to raise awareness about diseases that spread between animals and humans?

A.5 July

B.6 July

C.7 July

D.8 July

E.9 July

Answer: B

World Zoonoses Day 2026 is observed globally on **6 July 2026** to raise awareness about **zoonotic diseases**, which are diseases that spread between **animals and humans**.

The day commemorates the **first successful administration of the rabies vaccine** by **Louis Pasteur**, a French biologist and microbiologist, to **Joseph Meister** on **6 July 1885**, after he was bitten by a rabid dog.

The observance aims to promote awareness about the **prevention, surveillance, and control of zoonotic diseases** through the **One Health** approach, which recognises the

interconnected health of humans, animals, and the environment.

111. In 2026, what was the theme of the International Day of Cooperatives observed on 4 July 2026?

A.Cooperatives Build a Better Future for All
B.Cooperatives for Sustainable Communities
C.Cooperatives for a Peaceful World
D.Cooperatives Driving Inclusive Growth
E.Cooperatives for Climate Resilience

Answer: C

International Day of Cooperatives 2026 was observed globally on **4 July 2026**, the **first Saturday of July**.

The **2026 theme** is **"Cooperatives for a Peaceful World"**, highlighting the role of cooperatives in promoting peace, social cohesion, inclusion, solidarity, and sustainable development.

The **International Cooperative Alliance (ICA)** has observed the day since **1923**.

112. In 2026, what is the tagline of HDFC Bank?

A.Hum Hai Na
B.We understand your world
C.Apno ka bank
D.Trusted for generations
E.Banking for tomorrow

Answer: B

About HDFC Bank:

Headquarters: Mumbai, Maharashtra, India
Managing Director & CEO: Sashidhar Jagdishan
Tagline: "We understand your world"

113. In 2026, Gunveer Singh was appointed as Executive Director (ED) of the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) to oversee which department?

A.Department of Regulation
B.Department of Supervision
C.Department of Statistics and Information Management
D.Department of Economic and Policy Research
E.Department of Payment and Settlement Systems

Answer: E

About RBI :

Established: 1 April 1935 under the **Reserve Bank of India Act, 1934**, and serves as India's central bank.
Nationalised: 1 January 1949
Headquarters: Mumbai, Maharashtra
Governor: Sanjay Malhotra (26th Governor)
Deputy Governors: Rohit Jain, Shirish Chandra Murmu, Swaminathan Janakiraman, Poonam Gupta
Wholly Owned by RBI:
BRBNMPL – Bharatiya Reserve Bank Note Mudran Private Limited
DICGC – Deposit Insurance and Credit Guarantee Corporation
ReBIT – Reserve Bank Information Technology Private Limited
RBIH – Reserve Bank Innovation Hub
Promoted by RBI (Now Government-owned):
NABARD – National Bank for Agriculture and Rural Development

NHB – National Housing Bank

The RBI is responsible for **monetary policy, currency management**, and **regulation of the financial system**.

The RBI organisational structure consists of **15 Executive Directors (EDs)** and **1 Chief Financial Officer (CFO)** overseeing key functional departments.

Gunveer Singh was recently appointed as **Executive Director (ED)** of the **Department of Payment and Settlement Systems (DPSS)**.

114. In 2026, the Unique Identification Authority of India (UIDAI) was originally established in which year?

A.2007

B.2008

C.2009

D.2010

E.2011

Answer: C

About Unique Identification Authority of India (UIDAI)

Established: 2009

Headquarters: New Delhi

Parent Ministry: Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY)

Chief Executive Officer (CEO): Saurabh Vijay

115. In 2026, what is the capital of Mali?

A.Dakar

B.Accra

C.Niamey

D.Bamako

E.Conakry

Answer: D

About Mali

Capital: Bamako

Currency: West African CFA Franc (XOF)

President (Transition): Assimi Goïta

Prime Minister: Abdoulaye Maïga

116. As per the news, the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) imposed a monetary penalty of ₹63.6 lakh on which institution for violations related to KYC norms, charging excess interest, and the FairPractices Code for Lenders?

A.GIC Housing Finance

B.Bank of Baroda

C.HDFC Bank

D.LIC Housing Finance

E.Punjab National Bank

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** imposed a combined monetary penalty of **Rs. 66.7 lakh** on **Bank of Baroda (BoB)** and **GIC Housing Finance** for non-compliance with regulatory directions.

The penalties were imposed for violations related to **Know Your Customer (KYC) norms**, **lending guidelines**, and the **Fair Practices Code for Lenders**.

The RBI detected these deficiencies during its **supervisory inspection** of the institutions.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** imposed a combined monetary penalty of **Rs. 66.7 lakh** on **Bank of Baroda (BoB)** and **GIC Housing Finance** for non-compliance with regulatory directions.

The penalties were imposed for violations related to **Know Your Customer (KYC) norms**, **lending guidelines**, and the **Fair Practices Code for Lenders**.

The RBI detected these deficiencies during its **supervisory inspection** of the institutions.

Bank of Baroda (BoB) was penalized **Rs. 63.6 lakh** for **charging interest rates higher than the contracted rates**, failing to upload KYC records to the **Central KYC Records Registry (CKYCR)** within the prescribed timelines, and violating the **Fair Practices Code for Lenders**.

GIC Housing Finance was imposed a penalty of **Rs. 3.1 lakh** for deficiencies in compliance with **KYC guidelines**.

117. As per the news, the Asian Development Bank (ADB) approved a USD 230 million loan for which project in Tamil Nadu?

A.Chennai Coastal Resilience Project

B.Chennai Urban Water and Sanitation Modernisation Project

C.Tamil Nadu Smart Drainage Mission

D.Greater Chennai Clean Water Initiative

E.Chennai Metro Water Expansion Project

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The **Asian Development Bank (ADB)** approved a **USD 230 million (approximately Rs. 1,920 crore) loan** to modernise and expand Chennai's water supply and sanitation infrastructure in Tamil Nadu (TN).

The **Chennai Urban Water and Sanitation Modernisation Project** is expected to benefit around **4.5 million residents** in the Greater Chennai Area.

The project is aligned with the **Atal Mission for Rejuvenation and Urban Transformation (AMRUT) 2.0** and the **Urban Challenge Fund**, supporting India's urban infrastructure modernisation.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Asian Development Bank (ADB)** approved a **USD 230 million (approximately Rs. 1,920 crore) loan** to modernise and expand Chennai's water supply and sanitation infrastructure in Tamil Nadu (TN).

The **Chennai Urban Water and Sanitation Modernisation Project** is expected to benefit around **4.5 million residents** in the Greater Chennai Area.

The project is aligned with the **Atal Mission for Rejuvenation and Urban Transformation (AMRUT) 2.0** and the **Urban Challenge Fund**, supporting India's urban infrastructure modernisation.

Under the project, more than **170 kilometres (km) of water supply and sewer pipelines** will be constructed to improve urban water distribution and sanitation.

The project includes the upgradation of **7 water pumping stations** and **38 sewer pumping stations** to enhance operational efficiency.

Performance-based contracts will be used to strengthen water utility assets, improve operations management, and ensure long-term sustainability.

Chennai will become the **first Indian city** to implement a comprehensive **Ring-Main Water Distribution System**, ensuring balanced water pressure, efficient distribution, equitable supply, and greater resilience to natural hazards.

118. As per the news, Paytm Europe Payments S.A. received a Payment Institution (PI) Licence from which financial regulator?

A.European Central Bank (ECB)

B.European Banking Authority (EBA)

C.Financial Conduct Authority (FCA)

D.Commission de Surveillance du Secteur Financier (CSSF)

E.Banque de France

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

Paytm Europe Payments S.A., the European arm of **One97 Communications (Paytm)**, secured a **Payment Institution (PI) Licence** from Luxembourg's financial regulator, **Commission de Surveillance du Secteur Financier (CSSF)**.

The PI Licence was officially registered on the CSSF list of payment institutions with effect from **2 July 2026**.

The licence authorises Paytm Europe to offer regulated payment services across the **European Economic Area (EEA)**.

The regulatory approval followed Paytm's **May 2026** announcement that **Paytm Cloud Technologies Limited (PCTL)** would invest an additional **EUR 9 million** in Paytm Europe Payments S.A.

Detailed Explanation:

Paytm Europe Payments S.A., the European arm of **One97 Communications (Paytm)**, secured a **Payment Institution (PI) Licence** from Luxembourg's financial regulator, **Commission de Surveillance du Secteur Financier (CSSF)**.

The PI Licence was officially registered on the CSSF list of payment institutions with effect from **2 July 2026**.

The licence authorises Paytm Europe to offer regulated payment services across the **European Economic Area (EEA)**.

The regulatory approval followed Paytm's **May 2026** announcement that **Paytm Cloud Technologies Limited (PCTL)** would invest an additional **EUR 9 million** in Paytm Europe Payments S.A.

The **EUR 9 million** capital infusion is intended to meet business funding requirements and increase the company's paid-up capital.

The licence enables Paytm Europe to execute **payment transactions and credit transfers**, including **standing orders**, through payment accounts and credit lines.

The approval also authorises the company to provide **payment-acquiring services** across the EEA.

119. As per the news, which type of tax system is Goods and Services Tax (GST) in India?

A.Origin-based production tax

B.Destination-based consumption tax

C.Export-based customs tax

D.Direct income tax

E.Wealth-based taxation system

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Goods and Services Tax (GST) was launched on **1 July 2017** under the vision of **"One Nation, One Tax"**, replacing **17 indirect taxes and 13 cesses** with a unified indirect tax system.

GST eliminated the **cascading effect of taxes (tax on tax)**, created a common national market, and strengthened the vision of **"Ek Bharat – Shreshtha Bharat."**

GST is a **destination-based consumption tax**, where tax revenue accrues to the State in which goods or services are finally consumed.

GST is levied on the **supply of goods and services** rather than separately on manufacture, sale, or services.

Detailed Explanation:

Goods and Services Tax (GST) was launched on **1 July 2017** under the vision of **"One Nation, One Tax"**, replacing **17 indirect taxes and 13 cesses** with a unified indirect tax system.

GST eliminated the **cascading effect of taxes (tax on tax)**, created a common national market, and strengthened the vision of **"Ek Bharat – Shreshtha Bharat."**

GST is a **destination-based consumption tax**, where tax revenue accrues to the State in which goods or services are finally consumed.

GST is levied on the **supply of goods and services** rather than separately on manufacture, sale, or services.

India follows a **Dual GST Model**, comprising **Central Goods and Services Tax (CGST)**, **State Goods and Services Tax (SGST)**, and **Integrated Goods and Services Tax (IGST)** for inter-state supplies.

IGST is levied on inter-state supplies, and its rate is generally **twice the CGST/SGST rate**.

The **GST Council** is a statutory body that promotes **co-operative federalism** by enabling joint decision-making between the Central Government and State Governments.

120. As per the news, the newly inaugurated CG Semi facility at Sanand, Gujarat, is related to which segment of semiconductor manufacturing?

A.Wafer fabrication only

B.Chip design software development

C.Outsourced Semiconductor Assembly and Test (OSAT)

D.Rare earth mineral extraction

E.Solar semiconductor coating

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

Prime Minister Narendra Modi inaugurated the **CG Semi Outsourced Semiconductor Assembly and Test (OSAT) Facility** at **Sanand, Gujarat**, marking a major

milestone in India's semiconductor manufacturing journey.

The facility has been developed under the **Semicon India Programme** to strengthen India's semiconductor ecosystem by expanding **chip assembly, packaging, and testing** capabilities.

Detailed Explanation:

Prime Minister Narendra Modi inaugurated the **CG Semi Outsourced Semiconductor Assembly and Test (OSAT) Facility** at **Sanand, Gujarat**, marking a major milestone in India's semiconductor manufacturing journey.

The facility has been developed under the **Semicon India Programme** to strengthen India's semiconductor ecosystem by expanding **chip assembly, packaging, and testing** capabilities.

The project supports India's vision of building a **complete semiconductor value chain**, covering **chip design, fabrication, assembly, packaging, and testing**, while promoting technological self-reliance.

An **Outsourced Semiconductor Assembly and Test (OSAT)** facility performs the final stages of semiconductor manufacturing, including:

Semiconductor chip assembly

Chip packaging

Electrical testing

Quality assurance

Reliability testing

Verification of packaging specifications

OSAT facilities ensure semiconductor chips are ready for use in **smartphones, automobiles, industrial equipment, and consumer electronics**.

121. As per the news, which initiative was launched by the Delhi Government to modernise the infrastructure of government schools?

A.Mission Shiksha Setu

B.Mission Pragati Path

C.Mission Vidya Jyoti

D.Mission School Vikas

E.Mission Kayakalp

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

The **Delhi Government** has launched **Mission Kayakalp**, a comprehensive initiative to modernise the infrastructure of **government schools** and provide students with a **safe, clean, inclusive, and technology-enabled learning environment**.

The mission aims to upgrade school infrastructure through **repair of school buildings, modernisation of laboratories, improvement of sanitation facilities, provision of safe drinking water, and enhancement of campus amenities**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Delhi Government** has launched **Mission Kayakalp**, a comprehensive initiative to modernise the infrastructure of **government schools** and provide students with a **safe,**

clean, inclusive, and technology-enabled learning environment.

The mission aims to upgrade school infrastructure through **repair of school buildings, modernisation of laboratories, improvement of sanitation facilities, provision of safe drinking water, and enhancement of campus amenities**.

According to **Chief Minister Rekha Gupta**, the objective is to transform government schools into **modern, clean, and inspiring centres of learning**.

Mission Kayakalp focuses on improving the **quality of educational infrastructure**, ensuring **safe and hygienic learning conditions**, strengthening **water and sanitation facilities**, upgrading **science laboratories and other educational facilities**, and enhancing **accessibility for children with disabilities**.

122. As per the news, India will chair the Ninth Session of the Intergovernmental Group of Experts (IGE) on which subject under UNCTAD?

A.International Trade and Tariff Reforms

B.Consumer Protection Law and Policy

C.Climate Finance and Sustainable Investment

D.Digital Public Infrastructure Governance

E.Competition in Global Agriculture Markets

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

India will chair the **Ninth Session of the Intergovernmental Group of Experts (IGE) on Consumer Protection Law and Policy**, organised by the **United Nations Trade and Development (UNCTAD)**.

The **three-day meeting** will be held at the **Palais des Nations, Geneva, Switzerland**.

The session will bring together **policymakers, regulators, consumer protection authorities, and international organisations** to discuss emerging consumer protection challenges and strengthen international cooperation.

Detailed Explanation:

India will chair the **Ninth Session of the Intergovernmental Group of Experts (IGE) on Consumer Protection Law and Policy**, organised by the **United Nations Trade and Development (UNCTAD)**.

The **three-day meeting** will be held at the **Palais des Nations, Geneva, Switzerland**.

The session will bring together **policymakers, regulators, consumer protection authorities, and international organisations** to discuss emerging consumer protection challenges and strengthen international cooperation.

The **Intergovernmental Group of Experts (IGE) on Consumer Protection Law and Policy** functions under the **United Nations Guidelines for Consumer Protection (UNGCP)** and serves as the principal global platform for cooperation on consumer protection policies.

Nidhi Khare, **Secretary, Department of Consumer Affairs**, will lead the Indian delegation and chair the session, facilitating

discussions and building consensus among member countries.

123. As per the news, India Commemorates 125th Birth Anniversary of Dr. Syama Prasad Mookerjee. He is known as the founder of which political party in 1951?

A.Bharatiya Jana Sangh

B.Bharatiya Janata Party

C.Swatantra Party

D.Indian National Congress

E.Praja Socialist Party

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

India commemorated the **125th birth anniversary of Dr. Syama Prasad Mookerjee** on **6 July 2026**, honouring his contributions as a **statesman, educationist, lawyer, parliamentarian, and nationalist leader**.

Dr. Syama Prasad Mookerjee was born on **6 July 1901** in **Calcutta (now Kolkata), West Bengal**.

In **1951**, **Dr. Syama Prasad Mookerjee** founded the **Bharatiya Jana Sangh (BJS)**, which later evolved into the **Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP)**.

Detailed Explanation:

India commemorated the **125th birth anniversary of Dr. Syama Prasad Mookerjee** on **6 July 2026**, honouring his contributions as a **statesman, educationist, lawyer, parliamentarian, and nationalist leader**.

Dr. Syama Prasad Mookerjee was born on **6 July 1901** in **Calcutta (now Kolkata), West Bengal**.

He served as **India's first Minister for Industry and Supply** in the **first Union Cabinet** headed by **Prime Minister Jawaharlal Nehru** after Independence and played a key role in laying the foundation for India's industrial development.

In **1934**, at the age of **33**, he became the **youngest Vice-Chancellor of the University of Calcutta**, where he introduced academic reforms, promoted research, encouraged the use of Indian languages, and strengthened higher education.

In **1951**, **Dr. Syama Prasad Mookerjee** founded the **Bharatiya Jana Sangh (BJS)**, which later evolved into the **Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP)**.

124. As per the news, the AI for Good Global Commission was launched by which organisation?

A.World Economic Forum (WEF)

B.UNESCO

C.United Nations Development Programme (UNDP)

D.International Telecommunication Union (ITU)

E.Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD)

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The **International Telecommunication Union (ITU)**, a **United Nations (UN)-backed agency**, launched the **Artificial Intelligence (AI) for**

Good Global Commission in **Geneva, Switzerland**.

The AI for Good Global Commission was launched with **44 founding members** to strengthen **global AI governance, digital inclusion, trust, and innovation frameworks**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **International Telecommunication Union (ITU)**, a **United Nations (UN)-backed agency**, launched the **Artificial Intelligence (AI) for Good Global Commission** in **Geneva, Switzerland**.

The AI for Good Global Commission was launched with **44 founding members** to strengthen **global AI governance, digital inclusion, trust, and innovation frameworks**.

The primary objective of the Commission is to ensure **Artificial Intelligence (AI)** is used as a **force for global good** by promoting equitable digital inclusion, expanding AI access, strengthening trust, and addressing global inequalities caused by the digital divide.

India is represented among the founding members by **Mukesh Ambani** (Chairman & Managing Director of Reliance Industries), **Sunil Bharti Mittal** (Founder & Chairman of Bharti Enterprises Limited), and **Lakshmi N. Mittal** (Executive Chairman of ArcelorMittal S.A.).

125. As per the news, which edition of the India-Japan Annual Summit was recently held in New Delhi during the visit of Japanese Prime Minister Sanae Takaichi?

A.14th

B.16th

C.15th

D.17th

E.18th

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The **16th India-Japan Annual Summit** was held in **New Delhi**, where both countries announced **16 key outcomes** to deepen bilateral cooperation.

The **16 key outcomes** cover strategic sectors including **Artificial Intelligence (AI)**, **economic security**, **clean energy**, **critical minerals**, **mobility**, **biotechnology**, **pharmaceuticals**, and **financial services**.

Detailed Explanation:

Japanese Prime Minister **Sanae Takaichi** paid a **3-day official visit to India** from **1–3 July 2026** at the invitation of Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** to participate in the **16th India-Japan Annual Summit**.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi held a bilateral meeting with PM Sanae Takaichi at **Hyderabad House, New Delhi**, focusing on **economic cooperation**, **resilient semiconductor supply chains**, and **critical technologies**.

The **16th India-Japan Annual Summit** was held in **New Delhi**, where both countries announced **16 key outcomes** to deepen bilateral cooperation.

The **16 key outcomes** cover strategic sectors including **Artificial Intelligence (AI)**, **economic security**, **clean energy**, **critical**

minerals, **mobility**, **biotechnology**, **pharmaceuticals**, and **financial services**.

126. As per the news, the Indian Council of Medical Research (ICMR) received the Gold Award at the National Awards for e-Governance 2026 for which AI-powered platform?

A.ICMR-HEALTHNET

B.ICMR-DIGIHEAL

C.ICMR-SANJEEVANI

D.ICMR-MEDCARE

E.ICMR-MINDS

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

The **Indian Council of Medical Research (ICMR)** received the **Gold Award** at the **National Awards for e-Governance 2026** under the category **"Innovation through the Use of Artificial Intelligence (AI) and Other New Age Technologies to Deliver Citizen-Centric Services."**

The award was conferred for **ICMR-MINDS**, an **Artificial Intelligence (AI)-powered mental health management platform** designed to improve access to quality mental healthcare across India.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Indian Council of Medical Research (ICMR)** received the **Gold Award** at the **National Awards for e-Governance 2026** under the category **"Innovation through the Use of Artificial Intelligence (AI) and Other New Age Technologies to Deliver Citizen-Centric Services."**

The award was conferred for **ICMR-MINDS**, an **Artificial Intelligence (AI)-powered mental health management platform** designed to improve access to quality mental healthcare across India.

The award was presented during the **29th National Conference on e-Governance (NCeG)**, held in **Jaipur, Rajasthan**, on **1–2 July 2026**.

Dr. Jitendra Singh, **Union Minister of State for Personnel, Public Grievances and Pensions**, presented the award to the **Indian Council of Medical Research (ICMR)**.

ICMR-MINDS aims to integrate **mental healthcare** with the management of **Non-Communicable Diseases (NCDs)** by enabling trained frontline healthcare workers to deliver **standardised, evidence-based mental health services** through digital tools.

127. As per the news, who has assumed charge as the Chairman and Managing Director (CMD) of Hindustan Shipyard Limited (HSL)?

A.Captain Ganti Venkateswarlu

B.Rear Admiral (Retd.) C. Raghuram

C.Sanjeev Kumar

D.Admiral R. Hari Kumar

E.P. S. Reddy

Answer: B

Rear Admiral (Retd.) Chadrasekhran (C.) Raghuram assumed charge as the **Chairman**

and Managing Director (CMD) of **Hindustan Shipyard Limited (HSL)** at Visakhapatnam, Andhra Pradesh.

2026. Raghuram succeeded **Captain Ganti Venkateswarlu**, who had been holding the additional charge of CMD since **January 2026**.

128. As per the news, who was declared the winner of Peru's 2026 Presidential Election?

A.Dina Boluarte

B.José María Balcázar

C.Pedro Castillo

D.Keiko Fujimori

E.Rafael López Aliaga

Answer: D

Keiko Fujimori, leader of the conservative **Popular Force Party**, was declared the winner of **Peru's 2026 Presidential Election** after a closely contested runoff.

Keiko Fujimori is scheduled to assume office on **28 July 2026** as the **President of Peru**. She will succeed interim President **José María Balcázar**.

129. As per the news, VIJAY, unveiled by General Dhiraj Seth after assuming charge as Chief of the Army Staff, stands for_____

A.Vision, Integrity, Joint Operations, Agility and Youth

B.Vigilance, Innovation, Jointness and Integration, Aatmanirbharta, and Yodha first

C.Victory, Intelligence, Justice, Action and Yield

D.Valour, Initiative, Growth, Joint Command and Advancement

E.Vigilance, Infrastructure, Governance, Jawan Welfare and Yearly Modernisation

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

General Dhiraj Seth assumed charge as the **31st Chief of the Army Staff (COAS)** of the **Indian Army (IA)** and unveiled the **'VIJAY' roadmap** to build a technology-driven, future-ready military force.

VIJAY stands for **Vigilance, Innovation, Jointness and Integration, Aatmanirbharta, and Yodha first**.

Detailed Explanation:

General Dhiraj Seth assumed charge as the **31st Chief of the Army Staff (COAS)** of the **Indian Army (IA)** and unveiled the **'VIJAY' roadmap** to build a technology-driven, future-ready military force.

VIJAY stands for **Vigilance, Innovation, Jointness and Integration, Aatmanirbharta, and Yodha first**.

The VIJAY roadmap is aligned with the **Ministry of Defence (MoD)**'s **'Decade of Transformation (2023–2032)'**, focusing on transforming the Indian Army into a digitized, technology-enabled, self-reliant (**Aatmanirbhar**), and multi-domain-capable force.

The **VIJAY framework** was developed under the direction of the Chief of the Army Staff

(COAS) and will be implemented across all **operational commands of the Indian Army**.

130. As per the news, AgniKul Cosmos signed an MoU with which company to develop an end-to-end Synthetic Aperture Radar (SAR) Earth-observation ecosystem from India?

A.SpaceX
B.Arianespace
C.OneWeb
D.Planet Labs
E.ICEYE

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

AgniKul Cosmos Private Limited, an Indian private space startup, signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** with **ICEYE**, a Finland-based Earth observation company, to jointly develop an end-to-end **Synthetic Aperture Radar (SAR)** Earth-observation ecosystem from India.

The MoU was signed during the **Bharat Innovates Summit**, held in **Nice, France**, from **30 June to 1 July 2026**.

Detailed Explanation:

AgniKul Cosmos Private Limited, an Indian private space startup, signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** with **ICEYE**, a Finland-based Earth observation company, to jointly develop an end-to-end **Synthetic Aperture Radar (SAR)** Earth-observation ecosystem from India.

The MoU was signed during the **Bharat Innovates Summit**, held in **Nice, France**, from **30 June to 1 July 2026**.

The collaboration combines ICEYE's advanced **SAR satellite technology** with AgniKul Cosmos' **indigenous launch vehicle capability**.

The partnership aims to establish a **sovereign end-to-end space ecosystem** in India, reducing dependence on foreign space systems.

Synthetic Aperture Radar (SAR) satellites use **radar technology** instead of optical cameras to capture high-resolution Earth images, irrespective of **cloud cover, weather conditions, or day and night**.

131. As per the news, ABHA under the Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission (ABDM) is a:

A.10-digit hospital registration code
B.12-digit insurance policy number
C.14-digit unique digital health identifier
D.16-digit digital prescription number
E.8-digit patient verification code

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission (ABDM) was launched in **September 2021** by the **Government of India** to create an integrated, citizen-centric national digital health ecosystem.

ABHA (Ayushman Bharat Health Account) is a **14-digit unique digital health identifier** that securely links an individual's health records,

healthcare providers, insurers, and national health programmes, similar to Aadhaar.

Healthcare Professionals Registry (HPR) is the national digital registry of verified doctors, AYUSH practitioners, and other healthcare professionals.

Health Facility Registry (HFR) is the national digital registry of hospitals, clinics, diagnostic laboratories, pharmacies, and other healthcare facilities across India.

Unified Health Interface (UHI) functions as the **UPI for healthcare**, enabling appointment booking, teleconsultations, doctor discovery, and healthcare services through interoperable applications.

Detailed Explanation:

Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission (ABDM) was launched in **September 2021** by the **Government of India** to create an integrated, citizen-centric national digital health ecosystem.

ABDM is one of the world's largest digital health ecosystems, with over **104 crore health records** linked to more than **93 crore Ayushman Bharat Health Account (ABHA)** accounts.

The mission supports **Universal Health Coverage (UHC)** by enabling quality healthcare services, reducing paperwork, shortening waiting times, and improving healthcare accessibility.

ABDM securely manages digital patient records, connects patients, hospitals, doctors, laboratories, pharmacies, insurers, and enables **seamless portability of health records** across ABDM-enabled healthcare facilities.

Health records under ABDM are shared only through the patient's **revocable and time-bound consent**, ensuring privacy, security, and data protection.

ABHA (Ayushman Bharat Health Account) is a **14-digit unique digital health identifier** that securely links an individual's health records, healthcare providers, insurers, and national health programmes, similar to Aadhaar.

Healthcare Professionals Registry (HPR) is the national digital registry of verified doctors, AYUSH practitioners, and other healthcare professionals.

Health Facility Registry (HFR) is the national digital registry of hospitals, clinics, diagnostic laboratories, pharmacies, and other healthcare facilities across India.

Unified Health Interface (UHI) functions as the **UPI for healthcare**, enabling appointment booking, teleconsultations, doctor discovery, and healthcare services through interoperable applications.

Aarogya Setu 2.0, launched on **29 June 2026** by Union Health Minister **Jagat Prakash Nadda**, has been transformed from a COVID-19 contact tracing application into a citizen-facing digital health application under ABDM.

132. As per the news, the newly discovered deep-sea fish species Cyttopsis indica (Indian dory) was found in which sea region?

A.Bay of Bengal
B.Andaman Sea
C.Arabian Sea
D.Red Sea
E.Mediterranean Sea
Answer: C
Short Explanation:
Researchers from the **Indian Council of Agricultural Research–Central Marine Fisheries Research Institute (ICAR-CMFRI)** discovered a new deep-sea fish species named **Cyttopsis indica (Indian dory)**.
The new species was discovered in the **Arabian Sea** off the **Kerala Coast**.
The detailed findings of the discovery were published in the **Indian Journal of Fisheries**.
Detailed Explanation:
Researchers from the **Indian Council of Agricultural Research–Central Marine Fisheries Research Institute (ICAR-CMFRI)** discovered a new deep-sea fish species named **Cyttopsis indica (Indian dory)**.
The new species was discovered in the **Arabian Sea** off the **Kerala Coast**.
The detailed findings of the discovery were published in the ***Indian Journal of Fisheries***.
Cyttopsis indica was discovered in the eastern region of the **Lakshadweep Sea**.
The species was found at a depth of approximately **350–500 metres** below sea level.
Cyttopsis indica belongs to the genus **Cyttopsis**, a primitive group of marine fishes commonly known as **"dories"**.

133. As per the news, astronomers used which radio array to discover a hidden population of weakly active supermassive black holes in nearby galaxies?
A.ALMA
B.VLA
C.FAST
D.MeerKAT
E.e-MERLIN
Answer: E
Short Explanation:
Astronomers discovered a **hidden population of weakly active supermassive black holes** in nearby galaxies using **high-resolution radio observations**, revealing black holes that were previously difficult to detect.
The team used the **e-MERLIN radio array** to observe **280 nearby galaxies** selected from the **Palomar sample**, examining their central regions on **parsec scales**.
The study detected **compact radio emission** from the centres of nearly **one-quarter of the galaxies**, confirming the presence of **weakly accreting supermassive black holes**.
Detailed Explanation:
Astronomers discovered a **hidden population of weakly active supermassive black holes** in nearby galaxies using **high-resolution radio observations**, revealing black holes that were previously difficult to detect.
The discovery is significant because weakly active black holes **inject energy into their surroundings through jets and outflows**,

influencing **star formation** and the long-term evolution of galaxies.

Astronomers believe that almost every galaxy contains a **supermassive black hole at its centre**, but many remain extremely faint and escape conventional detection.

The research was conducted by an international team of astronomers, including **Dr. Aru Beri** from the **Indian Institute of Astrophysics (IIA)**, an autonomous institute under the **Department of Science and Technology (DST)**.

The team used the **e-MERLIN radio array** to observe **280 nearby galaxies** selected from the **Palomar sample**, examining their central regions on **parsec scales**.

The study detected **compact radio emission** from the centres of nearly **one-quarter of the galaxies**, confirming the presence of **weakly accreting supermassive black holes**.

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134. As per the news, consider the following statements regarding India's performance in the Global Passport Index (GPI) 2026:

India ranked 125th out of 197 countries in the Global Passport Index 2026.

The Global Passport Index is published by Global Citizen Solutions.

India ranked 94th in the Investment Opportunities component of the index.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

A.1 and 2 only

B.2 and 3 only

C.1 and 3 only

D.All are correct

E.1 only

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

India ranked **125th** out of **197 countries** in the **Global Passport Index (GPI) 2026**, published by **Global Citizen Solutions**.

India slipped **one position** from **124th** in the previous edition, despite improving its **overall composite score to 45.1**, the **highest in the last five years**.

The **Global Passport Index (GPI)** evaluates passports based on **Enhanced Mobility (50%)**, **Quality of Living (25%)**, and **Investment Opportunities (25%)**.

India ranked **136th** in **Enhanced Mobility**, **118th** in **Quality of Living**, and **94th** in **Investment Opportunities**.

Detailed Explanation:

India ranked **125th** out of **197 countries** in the **Global Passport Index (GPI) 2026**, published by **Global Citizen Solutions**.

India slipped **one position** from **124th** in the previous edition, despite improving its **overall composite score to 45.1**, the **highest in the last five years**.

The **Global Passport Index (GPI)** evaluates passports based on **Enhanced Mobility (50%)**, **Quality of Living (25%)**, and **Investment Opportunities (25%)**.

India ranked **136th** in **Enhanced Mobility**, **118th** in **Quality of Living**, and **94th** in **Investment Opportunities**.

India's lower overall ranking is primarily due to its **limited visa-free travel access**, although it recorded improvements in quality of living and investment indicators.

Indian passport holders enjoy **visa-free or visa-on-arrival access to around 26 destinations**, including **Bhutan, Nepal, Jamaica, Barbados, Macau, Tunisia, Angola, and Palestine**.

Indian citizens still require visas for several major destinations, including the **United States of America, United Kingdom, Germany, France, China, and United Arab Emirates**.

135. As per the news, consider the following statements regarding the U.S. News & World Report 2026 global rankings:

The United States was ranked as the world's most influential country.

India secured the 16th position in the rankings.

The United Kingdom was ranked third among the world's most influential countries.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

A.1 and 2 only

B.2 and 3 only

C.1 only

D.3 only

E.1 and 3 only

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

According to the **U.S. News & World Report 2026** global rankings, the **United States** has been ranked as the **world's most influential country**, reflecting its leadership in **economic strength, military capability, diplomacy, innovation, and cultural influence**.

The rankings assess countries based on their **overall global influence and national performance** across multiple governance and development indicators.

India secured the **16th position**, highlighting its growing global influence driven by rapid economic growth, digital transformation, strategic partnerships, and expanding diplomatic engagement.

Top 3 Most Influential Countries in the World – 2026

Rank	Country
1	United States
2	United Kingdom
3	Germany

Detailed Explanation:

According to the **U.S. News & World Report 2026** global rankings, the **United States** has been ranked as the **world's most influential country**, reflecting its leadership in **economic strength, military capability, diplomacy, innovation, and cultural influence**.

The rankings assess countries based on their **overall global influence and national performance** across multiple governance and development indicators.

India secured the **16th position**, highlighting its growing global influence driven by rapid economic growth, digital transformation, strategic partnerships, and expanding diplomatic engagement.

Top 3 Most Influential Countries in the World – 2026

Rank	Country
1	United States
2	United Kingdom
3	Germany

India ranked **16th**, reflecting its expanding role in **global diplomacy, economic development, technological innovation, and multilateral cooperation**.

The **United States** retained the top position due to its dominance in **technology, finance, defence, higher education, innovation, entertainment, and foreign policy**.

Europe maintained a strong presence, with **six countries—United Kingdom, Germany, France, Netherlands, Sweden, and Switzerland**—featured among the **top 10**.

Japan ranked **5th**, supported by its leadership in **technology, manufacturing, innovation, and economic development**.

China secured the **9th position**, reflecting its continued importance as one of the world's largest economies with significant geopolitical influence.

136. As per the news, which state received the highest number of new Geographical Indication (GI) registrations in FY 2025–26?

A.West Bengal

B.Himachal Pradesh

C.Madhya Pradesh

D.Uttar Pradesh

E.Tamil Nadu

Answer: C

India granted **125 new Geographical Indication (GI) registrations** during **Financial Year (FY) 2025–26**, taking the **total number of registered Geographical Indication (GI) products to 822**.

Madhya Pradesh emerged as the **top state** with **26 new Geographical Indication (GI) registrations**, followed by **West Bengal (24)** and **Himachal Pradesh (13)**.

The rise in **Geographical Indication (GI)** registrations reflects growing efforts by states to protect **traditional products, indigenous knowledge, handicrafts, agricultural produce, and cultural heritage** while improving market access for farmers and artisans.

137. As per the news, Neymar Jr. announced his retirement from international football after Brazil's defeat in the Round of 16 of the 2026 FIFA World Cup against which country?

A.Norway

B.Spain

C.Argentina

D.Germany

E.Portugal

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

Brazilian football star Neymar Jr. announced his retirement from **international football** following **Brazil's 2–1 defeat to Norway** in the **Round of 16** of the **2026 Fédération Internationale de Football Association (FIFA) World Cup** at **MetLife Stadium**.

The announcement marked the end of a **16-year international career (2010–2026)**, during which Neymar became **Brazil's all-time highest goalscorer in men's international football**.

Neymar's farewell came at the **same stadium where he scored his first international goal for Brazil in 2010**, making his international career come full circle.

Detailed Explanation:

Brazilian football star Neymar Jr. announced his retirement from **international football** following **Brazil's 2–1 defeat to Norway** in the **Round of 16** of the **2026 Fédération Internationale de Football Association (FIFA) World Cup** at **MetLife Stadium**.

The announcement marked the end of a **16-year international career (2010–2026)**, during which Neymar became **Brazil's all-time highest goalscorer in men's international football**.

Neymar's farewell came at the **same stadium where he scored his first international goal for Brazil in 2010**, making his international career come full circle.

Neymar surpassed **Pelé** to become **Brazil's highest goalscorer in men's international football**.

Major achievements with Brazil include:

Fédération Internationale de Football Association (FIFA) Confederations Cup Champion (2013)

Olympic Gold Medal (Rio 2016), where he captained Brazil to its **first Olympic football gold medal**.

Brazil's all-time leading men's international goalscorer with **80 goals**.

Neymar represented Brazil in **four FIFA World Cups (2014, 2018, 2022, and 2026)** but did not win the title.

138. As per the news, Vaibhav Sooryavanshi became the youngest player to represent India in international cricket by making his debut in which format?

A.Test cricket

B.One Day International (ODI)

C.Twenty20 International (T20I)

D.Under-19 International

E.First-Class cricket

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

Vaibhav Sooryavanshi became the **youngest player to represent India in international cricket** after making his **Twenty20 International (T20I)** debut against **England** at **Old Trafford, Manchester**.

He made his debut at the age of **15 years and 99 days**, surpassing the long-standing record

of **Sachin Tendulkar**, who debuted for India at **16 years and 205 days** in a **Test match against Pakistan** at **Karachi** in **November 1989**.

Detailed Explanation:

Vaibhav Sooryavanshi became the **youngest player to represent India in international cricket** after making his **Twenty20 International (T20I)** debut against **England** at **Old Trafford, Manchester**. He made his debut at the age of **15 years and 99 days**, surpassing the long-standing record of **Sachin Tendulkar**, who debuted for India at **16 years and 205 days** in a **Test match against Pakistan** at **Karachi** in **November 1989**.

With his debut, **Vaibhav Sooryavanshi** also became the **youngest Indian men's Twenty20 International (T20I) cricketer**.

He surpassed the previous youngest Indian men's **Twenty20 International (T20I)** debutant **Washington Sundar**, who made his debut at **18 years and 80 days** in **2017**.

139. As per the news, which team won the ICC Women's T20 World Cup 2026 by defeating England in the final?

A.India

B.Australia

C.South Africa

D.New Zealand

E.

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Australia defeated host nation **England** by **7 wickets** in the **International Cricket Council (ICC) Women's Twenty20 (T20) World Cup 2026 Final** at the **Lord's Cricket Ground, London** to win a **record seventh Women's T20 World Cup title**.

After being asked to bat first, **England** scored **150/4 in 20 overs**, with captain **Nat Sciver-Brunt** remaining unbeaten on **58**, while **Freya Kemp** contributed an unbeaten **44**.

Australia chased down the target by scoring **153/3 in 17.1 overs**, completing the **highest successful run chase in a Women's T20 World Cup final**.

Detailed Explanation:

Australia defeated host nation **England** by **7 wickets** in the **International Cricket Council (ICC) Women's Twenty20 (T20) World Cup 2026 Final** at the **Lord's Cricket Ground, London** to win a **record seventh Women's T20 World Cup title**.

After being asked to bat first, **England** scored **150/4 in 20 overs**, with captain **Nat Sciver-Brunt** remaining unbeaten on **58**, while **Freya Kemp** contributed an unbeaten **44**.

Australia chased down the target by scoring **153/3 in 17.1 overs**, completing the **highest successful run chase in a Women's T20 World Cup final**.

Beth Mooney anchored the chase with an unbeaten **64 runs off 49 balls**, while **Phoebe**

Litchfield scored a quick **48 runs off 35 balls**, adding a **100-run partnership** for the second wicket.

Beth Mooney was named the **Player of the Match** for her match-winning innings and also received the **Player of the Tournament** award after scoring **238 runs in seven matches**.

140. As per the news, which country ranked 1st in the Global Passport Index (GPI) 2026?

A.Germany

B.Sweden

C.Switzerland

D.United State

E.Singapore

Answer: B

Sweden secured the **top position** with an overall score of **96.05**, while European countries dominated the rankings due to their strong performance in mobility, quality of living, and investment environment.

Among India's neighbours, **China** ranked **104th**, **India 125th**, **Nepal 164th**, **Bangladesh 166th**, and **Pakistan 188th**.

Unlike the **Henley Passport Index**, which ranks passports mainly on **visa-free travel access**, the **Global Passport Index (GPI)** also considers **quality of living** and **investment opportunities**.

141. Recently in news, which non-banking financial company (NBFC) was penalised ₹6.20 lakh by the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) for violations related to KYC Directions and the Fair Practices Code, including failure to implement robust software for identifying suspicious transactions?

A.Can Fin Homes Limited

B.Pahal Financial Services Private Limited

C.Five Star Business Finance Limited

D.Bajaj Finance Limited

E.LIC Housing Finance Limited

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** imposed **monetary penalties** on **Five Star Business Finance Limited**, **Can Fin Homes Limited**, and **Pahal Financial Services Private Limited** for violating **Know Your Customer (KYC) Directions** and the **Fair Practices Code**.

Five Star Business Finance Limited was penalised **₹6.20 lakh** by the RBI.

Can Fin Homes Limited was penalised **₹2.70 lakh** by the RBI.

Pahal Financial Services Private Limited was penalised **₹3.10 lakh** by the RBI.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** imposed **monetary penalties** on **Five Star Business Finance Limited**, **Can Fin Homes Limited**, and **Pahal Financial Services Private Limited** for violating **Know Your Customer (KYC) Directions** and the **Fair Practices Code**.

Five Star Business Finance Limited was penalised **₹6.20 lakh** by the RBI.

Can Fin Homes Limited was penalised **₹2.70 lakh** by the RBI.

Pahal Financial Services Private Limited was penalised **₹3.10 lakh** by the RBI.

Five Star Business Finance Limited was penalised for **failing to implement robust software** to identify and report **suspicious transactions**.

Five Star Business Finance Limited also failed to disclose the **risk gradation methodology** and the **rationale for charging different interest rates** to borrowers.

142. Recently in news, what was India's external debt-to-GDP ratio as of 31 March 2026, according to the latest data?

A.18.9%

B.19.8%

C.20.8%

D.21.6%

E.22.0%

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

India's **external debt** increased to **US$ 762.8 billion** as of **31 March 2026**, registering an increase of **US$ 26.3 billion** over the previous year.

The **external debt-to-GDP ratio** rose from **19.8% (March 2025)** to **20.8% (March 2026)**.

The share of **short-term external debt** increased to **19.6%** of total external debt.

The ratio of **short-term external debt to foreign exchange reserves** increased to **21.6%**, indicating higher short-term repayment obligations.

US dollar-denominated debt remained the **largest component** of India's external debt, accounting for **55.5%** of the total.

Detailed Explanation:

India's **external debt** increased to **US$ 762.8 billion** as of **31 March 2026**, registering an increase of **US$ 26.3 billion** over the previous year.

The **external debt-to-GDP ratio** rose from **19.8% (March 2025)** to **20.8% (March 2026)**.

The share of **short-term external debt** increased to **19.6%** of total external debt.

The ratio of **short-term external debt to foreign exchange reserves** increased to **21.6%**, indicating higher short-term repayment obligations.

US dollar-denominated debt remained the **largest component** of India's external debt, accounting for **55.5%** of the total.

The **currency-wise composition** of India's external debt was: **US Dollar – 55.5%**, **Indian Rupee – 29.4%**, **Japanese Yen – 6.4%**, **Special Drawing Rights (SDR) – 4.3%**, and **Euro – 3.7%**.

Non-financial corporations held the **largest share** of India's external debt at **36.4%**.

Deposit-taking corporations accounted for **26.5%**, followed by the **General Government (22.0%)** and **Other Financial Corporations (10.2%)** of total external debt.

143. Recently in news, consider the following statements regarding monetary penalties imposed by the Reserve Bank of India (RBI):

1. **Repco Home Finance Limited was penalised ₹70,000 for violating the Fair Practice Code.**
2. **True Credits Private Limited was penalised ₹3.10 lakh for non-compliance with KYC Directions.**
3. **The penalties were imposed after statutory inspections based on the financial position as of 31 March 2025.**

Which of the statements given above are correct?

A.1 and 2 only

B.2 and 3 only

C.1 and 3 only

D.1 only

E.All the above

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** imposed a **monetary penalty of ₹70,000** on **Repco Home Finance Limited** for violating the **Fair Practice Code**.

The RBI also imposed a **monetary penalty of ₹3.10 lakh** on **True Credits Private Limited** for non-compliance with **Know Your Customer (KYC) Directions**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** imposed a **monetary penalty of ₹70,000** on **Repco Home Finance Limited** for violating the **Fair Practice Code**.

The RBI also imposed a **monetary penalty of ₹3.10 lakh** on **True Credits Private Limited** for non-compliance with **Know Your Customer (KYC) Directions**.

Repco Home Finance Limited failed to disclose its **risk gradation methodology** and the **rationale for charging different interest rates** to different categories of borrowers in application forms and sanction letters.

True Credits Private Limited failed to conduct **Enhanced Due Diligence (EDD)** for certain customers onboarded through **non-face-to-face modes**, violating the RBI's KYC Directions.

The penalties were imposed after **statutory inspections** based on the companies' financial position as of **31 March 2025**.

144. Recently in news, consider the following statements regarding the Reserve Bank of India's Benchmark Issuance Strategy (BIS) and Treasury Bills calendar:

1. **The RBI expanded the Benchmark Issuance Strategy (BIS) from 9 States to 18 States and the Union Territory of Delhi from Q2 of FY 2026–27.**
2. **Under BIS, State Development Loans (SDLs) are issued only through ad hoc issuances without any fixed issuance calendar.**
3. **The RBI plans to raise ₹3,36,000 crore through weekly auctions of 91-day, 182-day, and 364-day Treasury Bills**

during the July–September 2026 quarter.

Which of the statements given above is incorrect?

A.1 only

B.2 only

C.3 only

D.1 and 2 only

E.None of the above

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** expanded the **Benchmark Issuance Strategy (BIS)** from **9 States to 18 States and the Union Territory of Delhi** from **Q2 of FY 2026–27**.

The expansion of the Benchmark Issuance Strategy (BIS) aims to **enhance transparency**, **improve price discovery**, and provide **greater clarity to investors** in **State Government Securities (SGSs)**.

Under the Benchmark Issuance Strategy (BIS), **State Development Loans (SDLs)** are issued in **pre-announced benchmark maturity buckets** through a **fixed issuance calendar**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** expanded the **Benchmark Issuance Strategy (BIS)** from **9 States to 18 States and the Union Territory of Delhi** from **Q2 of FY 2026–27**.

The expansion of the Benchmark Issuance Strategy (BIS) aims to **enhance transparency**, **improve price discovery**, and provide **greater clarity to investors** in **State Government Securities (SGSs)**.

Under the Benchmark Issuance Strategy (BIS), **State Development Loans (SDLs)** are issued in **pre-announced benchmark maturity buckets** through a **fixed issuance calendar**.

The BIS framework helps create **more liquid, predictable, and efficient bond markets** for State Development Loans (SDLs).

The **total market borrowing** by States and Union Territories (UTs) for the **July–September 2026 quarter** is estimated at **₹3,18,816 crore**.

The RBI will conduct **State Development Loan (SDL) auctions** in a non-disruptive manner, considering market conditions and borrowing requirements.

The RBI also released the **Treasury Bills (T-Bills) Issuance Calendar** for the **July–September 2026 quarter**.

The RBI plans to raise **₹3,36,000 crore** through **weekly auctions** of 91-day, 182-day, and 364-day Treasury Bills (T-Bills).

The **Treasury Bills (T-Bills)** are issued in **three maturities**: **91-day, 182-day, and 364-day**.

145. Recently in news, the 'Clean Air, Healthy Delhi' Project approved by the Delhi Government will be implemented for which period?

A.April 2026 to March 2032

B.September 2026 to August 2033

C.January 2027 to December 2033

D.July 2026 to June 2032

E.October 2026 to September 2034

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The **Delhi Government** approved the **₹8,300 crore 'Clean Air, Healthy Delhi' Project** to combat **air pollution** and improve environmental quality in the national capital.

The **seven-year project** will be implemented from **September 2026 to August 2033** and aims to accelerate Delhi's air pollution mitigation plan in line with the **National Clean Air Programme (NCAP)**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Delhi Government** approved the **₹8,300 crore 'Clean Air, Healthy Delhi' Project** to combat **air pollution** and improve environmental quality in the national capital.

The **seven-year project** will be implemented from **September 2026 to August 2033** and aims to accelerate Delhi's air pollution mitigation plan in line with the **National Clean Air Programme (NCAP)**.

The project will be supported by the **World Bank** and other **multilateral institutions**, with **65% of the funding** provided by the **World Bank** and the remaining **35%** contributed by the **Delhi Government**.

Chief Minister Rekha Gupta announced that the project will be implemented across **all districts of Delhi**, with a stakeholder workshop scheduled for **10 July 2026** to finalise the implementation roadmap.

The initiative will focus on major pollution sources, including **transport, road dust, construction and demolition (C&D) waste, solid waste management, industries, green spaces, and water pollution**.

146. Recently in news, Jalalabad town in Shahjahanpur district of Uttar Pradesh has been renamed as which of the following?

A.Parashurampuri

B.Ramnagar

C.Krishnapuri

D.Ayodhyadham

E.Shivpuri

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

The **Uttar Pradesh Cabinet**, chaired by **Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath**, approved the proposal to rename **Jalalabad** town in **Shahjahanpur district** as **Parashurampuri**.

The decision was taken after the **Central Government** conveyed **no objection** to the proposal, paving the way for the state government's approval.

Following the Cabinet's decision, the concerned departments will complete the required **administrative and legal formalities** to officially implement the new name.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Uttar Pradesh Cabinet**, chaired by **Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath**, approved the proposal to rename **Jalalabad** town in **Shahjahanpur district** as **Parashurampuri**.

The decision was taken after the **Central Government** conveyed **no objection** to the proposal, paving the way for the state government's approval.

Following the Cabinet's decision, the concerned departments will complete the required **administrative and legal formalities** to officially implement the new name.

According to the state government, the renaming was based on the demand of local residents to reflect the town's **historical, cultural, and religious significance**.

The government stated that **Jalalabad** is traditionally regarded as the **birthplace of Lord Parashurama**, and the new name **Parashurampuri** recognises this historical and religious association.

The town was named **Jalalabad** during the **Mughal period**, reportedly after **Jalal-ud-din Muhammad Akbar**.

147. Recently in news, the Pradhan Mantri Cha Shramik Protsahan Yojana (PMCSPY) approved by the West Bengal Government is aimed at benefiting which group?

A.Jute mill workers of South Bengal

B.Handloom workers of Murshidabad

C.Coal mine workers of Asansol region

D.Fisherfolk of coastal West Bengal

E.Tea garden workers of North Bengal

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

The **West Bengal Government** approved the implementation strategy of the **Pradhan Mantri Cha Shramik Protsahan Yojana (PMCSPY)** to improve the socio-economic conditions of **tea garden workers** in **North Bengal**.

The **state-level committee** approved a **special assistance package of ₹313.3 crore**, which is expected to benefit **over 3 lakh tea plantation workers and their families**.

The scheme aims to enhance **education, healthcare, worker welfare infrastructure, and essential public services** for tea garden workers.

The scheme will primarily cover **tea gardens in the North Bengal plains and hilly regions**, where the tea industry is a major source of livelihood.

Detailed Explanation:

The **West Bengal Government** approved the implementation strategy of the **Pradhan Mantri Cha Shramik Protsahan Yojana (PMCSPY)** to improve the socio-economic conditions of **tea garden workers** in **North Bengal**.

The **state-level committee** approved a **special assistance package of ₹313.3 crore**, which is expected to benefit **over 3 lakh tea plantation workers and their families**.

The scheme aims to enhance **education, healthcare, worker welfare infrastructure, and essential public services** for tea garden workers.

The **₹313.3 crore** package has been allocated under three major components:

₹177 crore for **Cha Shramik Shiksha Yojana (CSSY)** to upgrade educational infrastructure and improve access to quality education.

₹72 crore for **Cha Shramik Swasthya Suraksha Yojana (CSSSY)** to strengthen healthcare facilities and medical infrastructure.

₹63 crore for **Cha Shramik Ashray Yojana (CSAY)** to construct **321 rest sheds**, including **88 in hilly areas** and **233 in the North Bengal plains**.

The scheme will primarily cover **tea gardens in the North Bengal plains and hilly regions**, where the tea industry is a major source of livelihood.

148. Recently in news, which became the first fruit from Haryana to receive a Geographical Indication (GI) tag?

A.Hisar Guava

B.Rohtak Ber

C.Karnal Mango

D.Sirsa Kinnow

E.Panipat Pomegranate

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

Sirsa Kinnow became the **first fruit from Haryana** to receive the **Geographical Indication (GI) tag**, recognising its unique quality and geographical origin.

The **Geographical Indications Registry, Chennai** granted the **GI registration** to the **Kharisuverian Farmer Producer Company, Sirsa**.

The **GI application** was filed on **16 June 2023**, and the **registration certificate** was issued on **28 March 2026**.

Detailed Explanation:

Sirsa Kinnow became the **first fruit from Haryana** to receive the **Geographical Indication (GI) tag**, recognising its unique quality and geographical origin.

The **Geographical Indications Registry, Chennai** granted the **GI registration** to the **Kharisuverian Farmer Producer Company, Sirsa**.

The **GI application** was filed on **16 June 2023**, and the **registration certificate** was issued on **28 March 2026**.

The **GI tag** recognises the **distinctive taste, quality, and characteristics** of **Sirsa Kinnow**, which are attributed to the region's favourable climatic and geographical conditions.

Sirsa Kinnow is known for its **sweet taste, high juice content, large fruit size, and attractive colour**, making it one of the premium kinnow varieties in India.

The **GI certification** is expected to **enhance the commercial value** of Sirsa Kinnow, **prevent counterfeiting**, strengthen its brand identity, and improve farmers' income through better domestic and export market opportunities.

149. Recently in news, the Uttar Pradesh Data Centre Policy 2026 aims to attract investments of over how much to establish Uttar Pradesh as a hub for green and AI-enabled data centres?

A.₹50,000 crore

B.₹75,000 crore

C.₹1 lakh crore

D.₹2 lakh crore

E.₹3 lakh crore

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The **Uttar Pradesh Cabinet**, chaired by **Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath**, approved the **Uttar Pradesh Data Centre Policy 2026** to establish the state as a leading hub for **green and Artificial Intelligence (AI)-enabled data centres**.

The policy aims to attract **investments of over ₹2 lakh crore** and expand the state's **data centre capacity to 2 GW**.

It replaces the **Uttar Pradesh Data Centre Policy 2021**, which expired in **January 2026**, with a renewed framework for advanced data centre infrastructure.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Uttar Pradesh Cabinet**, chaired by **Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath**, approved the **Uttar Pradesh Data Centre Policy 2026** to establish the state as a leading hub for **green and Artificial Intelligence (AI)-enabled data centres**.

The policy aims to attract **investments of over ₹2 lakh crore** and expand the state's **data centre capacity to 2 GW**.

It replaces the **Uttar Pradesh Data Centre Policy 2021**, which expired in **January 2026**, with a renewed framework for advanced data centre infrastructure.

The policy promotes the development of **AI-ready, energy-efficient, and environmentally sustainable data centres**.

It provides **special incentives for GPU-based technologies** to support **Artificial Intelligence (AI)** and high-performance computing.

Additional subsidies will be offered for projects established in **Bundelkhand** and **Purvanchal** to encourage balanced regional development.

The policy also supports the establishment of **Tier III and Tier IV data centres** across the state.

It is expected to generate around **50,000 jobs** during the construction phase and nearly **7,500 jobs** in operations and maintenance.

150. Recently in news, Gujarat's first air-filled rubber dams are being constructed on which of the following rivers?

A.Narmada and Tapi

B.Sabarmati and Mahi

C.Heran and Ambika

D.Banas and Saraswati

E.Vishwamitri and Orsang

Answer:C

Short Explanation:

Gujarat is developing its **first two air-filled rubber dams** using **advanced technology from South Korea** to strengthen **water resource management** and modernise irrigation infrastructure.

The two dams are being constructed on the **Heran River** at **Rajvasana** in **Chhota Udepur district** and on the **Ambika River** at **Pathakwadi** in **Tapi district**.

The projects aim to **improve irrigation facilities, enhance groundwater recharge, increase water storage capacity, and mitigate**

floods, benefiting thousands of farmers across the state.

Detailed Explanation:

Gujarat is developing its **first two air-filled rubber dams** using **advanced technology from South Korea** to strengthen **water resource management** and modernise irrigation infrastructure.

The two dams are being constructed on the **Heran River** at **Rajvasana** in **Chhota Udepur district** and on the **Ambika River** at **Pathakwadi** in **Tapi district**.

The projects aim to **improve irrigation facilities, enhance groundwater recharge, increase water storage capacity, and mitigate floods**, benefiting thousands of farmers across the state.

The **Rajvasana Rubber Dam** is being constructed at a cost of **₹82.97 crore**, is **75% complete** (as of **6 July 2026**), is expected to be commissioned by **September 2027**, and will provide irrigation to over **3,420 hectares** of agricultural land.

The **Pathakwadi Rubber Dam** is being developed at a cost of **₹79.13 crore**, is **nearly 90% complete**, and will provide assured irrigation to around **650 hectares** of agricultural land.

The two projects involve a **combined investment of over ₹162 crore** and mark Gujarat's first use of **air-filled rubber dam technology**.

151. Recently in news, which Union Minister announced the establishment of a Cooperative Life Insurance Company during the Fifth Foundation Day of the Ministry of Cooperation?

A.Amit Shah

B.Piyush Goyal

C.Nirmala Sitharaman

D.Shivraj Singh Chouhan

E.Dharmendra Pradhan

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

The **Ministry of Cooperation** celebrated its **Fifth Foundation Day** with major announcements to strengthen the **cooperative movement** in India.

Union Minister for Cooperation Amit Shah announced the establishment of a **Cooperative Life Insurance Company** to enhance the cooperative sector's presence in the **life insurance industry**.

The proposed **Cooperative Life Insurance Company** aims to **strengthen the cooperative movement**, promote **financial inclusion**, and provide wider access to **life insurance products**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Ministry of Cooperation** celebrated its **Fifth Foundation Day** with major announcements to strengthen the **cooperative movement** in India.

Union Minister for Cooperation Amit Shah announced the establishment of a **Cooperative Life Insurance Company** to

enhance the cooperative sector's presence in the **life insurance industry**.

The proposed **Cooperative Life Insurance Company** aims to **strengthen the cooperative movement**, promote **financial inclusion**, and provide wider access to **life insurance products**.

Amit Shah stated that **Indian Farmers Fertiliser Cooperative Limited (IFFCO)-TOKIO General Insurance Company Limited** is already operating in the insurance sector and that India currently has **26 life insurance companies**.

The Minister also announced that **Bharat Taxi**, a **cooperatively-owned ride-hailing platform**, will be expanded to **500 cities** across India within the **next two years**.

Bharat Taxi currently has over **6.37 lakh registered drivers** and **35.77 lakh customers** on its platform.

152. Recently in news, Prime Minister Narendra Modi was conferred which of the following highest civilian awards of Indonesia during his visit to Jakarta?

A.Order of Temasek

B.Bintang Adipurna

C.Nishan-e-Pakistan

D.Order of the Rising Sun

E.Grand Collar of the State of Palestine

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Prime Minister Narendra Modi was conferred the **'Bintang Adipurna'**, the **highest civilian award of Indonesia**, by **President Prabowo Subianto** during his official visit to **Jakarta, Indonesia**.

The award recognises **Prime Minister Modi's outstanding contribution to strengthening India–Indonesia bilateral relations** and promoting **international cooperation**.

The honour was presented at **Istana Merdeka (Presidential Palace)** in **Jakarta**.

Detailed Explanation:

Prime Minister Narendra Modi was conferred the **'Bintang Adipurna'**, the **highest civilian award of Indonesia**, by **President Prabowo Subianto** during his official visit to **Jakarta, Indonesia**.

The award recognises **Prime Minister Modi's outstanding contribution to strengthening India–Indonesia bilateral relations** and promoting **international cooperation**.

The honour was presented at **Istana Merdeka (Presidential Palace)** in **Jakarta**.

Bintang Adipurna is Indonesia's **highest non-military civilian honour**, awarded to individuals for their exceptional contribution to **strengthening relations with Indonesia, promoting** friendship, and enhancing international cooperation.

Accepting the award, **Prime Minister Narendra Modi** dedicated the honour to the **1.4 billion people of India** and thanked the **Government and people of Indonesia** for the recognition and warm hospitality.

153. Recently in news, consider the following statements regarding the United Nations Sustainable Development Goals (SDG) Index 2026:

1. **India ranked 94th among 167 countries in the SDG Index 2026 with a score of 68.3.**
2. **The Sustainable Development Report 2026 was released by the United Nations Sustainable Development Solutions Network (SDSN).**
3. **India ranked ahead of Bhutan, Maldives, Nepal, and Sri Lanka in South Asia in the SDG Index 2026.**

Which of the statements given above are correct?

A.1 and 2 only

B.2 and 3 only

C.1 and 3 only

D.All the above

E.1 only

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

India ranked **94th** among **167 countries** in the **United Nations Sustainable Development Goals (SDG) Index 2026**, achieving its **highest-ever ranking** with an overall score of **68.3 out of 100**.

The **Sustainable Development Report 2026** was released by the **United Nations Sustainable Development Solutions Network (SDSN)**.

However, India continues to rank behind **Bhutan, Maldives, Nepal, and Sri Lanka** in South Asia.

Detailed Explanation:

India ranked **94th** among **167 countries** in the **United Nations Sustainable Development Goals (SDG) Index 2026**, achieving its **highest-ever ranking** with an overall score of **68.3 out of 100**.

The **Sustainable Development Report 2026** was released by the **United Nations Sustainable Development Solutions Network (SDSN)**.

Since the adoption of the **Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs)** in **2015**, India has improved its ranking by **18 places**, rising from **112th** to **94th**, making it one of the fastest-improving major economies.

However, India continues to rank behind **Bhutan, Maldives, Nepal, and Sri Lanka** in South Asia.

Globally, **none of the 17 Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs)** are on track to be achieved by **2030**. Only **16.5%** of individual SDG targets are progressing on track, while nearly half are making limited progress and **15%** have regressed since **2015**.

Rank	Country
1	Finland
2	Sweden
3	Denmark

Barbados ranked **first** globally in its commitment to **United Nations (UN)-based**

multilateralism, while the **United States of America (USA)** ranked **last**.

154. Recently in news, State Bank of India (SBI) acquired whose 10% stake in RMBS Development Company Limited (RDCL)?

A.Reserve Bank of India

B.SIDBI

C.NABARD

D.National Housing Bank

E.LIC Housing Finance

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

State Bank of India (SBI), India's largest and oldest **Public Sector Bank (PSB)**, acquired the **National Housing Bank's (NHB's) 10% stake** in **RMBS Development Company Limited (RDCL)**.

RDCL is a **Middle-Layer Non-Banking Financial Company (NBFC)** focused on developing the **Residential Mortgage-Backed Securities (RMBS)** market in India.

Detailed Explanation:

State Bank of India (SBI), India's largest and oldest **Public Sector Bank (PSB)**, acquired the **National Housing Bank's (NHB's) 10% stake** in **RMBS Development Company Limited (RDCL)**.

RDCL is a **Middle-Layer Non-Banking Financial Company (NBFC)** focused on developing the **Residential Mortgage-Backed Securities (RMBS)** market in India.

Following the acquisition, **NHB's shareholding** in RDCL **declined from 39% to 29%**.

The acquisition is expected to strengthen RDCL's role in developing a **deeper secondary mortgage market** in India.

RDCL enables banks and non-bank lenders to **pool housing loans**, convert them into **tradable securities**, **unlock capital**, **improve liquidity**, and support **fresh housing lending**.

155. Recently in news, INS Mahendragiri, the sixth Project 17A indigenous stealth frigate of the Indian Navy, has been constructed by which shipyard?

A.Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers (GRSE)

B.Cochin Shipyard Limited

C.Goa Shipyard Limited

D.Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders Limited

E.Hindustan Shipyard Limited

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The **Indian Navy (IN)** is set to commission its **sixth Project 17A indigenous stealth frigate**, **INS Mahendragiri (F38)**, at **Visakhapatnam, Andhra Pradesh**, on **11 July 2026**.

INS Mahendragiri is named after the **Mahendragiri mountain range** in the Eastern Ghats and is the **first Indian Naval warship** to bear this name.

INS Mahendragiri has been designed in-house by the Indian Navy's **Warship Design Bureau (WDB)**.

The frigate has been constructed by **Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders Limited (MDL), Mumbai**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Indian Navy (IN)** is set to commission its **sixth Project 17A indigenous stealth frigate**, **INS Mahendragiri (F38)**, at **Visakhapatnam, Andhra Pradesh**, on **11 July 2026**.

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INS Mahendragiri has been designed in-house by the Indian Navy's **Warship Design Bureau (WDB)**.

The frigate has been constructed by **Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders Limited (MDL), Mumbai**.

Project 17A is India's programme for building advanced indigenous stealth frigates with **enhanced combat capabilities**.

INS Mahendragiri incorporates **advanced stealth features**, **enhanced survivability**, **reduced radar signature**, and a **high degree of automation**.

The warship is powered by a **Combined Diesel or Gas (CODOG) propulsion system**, enabling high-speed operations with long endurance.

INS Mahendragiri contains **over 75% indigenous content**, reflecting the **Aatmanirbhar Bharat Initiative**.

156. Recently in news, the first static ground test of ISRO's Sub-Orbital Launch Vehicle for Experiments (SOLVE) was conducted at which centre?

A.Vikram Sarabhai Space Centre

B.U R Rao Satellite Centre

C.Satish Dhawan Space Centre

D.Liquid Propulsion Systems Centre

E.Human Space Flight Centre

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The **Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO)** successfully conducted the **first static ground test** of the **Sub-Orbital Launch Vehicle for Experiments (SOLVE)**.

The test was conducted at the **Static Test Facility** of the **Satish Dhawan Space Centre (SDSC)**, **Sriharikota**, **Andhra Pradesh**.

SOLVE is a **solid-propellant**, **sub-orbital launch vehicle** developed as a dedicated test platform for the **Gaganyaan Mission**.

The test successfully validated the **solid motor** for the **Integrated Parachute Test (IPT)** of the **Gaganyaan Crew Module**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO)** successfully conducted the **first static ground test** of the **Sub-Orbital Launch Vehicle for Experiments (SOLVE)**.

The test was conducted at the **Static Test Facility** of the **Satish Dhawan Space Centre (SDSC)**, **Sriharikota**, **Andhra Pradesh**.

SOLVE is a **solid-propellant**, **sub-orbital launch vehicle** developed as a dedicated test platform for the **Gaganyaan Mission**.

The test successfully validated the **solid motor** for the **Integrated Parachute Test (IPT)** of the **Gaganyaan Crew Module**.

SOLVE is designed to simulate the **Crew Module's deceleration** at an altitude of **10 km to 17 km** before human spaceflight.

The **primary objective** of SOLVE is to test the Crew Module's **deceleration system**, **parachute deployment**, and **safe recovery** under realistic mission conditions.

During SOLVE missions, the **Crew Module** will **separate** from the launch vehicle at an altitude of **10–17 km** and deploy a sequence of **10 parachutes** before **sea splashdown**.

157. Recently in news, Indiahandmade—launched in 2023 under the Digital India Initiative—is a digital marketplace developed to promote which sector?

A.Food processing and agri-tech products

B.Electronics manufacturing and start-ups

C.Tourism and hospitality services

D.Renewable energy equipment

E.Handloom and handicraft products

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

Indiahandmade is a dedicated digital marketplace for **handloom and handicraft products**, launched in **2023** under the **Digital India Initiative**.

The platform was developed by the **Digital India Corporation (DIC)** under the **Ministry of Textiles** to promote India's traditional handloom and handicraft sector through digital commerce.

India is home to an estimated **64.66 lakh handloom and handicraft artisans**, making the sector a major source of employment, inclusive livelihoods, and cultural heritage.

Detailed Explanation:

Indiahandmade is a dedicated digital marketplace for **handloom and handicraft products**, launched in **2023** under the **Digital India Initiative**.

The platform was developed by the **Digital India Corporation (DIC)** under the **Ministry of Textiles** to promote India's traditional handloom and handicraft sector through digital commerce.

India is home to an estimated **64.66 lakh handloom and handicraft artisans**, making the sector a major source of employment, inclusive livelihoods, and cultural heritage.

Women account for 71% of handloom weavers and 64% of total artisans (as of August 2025), highlighting the sector's role in **women empowerment** and **rural employment**.

Indiahandmade enables artisans and weavers to sell handmade products online, providing them with **direct market access** without relying heavily on intermediaries.

The platform directly connects buyers and artisans, ensuring **fair compensation**, **better price realization**, and improved income opportunities for craft communities.

158. Recently in news, Vaidya Rajesh Kotecha chaired which Executive Committee meeting of the Central Council for Research in Ayurvedic Sciences (CCRAS) in New Delhi?

A.2nd

B.3rd

C.4th

D.5th

E.6th

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

Vaidya Rajesh Kotecha, Secretary, **Ministry of AYUSH**, chaired the **5th Executive Committee (EC) Meeting** of the **Central Council for Research in Ayurvedic Sciences (CCRAS)** in **New Delhi, Delhi**.

CCRAS is the **apex research body** under the Ministry of AYUSH (Ayurveda, Yoga & Naturopathy, Unani, Siddha, Sowa-Rigpa and Homeopathy).

The meeting aimed to strengthen **evidence-based Ayurveda research**, education, scientific communication, and **digital governance**.

Detailed Explanation:

Vaidya Rajesh Kotecha, Secretary, **Ministry of AYUSH**, chaired the **5th Executive Committee (EC) Meeting** of the **Central Council for Research in Ayurvedic Sciences (CCRAS)** in **New Delhi, Delhi**.

CCRAS is the **apex research body** under the Ministry of AYUSH (Ayurveda, Yoga & Naturopathy, Unani, Siddha, Sowa-Rigpa and Homeopathy).

The meeting aimed to strengthen **evidence-based Ayurveda research**, education, scientific communication, and **digital governance**.

The meeting was attended by **Hoveyda Abbas** (Additional Secretary & Financial Adviser, Ministry of AYUSH), **Satyajit Paul** (Senior Statistical Adviser), **Dr. N. Srikanth** (Deputy Director General, CCRAS), **Deepak Kochhar** (Deputy Director–Administration, CCRAS), and other Executive Committee members.

Three major initiatives were launched during the meeting: **Research Methodology Textbook**, **CCRAS PRAYATNA 2026–27**, and the **CCRAS Digital Ecosystem Dashboard**

159. Recently in the news, what was the theme of the 29th National Conference on e-Governance (NCeG 2026)?

A.Digital India for Inclusive Growth

B.Smart Governance through Blockchain and AI

C.Viksit Bharat 2047: AI-enabled, Data-driven & Secure Digital Governance

D.e-Governance for Sustainable Development Goals

E.Citizen-Centric Governance in the Digital Era

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The **29th National Conference on e-Governance (NCeG 2026)** was jointly organised by the **Department of Administrative Reforms and Public Grievances (DARPG)**, **Ministry of**

Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY), and the **Government of Rajasthan** at the **Rajasthan International Centre, Jaipur, Rajasthan**.

The conference was held on **1–2 July 2026**.

Rajasthan Chief Minister **Bhajan Lal Sharma** inaugurated the 29th National Conference on e-Governance (NCeG 2026).

The theme of NCeG 2026 was **"Viksit Bharat 2047: AI-enabled, Data-driven & Secure Digital Governance."**

The **National Awards for e-Governance 2026** were presented during the conference.

Detailed Explanation:

The **29th National Conference on e-Governance (NCeG 2026)** was jointly organised by the **Department of Administrative Reforms and Public Grievances (DARPG)**, **Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY)**, and the **Government of Rajasthan** at the **Rajasthan International Centre, Jaipur, Rajasthan**.

The conference was held on **1–2 July 2026**.

Rajasthan Chief Minister **Bhajan Lal Sharma** inaugurated the 29th National Conference on e-Governance (NCeG 2026).

The theme of NCeG 2026 was **"Viksit Bharat 2047: AI-enabled, Data-driven & Secure Digital Governance."**

The **National Awards for e-Governance 2026** were presented during the conference.

A total of **17 awards** were conferred across **7 categories**.

The awards included **10 Gold Awards** carrying **₹10 lakh each**, **6 Silver Awards** carrying **₹5 lakh each**, and **1 Jury Award**.

The conference concluded with the adoption of the **Jaipur Declaration on e-Governance 2026**.

160. Recently in news, Teejan Bai, who passed away recently, was associated with which traditional folk art form?

A.Pandavani

B.Yakshagana

C.Lavani

D.Tamasha

E.Baul

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

Renowned **Pandavani** singer and Padma awardee **Teejan Bai** passed away at the age of 70 in **Raipur, Chhattisgarh**.

Teejan Bai was born on **8 August 1956** in **Ganiyari village, Durg district, Chhattisgarh**.

She dedicated her life to transforming **Pandavani**, a traditional folk storytelling art, into an internationally acclaimed art form.

Detailed Explanation:

Renowned **Pandavani** singer and Padma awardee **Teejan Bai** passed away at the age of 70 in **Raipur, Chhattisgarh**.

Teejan Bai was born on **8 August 1956** in **Ganiyari village, Durg district, Chhattisgarh**.

She dedicated her life to transforming **Pandavani**, a traditional folk storytelling art, into an internationally acclaimed art form.

Teejan Bai was widely recognised for her powerful voice, commanding stage presence, expressive performance style, and **tambura rhythm**.

The **Government of India (GoI)** honoured Teejan Bai with the **Padma Shri (1988)**.

She was awarded the **Padma Bhushan (2003)** for her outstanding contribution to the field of **Art**.

Teejan Bai received the **Padma Vibhushan (2019)**, India's second-highest civilian award, for her exceptional contribution to **Indian folk art**.

She was conferred the prestigious **Sangeet Natak Akademi Award in 1995**.

She received the **Shreshth Kala Acharya** recognition in **1994**.

Teejan Bai was honoured with the **M. S. Subbulakshmi Centenary Award in 2016**.

She was awarded **Japan's Fukuoka Prize in 2018** for promoting traditional arts and culture.

Bilaspur University, Chhattisgarh, conferred upon Teejan Bai the **Honorary Doctor of Letters (D.Litt.)** degree.

161. As per the recent government decision regarding the National Pension System (NPS), which of the following additional investment choices has been extended to employees of Central Autonomous Bodies (CABs) covered under NPS?

A.Conservative Life Cycle Fund with equity exposure up to 25%

B.LC-75-High with equity exposure up to 75%

C.Government Securities Fund with 100% debt allocation

D.Tier-II Pension Growth Fund with equity exposure up to 90%

E.Atal Pension Equity Scheme with equity exposure up to 60%

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The **Government of India (GoI)** has extended **two additional investment choices** under the **National Pension System (NPS)** to employees of **Central Autonomous Bodies (CABs)** covered under NPS.

The **Department of Expenditure, Ministry of Finance**, extended the applicability of the **Department of Financial Services (DFS) Notification dated 13 November 2025** to NPS subscribers employed in Central Autonomous Bodies (CABs).

The **Aggressive Life Cycle Fund (LC-75)** has been renamed as **LC-75-High** and allows **equity exposure of up to 75%**, making it suitable for subscribers seeking higher long-term growth potential.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Government of India (GoI)** has extended **two additional investment choices** under the **National Pension System**

(NPS) to employees of **Central Autonomous Bodies (CABs)** covered under NPS.

The **Department of Expenditure, Ministry of Finance**, extended the applicability of the **Department of Financial Services (DFS) Notification dated 13 November 2025** to NPS subscribers employed in Central Autonomous Bodies (CABs).

These additional investment choices were earlier available only to **Central Government employees** covered under NPS and have now been extended to **CAB employees**.

The **Aggressive Life Cycle Fund (LC-75)** has been renamed as **LC-75-High** and allows **equity exposure of up to 75%**, making it suitable for subscribers seeking higher long-term growth potential.

The **Balanced Life Cycle Fund (BLC)** has been renamed as **Aggressive Life Cycle Fund** and provides **equity exposure up to 50%**, with **gradual reduction in equity allocation from the age of 45 years**, ensuring a balanced approach between growth and stability.

162. Recently in news, Emergency Credit Line Guarantee Scheme (ECLGS) 5.0 was approved by the Union Cabinet mainly to provide liquidity support to which category of borrowers?

A.Businesses affected by the West Asia geopolitical situation

B.Exporters affected by global tariff hikes

C.Farmers impacted by delayed monsoon

D.Start-ups facing funding shortages in the technology sector

E.Housing finance companies facing asset-liability mismatches

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

Emergency Credit Line Guarantee Scheme (ECLGS) 5.0 was approved by the Union Cabinet on **5 May 2026** to provide **liquidity support** to businesses affected by the **West Asia geopolitical situation**.

ECLGS 5.0 is designed to provide **risk mitigation** to **Member Lending Institutions (MLIs)** by enabling them to extend **additional credit** to borrowers facing cash-flow disruptions.

Detailed Explanation:

Emergency Credit Line Guarantee Scheme (ECLGS) 5.0 was approved by the Union Cabinet on **5 May 2026** to provide **liquidity support** to businesses affected by the **West Asia geopolitical situation**.

ECLGS 5.0 is designed to provide **risk mitigation** to **Member Lending Institutions (MLIs)** by enabling them to extend **additional credit** to borrowers facing cash-flow disruptions.

The scheme provides **100% guarantee coverage** on additional loans to **Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises (MSMEs)** and **90% guarantee coverage** for other business segments, encouraging higher lending by financial institutions.

Since its launch, **4,11,497 guarantees** have been issued under ECLGS 5.0, with the **guaranteed amount reaching ₹1,55,229**

crore, reflecting rapid adoption across the lending ecosystem.

MSMEs are the **largest beneficiaries**, accounting for **98% of the total guarantees issued (by number)** and **82% of the total guaranteed amount** under the scheme.

The **Department of Financial Services (DFS)** has conducted a **nationwide awareness campaign** to maximise the adoption and effective implementation of ECLGS 5.0.

163. As per the recent development, POWERGRID secured a Japanese Yen 80 billion Green Loan to finance which of the following transmission projects?

A.Leh–Delhi Solar Transmission Corridor

B.Vindhyachal–Nagpur Ultra Mega Power Corridor

C.Mumbai–Hyderabad Green Energy Transmission Link

D.Gujarat–Rajasthan Renewable Grid Project

E.Khavda–Nagpur High Voltage Direct Current (HVDC) Transmission Project

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

Power Grid Corporation of India Limited (POWERGRID), a **'Maharatna' Central Public Sector Enterprise (CPSE)** under the **Ministry of Power (MoP)**, secured a **Japanese Yen (JPY) 80 billion Green Loan** from the **Japan Bank for International Cooperation (JBIC)**.

The JPY 80 billion Green Loan is among India's largest **green financing arrangements** for the **power transmission sector** and supports the integration of **Renewable Energy (RE)** into the national power grid.

The loan agreement was signed in **June 2026** to finance the **Khavda–Nagpur High Voltage Direct Current (HVDC) Transmission Project**.

Detailed Explanation:

Power Grid Corporation of India Limited (POWERGRID), a **'Maharatna' Central Public Sector Enterprise (CPSE)** under the **Ministry of Power (MoP)**, secured a **Japanese Yen (JPY) 80 billion Green Loan** from the **Japan Bank for International Cooperation (JBIC)**.

The JPY 80 billion Green Loan is among India's largest **green financing arrangements** for the **power transmission sector** and supports the integration of **Renewable Energy (RE)** into the national power grid.

The loan agreement was signed in **June 2026** to finance the **Khavda–Nagpur High Voltage Direct Current (HVDC) Transmission Project**.

The **Khavda–Nagpur HVDC Project** will evacuate renewable energy from the **Khavda Renewable Energy Park, Gujarat**, and transmit it to **Nagpur, Maharashtra**.

Japan Bank for International Cooperation (JBIC) will provide **JPY 48 billion**, while the remaining amount will be **co-financed** by **Sumitomo Mitsui Banking Corporation (SMBC)**, **Kansai Mirai Bank**, **Kiraboshi Bank**, and **The Joyo Bank**, with JBIC **guaranteeing** the co-financed portion.

The project supports India's target of achieving **500 Gigawatt (GW) of Renewable Energy capacity by 2030** and expanding the

transmission network to **191,000 circuit kilometres (ckm) by 2032**.

164. Recently in news, the Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (IRDAI) launched a crackdown on "Dark Patterns" mainly to address which of the following issues in the insurance sector?

A.Delayed claim settlement by reinsurance companie

B.High solvency margin requirements for insurers

C.Low insurance penetration in rural areas

D.Mis-selling of insurance products through deceptive digital practices

E.Rising cyberattacks on insurance databases

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The **Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (IRDAI)** has launched a crackdown on **"Dark Patterns"** in digital insurance platforms to curb **mis-selling**, improve **transparency**, strengthen **consumer protection**, and enhance **public trust** in the insurance sector.

Dark Patterns are **deceptive design techniques** used on websites and mobile applications that **manipulate users** into sharing personal information, accepting unwanted products, paying hidden charges, facing difficult policy cancellations, or receiving unsolicited calls and messages.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (IRDAI)** has launched a crackdown on **"Dark Patterns"** in digital insurance platforms to curb **mis-selling**, improve **transparency**, strengthen **consumer protection**, and enhance **public trust** in the insurance sector.

Dark Patterns are **deceptive design techniques** used on websites and mobile applications that **manipulate users** into sharing personal information, accepting unwanted products, paying hidden charges, facing difficult policy cancellations, or receiving unsolicited calls and messages.

Common examples of Dark Patterns include **forcing users to share personal details** before viewing insurance products, making **policy cancellation difficult**, **spam calls**, **hidden charges**, and **misleading website/app interfaces**.

The **core issue** behind Dark Patterns is **mis-selling**, where agents, brokers, banks, or digital platforms push **unsuitable or complex insurance products** to customers to increase sales.

IRDAI has partnered with the **Institute of Public Auditors of India** to **independently monitor** insurance companies and digital insurance platforms for **9 months** to identify the use of Dark Patterns.

165. Recently in news, the Government of India increased the procurement price of onions for the Price Stabilisation Buffer

(PSB) to which of the following amounts with effect from 4 July 2026?

A.₹1,875 per quintal

B.₹2,000 per quintal

C.₹2,125 per quintal

D.₹2,250 per quintal

E.₹2,500 per quintal

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The **Government of India** increased the **procurement price of onions** for the **Price Stabilisation Buffer (PSB)** by **13%**, from **₹1,875 per quintal** to **₹2,125 per quintal**, with effect from **4 July 2026**.

The revised procurement price marks the **fifth upward revision** during the current procurement season, with prices increasing from **₹12.70 per kilogram** at the beginning of the season to **₹21.25 per kilogram**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Government of India** increased the **procurement price of onions** for the **Price Stabilisation Buffer (PSB)** by **13%**, from **₹1,875 per quintal** to **₹2,125 per quintal**, with effect from **4 July 2026**.

The decision was announced by the **Ministry of Consumer Affairs, Food and Public Distribution** to ensure **better remuneration for onion farmers** while strengthening the government's buffer stock.

Procurement of onions for the **Price Stabilisation Buffer (PSB)** is being carried out through the **National Agricultural Cooperative Marketing Federation of India (NAFED)** and the **National Cooperative Consumers' Federation of India Limited (NCCF)**.

The revised procurement price marks the **fifth upward revision** during the current procurement season, with prices increasing from **₹12.70 per kilogram** at the beginning of the season to **₹21.25 per kilogram**.

According to the **Second Advance Estimates** of the **Department of Agriculture and Farmers' Welfare**, onion production for **2025–26** is estimated at **307.37 lakh metric tonnes (LMT)**, compared to **307.67 lakh metric tonnes (LMT)** in **2024–25**.

The Government stated that **overall onion availability remains adequate**, although prices may witness **normal seasonal fluctuations**.

166. Recently in news, the Prime Minister launched which scheme during his visit to Jodhpur, Rajasthan, to strengthen regional air connectivity in remote and underserved areas?

A.Modified Ude Desh ka Aam Nagrik (UDAN) Scheme

B.RCS-Connect Bharat Scheme

C.National Regional Aviation Development Mission

D.Bharat Air Linkage Yojana

E.PM Gramin Hawa Seva Abhiyan

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

Prime Minister (PM) Narendra Modi visited **Rajasthan** and **Gujarat**, where he **inaugurated**, **dedicated**, and **laid the**

foundation stones for several major infrastructure and connectivity projects.

In **Jodhpur, Rajasthan**, the Prime Minister inaugurated the newly developed **₹480 crore terminal building at Jodhpur Airport**, designed to handle **up to 2 million passengers annually**.

He also launched the **Modified Ude Desh ka Aam Nagrik (UDAN) Scheme** to strengthen **regional air connectivity**, particularly in **remote and underserved areas**.

Detailed Explanation:

Prime Minister (PM) Narendra Modi visited **Rajasthan** and **Gujarat**, where he **inaugurated**, **dedicated**, and **laid the foundation stones** for several major infrastructure and connectivity projects.

In **Jodhpur, Rajasthan**, the Prime Minister inaugurated the newly developed **₹480 crore terminal building at Jodhpur Airport**, designed to handle **up to 2 million passengers annually**.

He also launched the **Modified Ude Desh ka Aam Nagrik (UDAN) Scheme** to strengthen **regional air connectivity**, particularly in **remote and underserved areas**.

During his visit to **Balotra, Rajasthan**, the Prime Minister inaugurated and laid the foundation stones for **development projects worth over ₹1.06 lakh crore** across the **railways, highways, renewable energy, and power transmission** sectors.

The Prime Minister dedicated **India's first greenfield integrated refinery-cum-petrochemical complex** at **Pachpadra, Rajasthan**, developed through a **Joint Venture (JV)** between **Hindustan Petroleum Corporation Limited (HPCL)** and the **Government of Rajasthan**.

167. Recently in news, the 29th National Conference on e-Governance (NCeG) 2026 was organised around which of the following themes?

A.Digital India for Inclusive Public Service Delivery

B.Viksit Bharat 2047: AI-enabled, Data-driven & Secure Digital Governance

C.Smart Governance through Blockchain and Cloud Infrastructure

D.Citizen First: Reforms in Digital Public Administration

E.AI for Rural Transformation and Digital Inclusion

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The **Department of Administrative Reforms and Public Grievances (DARPG)**, under the **Ministry of Personnel, Public Grievances and Pensions**, in collaboration with the **Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY)** and the **Government of Rajasthan**, organised the **29th National Conference on e-Governance (NCeG) 2026** at the **Rajasthan International Centre, Jaipur, Rajasthan**.

The conference was inaugurated by **Rajasthan Chief Minister Bhajan Lal Sharma**.

The theme of the conference was **"Viksit Bharat 2047: AI-enabled, Data-driven & Secure Digital Governance."**

Detailed Explanation:

The **Department of Administrative Reforms and Public Grievances (DARPG)**, under the **Ministry of Personnel, Public Grievances and Pensions**, in collaboration with the **Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY)** and the **Government of Rajasthan**, organised the **29th National Conference on e-Governance (NCeG) 2026** at the **Rajasthan International Centre, Jaipur, Rajasthan**.

The conference was inaugurated by **Rajasthan Chief Minister Bhajan Lal Sharma**.

The theme of the conference was **"Viksit Bharat 2047: AI-enabled, Data-driven & Secure Digital Governance."**

During the conference, the **National Awards for e-Governance 2026** were presented across **seven categories**.

A total of **17 awards** were conferred, including **10 Gold Awards** (₹10 lakh each), **6 Silver Awards** (₹5 lakh each), and **1 Jury Award**.

The conference concluded with the adoption of the **Jaipur Declaration on e-Governance 2026**, which provides a roadmap for strengthening **Artificial Intelligence (AI)-enabled, data-driven, secure, and citizen-centric digital governance** across India.

168. Recently in news, Nita Ambani received the Humanitarian Award at the AAPI Annual Convention 2026 from which organisation?

A.Association of American Medical Colleges

B.Global Health Foundation

C.Indian Medical Association

D.World Health Organization

E.American Association of Physicians of Indian Origin

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

Nita Ambani, **Founder and Chairperson of Reliance Foundation**, received the **American Association of Physicians of Indian Origin (AAPI) Humanitarian Award** during the **American Association of Physicians of Indian Origin (AAPI) Annual Convention 2026**, held in **Tampa, Florida, United States of America (USA)**.

The award was presented by **Dr. Amit Chakrabarty**, **President of the American Association of Physicians of Indian Origin (AAPI)**, in recognition of her contributions to **healthcare, education, sports, culture, rural transformation, women's empowerment, disaster response, and preservation of India's arts and cultural heritage** through the **Reliance Foundation**.

Detailed Explanation:

Nita Ambani, **Founder and Chairperson of Reliance Foundation**, received the **American Association of Physicians of Indian Origin (AAPI) Humanitarian Award** during the **American Association of Physicians of**

Indian Origin (AAPI) Annual Convention 2026, held in **Tampa, Florida, United States of America (USA)**.

The award was presented by **Dr. Amit Chakrabarty**, **President of the American Association of Physicians of Indian Origin (AAPI)**, in recognition of her contributions to **healthcare, education, sports, culture, rural transformation, women's empowerment, disaster response, and preservation of India's arts and cultural heritage** through the **Reliance Foundation**.

During the event, **Jane Castor**, **Mayor of Tampa**, conferred **Nita Ambani** with the **"Key to the City of Tampa"**, one of the **highest civic honours** in the **United States of America (USA)**.

The **City of Tampa** also declared **2 July** and the remainder of the **United States Independence Day weekend** as **"AAPI Day"**.

Nita Ambani announced a **strategic partnership** between the **Reliance Foundation** and the **American Association of Physicians of Indian Origin (AAPI)** to strengthen cooperation in **rural and community healthcare, preventive and integrative medicine, women's and children's health, telemedicine, digital health, medical education, and disaster response**.

169. Recently in news, which country became the first OECD member nation to sign a Bilateral Investment Agreement (BIA) with India?

A.France

B.Germany

C.Israel

D.Japan

E.South Korea

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The **Bilateral Investment Agreement (BIA)** between the **Government of India** and the **Government of the State of Israel** came into force on **4 July 2026**.

The agreement was **signed on 8 September 2025** in **New Delhi**.

According to the **Ministry of Finance**, the **Bilateral Investment Agreement (BIA)** aims to strengthen **bilateral economic relations**, promote **cross-border investments**, and provide a **secure, transparent, and predictable investment environment**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Bilateral Investment Agreement (BIA)** between the **Government of India** and the **Government of the State of Israel** came into force on **4 July 2026**.

The agreement was **signed on 8 September 2025** in **New Delhi**.

According to the **Ministry of Finance**, the **Bilateral Investment Agreement (BIA)** aims to strengthen **bilateral economic relations**, promote **cross-border investments**, and provide a **secure, transparent, and predictable investment environment**.

The agreement provides **protection to investments and investors** while preserving

the **sovereign right of governments** to pursue legitimate public policy objectives.

Under the agreement, **India** has reduced the **local remedies exhaustion period** for **Israeli investors** from **5 years** (under India's **2015 Model Bilateral Investment Treaty (BIT)**) to **3 years**, enabling quicker access to **international arbitration** after exhausting domestic legal remedies.

Israel has become the **first Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD) member country** to sign a **Bilateral Investment Agreement (BIA)** with India.

170. Recently in news, Adani Enterprises Limited (AEL) and International Resources Holding (IRH) signed an MoU with the Government of Odisha to develop an integrated greenfield aluminium project worth approximately how much?

A.USD 5.5 billion

B.USD 8.0 billion

C.USD 9.5 billion

D.USD 11.5 billion

E.USD 15.0 billion

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

Adani Enterprises Limited (AEL) and **Abu Dhabi-based International Resources Holding (IRH)**, a **International Holding Company (IHC) Group** entity, signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** with the **Government of Odisha** to develop a **USD 11.5 billion (around ₹1.08 lakh crore)** integrated **greenfield aluminium project** in Odisha.

Adani Enterprises Limited (AEL) and **International Resources Holding (IRH)** will establish a **50:50 Joint Venture (JV)** to execute the project.

The project is expected to become **Odisha's largest Foreign Direct Investment (FDI) proposal** and **India's largest Foreign Direct Investment (FDI) in the metallurgy sector**.

Detailed Explanation:

Adani Enterprises Limited (AEL) and **Abu Dhabi-based International Resources Holding (IRH)**, a **International Holding Company (IHC) Group** entity, signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** with the **Government of Odisha** to develop a **USD 11.5 billion (around ₹1.08 lakh crore)** integrated **greenfield aluminium project** in Odisha.

Adani Enterprises Limited (AEL) and **International Resources Holding (IRH)** will establish a **50:50 Joint Venture (JV)** to execute the project.

The project is expected to become **Odisha's largest Foreign Direct Investment (FDI) proposal** and **India's largest Foreign Direct Investment (FDI) in the metallurgy sector**.

The integrated project will include:

A **4 Million Metric Tonnes Per Annum (MMTPA) alumina refinery** at **Rayagada district**.

A **2 Million Metric Tonnes Per Annum (MMTPA) aluminium smelter** at **Sundargarh district**.

A **4,000-megawatt captive power plant**, including **400 megawatts of renewable energy capacity**.

A **1 Million Metric Tonnes Per Annum (MMTPA) downstream manufacturing park**.

The project will require around **7,300 acres of land** and will be implemented in **two phases**, with investments of **₹66,000 crore** in the first phase and **₹44,000 crore** in the second phase.

171. Recently in news, Air India signed an MoU with which company to explore collaboration in the Maintenance, Repair and Overhaul (MRO) sector?

A.Singapore Airlines Limited

B.SIA Engineering Company Limited

C.SATS Limited

D.Rolls-Royce Singapore

E.Changi Airport Group

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Air India signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** with **Singapore-based SIA Engineering Company Limited (SIAEC)** to explore collaboration in the **Maintenance, Repair and Overhaul (MRO)** sector.

The **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** aims to support the development of **India as a global aviation Maintenance, Repair and Overhaul (MRO) hub**.

The agreement was signed in **Mumbai, Maharashtra**, by **Campbell Wilson**, **Chief Executive Officer (CEO) and Managing Director (MD) of Air India**, and **Chin Yau Seng**, **Chief Executive Officer (CEO) of SIA Engineering Company Limited (SIAEC)**.

Detailed Explanation:

Air India signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** with **Singapore-based SIA Engineering Company Limited (SIAEC)** to explore collaboration in the **Maintenance, Repair and Overhaul (MRO)** sector.

The **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** aims to support the development of **India as a global aviation Maintenance, Repair and Overhaul (MRO) hub**.

The agreement was signed in **Mumbai, Maharashtra**, by **Campbell Wilson**, **Chief Executive Officer (CEO) and Managing Director (MD) of Air India**, and **Chin Yau Seng**, **Chief Executive Officer (CEO) of SIA Engineering Company Limited (SIAEC)**.

The collaboration builds on the existing partnership between the two companies and will leverage **SIA Engineering Company Limited's (SIAEC)** technical expertise to strengthen **Air India's** expanding operations.

The partnership also aims to develop a **world-class aviation Maintenance, Repair and Overhaul (MRO) ecosystem** in India.

The proposed collaboration may include the establishment of a **Maintenance, Repair and Overhaul (MRO) Joint Venture (JV)** in India to

cater to the growing requirements of the **Indian and regional aviation markets**.

172. Recently in news, which university from Karnataka signed a five-year Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with the Industrial University of Ho Chi Minh City (IUH), Vietnam?

A.Karnataka State Open University
B.Central University of Karnataka
C.Visvesvaraya Technological University
D.Bangalore University
E.Sharnbasva University
Answer: E

Sharnbasva University, **Kalaburagi, Karnataka**, signed a **five-year Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** with the **Industrial University of Ho Chi Minh City (IUH)**, **Ho Chi Minh City, Vietnam**.

The **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** aims to strengthen **academic collaboration, collaborative research, faculty exchange, student exchange, and scientific and cultural cooperation** between the two universities.

The collaboration will initially focus on **Engineering, Technology, and Management Studies**.

The partnership is expected to promote **academic excellence, innovation, international collaboration, and global exposure** for students and faculty members of both institutions

173. Recently in news, Dilip Asbe, MD and CEO of NPCI, was appointed to the Supervisory Board of which international financial messaging organisation?

A.International Monetary Fund (IMF)
B.Society for Worldwide Interbank Financial Telecommunication (SWIFT)
C.Bank for International Settlements (BIS)
D.Financial Action Task Force (FATF)
E.World Bank
Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Dilip Asbe, Managing Director (MD) and Chief Executive Officer (CEO) of the **National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI)**, was appointed to the **Supervisory Board** of the **Society for Worldwide Interbank Financial Telecommunication (SWIFT)**.

Detailed Explanation:

Dilip Asbe, Managing Director (MD) and Chief Executive Officer (CEO) of the **National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI)**, was appointed to the **Supervisory Board** of the **Society for Worldwide Interbank Financial Telecommunication (SWIFT)**.

Dilip Asbe's appointment coincides with SWIFT's transition from a single-tier Board of Directors to a **two-tier governance structure** comprising a **Supervisory Board** and a **Management Board**.

The SWIFT Supervisory Board will consist of **12 members**, expandable to 15 members in exceptional cases.

The Supervisory Board includes **8 shareholder-affiliated directors** and **4 independent directors**, ensuring the **one-third independence requirement**.

174. Recently in news, consider the following statements regarding the recent appointments approved by the Appointments Committee of the Cabinet (ACC):

1. **Alok Kumar Mittal was appointed as Director General of the Bureau of Police Research & Development (BPR&D).**
2. **Amit Garg was appointed as Director of the National Crime Records Bureau (NCRB).**
3. **Sujeet Pandey was appointed as Director of the Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel National Police Academy (SVPNPA).**

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

A.Only 1

B.Only 2

C.Only 1 and 3

D.Only 2 and 3

E.All the above

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

The **Appointments Committee of the Cabinet (ACC)**, chaired by Prime Minister **Narendra Modi**, approved the appointments of senior **Indian Police Service (IPS)** officers to **three key police and law enforcement institutions** based on a proposal from the **Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA)**.

Alok Kumar Mittal, a 1993-batch IPS officer of the **Haryana cadre**, was appointed as **Director General (DG)** of the **Bureau of Police Research & Development (BPR&D)**.

Amit Garg, a 1993-batch IPS officer of the **Andhra Pradesh (AP) cadre**, was appointed as **Director** of the **National Crime Records Bureau (NCRB)**.

Sujeet Pandey, a 1994-batch IPS officer of the **Uttar Pradesh (UP) cadre**, was appointed as **Director** of the **Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel National Police Academy (SVPNPA)**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Appointments Committee of the Cabinet (ACC)**, chaired by Prime Minister **Narendra Modi**, approved the appointments of senior **Indian Police Service (IPS)** officers to **three key police and law enforcement institutions** based on a proposal from the **Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA)**.

Alok Kumar Mittal, a 1993-batch IPS officer of the **Haryana cadre**, was appointed as **Director General (DG)** of the **Bureau of Police Research & Development (BPR&D)**.

Alok Kumar Mittal will serve as DG, BPR&D from the date of assuming charge until **30 June 2029 (superannuation)** or until further orders, whichever is earlier.

Amit Garg, a 1993-batch IPS officer of the **Andhra Pradesh (AP) cadre**, was appointed as **Director** of the **National Crime Records Bureau (NCRB)**.

Amit Garg will serve as Director, NCRB until **31 October 2027** or until further orders.

Amit Garg succeeds **Alok Ranjan**, a 1991-batch IPS officer, as Director of NCRB.

Sujeet Pandey, a 1994-batch IPS officer of the **Uttar Pradesh (UP) cadre**, was appointed as **Director** of the **Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel National Police Academy (SVPNPA)**.

Sujeet Pandey will serve as Director, SVPNPA until **31 July 2028 (retirement)** or until further orders.

175. Recently in news, TPG Inc. signed definitive agreements to acquire a 100% stake in Aseem Infrastructure Finance Limited (AIFL) through which of the following platforms?

A.TPG Capital Asia

B.TPG Growth Equity

C.TPG Rise Climate

D.TPG Real Estate Partners

E.TPG Infrastructure Ventures

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

TPG Inc., a global alternative asset management firm, signed definitive agreements to acquire a **100% stake** in **Aseem Infrastructure Finance Limited (AIFL)** from the **National Investment and Infrastructure Fund (NIIF)** and other shareholders for an undisclosed amount.

The acquisition will be carried out through **TPG Rise Climate**, TPG's dedicated climate investing platform, in partnership with the **Government of Singapore Investment Corporation (GIC)** and **ICICI Bank Limited**.

Detailed Explanation:

TPG Inc., a global alternative asset management firm, signed definitive agreements to acquire a **100% stake** in **Aseem Infrastructure Finance Limited (AIFL)** from the **National Investment and Infrastructure Fund (NIIF)** and other shareholders for an undisclosed amount.

The acquisition will be carried out through **TPG Rise Climate**, TPG's dedicated climate investing platform, in partnership with the **Government of Singapore Investment Corporation (GIC)** and **ICICI Bank Limited**.

Under the transaction, **TPG and GIC** will acquire AIFL, while **ICICI Bank Limited** will retain up to a **5% equity stake** after the completion of the deal.

The **objective** of the acquisition is to strengthen **climate financing** and **sustainable infrastructure development** in India.

176. Recently in news, the 2nd Joint Defence Cooperation Committee (JDCC) Meeting held in New Delhi was conducted between India and which country?

A.Kenya

B.Uganda

C.Tanzania

D.Ethiopia

E.Rwanda

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

The **2nd Joint Defence Cooperation Committee (JDCC) Meeting** between **India and Rwanda** was held in **New Delhi** on **6–7 July 2026**.

The meeting focused on expanding **bilateral defence cooperation** in the areas of **military training**, **joint military exercises**, **medical cooperation**, and **defence industries**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **2nd Joint Defence Cooperation Committee (JDCC) Meeting** between **India and Rwanda** was held in **New Delhi** on **6–7 July 2026**.

The meeting focused on expanding **bilateral defence cooperation** in the areas of **military training**, **joint military exercises**, **medical cooperation**, and **defence industries**.

Both countries agreed on an **Implementation Plan** with **defined timelines** for the action items arising from the JDCC meeting.

The meeting was **co-chaired** by **Amitabh Prasad**, Joint Secretary, Ministry of Defence (India), and **Brigadier General Louis Kanobayier**, Chief for Joint Force Development, Training and Doctrine (Chief J7), **Rwanda Defence Force (RDF) Headquarters**.

177. Recently in news, which oceanographic satellite was launched by China aboard a Long March 4B rocket from the Jiuquan Satellite Launch Center?

A.Gaofen-12

B.Shijian-21

C.Fengyun-4C

D.Tianhui-6

E.Haiyang (HY)-2E

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

China successfully launched its latest oceanographic satellite, **Haiyang (HY)-2E**, aboard a **Long March 4B rocket** from the **Jiuquan Satellite Launch Center**, Northwest China.

The launch marked China's **47th space mission in 2026** and the **654th flight** of the **Long March rocket series**.

HY-2E is designed to replace the **HY-2B satellite**, which was launched in 2018.

HY-2E will operate together with the existing **HY-2C and HY-2D satellites** to monitor the **global marine dynamic environment**.

Detailed Explanation:

China successfully launched its latest oceanographic satellite, **Haiyang (HY)-2E**, aboard a **Long March 4B rocket** from the **Jiuquan Satellite Launch Center**, Northwest China.

The launch marked China's **47th space mission in 2026** and the **654th flight** of the **Long March rocket series**.

HY-2E is designed to replace the **HY-2B satellite**, which was launched in 2018.

HY-2E will operate together with the existing **HY-2C and HY-2D satellites** to monitor the **global marine dynamic environment**.

The **HY-2E satellite** was developed by the **China Academy of Space Technology (CAST)**.

The satellite is equipped with **four microwave remote sensing payloads** for advanced **ocean observation and marine monitoring**.

The **Radar Altimeter** is used to measure **sea surface height**.

The **Microwave Radiometer** is used to record the **sea surface temperature**.

The **Microwave Scatterometer** is designed to monitor **sea surface wind speed and wind direction**.

178. Recently in news, consider the following statements regarding POSHAN Abhiyaan and Poshan Tracker:

1. **POSHAN Abhiyaan was launched on 8 March 2018 as India's flagship National Nutrition Mission.**
2. **Poshan Tracker was launched in March 2021 by the Ministry of Women and Child Development in collaboration with the National e-Governance Division.**
3. **Poshan Tracker replaced the manual registers maintained by Anganwadi Workers with smartphone-based digital reporting.**

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

A.Only 1

B.Only 2

C.Only 1 and 3

D.Only 2 and 3

E.All the above

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

POSHAN Abhiyaan (Prime Minister's Overarching Scheme for Holistic Nourishment) is India's flagship **National Nutrition Mission**, launched on **8 March 2018**, to improve nutrition outcomes through convergence, technology, and community mobilisation.

POSHAN Abhiyaan functions under the **Ministry of Women and Child Development (MoWCD)** and follows a **Jan Andolan (People's Movement)** approach with time-bound targets, digital monitoring, and a multi-ministerial framework.

Under Union Budget 2021–22, POSHAN Abhiyaan, Anganwadi Services, and the Scheme for Adolescent Girls were merged under **Mission POSHAN 2.0 (Mission Saksham Anganwadi and Poshan 2.0)**.

Poshan Tracker is a mobile-based governance application and the **digital backbone** of POSHAN Abhiyaan, launched in **March 2021** by the MoWCD in collaboration with the **National e-Governance Division (NeGD)**.

Detailed Explanation:

POSHAN Abhiyaan (Prime Minister's Overarching Scheme for Holistic Nourishment) is India's flagship **National Nutrition Mission**, launched on **8 March 2018**, to improve nutrition outcomes through convergence, technology, and community mobilisation.

POSHAN Abhiyaan functions under the **Ministry of Women and Child Development**

(MoWCD) and follows a **Jan Andolan (People's Movement)** approach with time-bound targets, digital monitoring, and a multi-ministerial framework.

Under Union Budget 2021–22, POSHAN Abhiyaan, Anganwadi Services, and the Scheme for Adolescent Girls were merged under **Mission POSHAN 2.0 (Mission Saksham Anganwadi and Poshan 2.0)**.

Poshan Tracker is a mobile-based governance application and the **digital backbone** of POSHAN Abhiyaan, launched in **March 2021** by the MoWCD in collaboration with the **National e-Governance Division (NeGD)**.

Poshan Tracker enables **near real-time monitoring** of nutrition, Anganwadi infrastructure, service delivery, beneficiary coverage, and growth monitoring through a unified digital platform.

The application supports **dynamic identification** of stunting, wasting, underweight, **Severe Acute Malnutrition (SAM)**, **Moderate Acute Malnutrition (MAM)**, and overweight/obesity among children using **WHO Child Growth Standards**.

Before Poshan Tracker, Anganwadi Workers (AWWs) maintained **11 manual registers**; the platform has replaced these with **smartphone-based digital reporting**, reducing delays and improving service delivery.

179. Recently in news, Union Agriculture Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan directed ICAR to constitute a high-level expert committee to address the problems faced by growers of which crop in Andhra Pradesh?

A.Alphonso mango

B.Totapuri mango

C.Dasheri mango

D.Banganapalli mango

E.Kesar mango

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Union Agriculture Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan directed **ICAR (Indian Council of Agricultural Research)** to constitute a **high-level expert committee** to address the problems faced by **Totapuri mango growers** in **Andhra Pradesh**.

The decision was taken after farmers reported a **sharp fall in Totapuri mango prices**, resulting in heavy financial losses and **declining farm incomes**.

The committee will conduct a **comprehensive study** of the **Totapuri mango value chain**, covering cultivation, production costs, processing, marketing, domestic trade, exports, and farmers' income.

Detailed Explanation:

Union Agriculture Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan directed **ICAR (Indian Council of Agricultural Research)** to constitute a **high-level expert committee** to address the problems faced by **Totapuri mango growers** in **Andhra Pradesh**.

The decision was taken after farmers reported a **sharp fall in Totapuri mango prices**,

resulting in heavy financial losses and **declining farm incomes**.

The committee will conduct a **comprehensive study** of the **Totapuri mango value chain**, covering cultivation, production costs, processing, marketing, domestic trade, exports, and farmers' income.

The committee will also analyse **demand-supply dynamics**, processing capacity and utilisation, export market conditions, and the **factors responsible for the recent price decline**.

Field visits will be conducted **within 10 days**, during which the committee will interact with **farmers, processors, exporters, Farmer Producer Organisations (FPOs)**, and Andhra Pradesh Government officials.

180. Recently in news, scientists identified the world's oldest accurately dated banyan tree in which district of Bihar?

A.Patna

B.Gaya

C.Munger

D.Bhagalpur

E.Muzaffarpur

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

Scientists identified a **banyan tree in Munger district, Bihar**, as the **world's oldest accurately dated banyan tree**, estimating its age at around **700 years** using **high-precision radiocarbon dating**.

The research was published in the journal **Quaternary Research** and is the **first scientific study** to determine the age of a banyan tree (*Ficus benghalensis*) using **scientific evidence** instead of folklore, historical records, or local traditions.

The study was led by **Dr. Trina Bose** of the **Birbal Sahni Institute of Palaeosciences (BSIP), Lucknow**, an autonomous institute under the **Department of Science and Technology (DST)**, along with Dr. Mayank Shekhar and Dr. Akhilesh K. Yadava.

Detailed Explanation:

Scientists identified a **banyan tree in Munger district, Bihar**, as the **world's oldest accurately dated banyan tree**, estimating its age at around **700 years** using **high-precision radiocarbon dating**.

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The study was led by **Dr. Trina Bose** of the **Birbal Sahni Institute of Palaeosciences (BSIP), Lucknow**, an autonomous institute under the **Department of Science and Technology (DST)**, along with Dr. Mayank Shekhar and Dr. Akhilesh K. Yadava.

The study was initiated after the **Bihar Forest Department** requested the scientific determination of the age of the **Munger Banyan Tree**.

The researchers developed a **new scientific methodology** because tropical broadleaf trees **generally lack distinct annual growth rings**, making conventional dendrochronology unsuitable.

181. Recently in news, Girish Bharadwaj, who passed away recently, was popularly known by which of the following titles?

A.Bridge Man of India

B.Water Man of India

C.Tree Man of India

D.Canal Man of India

E.Road Man of India

Answer: A

Girish Bharadwaj, popularly known as the **"Bridge Man of India"**, was a renowned Indian social worker and engineer who passed away at the age of 76 in Sullia, Karnataka.

He was born on **2 May 1950** in **Sullia, Dakshina Kannada district, Karnataka**.

He was conferred the **Padma Shri in 2017**, India's fourth-highest civilian award, by the Government of India (GoI) for his outstanding contribution to **Social Work**.

182. Recently in news, which digital platform under the Ministry of Women and Child Development was recognised by the World Health Organization (WHO) 2024, as an exemplary nutrition data ecosystem?

A.Poshan Setu

B.Poshan Tracker

C.Saksham Poshan Portal

D.Nutrition India Dashboard

E.ICDS Connect

Answer: B

The **World Health Organization (WHO)** recognised Poshan Tracker as an **exemplary nutrition data ecosystem**, while **UNICEF** appreciated its simplicity and beneficiary tracking features.

In **2023**, Poshan Tracker was showcased at the **G20 Ministerial Conference on Women Empowerment**, where its contribution to nutrition monitoring and ECCE delivery was acknowledged.

In **2024**, the Ministry of Women and Child Development received the **Prime Minister's Award for Excellence in Public Administration** for its achievements under Poshan Tracker.

183. Recently in news, "Aadharshila" refers to which of the following?

A.A digital nutrition monitoring platform under POSHAN Abhiyaan

B.A financial assistance scheme for adolescent girls

C.The National Curriculum for Early Childhood Care and Education for children aged 3–6 years

D.A mobile application for Anganwadi worker attendance tracking

E.A supplementary nutrition programme for pregnant women

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

Poshan Tracker provides **249 ECCE videos**, **190 voice notes**, and **159 Early Childhood Care and Education (ECCE) activity PDFs** based on Aadharshila for children aged 3–6 years.

Aadharshila, launched in **March 2024**, is the **National Curriculum for Early Childhood Care and Education (ECCE)** for children aged 3–6 years, promoting play-based learning through Anganwadi Centres.

Poshan Helpline – 1515, launched in **November 2025**, provides a **toll-free grievance redressal mechanism** for beneficiaries.

Every Anganwadi Worker (AWW) has been provided with a **smartphone**, internet connectivity support of **₹2,000 per annum**, and **Growth Monitoring Devices (GMDs)** for each Anganwadi Centre (AWC).

Detailed Explanation:

Poshan Tracker provides **249 ECCE videos**, **190 voice notes**, and **159 Early Childhood Care and Education (ECCE) activity PDFs** based on Aadharshila for children aged 3–6 years.

Aadharshila, launched in **March 2024**, is the **National Curriculum for Early Childhood Care and Education (ECCE)** for children aged 3–6 years, promoting play-based learning through Anganwadi Centres.

Poshan Helpline – 1515, launched in **November 2025**, provides a **toll-free grievance redressal mechanism** for beneficiaries.

Every Anganwadi Worker (AWW) has been provided with a **smartphone**, internet connectivity support of **₹2,000 per annum**, and **Growth Monitoring Devices (GMDs)** for each Anganwadi Centre (AWC).

Saksham Anganwadi focuses on upgrading existing Anganwadi Centres with LED screens, water purifiers, smart learning aids, and **Poshan Vatikas (Nutri-Gardens)** to improve service quality.

The **Supplementary Nutrition Programme (SNP)** under Integrated Child Development Services (ICDS) provides nutrition support to children (6 months–6 years), pregnant women, lactating mothers, and out-of-school adolescent girls (11–14 years).

184. What is the capital of Rwanda?

A.Kigali

B.Nairobi

C.Kampala

D.Addis Ababa

E.Dodoma

Answer: A

Solution: **About Rwanda :**

President : Paul Kagame

Prime Minister : Justin Nsengiyumva

Capital : Kigali

Currency : Rwandan franc (RWF)

185. In news, the currency of Vietnam is which of the following?

A.Baht

B.Kip

C.Ringgit
D.Dong
E.Riel
Answer: D
About Vietnam
Capital: Hanoi
Currency: Vietnamese dong
President: Tô Lâm
Prime Minister: Lê Minh Hưng

186. As per the Grievance Redressal Assessment & Index (GRAI) Rankings for May 2026, which division of the Department of Financial Services (DFS) secured the 2nd position in Group A?
ABanking Division
B.Insurance Division
C.Pension Division
D.Revenue Division
E.Economic Affairs Division
Answer: B
Short Explanation:
The **Department of Financial Services (DFS)** under the **Ministry of Finance** (through its Banking and Insurance Divisions) receives **more than 2.50 lakh grievances annually**.
The DFS has consistently featured among the **Top 10 Ministries/Departments** in the **Grievance Redressal Assessment & Index (GRAI)** rankings since November 2025.
In the **GRAI Rankings for May 2026**, the **Insurance Division** secured the **2nd position in Group A** (ministries/departments registering 500 or more grievances).
In the same May 2026 GRAI Rankings, the **Banking Division** secured the **6th position in Group A**.
Detailed Explanation:
The **Department of Financial Services (DFS)** under the **Ministry of Finance** (through its Banking and Insurance Divisions) receives **more than 2.50 lakh grievances annually**.
The DFS has consistently featured among the **Top 10 Ministries/Departments** in the **Grievance Redressal Assessment & Index (GRAI)** rankings since November 2025.
In the **GRAI Rankings for May 2026**, the **Insurance Division** secured the **2nd position in Group A** (ministries/departments registering 500 or more grievances).
In the same May 2026 GRAI Rankings, the **Banking Division** secured the **6th position in Group A**.
Since **7 January 2024**, the **Secretary, Department of Financial Services** has been **personally reviewing 20 randomly selected grievances** with direct participation of complainants, Chairpersons, MDs, CEOs, and senior officials of the concerned financial institutions.
The grievance review initiative aims to **improve customer trust**, ensure **meaningful grievance resolution**, and strengthen **citizen-centric governance**.

The DFS has organised workshops on **"Effective Grievance Redressal Framework"** in collaboration with **RBI, IRDAI, PFRDA**, and all **Public Sector Banks (PSBs)**.

187. Recently in news, which entity signed a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with the Vietnam International Financial Center–Da Nang (VIFC-DN) to support the development of Vietnam's International Financial Centre?

A.International Financial Services Centres Authority (IFSCA)

B.Gujarat International Finance Tec-City (GIFT City)

C.National Stock Exchange International Exchange

D.Reserve Bank of India

E.Invest India

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Gujarat International Finance Tec-City (GIFT City), India's **International Financial Services Centre (IFSC)**, signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** with the **Vietnam International Financial Center–Da Nang (VIFC-DN)** in **New Delhi, Delhi**.

The MoU aims to support the development of **Vietnam's International Financial Centre**, promote **cross-border investments**, and strengthen **financial and business linkages** between India and Vietnam.

The partnership focuses on **financial services**, **financial technology (FinTech)**, **digital innovation**, **capacity building**, financial sector development, and the exchange of institutional knowledge and best practices.

Detailed Explanation:

Gujarat International Finance Tec-City (GIFT City), India's **International Financial Services Centre (IFSC)**, signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** with the **Vietnam International Financial Center–Da Nang (VIFC-DN)** in **New Delhi, Delhi**.

The MoU aims to support the development of **Vietnam's International Financial Centre**, promote **cross-border investments**, and strengthen **financial and business linkages** between India and Vietnam.

The partnership focuses on **financial services**, **financial technology (FinTech)**, **digital innovation**, **capacity building**, financial sector development, and the exchange of institutional knowledge and best practices.

Under the collaboration, both institutions will undertake **joint research**, publications, professional exchanges, conferences, seminars, outreach programmes, and regular institutional engagement in areas of mutual interest.

GIFT City also signed an MoU with **Tata Communications Limited** to promote **Global Capability Centres (GCCs)** and technology businesses.

Another MoU was signed between GIFT City and **CEPT University, Gujarat**, to

strengthen **research, knowledge exchange, and capacity building**.

GIFT City is **India's first International Financial Services Centre (IFSC)** and serves as a **global hub** for international finance, banking, capital markets, and FinTech.

188. Recently in news, Kutch Copper Limited (KCL) secured London Metal Exchange (LME) certification for which product?

A.Copper wire rods

B.Refined aluminium ingots

C.Copper concentrate

D.Adani Copper Grade A copper cathodes

E.Zinc cathodes

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

Kutch Copper Limited (KCL), a subsidiary of **Adani Enterprises Limited (AEL)**, secured **London Metal Exchange (LME) certification** for its **"Adani Copper" Grade A copper cathodes**.

The **LME approval** allows Adani Copper Grade A cathodes to be delivered with warrants eligible for issuance against **LME Copper Futures Contracts** from **10 July 2026**.

Detailed Explanation:

Kutch Copper Limited (KCL), a subsidiary of **Adani Enterprises Limited (AEL)**, secured **London Metal Exchange (LME) certification** for its **"Adani Copper" Grade A copper cathodes**.

The **LME approval** allows Adani Copper Grade A cathodes to be delivered with warrants eligible for issuance against **LME Copper Futures Contracts** from **10 July 2026**.

The **LME listing** places Adani Copper among the world's leading copper brands, providing **global recognition**, **international market credibility**, and strengthening Adani Group's presence in the metals sector.

LME-listed copper cathodes can be stored under **LME-approved warehouse warrants** and used as **collateral**, enhancing **global tradability, liquidity, and financing flexibility**.

189. Recently in news, NTPC Limited incorporated its wholly owned subsidiary NTPC Energy in which country to expand its clean energy portfolio?

A.Sri Lanka

B.Mauritius

C.Seychelles

D.Maldives

E.South Africa

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

NTPC Limited has incorporated a **wholly owned subsidiary (WOS)** named **NTPC (Mauritius) Energy** in **Mauritius** to strengthen its international presence and expand its clean energy portfolio.

NTPC (Mauritius) Energy will develop a proposed **Floating Solar Photovoltaic (FSPV) Project** integrated with a **Battery Energy Storage System (BESS)** in Mauritius.

The **Floating Solar Photovoltaic (FSPV) project** will generate renewable electricity using floating solar panels installed on water bodies, improving efficient **land and water resource utilization**.

Detailed Explanation:

NTPC Limited has incorporated a **wholly owned subsidiary (WOS)** named **NTPC (Mauritius) Energy** in **Mauritius** to strengthen its international presence and expand its clean energy portfolio.

NTPC (Mauritius) Energy will develop a proposed **Floating Solar Photovoltaic (FSPV) Project** integrated with a **Battery Energy Storage System (BESS)** in Mauritius.

The **Floating Solar Photovoltaic (FSPV) project** will generate renewable electricity using floating solar panels installed on water bodies, improving efficient **land and water resource utilization**.

The **Battery Energy Storage System (BESS)** will store excess solar energy and ensure a **reliable and continuous power supply** during periods of low solar generation.

BESS will enhance **grid stability**, improve the **integration of renewable energy**, and provide **uninterrupted electricity**, supporting a more resilient power system.

190. Recently in news, the Employees' Provident Fund Organisation (EPFO) launched which upgraded platform to consolidate member accounts into a single nationwide database?

A.UMANG 2.0

B.Central Pension Grid

C.DigiEPF Connect

D.EPFO One Nation Portal

E.CITES 2.01

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

The **Employees' Provident Fund Organisation (EPFO)** launched the upgraded **Centralised IT Enabled Services (CITES 2.01)** platform, marking the **largest digital transformation** in the organisation's history.

The platform consolidates **around 340-million-member accounts** from **more than 120 decentralised databases** into a **single nationwide database**, enabling faster claim processing and improved member services.

Earlier, each **EPFO regional office** maintained its own database, restricting claim processing to the member's registered office. Under **CITES 2.01**, authorised **EPFO offices across India** can process service requests through a unified platform.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Employees' Provident Fund Organisation (EPFO)** launched the upgraded **Centralised IT Enabled Services (CITES 2.01)** platform, marking the **largest digital transformation** in the organisation's history.

The platform consolidates **around 340-million-member accounts** from **more than 120 decentralised databases** into a **single nationwide database**, enabling faster claim processing and improved member services.

Earlier, each **EPFO regional office** maintained its own database, restricting claim processing to the member's registered office. Under **CITES 2.01**, authorised **EPFO offices across India** can process service requests through a unified platform.

The nationwide rollout of **CITES 2.01** is expected to become fully operational by the end of the rollout week.

Alongside the launch, the **Ministry of Labour and Employment** announced that **Employees' Provident Fund (EPF)** interest for **Financial Year 2025–26** at **8.25%** will be credited to members' accounts by **15 July 2026**.

191. Recently in news, the Natural History Museum (NHM), Mizoram University, Aizawl was notified as India's 21st Designated Repository under which Act?

A.Wildlife Protection Act, 1972

B.Forest Conservation Act, 1980

C.Biological Diversity Act, 2002

D.Environment Protection Act, 1986

E.National Green Tribunal Act, 2010

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The **Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change (MoEFCC)** has notified the **Natural History Museum (NHM), Mizoram University, Aizawl**, as **India's 21st Designated Repository** under **Section 39 of the Biological Diversity Act, 2002**.

The notification was issued on **19 June 2026** following the recommendation of the **National Biodiversity Authority (NBA)**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change (MoEFCC)** has notified the **Natural History Museum (NHM), Mizoram University, Aizawl**, as **India's 21st Designated Repository** under **Section 39 of the Biological Diversity Act, 2002**.

The notification was issued on **19 June 2026** following the recommendation of the **National Biodiversity Authority (NBA)**.

The designation strengthens **India's scientific infrastructure** for preserving **authenticated biological specimens** and supports **long-term biodiversity conservation**.

A **Designated Repository** is an institution officially recognised to preserve biological specimens collected under the **Biological Diversity Act, 2002**, maintain reference collections for scientific research, support species identification and classification, and conserve India's biological resources.

Established in **2022**, the **Natural History Museum** is located within the **Indo-Burma Biodiversity Hotspot**, one of the world's richest biodiversity regions.

192. As per the recent decision of the Ministry of Finance regarding the National Pension System (NPS) for employees of Central Autonomous Bodies (CABs), consider the following statements:

Two additional life cycle investment options under NPS have been extended to employees of Central Autonomous Bodies covered under the scheme.

Earlier, these additional investment options were available only to Central Government employees under NPS.

LC-75 High allows a maximum equity exposure of 75%, while the Aggressive Life Cycle Fund has equity exposure capped at around 50%.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

A.Only 1

B.Only 2

C.Only 1 and 3

D.All the above

E.Only 2 and 3

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The **Ministry of Finance** has extended **two additional life cycle investment options** under the **National Pension System (NPS)** to employees of **Central Autonomous Bodies (CABs)** covered under the scheme.

The decision was announced by the **Department of Expenditure**, **Ministry of Finance**.

Earlier, these additional investment options were available only to **Central Government employees** under the **National Pension System (NPS)**.

LC-75 High *(earlier known as LC-75 Aggressive Life Cycle Fund)*:

Maximum **75% equity exposure**.

Suitable for subscribers with a **high risk appetite**.

Designed for **long-term wealth creation** and higher growth potential.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Ministry of Finance** has extended **two additional life cycle investment options** under the **National Pension System (NPS)** to employees of **Central Autonomous Bodies (CABs)** covered under the scheme.

The decision was announced by the **Department of Expenditure**, **Ministry of Finance**.

Earlier, these additional investment options were available only to **Central Government employees** under the **National Pension System (NPS)**.

The move aims to provide **greater flexibility** in retirement planning by allowing employees to choose investment strategies based on their **risk appetite** and **retirement goals**.

New investment options under the National Pension System (NPS):

LC-75 High *(earlier known as LC-75 Aggressive Life Cycle Fund)*:

Maximum **75% equity exposure**.

Suitable for subscribers with a **high risk appetite**.

Designed for **long-term wealth creation** and higher growth potential.

Aggressive Life Cycle Fund *(earlier known as Balanced Life Cycle Fund)*:

Equity exposure capped at **around 50%**.

Equity allocation gradually reduces from the age of **45 years**.

Suitable for subscribers seeking a **balanced investment strategy** with moderate risk.

193. Recently in news, the National Workshop on Strengthening Tribal Research Institutes (TRIs), during which TribeX was launched, was held in which city?

A.Ranchi, Jharkhand

B.Aizawl, Mizoram

C.Imphal, Manipur

D.Raipur, Chhattisgarh

E.Bhubaneswar, Odisha

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

The **Ministry of Tribal Affairs** launched **TribeX**, **India's first dedicated digital learning platform** for **tribal arts, culture, languages, and traditional knowledge**.

The platform was launched by **Union Minister for Tribal Affairs Jual Oram** during the **National Workshop on Strengthening Tribal Research Institutes (TRIs)** held in **Bhubaneswar, Odisha**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Ministry of Tribal Affairs** launched **TribeX**, **India's first dedicated digital learning platform** for **tribal arts, culture, languages, and traditional knowledge**.

The platform was launched by **Union Minister for Tribal Affairs Jual Oram** during the **National Workshop on Strengthening Tribal Research Institutes (TRIs)** held in **Bhubaneswar, Odisha**.

TribeX is a comprehensive digital platform that integrates **education, digital documentation, research, knowledge preservation, and skill development** related to India's tribal heritage.

The platform provides learners with authentic access to tribal knowledge through **tribal artisans, scholars, and cultural experts**, helping preserve indigenous traditions in digital form

194. Recently in news, the inaugural United Nations Global Dialogue on Artificial Intelligence (AI) Governance, where India was represented by Kirti Vardhan Singh, was held in which city?

A.Vienna, Austria

B.New York, United States

C.Geneva, Switzerland

D.Paris, France

E.The Hague, Netherlands

Answer: C

Union Minister of State (MoS) Kirti Vardhan Singh represented India at the **inaugural United Nations (UN) Global Dialogue on Artificial Intelligence (AI) Governance** held in **Geneva, Switzerland**, from **6–7 July 2026**.

Kirti Vardhan Singh represented both the **Ministry of External Affairs (MEA)** and the **Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change (MoEFCC)**.

India reaffirmed its **"AI for All"** vision, advocating **responsible, inclusive, human-centric AI**, human rights protection, regulatory oversight, and safeguards against the **misuse of AI**.

The **UN Global Dialogue on AI Governance 2026** is a universal multi-stakeholder forum established under **United Nations General Assembly (UNGA) Resolution 79/325**.

195. Recently in news, who has been approved by the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) as the Managing Director (MD) and Chief Executive Officer (CEO) of South Indian Bank?

A.P. R. Seshadri

B.Mahesh Muralidhar Pai

C.S. Krishnan

D.Rajesh Kumar

E.N. Venkatesh

Answer: B

The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** approved the appointment of **Mahesh Muralidhar Pai** as the **Managing Director (MD) and Chief Executive Officer (CEO)** of **South Indian Bank (SIB)**.

Mahesh Muralidhar Pai has been appointed for a **3-year term** effective from **1 October 2026**, subject to completion of all statutory and regulatory formalities.

He will succeed **P. R. Seshadri**, who will remain in office until **30 September 2026** (having stepped down earlier from active responsibilities to pursue personal interests).

196. Recently in news, which insurtech platform appointed Sourav Ganguly as its Brand Ambassador and launched the 'Khul Kar Khelo' campaign?

A.Policybazaar

B.Coverfox

C.Acko

D.InsuranceDekho

E.Digit Insurance

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

InsuranceDekho, an **Insurtech platform**, appointed former Indian cricket captain **Sourav Ganguly** as its **Brand Ambassador**.

Along with the appointment, InsuranceDekho launched the **'Khul Kar Khelo' campaign** to empower **insurance advisors** across India.

Theme: The 'Khul Kar Khelo' campaign is inspired by Sourav Ganguly's **fearless leadership**, highlighting his role in supporting teammates and nurturing a generation of successful cricketers.

Detailed Explanation:

InsuranceDekho, an **Insurtech platform**, appointed former Indian cricket captain **Sourav Ganguly** as its **Brand Ambassador**.

Along with the appointment, InsuranceDekho launched the **'Khul Kar Khelo' campaign** to empower **insurance advisors** across India.

Theme: The 'Khul Kar Khelo' campaign is inspired by Sourav Ganguly's **fearless leadership**, highlighting his role in supporting

teammates and nurturing a generation of successful cricketers.

Objective: The campaign aims to help insurance advisors **grow their businesses**, increase earnings, expand customer reach, and strengthen their role as **micro-entrepreneurs** while promoting **financial protection** for Indian families.

The campaign will be promoted through **Television, Digital, and Broadcast** platforms.

Sourav Ganguly was the **39th Test Captain of India** and led the Indian team to the **2003 ICC Cricket World Cup Final**.

197. Recently in news, the Jawahar Institute of Mountaineering & Winter Sports (JIM & WS), Pahalgam conducted a mountaineering expedition to which massif in Ladakh?

A.Nun Kun Massif

B.Mt Khyam Tso Massif

C.Stok Kangri Massif

D.Zanskar Massif

E.Kang Yatse Massif

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The **Jawahar Institute of Mountaineering & Winter Sports (JIM & WS), Pahalgam** successfully conducted a **22-member mountaineering expedition** to the **Mt Khyam Tso Massif** in the **Rumtse Phu region, Ladakh**.

The expedition was **flagged off on 26 June 2026** by Team Leader **Col Hem Chandra Singh**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Jawahar Institute of Mountaineering & Winter Sports (JIM & WS), Pahalgam** successfully conducted a **22-member mountaineering expedition** to the **Mt Khyam Tso Massif** in the **Rumtse Phu region, Ladakh**.

The expedition was **flagged off on 26 June 2026** by Team Leader **Col Hem Chandra Singh**.

After a structured acclimatization programme in Ladakh, the team **successfully summited Peak Pt 5901M on 2 July 2026** despite extreme weather conditions.

During the expedition, **Col Hem Chandra Singh** achieved a **historic first-ever paragliding flight** from an altitude of **5,600 metres** from Peak Pt 5901M.

On **3 July 2026**, the team successfully climbed another technically challenging peak (**6,090 metres**) and **Peak Pt 5944M**, displaying exceptional grit, endurance, and teamwork.

198. Recently in news, the Flight Acceptance Hot Test of the CE20 Cryogenic Engine for the LVM3-M7 mission was conducted at which ISRO facility?

A.Vikram Sarabhai Space Centre, Thiruvananthapuram

B.Satish Dhawan Space Centre, Sriharikota

C.U R Rao Satellite Centre, Bengaluru

D.Liquid Propulsion Systems Centre, Bengaluru

E.ISRO Propulsion Complex (IPRC), Mahendragiri

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

The **Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO)** successfully conducted the **Flight Acceptance Hot Test** of the **CE20 Cryogenic Engine** for the **LVM3-M7 (Launch Vehicle Mark-3 Mission-7)**.

The test was conducted at the **Main Engine & Stage Test Facility (MET)** of the **ISRO Propulsion Complex (IPRC), Mahendragiri, Tamil Nadu**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO)** successfully conducted the **Flight Acceptance Hot Test** of the **CE20 Cryogenic Engine** for the **LVM3-M7 (Launch Vehicle Mark-3 Mission-7)**.

The test was conducted at the **Main Engine & Stage Test Facility (MET)** of the **ISRO Propulsion Complex (IPRC), Mahendragiri, Tamil Nadu**.

During the test, the CE20 Cryogenic Engine operated at **19.5 tonnes of thrust for 45 seconds** and **22 tonnes of thrust for 25 seconds**, successfully validating its performance for the LVM3-M7 mission.

The **Nozzle Protection System (NPS)** was used for the **first time** during a CE20 engine flight acceptance test.

The successful test confirmed the **satisfactory performance** of both the CE20 engine systems and the Nozzle Protection System (NPS).

199. Recently in news, which company unveiled the world's first sub-1 nanometre (0.7 nm / 7 angstrom) semiconductor chip technology?

A.Intel

B.Samsung

C.IBM

D.TSMC

E.NVIDIA

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

IBM unveiled the world's first **sub-1 nanometre (0.7 nm / 7 angstrom) semiconductor chip technology**, marking a major breakthrough in next-generation computing and semiconductor manufacturing.

The innovation moves chip manufacturing beyond the traditional nanometre era toward **atomic-scale (angstrom-level) engineering**, overcoming the physical limits of conventional chip scaling.

Detailed Explanation:

IBM unveiled the world's first **sub-1 nanometre (0.7 nm / 7 angstrom) semiconductor chip technology**, marking a major breakthrough in next-generation computing and semiconductor manufacturing.

The innovation moves chip manufacturing beyond the traditional nanometre era toward **atomic-scale (angstrom-level)**

engineering, overcoming the physical limits of conventional chip scaling.

The chip is built using IBM's **3D "Nanostack" transistor architecture**, the industry's first three-dimensional nanosheet-based transistor design.

The 0.7 nm (7 angstrom) chip packs nearly **100 billion transistors** on a chip approximately the size of a fingernail, almost **twice the transistor density** of IBM's 2 nm chip launched in 2021.

According to IBM, the new chip is expected to deliver up to **50% higher performance** or **70% greater energy efficiency** compared to its 2 nm node technology.

200. Recently in news, the Sub-Mission on Agricultural Mechanization (SMAM) was launched under which scheme to promote farm mechanization across India?

A.Pradhan Mantri Fasal Bima Yojana

B.Paramparagat Krishi Vikas Yojana

C.National Food Security Mission

D.Rashtriya Krishi Vikas Yojana

E.PM-KISAN

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The Sub-Mission on Agricultural Mechanization (SMAM) was launched in **2014–15** as a **Centrally Sponsored Scheme (CSS)** under the **Rashtriya Krishi Vikas Yojana (RKVY)** to promote farm mechanization across India.

Objective: To **"reach the unreached"** by extending mechanization benefits to **small & marginal farmers, women farmers, SCs, STs, Farmer Producer Organisations (FPOs), Self-Help Groups (SHGs)**, and rural entrepreneurs.

Detailed Explanation:

The Sub-Mission on Agricultural Mechanization (SMAM) was launched in **2014–15** as a **Centrally Sponsored Scheme (CSS)** under the **Rashtriya Krishi Vikas Yojana (RKVY)** to promote farm mechanization across India.

Objective: To **"reach the unreached"** by extending mechanization benefits to **small & marginal farmers, women farmers, SCs, STs, Farmer Producer Organisations (FPOs), Self-Help Groups (SHGs)**, and rural entrepreneurs.

Farm mechanization covers the **entire crop cycle** including land preparation, sowing, irrigation, plant protection, harvesting, and post-harvest management, improving productivity and **reducing labour dependence**.

Special emphasis has been given to **North-Eastern (NE) States** and underserved regions to reduce **regional disparities** in mechanization.

Since inception, **₹9,404.47 crore** has been provided under SMAM, supporting the distribution of **21.61 lakh agricultural machines** to individual farmers.

Under SMAM, **27,554 Custom Hiring Centres (CHCs)**, **646 Hi-Tech Hubs**, and **25,608 Farm Machinery Banks (FMBs)** have been established.

The number of beneficiaries receiving individual farm machinery increased from **2.07 lakh (2020–21)** to **2.32 lakh (2024–25)**.

201. Recently in news, the proposed Index of Services Production (ISP) will complement which existing index by providing a monthly measure of India's formal services sector?

A.Wholesale Price Index (WPI)
B.Consumer Price Index (CPI)
C.Index of Industrial Production (IIP)
D.Index of Eight Core Industries
E.Producer Price Index (PPI)
Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The **Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI)** released the report of the **Technical Advisory Committee on the Index of Services Production (ISP)**, marking a significant step towards strengthening India's economic statistics.

The proposed **Index of Services Production (ISP)** will be a **high-frequency monthly indicator** to measure the performance of India's **formal services sector**.

The **Index of Services Production (ISP)** will complement the **Index of Industrial Production (IIP)** by providing a monthly measure of the services sector, enabling better economic monitoring and evidence-based policymaking.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI)** released the report of the **Technical Advisory Committee on the Index of Services Production (ISP)**, marking a significant step towards strengthening India's economic statistics.

The proposed **Index of Services Production (ISP)** will be a **high-frequency monthly indicator** to measure the performance of India's **formal services sector**.

The **base year** for the index has been fixed as **2024–25**.

The **trial release** of the **Index of Services Production (ISP)** is scheduled for **14 July 2026**.

The **services sector** contributes nearly **53% of India's Gross Value Added (GVA)**, making it the largest contributor to the Indian economy.

The **Index of Services Production (ISP)** will complement the **Index of Industrial Production (IIP)** by providing a monthly measure of the services sector, enabling better economic monitoring and evidence-based policymaking.

It is India's **first comprehensive monthly index** covering the production performance of the **formal services sector**.

202. Recently in news, Garuda Aerospace signed an MoU with Micron Instruments to jointly develop which of the following defence systems?

A.Ballistic missile defence radars
B.Loitering munitions and payload-enabled UAVs
C.Nuclear submarine propulsion systems
D.Anti-tank guided missile launchers
E.Aircraft carrier combat systems
Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Garuda Aerospace, a **Chennai-based drone technology company**, signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** with **Micron Instruments**, a manufacturer of **precision fuzes, defence ammunition systems, and critical military components**.

Under the collaboration, the companies will jointly develop **loitering munitions, payload-enabled Unmanned Aerial Vehicles (UAVs), and advanced unmanned defence systems**.

Detailed Explanation:

Garuda Aerospace, a **Chennai-based drone technology company**, signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** with **Micron Instruments**, a manufacturer of **precision fuzes, defence ammunition systems, and critical military components**.

The partnership aims to develop **next-generation indigenous defence solutions** by combining expertise in **advanced manufacturing, defence engineering, and innovation**.

Under the collaboration, the companies will jointly develop **loitering munitions, payload-enabled Unmanned Aerial Vehicles (UAVs), and advanced unmanned defence systems**.

The **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** will integrate **Micron Instruments' expertise in custom-designed precision fuzes** with **Garuda Aerospace's advanced drone technologies**.

203. Recently in news, the payment agreement signed by Madhya Pradesh, Gujarat, Rajasthan, and Maharashtra was related to the settlement of financial issues under which project?

A.Narmada Project

B.Ken-Betwa Link Project

C.Polavaram Project

D.Tehri Hydroelectric Project

E.Damodar Valley Project

Answer: A

The **States of Madhya Pradesh, Gujarat, Rajasthan, and Maharashtra** signed a **payment agreement** in **New Delhi** to resolve long-pending financial issues related to the **Narmada Project**.

The agreement settles the **cost-sharing** of the **Sardar Sarovar Project** and the **Indira Sagar Project** in accordance with the **Narmada Water Disputes Tribunal (NWDT) Award**.

The signing ceremony was attended by **Union Home Minister Amit Shah** and **Union Minister for Jal Shakti C. R. Patil**.

The agreement covers **rehabilitation and resettlement expenses, compensation for submerged land, construction costs, interest on borrowings, and settlement of pending financial liabilities** among the participating states.

204. Recently in news, Indian athletes and officials will wear jute-viscose blended apparel at which international sporting event in 2026?

A.Asian Games 2026
B.Commonwealth Games 2026
C.Olympic Games 2026
D.World University Games 2026
E.Asian Indoor and Martial Arts Games 2026
Answer: B
Short Explanation:
Indian athletes and officials will wear **jute-viscose blended apparel** during the **Commonwealth Games 2026** to be held in **Glasgow, Scotland**, from **23 July to 2 August 2026**.
The eco-friendly apparel has been developed by the **National Jute Board (NJB)** under the **Ministry of Textiles** to promote **sustainable textiles, natural fibres, value-added jute products, and the Make in India initiative**.
The apparel is made from **100% biodegradable jute-viscose blended fabric**, showcasing India's commitment to **environmentally sustainable textile innovation**.
Detailed Explanation:
Indian athletes and officials will wear **jute-viscose blended apparel** during the **Commonwealth Games 2026** to be held in **Glasgow, Scotland**, from **23 July to 2 August 2026**.
The eco-friendly apparel has been developed by the **National Jute Board (NJB)** under the **Ministry of Textiles** to promote **sustainable textiles, natural fibres, value-added jute products, and the Make in India initiative**.
The apparel is made from **100% biodegradable jute-viscose blended fabric**, showcasing India's commitment to **environmentally sustainable textile innovation**.
The **Commonwealth Games 2026** will be the **first international multi-sport event** in which a national contingent will officially wear **jute-based apparel**.
India will be represented by a **124-member contingent**, comprising **78 male athletes** and **46 female athletes**, who will wear the special apparel during **official ceremonies and team engagements**.
The **Kit Unveiling and Send-off Ceremony** was held in **New Delhi** on **7 July 2026**.

205. Recently in news, Shapoor Zadran, who passed away recently, was associated with which sport?
A.Football
B.Hockey
C.Boxing
D.Wrestling
E.Cricket
Answer: E
Shapoor Zadran, former **Afghanistan fast bowler** and one of the pioneers of Afghanistan's rise in international cricket, **passed away at the age of 38 in New Delhi, Delhi**.
He was born on **8 July 1987** in **Paktia Province, Afghanistan**.
He represented Afghanistan in **44 One Day Internationals (ODIs)** and **36 Twenty20 Internationals (T20Is)** between 2009 and 2020.

He claimed a total of **80 international wickets** across ODIs and T20Is.

206. Recently in news, Alan Greenspan, who passed away recently, was best known for serving as the Chairman of which institution?

A.International Monetary Fund

B.U.S. Treasury Department

C.World Bank

D.Bank of England

E.U.S. Federal Reserve

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

Alan Greenspan, former **Chairman of the U.S. Federal Reserve (Fed)**, **passed away at the age of 99 in Washington, D.C., USA**.

Alan Greenspan served as the **Chairman of the U.S. Federal Reserve from 1987 to 2006**, making him one of the **longest-serving central bank chiefs** in U.S. history.

He was popularly known as the **"Fed Wizard"** for his significant influence on **U.S. monetary policy** and global financial markets.

Detailed Explanation:

Alan Greenspan, former **Chairman of the U.S. Federal Reserve (Fed)**, **passed away at the age of 99 in Washington, D.C., USA**.

Alan Greenspan served as the **Chairman of the U.S. Federal Reserve from 1987 to 2006**, making him one of the **longest-serving central bank chiefs** in U.S. history.

He was popularly known as the **"Fed Wizard"** for his significant influence on **U.S. monetary policy** and global financial markets. During his tenure, he guided the American economy through major events including the **1987 Stock Market Crash**, the **Dot-com Boom**, and the **September 11 (9/11) terrorist attacks**.

Before becoming Federal Reserve Chairman, he served as **Chairman of the U.S. Council of Economic Advisers** under President Gerald Ford.

President Ronald Reagan appointed Alan Greenspan as the Chairman of the Federal Reserve in **1987**.

He authored the book **"The Age of Turbulence: Adventures in a New World" (2007)**, focusing on global economic developments, financial markets, and public policy.

208. ecently in news, under EPFO's upgraded CITES 2.01 platform, the auto-settlement limit for eligible advance claims of KYC-compliant members has been increased to_____

A.₹1 lakh

B.₹2 lakh

C.₹3 lakh

D.₹5 lakh

E.₹10 lakh

Answer: D

CITES 2.01 introduces **automated pre-validation of claims**, instant notifications for discrepancies, display of eligible withdrawal

amounts before claim submission, and **centralised claim processing**, reducing delays and claim rejections.

The **auto-settlement limit** for eligible advance claims has been increased from **₹1 lakh to ₹5 lakh** for **Know Your Customer (KYC)-compliant** members, enabling quicker settlements with minimal manual intervention.

The platform also introduces a **centralised payment architecture** for faster electronic transfers and revises the interest calculation method by computing interest **up to the actual date of payment authorisation**, instead of only up to the previous month's end.

209. In which state Murlen National Park is located?

A.Mizoram

B.Manipur

C.Nagaland

D.Tripura

E.Arunachal Pradesh

Answer: A

About Mizoram:

Chief Minister: Lalduhoma

Governor: Vijay Kumar Singh

Capital: Aizawl

National Parks: Murlen National Park, Phawngpui (Blue Mountain) National Park

Wildlife Sanctuaries: Dampa Wildlife Sanctuary, Khawnglung Wildlife Sanctuary, Lengteng Wildlife Sanctuary, Tawi Wildlife Sanctuary, Thorangtlang Wildlife Sanctuary, Tokalo Wildlife Sanctuary

210. According to the news, the National Pension System (NPS) was opened to all citizens in which year?

A.2004

B.2006

C.2008

D.2009

E.2011

Answer: D

About National Pension System (NPS)

Launched: 1 January 2004 (for Central Government employees); opened to all citizens in 2009.

Regulator: Pension Fund Regulatory and Development Authority (PFRDA).

Administrative Ministry: Ministry of Finance

211. Recently, the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) introduced the Reserve Bank–Integrated Ombudsman Scheme (RB-IOS), 2026, replacing which of the following schemes?

A.Banking Ombudsman Scheme, 2006

B.Ombudsman Scheme for NBFCs, 2018

C.Integrated Ombudsman Scheme, 2021

D.Digital Payments Ombudsman Scheme, 2019

E.Consumer Protection Scheme, 2020

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

Reserve Bank of India (RBI) introduced the **Reserve Bank–Integrated Ombudsman Scheme (RB-IOS), 2026**, replacing the

Integrated Ombudsman Scheme, 2021, with effect from **1 July 2026**.

RB-IOS, 2026 aims to provide a **faster, simpler, free, and non-adversarial mechanism** for resolving customer complaints against **RBI-regulated financial entities**.

Complaints, appeals, and awards filed under the 2021 Scheme will continue to be governed by the earlier provisions.

Detailed Explanation:

Reserve Bank of India (RBI) introduced the **Reserve Bank–Integrated Ombudsman Scheme (RB-IOS), 2026**, replacing the Integrated Ombudsman Scheme, 2021, with effect from **1 July 2026**.

RB-IOS, 2026 aims to provide a **faster, simpler, free, and non-adversarial mechanism** for resolving customer complaints against **RBI-regulated financial entities**.

Complaints, appeals, and awards filed under the 2021 Scheme will continue to be governed by the earlier provisions.

The scheme follows the **"One Nation, One Ombudsman"** approach, allowing customers to file complaints **without considering the geographical location** of the customer or the regulated entity.

RB-IOS, 2026 covers **Banks, Eligible NBFCs, Non-Bank Prepaid Payment Instrument (PPI) Issuers, and Credit Information Companies (CICs)** regulated by RBI.

Complaints against RBI-regulated entities not covered under the scheme are handled through **Consumer Education and Protection Cells (CEPCs)** and other RBI grievance redress mechanisms.

212. According to the Asian Development Bank (ADB), what is India's revised GDP growth forecast for FY2026–27 (FY27)?

A.6.6%

B.6.4%

C.6.5%

D.6.9%

E.7.3%

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

The Asian Development Bank (ADB) lowered **India's GDP Growth Forecast for FY2026–27 (FY27)** to **6.6%** from the earlier projection of 6.9% (April 2026).

ADB attributed the downward revision to **high global energy prices**, which are reducing household incomes and affecting **domestic demand**.

ADB retained India's GDP Growth Forecast for **FY2027–28 (FY28)** at **7.3%**, supported by policy measures, stronger exports, and improving global economic conditions.

Detailed Explanation:

The Asian Development Bank (ADB) lowered **India's GDP Growth Forecast for FY2026–27 (FY27)** to **6.6%** from the earlier projection of 6.9% (April 2026).

ADB attributed the downward revision to **high global energy prices**, which are reducing household incomes and affecting **domestic demand**.

ADB retained India's GDP Growth Forecast for **FY2027–28 (FY28)** at **7.3%**, supported by policy measures, stronger exports, and improving global economic conditions.

ADB increased **India's Inflation Forecast for FY2026–27** to **5.2%** from 4.5%, citing higher global oil prices, a **weaker Indian Rupee**, and **persistent food inflation**.

ADB retained India's **FY2027–28 Inflation Forecast at 4.0%**, expecting fuel and food prices to moderate.

For **South Asia**, ADB revised the **2026 Growth Forecast downward to 6.0%** from 6.3%.

213. According to the International Monetary Fund (IMF) World Economic Outlook (WEO) Update – July 2026, what is India's GDP growth forecast for FY2026–27 (FY27)?

A.6.2%

B.6.4%

C.6.5%

D.6.7%

E.7.7%

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The International Monetary Fund (IMF) released the **World Economic Outlook (WEO) Update – July 2026** titled **"Global Economy in Crosscurrents of War and Technology"**.

The IMF projected **India's Gross Domestic Product (GDP) Growth at 6.4% for FY2026–27 (FY27)**, slightly lower than the 6.5% forecast issued in April 2026.

IMF revised **India's FY2027–28 (FY28) GDP Growth Forecast upward to 6.7%**, compared to the earlier estimate of 6.5%.

India's Gross Domestic Product (GDP) recorded a **7.7% Growth during FY2025–26 (FY26)**.

Detailed Explanation:

The International Monetary Fund (IMF) released the **World Economic Outlook (WEO) Update – July 2026** titled **"Global Economy in Crosscurrents of War and Technology"**.

The IMF projected **India's Gross Domestic Product (GDP) Growth at 6.4% for FY2026–27 (FY27)**, slightly lower than the 6.5% forecast issued in April 2026.

IMF revised **India's FY2027–28 (FY28) GDP Growth Forecast upward to 6.7%**, compared to the earlier estimate of 6.5%.

India's Gross Domestic Product (GDP) recorded a **7.7% Growth during FY2025–26 (FY26)**.

Global Economic Growth is projected by the IMF at **3.0% in 2026**, improving further to **3.4% in 2027** due to a gradual recovery in global economic activity.

World Trade Volume Growth is expected to decline from 5.0% in 2025 to **3.5% in 2026**, before recovering to **4.3% in 2027**.

Global Headline Inflation is projected to increase from 4.1% in 2025 to **4.7% in 2026**, before moderating to **3.9% in 2027**.

214. Recently, Prime Minister Narendra Modi visited the Prambanan Temple Complex in

Indonesia. The temple complex is dedicated to which of the following?

A.Lord Buddha, Lord Mahavira, and Guru Nanak

B.Lord Shiva, Lord Vishnu, and Lord Brahma

C.Lord Rama, Lord Krishna, and Lord Hanuman

D.Lord Ganesha, Lord Kartikeya, and Goddess Durga

E.Lord Surya, Lord Indra, and Lord Varuna

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Prime Minister (PM) Narendra Modi visited the **Prambanan Temple Complex** in **Yogyakarta, Indonesia**, reaffirming the centuries-old cultural and civilisational ties between **India and Indonesia**.

The temple complex was built in the **9th century** by the **Sanjaya Dynasty** and is dedicated to the **Hindu Trimurti**:

Lord Shiva

Lord Vishnu

Lord Brahma

Detailed Explanation:

Prime Minister (PM) Narendra Modi visited the **Prambanan Temple Complex** in **Yogyakarta, Indonesia**, reaffirming the centuries-old cultural and civilisational ties between **India and Indonesia**.

Indonesian President Prabowo Subianto accompanied the Prime Minister during the visit, and both leaders unveiled a **commemorative plaque** marking the commencement of the **Archaeological Survey of India (ASI)**-led conservation and restoration project.

The restoration project follows the understanding reached during **President Prabowo Subianto's State Visit to India in 2025**, when both countries agreed to explore India's assistance in preserving Indonesia's historic temples.

Prambanan Temple Complex is the **largest Hindu temple complex in Indonesia**, located in **Sleman Regency, Yogyakarta, on the island of Java**.

The temple complex was built in the **9th century** by the **Sanjaya Dynasty** and is dedicated to the **Hindu Trimurti**:

Lord Shiva

Lord Vishnu

Lord Brahma

Locally known as **Roro Jonggrang (Temple of the Slender Virgin)**, the temple remained abandoned for centuries before being rediscovered and restored during the **19th century**.

215. Recently, the Union Government launched the PRAGATI initiative. What is the target number of rural agri-entrepreneurs to be empowered under this initiative?

A.5,000

B.10,000

C.15,000

D.20,000

E.25,000

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

Union Minister for Agriculture and Farmers Welfare and Rural Development, Shivraj Singh Chouhan, launched the **PRAGATI (Promoting Regenerative Agriculture, Growth, Agri-Entrepreneurship and Transformative Innovation)** initiative.

The initiative aims to **empower 20,000 rural agri-entrepreneurs** and improve the livelihoods of **20 lakh small and marginal farmers** through sustainable agriculture, rural entrepreneurship and technology-driven farming.

Detailed Explanation:

Union Minister for Agriculture and Farmers Welfare and Rural Development, Shivraj Singh Chouhan, launched the **PRAGATI (Promoting Regenerative Agriculture, Growth, Agri-Entrepreneurship and Transformative Innovation)** initiative.

The initiative aims to **empower 20,000 rural agri-entrepreneurs** and improve the livelihoods of **20 lakh small and marginal farmers** through sustainable agriculture, rural entrepreneurship and technology-driven farming.

PRAGATI seeks to transform Indian agriculture by promoting regenerative farming, climate-resilient agriculture, digital innovation, value addition and agri-entrepreneurship, making farming more profitable while reducing cultivation costs.

Major objectives of the initiative include:

Empowering **20,000 rural youth** as agri-entrepreneurs.

Benefiting **20 lakh small and marginal farmers**.

Promoting **crop diversification** and value addition to enhance farmers' income.

Encouraging **climate-resilient and regenerative farming practices**.

Expanding access to **technology, mechanisation, digital advisory services, financial inclusion and market linkages**.

216. Recently, which state government launched the Chief Minister Teacher Cashless Medical Scheme, popularly known as "Guru Dakshina"?

A.Madhya Pradesh

B.Rajasthan

C.Uttarakhand

D.Haryana

E.Uttar Pradesh

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

The **Government of Uttar Pradesh** launched the **Chief Minister Teacher Cashless Medical Scheme**, popularly called **"Guru Dakshina"**, to provide **cashless medical treatment** to teachers, **Shiksha Mitras**, instructors and their eligible family members.

The scheme was announced by **Chief Minister (CM) Yogi Adityanath**, who described it as the government's **"Guru Dakshina"** to the teaching community in recognition of their contribution to nation-building.

The **Uttar Pradesh Government** will bear the **entire annual insurance premium of around ₹447 crore** (about **₹3,000 per teacher**

annually), ensuring beneficiaries receive treatment without paying any premium.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Government of Uttar Pradesh** launched the **Chief Minister Teacher Cashless Medical Scheme**, popularly called **"Guru Dakshina"**, to provide **cashless medical treatment** to teachers, **Shiksha Mitras**, instructors and their eligible family members.

The scheme was announced by **Chief Minister (CM) Yogi Adityanath**, who described it as the government's **"Guru Dakshina"** to the teaching community in recognition of their contribution to nation-building.

The **Uttar Pradesh Government** will bear the **entire annual insurance premium of around ₹447 crore** (about **₹3,000 per teacher annually**), ensuring beneficiaries receive treatment without paying any premium.

The scheme will be implemented through the **State Agency for Comprehensive Health and Integrated Services (SACHIS)** and will provide cashless treatment in **government and empanelled private hospitals**.

Around **10 lakh beneficiaries** are expected to be covered, including teachers of Basic and Secondary Schools, teachers under the **Uttar Pradesh Basic Education Council**, teachers of aided and self-financed schools, **Shiksha Mitras**, Special Educators for **Children with Special Needs (CWSN)**, instructors, wardens of **Kasturba Gandhi Balika Vidyalayas (KGBVs)**, **Pradhan Mantri Poshan Shakti Nirman (PM POSHAN)** cooks and eligible family members.

217. Recently, Navi Mumbai International Airport was notified as a designated port for the import of drugs under which of the following rules?

A.Drugs Rules, 1945 – Rule 23

B.Drugs Rules, 1945 – Rule 43A

C.Drugs and Cosmetics Rules, 1945 – Rule 55

D.Medical Devices Rules, 2017 – Rule 18

E.Drugs Rules, 1945 – Rule 67B

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The **Government of India** has notified **Navi Mumbai International Airport** as a **designated port for the import of drugs** under **Rule 43A of the Drugs Rules, 1945**.

The notification was issued by the **Ministry of Health and Family Welfare** on **8 July 2026** after consultation with the **Drugs Technical Advisory Board (DTAB)** under the provisions of the **Drugs and Cosmetics Act, 1940**.

With this amendment, **Navi Mumbai International Airport** has been added to the list of authorised ports through which **pharmaceuticals and medicines** can be legally imported into India.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Government of India** has notified **Navi Mumbai International Airport** as a **designated port for the import of drugs** under **Rule 43A of the Drugs Rules, 1945**.

The notification was issued by the **Ministry of Health and Family Welfare** on **8 July 2026** after consultation with the **Drugs Technical Advisory Board (DTAB)** under the provisions of the **Drugs and Cosmetics Act, 1940**.

With this amendment, **Navi Mumbai International Airport** has been added to the list of authorised ports through which **pharmaceuticals and medicines** can be legally imported into India.

The amendment aims to **expand pharmaceutical import infrastructure, improve supply chain efficiency, reduce congestion at existing ports, provide greater flexibility to importers, and strengthen India's healthcare logistics network**.

Following this notification, the **total number of designated ports of entry for drug imports in India has increased to 42**, covering **airports, seaports, road entry points, and rail entry points**.

218. With reference to the EPFO 3.0 digital initiative, consider the following statements:

1. **Eligible Aadhaar-linked and KYC-verified online advance claims will be settled within 3 working days.**
2. **The auto-settlement limit for eligible advance claims has been increased to ₹5 lakh.**
3. **Employees must retain at least 25% of their EPF balance while they remain employed.**

A.Only Statement 1 is correct

B.Only Statements 1 and 2 are correct

C.Only Statements 2 and 3 are correct

D.All the above

E.None of the above

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The **Employees' Provident Fund Organisation (EPFO)** introduced major reforms under its **EPFO 3.0** digital initiative to make **Employees' Provident Fund (EPF)** withdrawals faster, simpler, and fully digital.

Eligible **Aadhaar-linked** and **Know Your Customer (KYC)-verified** online advance claims will now be settled within **3 working days**, compared to the earlier **7–20 days**.

The **auto-settlement limit** for eligible advance claims has been increased from **₹1 lakh to ₹5 lakh**, reducing manual intervention and speeding up claim processing.

Under the new rules, employees must retain **at least 25% of their Employees' Provident Fund (EPF) balance** while they remain employed, with only **75% available for eligible withdrawals**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Employees' Provident Fund Organisation (EPFO)** introduced major reforms under its **EPFO 3.0** digital initiative to make **Employees' Provident Fund (EPF)** withdrawals faster, simpler, and fully digital.

The reforms include **3-day online claim settlement, an increased auto-settlement limit of ₹5 lakh, simplified withdrawal categories, a 12-month uniform eligibility period for most partial withdrawals, and a mandatory 25% minimum balance retention rule**.

Eligible **Aadhaar-linked** and **Know Your Customer (KYC)-verified** online advance claims will now be settled within **3 working days**, compared to the earlier **7–20 days**.

The **auto-settlement limit** for eligible advance claims has been increased from **₹1 lakh to ₹5 lakh**, reducing manual intervention and speeding up claim processing.

Under the new rules, employees must retain **at least 25% of their Employees' Provident Fund (EPF) balance** while they remain employed, with only **75% available for eligible withdrawals**.

219. Recently, Acharya Ranchhodlal Goswami was selected for the Ustad Bismillah Khan Yuva Puraskar 2025 for his contribution to the preservation and promotion of which traditional music form?

A.Dhrupad

B.Haveli Sangeet

C.Pandavani

D.Baul Music

E.Baul Music

Answer: B

Acharya Ranchhodlal Goswami from Ahmedabad, Gujarat, has been selected for the **Ustad Bismillah Khan Yuva Puraskar 2025, announced by the Sangeet Natak Akademi under the Union Ministry of Culture for the 2024–25 awards cycle.**

He has been honoured for his outstanding contribution to the preservation and promotion of **Haveli Sangeet**, a traditional devotional music **form associated with the Pushtimarg tradition.**

Acharya Ranchhodlal Goswami, aged **32 years**, is the **16th-generation Acharya of the historic Goswami Haveli located in Doshiwada ni Pol, Kalupur, Ahmedabad.**

The 450-year-old Goswami Haveli is an important centre of the Pushtimarg sect, founded by Mahaprabhu Vallabhacharya.

220. Recently, former Indian tennis player Leander Paes was appointed as the Player Ambassador of which organisation?

A.International Tennis Federation (ITF)

B.All India Tennis Association (AITA)

C.Asian Tennis Federation (ATF)

D.Association of Tennis Professionals (ATP)

E.Olympic Council of Asia (OCA)

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

Leander Paes, former Indian professional tennis player and Olympic medallist, was appointed as the **Player Ambassador** of the **Asian Tennis Federation (ATF)**.

As **ATF Player Ambassador**, he will promote **grassroots tennis**, encourage **youth**

participation, and strengthen the development of tennis across Asia.

Detailed Explanation:

Leander Paes, former Indian professional tennis player and Olympic medallist, was appointed as the **Player Ambassador** of the **Asian Tennis Federation (ATF)**.

As **ATF Player Ambassador**, he will promote **grassroots tennis**, encourage **youth participation**, and strengthen the development of tennis across Asia.

Leander Paes enjoyed a professional tennis career spanning more than three decades before **retiring in 2021**.

He is a former **World No. 1 in Doubles** and remains India's only tennis player to win an Olympic medal, securing the **Bronze Medal in Men's Singles** at the **1996 Atlanta Olympic Games (USA)**.

221. Recently, who was appointed as the Managing Director (MD) and Chief Executive Officer (CEO) of SBICAP Securities?

A.Baldev Prakash

B.Dinesh Kumar Khara

C.Challa Sreenivasulu Setty

D.Rajnish Kumar

E.Ashwini Kumar Tewari

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

SBICAP Securities, the full-service brokerage arm and wholly-owned subsidiary of the State Bank of India (SBI), appointed **Baldev Prakash** as its **Managing Director (MD) and Chief Executive Officer (CEO)**.

Baldev Prakash joined SBICAP Securities on deputation from SBI, where he was serving as **Deputy Managing Director (DMD)** and **Group Chief Risk Officer (GCRO)**.

Detailed Explanation:

SBICAP Securities, the full-service brokerage arm and wholly-owned subsidiary of the State Bank of India (SBI), appointed **Baldev Prakash** as its **Managing Director (MD) and Chief Executive Officer (CEO)**.

Baldev Prakash joined SBICAP Securities on deputation from SBI, where he was serving as **Deputy Managing Director (DMD)** and **Group Chief Risk Officer (GCRO)**.

He brings more than **35 years of experience** in banking and financial services.

His expertise covers **retail banking, corporate banking, foreign exchange, digital banking, risk management, and financial services**.

Earlier, he served as **Managing Director & CEO of Jammu & Kashmir Bank** from December 2021 to December 2024.

222. Recently, Adani Defence and Aerospace announced an investment of ₹2,500 crore to establish South Asia's largest private-sector missile ecosystem in which state?

A.Gujarat

B.Maharashtra

C.Madhya Pradesh

D.Rajasthan

E.Uttar Pradesh

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

Adani Defence and Aerospace, part of the Adani Group, invested **₹2,500 crore** to establish **South Asia's largest private-sector missile ecosystem** in **Shivpuri, Madhya Pradesh (MP)**.

The **foundation stone** of the facility was laid by **Mohan Yadav**, Chief Minister of Madhya Pradesh, and **Jyotiraditya Scindia**, Union Minister for Communications.

Detailed Explanation:

Adani Defence and Aerospace, part of the Adani Group, invested **₹2,500 crore** to establish **South Asia's largest private-sector missile ecosystem** in **Shivpuri, Madhya Pradesh (MP)**.

The **foundation stone** of the facility was laid by **Mohan Yadav**, Chief Minister of Madhya Pradesh, and **Jyotiraditya Scindia**, Union Minister for Communications.

The Shivpuri facility aims to create an **end-to-end indigenous missile ecosystem** for the production of **medium- and long-range missile systems**.

The project will become **India's first private-sector defence complex** to integrate **composite propellant production**, **Trinitrotoluene (TNT) manufacturing**, and **missile system integration** at a single location.

223. Recently, the Defence Research & Development Organisation (DRDO) successfully tested the Pinaka Long Range Guided Rocket (LRGR) for a user-defined minimum range of_____

A.40 km

B.50 km

C.55 km

D.60 km

E.100 km

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

Defence Research & Development Organisation (DRDO) successfully conducted the flight test of the **Pinaka Long Range Guided Rocket (LRGR)** at the **Integrated Test Range (ITR), Chandipur, Odisha**.

The Pinaka LRGR was successfully tested for a user-defined **minimum range of 60 kilometres (km)**.

During the trial, the Long Range Guided Rocket (LRGR) successfully executed all planned in-flight manoeuvres and **struck the target with exact precision**, following the predicted trajectory.

Detailed Explanation:

Defence Research & Development Organisation (DRDO) successfully conducted the flight test of the **Pinaka Long Range Guided Rocket (LRGR)** at the **Integrated Test Range (ITR), Chandipur, Odisha**.

The Pinaka LRGR was successfully tested for a user-defined **minimum range of 60 kilometres (km)**.

During the trial, the Long Range Guided Rocket (LRGR) successfully executed all planned in-

flight manoeuvres and **struck the target with exact precision**, following the predicted trajectory.

The entire flight was continuously monitored and tracked by all deployed range instruments, confirming the rocket's **accuracy, reliability, and performance**.

The flight trial was **jointly coordinated** by **Integrated Test Range (ITR)** and **Proof & Experimental Establishment (PXE)**, Chandipur, Odisha.

The Pinaka Long Range Guided Rocket (LRGR) was designed by the **Armament Research and Development Establishment (ARDE), Pune, Maharashtra**, in association with the **High Energy Materials Research Laboratory (HEMRL)**.

224. Recently, Bisleri International signed a Letter of Association (LoA) with the Indian Coast Guard under its flagship initiative to promote plastic waste management. What is the name of this initiative?

A.Swachh Sagar Abhiyan

B.Plastic Free India

C.Bottles for Change (BFC)

D.Blue Ocean Mission

E.Green Coast Initiative

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

Bisleri International Private Limited signed a **Letter of Association (LoA)** with the **Indian Coast Guard (ICG) (Kerala and Mahe)** to promote **plastic waste management** and environmental sustainability across coastal regions.

The collaboration is being implemented through Bisleri's flagship initiative **Bottles for Change (BFC)**, expanding its reach to coastal and marine ecosystems.

Detailed Explanation:

Bisleri International Private Limited signed a **Letter of Association (LoA)** with the **Indian Coast Guard (ICG) (Kerala and Mahe)** to promote **plastic waste management** and environmental sustainability across coastal regions.

The collaboration is being implemented through Bisleri's flagship initiative **Bottles for Change (BFC)**, expanding its reach to coastal and marine ecosystems.

The initiative reinforces Bisleri International's commitment to **environmental sustainability and marine conservation**.

The agreement is aligned with the Indian Coast Guard's mission – **"Plastic Free Oceans"**.

The LoA was signed by **Dr. Angelo George**, Chief Executive Officer (CEO), Bisleri International, and **Ashish Mehrotra**, Deputy Inspector General (DIG), Indian Coast Guard.

225. Recently, the Council of Scientific and Industrial Research (CSIR) signed an agreement with IP Australia to provide access to which of the following databases?

A.National Digital Library (NDL)

B.Traditional Knowledge Digital Library (TKDL)

C.Indian Patent Information System (IPIS)

D.National Biodiversity Database (NBD)

E.Digital India Knowledge Repository (DIKR)

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Council of Scientific and Industrial Research (CSIR) and **IP Australia** signed an Agreement for access to the **CSIR–Traditional Knowledge Digital Library (CSIR-TKDL)** during the **3rd India–Australia Annual Summit** held in **Melbourne, Australia**, on **9 July 2026**.

The Agreement was concluded in the presence of Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** and Australian Prime Minister **Anthony Albanese**.

Traditional Knowledge Digital Library (TKDL) is the **world's first prior-art database** developed to prevent the **misappropriation of India's traditional knowledge** through the erroneous grant of patents.

Detailed Explanation:

Council of Scientific and Industrial Research (CSIR) and **IP Australia** signed an Agreement for access to the **CSIR–Traditional Knowledge Digital Library (CSIR-TKDL)** during the **3rd India–Australia Annual Summit** held in **Melbourne, Australia**, on **9 July 2026**.

The Agreement was concluded in the presence of Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** and Australian Prime Minister **Anthony Albanese**.

The TKDL Access Agreement was one of the **18 key outcomes** of the India–Australia Annual Summit covering **defence, security, energy, education, skill development, science & technology, film-making, traditional knowledge, and repatriation of cultural properties**.

Traditional Knowledge Digital Library (TKDL) is the **world's first prior-art database** developed to prevent the **misappropriation of India's traditional knowledge** through the erroneous grant of patents.

Under the agreement, **IP Australia** will access the TKDL database to **identify prior art** while examining patent applications in accordance with **Australian patent laws**.

The agreement will **strengthen patent examination**, **prevent wrongful patent grants**, and **protect India's documented traditional heritage**.

India and Australia reaffirmed their commitment to protecting **indigenous knowledge systems, traditional practices, and cultural expressions** through stronger **intellectual property (IP) cooperation**.

226. Recently, ISRO successfully conducted the Integrated Main Parachute Airdrop Test-05 (IMAT-05) for which mission?

A.Chandrayaan-4 Mission

B.Aditya-L1 Mission

C.Gaganyaan G1 Mission

D.NISAR Mission

E.SPADEX Mission

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) successfully conducted the **Integrated**

Main Parachute Airdrop Test-05 (IMAT-05) for the **Gaganyaan G1 Mission** at the **Aerial Delivery Research and Development Establishment (ADRDE) Drop Zone, Sheopur, Madhya Pradesh**.

IMAT-05 was conducted to validate the **Main Parachute System** under maximum expected load conditions for the first uncrewed Gaganyaan G1 Mission.

During the test, a simulated payload was dropped from an altitude of **2.5 kilometres (km)** using an **Indian Air Force (IAF) IL-76 aircraft** to verify the performance, reliability, and structural integrity of the Main Parachute System.

Detailed Explanation:

Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) successfully conducted the **Integrated Main Parachute Airdrop Test-05 (IMAT-05)** for the **Gaganyaan G1 Mission** at the **Aerial Delivery Research and Development Establishment (ADRDE) Drop Zone, Sheopur, Madhya Pradesh**.

IMAT-05 was conducted to validate the **Main Parachute System** under maximum expected load conditions for the first uncrewed Gaganyaan G1 Mission.

During the test, a simulated payload was dropped from an altitude of **2.5 kilometres (km)** using an **Indian Air Force (IAF) IL-76 aircraft** to verify the performance, reliability, and structural integrity of the Main Parachute System.

IMAT-05 is the **5th test in the series** of Integrated Main Parachute Airdrop Tests (IMAT) conducted to qualify the Main Parachute for the Gaganyaan Mission.

The descent sequence successfully deployed the **Extractor Parachute, Drogue Parachute, and Main Parachute**, with the Main Parachute reducing the payload to a **safe terminal velocity** before landing.

The **Gaganyaan Crew Module Deceleration System** consists of **10 parachutes of 4 different types**: 2 Apex Cover Separation Parachutes, 2 Drogue Parachutes, 3 Pilot Parachutes, and 3 Main Parachutes.

227. Recently, the International Centre for Civilizational Studies "Manas and Mahabharata" was established in which country?

A.Kazakhstan

B.Uzbekistan

C.Turkmenistan

D.Tajikistan

E.Kyrgyzstan

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

Centre for Studies of International Relations (CSIR), New Delhi, in collaboration with the **Manas National Academy**, established the **International Centre for Civilizational Studies "Manas and Mahabharata"** in **Bishkek, Kyrgyzstan**.

The International Centre for Civilizational Studies aims to strengthen **scientific,**

educational, and cultural cooperation between India and Kyrgyzstan through **comparative civilizational and epic studies**.

Detailed Explanation:

Centre for Studies of International Relations (CSIR), New Delhi, in collaboration with the **Manas National Academy**, established the **International Centre for Civilizational Studies "Manas and Mahabharata"** in **Bishkek, Kyrgyzstan**.

The International Centre for Civilizational Studies aims to strengthen **scientific, educational, and cultural cooperation** between India and Kyrgyzstan through **comparative civilizational and epic studies**.

The Centre was **inaugurated** during the visit of an Indian delegation to Kyrgyzstan from **4–7 July 2026**.

The Centre will promote comparative civilizational studies, **humanitarian diplomacy**, international scientific cooperation, and **researcher training**.

During the inauguration, the **first Hindi translation** of the Kyrgyz epic **"Manas"**, translated by **Hem Chandra Pande and Ramakant Dwivedi**, was officially released.

228. Recently, Aviva Plc became the first foreign insurer to achieve 100% ownership of its Indian life insurance business after acquiring the remaining stake from which joint venture partner?

A.HDFC Ltd

B.Dabur Invest Corp. (DIC)

C.ICICI Bank

D.Max Financial Services

E.Tata Sons

Answer: B

Aviva Plc (United Kingdom) announced the acquisition of the remaining **26% stake** in **Aviva Life Insurance Company India Limited (Aviva India)** from its Joint Venture (JV) partner, **Dabur Invest Corp. (DIC)**.

With this acquisition, Aviva Plc will increase its shareholding from **74% to 100%**, becoming the **first foreign insurer to achieve 100% ownership** of its Indian life insurance business.

The acquisition follows the Government of India's decision to allow **100% Foreign Direct Investment (FDI)** in the insurance sector in **May 2026**.

229. With reference to the Happy City Index 2026, consider the following statements:

1. **Jaipur was the only Indian city to feature in the global Top 10 rankings.**
2. **Jaipur secured the 6th position in the Happy City Index 2026.**
3. **London (United Kingdom) ranked first in the Happy City Index 2026.**

A.Only Statement 1 is correct

B.Only Statements 1 and 2 are correct

C.Only Statements 2 and 3 are correct

D.All the above

E.None of the above

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

Jaipur, Rajasthan, became the **only Indian city** to feature in the **Top 10 of the Happy City Index 2026**, securing the **6th position globally**. **London (United Kingdom)** secured the **1st rank** in the **Happy City Index 2026**.

Detailed Explanation:

Jaipur, Rajasthan, became the **only Indian city** to feature in the **Top 10 of the Happy City Index 2026**, securing the **6th position globally**.

The **Happy City Index 2026** recognises cities based on **governance, economy, health, environment, mobility, citizen well-being, and quality of life**.

Jaipur was recognised for its high quality of life, rich cultural heritage, good governance, sustainable urban development, and modern infrastructure.

The ranking highlights Jaipur's success in balancing heritage conservation with urban growth and smart city development.

London (United Kingdom) secured the **1st rank** in the **Happy City Index 2026**.

Top 10 Cities in Happy City Index 2026

Rank	City	Country
1	London	United Kingdom
2	New York City	United States
3	Paris	France
4	Tokyo	Japan
5	Madrid	Spain
6	**Jaipur**	**India**
7	Rome	Italy
8	Dubai	United Arab Emirates
9	Berlin	Germany
10	Barcelona	Spain

230. Recently, World Population Day was observed on which of the following dates every year?

A.5 June

B.11 July

C.15 August

D.24 October

E.1 December

Answer: B

World Population Day is observed every year on **11 July** to create awareness about global population-related issues and their impact on society.

The **United Nations (UN)** recognised **11 July as World Population Day in 1989** to raise awareness about population-related challenges.

World Population Day was first observed on 11 July 1990 in more than **90 countries** with the support of **United Nations Population Fund (UNFPA)** offices, governments and civil society organisations.

231. As per the news, Financial Intelligence Unit–India (FIU-IND) secured which position at the Best Egmont Case Award (BECA) 2026 during the Egmont Group Plenary held in Baku, Azerbaijan?

A.Winner

B.Runner-up

C.Second Runner-up

D.Special Jury Award

E.Excellence Award

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Financial Intelligence Unit–India (FIU-IND) secured the **Runner-up position** at the **Best Egmont Case Award (BECA) 2026** during the **Egmont Group Plenary** held in **Baku, Azerbaijan**.

The achievement came under the leadership of **Shri Amit Mohan Govil**, Director, FIU-IND.

The **Best Egmont Case Award (BECA)** is one of the highest honours of the Egmont Group, recognising excellence in **financial intelligence**, **international cooperation**, and efforts to combat **money laundering** and **terrorist financing**.

Detailed Explanation:

Financial Intelligence Unit–India (FIU-IND) secured the **Runner-up position** at the **Best Egmont Case Award (BECA) 2026** during the **Egmont Group Plenary** held in **Baku, Azerbaijan**.

The achievement came under the leadership of **Shri Amit Mohan Govil**, Director, FIU-IND.

The **Best Egmont Case Award (BECA)** is one of the highest honours of the Egmont Group, recognising excellence in **financial intelligence**, **international cooperation**, and efforts to combat **money laundering** and **terrorist financing**.

FIU-IND's case was selected as one of only **two finalist cases** from **182 member jurisdictions** of the Egmont Group, before being declared the Runner-up.

The investigation originated from intelligence shared by the **Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre (I4C)** regarding a **large-scale cyber fraud**.

FIU-IND uncovered a sophisticated money laundering network involving approximately **₹868 crore** in cyber fraud proceeds, over **5,000 mule bank accounts**, and cross-border **cryptocurrency transactions**.

232. As per the news, under the Ahimsa Investment Movement (AIM) Framework, companies are classified into which categories based on the impact of their products, services, and business practices on animals?

A.Green, Orange, and Red bands

B.Platinum, Gold, and Silver bands

C.A, B, and C grades

D.Sustainable, Transitional, and Conventional categories

E.Low, Medium, and High Impact categories

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

NSE Indices Limited, the index services subsidiary of the **National Stock Exchange (NSE)**, launched the **Nifty500 Ahimsa Index**.

The **Nifty500 Ahimsa Index** is a **thematic index** that tracks companies from the **Nifty 500 universe** whose business practices follow the principles of **Ahimsa (non-violence)**.

The index was developed in collaboration with the **Ahimsagain Foundation** using the **Ahimsa Investment Movement (AIM) Framework**.
Under the AIM Framework, companies are classified into **Green, Orange, and Red bands** based on the impact of their products, services, and business practices on **animals**.
Detailed Explanation:
NSE Indices Limited, the index services subsidiary of the **National Stock Exchange (NSE)**, launched the **Nifty500 Ahimsa Index**.
The **Nifty500 Ahimsa Index** is a **thematic index** that tracks companies from the **Nifty 500 universe** whose business practices follow the principles of **Ahimsa (non-violence)**.
The index **excludes companies** involved in activities that **harm animals**, enabling **values-based and ethical investing**.
The index was developed in collaboration with the **Ahimsagain Foundation** using the **Ahimsa Investment Movement (AIM) Framework**.
Under the AIM Framework, companies are classified into **Green, Orange, and Red bands** based on the impact of their products, services, and business practices on **animals**.
Only **Green-band companies** are **eligible** for inclusion, while **Orange and Red-band companies** are **excluded** from the index.
The index provides **diversified sectoral representation** by selecting eligible companies from the **Nifty 500**, while promoting **responsible and sustainable business practices**.

233. As per the news, how much loan has the International Bank for Reconstruction and Development (IBRD) committed as part of the World Bank's $890 million financing package for India's PM Surya Ghar: Muft Bijli Yojana?
A.$600 million
B.$700 million
C.$820 million
D.$850 million
E.$890 million
Answer: C
Short Explanation:
The **World Bank Board of Executive Directors** approved an **$890 million financing package** for India's national rooftop solar programme on **9–10 July 2026**.
The funding supports **PM Surya Ghar: Muft Bijli Yojana**, India's flagship residential rooftop solar scheme for rural and urban households.
The scheme aims to install rooftop solar systems in **10 million households** across India, promoting **clean energy generation** and grid-connected electricity supply.
The financing package includes an **$820 million loan** from the **International Bank for Reconstruction and Development (IBRD)**, a **$60 million concessional loan** from the **Clean Technology Fund (CTF)**, and a **$10 million grant** from the IBRD's **Livable Planet Fund**.
Detailed Explanation:
The **World Bank Board of Executive Directors** approved an **$890 million financing**

package for India's national rooftop solar programme on **9–10 July 2026**.

The funding supports **PM Surya Ghar: Muft Bijli Yojana**, India's flagship residential rooftop solar scheme for rural and urban households.

The scheme aims to install rooftop solar systems in **10 million households** across India, promoting **clean energy generation** and grid-connected electricity supply.

The financing package includes an **$820 million loan** from the **International Bank for Reconstruction and Development (IBRD)**, a **$60 million concessional loan** from the **Clean Technology Fund (CTF)**, and a **$10 million grant** from the IBRD's **Livable Planet Fund**.

The programme is expected to mobilise an additional **$4.2 billion in private financing** through commercial loans for residential rooftop solar installations.

The initiative is projected to create around **1.7 million jobs** across the renewable energy manufacturing, installation, and services value chain.

The financing aims to **reduce financial barriers** for households and strengthen the capacity of **Distribution Companies (DISCOMs)**, banks, and solar equipment vendors.

DISCOMs (Distribution Companies) are key entities responsible for electricity distribution and consumer services in India.

Rooftop solar systems generate electricity at the point of consumption, helping **reduce household electricity bills** and **improving energy security**.

The scheme also promotes **domestic manufacturing** of rooftop solar equipment, supporting the **Atmanirbhar Bharat** initiative.

234. As per the All-India Survey on Higher Education (AISHE) 2023–24, consider the following statements:

1. **The Gross Enrolment Ratio (GER) in higher education increased to 30.0 in 2023–24.**
2. **The Gender Parity Index (GPI) stood at 1.08, indicating that female enrolment exceeded male enrolment.**
3. **Total enrolment in higher education reached an all-time high of 4.5 crore students in 2023–24.**

A.Only Statement 1 is correct

B.Only Statements 1 and 2 are correct

C.Only Statements 2 and 3 are correct

D.All the above

E.Only Statements 1 and 3 are correct

Explanation

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The **Union Ministry of Education** released the **All-India Survey on Higher Education (AISHE) Reports** for **2022–23** and **2023–24**, highlighting record growth in **higher education enrolment**, **Gross Enrolment Ratio (GER)**, **women's participation**, **Science, Technology, Engineering and Mathematics (STEM)** education, and enrolment of **Scheduled**

Castes (SCs), **Scheduled Tribes (STs)**, and **Other Backward Classes (OBCs)**.

The **Gross Enrolment Ratio (GER)** in higher education increased to **30.0** in **2023–24**, compared to **29.5** in **2022–23** and **23.7** in **2014–15**, reflecting improved access to higher education among the **18–23 years** age group.

Female enrolment rose to **2.24 crore** in **2023–24**, up from **2.18 crore** in **2022–23** and **1.57 crore** in **2014–15**, recording an increase of **42.2%** since **2014–15**. The **female Gross Enrolment Ratio (GER)** stood at **31.2**, higher than the national average.

The **Gender Parity Index (GPI)** reached **1.08** in **2023–24** and has remained **above 1** for the past **seven years**, indicating that **female enrolment exceeds male enrolment** in higher education.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Union Ministry of Education** released the **All-India Survey on Higher Education (AISHE) Reports** for **2022–23** and **2023–24**, highlighting record growth in **higher education enrolment**, **Gross Enrolment Ratio (GER)**, **women's participation**, **Science, Technology, Engineering and Mathematics (STEM)** education, and enrolment of **Scheduled Castes (SCs)**, **Scheduled Tribes (STs)**, and **Other Backward Classes (OBCs)**.

The **All-India Survey on Higher Education (AISHE)** is the **Government of India's annual web-based survey** that collects data from universities, colleges, and standalone higher education institutions on student enrolment, faculty, infrastructure, academic programmes, examination results, and institutional facilities.

Total enrolment in higher education reached an **all-time high of 4.5 crore students** in **2023–24**, registering a **31.5% increase** from **3.42 crore** in **2014–15**.

The **Gross Enrolment Ratio (GER)** in higher education increased to **30.0** in **2023–24**, compared to **29.5** in **2022–23** and **23.7** in **2014–15**, reflecting improved access to higher education among the **18–23 years** age group.

Female enrolment rose to **2.24 crore** in **2023–24**, up from **2.18 crore** in **2022–23** and **1.57 crore** in **2014–15**, recording an increase of **42.2%** since **2014–15**. The **female Gross Enrolment Ratio (GER)** stood at **31.2**, higher than the national average.

The **Gender Parity Index (GPI)** reached **1.08** in **2023–24** and has remained **above 1** for the past **seven years**, indicating that **female enrolment exceeds male enrolment** in higher education.

235. As per the news, who launched the new Letter of Authorisation (LoA) regime to promote sustainable high-seas fishing and strengthen India's Blue Economy?

A.Narendra Modi

B.C.P. Radhakrishnan

C.Rajnath Singh

D.Shivraj Singh Chouhan

E.Sarbananda Sonowal

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Vice President C.P. Radhakrishnan launched the new **Letter of Authorisation (LoA) regime** to promote **sustainable high-seas fishing**, enhance the income of fishing communities, and strengthen **India's Blue Economy**.

The **Letter of Authorisation (LoA)** is a regulatory mechanism that authorises **Indian fishing vessels** to undertake fishing operations in the **Exclusive Economic Zone (EEZ)** and the **high seas** through a simplified and transparent approval process.

Detailed Explanation:

Vice President C.P. Radhakrishnan launched the new **Letter of Authorisation (LoA) regime** to promote **sustainable high-seas fishing**, enhance the income of fishing communities, and strengthen **India's Blue Economy**.

The **Letter of Authorisation (LoA)** is a regulatory mechanism that authorises **Indian fishing vessels** to undertake fishing operations in the **Exclusive Economic Zone (EEZ)** and the **high seas** through a simplified and transparent approval process.

The initiative aims to promote **sustainable deep-sea fishing**, increase access to **high-value marine species**, reduce pressure on **overexploited coastal fisheries**, and improve the utilisation of marine resources.

India has a **coastline of over 11,000 kilometres** and an **Exclusive Economic Zone (EEZ)** of nearly **2.4 million square kilometres (24 lakh sq. km.)**, but most fishing activities are currently confined within **40–50 nautical miles** from the coast.

The new regime is expected to strengthen **Fish Farmer Producer Organisations (FFPOs)** and fishing cooperatives, generate employment opportunities, increase **seafood exports**, and expand India's presence in the global seafood market.

236. As per the news, the Department of Telecommunications (DoT) won the World Summit on the Information Society (WSIS) Prize 2026 for which flagship initiative?

A.PM-WANI

B.BharatNet Phase III

C.Samriddh Gram: Integrated Phygital Service Delivery Model

D.Digital India Bhashini Mission

E.National Broadband Mission

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The **Department of Telecommunications (DoT)**, under the **Ministry of Communications**, won the **World Summit on the Information Society (WSIS) Prize 2026** for its flagship **Samriddh Gram: Integrated Phygital Service Delivery Model**, enabled by the **BharatNet** initiative.

The award was presented during the **World Summit on the Information Society (WSIS) Forum 2026** held in **Geneva, Switzerland**, under **Action Line C6 – Enabling Environment**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Department of Telecommunications (DoT)**, under the **Ministry of Communications**, won the **World Summit on the Information Society (WSIS) Prize 2026** for its flagship **Samriddh Gram: Integrated Phygital Service Delivery Model**, enabled by the **BharatNet** initiative.

The award was presented during the **World Summit on the Information Society (WSIS) Forum 2026** held in **Geneva, Switzerland**, under **Action Line C6 – Enabling Environment**.

Samriddh Gram is a rural digital transformation initiative built on the **BharatNet** broadband network to convert digital connectivity into socio-economic opportunities by establishing **Samriddhi Kendras** in villages across India.

Samriddhi Kendras function as integrated **"phygital" service centres**, combining **digital platforms** with **assisted physical services** to improve access to government services, financial inclusion, healthcare, education, skill development, and agricultural support, especially for citizens with limited digital literacy.

The initiative was recognised for demonstrating how **telecommunication infrastructure**, **Digital Public Infrastructure (DPI)**, and community participation can improve public service delivery and promote inclusive rural development.

237. As per the news, who has been appointed as the Managing Director (MD) for OpenAI India Operations?

A.Sam Altman

B.Kevin Weil

C.Brad Lightcap

D.Mira Murati

E.Prabhjeet Singh

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

OpenAI has appointed **Prabhjeet Singh**, former Head of Uber India and South Asia, as the **Managing Director (MD) for India Operations**.

As Managing Director, Prabhjeet Singh will lead **consumer growth, enterprise adoption, and strategic partnerships** for OpenAI in India.

OpenAI also announced the limited preview release of its latest AI model family, **GPT-5.6**.

Detailed Explanation:

OpenAI has appointed **Prabhjeet Singh**, former Head of Uber India and South Asia, as the **Managing Director (MD) for India Operations**.

As Managing Director, Prabhjeet Singh will lead **consumer growth, enterprise adoption, and strategic partnerships** for OpenAI in India.

OpenAI also announced the limited preview release of its latest AI model family, **GPT-5.6**.

The GPT-5.6 rollout will be **phased**, while the company coordinates with the **United States (U.S.) Government** for wider public availability.

GPT-5.6 introduces **three variants**: **Sol (flagship model)**, **Terra (mid-tier model)**, and **Luna (base model)**.

Terra offers performance comparable to GPT-5.5 at **nearly half the cost**, making it a more cost-effective AI model.

Luna is designed to provide **faster AI responses** and is available **without requiring a subscription**.

238. As per the news, the Carl Gustaf Mark-IV (M4) 84 mm lightweight recoilless rocket launcher is developed by which company?

A.Lockheed Martin

B.BAE Systems

C.Thales Group

D.Saab

E.Rheinmetall

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

Indian Army issued a **Request for Proposal (RFP)** in **July 2026** to procure **450 Carl Gustaf Mark-IV (M4) 84 mm lightweight recoilless rocket launchers**.

The **Carl Gustaf M4** is a **shoulder-fired, multi-role recoilless rifle system** designed for **infantry support**, **anti-armour operations**, **bunker destruction**, and battlefield combat.

The Carl Gustaf weapon system is developed by **Saab, Sweden**, and has been in service with the Indian Army since **1974** through earlier **M2 and M3 variants**.

Detailed Explanation:

Indian Army issued a **Request for Proposal (RFP)** in **July 2026** to procure **450 Carl Gustaf Mark-IV (M4) 84 mm lightweight recoilless rocket launchers**.

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The Carl Gustaf weapon system is developed by **Saab, Sweden**, and has been in service with the Indian Army since **1974** through earlier **M2 and M3 variants**.

The **M4 variant weighs less than 7 kg**, compared to 14 kg (M2) and 10 kg (M3), significantly **improving mobility and endurance**, especially in **high-altitude regions**.

The Carl Gustaf M4 will be **manufactured in India** at Saab's facility in **Reliance MET City, Jhajjar, Haryana**.

Saab's Jhajjar facility is **India's first fully foreign-owned defence manufacturing unit**, established after receiving approval for **100% Foreign Direct Investment (FDI)**.

Construction of the Saab manufacturing plant began in **March 2024**, supporting both **Indian Armed Forces** and **global export markets**.

239. As per the news, NASA astronaut Anil Menon is scheduled to launch to the International Space Station (ISS) aboard which spacecraft?

A.SpaceX Crew Dragon

B.Boeing Starliner

C.Soyuz MS-29

D.Orion

E.Tianzhou-10

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

National Aeronautics and Space Administration (NASA) astronaut Anil Menon is scheduled to launch to the **International Space Station (ISS)** on **14 July 2026** aboard the **Roscosmos Soyuz MS-29 spacecraft**.

The launch will take place from the **Baikonur Cosmodrome, Kazakhstan**.

Anil Menon will travel with Roscosmos cosmonauts **Pyotr Dubrov** and **Anna Kikina** as part of **Expedition 74/75**.

The Soyuz MS-29 spacecraft will automatically dock with the **Prichal module** of the ISS after a **two-orbit, three-hour journey**.

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The Soyuz MS-29 spacecraft will automatically dock with the **Prichal module** of the ISS after a **two-orbit, three-hour journey**.

On arrival, the crew will join NASA astronauts **Jessica Meir**, **Jack Hathaway**, **Chris Williams**, ESA astronaut **Sophie Adenot**, and Roscosmos cosmonauts **Sergey Kud-Sverchkov**, **Serhei Mikaev**, and **Andrey Fedyaev**.

The mission will last approximately **8 months**, with the crew expected to return to Earth in **April 2027**.

This will be **Anil Menon's first spaceflight** since being selected as a **NASA astronaut in 2021** and completing astronaut training in **March 2024**.

240. As per the news, the Union Ministry of Road Transport and Highways (MoRTH) plans to centralise the National Bridge Health Monitoring Software by involving which institution?

A.IIT Madras

B.IIT Delhi

C.IIT Bombay

D.IISc Bengaluru

E.NIT Tiruchirappalli

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

The **Union Ministry of Road Transport and Highways (MoRTH)** plans to centralise the **National Bridge Health Monitoring Software** by involving **Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) Madras** and the **Centre for Development of Advanced Computing (C-DAC)**.

The software is linked to the **Bridge Health Monitoring System (BHMS)**, which uses **sensor-based technology** for **real-time monitoring** of bridges on the **National Highway network**.

The **Bridge Health Monitoring System (BHMS)** continuously monitors bridge movement, stress, vibration, and structural health using **sensors installed on bridge components**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Union Ministry of Road Transport and Highways (MoRTH)** plans to centralise the **National Bridge Health Monitoring Software** by involving **Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) Madras** and the **Centre for Development of Advanced Computing (C-DAC)**.

The software is linked to the **Bridge Health Monitoring System (BHMS)**, which uses **sensor-based technology** for **real-time monitoring** of bridges on the **National Highway network**.

The **Bridge Health Monitoring System (BHMS)** continuously monitors bridge movement, stress, vibration, and structural health using **sensors installed on bridge components**.

The Ministry has introduced a standardised **Model Request for Proposal (Model RFP)** for all future BHMS projects.

Under the new policy, the **supply, installation, and maintenance of sensors** will be **awarded separately** through competitive bidding.

All BHMS components in highway contracts where physical work has not yet started will be **de-scoped and re-tendered** using the new Model RFP.

The objective is to create a **uniform framework** for deploying continuous real-time bridge monitoring systems across India's National Highway network.

241. As per the news, which semiconductor foundry is associated with DeepSeek's custom AI chip project?

A.Taiwan Semiconductor Manufacturing Company (TSMC)

B.Intel Foundry Services

C.GlobalFoundries

D.Semiconductor Manufacturing International Corporation (SMIC)

E.Samsung Foundry

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

DeepSeek is a Chinese **Artificial Intelligence (AI) startup** headquartered in **Hangzhou, China**.

In **July 2026**, DeepSeek was linked to the development of a **custom AI chip** designed for **AI inference workloads** and to reduce China's dependence on foreign semiconductor technology.

Semiconductor Manufacturing International Corporation (SMIC), China's largest semiconductor foundry, is associated with the project.

Detailed Explanation:

DeepSeek is a Chinese **Artificial Intelligence (AI) startup** headquartered in **Hangzhou, China**.

In **July 2026**, DeepSeek was linked to the development of a **custom AI chip** designed for **AI inference workloads** and to reduce China's dependence on foreign semiconductor technology.

AI Inference is the stage where a trained AI model processes inputs and generates outputs such as text, images, or predictions.

AI Training is the process of building an AI model using large datasets and high computational power, requiring more advanced hardware than inference.

The AI chip project reportedly began around **July 2025** and remained in an early development stage during 2026.

DeepSeek has been recruiting **chip-design engineers** and holding discussions with semiconductor foundries and memory manufacturers for chip production.

Semiconductor Manufacturing International Corporation (SMIC), China's largest semiconductor foundry, is associated with the project.

242. As per the news, PROMISE (Polar Rover for Observation, Mapping, and In-Situ Exploration) is being considered by NASA for deployment under which programme?

A.Apollo Programme

B.Artemis Programme

C.Commercial Lunar Payload Services (CLPS)

D.Lunar Gateway Programme

E.Mars Sample Return Mission

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

National Aeronautics and Space Administration (**NASA)** is considering repurposing **PROMISE (Polar Rover for Observation, Mapping, and In-Situ Exploration)** into a lunar rover for the **Artemis Programme**.

PROMISE is a **full-scale engineering model** that was originally built to support the **Curiosity and Perseverance Mars rover missions**.

If approved, PROMISE will explore the **Moon's South Pole**, one of the key target regions of the Artemis Programme.

Detailed Explanation:

National Aeronautics and Space Administration (**NASA)** is considering repurposing **PROMISE (Polar Rover for Observation, Mapping, and In-Situ Exploration)** into a lunar rover for the **Artemis Programme**.

PROMISE is a **full-scale engineering model** that was originally built to support the **Curiosity and Perseverance Mars rover missions**.

If approved, PROMISE will explore the **Moon's South Pole**, one of the key target regions of the Artemis Programme.

The rover will **map lunar terrain**, search for **water ice** and other resources, identify sites for future lunar infrastructure, and support

NASA's long-term goal of establishing a permanent human presence on the Moon.
PROMISE is powered by a **Radioisotope Thermoelectric Generator (RTG)**, a **nuclear power source** that generates electricity from the natural decay of radioactive material.

243. As per the news, India's first mobile "Liquid Tree" (SALT) was developed by which institution?

A.CSIR–National Environmental Engineering Research Institute (CSIR-NEERI)
B.Indian Institute of Science (IISc), Bengaluru
C.CSIR–Central Institute of Mining and Fuel Research (CSIR-CIMFR)
D.Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) Delhi
E.National Botanical Research Institute (NBRI)

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

Scientists at the Council of Scientific and Industrial Research–Central Institute of Mining and Fuel Research (CSIR-CIMFR), Dhanbad, Jharkhand, developed India's first mobile "Liquid Tree", called the **Smart Algal Liquid Tree (SALT)**.

SALT (Smart Algal Liquid Tree) is an innovative **air purification system** designed to improve air quality in densely populated urban and industrial areas where planting conventional trees is difficult.

Detailed Explanation:

Scientists at the Council of Scientific and Industrial Research–Central Institute of Mining and Fuel Research (CSIR-CIMFR), Dhanbad, Jharkhand, developed India's first mobile "Liquid Tree", called the **Smart Algal Liquid Tree (SALT)**.

SALT (Smart Algal Liquid Tree) is an innovative **air purification system** designed to improve air quality in densely populated urban and industrial areas where planting conventional trees is difficult.

SALT is a compact container filled with water and **microalgae**, which are microscopic single-celled organisms that perform **photosynthesis** by absorbing **carbon dioxide (CO_2)** and releasing **oxygen (O_2)**.
Microalgae are responsible for generating nearly **50% of the Earth's oxygen** through photosynthesis.
SALT works by drawing or bubbling polluted air through the algae-filled tank, where **CO_2 is absorbed, oxygen is released**, and certain air pollutants are trapped or biologically processed.

244. As per the news, South Korea's 4th next-generation medium-sized Earth Observation Satellite has been developed under which organisation?

A.Korea Institute of Science and Technology (KIST)
B.Korea Aerospace Research Institute (KARI)
C.Korea Meteorological Administration (KMA)
D.Ministry of Science and ICT
E.Korea AeroSpace Administration (KASA)

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

South Korea is set to launch its **4th next-generation medium-sized Earth Observation Satellite** aboard a **SpaceX Falcon 9 rocket** from **Vandenberg Space Force Base, California, USA**.

The satellite has been developed under the **Korea AeroSpace Administration (KASA)**.

The **500-kg satellite** carries indigenous **high-resolution imaging payloads** capable of capturing images of the entire **Korean Peninsula** every three days.

The satellite will be placed in **Low Earth Orbit (LEO)** at an altitude of approximately **888 km**.

Detailed Explanation:

South Korea is set to launch its **4th next-generation medium-sized Earth Observation Satellite** aboard a **SpaceX Falcon 9 rocket** from **Vandenberg Space Force Base, California, USA**.

The satellite has been developed under the **Korea AeroSpace Administration (KASA)**.

The **500-kg satellite** carries indigenous **high-resolution imaging payloads** capable of capturing images of the entire **Korean Peninsula** every three days.

The satellite will be placed in **Low Earth Orbit (LEO)** at an altitude of approximately **888 km**.

After launch, the satellite will undergo **four months of in-orbit testing** before becoming fully operational in the **first half of 2027**.

The Earth Observation Satellite will support **agriculture, forest management, disaster response, climate change monitoring, environmental observation, and public safety**.

245. As per the news, the newly inaugurated International Centre for Civilizational Studies in Bishkek is named after which two epics?

A.Ramayana and Iliad

B.Mahabharata and Odyssey

C.Manas and Mahabharata

D.Shahnameh and Ramayana

E.Manas and Gilgamesh

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

India and **Kyrgyzstan** strengthened their cultural and academic partnership with the inauguration of the **International Centre for Civilizational Studies "Manas and Mahabharata"** in **Bishkek, Kyrgyzstan**.

The centre has been established by the **Manas National Academy** in collaboration with the **Centre for the Studies of International Relations (CSIR), New Delhi**, to promote **comparative civilizational research, cultural diplomacy, and academic exchanges**.

Detailed Explanation:

India and **Kyrgyzstan** strengthened their cultural and academic partnership with the inauguration of the **International Centre for Civilizational Studies "Manas and Mahabharata"** in **Bishkek, Kyrgyzstan**.

The centre has been established by the **Manas National Academy** in collaboration with the **Centre for the Studies of International**

Relations (CSIR), New Delhi, to promote **comparative civilizational research, cultural diplomacy, and academic exchanges**.

The centre aims to encourage interdisciplinary research on the **Mahabharata** of India and the **Manas** epic of Kyrgyzstan, covering areas such as **history, literature, philosophy, international relations, and cultural studies**.

The initiative seeks to promote **civilizational dialogue**, **humanitarian diplomacy**, **international research collaboration**, **faculty and student exchanges**, and studies on the shared historical and cultural heritage of the **Eurasian region**.

During the event, **trilateral cooperation agreements** were signed between the **Manas National Academy**, the **Centre for the Studies of International Relations (CSIR), New Delhi**, and **seven leading universities of Kyrgyzstan** to facilitate joint research projects, academic partnerships, and educational exchange programmes.

As part of the event, the **first Hindi translation** of the **Kyrgyz national epic "Manas"** was released. The translation was prepared by **Professor Hem Chandra Pande** and **Professor Ramakant Dwivedi**, based on the **Russian poetic adaptation** by **Mar Baizhiev**, and includes the three major sections—**Manas, Semetey, and Seitek**.

246. As per the news, the Australia-India Partnership for Cyber, Critical Technologies and Supply Chains (PACTS) focuses on how many key pillars?

A.Three

B.Four

C.Six

D.Five

E.Seven

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

India and **Australia** launched the **Australia-India Partnership for Cyber, Critical Technologies and Supply Chains (PACTS)** during the **third India- Australia Annual Summit** held in **Melbourne, Australia**, in the presence of **Prime Minister Narendra Modi** and **Australian Prime Minister Anthony Albanese**.

The partnership focuses on **five key pillars**: **Supply Chain Flexibility and Diversification**, **Critical Technologies**, **Cybersecurity**, **Digital Resilience**, and **Defence Research Cooperation**.

Detailed Explanation:

India and **Australia** launched the **Australia-India Partnership for Cyber, Critical Technologies and Supply Chains (PACTS)** during the **third India- Australia Annual Summit** held in **Melbourne, Australia**, in the presence of **Prime Minister Narendra Modi** and **Australian Prime Minister Anthony Albanese**.

The **Australia-India Partnership for Cyber, Critical Technologies and Supply Chains (PACTS)** aims to strengthen cooperation in cybersecurity, artificial intelligence, semiconductors, critical minerals, digital resilience, defence research, and resilient supply chains.

The partnership will bring together government institutions, private companies, universities, research organisations, and defence technology developers to promote innovation, technology collaboration, investment, and commercialisation of research.

The partnership focuses on **five key pillars**: **Supply Chain Flexibility and Diversification**, **Critical Technologies**, **Cybersecurity**, **Digital Resilience**, and **Defence Research Cooperation**.

The initiative seeks to enhance **economic resilience**, strengthen **national security**, reduce dependence on single-country supply chains, and ensure secure access to **critical technologies** and **strategic minerals**.

247. As per the news, Sourav Ganguly became the _____ Indian cricketer to be inducted into the ICC Hall of Fame.

A.12th

B.11th

C.10th

D.13th

E.14th

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

Former India captain Sourav Ganguly was inducted into the **International Cricket Council (ICC) Hall of Fame**, becoming the **12th Indian cricketer** to receive one of cricket's highest individual honours.

The **International Cricket Council (ICC) Hall of Fame** recognises **retired cricketers** who have made exceptional contributions to the game through **outstanding performances, leadership, and lasting impact** on international cricket.

Detailed Explanation:

Former India captain Sourav Ganguly was inducted into the **International Cricket Council (ICC) Hall of Fame**, becoming the **12th Indian cricketer** to receive one of cricket's highest individual honours.

The **International Cricket Council (ICC) Hall of Fame** recognises **retired cricketers** who have made exceptional contributions to the game through **outstanding performances, leadership, and lasting impact** on international cricket.

Popularly known as **"Dada"**, **Sourav Ganguly** is credited with transforming Indian cricket through his **aggressive leadership**, building a fearless team, and laying the foundation for India's success in international cricket.

Under his captaincy, **India** reached the **2003 International Cricket Council (ICC) Cricket World Cup Final**, registered several memorable overseas Test victories, and nurtured future stars such as **Mahendra Singh (MS) Dhoni,**

Virender Sehwag, Harbhajan Singh, Yuvraj Singh, and Zaheer Khan.

248. As per the news, World Malala Day is observed every year on_____

A.10 July

B.12 July

C.13 July

D.15 July

E.24 October

Answer: B

World Malala Day is observed annually on **12 July** to honour **Malala Yousafzai** and raise awareness about the **right to education**, **women's empowerment**, and **children's rights** across the world.

The **United Nations (UN)** declared **12 July** as **Malala Day** in recognition of **Malala Yousafzai's** contribution to promoting **girls' education** and **human rights**.

Malala Yousafzai was born on **12 July 1997** in **Mingora, Pakistan**. In **2014**, at the age of **17**, she became the **youngest-ever recipient of the Nobel Peace Prize** for her advocacy of girls' education.

249. As per the news, TIME Magazine included Malala Yousafzai among the World's Most Influential People in which year?

A.2011

B.2012

C.2013

D.2014

E.2015

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

TIME Magazine included **Malala Yousafzai** among the **World's Most Influential People** in **2013**. She has also received the **United Nations Human Rights Prize** and the **Liberty Medal**.

In **2017**, **Malala Yousafzai** joined the **University of Oxford** for higher education and continues to campaign globally for **girls' education** and **women's rights** through the **Malala Fund**.

Detailed Explanation:

World Malala Day is observed annually on **12 July** to honour **Malala Yousafzai** and raise awareness about the **right to education**, **women's empowerment**, and **children's rights** across the world.

On her **16th birthday (12 July 2013)**, Malala addressed the **United Nations (UN) Youth Assembly** in **New York**, delivering a landmark speech advocating universal access to education.

TIME Magazine included **Malala Yousafzai** among the **World's Most Influential People** in **2013**. She has also received the **United Nations Human Rights Prize** and the **Liberty Medal**.

In **2017**, **Malala Yousafzai** joined the **University of Oxford** for higher education and continues to campaign globally for **girls' education** and **women's rights** through the **Malala Fund**.

250. As per the news, consider the following statements regarding OpenAI's GPT-5.6:

1. **OpenAI develops the GPT (Generative Pre-trained Transformer) series of Large Language Models (LLMs).**
2. **Terra is the base variant of GPT-5.6.**
3. **Luna offers performance comparable to GPT-5.5 at nearly half the cost.**

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

A.Only Statement 1 is correct

B.Only Statements 1 and 2 are correct

C.Only Statements 2 and 3 are correct

D.All the above

E.Only Statement 3 is correct

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

GPT-5.6 introduces **three variants**: **Sol (flagship model)**, **Terra (mid-tier model)**, and **Luna (base model)**.

Terra offers performance comparable to GPT-5.5 at **nearly half the cost**, making it a more cost-effective AI model.

Luna is designed to provide **faster AI responses** and is available **without requiring a subscription**.

OpenAI develops the **GPT (Generative Pre-trained Transformer)** series of **Large Language Models (LLMs)** used for text generation, reasoning, coding, and AI-powered applications.

Detailed Explanation:

OpenAI also announced the limited preview release of its latest AI model family, **GPT-5.6**.

The GPT-5.6 rollout will be **phased**, while the company coordinates with the **United States (U.S.) Government** for wider public availability.

GPT-5.6 introduces **three variants**: **Sol (flagship model)**, **Terra (mid-tier model)**, and **Luna (base model)**.

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Luna is designed to provide **faster AI responses** and is available **without requiring a subscription**.

OpenAI is an American **Artificial Intelligence (AI) research organisation** known for developing **Generative AI technologies**.

OpenAI develops the **GPT (Generative Pre-trained Transformer)** series of **Large Language Models (LLMs)** used for text generation, reasoning, coding, and AI-powered applications.

251. Recently, which Reserve Bank of India (RBI) survey is conducted across 19 cities to assess households' inflation expectations based on their individual consumption baskets?

A.Rural Consumer Confidence Survey (RCCS)

B.Urban Consumer Confidence Survey (UCCS)

C.Inflation Expectations Survey of Households (IESH)

D.Consumer Price Index Survey (CPIS)

E.Household Income Survey (HIS)

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) launched the **Inflation Expectations Survey of Households (IESH)**, **Rural Consumer Confidence Survey (RCCS)**, and **Urban Consumer Confidence Survey (UCCS)** to collect household feedback on inflation, economic conditions, employment, income, and spending.

The surveys provide critical inputs for **monetary policy formulation** ahead of the **Monetary Policy Committee (MPC) meeting** scheduled from **3–5 August 2026**.

The **Inflation Expectations Survey of Households (IESH)** is conducted across **19 cities** to assess households' inflation expectations based on their individual consumption baskets.

Detailed Explanation:

The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) launched the **Inflation Expectations Survey of Households (IESH)**, **Rural Consumer Confidence Survey (RCCS)**, and **Urban Consumer Confidence Survey (UCCS)** to collect household feedback on inflation, economic conditions, employment, income, and spending.

The surveys provide critical inputs for **monetary policy formulation** ahead of the **Monetary Policy Committee (MPC) meeting** scheduled from **3–5 August 2026**.

The **Inflation Expectations Survey of Households (IESH)** is conducted across **19 cities** to assess households' inflation expectations based on their individual consumption baskets.

IESH gathers **qualitative responses** on general and product-specific price movements for the **next 3 months and 1 year**.

IESH also collects **quantitative estimates** of current inflation, 3-month-ahead inflation, and 1-year-ahead inflation.

The **Rural Consumer Confidence Survey (RCCS)** covers **rural and semi-urban households** across **31 States and Union Territories (UTs)**.

252. Recently, AU Small Finance Bank (AU SFB) partnered with Zaggle Prepaid Ocean Services Limited to launch the AU Zaggle Co-Branded Retail Credit Card on which payment networks?

A.Visa and RuPay

B.Visa and Mastercard

C.RuPay and American Express

D.Mastercard and Discover

E.Visa only

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

AU Small Finance Bank Limited (AU SFB) partnered with **Zaggle Prepaid Ocean Services Limited (Zaggle)** to launch the **AU Zaggle Co-Branded Retail Credit Card** on the **Visa and RuPay payment networks** through the **zagg.money platform**.

The **AU Zaggle Co-Branded Retail Credit Card** offers **customizable rewards**, **Zagg**

Coins-to-cashback, **Unified Payments Interface (UPI) support**, and **contactless payment benefits**, providing customers with a personalized digital credit card experience.

Detailed Explanation:

AU Small Finance Bank Limited (AU SFB) partnered with **Zaggle Prepaid Ocean Services Limited (Zaggle)** to launch the **AU Zaggle Co-Branded Retail Credit Card** on the **Visa and RuPay payment networks** through the **zagg.money platform**.

The **AU Zaggle Co-Branded Retail Credit Card** offers **customizable rewards**, **Zagg Coins-to-cashback**, **Unified Payments Interface (UPI) support**, and **contactless payment benefits**, providing customers with a personalized digital credit card experience.

Cardholders can earn **accelerated Zagg Coins** on **UPI and contactless transactions**, along with **higher cashback** upon achieving specified spending milestones.

Zagg Coins earned through card usage can be **converted into cashback** via the **zagg.money app**, with the cashback amount credited directly to the credit card account.

253. Recently, which bank launched EPFO Payment Services by integrating with the Employees' Provident Fund Organisation (EPFO)?

A.HDFC Bank

B.ICICI Bank

C.Punjab National Bank

D.Axis Bank

E.IDFC FIRST Bank

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

IDFC FIRST Bank has launched **Employees' Provident Fund Organisation (EPFO) Payment Services** through integration with the Employees' Provident Fund Organisation (EPFO) under the **Ministry of Labour and Employment**.

The new service enables employers and establishments to make **Employees' Provident Fund (EPF) contributions digitally** by initiating payments through the **EPFO Portal** and completing them via IDFC FIRST Bank's **Retail and Corporate Internet Banking platforms**.

The integration provides a **fully digital, secure, and paperless payment solution** for Provident Fund (PF) contributions.

Detailed Explanation:

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The new service enables employers and establishments to make **Employees' Provident Fund (EPF) contributions digitally** by initiating payments through the **EPFO Portal** and completing them via IDFC FIRST Bank's **Retail and Corporate Internet Banking platforms**.

The integration provides a **fully digital, secure, and paperless payment solution** for Provident Fund (PF) contributions.

The service offers **real-time transaction confirmation**, **instant challan download**, and an intuitive user interface for easier payment processing and record maintenance.

The facility supports easy reconciliation of PF payments through **instant challan generation**.

The EPFO integration helps businesses ensure **timely statutory compliance** and **efficient cash flow management** by enabling seamless digital PF payments throughout the year.

254. Recently, Bank of Baroda (BoB) agreed to pay USD 600 million in an out-of-court settlement to resolve claims related to its lending exposure to which collapsed company?

A.Abraaj Group

B.NMC Health PLC

C.Dubai World

D.Emirates NBD

E.Gulf Finance House

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Bank of Baroda (BoB) has entered into a joint out-of-court settlement with **NMC Health PLC** and **NMC Healthcare Ltd**, agreeing to pay **USD 600 million (around ₹5,100 crore)** to resolve claims related to its lending exposure to the collapsed UAE-based NMC Group.

The settlement ends the long-running legal proceedings before the **Abu Dhabi Global Market (ADGM) Court** and the **UK Insolvency and Companies Court**, avoiding prolonged litigation and legal expenses.

The settlement was reached **without any admission of liability or wrongdoing** by Bank of Baroda.

Detailed Explanation:

Bank of Baroda (BoB) has entered into a joint out-of-court settlement with **NMC Health PLC** and **NMC Healthcare Ltd**, agreeing to pay **USD 600 million (around ₹5,100 crore)** to resolve claims related to its lending exposure to the collapsed UAE-based NMC Group.

The settlement ends the long-running legal proceedings before the **Abu Dhabi Global Market (ADGM) Court** and the **UK Insolvency and Companies Court**, avoiding prolonged litigation and legal expenses.

The settlement was reached **without any admission of liability or wrongdoing** by Bank of Baroda.

The agreement resolves **all claims against Bank of Baroda** arising from the NMC Health case.

NMC Group collapsed in 2020 following allegations of **financial fraud and undisclosed debt**, becoming one of the largest corporate failures in the Gulf region.

Indian banks, including Bank of Baroda, had **significant lending exposure** to the NMC Group

255. Recently, the Pension Fund Regulatory and Development Authority (PFRDA) constituted which committee to strengthen the National Pension System (NPS) by attracting global pension fund investments into India?

A.ASCEND Committee

B.VIKAS Committee

C.SAMRIDH Committee

D.VISION Committee

E.UDAAN Committee

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

Pension Fund Regulatory and Development Authority (PFRDA) has constituted the **ASCEND (Accelerated Scaling of Global Capital Ecosystem and NPS Development) Committee** to strengthen the **National Pension System (NPS)** by attracting **global pension fund investments** into India.

The ASCEND Committee will prepare a roadmap for collaboration between Indian pension funds under the NPS framework and leading global pension funds to channel **long-term, stable capital** into **infrastructure** and other strategic sectors, while safeguarding NPS subscribers' interests.

The ASCEND Committee is chaired by **Dinesh Khara**, Chairman of the **NPS Trust**.

Detailed Explanation:

Pension Fund Regulatory and Development Authority (PFRDA) has constituted the **ASCEND (Accelerated Scaling of Global Capital Ecosystem and NPS Development) Committee** to strengthen the **National Pension System (NPS)** by attracting **global pension fund investments** into India.

The ASCEND Committee will prepare a roadmap for collaboration between Indian pension funds under the NPS framework and leading global pension funds to channel **long-term, stable capital** into **infrastructure** and other strategic sectors, while safeguarding NPS subscribers' interests.

The ASCEND Committee is chaired by **Dinesh Khara**, Chairman of the **NPS Trust**.

Other members of the ASCEND Committee include **Narayan Ramachandran** (Chairman, TeamLease Services), **Ananth Narayan** (Former Whole-Time Member, SEBI), **Ashvin Parekh** (Managing Partner, Ashvin Parekh Advisory Services), **Dr. Arvind Gupta** (Trustee, NPS Trust), and **Suparna Tandon** (CEO, NPS Trust), who serves as the **Member Secretary**.

India's National Pension System (NPS) currently manages assets worth around **USD 185 billion (approximately ₹17.5 lakh crore)**, equivalent to nearly **5% of India's Gross Domestic Product (GDP)**, making it one of the country's largest sources of long-term domestic savings.

256. Recently, the Ministry of MSME mandated all operating Central Public Sector Enterprises (CPSEs) to settle MSME invoices through which RBI-authorised digital platform?

A.Bharat Bill Payment System (BBPS)

B.Trade Receivables Discounting System (TReDS)

C.Unified Payments Interface (UPI)

D.Public Financial Management System (PFMS)

E.Open Credit Enablement Network (OCEN)

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The **Ministry of Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises (MSME)**, through a notification issued on **30 June 2026**, mandated all operating **Central Public Sector Enterprises (CPSEs)** to settle MSME invoices for goods and services through **Trade Receivables Discounting System (TReDS) platforms** authorised by the **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)**.

The new mandate implements a key announcement of the **Union Budget FY2026–27**, aimed at strengthening **MSME financing** and ensuring **timely payments**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Ministry of Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises (MSME)**, through a notification issued on **30 June 2026**, mandated all operating **Central Public Sector Enterprises (CPSEs)** to settle MSME invoices for goods and services through **Trade Receivables Discounting System (TReDS) platforms** authorised by the **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)**.

The new mandate implements a key announcement of the **Union Budget FY2026–27**, aimed at strengthening **MSME financing** and ensuring **timely payments**.

Under the new framework, CPSEs must route and settle MSME invoices through TReDS, enhancing **transparency, accountability, and payment discipline**.

CPSEs are required to disclose details of MSME invoices processed through TReDS and obtain a **Statutory Auditor's Certificate** confirming **TReDS registration and compliance** during the annual audit.

The initiative will facilitate **collateral-free working capital** for MSMEs by enabling **invoice discounting** before the payment due date, improving their **liquidity**.

The reform is expected to make CPSEs role models for **timely payment practices** among large corporate buyers.

Trade Receivables Discounting System (TReDS) is an RBI-authorised **digital platform**, operational since **2017**, designed to facilitate financing and discounting of trade receivables of MSMEs due from corporate buyers, Government Departments, and Public Sector Undertakings (PSUs) through **competitive bidding** by multiple financiers.

257. Recently, which state government unveiled the Artificial Intelligence (AI) Policy 2026–31 Roadmap to position itself as a leading AI-driven governance and technology hub?

A.Karnataka

B.Telangana

C.Maharashtra

D.Jharkhand

E.Gujarat

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The **Government of Jharkhand** unveiled the **Artificial Intelligence (AI) Policy 2026–31 Roadmap** to position the state as a leading **Artificial Intelligence (AI)-driven governance** and **technology hub**.

The roadmap was presented during the **National Stakeholder Consultation 2026** in **New Delhi**.

The roadmap aims to attract **more than ₹10,000 crore** in **private investment**, establish **50+ Global Capability Centres (GCCs)**, support **1,000 Artificial Intelligence (AI) startups**, and create **over one lakh Artificial Intelligence (AI)-enabled jobs** during **2026–31**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Government of Jharkhand** unveiled the **Artificial Intelligence (AI) Policy 2026–31 Roadmap** to position the state as a leading **Artificial Intelligence (AI)-driven governance** and **technology hub**.

The roadmap was presented during the **National Stakeholder Consultation 2026** in **New Delhi**.

The roadmap aims to attract **more than ₹10,000 crore** in **private investment**, establish **50+ Global Capability Centres (GCCs)**, support **1,000 Artificial Intelligence (AI) startups**, and create **over one lakh Artificial Intelligence (AI)-enabled jobs** during **2026–31**.

The **Government of Jharkhand** plans to invest **₹1,150 crore** over five years to develop **Artificial Intelligence (AI) infrastructure**, strengthen **digital governance**, promote **innovation**, and build a robust technology ecosystem.

The policy focuses on integrating **Artificial Intelligence (AI)** into **public administration** through **predictive analytics**, **intelligent decision-making systems**, and **data-driven governance** to improve public service delivery, administrative efficiency, and policymaking.

258. Recently, which state government is implementing the Nishulk Boring Yojana 2026 to provide free borewell installation and subsidised pump sets to eligible farmers?

A.Madhya Pradesh

B.Rajasthan

C.Uttar Pradesh

D.Bihar

E.Haryana

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The **Government of Uttar Pradesh** is set to implement the **Uttar Pradesh Nishulk Boring Yojana 2026** to provide **free borewell (boring) installation** and **subsidised pump sets** for eligible farmers to improve irrigation facilities and agricultural productivity.

The scheme primarily targets **small and marginal farmers**, enabling them to access **groundwater for irrigation**, reduce dependence on **monsoon rainfall**, and increase crop yields.

Originally launched in **1985**, the **Uttar Pradesh Nishulk Boring Yojana** continues to strengthen irrigation infrastructure and support sustainable agricultural development across the state.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Government of Uttar Pradesh** is set to implement the **Uttar Pradesh Nishulk Boring Yojana 2026** to provide **free borewell (boring) installation** and **subsidised pump sets** for eligible farmers to improve irrigation facilities and agricultural productivity.

The scheme primarily targets **small and marginal farmers**, enabling them to access **groundwater for irrigation**, reduce dependence on **monsoon rainfall**, and increase crop yields.

Originally launched in **1985**, the **Uttar Pradesh Nishulk Boring Yojana** continues to strengthen irrigation infrastructure and support sustainable agricultural development across the state.

Under the scheme, eligible farmers will receive **free agricultural borewell installation** along with **pump sets of up to 5 Horsepower (HP)** at subsidised rates or free, depending on eligibility.

The scheme aims to provide **affordable irrigation**, improve **farm income**, enhance **year-round cultivation**, and reduce the financial burden of installing irrigation infrastructure.

Small farmers with landholdings of up to **2 hectares** and **marginal farmers** with landholdings of up to **1 hectare** are eligible for the scheme. **Scheduled Caste (SC)** and **Scheduled Tribe (ST)** farmers are eligible irrespective of landholding limits, subject to applicable provisions.

259. Recently, which smart card has been made mandatory by the Government of Delhi for women to avail free travel on DTC and DIMTS Cluster buses from 1 August 2026?

A.One Delhi Card

B.Pink Saheli Smart Card

C.National Common Mobility Card (NCMC)

D.Delhi Metro Smart Card

E.Shakti Transit Card

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The **Government of Delhi** has made the **Pink Saheli Smart Card** mandatory for women to avail **free travel** on **Delhi Transport Corporation (DTC)** and **Delhi Integrated Multi-Modal Transit System (DIMTS) Cluster** buses from **1 August 2026**.

The **Pink Saheli Smart Card** will replace the existing **paper-based pink ticket** system as part of the government's initiative to **digitise public transport services**, improve transparency, and prevent misuse of the free travel scheme.

From **1 August 2026**, **paper pink tickets will no longer be valid**. Eligible women passengers must carry the **Pink Saheli Smart Card** and **tap it on the card reader** while boarding the bus to avail free travel.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Government of Delhi** has made the **Pink Saheli Smart Card** mandatory for women to avail **free travel** on **Delhi Transport Corporation (DTC)** and **Delhi Integrated Multi-Modal Transit System (DIMTS) Cluster** buses from **1 August 2026**.

The **Pink Saheli Smart Card** will replace the existing **paper-based pink ticket** system as part of the government's initiative to **digitise public transport services**, improve transparency, and prevent misuse of the free travel scheme.

From **1 August 2026**, **paper pink tickets will no longer be valid**. Eligible women passengers must carry the **Pink Saheli Smart Card** and **tap it on the card reader** while boarding the bus to avail free travel.

Women who do not possess the **Pink Saheli Smart Card** after the implementation date will be required to purchase **regular bus tickets** for travel.

The initiative aims to promote **paperless ticketing**, improve **ticket verification**, enhance **operational efficiency**, ensure **transparent implementation** of the scheme, and reduce fraudulent claims.

The new system will be applicable on buses operated by the **Delhi Transport Corporation (DTC)** and the **Delhi Integrated Multi-Modal Transit System (DIMTS)**.

To facilitate implementation, the **Government of Delhi** has established **50 authorised registration centres** across the city, where eligible women can apply for the **Pink Saheli Smart Card**.

260. With reference to the Uttar Pradesh Mahila Udyam Nidhi Yojana 2026, consider the following statements:

1. **The scheme aims to provide affordable credit to women entrepreneurs for establishing or expanding micro and small enterprises.**
2. **Eligible women can avail loans ranging from ₹50,000 to ₹10 lakh at a concessional interest rate of around 4%.**
3. **Collateral is not required for loans up to ₹2 lakh under the scheme.**

A.Only Statement 1 is correct

B.Only Statements 1 and 2 are correct

C.Only Statements 2 and 3 are correct

D.All the above

E.None of the above

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The **Government of Uttar Pradesh** is implementing the **Uttar Pradesh Mahila Udyam Nidhi Yojana 2026** to provide **affordable credit** to women entrepreneurs for establishing or expanding **micro and small enterprises**, with the objective of promoting **self-employment** and **financial independence**.

The scheme, implemented through **Uttar Pradesh Mahila Nidhi**, was originally launched in **2016** to improve women's access

to **institutional finance** and encourage entrepreneurship across the state.
Under the scheme, eligible women can avail loans ranging from **₹50,000 to ₹10 lakh** at a concessional interest rate of around **4%**. **Collateral is not required** for loans up to **₹2 lakh**, making credit more accessible to first-time entrepreneurs.
Detailed Explanation:
The **Government of Uttar Pradesh** is implementing the **Uttar Pradesh Mahila Udyam Nidhi Yojana 2026** to provide **affordable credit** to women entrepreneurs for establishing or expanding **micro and small enterprises**, with the objective of promoting **self-employment** and **financial independence**.
The scheme, implemented through **Uttar Pradesh Mahila Nidhi**, was originally launched in **2016** to improve women's access to **institutional finance** and encourage entrepreneurship across the state.
Under the scheme, eligible women can avail loans ranging from **₹50,000 to ₹10 lakh** at a concessional interest rate of around **4%**. **Collateral is not required** for loans up to **₹2 lakh**, making credit more accessible to first-time entrepreneurs.
The scheme aims to promote **women entrepreneurship**, strengthen **financial inclusion**, support **micro-enterprises**, generate **self-employment opportunities**, and improve the socio-economic status of women in **Uttar Pradesh**.
Priority is given to **Self-Help Group (SHG)** members, **widows**, **women with disabilities**, and women belonging to **socially disadvantaged and minority communities** during loan disbursement.
Eligible applicants must be **women aged between 18 and 60 years**, permanent residents of **Uttar Pradesh**, have an annual family income below **₹3 lakh**, possess an **Aadhaar-linked bank account**, and have a viable business proposal or an existing micro or small enterprise.
A **Credit Information Bureau (India) Limited (CIBIL)** score may be considered for higher-value loans.

261. Recently, which state government launched the 'Viksit – Data Centre Policy 2026–29' to position itself as a leading hub for hyperscale data centres and AI infrastructure?
A.Gujarat
B.Karnataka
C.Telangana
D.Maharashtra
E.Tamil Nadu
Answer: A
Short Explanation:
The **Government of Gujarat** launched the **'Viksit Gujarat – Data Centre Policy 2026–29'** to position the state as a leading hub for **hyperscale data centres**, **Artificial Intelligence (AI) infrastructure**, **cloud computing**, and **digital services**.

Chief Minister Bhupendra Patel unveiled the policy in **Gandhinagar, Gujarat**, with the objective of attracting **domestic and global investments** in digital infrastructure and strengthening the state's technology ecosystem.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Government of Gujarat** launched the **'Viksit Gujarat – Data Centre Policy 2026–29'** to position the state as a leading hub for **hyperscale data centres**, **Artificial Intelligence (AI) infrastructure**, **cloud computing**, and **digital services**.

Chief Minister Bhupendra Patel unveiled the policy in **Gandhinagar, Gujarat**, with the objective of attracting **domestic and global investments** in digital infrastructure and strengthening the state's technology ecosystem.

The policy recognises **data centres** as **strategic infrastructure** and aims to support the growing demand for **digital payments, cloud services, Artificial Intelligence (AI), e-governance, and modern digital businesses**.

The policy provides several **fiscal incentives**, including **capital subsidies**, **interest subsidies**, **power tariff support**, **State Goods and Services Tax (SGST) reimbursement**, **electricity duty reimbursement**, **stamp duty exemptions**, and assistance for **desalination plants**.

262. Recently, State Bank of India (SBI) raised ₹1,655 crore by selling a 1.42% stake in which of its subsidiaries through a pre-IPO placement?

A.SBI Life Insurance Company Ltd

B.SBI General Insurance Company Ltd.

C.SBI Funds Management Limited (SBIFM)

D.SBI Cards and Payment Services Ltd

E.SBI Capital Markets Ltd.

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

State Bank of India (SBI) sold a **1.42% stake** in its asset management subsidiary **SBI Funds Management Limited (SBIFM)** through a **pre-Initial Public Offering (IPO) placement**, raising **₹1,655 crore**.

SBI sold **2.88 crore equity shares** to **30 institutional investors** at **₹574 per share**, which was the upper end of the IPO price band.

The pre-IPO placement was completed ahead of the **₹11,700 crore IPO**, which is scheduled to open on **14 July 2026**.

Detailed Explanation:

State Bank of India (SBI) sold a **1.42% stake** in its asset management subsidiary **SBI Funds Management Limited (SBIFM)** through a **pre-Initial Public Offering (IPO) placement**, raising **₹1,655 crore**.

SBI sold **2.88 crore equity shares** to **30 institutional investors** at **₹574 per share**, which was the upper end of the IPO price band.

The pre-IPO placement was completed ahead of the **₹11,700 crore IPO**, which is scheduled to open on **14 July 2026**.

The 30 institutional investors included **Tata AIG General Insurance**, **Go Digit General**

Insurance, **360 ONE Funds**, and **Bennett Coleman**, among others.

Following the transaction, **SBI and Amundi India Holding** will together divest around **10% of SBIFM's paid-up equity** through the IPO.

The proposed IPO is an **Offer for Sale (OFS)**, meaning the existing shareholders are selling their shares and **SBI Funds Management Limited (SBIFM)** will not receive any proceeds from the issue.

263. Recently, the Government of India approved a Joint Venture (JV) between Dixon Technologies (India) Limited and Vivo Mobile India Limited (VMI). What will be Dixon Technologies' stake in the proposed JV?

A.49%

B.51%

C.50%

D.74%

E.100%

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The **Government of India (GoI)** approved the formation of a **Joint Venture (JV)** between **Dixon Technologies (India) Limited** and **Vivo Mobile India Limited (VMI)** for the manufacturing of electronic devices and smartphones in India.

As per the JV agreement and shareholders' agreement, the proposed entity will function as an **Original Equipment Manufacturer (OEM)** for electronic devices, particularly smartphones.

Under the shareholding structure, **Dixon Technologies will hold a 51% stake**, while **Vivo Mobile India Limited (VMI) will own the remaining 49% stake** in the Joint Venture.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Government of India (GoI)** approved the formation of a **Joint Venture (JV)** between **Dixon Technologies (India) Limited** and **Vivo Mobile India Limited (VMI)** for the manufacturing of electronic devices and smartphones in India.

As per the JV agreement and shareholders' agreement, the proposed entity will function as an **Original Equipment Manufacturer (OEM)** for electronic devices, particularly smartphones.

Under the shareholding structure, **Dixon Technologies will hold a 51% stake**, while **Vivo Mobile India Limited (VMI) will own the remaining 49% stake** in the Joint Venture.

The Joint Venture (JV) will be incorporated with an **initial paid-up capital of ₹5 crore**, contributed by both companies in proportion to their respective shareholding.

The approval allows Vivo Mobile India Limited (VMI) to participate in the JV under **Note 3 of 2020** issued by the **Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT)** under the Ministry of Commerce and Industry (MoC&I).

Note 3 of 2020 mandates that entities from countries sharing a land border with India, including China, must obtain prior approval from the Government of India before making investments in India.

264. Recently, which country successfully achieved the first controlled recovery of an orbital-class reusable rocket booster following the maiden launch of the Long March-10B carrier rocket?

A.United States

B.Russia

C.China

D.Japan

E.India

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

China successfully achieved the first **controlled recovery of an orbital-class reusable rocket booster** following the maiden launch of the **Long March-10B carrier rocket** from **Hainan Province, China**.

The **Long March-10B** was developed by the **China Academy of Launch Vehicle Technology (CALT)** and successfully placed its payload into orbit, while its **first-stage booster** was recovered on a **sea-based net platform**.

Detailed Explanation:

China successfully achieved the first **controlled recovery of an orbital-class reusable rocket booster** following the maiden launch of the **Long March-10B carrier rocket** from **Hainan Province, China**.

The **Long March-10B** was developed by the **China Academy of Launch Vehicle Technology (CALT)** and successfully placed its payload into orbit, while its **first-stage booster** was recovered on a **sea-based net platform**.

This mission marks China's **first-ever controlled recovery of an orbital-class reusable rocket booster**, representing a major breakthrough in the country's **reusable space technology**.

The achievement comes more than a decade after **SpaceX**, which became the first company in the world to recover an orbital-class rocket booster with the **Falcon 9 in 2015**.

The Long March-10B is a **liquid-fuelled reusable launch vehicle** designed to support China's reusable rocket programme and **reduce launch costs through booster reuse**.

The rocket is **63 metres tall**, has a **5-metre diameter**, a **lift-off mass of 760 tonnes**, generates **890 tonnes of thrust**, and can carry a **16-tonne payload to Low Earth Orbit (LEO)**.

265. Recently, Indian Naval Sail Training Ship INS Sudarshini arrived at which city in the United States after participating in the Sail4th 250 celebrations?

A.New York

B.Boston

C.San Francisco

D.Miami

E.Washington, D.C.

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Indian Naval Sail Training Ship (STS) INS Sudarshini arrived at **Boston, United States of America (USA)** on **12 July 2026** after

successfully participating in the **Sail4th 250 celebrations at New York**.

INS Sudarshini participated in the **Grand Parade of Sails**, marking the commencement of **Sail Boston 2026**.

Shri Raghuram Sastry, Consul General of India in Boston, embarked on INS Sudarshini during the Grand Parade of Sails and the ship's ceremonial entry into Boston.

Detailed Explanation:

Indian Naval Sail Training Ship (STS) INS Sudarshini arrived at **Boston, United States of America (USA)** on **12 July 2026** after successfully participating in the **Sail4th 250 celebrations at New York**.

INS Sudarshini participated in the **Grand Parade of Sails**, marking the commencement of **Sail Boston 2026**.

Shri Raghuram Sastry, Consul General of India in Boston, embarked on INS Sudarshini during the Grand Parade of Sails and the ship's ceremonial entry into Boston.

Sailing proudly with the **Indian Tricolour**, INS Sudarshini passed major Boston landmarks including **Castle Island** and the **Seaport District** before berthing at **Boston Fish Pier**.

INS Sudarshini joined an international fleet of **over 60 tall ships** representing **more than 20 countries**, showcasing India's maritime presence at Sail Boston 2026.

The ship is representing India as a **maritime ambassador of goodwill** during its ongoing **Lokayan 2026 Transoceanic Expedition**.

The visit highlights the **Indian Navy's commitment to maritime diplomacy**, international goodwill, cultural exchange, and global naval cooperation.

266. Recently, India and Japan held which edition of the Defence Policy Dialogue in Tokyo to strengthen bilateral defence and strategic cooperation?

A.5th Defence Policy Dialogue

B.6th Defence Policy Dialogue

C.7th Defence Policy Dialogue

D.8th Defence Policy Dialogue

E.9th Defence Policy Dialogue

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

India and Japan held the **8th Defence Policy Dialogue** in **Tokyo, Japan**, on **13 July 2026** to strengthen bilateral defence and strategic cooperation.

The Indian delegation was led by **Defence Secretary Shri Rajesh Kumar Singh**, while the Japanese delegation was headed by **Vice Minister of Defence for International Affairs Mr. Kano Koji**.

Both countries reviewed the progress made since the previous dialogue and reaffirmed their commitment to further strengthening the **India–Japan Special Strategic and Global Partnership**.

Detailed Explanation:

India and Japan held the **8th Defence Policy Dialogue** in **Tokyo, Japan**, on **13 July 2026** to

strengthen bilateral defence and strategic cooperation.

The Indian delegation was led by **Defence Secretary Shri Rajesh Kumar Singh**, while the Japanese delegation was headed by **Vice Minister of Defence for International Affairs Mr. Kano Koji**.

Both countries reviewed the progress made since the previous dialogue and reaffirmed their commitment to further strengthening the **India–Japan Special Strategic and Global Partnership**.

The dialogue included discussions on the **regional and global security environment** and exchanged views on issues of **mutual strategic interest**.

Both sides reviewed the entire spectrum of **bilateral defence cooperation**, including **military-to-military exchanges**, joint headquarters cooperation, maritime cooperation, **defence exercises**, capacity building, **defence equipment**, **maritime technology**, and institutional interactions.

267. Recently, Prime Minister Narendra Modi announced the India–Australia Roadmap for Sports Collaboration during his visit to Australia. The roadmap aims to strengthen cooperation ahead of which major sporting event to be hosted in Ahmedabad?

A.Asian Games 2030

B.Commonwealth Games 2030

C.Olympic Games 2036

D.Cricket World Cup 2031

E.Youth Olympic Games 2030

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Prime Minister Narendra Modi announced the **India–Australia Roadmap for Sports Collaboration** during his visit to **Australia** to strengthen long-term cooperation in **coaching**, **sports science**, **athlete development**, **sports technology**, **major sporting events**, and **women in sports**.

The initiative aims to enhance cooperation ahead of major international sporting events, including the **Commonwealth Games 2030** in **Ahmedabad** and the **Olympic and Paralympic Games 2032** in **Brisbane, Australia**, while supporting India's long-term aspiration to host the **Olympic Games**.

Detailed Explanation:

Prime Minister Narendra Modi announced the **India–Australia Roadmap for Sports Collaboration** during his visit to **Australia** to strengthen long-term cooperation in **coaching**, **sports science**, **athlete development**, **sports technology**, **major sporting events**, and **women in sports**.

The roadmap builds upon the **2023 Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) on Cooperation in Sports** and provides a comprehensive framework for collaboration in **skill development**, **capacity building**, **sports research**, **sports governance**, and **sports industry partnerships**.

The initiative aims to enhance cooperation ahead of major international sporting events, including the **Commonwealth Games 2030** in **Ahmedabad** and the **Olympic and Paralympic Games 2032** in **Brisbane, Australia**, while supporting India's long-term aspiration to host the **Olympic Games**.
India and Australia will collaborate on **sports event management**, **athlete training**, **sports infrastructure**, **support systems**, and **competition preparation** to improve performance in international sporting events.

268. Recently, the Department of Posts (DoP) signed a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with which organisation to conduct India's largest-ever rural telecom network performance survey?

A.National Informatics Centre (NIC)
B.Telecom Regulatory Authority of India (TRAI)
C.Bharat Broadband Network Limited (BBNL)
D.Centre for Development of Telematics (C-DOT)
E.Centre for Development of Telematics (C-DOT)

Answer: B

Short Explanation:
The **Department of Posts (DoP)** and the **Telecom Regulatory Authority of India (TRAI)** signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** to conduct **India's largest-ever rural telecom network performance survey** across **5.68 lakh villages**.
The survey aims to assess the **availability**, **coverage**, and **quality** of mobile telecom services in rural India and provide scientific data to support **evidence-based policy decisions** and strengthen the country's digital infrastructure.

Detailed Explanation:
The **Department of Posts (DoP)** and the **Telecom Regulatory Authority of India (TRAI)** signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** to conduct **India's largest-ever rural telecom network performance survey** across **5.68 lakh villages**.
The survey aims to assess the **availability**, **coverage**, and **quality** of mobile telecom services in rural India and provide scientific data to support **evidence-based policy decisions** and strengthen the country's digital infrastructure.
The initiative will evaluate the performance of major telecom service providers, including **Bharti Airtel**, **Reliance Jio**, **Vodafone Idea (Vi)**, and **Bharat Sanchar Nigam Limited (BSNL)**.
The survey will cover **all States and Union Territories** and identify issues such as **poor network coverage**, **call drops**, **weak signal strength**, and **slow internet connectivity**, particularly in remote and underserved villages.

269. Recently, India and New Zealand launched the Strategic Partnership Roadmap with a target year of_____

A.2030

B.2029
C.2032
D.2035
E.2040
Answer: A
Short Explanation:
India and **New Zealand** upgraded their bilateral relationship to a **Strategic Partnership** by launching the **India–New Zealand Strategic Partnership Roadmap 2030** and signing **10 agreements and Memoranda of Understanding (MoUs)** during **Prime Minister Narendra Modi's** official visit to **New Zealand**.
The **Strategic Partnership Roadmap 2030** aims to strengthen cooperation in **defence**, **security**, **trade and investment**, **maritime cooperation**, **agriculture**, **tourism**, **sports**, **culture**, **education**, **scientific research**, and **global affairs**.
Detailed Explanation:
India and **New Zealand** upgraded their bilateral relationship to a **Strategic Partnership** by launching the **India–New Zealand Strategic Partnership Roadmap 2030** and signing **10 agreements and Memoranda of Understanding (MoUs)** during **Prime Minister Narendra Modi's** official visit to **New Zealand**.
The **Strategic Partnership Roadmap 2030** aims to strengthen cooperation in **defence**, **security**, **trade and investment**, **maritime cooperation**, **agriculture**, **tourism**, **sports**, **culture**, **education**, **scientific research**, and **global affairs**.
The two countries signed key agreements on **maritime cooperation**, **hydrography and nautical cartography**, **mutual logistics support between the Indian Navy and the New Zealand Defence Force**, **counter-terrorism**, **disaster management**, **animal husbandry and dairying**, **tourism**, **sports**, **maritime heritage**, and **cultural cooperation**.
India and New Zealand also agreed to **double bilateral trade to New Zealand Dollar (NZD) 7 billion (approximately ₹35,000 crore) by 2030** and establish a **Maritime Security Dialogue** to strengthen cooperation in the **Indo-Pacific region**.
New Zealand announced its decision to join the **Global Biofuels Alliance** and nominated **Maritime Security** as its priority pillar under the **Indo-Pacific Oceans Initiative (IPOI)**.

270. Recently, India and Australia announced 18 agreements and initiatives during which edition of the India–Australia Annual Summit?
A.First India–Australia Annual Summit
B.Second India–Australia Annual Summit
C.Third India–Australia Annual Summit
D.Fourth India–Australia Annual Summit
E.Fifth India–Australia Annual Summit
Answer: C
Short Explanation:

Prime Minister Narendra Modi and **Australian Prime Minister Anthony Albanese** announced **18 agreements and initiatives** during the **Third India–Australia Annual Summit**, marking a major expansion of the **India–Australia Comprehensive Strategic Partnership**.

The agreements strengthen cooperation in **defence**, **maritime security**, **clean energy**, **civil nuclear energy**, **cybersecurity**, **critical technologies**, **education**, **skill development**, **research**, **mining**, and **cultural cooperation**, while reaffirming the shared vision of a free, open, inclusive, and rules-based Indo-Pacific.

Detailed Explanation:

Prime Minister Narendra Modi and **Australian Prime Minister Anthony Albanese** announced **18 agreements and initiatives** during the **Third India–Australia Annual Summit**, marking a major expansion of the **India–Australia Comprehensive Strategic Partnership**.

The agreements strengthen cooperation in **defence**, **maritime security**, **clean energy**, **civil nuclear energy**, **cybersecurity**, **critical technologies**, **education**, **skill development**, **research**, **mining**, and **cultural cooperation**, while reaffirming the shared vision of a free, open, inclusive, and rules-based Indo-Pacific.

The major outcomes include the **Joint Declaration on Defence and Security Cooperation (JDDSC)**, **Maritime Security Cooperation Roadmap (MSCR)**, **India–Australia Joint Declaration on Energy Security**, and the **finalisation of the Administrative Arrangement under the India–Australia Civil Nuclear Cooperation Agreement**.

Both countries launched the **Australia–India Partnership for Cyber, Critical Technologies and Supply Chains (PACTS)** and signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** under the **Australia–Canada–India Technology and Innovation Partnership (ACITI)** to strengthen cooperation in **cybersecurity**, **Artificial Intelligence (AI)**, **critical technologies**, **innovation**, and **resilient supply chains**.

271. As per the news, the Reserve Bank of India's (RBI) swap facility scheme received an encouraging response primarily from which of the following groups?

A.Foreign Institutional Investors (FIIs)

B.Non-Resident Indians (NRIs)

C.Domestic Mutual Funds

D.State Governments

E.Small Finance Banks

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Union Finance Minister Smt. Nirmala Sitharaman reviewed the progress of **RBI's Swap Facility Schemes** for **FCNR(B)**

Deposits, **External Commercial Borrowings (ECBs)**, and **Overseas Foreign Currency Borrowings (OFCBs)** with MDs & CEOs of **Public Sector Banks (PSBs)** and **Public Financial Institutions (PFIs)** in **New Delhi**.
Significant participation has been reported from **NRIs residing in Singapore, Hong Kong, West Asia, the United Kingdom (UK), the United States (US)** and other overseas locations.

Detailed Explanation:

Union Finance Minister Smt. Nirmala Sitharaman reviewed the progress of **RBI's Swap Facility Schemes** for **FCNR(B) Deposits**, **External Commercial Borrowings (ECBs)**, and **Overseas Foreign Currency Borrowings (OFCBs)** with MDs & CEOs of **Public Sector Banks (PSBs)** and **Public Financial Institutions (PFIs)** in **New Delhi**.
The meeting was attended by Secretaries of the **Department of Financial Services (DFS)**, **Department of Economic Affairs (DEA)**, **Department of Revenue (DoR)**, **Chief Economic Advisor (CEA)**, **RBI Deputy Governor**, and other senior officials.
Public Sector Banks (PSBs) and PFIs informed that the RBI swap facility schemes have received an **encouraging response from the Indian diaspora (NRIs)** across the world.
Banks are offering **attractive returns on FCNR(B) deposits**, including **5-year FCNR(B) deposits**, after the **RBI suspended the interest rate ceiling** on fresh FCNR(B) deposits under the scheme.
Significant participation has been reported from **NRIs residing in Singapore, Hong Kong, West Asia, the United Kingdom (UK), the United States (US)** and other overseas locations.
Banks expect **stronger mobilisation of External Commercial Borrowings (ECBs)** during the **3rd Quarter (October–December 2026)** of the current Financial Year (FY).

272. As per the news, the Central Bureau of Narcotics (CBN) dismantled a sophisticated Mephedrone (MD) manufacturing laboratory under which operation?

A.Operation Vajra
B.Operation Trident
C.Operation Rakshak
D.Operation Shakti
E.Operation Garuda

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

The **Central Bureau of Narcotics (CBN), Madhya Pradesh Unit**, dismantled a sophisticated **Mephedrone (MD) manufacturing laboratory** in **Pune, Maharashtra**, under **Operation Vajra**.
The operation led to the **arrest of two chief conspirators** of an interstate synthetic drug trafficking syndicate from **Ujjain (Madhya Pradesh)** and **Jodhpur (Rajasthan)**.
Operation Vajra was conducted by the **Preventive Branch, Office of the Deputy Narcotics Commissioner, CBN, Neemuch**,

based on specific intelligence, between **1–10 July 2026**.

Detailed Explanation:

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The operation led to the **arrest of two chief conspirators** of an interstate synthetic drug trafficking syndicate from **Ujjain (Madhya Pradesh)** and **Jodhpur (Rajasthan)**.

Operation Vajra was conducted by the **Preventive Branch, Office of the Deputy Narcotics Commissioner, CBN, Neemuch**, based on specific intelligence, between **1–10 July 2026**.

During the operation, CBN seized a **high-tech illicit MD laboratory**, sophisticated machinery, laboratory equipment, **precursor chemicals**, and safety gear used for manufacturing synthetic drugs.

The accused were arrested under the **Narcotic Drugs and Psychotropic Substances (NDPS) Act, 1985**.

The investigation originated in **February 2026**, when CBN Neemuch intercepted a passenger bus at **Mandsaur (Madhya Pradesh)** and seized **8.17 kg of Mephedrone (MD)**.

Follow-up searches uncovered an illegal drug laboratory at **Thavlay, Mhow**, leading to the seizure of **43.82 kg Mephedrone**, **261.32 kg precursor chemicals**, and advanced manufacturing equipment.

273. As per the news, consider the following statements regarding the World Bank Country Income Classification (FY2027):

1. **India continues to be classified as a Lower-Middle-Income Economy.**
2. **India's Gross National Income (GNI) per capita under the Atlas Method was USD 2,760 in 2025.**
3. **Delhi ranks first among Indian states with a GNI per capita of USD 6,217 and has crossed the World Bank's Upper-Middle-Income threshold.**

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

A.Only 1

B.Only 2

C.Only 3

D.All the above

E.None of the above

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

According to the **World Bank Country Income Classification (FY2027)**, **India** continues to be classified as a **Lower-Middle-Income Economy**.

India's **Gross National Income (GNI) per capita** under the **Atlas Method** was **USD 2,760 (2025)**, and the country has remained in the Lower-Middle-Income category since **2009**.

Delhi ranks first among Indian states with a GNI per capita of **USD 6,217**, followed by **Karnataka (USD 5,579)**, **Telangana (USD 5,407)**, **Tamil Nadu (USD 5,329)**, and **Gujarat (USD 4,734)**.

Maharashtra (USD 4,628), **Haryana (USD 4,627)**, and **Kerala (USD 4,610)** narrowly missed the Upper-Middle-Income threshold by **USD 8**, **USD 9**, and **USD 26**, respectively.

Detailed Explanation:

According to the **World Bank Country Income Classification (FY2027)**, **India** continues to be classified as a **Lower-Middle-Income Economy**.

India's **Gross National Income (GNI) per capita** under the **Atlas Method** was **USD 2,760 (2025)**, and the country has remained in the Lower-Middle-Income category since **2009**.

The **World Bank** classifies economies annually on **1 July** based on the previous year's **Gross National Income (GNI) per capita** calculated using the **Atlas Method**.

Under the **FY2027 World Bank Income Classification**, **Low Income** economies have GNI per capita of **USD 1,175 or less**, **Lower-Middle Income** economies have **USD 1,176–4,635**, **Upper-Middle Income** economies have **USD 4,636–14,375**, and **High Income** economies have **above USD 14,375**.

Five Indian states have crossed the World Bank's **Upper-Middle-Income threshold** (GNI per capita above USD 4,636).

Delhi ranks first among Indian states with a GNI per capita of **USD 6,217**, followed by **Karnataka (USD 5,579)**, **Telangana (USD 5,407)**, **Tamil Nadu (USD 5,329)**, and **Gujarat (USD 4,734)**.

Maharashtra (USD 4,628), **Haryana (USD 4,627)**, and **Kerala (USD 4,610)** narrowly missed the Upper-Middle-Income threshold by **USD 8**, **USD 9**, and **USD 26**, respectively.

274. As per the news, the Indian Council of Medical Research (ICMR) Centre for High Altitude Medicine and Public Health Research will be established at which location?

A.Leh, Ladakh

B.Keylong, Himachal Pradesh

C.Gangtok, Sikkim

D.Dehradun, Uttarakhand

E.Tawang, Arunachal Pradesh

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Union Health Minister Jagat Prakash Nadda will lay the foundation stone of the **Indian Council of Medical Research (ICMR) Centre for High Altitude Medicine and Public Health Research** at **Keylong, Himachal Pradesh**.

The centre aims to strengthen **climate-resilient healthcare and biomedical research** across India's **Himalayan region** by developing scientific solutions for high-altitude and climate-sensitive areas.

The existing **ICMR field station at Keylong** will be upgraded into a **full-fledged multidisciplinary research hub** for research, innovation, and capacity building in high-altitude healthcare.

Detailed Explanation:

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The existing **ICMR field station at Keylong** will be upgraded into a **full-fledged multidisciplinary research hub** for research, innovation, and capacity building in high-altitude healthcare.

The centre will focus on research areas such as **high-altitude physiology and acclimatisation, maternal and child health, disaster medicine, tribal health, and public health challenges in Himalayan regions**.

It will generate **region-specific scientific evidence** and develop scalable healthcare solutions to improve medical services in remote and difficult terrains.

The centre will integrate advanced healthcare technologies including **digital health platforms, telemedicine, drone-enabled healthcare logistics, and real-time public health surveillance systems**.

275. As per the news, Ahmedabad Municipal Corporation (AMC) created a Guinness World Record by planting how many saplings in a single hour through the largest Miyawaki plantation drive?

A.2,61,000 saplings

B.6,61,000 saplings

C.4,61,000 saplings

D.5,61,000 saplings

E.3,61,000 saplings

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

Ahmedabad Municipal Corporation (AMC) created a new **Guinness World Record** by planting **3,61,000 saplings in a single hour** through the **largest Miyawaki plantation drive in one hour**.

The record-breaking plantation campaign was organised on **12 July 2026** at **Bhadaj near Gota-Godhavi Canal, Ahmedabad, Gujarat**, under the guidance of **Union Home Minister Amit Shah**.

Detailed Explanation:

Ahmedabad Municipal Corporation (AMC) created a new **Guinness World Record** by planting **3,61,000 saplings in a single hour** through the **largest Miyawaki plantation drive in one hour**.

The record-breaking plantation campaign was organised on **12 July 2026** at **Bhadaj near Gota-Godhavi Canal, Ahmedabad, Gujarat**, under the guidance of **Union Home Minister Amit Shah**.

The initiative involved participation from more than **25,000 volunteers**, including **students, National Cadet Corps (NCC) cadets, government officials, law enforcement personnel, organisations, and local residents**.

The plantation drive was conducted as part of Ahmedabad's efforts to **increase green cover, promote ecological restoration, and combat climate change**.

Key Highlights of the Record:

Saplings planted: 3,61,000

Time taken: 1 hour

Date: 12 July 2026

Location: Bhadaj, Ahmedabad, Gujarat

Organiser: Ahmedabad Municipal Corporation (AMC)

Technique used: Miyawaki afforestation method

Volunteers involved: More than 25,000

The plantation was carried out at the **Gota-Godhavi Canal area in Thaltej Ward** of Ahmedabad.

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276. As per the news, which state government has announced that August 16 will be observed as 'Ayushman Diwas' to promote awareness about Ayushman Bharat Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya Yojana (AB-PMJAY)?

A.Odisha Government

B.West Bengal Government

C.Bihar Government

D.Assam Government

E.Jharkhand Government

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The **West Bengal Government** has announced that **August 16** will be observed as **'Ayushman Diwas'** instead of **'Khela Hobe Diwas'**, shifting the focus towards healthcare awareness and promotion of the **Ayushman Bharat Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya Yojana (AB-PMJAY)**.

The announcement was made by **West Bengal Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari** and coincides with the completion of the **first 100 days of the BJP-led government** in the state.

Detailed Explanation:

The **West Bengal Government** has announced that **August 16** will be observed as **'Ayushman Diwas'** instead of **'Khela Hobe Diwas'**, shifting the focus towards healthcare awareness and promotion of the **Ayushman Bharat Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya Yojana (AB-PMJAY)**.

The announcement was made by **West Bengal Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari** and coincides with the completion of the **first 100 days of the BJP-led government** in the state.

Ayushman Diwas aims to spread awareness among citizens about the benefits, eligibility criteria, and utilisation of cashless healthcare services under the **Ayushman Bharat scheme**.

The day will be marked through **awareness campaigns, outreach programmes, and public events** across West Bengal to encourage eligible families to access affordable healthcare facilities.

The decision represents a shift in the state government's public welfare focus from **sports promotion** under **Khela Hobe Diwas** to **healthcare accessibility and financial protection**.

277. As per the news, India is set to observe which NAMASTE Day, marking three years since the launch of the National Action for Mechanized Sanitation Ecosystem (NAMASTE) Scheme?

A.1st NAMASTE Day

B.2nd NAMASTE Day

C.3rd NAMASTE Day

D.4th NAMASTE Day

E.5th NAMASTE Day

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

India is set to observe the **3rd NAMASTE Day**, marking **three years since the launch of the National Action for Mechanized Sanitation Ecosystem (NAMASTE) Scheme**.

The nationwide celebrations are being led by the **Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment**, with the main event scheduled at **Rabindra Sadan, Kolkata, West Bengal**.

Detailed Explanation:

India is set to observe the **3rd NAMASTE Day**, marking **three years since the launch of the National Action for Mechanized Sanitation Ecosystem (NAMASTE) Scheme**.

The nationwide celebrations are being led by the **Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment**, with the main event scheduled at **Rabindra Sadan, Kolkata, West Bengal**.

The observance aims to recognise the **valuable contribution of sanitation workers** and highlight their role in maintaining public health and cleanliness.

National Action for Mechanized Sanitation Ecosystem (NAMASTE) Scheme focuses on transforming sanitation work by promoting **mechanised cleaning of sewer and septic tanks** and eliminating hazardous manual cleaning practices.

The scheme aims to ensure the **safety, dignity, and livelihood security of sanitation workers** by providing:

Safety training and protective equipment

Skill development opportunities

Health support

Access to welfare benefits

The initiative strengthens the government's efforts towards achieving **zero fatalities during sanitation work** and creating a safer sanitation ecosystem in India.

278. As per the news, the Centre of Excellence (CoE) on Human-Wildlife Conflict was inaugurated at which institute?

A.Sálim Ali Centre for Ornithology and Natural History (SACON), Coimbatore

B.Wildlife Institute of India (WII), Dehradun

C.Indian Institute of Forest Management, Bhopal

D.National Centre for Sustainable Coastal Management, Chennai

E.Forest Research Institute, Dehradun

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

Union Minister for Environment, Forest and Climate Change Bhupender Yadav inaugurated the **Centre of Excellence (CoE) on Human-Wildlife Conflict** at

the **Wildlife Institute of India–Sálim Ali Centre for Ornithology and Natural History (WII-SACON), Coimbatore, Tamil Nadu**.

Along with the Centre of Excellence, the **National Human-Wildlife Conflict Portal** was also launched to strengthen data management, knowledge sharing, and decision-making for reducing human-wildlife conflicts across India.

The inauguration was followed by the **National Workshop on Human-Wildlife Conflict**, which brought together policymakers, forest officials, scientists, researchers, technology experts, and conservation practitioners from across the country.

Detailed Explanation:

Union Minister for Environment, Forest and Climate Change Bhupender Yadav inaugurated the **Centre of Excellence (CoE) on Human-Wildlife Conflict** at the **Wildlife Institute of India–Sálim Ali Centre for Ornithology and Natural History (WII-SACON), Coimbatore, Tamil Nadu**.

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The inauguration was followed by the **National Workshop on Human-Wildlife Conflict**, which brought together policymakers, forest officials, scientists, researchers, technology experts, and conservation practitioners from across the country.

The **Centre of Excellence (CoE)** was announced earlier by **Prime Minister Narendra Modi** during the **7th meeting of the National Board for Wildlife**.

The Centre will function as a **national hub** for:

Research and innovation

Policy support

Capacity building

Development and dissemination of best practices

Scientific and evidence-based management of human-wildlife conflict

Bhupender Yadav highlighted that human-wildlife conflict has become a major conservation and development challenge due to **habitat fragmentation, changing land-use patterns, and increasing human activities**.

279. As per the news, Kamarajar Port Limited (KPL) has become the second major port in India to achieve an operational draft of how many metres?

A.15 metres

B.16 metres

C.17 metres

D.18 metres

E.20 metres

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

Kamarajar Port Limited (KPL) in **Tamil Nadu** has become the **second major port in**

India to achieve an **operational draft of 18 metres**, after **Visakhapatnam Port**.

The achievement was announced by the **Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways** after the successful completion of the **Capital Dredging Phase VI Project** at Kamarajar Port.

With the enhanced draft capacity, the port can now accommodate fully laden **Capesize vessels** carrying cargo parcels of up to **1,70,000 Deadweight Tonnage (DWT)**, making it a deep-draft and **"Cape Compliant" port**.

Detailed Explanation:

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With the enhanced draft capacity, the port can now accommodate fully laden **Capesize vessels** carrying cargo parcels of up to **1,70,000 Deadweight Tonnage (DWT)**, making it a deep-draft and **"Cape Compliant" port**.

The dredging project was completed with an investment of around **₹440 crore** and involved deepening of major navigational areas:

Outer approach channel: Increased from **20 metres to 23 metres**

Inner entrance channel: Increased from **19 metres to 22 metres**

Alongside berths and harbour basin: Upgraded to support **18 metre draft vessels**

The project was undertaken in alignment with the objectives of **Maritime India Vision 2030** and **Maritime Amrit Kaal Vision 2047**.

280. As per the news, the upgraded CITES 2.01 platform was launched for which organisation?

A.Employees' Provident Fund Organisation (EPFO)

B.Employees' State Insurance Corporation (ESIC)

C.Pension Fund Regulatory and Development Authority (PFRDA)

D.National Pension System (NPS) Trust

E.Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (IRDAI)

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

The **Government of India** launched the upgraded **Centralised IT Enabled Services (CITES 2.01)** platform for the **Employees' Provident Fund Organisation (EPFO)**, migrating around **34 crore member accounts** from more than **120 decentralised databases** into a single **unified national system**.

The platform was launched by **Union Minister for Labour and Employment Mansukh Mandaviya** and aims to modernise EPFO services, improve efficiency, enable faster claim

settlements, and provide seamless services to members across India.

The upgraded system will enable the crediting of **Provident Fund interest for 2025–26 by 15 July 2026**, much earlier than the usual **October–November timeline**.

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The upgraded system will enable the crediting of **Provident Fund interest for 2025–26 by 15 July 2026**, much earlier than the usual **October–November timeline**.

Interest at **8.25% for 2025–26**, amounting to an estimated **₹1.44 lakh crore**, will be automatically processed for around **34 crore EPFO members** and verified by field authorities before being credited to members' accounts.

The **CITES 2.01 project** was approved by the **Central Board of Trustees (CBT), EPFO** in **2021**, implementation started in **January 2023**, and nationwide migration was completed in **2026**.

Under the new centralised framework, EPFO members can now submit and process service requests through **any authorised EPFO office** instead of being restricted to their respective regional offices.

281. As per the news, Navi Mumbai International Airport has been notified as an authorised port of entry for the import of drugs under which rules?

A.Drugs Rules, 1945

B.Pharmacy Rules, 1948

C.Medical Devices Rules, 2017

D.New Drugs and Clinical Trials Rules, 2019

E.Drugs and Cosmetics Rules, 1940

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

The **Ministry of Health and Family Welfare (MoHFW)** notified **Navi Mumbai International Airport, Maharashtra** as an **authorised port of entry for the import of drugs** under the **Drugs Rules, 1945**.

The notification was issued through an amendment to **Rule 43A of the Drugs Rules, 1945** after consultation with the **Drugs Technical Advisory Board (DTAB)** under the provisions of the **Drugs and Cosmetics Act, 1940**.

With the inclusion of **Navi Mumbai International Airport**, the total number of notified ports of entry for the import of drugs

through **air, sea, road, and rail routes** has increased to **42**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Ministry of Health and Family Welfare (MoHFW)** notified **Navi Mumbai International Airport, Maharashtra** as an **authorised port of entry for the import of drugs** under the **Drugs Rules, 1945**.

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With the inclusion of **Navi Mumbai International Airport**, the total number of notified ports of entry for the import of drugs through **air, sea, road, and rail routes** has increased to **42**.

The move aims to facilitate smoother movement of **pharmaceutical consignments**, strengthen **logistics infrastructure**, provide importers with an additional gateway for medicines, and promote **Ease of Doing Business** while ensuring effective regulatory oversight.

The amendment is part of the government's efforts to strengthen the **drug regulatory framework** and improve trade facilitation for the pharmaceutical sector.

Navi Mumbai International Airport was inaugurated in **October 2025** and is among India's largest **greenfield airport projects**, developed under the **Public-Private Partnership (PPP)** model.

282. As per the World Intangible Investment Report 2026, which country recorded the fastest growth in intangible investments among the world's 15 largest economies?

A.Japan

B.United States of America (USA)

C.China

D.Philippines

E.India

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

The **World Intellectual Property Organization (WIPO)** and **Luiss Business School (LBS)** jointly released the **3rd edition of the World Intangible Investment Report 2026**.

The **World Intangible Investment Report 2026** highlights **India** as the **fastest-growing major economy in intangible investments** among the world's 15 largest economies.

India's intangible investment reached **USD 78.2 billion in 2023**, registering an **annual growth of 7.9%**.

India recorded the **highest intangible investment growth of 7.9%**, surpassing **Japan (4.8%)**, the **Philippines (4.6%)**, and the **United States of America (USA) (4.4%)**.

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India recorded the **highest intangible investment growth of 7.9%**, surpassing **Japan (4.8%)**, the **Philippines (4.6%)**, and the **United States of America (USA) (4.4%)**.

India's intangible investment growth (7.9%) was **higher than its tangible investment growth**, reflecting a shift towards a **knowledge-based economy**.

India's intangible investments are driven by **software, Research and Development (R&D), intellectual property, innovation, brands, design, databases, and organisational capital**.

283. As per the news, the Passage Exercise (PASSEX) was conducted between INS Surat and which country's maritime force?

A.United States Navy

B.Japan Maritime Self-Defence Force (JMSDF)

C.Royal Australian Navy

D.French Navy

E.Royal Navy of the United Kingdom

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The **Japan Maritime Self-Defence Force (JMSDF)** warship **JS Takanami (DD-110)** conducted a **Passage Exercise (PASSEX)** with the Indian Navy warship **INS Surat** off the coast of **Mumbai, Maharashtra**.

The PASSEX focused on **validating communication procedures, tactical manoeuvres**, and **enhancing interoperability** between the Indian Navy and the Japan Maritime Self-Defence Force (JMSDF).

The exercise reflects the strengthening **India–Japan Strategic Partnership** and their shared commitment to a **Free, Open, Secure, and Rules-Based Indo-Pacific Region**.

INS Surat is a state-of-the-art **stealth guided missile destroyer** of the Indian Navy.

Detailed Explanation:

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INS Surat is a state-of-the-art **stealth guided missile destroyer** of the Indian Navy.
INS Surat is the **fourth and final vessel** of the **Visakhapatnam-class (Project 15B Guided Missile Destroyer Project)**.
The warship was designed by the Indian Navy's **Warship Design Bureau** and built by **Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders Limited (MDL), Mumbai**.
INS Surat has approximately **75% indigenous content**, supporting India's **Aatmanirbhar Bharat** initiative in defence manufacturing.
INS Surat was **commissioned into the Indian Navy in 2025**.
With a displacement of **7,400 tonnes** and a length of **164 metres**, INS Surat is among the **largest destroyers in the world**.

284. As per the news, Mission Drishti, the world's first OptoSAR (Optical + Synthetic Aperture Radar) Earth observation satellite, was developed by which space startup?

A.Skyroot Aerospace
B.Pixxel
C.GalaxEye
D.Agnikul Cosmos
E.Dhruva Space

Answer: C

Short Explanation:
Bengaluru-based space startup GalaxEye lost communication with **Mission Drishti**, the world's first **OptoSAR (Optical + Synthetic Aperture Radar)** Earth observation satellite, after an onboard anomaly.
Mission Drishti was launched on **3 May 2026** aboard **SpaceX's Falcon 9 rocket**, marking a major milestone for India's private space sector.
Drishti was the **world's first satellite to integrate Electro-Optical (EO) and Synthetic Aperture Radar (SAR)** sensors on a single platform.

Detailed Explanation:
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Mission Drishti was launched on **3 May 2026** aboard **SpaceX's Falcon 9 rocket**, marking a major milestone for India's private space sector.
Drishti was the **world's first satellite to integrate Electro-Optical (EO) and Synthetic Aperture Radar (SAR)** sensors on a single platform.
The combination of **EO and SAR technology** enabled **all-weather, day-and-night, and continuous Earth observation**, overcoming limitations of conventional optical satellites.
Mission Drishti was **India's largest privately developed Earth observation satellite**, weighing **190 kg**.
The satellite was capable of capturing **high-precision Earth imagery** with a spatial resolution of **1.5 metres**, optimized for spatial, spectral, and temporal observations.

The mission was designed to provide **advanced geospatial intelligence** for governments, defence agencies, and commercial users.

285. As per the news, Indonesia became the first foreign country to import which indigenously developed missile system from India?

A.Akash Missile System

B.Astra Mk 1 Beyond Visual Range Air-to-Air Missile (BVRAAM)

C.BrahMos Supersonic Cruise Missile

D.Pinaka Rocket System

E.Nag Anti-Tank Guided Missile

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

India and Indonesia signed a **landmark defence agreement** for the export of the **Astra Mk 1 Beyond Visual Range Air-to-Air Missile (BVRAAM)**, making **Indonesia** the **first foreign country** to import India's indigenously developed Astra missile system.

The agreements were announced during **Prime Minister Narendra Modi's visit to Indonesia**, strengthening bilateral defence cooperation under India's **Act East Policy**.

The defence package also includes the export of **BrahMos supersonic cruise missiles** and cooperation in defence technology, maritime security, and critical minerals.

Detailed Explanation:

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The agreements were announced during **Prime Minister Narendra Modi's visit to Indonesia**, strengthening bilateral defence cooperation under India's **Act East Policy**.

The defence package also includes the export of **BrahMos supersonic cruise missiles** and cooperation in defence technology, maritime security, and critical minerals.

The **BrahMos Missile Defence System contract** was signed between **BrahMos Aerospace** and the **Ministry of Defence of Indonesia**.

The **Astra Mk 1 export agreement** was signed between **Bharat Dynamics Limited (BDL)** and **Republikorp**.

The agreements mark a **major milestone** for India's defence export ambitions and highlight India's emergence as a **trusted defence partner** in Southeast Asia.

Astra is an indigenous **Beyond Visual Range Air-to-Air Missile (BVRAAM)** family developed by the **Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO)**.

The **Astra Mk 1** has an **operational range of 80–110 km** and can engage aerial targets at an altitude of up to **20 km**.

Astra Mk 1 travels at a **maximum speed of Mach 4.5**, making it one of India's advanced air-to-air missiles.

The missile uses **Inertial Guidance, Mid-Course Updates, and Terminal Active Radar**

Homing to achieve high-precision target engagement.

Astra Mk 1 is currently integrated with the Indian Air Force's **Su-30 MKI fighter aircraft** and is planned for future integration with the **Tejas Mk 1A and Rafale** fighter aircraft.

Indonesia will integrate the Astra Mk 1 missile with its **Sukhoi Su-27 and Su-30 fighter aircraft**, significantly enhancing its air combat capability.

The **BrahMos missile deal** will strengthen Indonesia's **maritime strike capability** across its vast archipelagic territory.

The Philippines became the **first international customer** for the BrahMos missile system under a **USD 375 million contract signed in 2022**, with deliveries beginning in **2024**.

Astra Mk 3, officially named **Gandiva**, is currently under development by **DRDO**.

Astra Mk 3 (Gandiva) is expected to have a **range exceeding 350 km**, making it India's **longest-range indigenous air-to-air missile**.

286. As per the news, the advanced ammonia sensing platform was developed by researchers from which institute?

A.Indian Institute of Science (IISc), Bengaluru

B.Centre for Nano and Soft Matter Sciences (CeNS), Bengaluru

C.Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) Madras

D.National Chemical Laboratory (NCL), Pune

E.Tata Institute of Fundamental Research (TIFR), Mumbai

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Scientists have developed an **advanced ammonia sensing platform** capable of detecting ammonia gas at extremely low concentrations while operating efficiently at **room temperature**.

The technology was developed by researchers at the **Centre for Nano and Soft Matter Sciences (CeNS), Bengaluru**, an autonomous institute under the **Department of Science and Technology (DST)**.

The sensor is based on a hybrid **Vanadium Oxide–Vanadium Sulfide (VOx/VS2) heterostructure**, engineered through a controlled surface transformation process.

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The sensor is based on a hybrid **Vanadium Oxide–Vanadium Sulfide (VOx/VS2) heterostructure**, engineered through a controlled surface transformation process.

The VOx/VS2 heterostructure creates **abundant active sites** for ammonia adsorption and **enhances charge transport**, resulting in

rapid, highly selective, and highly sensitive ammonia detection.

The sensor can detect ammonia concentrations as low as **319 parts per billion (ppb)**, which is well below occupational safety limits.

287. As per the news, what is the total investment planned for the Atal Incubation Centre–Chitkara Incubation Foundation (AIC-CIF) and AIC-PRIDE Labs over a period of five years?

A.₹10 crore

B.₹15 crore

C.₹20 crore

D.₹25 crore

E.₹30 crore

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

Chitkara University, Punjab launched the **Atal Incubation Centre–Chitkara Incubation Foundation (AIC-CIF)** and **AIC-PRIDE Labs** to strengthen India's **deep-tech startup ecosystem**.

The initiative involves a combined investment of **₹20 crore over a period of five years**.

The incubation ecosystem will support startups working in **Drone Technologies, Agritech, and Renewable Energy**.

The primary objective of **AIC-CIF** is to promote **research commercialisation, entrepreneurship, and technology-led economic growth** by nurturing deep-tech startups.

Detailed Explanation:

Chitkara University, Punjab launched the **Atal Incubation Centre–Chitkara Incubation Foundation (AIC-CIF)** and **AIC-PRIDE Labs** to strengthen India's **deep-tech startup ecosystem**.

The initiative involves a combined investment of **₹20 crore over a period of five years**.

The incubation ecosystem will support startups working in **Drone Technologies, Agritech, and Renewable Energy**.

The primary objective of **AIC-CIF** is to promote **research commercialisation, entrepreneurship, and technology-led economic growth** by nurturing deep-tech startups.

AIC-CIF was launched in collaboration with the **Atal Innovation Mission (AIM)** under **NITI Aayog** (National Institution for Transforming India), Government of India (GoI), and Chitkara University.

The inauguration was attended by **Amit Dhaka (IAS)**, CEO, Invest Punjab, **Prateek Deshmukh**, **Deepakshi Jindal** from Atal Innovation Mission (AIM), NITI Aayog, and **Dr. Ashok Chitkara** and **Dr. Madhu Chitkara** of Chitkara University.

The event also marked the launch of **ATL Sarthi Punjab**, an initiative of the **Atal Innovation Mission (AIM)**.

288. As per the news, Jannik Sinner defeated which player in the Men's Singles final to win the Wimbledon 2026 title?

A.Carlos Alcaraz

B.Novak Djokovic

C.Daniil Medvedev

D.Alexander Zverev

E.Holger Rune

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

World No. 1 Jannik Sinner (Italy) won the **men's singles title at Wimbledon 2026** for the **second consecutive year**, defeating **Alexander Zverev (Germany)** in a four-set final.

In the men's singles final, **Jannik Sinner defeated Alexander Zverev** with a score of **6-7 (7-9), 7-6 (7-2), 6-3, 6-4** in a match lasting **3 hours and 46 minutes**.

With this victory, Sinner successfully **defended his Wimbledon title** and registered his **10th consecutive victory over Alexander Zverev**.

Linda Noskova (Czechia) won her **maiden Grand Slam singles title** by defeating fellow Czech player **Karolina Muchova** in the **women's singles final**.

Detailed Explanation:

World No. 1 Jannik Sinner (Italy) won the **men's singles title at Wimbledon 2026** for the **second consecutive year**, defeating **Alexander Zverev (Germany)** in a four-set final.

In the men's singles final, **Jannik Sinner defeated Alexander Zverev** with a score of **6-7 (7-9), 7-6 (7-2), 6-3, 6-4** in a match lasting **3 hours and 46 minutes**.

With this victory, Sinner successfully **defended his Wimbledon title** and registered his **10th consecutive victory over Alexander Zverev**.

Linda Noskova (Czechia) won her **maiden Grand Slam singles title** by defeating fellow Czech player **Karolina Muchova** in the **women's singles final**.

In an all-Czech women's single final, **9th seed Linda Noskova defeated 10th seed Karolina Muchova** with a score of **6-2, 5-7, 6-3**.

Noskova became the **ninth consecutive first-time women's singles champion at Wimbledon** after securing her first Grand Slam title.

In **men's doubles**, **Harri Heliovaara (Finland)** and **Henry Patten (Great Britain)** won the title by defeating **Marcelo Arévalo (El Salvador)** and **Mate Pavić (Croatia)** in straight sets.

289. As per the news, S. Aswath became India's which numbered Chess Grandmaster (GM) after securing his third and final GM norm?

A.98th Chess Grandmaster

B.97th Chess Grandmaster

C.96th Chess Grandmaster

D.99th Chess Grandmaster

E.100th Chess Grandmaster

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

17-year-old S. Aswath from **Nagercoil, Tamil Nadu** became **India's 98th Chess Grandmaster (GM)** after securing his **third and final GM norm** at the **2026 Pune International Grandmaster Round Robin Tournament**.

Aswath achieved the Grandmaster title requirement after defeating **United States' FIDE Master (FM) Kannan Vaidyanathan** with the **black pieces** in the final round.

Detailed Explanation:

17-year-old S. Aswath from **Nagercoil, Tamil Nadu** became **India's 98th Chess Grandmaster (GM)** after securing his **third and final GM norm** at the **2026 Pune International Grandmaster Round Robin Tournament**.

Aswath achieved the Grandmaster title requirement after defeating **United States' FIDE Master (FM) Kannan Vaidyanathan** with the **black pieces** in the final round.

He finished the tournament with **7 points from 9 rounds**, including **6 wins, 2 draws, and 1 loss**, securing the **runner-up position**.

The **Grandmaster title** is awarded by the **International Chess Federation (FIDE)** to players who achieve:

Three Grandmaster (GM) norms

FIDE rating of 2500 or above

With Aswath's achievement, India's total number of **Chess Grandmasters has increased to 98**, bringing the country closer to achieving its **100th Grandmaster milestone**.

290. As per the news, Leander Paes has been appointed as the Player Ambassador of which organisation?

A.International Tennis Federation (ITF)

B.Asian Tennis Federation (ATF)

C.Association of Tennis Professionals (ATP)

D.All India Tennis Association (AITA)

E.Wimbledon Foundation

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Indian tennis legend Leander Paes has been appointed as the **Player Ambassador of the Asian Tennis Federation (ATF)**.

The announcement was made during a ceremony held on the sidelines of the **Wimbledon Championships in London**, in the presence of **ATF President Yuriy Polskiy**, senior officials, players, and members of the international tennis community.

Detailed Explanation:

Indian tennis legend Leander Paes has been appointed as the **Player Ambassador of the Asian Tennis Federation (ATF)**.

The announcement was made during a ceremony held on the sidelines of the **Wimbledon Championships in London**, in the presence of **ATF President Yuriy Polskiy**, senior officials, players, and members of the international tennis community.

As the **Player Ambassador**, Leander Paes will work with the **Asian Tennis Federation (ATF)** to promote tennis across Asia, mentor emerging players, support grassroots development programmes, and represent the federation at major international events.

Paes is the **only Indian tennis player to have won an Olympic medal**, securing a **bronze medal in Men's Singles at the 1996 Atlanta Olympic Games**.

He represented India at **7 consecutive Olympic Games** and retired in **2021** after a professional career spanning **three decades**.

Leander Paes became the **World No. 1 Doubles Player in 1999** and spent around **462 weeks inside the Association of Tennis Professionals (ATP) Top 10 rankings**.

291. As per the news, Veteran Playback Singer S. Janaki passed away at the age of 88. She made her playback singing debut with which Tamil film in 1957?

A.Vidhiyin Vilayattu
B.Chandralekha
C.Thillana Mohanambal
D.Paava Mannippu
E.Kaviya Thalaivi
Answer: A

Short Explanation:

Legendary playback singer Sistla Sreeramamurthy (S.) Janaki, popularly known as the **"Nightingale of South India"** and **"Nightingale of the South"**, passed away at the age of **88** in **Mysuru, Karnataka** after battling age-related health issues.

S. Janaki was born on **23 April 1938** at **Repalle, Guntur district, Andhra Pradesh (AP)**.

S. Janaki made her **playback singing debut** with the **Tamil film "Vidhiyin Vilayattu"** in **1957**.

Detailed Explanation:

Legendary playback singer Sistla Sreeramamurthy (S.) Janaki, popularly known as the **"Nightingale of South India"** and **"Nightingale of the South"**, passed away at the age of **88** in **Mysuru, Karnataka** after battling age-related health issues.

S. Janaki was born on **23 April 1938** at **Repalle, Guntur district, Andhra Pradesh (AP)**.

S. Janaki made her **playback singing debut** with the **Tamil film "Vidhiyin Vilayattu"** in **1957**.

Her illustrious career spanned **more than six decades (1957–2017)**, making her one of India's **greatest and most versatile** playback singers.

During her career, she recorded **more than 48,000 songs** in **nearly 20 Indian languages**, including **Tamil, Telugu, Malayalam, Kannada, Hindi**, and several other regional languages.

S. Janaki won **4 National Film Awards for Best Female Playback Singer**.

She received her National Film Awards for **"Senthoora Poove" from 16 Vayathinile (Tamil, 1977)**, **"Ettumanoor Ambalathil" from Oppol (Malayalam, 1981)**, **"Vennello Godari Andam" from Sitara (Telugu, 1984)**, and **"Inji Iduppazhagi" from Thevar Magan (Tamil, 1992)**.

She was honoured with **33 State Film Awards**, one of the highest recognitions received by an Indian playback singer.

S. Janaki was selected for the **Padma Bhushan in 2013** for her contribution to Arts, but she **declined the honour**.

292. As per the news, Sheikh Hamad bin Khalifa Al Thani, who passed away recently, was the former Emir of which country?

A.Saudi Arabia
B.Qatar
C.Kuwait
D.Bahrain
E.Oman
Answer: B

Sheikh Hamad bin Khalifa Al Thani, the former Emir of Qatar, passed away at the age of **74**.
Sheikh Hamad bin Khalifa Al Thani was born in **1952** into the **Al Thani royal family**, which has ruled Qatar since 1851.
Before becoming Emir of Qatar, he served as **Commander of the Armed Forces, Defence Minister, and Crown Prince**.
He came to power through a **bloodless coup in 1995** and ruled Qatar from **1995 to 2013**.

293. As per the news, World Youth Skills Day is observed every year on which date?
A.10 July
B.12 July
C.13 July
D.15 July
E.20 July
Answer: D
Short Explanation:
World Youth Skills Day is observed every year on **15 July** to highlight the importance of **skill development among youth** and the need to equip young people with skills required for **employment, entrepreneurship, and self-employment**.
Detailed Explanation:
World Youth Skills Day is observed every year on **15 July** to highlight the importance of **skill development among youth** and the need to equip young people with skills required for **employment, entrepreneurship, and self-employment**.
World Youth Skills Day 2026 focuses on creating awareness about the importance of investing in **Technical and Vocational Education and Training (TVET)** and developing future-ready skills among young people.
The **United Nations General Assembly (UNGA)** declared **15 July as World Youth Skills Day** in **November 2014** through a resolution initiated by **Sri Lanka**.
The first **World Youth Skills Day** was observed on **15 July 2015**.

294. As per the news, who is the President of the United Nations General Assembly (UNGA)?
A.António Guterres
B.Volker Türk
C.Dennis Francis
D.Amina J. Mohammed
E.Annalena Baerbock
Answer: E
About United Nations General Assembly (UNGA)
Established: 1945
Headquarters: New York, United States
President: Annalena Baerbock
Members: 193 Member States

295. As per the news, the World Intellectual Property Organization (WIPO) has how many member states?

A.191 member states

B.192 member states

C.193 member states

D.194 member states

E.195 member states

Answer: D

About World Intellectual Property Organization :

Formation : 14 July 1967

Headquarters : Geneva, Switzerland

Director General **:** Daren Tang

Members : 194 member states

Parent Organization : United Nations Economic and Social Council

296. As per the United Nations Conference on Trade and Development (UNCTAD) World Investment Report 2026, India ranked as the _____ largest recipient of Foreign Direct Investment (FDI) in the world in 2025.

A.9th

B.10th

C.11th

D.12th

E.13th

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

According to the **United Nations Conference on Trade and Development (UNCTAD) World Investment Report 2026**, India became the **11th-largest recipient** of **Foreign Direct Investment (FDI)** in the world in **2025**, improving from **13th position** in **2024**.

FDI inflows into India increased by **44%**, rising from **USD 27.09 billion (2024)** to **USD 38.89 billion (2025)**.

Detailed Explanation:

According to the **United Nations Conference on Trade and Development (UNCTAD) World Investment Report 2026**, India became the **11th-largest recipient** of **Foreign Direct Investment (FDI)** in the world in **2025**, improving from **13th position** in **2024**.

FDI inflows into India increased by **44%**, rising from **USD 27.09 billion (2024)** to **USD 38.89 billion (2025)**.

India's improved ranking was driven by **policy support for advanced manufacturing**, **infrastructure development**, and deeper integration into **Global Value Chains (GVCs)**.

India's strong FDI performance contrasted with **developing economies**, where FDI inflows increased by only **2%**, while **developing Asia** recorded **3% growth**.

Despite higher overall FDI inflows, the value of **announced greenfield investments** in India declined from **USD 111.14 billion (2024)** to **USD 74.12 billion (2025)**.

India attracted the world's **largest announced greenfield investment project** in **2025**, with **Alphabet Inc. (USA)** announcing a **USD 14.5 billion data centre investment**.

297. As per the news, which bank became the first in the world to successfully process a cross-border remittance under SWIFT's new Retail Payments Framework?

A.HSBC

B.Standard Chartered

C.Citibank

D.ICICI Bank

E.State Bank of India

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Standard Chartered became the **first bank in the world** to successfully process a **cross-border remittance** under **SWIFT's new Retail Payments Framework**.

The **first live cross-border transaction** was completed from **Australia to India** in just **37 seconds**, demonstrating **near real-time international payments**.

The transaction was initiated by **Westpac (Australia)** and routed through **Standard Chartered** using the **SWIFT** (Society for Worldwide Interbank Financial Telecommunication) network.

Detailed Explanation:

Standard Chartered became the **first bank in the world** to successfully process a **cross-border remittance** under **SWIFT's new Retail Payments Framework**.

The **first live cross-border transaction** was completed from **Australia to India** in just **37 seconds**, demonstrating **near real-time international payments**.

The transaction was initiated by **Westpac (Australia)** and routed through **Standard Chartered** using the **SWIFT** (Society for Worldwide Interbank Financial Telecommunication) network.

The transaction enabled **near real-time credit** to the beneficiary bank in **India**, showcasing the efficiency of **SWIFT's enhanced payment infrastructure**.

Standard Chartered became the **first bank in India** to process a **cross-border remittance** under **SWIFT's Retail Payments Framework**.

The **SWIFT Retail Payments Framework** is designed to make international remittances as **simple, secure, transparent, and efficient** as **domestic payment systems**.

298. As per the news, which Public Sector Bank (PSB) launched the national-level cybersecurity hackathon "FinSpark'26", offering a prize pool of more than ₹10 lakh?

A.Punjab National Bank

B.Bank of Baroda

C.Canara Bank

D.Bank of Maharashtra (BoM)

E.Indian Bank

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

Bank of Maharashtra (BoM), one of India's leading Public Sector Banks (PSBs), launched **"FinSpark'26"**, a national-level **cybersecurity hackathon**, under the theme **"Securing the Future of Banking"**.

FinSpark'26 aims to encourage **students and dropouts** across India to develop **innovative solutions** for real-world **cybersecurity challenges** in the banking sector.

Detailed Explanation:

Bank of Maharashtra (BoM), one of India's leading Public Sector Banks (PSBs), launched **"FinSpark'26"**, a national-level **cybersecurity hackathon**, under the theme **"Securing the Future of Banking"**.

FinSpark'26 aims to encourage **students and dropouts** across India to develop **innovative solutions** for real-world **cybersecurity challenges** in the banking sector.

The hackathon is being organised by **Bank of Maharashtra (BoM)** in association with the **Indian Banks' Association (IBA)**, **Department of Financial Services (DFS)**, Government of India (GoI), and **COEP Technological University, Pune**.

FinSpark'26 offers a **prize pool of more than ₹10 lakh** to encourage innovation in banking cybersecurity.

The **top 20 teams** will get an opportunity to **present their solutions** at the **Grand Finale** to be held at **COEP Technological University, Pune, Maharashtra**.

The winning teams will also receive an opportunity to **showcase their innovations** at the **Global FinTech Fest 2026**.

299. As per the news, which organisation launched "Gramodyam", a three-year entrepreneurship development programme for rural youth with a target of creating approximately 4,000 rural entrepreneurs?

A.Small Industries Development Bank of India (SIDBI)

B.National Bank for Agriculture and Rural Development (NABARD)

C.National Skill Development Corporation (NSDC)

D.Ministry of Rural Development

E.Khadi and Village Industries Commission (KVIC)

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

National Bank for Agriculture and Rural Development (NABARD) launched **Gramodyam**, an **entrepreneurship development programme for rural youth**, during its **45th Foundation Day celebrations**.

Gramodyam aims to **identify, nurture, mentor, and empower aspiring rural entrepreneurs** by helping them establish **sustainable rural enterprises** and generate **employment opportunities**.

Detailed Explanation:

National Bank for Agriculture and Rural Development (NABARD) launched **Gramodyam**, an **entrepreneurship development programme for rural youth**, during its **45th Foundation Day celebrations**.

Gramodyam aims to **identify, nurture, mentor, and empower aspiring rural entrepreneurs** by helping them establish **sustainable rural**

enterprises and generate **employment opportunities**.

The programme seeks to **convert local ideas into viable businesses**, promoting **sustainable economic growth** in rural India.

Gramodyam is a **three-year pilot programme** with a target of creating approximately **4,000 rural entrepreneurs**.

The programme follows a **digital-first hybrid delivery model**, ensuring implementation across **all States and Union Territories (UTs)** of India.

Gramodyam is a collaborative initiative of **NABARD** and the **National Skill Development Corporation (NSDC)** under the **Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship (MSDE)**.

300. As per the news, India announced the establishment of which of the following under its new humanitarian and developmental assistance package for Palestine?

1. **A Specialty Medical Hospital**
2. **An Artificial Limb Fitting Centre**
3. **An Institute for Vocational Training**

Which of the above is/are correct?

A.Only 1

B.Only 2

C.Only 3

D.All the above

E.None of the above

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

India has reiterated its support for **Palestine's application for full membership of the United Nations (UN)** and reaffirmed its commitment to the establishment of an **independent, sovereign, and peaceful Palestine**.

Under the new assistance programme, India will establish:

A Specialty Medical Hospital

An Artificial Limb Fitting Centre

An Institute for Vocational Training

Detailed Explanation:

India has reiterated its support for **Palestine's application for full membership of the United Nations (UN)** and reaffirmed its commitment to the establishment of an **independent, sovereign, and peaceful Palestine**.

India expressed its support during international meetings held in **Brussels, Belgium and New York, United States of America**, highlighting the importance of the **two-state solution** for achieving lasting peace in **West Asia**.

India maintained that **dialogue and diplomacy** remain the most effective approaches for ensuring peace and stability between **Israel and Palestine**.

Minister of External Affairs Dr. S. Jaishankar announced a new humanitarian and developmental assistance package for Palestine.

Under the new assistance programme, India will establish:

A Specialty Medical Hospital

An Artificial Limb Fitting Centre

An Institute for Vocational Training

301. As per the news, how much monthly financial assistance will be provided to eligible women under the Delhi Lakshmi Yojana?

A.₹1,500 per month

B.₹2,000 per month

C.₹2,500 per month

D.₹3,000 per month

E.₹3,500 per month

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The **Government of the National Capital Territory (NCT) of Delhi** has renamed its flagship women's welfare scheme **Mahila Samriddhi Yojana** as the **Delhi Lakshmi Yojana**.

The scheme is expected to be launched around **Raksha Bandhan 2026** and aims to provide **₹2,500 per month** to eligible women through the **Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT)** mechanism.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Government of the National Capital Territory (NCT) of Delhi** has renamed its flagship women's welfare scheme **Mahila Samriddhi Yojana** as the **Delhi Lakshmi Yojana**.

The scheme is expected to be launched around **Raksha Bandhan 2026** and aims to provide **₹2,500 per month** to eligible women through the **Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT)** mechanism.

The initiative is intended to strengthen the **financial security and economic independence** of women belonging to **economically weaker sections**.

Chief Minister Rekha Gupta announced the renaming as part of the government's preparations for the official rollout of the scheme.

The change in the scheme's name **does not alter its objective**, which remains focused on providing **direct financial assistance** to eligible women.

Under the scheme, the monthly financial assistance will be **credited directly to beneficiaries' bank accounts** through the **Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT)** system, ensuring transparency and reducing leakages.

302. As per the news, the Government of India has officially renamed the Central Vista redevelopment area as what?

A.Bharat Bhawan Area

B.Kartavya Bhawan Area

C.Rashtriya Bhawan Complex

D.Jan Seva Bhawan Area

E.Amrit Bhawan Complex

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The **Government of India** has officially renamed the **Central Vista redevelopment area** as the **Kartavya Bhawan Area** (also referred to as the **Kartavya Bhawan Complex**).

Union Minister of Housing and Urban Affairs, Manohar Lal, announced that the term **"Central**

Vista" should no longer be used in official communications and government documents, and should be replaced with **"Kartavya Bhawan Area"**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Government of India** has officially renamed the **Central Vista redevelopment area** as the **Kartavya Bhawan Area** (also referred to as the **Kartavya Bhawan Complex**). **Union Minister of Housing and Urban Affairs, Manohar Lal**, announced that the term **"Central Vista"** should no longer be used in official communications and government documents, and should be replaced with **"Kartavya Bhawan Area"**.

The announcement was made during the **Foundation Day celebrations of the Central Public Works Department (CPWD)**.

The renaming is aimed at reflecting **India's evolving national identity** and continuing the effort to replace **colonial-era nomenclature** with names rooted in **Indian values and public service**.

The term **"Kartavya"** means **"Duty"**, symbolising the responsibility and commitment of **public institutions and civil servants** towards citizens.

303. As per the news, Unjha Cumin (Jeera) and Unjha Fennel (Saunf), which recently received the Geographical Indication (GI) tag, originate from which state?

A.Rajasthan

B.Haryana

C.Madhya Pradesh

D.Maharashtra

E.Gujarat

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

The **Geographical Indications Registry** has granted the **Geographical Indication (GI) tag** to **Unjha Cumin (Jeera)** and **Unjha Fennel (Saunf)**, recognising them as unique agricultural products originating from **Unjha, Mehsana district, Gujarat**.

The **GI certification** strengthens the global identity of **Gujarat's spice sector**, enhances export opportunities, improves farmers' income, and protects the products from imitation and misuse.

The registration was facilitated through the joint efforts of the **Unjha Agricultural Produce Market Committee (APMC)**, **Department of Horticulture and Farmers' Welfare, Government of Gujarat**, **Sardarkrushinagar Dantiwada Agricultural University (SDAU)**, and the **Entrepreneurship Development Institute of India (EDII)**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Geographical Indications Registry** has granted the **Geographical Indication (GI) tag** to **Unjha Cumin (Jeera)** and **Unjha Fennel (Saunf)**, recognising them as unique agricultural products originating from **Unjha, Mehsana district, Gujarat**.

The **GI certification** strengthens the global identity of **Gujarat's spice sector**, enhances export opportunities, improves farmers' income,

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The registration was facilitated through the joint efforts of the **Unjha Agricultural Produce Market Committee (APMC)**, **Department of Horticulture and Farmers' Welfare, Government of Gujarat**, **Sardarkrushinagar Dantiwada Agricultural University (SDAU)**, and the **Entrepreneurship Development Institute of India (EDII)**.

The **GI tag** ensures that only cumin and fennel produced in the **Unjha region** can be marketed under these names, preserving their authenticity and regional identity.

The recognition is expected to increase **consumer confidence**, strengthen **regional branding**, boost **export competitiveness**, and safeguard the traditional agricultural heritage of **Gujarat**.

304. As per the news, the Directorate General of Foreign Trade (DGFT) has notified the Tariff Rate Quota (TRQ) allocation procedure under which agreement?

A.India–UAE Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement (CEPA)

B.India–Australia Economic Cooperation and Trade Agreement (ECTA)

C.India–Oman Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement (CEPA)

D.India–Singapore Comprehensive Economic Cooperation Agreement (CECA)

E.India–Sri Lanka Free Trade Agreement (ISLFTA)

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The **Directorate General of Foreign Trade (DGFT), Ministry of Commerce and Industry** has notified the **Tariff Rate Quota (TRQ) allocation procedure** under the **India–Oman Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement (CEPA)**.

The **India–Oman Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement (CEPA)** came into force on **1 June 2026** to enhance **bilateral trade, investment, and economic cooperation** between **India** and **Oman**.

Under the agreement, specified goods imported from **Oman** will be eligible for **preferential tariff treatment**, including **reduced or zero customs duty**, within the prescribed quota limits.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Directorate General of Foreign Trade (DGFT), Ministry of Commerce and Industry** has notified the **Tariff Rate Quota (TRQ) allocation procedure** under the **India–Oman Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement (CEPA)**.

The **India–Oman Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement (CEPA)** came into force on **1 June 2026** to enhance **bilateral trade, investment, and economic cooperation** between **India** and **Oman**.

Under the agreement, specified goods imported from **Oman** will be eligible for **preferential tariff treatment**, including **reduced or zero customs duty**, within the prescribed quota limits.

A **Tariff Rate Quota (TRQ)** allows the import of a specified quantity of goods at **lower or nil customs duty**, while imports beyond the quota are subject to the **applicable normal customs duty**.

Products covered under the TRQ mechanism include **dates, marble and travertine blocks, copper weld wire, aluminium ingots, aluminium billets, aluminium wires, ethylene glycol, linear alkylbenzenes, low-density polyethylene (LDPE), and selected petrochemical products**.

305. As per the news, the Central Government has proposed the establishment of Autonomous Hill Development Councils (AHDCs) in every district of which Union Territory?

A.Jammu & Kashmir

B.Ladakh

C.Chandigarh

D.Dadra & Nagar Haveli and Daman & Diu

E.Lakshadweep

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The **Central Government** has proposed the establishment of **Autonomous Hill Development Councils (AHDCs)** in **every district of Ladakh** to strengthen **local self-governance** while preserving the region's unique identity.

At present, **Leh** and **Kargil** have Autonomous Hill Development Councils.

The proposal extends the system to the newly created districts of **Sham, Nubra, Changthang, Zanskar, and Drass**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Central Government** has proposed the establishment of **Autonomous Hill Development Councils (AHDCs)** in **every district of Ladakh** to strengthen **local self-governance** while preserving the region's unique identity.

At present, **Leh** and **Kargil** have Autonomous Hill Development Councils.

The proposal extends the system to the newly created districts of **Sham, Nubra, Changthang, Zanskar, and Drass**.

The proposed councils are expected to function under a **special constitutional framework inspired by Article 371 of the Constitution of India**, ensuring greater local participation in governance while safeguarding the interests of Ladakh.

Article 371 provides **special constitutional provisions** to certain states and regions based on their **historical, cultural, geographical, tribal, administrative, and developmental needs**, while preserving India's federal structure.

States and regions covered under **Article 371 and its sub-clauses** include **Maharashtra, Gujarat, Nagaland, Assam, Manipur, Andhra Pradesh, Telangana, Sikkim, Mizoram, Arunachal Pradesh, Goa, and the Hyderabad-Karnataka region of Karnataka**

306. As per the news, during Prime Minister Narendra Modi's visit, New Zealand announced its decision to join which India-led global initiative?

A.Coalition for Disaster Resilient Infrastructure (CDRI)

B.International Solar Alliance (ISA)

C.One Sun One World One Grid (OSOWOG)

D.International Big Cat Alliance (IBCA)

E.Global Biofuels Alliance (GBA)

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

Prime Minister (PM) Narendra Modi visited **New Zealand** from **10–11 July 2026** as the final leg of his **three-nation tour**, which included **Indonesia**, **Australia**, and **New Zealand**.

The visit was made at the invitation of **Christopher Luxon**, Prime Minister of New Zealand.

PM Narendra Modi arrived in **Auckland**, where he was received by PM Christopher Luxon, marking the **first visit by an Indian Prime Minister to New Zealand in 40 years**.

Detailed Explanation:

Prime Minister (PM) Narendra Modi visited **New Zealand** from **10–11 July 2026** as the final leg of his **three-nation tour**, which included **Indonesia**, **Australia**, and **New Zealand**.

The visit was made at the invitation of **Christopher Luxon**, Prime Minister of New Zealand.

PM Narendra Modi arrived in **Auckland**, where he was received by PM Christopher Luxon, marking the **first visit by an Indian Prime Minister to New Zealand in 40 years**.

During the visit, PM Modi received the traditional **Māori Powhiri ceremonial welcome** at **Government House, Auckland**, showcasing New Zealand's indigenous Māori culture and traditions.

PM Narendra Modi held wide-ranging **bilateral talks** with Christopher Luxon at Government House, Auckland.

India and New Zealand agreed to establish a **Maritime Security Dialogue** to strengthen cooperation in the **Indo-Pacific region**.

New Zealand designated **Maritime Security** as the priority pillar under the **Indo-Pacific Oceans Initiative (IPOI)**.

New Zealand also announced its decision to join the Government of India-led **Global Biofuels Alliance (GBA)**.

307. As per the news, the 80th meeting of the Board of Control Canteen Services (BOCCS) was held in which state?

A.Bihar

B.Chhattisgarh

C.Odisha

D.Jharkhand

E.West Bengal

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

Raksha Rajya Mantri Sanjay Seth reviewed the functioning of the **Canteen Services**

Department (CSD) during the **80th meeting of the Board of Control Canteen Services (BOCCS)** held in **Ranchi, Jharkhand**, on **14 July 2026**.

The meeting focused on improving **operational efficiency**, **administrative reforms**, and enhancing **service quality** for serving **Defence personnel**, **Ex-servicemen**, and their **dependents**.

Detailed Explanation:

Raksha Rajya Mantri Sanjay Seth reviewed the functioning of the **Canteen Services Department (CSD)** during the **80th meeting of the Board of Control Canteen Services (BOCCS)** held in **Ranchi, Jharkhand**, on **14 July 2026**.

The meeting focused on improving **operational efficiency**, **administrative reforms**, and enhancing **service quality** for serving **Defence personnel**, **Ex-servicemen**, and their **dependents**.

Major agenda items included **enhancement of budgetary support** for CSD, **modernisation of CSD depots**, extension of Central and State Government **subsidies on electric two-wheelers (EVs)** purchased through CSD, **induction of cooperative products** into the supply chain, and **human resource-related reforms**.

Senior officials from the **Ministry of Defence (MoD)**, **Defence Services**, and the **Canteen Services Department (CSD)** participated in the meeting.

Sanjay Seth stated that the ongoing transformation of CSD is driven by continuous reforms and a **beneficiary-centric approach** to meet the evolving needs of the Defence Forces community.

308. As per the news, Phase-III of the Biomedical Research Career Programme (BRCP) is jointly implemented by the Department of Biotechnology (DBT), Government of India, in collaboration with which organisation?

A.World Health Organization (WHO)

B.Bill & Melinda Gates Foundation

C.Wellcome Trust, United Kingdom (UK)

D.Indian Council of Medical Research (ICMR)

E.Biotechnology Industry Research Assistance Council (BIRAC)

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

Union Minister Dr. Jitendra Singh launched **Phase-III** of the **Biomedical Research Career Programme (BRCP)** with a total outlay of **₹1,500 crore** to strengthen India's biomedical research ecosystem.

Phase-III of BRCP has funding support of **₹1,000 crore** from the **Department of Biotechnology (DBT)** and **₹500 crore** from the **Wellcome Trust, United Kingdom (UK)**.

The programme is jointly implemented by the **Department of Biotechnology (DBT)**, Government of India, and the **Wellcome Trust (UK)** through the **DBT–Wellcome Trust India Alliance**.

Detailed Explanation:

Union Minister Dr. Jitendra Singh launched **Phase-III** of the **Biomedical Research Career Programme (BRCP)** with a total outlay of **₹1,500 crore** to strengthen India's biomedical research ecosystem.

Phase-III of BRCP has funding support of **₹1,000 crore** from the **Department of Biotechnology (DBT)** and **₹500 crore** from the **Wellcome Trust, United Kingdom (UK)**.

The programme is jointly implemented by the **Department of Biotechnology (DBT)**, Government of India, and the **Wellcome Trust (UK)** through the **DBT–Wellcome Trust India Alliance**.

BRCP aims to build a **globally competitive biomedical research workforce**, including basic scientists, clinician-researchers, public health experts, science communicators, and research managers.

The programme promotes **interdisciplinary, collaborative, and translational biomedical research** to develop technologies, diagnostics, and affordable healthcare solutions.

Phase-III seeks to strengthen India's **biomedical innovation ecosystem** while encouraging **international collaborations** and **philanthropic partnerships** in scientific research.

309. As per the news, which space agency successfully conducted the first lift-off and landing test of the RV-X reusable rocket prototype?

A.Japan Aerospace Exploration Agency (JAXA)

B.European Space Agency (ESA)

C.NASA

D.Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO)

E.China National Space Administration (CNSA)

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

The **Japan Aerospace Exploration Agency (JAXA)** successfully conducted the **first lift-off and landing test** of its **RV-X reusable rocket prototype** at the **Noshiro Testing Center, Akita Prefecture, Japan**.

During the test, the **RV-X rocket** lifted off to approximately **10 metres (33 feet)**, remained airborne for about **40 seconds**, and completed a **safe vertical landing**.

The test marked **Japan's first successful lift-off and landing demonstration** of a reusable rocket prototype.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Japan Aerospace Exploration Agency (JAXA)** successfully conducted the **first lift-off and landing test** of its **RV-X reusable rocket prototype** at the **Noshiro Testing Center, Akita Prefecture, Japan**.

During the test, the **RV-X rocket** lifted off to approximately **10 metres (33 feet)**, remained airborne for about **40 seconds**, and completed a **safe vertical landing**.

The test marked **Japan's first successful lift-off and landing demonstration** of a reusable rocket prototype.

RV-X successfully demonstrated **Vertical Take-Off and Vertical Landing (VTVL)** technology, a key capability for future reusable launch vehicles.

The **RV-X reusable rocket** was jointly developed by the **Japan Aerospace Exploration Agency (JAXA)** and **Mitsubishi Heavy Industries (MHI)**.

The RV-X measures **7.3 metres in length and 1.8 metres in diameter**.

The prototype is equipped with an **enhanced-durability rocket engine** and **four shock-absorbing landing legs** to enable safe and repeated landings.

The successful test is a **major milestone** in Japan's **reusable launch vehicle programme**, aimed at developing **next-generation reusable space transportation systems**.

310. As per the news, the Crew Module Uprighting System (CMUS), recently tested by ISRO under the Gaganyaan Mission, is designed to perform which function?

A.Dock the Crew Module with the space station

B.Ensure the Crew Module returns to an upright position after sea splashdown

C.Control the Crew Module during orbital manoeuvres

D.Provide life support to astronauts during flight

E.Enable re-entry into the Earth's atmosphere

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The **Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO)** successfully conducted **three critical tests** of the **Gaganyaan Crew Module (CM)** systems as part of India's **Human Spaceflight Programme**.

The successful tests mark another **significant milestone** towards India's first crewed orbital mission under the **Gaganyaan Mission**.

The first test validated the **Crew Module Uprighting System (CMUS)** through a **Float Inflation Test**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO)** successfully conducted **three critical tests** of the **Gaganyaan Crew Module (CM)** systems as part of India's **Human Spaceflight Programme**.

The successful tests mark another **significant milestone** towards India's first crewed orbital mission under the **Gaganyaan Mission**.

The first test validated the **Crew Module Uprighting System (CMUS)** through a **Float Inflation Test**.

The **Crew Module Uprighting System (CMUS)** ensures that the Crew Module returns to an **upright position after splashdown** in the sea, which is a **critical astronaut safety feature**.

The CMUS is based on **stored cold-gas technology**, enabling **automatic uprighting** of the crew module after ocean landing.

The second test involved the **Umbilical Separation Testing** of the **Connect-Disconnect System (CS-CDS)**.

311. As per the Brand Finance India 100 – 2026 Report, which company was recognised as the Most Valuable Tyre Brand and the Strongest Tyre Brand in India?

A.Apollo Tyres
B.CEAT
C.JK Tyre
D.MRF Limited
E.Bridgestone India
Answer: D
Short Explanation:
MRF Limited (Madras Rubber Factory Limited) has been recognised as the **Most Valuable Tyre Brand** and the **Strongest Tyre Brand in India** in the **Brand Finance India 100 – 2026 Report**.
MRF Limited also secured the position of the **3rd Strongest Tyre Brand in the World** in the **Brand Finance Tyres 25 – 2026 Rankings**.
The company achieved a **Brand Strength Index (BSI) score of 87.7 out of 100**, highlighting strong **customer loyalty, brand reputation, marketing efficiency, and business performance**.
Detailed Explanation:
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MRF Limited also secured the position of the **3rd Strongest Tyre Brand in the World** in the **Brand Finance Tyres 25 – 2026 Rankings**.
The company achieved a **Brand Strength Index (BSI) score of 87.7 out of 100**, highlighting strong **customer loyalty, brand reputation, marketing efficiency, and business performance**.
In the **Brand Finance India 100 – 2026 Report**, MRF Limited was ranked among the **Top 50 Most Valuable Brands in India**.
The ranking was based on parameters such as **financial performance, market presence, brand investment, customer perception, and overall brand strength**.
The achievement reflects the leadership of **MRF Limited** in the **Indian tyre manufacturing sector** and highlights India's growing importance in the **global automobile industry**.

312. As per the news, how many gold medals did India win at the 56th International Physics Olympiad (IPhO) 2026?
A.3
B.4
C.5
D.6
E.7
Answer: C
Short Explanation:
India secured **5 gold medals** at the **56th International Physics Olympiad (IPhO) 2026**, with **all five members** of the Indian team winning gold medals.
With this achievement, **India** finished in **joint first place** along with **China, Kazakhstan, Russia, South Korea, and Taiwan**.
Detailed Explanation:
India secured **5 gold medals** at the **56th International Physics Olympiad (IPhO) 2026**, with **all five members** of the Indian team winning gold medals.

With this achievement, **India** finished in **joint first place** along with **China, Kazakhstan, Russia, South Korea, and Taiwan**.

The **56th International Physics Olympiad (IPhO) 2026** was held in **Bucaramanga, Colombia**, with **381 students from 87 countries** participating.

The five Indian gold medalists are:

Kanishk Jain – Pune, Maharashtra

Riddhesh Anant Bendale – Indore, Madhya Pradesh

Rishit Garg – Dwarka, Delhi

Shresth Suraiya – Mumbai, Maharashtra

Svarit Joshi – Ahmedabad, Gujarat

313. As per the news, H. Hanumanthappa, who passed away recently, was associated with which political party?

A.Indian National Congress (INC)

B.Janata Dal (Secular) [JD(S)]

C.Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP)

D.Communist Party of India (CPI)

E.Nationalist Congress Party (NCP)

Answer: A

Veteran **Indian National Congress (INC)** leader and former Member of Parliament (MP) **H. Hanumanthappa** passed away at the age of **94** in **Chitradurga, Karnataka**.

H. Hanumanthappa was born on **13 May 1932** in **Guddadarangenahalli, Chitradurga district, Karnataka**.

He was a **senior leader** of the Indian National Congress (INC) and made **significant contributions** to public service and rural development.

H. Hanumanthappa served **three terms** as a **Rajya Sabha Member of Parliament (MP)** representing the state of **Karnataka**.

314. As per the news, Renowned Tamil writer and novelist Poomani, whose original name was Pulithurai Manickavasagam, passed away. He received the Sahitya Akademi Award (Tamil) in 2014 for which novel?

A.Agnaadi

B.Vekkai

C.Piragu

D.Naivedhyam

E.Oru Kottukku VeliyE

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

Renowned Tamil writer and novelist Poomani, whose original name was **Pulithurai Manickavasagam**, passed away at the age of **79** in **Chennai, Tamil Nadu**.

Poomani was born on **12 May 1947** in **Andipatti, Thoothukudi district, Tamil Nadu**.

He adopted the pen name **"Poomani"** and became widely known for his realistic portrayal of life in the **Karisal Bhoomi** region of southern Tamil Nadu.

Poomani was honoured with the prestigious **Sahitya Akademi Award in 2014** in the Tamil language category for his acclaimed novel **"Agnaadi"**.

Detailed Explanation:

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Poomani was honoured with the prestigious **Sahitya Akademi Award in 2014** in the Tamil language category for his acclaimed novel **"Agnaadi"**.

The novel **"Agnaadi"** is based on the **Kazhugumalai communal conflict (1895)** and the **Sivakasi communal conflict (1899)**.

His literary works primarily depicted **rural life, social inequalities, and the lives of marginalized communities** in Tamil Nadu.

315. As per the news, what is the tagline of the Bank of Maharashtra?

A.Trusted Family Bank

B.One Family One Bank

C.Banking for All

D.Your Trusted Partner

E.Together We Prosper

Answer: B

About Bank of Maharashtra:

Headquarters: Pune, Maharashtra

Founded: September 16, 1935

MD & CEO: Nidhu Saxena

Tagline: "One Family One Bank"

316. As per the news, Indian Mercantile Co-operative Bank Limited, Lucknow has been excluded from the Second Schedule of the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) Act, 1934. Under which section of the RBI Act, 1934 is a bank granted Scheduled Bank status?

A.Section 17

B.Section 22

C.Section 35A

D.Section 42

E.Section 45

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

Indian Mercantile Co-operative Bank Limited., Lucknow has been **excluded from the Second Schedule of the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) Act, 1934**, through a notification dated **4 June 2026**, published in the **Gazette of India (Part III – Section 4)** on **22 June 2026**.

With its removal from the **Second Schedule**, the bank loses its status as a **Scheduled Bank** under the **RBI Act, 1934**.

As a result, the bank will no longer enjoy the privileges available to **Scheduled Banks**, including access to **RBI refinance facilities**, participation in **monetary policy operations**, and **liquidity support mechanisms** provided by the **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)**.

Detailed Explanation:

Indian Mercantile Co-operative Bank Limited., Lucknow has been **excluded from**

the Second Schedule of the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) Act, 1934, through a notification dated **4 June 2026**, published in the **Gazette of India (Part III – Section 4)** on **22 June 2026**.
With its removal from the **Second Schedule**, the bank loses its status as a **Scheduled Bank** under the **RBI Act, 1934**.
As a result, the bank will no longer enjoy the privileges available to **Scheduled Banks**, including access to **RBI refinance facilities**, participation in **monetary policy operations**, and **liquidity support mechanisms** provided by the **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)**.
Scheduled Bank status is granted under **Section 42 of the Reserve Bank of India Act, 1934**, subject to compliance with prescribed **regulatory requirements**.
To qualify as a **Scheduled Bank**, a bank must satisfy conditions such as **minimum capital requirements**, maintenance of **Cash Reserve Ratio (CRR)/reserve requirements**, and compliance with **RBI's regulatory and supervisory norms**.

317. As per the news, where did the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) organise the 3rd Annual Conference of Internal Ombudsmen (IO)?

A.New Delhi
B.Chennai
C.Mumbai
D.Hyderabad
E.Bengaluru

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** organised the **3rd Annual Conference of Internal Ombudsmen (IO)** in **Mumbai, Maharashtra**.
The conference brought together **Internal Ombudsmen (IOs)** from various **Regulated Entities (REs)**, including **Banks**, **Non-Banking Financial Companies (NBFCs)**, **Credit Information Companies (CICs)**, and other regulated institutions, along with **RBI Ombudsmen** and **senior RBI officials**.
The event was also attended by **Managing Directors (MDs)**, **Chief Executive Officers (CEOs)**, **Executive Directors (EDs)** in charge of customer service, and **Principal Nodal Officers (PNOs)** of regulated entities.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** organised the **3rd Annual Conference of Internal Ombudsmen (IO)** in **Mumbai, Maharashtra**.
The conference brought together **Internal Ombudsmen (IOs)** from various **Regulated Entities (REs)**, including **Banks**, **Non-Banking Financial Companies (NBFCs)**, **Credit Information Companies (CICs)**, and other regulated institutions, along with **RBI Ombudsmen** and **senior RBI officials**.
The event was also attended by **Managing Directors (MDs)**, **Chief Executive Officers (CEOs)**, **Executive Directors (EDs)** in charge of customer service, and **Principal Nodal Officers (PNOs)** of regulated entities.
Shri Swaminathan J., **Deputy Governor, RBI**, delivered the **keynote address**, urging Internal

Ombudsmen to ensure **meaningful, fair, and effective resolution** of customer complaints.

The Deputy Governor advised IOs to **identify recurring customer issues**, conduct **root cause analysis**, and recommend **remedial measures** to improve grievance handling.

318. As per the news, the Variable Annuity component of Axis Max Life Smart Retirement Income with Sustained Earnings Plan (Smart RISE) is linked to which index?

A.BSE Sensex

B.NIFTY Bank Index

C.NIFTY Midcap 100 Index

D.NIFTY 50 Index

E.NIFTY Next 50 Index

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

Axis Max Life Insurance Limited launched **Axis Max Life Smart Retirement Income with Sustained Earnings Plan (Smart RISE)**, a retirement-focused insurance product designed to provide stable post-retirement income.

Smart RISE combines a **Guaranteed Annuity** with a **Variable Annuity** linked to the **NIFTY 50 Index**, offering both fixed income and market-linked growth potential.

Detailed Explanation:

Axis Max Life Insurance Limited launched **Axis Max Life Smart Retirement Income with Sustained Earnings Plan (Smart RISE)**, a retirement-focused insurance product designed to provide stable post-retirement income.

Smart RISE combines a **Guaranteed Annuity** with a **Variable Annuity** linked to the **NIFTY 50 Index**, offering both fixed income and market-linked growth potential.

The plan aims to provide **predictable retirement income**, **equity market participation**, **financial security**, and **long-term legacy planning**.

The **Guaranteed Annuity component** provides **fixed and predictable income** throughout the selected annuity period.

The **Variable Annuity component** is linked to the **NIFTY 50 Index**, enabling policyholders to benefit from **potential equity market returns** while receiving retirement income.

319. As per the Ministry of Commerce and Industry's Trade Data for Q1 (April–June) FY2026–27, consider the following statements:

1. **India's total exports during Q1 FY2026–27 stood at USD 232.73 billion.**
2. **Merchandise exports during Q1 FY2026–27 were USD 129.32 billion.**
3. **Service exports during Q1 FY2026–27 were estimated at USD 103.41 billion.**

A.Only 1

B.Only 2

C.Only 1 and 3

D.Only 2 and 3

E.All the above

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

According to the data, **India's total exports** during **Q1 FY27** stood at **USD 232.73**

billion, while **total imports** were estimated at **USD 270.15 billion**.

Merchandise exports during **Q1 FY27** increased to **USD 129.32 billion**, compared to **USD 111.57 billion** in **Q1 FY26**, reflecting strong growth in **goods exports**.

Service exports during **April–June FY27** were estimated at **USD 103.41 billion**, up from **USD 97.41 billion** during the corresponding period of **FY26**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Ministry of Commerce and Industry (MoC&I)** released **India's Trade Data** for **Quarter 1 (Q1: April–June)** of **Financial Year 2026–27 (FY27)** and for the month of **June 2026**.

According to the data, **India's total exports** during **Q1 FY27** stood at **USD 232.73 billion**, while **total imports** were estimated at **USD 270.15 billion**.

Merchandise exports during **Q1 FY27** increased to **USD 129.32 billion**, compared to **USD 111.57 billion** in **Q1 FY26**, reflecting strong growth in **goods exports**.

Service exports during **April–June FY27** were estimated at **USD 103.41 billion**, up from **USD 97.41 billion** during the corresponding period of **FY26**.

Merchandise imports during **Q1 FY27** rose to **USD 216.18 billion**, compared to **USD 180.31 billion** in **Q1 FY26**.

Service imports during **April–June FY27** were estimated at **USD 53.97 billion**, compared to **USD 49.51 billion** in **April–June FY26**.

320. As per the RBI's draft amendment on acquisition of major shareholding in banks, after obtaining one-time RBI approval, eligible institutional investors can increase or retain their stake in the same banking company up to what limit without seeking fresh approval?

A.5% of the paid-up share capital or voting rights

B.7.5% of the paid-up share capital or voting rights

C.10% of the paid-up share capital or voting rights

D.15% of the paid-up share capital or voting rights

E.26% of the paid-up share capital or voting rights

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

Reserve Bank of India (RBI) has released a **draft amendment** proposing a **one-time approval mechanism** for eligible institutional investors to acquire and retain **major shareholding (5% or more)** in the same banking company without seeking repeated approvals.

Under the proposed framework, **prior RBI approval** will continue to be **mandatory** for the **first acquisition** of a major shareholding in a bank.

After obtaining the one-time approval, eligible investors can increase or retain their stake in the same bank **up to 10%** of the paid-up share capital or voting rights **without seeking fresh**

RBI approval every time their holding falls below and later exceeds 5%.

Detailed Explanation:

Reserve Bank of India (RBI) has released a **draft amendment** proposing a **one-time approval mechanism** for eligible institutional investors to acquire and retain **major shareholding (5% or more)** in the same banking company without seeking repeated approvals.

Under the proposed framework, **prior RBI approval** will continue to be **mandatory** for the **first acquisition** of a major shareholding in a bank.

After obtaining the one-time approval, eligible investors can increase or retain their stake in the same bank **up to 10%** of the paid-up share capital or voting rights **without seeking fresh RBI approval** every time their holding falls below and later exceeds 5%.

The proposed facility will be available only to **"Qualifying Persons"**, including **SEBI-registered Mutual Funds**, **IRDAI-registered Insurance Companies**, and **PFRDA-registered Pension Funds**.

To qualify, these institutional investors **must not belong to the promoter group** or group entities of the concerned banking company.

The proposal applies to **Commercial Banks**, **Small Finance Banks (SFBs)**, **Payments Banks**, and **Local Area Banks (LABs)**.

Under the **existing framework**, any investor whose holding **falls below 5%** must obtain **fresh RBI approval** before acquiring another major shareholding, even in the same bank.

321. As per the news, the trial version of India's first Index of Services Production (ISP) has been launched with which base year?

A.2011–12

B.2017–18

C.2019–20

D.2023–24

E.2024–25

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

The **Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI)** has introduced India's first **trial version of the Index of Services Production (ISP)** to measure the monthly performance of the **formal services sector**.

The **Index of Services Production (ISP)** has been launched with the **base year 2024–25** and provides a short-term indicator to track changes in the output of India's services economy.

Similar to the **Index of Industrial Production (IIP)**, which measures output in **manufacturing, mining, and electricity sectors**, the ISP will monitor monthly production trends in key **service industries**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI)** has introduced India's first **trial version of the Index of Services**

Production (ISP) to measure the monthly performance of the **formal services sector**.

The **Index of Services Production (ISP)** has been launched with the **base year 2024–25** and provides a short-term indicator to track changes in the output of India's services economy.

Similar to the **Index of Industrial Production (IIP)**, which measures output in **manufacturing, mining, and electricity sectors**, the ISP will monitor monthly production trends in key **service industries**.

The pilot ISP covers **19 service sub-sectors**, accounting for around **60% of India's services sector**, which contributes more than **50% of India's Gross Value Added (GVA)**.

The introduction of ISP will strengthen **macroeconomic monitoring**, support **evidence-based policymaking**, and provide timely information to **businesses, investors, analysts, and policymakers**.

The first ISP report covering **April 2026** showed strong growth in the services sector, with **14 out of 19 sub-sectors recording double-digit year-on-year growth**.

The highest growth-performing service sectors in April 2026 were:

Accommodation and Food Services: 37.2%

Retail Trade: 30.8%

Administrative and Support Services: 28.7%

Real Estate Services: 27.7%

Telecommunication Services: 22.8%

322. As per the news, the Indian Grey Hornbill has been successfully reintroduced to which forest after an absence of more than 60 years?

A.Kaziranga National Park

B.Gir Forest

C.Jim Corbett National Park

D.Bandipur National Park

E.Kanha National Park

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The **Gujarat Forest Department** has successfully reintroduced the **Indian Grey Hornbill** to the **Gir Forest**, marking the return of the species after an absence of more than **60 years**.

The species had disappeared from the **Gir ecosystem** during the **1950s–1960s**, primarily due to **hunting pressure**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Gujarat Forest Department** has successfully reintroduced the **Indian Grey Hornbill** to the **Gir Forest**, marking the return of the species after an absence of more than **60 years**.

The species had disappeared from the **Gir ecosystem** during the **1950s–1960s**, primarily due to **hunting pressure**.

Scientific assessments confirmed that the reintroduced hornbills have **survived, established permanent territories, adapted to the habitat, and successfully bred for four consecutive breeding seasons**, making it one of **India's most successful bird reintroduction programmes**.

Under the conservation programme, **40 Indian Grey Hornbills** were released into Gir in two phases:

2021–22: 28 hornbills

2023: 12 hornbills

Eleven male hornbills were fitted with **satellite transmitters** to monitor their **movement, habitat use, territorial establishment, nesting behaviour, and breeding success**.

323. As per the news, which state has announced the establishment of India's first government-driven Artificial Intelligence (AI) University?

A.Telangana

B.Tamil Nadu

C.Maharashtra

D.Karnataka

E.Gujarat

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

Karnataka Chief Minister D.K. Shivakumar announced that the state will establish **India's first government-driven Artificial Intelligence (AI) University** during **Google I/O Connect India 2026** held at the **Bangalore International Exhibition Centre (BIEC), Bengaluru**.

The initiative aims to position **Karnataka as an "AI-native State"** by promoting **Artificial Intelligence (AI)-driven education, research, innovation, and governance**.

The proposed **AI University** will serve as a **centre of excellence** for Artificial Intelligence by developing **world-class AI talent**, promoting **advanced AI research**, encouraging **innovation and entrepreneurship**, and strengthening collaboration among **academia, industry, and government**.

Detailed Explanation:

Karnataka Chief Minister D.K. Shivakumar announced that the state will establish **India's first government-driven Artificial Intelligence (AI) University** during **Google I/O Connect India 2026** held at the **Bangalore International Exhibition Centre (BIEC), Bengaluru**.

The initiative aims to position **Karnataka as an "AI-native State"** by promoting **Artificial Intelligence (AI)-driven education, research, innovation, and governance**.

The proposed **AI University** will serve as a **centre of excellence** for Artificial Intelligence by developing **world-class AI talent**, promoting **advanced AI research**, encouraging **innovation and entrepreneurship**, and strengthening collaboration among **academia, industry, and government**.

The university will also help create a **skilled workforce** to meet the growing demand of **AI-driven industries** and support India's digital economy.

Alongside the university, the **Karnataka Government** will establish an **AI Hub** to promote **AI research, startup incubation, innovation, and industry collaboration**.

The **AI Hub** will provide a platform for **startups, researchers, companies, and academic institutions** to develop AI-based solutions, undertake advanced research, and accelerate the commercialisation of AI technologies.

324. As per the World LNG Report 2026, which Indian LNG terminal ranked as the 6th largest LNG regasification terminal in the world?

A.Kochi LNG Terminal

B.Hazira LNG Terminal

C.Ennore LNG Terminal

D.Dahej LNG Terminal

E.Dhamra LNG Terminal

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The **International Gas Union (IGU)** has released the **World LNG Report 2026**, providing a comprehensive review of the global **Liquefied Natural Gas (LNG)** industry and market trends.

Global LNG trade reached a record **437 million tonnes in 2025**, registering a **6.3% increase**, the strongest annual growth since **2022**.

India added **52.5 million tonnes per annum (MTPA)** of LNG regasification capacity across **eight terminals**, surpassing **Spain** to become the **4th largest LNG regasification market** globally in **2025**.

The **Dahej LNG Terminal** in **Gujarat** ranked as the **6th largest LNG regasification terminal in the world** and remains India's largest ultra-scale LNG energy hub.

Detailed Explanation:

The **International Gas Union (IGU)** has released the **World LNG Report 2026**, providing a comprehensive review of the global **Liquefied Natural Gas (LNG)** industry and market trends.

Global LNG trade reached a record **437 million tonnes in 2025**, registering a **6.3% increase**, the strongest annual growth since **2022**.

The growth was driven by expanding LNG supplies from the **United States, Qatar, Australia, Russia**, and other major producing countries.

Canada and **Mauritania/Senegal** became new LNG-exporting countries, marking the **first new LNG export markets since 2022**.

Europe's LNG imports increased significantly following the expiry of **Russian natural gas pipeline transit through Ukraine** in early **2025**.

Asia accounted for the largest increase in global **LNG regasification capacity** during **2025**, with **China** contributing **24%** and **India** contributing **11.3%** of the total global capacity additions.

Although **Asia Pacific** remained the world's largest LNG-importing region, LNG imports into the region declined due to lower demand from **China and India**.

India added **52.5 million tonnes per annum (MTPA)** of LNG regasification capacity across **eight terminals**, surpassing **Spain** to become the **4th largest LNG regasification market** globally in **2025**.

The **Dahej LNG Terminal** in **Gujarat** ranked as the **6th largest LNG regasification terminal in the world** and remains India's largest ultra-scale LNG energy hub.

325. As per the news, the Government of India secured approval for developing a Codex Standard for which product under the Codex Committee on Processed Fruits and Vegetables (CCPFV)?

A.Black Pepper

B.Cashew Kernels

C.Turmeric

D.Cumin Seeds

E.Green Cardamom

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The 49th Session of the Codex Alimentarius Commission (CAC49) was held from **6–11 July 2026** in **Geneva, Switzerland**,
where **India** achieved major success in the development of **science-based global food standards**.

At **CAC49**, **seven Codex standards and guidelines** developed under **India's chairmanship and co-chairmanship** were officially adopted, highlighting India's growing leadership in the **global food safety framework**.

The **Government of India (GoI)** also secured approval for new work on developing a **Codex Standard for Cashew Kernels** under the **Codex Committee on Processed Fruits and Vegetables (CCPFV)**.

Detailed Explanation:

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At **CAC49**, **seven Codex standards and guidelines** developed under **India's chairmanship and co-chairmanship** were officially adopted, highlighting India's growing leadership in the **global food safety framework**.

The **Government of India (GoI)** also secured approval for new work on developing a **Codex Standard for Cashew Kernels** under the **Codex Committee on Processed Fruits and Vegetables (CCPFV)**.

The **Indian delegation** was led by **Rajit Punhani, Chief Executive Officer (CEO)** of the **Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI)**, along with technical experts from **FSSAI** and the **Spices Board**.

Under **India's chairmanship**, the Commission adopted the **Codex Standards for Dried Coriander Seeds and Fresh Curry Leaves**, providing internationally harmonised quality benchmarks and facilitating global trade.

Under **India's co-chairmanship**, **five Codex texts** were adopted, including **Standards for Vanilla, Large Cardamom**, **Guidelines for the Safe Use and Reuse of Water in Food Production and Processing**, **Guidelines for the Control of Campylobacter and**

Salmonella in Chicken Meat, and **Provisions for Joint Presentation and Multipack Formats** under the **General Standard for the Labelling of Prepackaged Foods**.

326. As per the news, Ukraine and nine European countries announced the formation of which coalition to strengthen Europe's defence against ballistic missile threats?

A.Anti-ballistic Missile Coalition

B.European Air Shield Coalition

C.NATO Missile Defence Initiative

D.European Strategic Defence Alliance

E.Integrated Air Defence Coalition

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

Ukraine and nine European countries announced the formation of an **Anti-ballistic Missile Coalition** to strengthen Europe's defence against the growing ballistic missile threat.

The announcement was made on the sidelines of the **Coalition of the Willing (CoW) Summit** held in **Paris, France**, which brought together over 30 countries and at least 25 Heads of State.

The primary objective of the Anti-ballistic Missile Coalition is to develop a **shared ballistic missile defence capability** for Europe.

Detailed Explanation:

Ukraine and nine European countries announced the formation of an **Anti-ballistic Missile Coalition** to strengthen Europe's defence against the growing ballistic missile threat.

The announcement was made on the sidelines of the **Coalition of the Willing (CoW) Summit** held in **Paris, France**, which brought together over 30 countries and at least 25 Heads of State.

The primary objective of the Anti-ballistic Missile Coalition is to develop a **shared ballistic missile defence capability** for Europe.

The **10 founding members** of the coalition are **Ukraine, Denmark, France, Germany, Italy, the Netherlands, Norway, Spain, Sweden, and the United Kingdom (UK)**.

The coalition was formed in response to the **increasing threat posed by ballistic missiles**, which are more difficult to intercept than cruise missiles or drones.

President Volodymyr Zelenskyy stated that Ukraine and its allies will jointly develop a **mass-produced, low-cost anti-ballistic missile defence system** within the **next 12 months (1 year)**.

327. As per the news, who was conferred the 60th Jnanpith Award (2025), India's highest literary honour?

A.Jayakanthan

B.Akilan

C.R. Vairamuthu

D.Poomani

E.Perumal Murugan

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

Tamil poet, lyricist, and writer R. Vairamuthu was conferred the **60th Jnanpith Award (2025)**, India's highest literary honour, at a ceremony held in **New Delhi**.

The award was presented by **Dr. Karan Singh**, noted scholar and statesman, in recognition of **R. Vairamuthu's outstanding contribution to Tamil literature**.

With this honour, **R. Vairamuthu** became the **third Tamil writer from Tamil Nadu** to receive the **Jnanpith Award**, after a gap of **24 years**.

Detailed Explanation:

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With this honour, **R. Vairamuthu** became the **third Tamil writer from Tamil Nadu** to receive the **Jnanpith Award**, after a gap of **24 years**.

The previous Tamil recipients of the **Jnanpith Award** are:

Akilan (1975)

Jayakanthan (2002)

R. Vairamuthu (2025)

The award carries a **cash prize of ₹11 lakh**, a **bronze statue of Goddess Vagdevi (Saraswati)**, and a **citation**.

328. As per the news, which Indian-origin economist has been appointed to head the Balance Sheet Policy Task Force under the US Federal Reserve's Monetary Policy Framework review?

A.Raghuram Rajan

B.Asha Sharma

C.Raj Chetty

D.Arvind Subramanian

E.Kaushik Basu

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

The **United States Federal Reserve (US Fed)** appointed three Indian-origin experts—**Raghuram Rajan**, **Raj Chetty**, and **Asha Sharma**—to lead three of its five task forces reviewing the US Federal Reserve's **Monetary Policy Framework**.

The five task forces were announced by **US Federal Reserve Chair Kevin Warsh** as part of a comprehensive review of the Fed's monetary policy framework.

Raghuram Rajan, Professor of Finance at the University of Chicago Booth School of Business and former Governor of the Reserve Bank of India (RBI), was appointed to head the **Balance Sheet Policy Task Force**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **United States Federal Reserve (US Fed)** appointed three Indian-origin experts—**Raghuram Rajan**, **Raj Chetty**, and **Asha Sharma**—to lead three of its five task forces reviewing the US Federal Reserve's **Monetary Policy Framework**.

The five task forces were announced by **US Federal Reserve Chair Kevin Warsh** as part of a comprehensive review of the Fed's monetary policy framework.

Raghuram Rajan, Professor of Finance at the University of Chicago Booth School of Business and former Governor of the Reserve Bank of India (RBI), was appointed to head the **Balance Sheet Policy Task Force**.

The **Balance Sheet Policy Task Force** will review the **costs, benefits, and institutional implications** of the Federal Reserve's balance sheet framework.

Raj Chetty, Professor of Economics at Harvard University and Director of Opportunity Insights, was appointed to lead the **Data Task Force**.

The **Data Task Force** will focus on improving the **quality, accuracy, and timeliness** of economic data used for monetary policy decision-making.

329. As per the news, Operation Southern Readiness 26-2 will be conducted under the aegis of which Combined Task Force (CTF)?

A.Combined Task Force 150

B.Combined Task Force 151

C.Combined Task Force 152

D.Combined Task Force 153

E.Combined Task Force 154

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

Indian Navy will host **Operation Southern Readiness 26-2** at the **Southern Naval Command, Kochi (Kerala)** from **20–23 July 2026** as a **four-day multinational maritime training engagement**.

The exercise will be conducted in partnership with the **Combined Maritime Forces (CMF)** under the aegis of **Combined Task Force 154 (CTF 154)**, the Indian Navy-led and CMF's dedicated **Training Task Force**.

Detailed Explanation:

Indian Navy will host **Operation Southern Readiness 26-2** at the **Southern Naval Command, Kochi (Kerala)** from **20–23 July 2026** as a **four-day multinational maritime training engagement**.

The exercise will be conducted in partnership with the **Combined Maritime Forces (CMF)** under the aegis of **Combined Task Force 154 (CTF 154)**, the Indian Navy-led and CMF's dedicated **Training Task Force**.

The exercise will bring together personnel from **CMF Partner Nations** to strengthen **professional maritime security training**, gain **practical operational experience**, and exchange **Best Practices**.

Combined Maritime Forces (CMF) is a **multinational maritime partnership** of **more than 40 nations** committed to enhancing **regional capacity building** and **collective maritime security**.

The training programme will include **classroom instruction**, **simulator-based training**, and **hands-on practical training** to improve the **operational skills** of participating personnel.

330. As per the news, the indigenous technology for producing C-Phycocyanin was developed by which institution?

A.Indian Institute of Science (IISc), Bengaluru

B.CSIR–National Chemical Laboratory (NCL), Pune

C.Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) Guwahati

D.Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) Madras

E.National Institute of Pharmaceutical Education and Research (NIPER), Mohali

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

Technology Development Board (TDB) under the **Department of Science & Technology (DST)**, Government of India, has extended financial assistance to **M/s K. N. Biosciences (India) Private Limited, Hyderabad** for the project **"Production of C-Phycocyanin using Spirulina sp. as a Cell Factory."**

The project aims to commercialise **indigenous technology** for producing **C-Phycocyanin**, a **natural blue pigment**, reducing India's dependence on **imported natural colourants** and strengthening **biotechnology-based sustainable manufacturing**.

C-Phycocyanin has applications in the **food, nutraceutical, agriculture, aquaculture, poultry feed, and biostimulant sectors**, making it a **high-value biotechnology product**.

The technology was developed by the **Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) Guwahati** using an **indigenous Spirulina strain (NCIM 5143)** and transferred to the company through a **Transfer of Technology (ToT) Agreement** for commercial production.

Detailed Explanation:

Technology Development Board (TDB) under the **Department of Science & Technology (DST)**, Government of India, has extended financial assistance to **M/s K. N. Biosciences (India) Private Limited, Hyderabad** for the project **"Production of C-Phycocyanin using Spirulina sp. as a Cell Factory."**

The project aims to commercialise **indigenous technology** for producing **C-Phycocyanin**, a **natural blue pigment**, reducing India's dependence on **imported natural colourants** and strengthening **biotechnology-based sustainable manufacturing**.

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The technology was developed by the **Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) Guwahati** using an **indigenous Spirulina strain (NCIM 5143)** and transferred to the company through a **Transfer of Technology (ToT) Agreement** for commercial production.

The initiative represents the successful commercialisation of **publicly funded research** and supports the Government's vision of **Bioeconomy, Sustainable Manufacturing, and Aatmanirbhar Bharat**.

331. As per the news, NIDAR 2.0 is being launched under which initiative?

A.Digital India Programme

B.Startup India Initiative

C.SwaYaan Initiative

D.Make in India Initiative

E.PM Gati Shakti Initiative

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The **Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY)**, in partnership with the **Drone Federation India (DFI)**, launched the **2nd edition of the National Innovation Challenge for Drone Application and Research (NIDAR 2.0)** for **2026–27** under the **SwaYaan Initiative** at **Electronics Niketan, New Delhi**.

During the launch event, **S. Krishnan, Secretary, MeitY**, formally unveiled the **problem statements, poster, and rulebook** for **NIDAR 2.0**.

NIDAR 2.0 focuses on developing **autonomous drone systems, indigenous avionics, and core drone components**, promoting self-reliance (**Aatmanirbharta**) in **India's drone ecosystem**.

A key highlight of **NIDAR 2.0** is the integration of the indigenously developed **VEGA Processor** under the **Digital India RISC-V (DIR-V) Programme**, challenging participants to build **drone intelligence** using indigenous technology.

The competition is organised under two specialised tracks: **Track 1 – Drone Innovation** and **Track 2 – Component Innovation**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY)**, in partnership with the **Drone Federation India (DFI)**, launched the **2nd edition of the National Innovation Challenge for Drone Application and Research (NIDAR 2.0)** for **2026–27** under the **SwaYaan Initiative** at **Electronics Niketan, New Delhi**.

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The competition is organised under two specialised tracks: **Track 1 – Drone Innovation** and **Track 2 – Component Innovation**.

NIDAR 2.0 offers a **prize pool of over ₹65 lakh**, along with **corporate internships, startup incubation support, cloud computing credits, software support, and mentorship** to help winning teams commercialise their innovations.

The **SwaYaan Initiative** was approved in **July 2022** with an **outlay of nearly ₹90 crore** to develop a **skilled workforce** and strengthen **India's drone ecosystem**.

The **first edition of NIDAR**, launched in **March 2025**, attracted **3,448 students** from **22 States, 4 Union Territories, and 109 cities**, with participants developing drone solutions for **precision agriculture and disaster management**.

The **inaugural edition** concluded with **93 finalist teams**, while **24 winning teams** received **prizes worth ₹40 lakh**.

332. As per the news, the Online Portal Application for Registration of Coal Exchanges was launched under the regulatory oversight of which organisation?

A.Coal Controller Organisation (CCO)

B.Ministry of Power

C.Coal India Limited (CIL)

D.Central Electricity Authority (CEA)

E.NITI Aayog

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

Union Minister of Coal and Mines, G. Kishan Reddy, in the presence of **Minister of State Satish Chandra Dubey** and **Coal Secretary Vikram Dev Dutt**, launched the **Online Portal Application for Registration of Coal Exchanges** in **New Delhi** during the **Curtain Raiser Event for Indian Mining Week 2026**.

The launch marks India's transition from a policy framework to **operational readiness for Coal Exchanges**, inviting eligible entities to apply for registration under the regulatory oversight of the **Coal Controller Organisation (CCO)**.

Detailed Explanation:

Union Minister of Coal and Mines, G. Kishan Reddy, in the presence of **Minister of State Satish Chandra Dubey** and **Coal Secretary Vikram Dev Dutt**, launched the **Online Portal Application for Registration of Coal Exchanges** in **New Delhi** during the **Curtain Raiser Event for Indian Mining Week 2026**.

The launch marks India's transition from a policy framework to **operational readiness for Coal Exchanges**, inviting eligible entities to apply for registration under the regulatory oversight of the **Coal Controller Organisation (CCO)**.

A **Coal Exchange** is an **online trading platform** where buyers and sellers of coal and processed coal products can undertake **delivery-based coal contracts** approved by the Authority.

The Coal Exchange will ensure **transparent market-based price discovery**, **quality assurance** through Authority-approved coal sampling agencies, **advanced market surveillance**, **secure clearing and settlement** backed by a **Settlement Fund**, and an **effective grievance redressal mechanism**.

333. As per the news, the Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement (CETA) between India and the United Kingdom (UK) came into effect on_____to increase bilateral trade to USD 100 billion by 2030.

A.1 July 2026

B.10 July 2026

C.15 July 2026

D.20 July 2026

E.1 August 2026

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The **Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement (CETA)** between **India** and the **United Kingdom (UK)** came into effect on **15 July 2026**, marking a major milestone in bilateral economic and trade relations.

The agreement aims to increase **bilateral trade to USD 100 billion by 2030** from the current level of around **USD 55–60 billion**, while promoting **trade, investment, supply chain integration, employment generation, and long-term economic cooperation**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement (CETA)** between **India** and the **United Kingdom (UK)** came into effect on **15 July 2026**, marking a major milestone in bilateral economic and trade relations.

The agreement aims to increase **bilateral trade to USD 100 billion by 2030** from the current level of around **USD 55–60 billion**, while promoting **trade, investment, supply chain integration, employment generation, and long-term economic cooperation**.

India–UK bilateral trade currently stands at around **USD 55–60 billion**, including **USD 25.12 billion in merchandise trade (FY 2025–26)** and **USD 35.44 billion in services trade (2024)**.

Under the agreement, **Indian exports** in sectors such as **textiles and apparel, leather products, footwear, gems and jewellery, plastics, and other labour-intensive industries** will receive **zero-duty access** to the UK market, enhancing their global competitiveness

334. As per the news, what is the name of the official mascot of the 22nd Commonwealth Table Tennis Championship 2026?

A.Shera

B.Udaan

C.Veera

D.Mayur

E.Garuda

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta unveiled **'Mayur'**, the official mascot of the **22nd Commonwealth Table Tennis Championship 2026**, at a special ceremony in **New Delhi**.

The **22nd Commonwealth Table Tennis Championship 2026** will be held from **27 July to 2 August 2026** at the **Thyagraj Stadium, New Delhi**.

Detailed Explanation:

Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta unveiled **'Mayur'**, the official mascot of the **22nd Commonwealth Table Tennis Championship 2026**, at a special ceremony in **New Delhi**.

The **22nd Commonwealth Table Tennis Championship 2026** will be held from **27 July to 2 August 2026** at the **Thyagraj Stadium, New Delhi**.

The championship is expected to witness participation from **over 35 Commonwealth countries**, making it one of the largest editions of the tournament.

'Mayur' is inspired by the **Indian Peacock**, the **National Bird of India**, and reflects the values of **unity, friendship, cultural diversity, sportsmanship, and international cooperation**.

335. As per the news, World Day for International Justice is observed every year on_____

A.15 July

B.16 July

C.17 July

D.18 July

E.19 July

Answer: C

World Day for International Justice 2026 was observed globally on **17 July 2026** to recognise and promote the importance of the **international justice system**.

The day is also known by various names such as **International Justice Day**, **World Day for International Justice**, and **Day of International Criminal Justice**.

336. Recently in news, Delhivery Financial Services Pvt. Ltd. received RBI approval for a Certificate of Registration (CoR) as which type of financial institution?

A.Small Finance Bank (SFB)

B.Payment Bank

C.Type-II Non-Banking Financial Company–Non-Deposit Taking (NBFC-ND)

D.Asset Reconstruction Company (ARC)

E.Housing Finance Company (HFC)

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

Delhivery Financial Services Private Limited, a wholly-owned subsidiary of **Delhivery Limited**, received **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** approval for the grant of a **Certificate of Registration (CoR)** as a **Type-II Non-Banking Financial Company–Non-Deposit Taking (NBFC-ND)**.

RBI clarified that the **Certificate of Registration (CoR)** will be issued subject to the **submission of specified documents** to the satisfaction of the central bank, as mentioned in the approval letter.

Detailed Explanation:

Delhivery Financial Services Private Limited, a wholly-owned subsidiary of **Delhivery Limited**, received **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** approval for the grant of a **Certificate of Registration (CoR)** as a **Type-II Non-Banking Financial Company–Non-Deposit Taking (NBFC-ND)**.

RBI clarified that the **Certificate of Registration (CoR)** will be issued subject to the **submission of specified documents** to the satisfaction of

the central bank, as mentioned in the approval letter.

The approval will enable Delhivery Financial Services to **expand its financial services offerings** and strengthen its **logistics ecosystem**.

The company plans to provide **credit facilities**, **payment solutions**, **FasTag aggregation**, **fuel cards**, and **insurance** for truckers, fleet owners, and other logistics stakeholders to reinforce Delhivery's logistics network.

Delhivery Financial Services Pvt. Ltd. was incorporated in **January 2026** as the financial services arm of Delhivery Limited, dedicated to offering **financial products for the logistics sector**.

337. Recently, since which financial year has the Services Sector continuously contributed more than 50% of India's Gross Value Added (GVA)?

A.2011–12

B.2012–13

C.2013–14

D.2014–15

E.2015–16

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The National Statistics Office (NSO) under the **Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI)** launched the **1st trial Sub-sectoral Index of Services Production (ISP)**, India's **first official monthly indicator** to measure services sector output.

The ISP measures short-term changes in the **volume of output** produced by the formal services sector relative to the base year, and should not be equated with **Gross Value Added (GVA)** used for GDP estimation.

The **Services Sector** has contributed **more than 50%** of India's **Gross Value Added (GVA)** continuously since **2013–14**, making it the largest contributor to India's GDP.

Detailed Explanation:

The National Statistics Office (NSO) under the **Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI)** launched the **1st trial Sub-sectoral Index of Services Production (ISP)**, India's **first official monthly indicator** to measure services sector output.

The **Index of Services Production (ISP)** is designed as a **high-frequency macroeconomic indicator** to capture the short-term performance of the **formal services sector**, complementing the Index of Industrial Production (IIP).

The **base year** for the trial ISP is **2024–25**, and the first index has been released for **April 2026**.

The trial ISP currently covers **19 sub-sectors**, representing nearly **60% of India's formal services sector**.

The ISP measures short-term changes in the **volume of output** produced by the formal services sector relative to the base year, and should not be equated with **Gross Value Added (GVA)** used for GDP estimation.

The **Services Sector** has contributed **more than 50%** of India's **Gross Value Added (GVA)** continuously since **2013–14**, making it the largest contributor to India's GDP.

338. Recently, Bloomberg facilitated the first electronic trade in Indian Government Bonds (IGBs) by integrating its Bloomberg Terminal with which trading platform?

A.BOLT

B.Negotiated Dealing System–Order Matching (NDS-OM)

C.NSE NEAT

D.INET Trading System

E.CBLO Platform

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Bloomberg has facilitated the **first electronic trade** in **Indian Government Bonds (IGBs)** through its **Bloomberg Terminal** by integrating it with the **Negotiated Dealing System–Order Matching (NDS-OM)**.

The new platform enables **Foreign Portfolio Investors (FPIs)** to electronically execute, monitor, allocate, and settle trades in Indian Government Bonds (IGBs) with domestic and international banks through a **single integrated platform**.

The **Bloomberg Terminal** is directly connected to **NDS-OM**, which is operated by **Clearcorp Dealing Systems (India) Ltd.**, providing an **end-to-end electronic workflow** for trading **Government Securities (G-Secs)**.

Detailed Explanation:

Bloomberg has facilitated the **first electronic trade** in **Indian Government Bonds (IGBs)** through its **Bloomberg Terminal** by integrating it with the **Negotiated Dealing System–Order Matching (NDS-OM)**.

The new platform enables **Foreign Portfolio Investors (FPIs)** to electronically execute, monitor, allocate, and settle trades in Indian Government Bonds (IGBs) with domestic and international banks through a **single integrated platform**.

The **Bloomberg Terminal** is directly connected to **NDS-OM**, which is operated by **Clearcorp Dealing Systems (India) Ltd.**, providing an **end-to-end electronic workflow** for trading **Government Securities (G-Secs)**.

The first electronic trade on the Bloomberg-NDS-OM platform was successfully executed by **State Street Investment Management**.

The integration connects **Bloomberg's global liquidity network** with India's NDS-OM platform, improving **market access**, **operational efficiency**, **transparency**, and **liquidity** in the Indian Government Bond market.

339. Recently, India unveiled "SHANTI" as its guiding vision for the 2028–2029 UN Security Council (UNSC) Non-Permanent Membership campaign. What does "SHANTI" stand for?

A.Securing Holistic Advancement through Norms, Trust and Integrity

B.Strategic Harmony and National Trust Initiative

C.Sustainable Humanitarian Action through International Cooperation

D.Security, Harmony and Alliance for Nations through Inclusion

E.Strengthening Humanitarian Assistance through New Technology and Innovation

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

India has officially launched its campaign for election as a **Non-Permanent Member of the United Nations Security Council (UNSC)** for the **2028–2029** term.

External Affairs Minister Dr. S. Jaishankar launched India's candidature at the **United Nations (UN) Headquarters, New York**, and unveiled **SHANTI** as India's guiding vision for the campaign.

SHANTI stands for **Securing Holistic Advancement through Norms, Trust and Integrity**, reflecting India's approach to promoting **global peace, security, multilateral cooperation, and equitable development**.

Detailed Explanation:

India has officially launched its campaign for election as a **Non-Permanent Member of the United Nations Security Council (UNSC)** for the **2028–2029** term.

External Affairs Minister Dr. S. Jaishankar launched India's candidature at the **United Nations (UN) Headquarters, New York**, and unveiled **SHANTI** as India's guiding vision for the campaign.

SHANTI stands for **Securing Holistic Advancement through Norms, Trust and Integrity**, reflecting India's approach to promoting **global peace, security, multilateral cooperation, and equitable development**.

During the launch, **Dr. S. Jaishankar** highlighted that the world is facing **growing conflicts and instability**, making the role of the **United Nations** more important than ever.

India reiterated its commitment to **dialogue, diplomacy, peaceful conflict resolution**, and representing the interests of the **Global South**.

340. Recently, the Union Cabinet approved the Mobile Phone Manufacturing Scheme (MPMS). What is the total outlay of the scheme?

A.₹42,500 crore

B.₹50,000 crore

C.₹62,500 crore

D.₹75,000 crore

E.₹82,500 crore

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The **Union Cabinet**, chaired by **Prime Minister Narendra Modi**, approved the **Mobile Phone Manufacturing Scheme (MPMS)** with a total outlay of **₹62,500 crore** to strengthen India's mobile phone manufacturing ecosystem.

The scheme aims to **boost domestic manufacturing**, **increase value addition**, **strengthen supply chains**, **promote Indian mobile brands**, and position **India as a global hub for mobile phone**

manufacturing under the **Make in India** initiative.

MPMS will be implemented for **five years**, from **FY 2026–27 to FY 2030–31**, and will provide **performance-linked incentives** to eligible manufacturers.

Detailed Explanation:

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The scheme aims to **boost domestic manufacturing**, **increase value addition**, **strengthen supply chains**, **promote Indian mobile brands**, and position **India as a global hub for mobile phone manufacturing** under the **Make in India** initiative.

MPMS will be implemented for **five years**, from **FY 2026–27 to FY 2030–31**, and will provide **performance-linked incentives** to eligible manufacturers.

The scheme seeks to enhance **mobile phone manufacturing capabilities**, promote **local production of key components**, reduce **import dependence**, encourage **product design and Research & Development (R&D)**, and build a **resilient electronics supply chain**.

Under the scheme, eligible manufacturers will receive **performance-linked incentives ranging from 2.25% to 5%** on qualified sales of **mobile phones manufactured in India**, based on category and performance criteria.

Manufacturers sourcing specified components domestically will be eligible for an **additional incentive of up to 1.5%**, encouraging localisation and deeper value addition.

341. Recently, the Government of India revised the Special Additional Excise Duty (SAED) on petroleum product exports. By how much was the SAED on diesel exports increased?

A.₹10.5 per litre

B.₹12.5 per litre

C.₹13.5 per litre

D.₹15.5 per litre

E.₹17.5 per litre

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The **Government of India** has revised the **Special Additional Excise Duty (SAED)**, commonly known as the **windfall tax**, on the export of petroleum products with effect from **16 July 2026**.

According to the **Ministry of Finance**, the revised rates will remain effective for the **fortnight beginning 16 July 2026** and will be reviewed in the next fortnightly revision.

The revised **SAED** rates are:

Diesel (Exports): Increased from **₹8.5/litre** to **₹15.5/litre**

Aviation Turbine Fuel (ATF) (Exports): Increased from **₹7.5/litre** to **₹14.5/litre**

Petrol (Exports): Reduced from **₹4/litre** to **₹2.5/litre**

Detailed Explanation:

The **Government of India** has revised the **Special Additional Excise Duty (SAED)**, commonly known as the **windfall tax**, on the export of petroleum products with effect from **16 July 2026**.

According to the **Ministry of Finance**, the revised rates will remain effective for the **fortnight beginning 16 July 2026** and will be reviewed in the next fortnightly revision.

The revised **SAED** rates are:

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Petrol (Exports): Reduced from **₹4/litre** to **₹2.5/litre**

Special Additional Excise Duty (SAED) is imposed on the export of petroleum products when **global crude oil prices rise sharply**, resulting in extraordinary profits for exporters.

The objective of the revised duty is to **ensure adequate domestic fuel availability**, **discourage excessive exports during periods of high international oil prices**, **limit windfall gains**, and **strengthen India's energy security**.

342. Recently, which metro rail system is set to introduce driverless train operations on its Green Line and Purple Line?

A.Delhi Metro

B.Bengaluru Metro

C.Chennai Metro

D.Kolkata Metro

E.Mumbai Metro

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

Kolkata Metro is set to introduce **driverless metro train operations** on the **Green Line** and **Purple Line**, marking a major milestone in India's urban public transport system.

The **Commissioner of Railway Safety (CRS)** has approved **driverless operations on the Green Line** after successfully completing safety inspections and trials.

With the launch, **Kolkata** will become one of the few Indian cities, after **Delhi** and **Bengaluru**, to operate **Grade of Automation 4 (GoA-4)** driverless metro services.

The first phase of driverless operations will cover the **Green Line (Howrah Maidan–Salt Lake Sector V)**, spanning **16.6 km** with **12 stations**.

The **Green Line** includes **India's first underwater metro tunnel beneath the Hooghly River**, connecting the western and eastern parts of Kolkata.

Detailed Explanation:

Kolkata Metro is set to introduce **driverless metro train operations** on the **Green Line** and **Purple Line**, marking a major milestone in India's urban public transport system.

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The first phase of driverless operations will cover the **Green Line (Howrah Maidan–Salt Lake Sector V)**, spanning **16.6 km** with **12 stations**.

The **Green Line** includes **India's first underwater metro tunnel beneath the Hooghly River**, connecting the western and eastern parts of Kolkata.

Driverless operations have also been planned for the **Purple Line**, further expanding Kolkata Metro's automated network.

The driverless trains use **Communication-Based Train Control (CBTC)** technology with **Grade of Automation 4 (GoA-4)**, enabling automatic **acceleration, braking, speed regulation, station stopping, door operation, and train movement** without a driver.

343. Recently, the Ministry of Heavy Industries (MHI) invited global bids to establish how much Advanced Chemistry Cell (ACC) battery manufacturing capacity under the PLI Scheme?

A.5 GWh

B.10 GWh

C.20 GWh

D.40 GWh

E.50 GWh

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The **Ministry of Heavy Industries (MHI)** has invited **global bids** to establish **10 GWh of Advanced Chemistry Cell (ACC) battery manufacturing capacity** under the **Production Linked Incentive (PLI) Scheme for ACC Batteries**.

The bidding marks the **final phase** of the **₹18,100 crore PLI Scheme**, aimed at creating a **robust domestic ACC battery manufacturing ecosystem** and reducing India's dependence on imported batteries.

Both domestic and global manufacturers are eligible to participate in the bidding process.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Ministry of Heavy Industries (MHI)** has invited **global bids** to establish **10 GWh of Advanced Chemistry Cell (ACC) battery manufacturing capacity** under the **Production Linked Incentive (PLI) Scheme for ACC Batteries**.

The bidding marks the **final phase** of the **₹18,100 crore PLI Scheme**, aimed at creating a **robust domestic ACC battery manufacturing ecosystem** and reducing India's dependence on imported batteries.

Both domestic and global manufacturers are eligible to participate in the bidding process.

The **Production Linked Incentive (PLI) Scheme for ACC Batteries** was approved by the **Union Cabinet in 2021** with:

Financial Outlay: ₹18,100 crore

Target Manufacturing Capacity: 50 GWh

Capacity Already Allocated: 40 GWh
Current Bidding Capacity: 10 GWh
The scheme aims to promote **domestic manufacturing of Advanced Chemistry Cell (ACC) batteries**, strengthen the battery value chain, support **clean energy adoption**, and enhance **India's energy security**.
Advanced Chemistry Cell (ACC) batteries are high-performance rechargeable batteries offering **higher energy density, faster charging, longer life, and improved safety** compared to conventional batteries.

344. Recently, the Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs (CCEA) approved the National Investment Policy for Urea-2026 (NIPU-2026). Which policy does NIPU-2026 replace?
A.National Fertilizer Policy, 2008
B.Urea Subsidy Policy, 2015
C.New Investment Policy (NIP)-2012
D.Nutrient Based Subsidy (NBS) Policy
E.National Chemical Policy, 2011
Answer: C
Short Explanation:
The **Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs (CCEA)**, chaired by **Prime Minister Narendra Modi**, approved the **National Investment Policy for Urea-2026 (NIPU-2026)** to promote **self-reliance in urea production** under the **Atmanirbhar Bharat** initiative.
NIPU-2026 has been introduced by the **Department of Fertilizers** to encourage investment in **new gas-based urea manufacturing plants** across the country.
The policy replaces the **New Investment Policy (NIP)-2012**, whose investment window closed in **October 2019**.
Detailed Explanation:
The **Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs (CCEA)**, chaired by **Prime Minister Narendra Modi**, approved the **National Investment Policy for Urea-2026 (NIPU-2026)** to promote **self-reliance in urea production** under the **Atmanirbhar Bharat** initiative.
NIPU-2026 has been introduced by the **Department of Fertilizers** to encourage investment in **new gas-based urea manufacturing plants** across the country.
The policy replaces the **New Investment Policy (NIP)-2012**, whose investment window closed in **October 2019**.
The policy aims to **increase domestic urea production**, **reduce dependence on imports**, **attract public and private investment**, improve **transparency in project economics**, and strengthen **India's fertilizer security**.
The policy focuses on establishing **energy-efficient and environment-friendly gas-based urea plants** using modern technologies.
A key feature of **NIPU-2026** is the **separation of fixed and variable costs**, ensuring **greater transparency, fair cost estimation, and better financial planning** for investors.

345. Recently, the 3rd India–European Union Trade and Technology Council (TTC) Meeting was held in which city?

A.Brussels, Belgium

B.Berlin, Germany

C.Paris, France

D.Rome, Italy

E.Vienna, Austria

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

India and the **European Union (EU)** held the **3rd India–European Union Trade and Technology Council (TTC) Meeting** in **Brussels, Belgium**, to deepen cooperation in **trade, technology, innovation, and resilient supply chains**.

During the meeting, both sides discussed expanding collaboration in **Artificial Intelligence (AI), semiconductors, electric vehicles (EVs), renewable energy technologies, digital technologies, high-performance computing, and secure digital infrastructure**.

The meeting also focused on building **trusted and resilient supply chains**, enhancing **bilateral trade and investment**, and promoting **economic resilience** amid global trade and technology disruptions.

Detailed Explanation:

India and the **European Union (EU)** held the **3rd India–European Union Trade and Technology Council (TTC) Meeting** in **Brussels, Belgium**, to deepen cooperation in **trade, technology, innovation, and resilient supply chains**.

During the meeting, both sides discussed expanding collaboration in **Artificial Intelligence (AI), semiconductors, electric vehicles (EVs), renewable energy technologies, digital technologies, high-performance computing, and secure digital infrastructure**.

The meeting also focused on building **trusted and resilient supply chains**, enhancing **bilateral trade and investment**, and promoting **economic resilience** amid global trade and technology disruptions.

External Affairs Minister Dr. S. Jaishankar emphasized that **trusted partnerships** have become increasingly important due to **global supply chain disruptions** and challenges in accessing advanced technologies.

India and the European Union agreed to strengthen cooperation in **emerging technologies**, **digital transformation**, and **innovation** to support a secure, sustainable, and modern global economy.

Under **clean energy and electric mobility**, discussions covered cooperation in **electric vehicles (EVs), battery technology, renewable energy, green hydrogen, energy efficiency, and sustainable mobility**.

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346. Recently, consider the following statements regarding Semicon 2.0:

1. **Semicon 2.0 has been approved with a total outlay of ₹1,27,500 crore.**
2. **The programme aims to strengthen semiconductor design, manufacturing, packaging, research, innovation, and talent development in India.**
3. **Semicon 2.0 is built around six strategic pillars.**

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

A.Only 1

B.Only 2 and 3

C.Only 1 and 3

D.All the above

E.Only 1 and 2

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The **Union Cabinet**, chaired by **Prime Minister Narendra Modi**, approved **Semicon 2.0**, India's next-generation semiconductor policy, with a total outlay of **₹1,27,500 crore**.

Semicon 2.0 aims to strengthen India's **semiconductor design, manufacturing, packaging, research, innovation, and talent development ecosystem**, while building a **resilient semiconductor supply chain** and promoting **technological self-reliance**.

Semicon 2.0 is built around **six strategic pillars**:

Strengthening semiconductor design

Developing semiconductor equipment, materials, and chemicals

Establishing additional semiconductor fabrication (Fab) facilities

Strengthening the Assembly, Testing, Marking and Packaging (ATMP) and Outsourced Semiconductor Assembly and Test (OSAT) ecosystem

Accelerating research and development (R&D)

Talent development and skill enhancement

Detailed Explanation:

The **Union Cabinet**, chaired by **Prime Minister Narendra Modi**, approved **Semicon 2.0**, India's next-generation semiconductor policy, with a total outlay of **₹1,27,500 crore**.

Semicon 2.0 aims to strengthen India's **semiconductor design, manufacturing, packaging, research, innovation, and talent development ecosystem**, while building a **resilient semiconductor supply chain** and promoting **technological self-reliance**.

The programme builds upon **Semicon 1.0** and seeks to establish a **comprehensive semiconductor ecosystem**, covering **chip design, fabrication, packaging, materials, equipment, research, and skilled workforce development**.

The initiative aims to attract global semiconductor manufacturers, enhance the capabilities of Indian chip design companies, promote domestic semiconductor production, reduce dependence on imports, and position India as a trusted global semiconductor hub.

Semiconductors are critical for industries such as **mobile devices, Artificial Intelligence (AI), electric vehicles, telecommunications,**

defence, medical devices, industrial electronics, and automation.

Semicon 2.0 is built around **six strategic pillars**:

Strengthening semiconductor design

Developing semiconductor equipment, materials, and chemicals

Establishing additional semiconductor fabrication (Fab) facilities

Strengthening the Assembly, Testing, Marking and Packaging (ATMP) and Outsourced Semiconductor Assembly and Test (OSAT) ecosystem

Accelerating research and development (R&D)

Talent development and skill enhancement

347. Recently, the United Nations (UN) released the first UN-commissioned scientific assessment of Artificial Intelligence (AI). What is the name of this report?

A.Global AI Governance Report 2026

B.World Artificial Intelligence Outlook 2026

C.Preliminary Report of the Independent International Scientific Panel on Artificial Intelligence (AI)

D.International AI Development Report 2026

E.Global AI Risk Assessment Report

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The **United Nations (UN)** released the **Preliminary Report of the Independent International Scientific Panel on Artificial Intelligence (AI)**, the **first UN-commissioned scientific assessment** of Artificial Intelligence (AI).

The report warns that **AI development is advancing faster than global governance** and urges governments to **strengthen AI regulatory frameworks** and **international cooperation**.

The report was prepared by a **40-member Independent International Scientific Panel on AI**, comprising scientists and experts from **all five UN regions**.

The panel is **co-chaired by Yoshua Bengio** (Turing Award laureate) and **Maria Ressa** (Nobel Peace Prize laureate).

Detailed Explanation:

The **United Nations (UN)** released the **Preliminary Report of the Independent International Scientific Panel on Artificial Intelligence (AI)**, the **first UN-commissioned scientific assessment** of Artificial Intelligence (AI).

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The panel is **co-chaired by Yoshua Bengio** (Turing Award laureate) and **Maria Ressa** (Nobel Peace Prize laureate).

The objective of the report is to provide an **independent scientific assessment** of **AI**

opportunities, risks, and governance to support **evidence-based policymaking** worldwide.

The report evaluates the **impact of Artificial Intelligence (AI)** across science, healthcare, education, agriculture, economy, security, environment, human rights, democracy, governance, and **AI reliability**.

348. Recently, who has been appointed as the new Secretary of the Ministry of Earth Sciences (MoES)?

A.M. Ravichandran

B.Dr. Srinivasa Kumar Tummala

C.Rajesh Gokhale

D.Ajay Kumar Sood

E.V. Narayanan

Answer: B

Government of India (GoI) appointed **Dr. Srinivasa Kumar Tummala** as the new **Secretary, Ministry of Earth Sciences (MoES)**.

The appointment was approved by the **Appointments Committee of the Cabinet (ACC)** for a **tenure of 2 years** from the date of assuming office or until further orders, whichever is earlier.

Before this appointment, **Dr. Srinivasa Kumar Tummala** served as the **Head of the Indian Ocean Tsunami Warning and Mitigation System (IOTWMS) Secretariat** under the **UNESCO Intergovernmental Oceanographic Commission (UNESCO-IOC)** in **Perth, Australia**.

349. Recently, who has been appointed as the new Prime Minister of Ukraine?

A.Denys Shmyhal

B.Yulia Svyrydenko

C.Sergii Koretskyi

D.Oleksii Reznikov

E.Ruslan Stefanchuk

Answer: C

Ukraine's Parliament (Verkhovna Rada) approved the appointment of **Sergii Koretskyi** as the **Prime Minister (PM)** of Ukraine, succeeding **Yulia Svyrydenko**.

Sergii Koretskyi was serving as the **Chief Executive Officer (CEO)** of **Naftogaz of Ukraine**, the country's state-owned energy company, before becoming Prime Minister.

He secured **289 votes** in the **450-member Verkhovna Rada**, obtaining parliamentary approval for his appointment as Prime Minister.

350. Recently, which Indian Navy warship is set to be commissioned on 22 July 2026 as the second Mahe-class Anti-Submarine Warfare Shallow Water Craft (ASW-SWC)?

A.INS Arnala

B.INS Malvan

C.INS Surat

D.INS Nilgiri

E.INS Kavaratti

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The Indian Navy will commission **INS Malvan** on **22 July 2026**, the **second Mahe-**

class Anti-Submarine Warfare Shallow Water Craft (ASW-SWC).

The commissioning ceremony will be presided over by **Air Chief Marshal A.P. Singh, Chief of the Air Staff**, in the presence of **Vice Admiral Sanjay Vatsayan**, Flag Officer Commanding-in-Chief (FOC-in-C), **Western Naval Command**.

INS Malvan has been built by **Cochin Shipyard Limited (CSL), Kochi**, showcasing India's growing capability in **indigenous naval shipbuilding**.

Detailed Explanation:

The Indian Navy will commission **INS Malvan** on **22 July 2026**, the **second Mahe-class Anti-Submarine Warfare Shallow Water Craft (ASW-SWC)**.

The commissioning ceremony will be presided over by **Air Chief Marshal A.P. Singh, Chief of the Air Staff**, in the presence of **Vice Admiral Sanjay Vatsayan**, Flag Officer Commanding-in-Chief (FOC-in-C), **Western Naval Command**.

INS Malvan has been built by **Cochin Shipyard Limited (CSL), Kochi**, showcasing India's growing capability in **indigenous naval shipbuilding**.

The warship has **over 80% indigenous content**, reflecting the success of the **Aatmanirbhar Bharat** initiative in the defence sector.

INS Malvan represents India's advancement in **warship design, construction, and systems integration**, strengthening the country's **self-reliance in naval defence**.

The **Mahe-class ASW-SWC** is specially designed for **Anti-Submarine Warfare (ASW) operations in shallow waters**, enhancing the Indian Navy's **coastal defence capabilities**.

351. Recently, researchers from IACS and SNBNCBS developed a new porous organic anode material for high-performance lithium-ion batteries. What is the material called?

A.Graphene Oxide Framework (GOF)

B.Metal Organic Framework (MOF)

C.Covalent Organic Framework (COF)

D.Lithium Iron Phosphate (LFP)

E.Solid Electrolyte Interface (SEI)

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

Researchers from the Indian Association for the Cultivation of Science (IACS) and **S. N. Bose National Centre for Basic Sciences (SNBNCBS)**, both under the **Department of Science and Technology (DST)**, developed a new **porous organic anode material** for **high-performance lithium-ion batteries**.

The newly developed material is a **Covalent Organic Framework (COF)**, a porous organic material designed to improve **energy storage capacity**, **fast charging**, and **battery durability**.

The research team was led by **Dr. Urmimala Maitra (IACS)** and **Dr. Pradip Pachfule (SNBNCBS)**.

Detailed Explanation:

Researchers from the Indian Association for the Cultivation of Science (IACS) and **S. N.**

Bose National Centre for Basic Sciences (SNBNCBS), both under the **Department of Science and Technology (DST)**, developed a new **porous organic anode material** for **high-performance lithium-ion batteries**.

The newly developed material is a **Covalent Organic Framework (COF)**, a porous organic material designed to improve **energy storage capacity**, **fast charging**, and **battery durability**.

The research team was led by **Dr. Urmimala Maitra (IACS)** and **Dr. Pradip Pachfule (SNBNCBS)**.

The **COF-based anode material** enables lithium ions to move more efficiently, resulting in **faster charging**, **improved ion transport**, **enhanced charge storage**, and **greater structural stability**.

Using the new COF material, the lithium-ion battery achieved **80% charging in just over one minute** while maintaining excellent performance over **repeated charging and discharging cycles**.

The material also demonstrated the ability to **store sodium ions**, creating opportunities for the development of **low-cost sodium-ion batteries** in the future.

352. Recently, which Kerala-based private spacetech startup successfully launched the satellite KOYO aboard SpaceX's Transporter-17 mission?

A.Skyroot Aerospace

B.Agnikul Cosmos

C.Pixxel

D.HEX20

E.Bellatrix Aerospace

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

Kerala-based private spacetech startup **HEX20** successfully launched its second satellite, **KOYO (Kinetic Optical Yaw Observer)** aboard **SpaceX's Transporter-17 mission** from **Vandenberg Space Force Base, California, USA**.

KOYO successfully entered **Earth orbit** as a **multi-payload technology demonstration platform**, carrying **81 payloads** for in-orbit technology validation and commissioning of international payloads.

The primary objective of the **KOYO Mission** is to qualify and validate **space hardware** before operational deployment through real-time in-orbit testing.

The satellite carries payloads from several international partners, including **Aegiverse (Taiwan)**, **Amplified Space (USA)**, **National Central University (Taiwan)**, and **ET Space Power**.

Detailed Explanation:

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platform, carrying **81 payloads** for in-orbit technology validation and commissioning of international payloads.

The primary objective of the **KOYO Mission** is to qualify and validate **space hardware** before operational deployment through real-time in-orbit testing.

The satellite carries payloads from several international partners, including **Aegiverse (Taiwan)**, **Amplified Space (USA)**, **National Central University (Taiwan)**, and **ET Space Power**.

The mission successfully validated several **indigenously developed HEX20 technologies**, including a new **solar panel deployment mechanism**, **deployable monopole antenna**, **advanced hinge system**, and the **AX CubeSat platform**.

KOYO is designed to operate for **18–24 months**, during which it will continue technology validation, payload testing, and space system performance evaluation.

During the **commissioning phase**, the satellite successfully decoded over **1,500 beacon packets** and executed more than **75 ground commands**, confirming its stable orbital performance

353. Recently, CSIR–Central Road Research Institute (CSIR-CRRI) is celebrating its Platinum Jubilee during which period?

A.16 July 2026 to 16 July 2027

B.15 August 2026 to 15 August 2027

C.1 January 2026 to 31 December 2026

D.1 April 2026 to 31 March 2027

E.26 January 2026 to 26 January 2027

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

CSIR–Central Road Research Institute (CSIR-CRRI) commenced its **Platinum Jubilee Celebrations** from **16 July 2026 to 16 July 2027**, marking **75 years of scientific excellence** in road infrastructure research.

As part of the celebrations, CSIR-CRRI launched the **first phase of nationwide implementation** of its advanced indigenous road infrastructure technologies across **16 towns/locations** in India.

The initiative aims to **demonstrate, commercialise, and scale up** innovative road construction and maintenance technologies through collaboration with industry and implementing agencies.

Detailed Explanation:

CSIR–Central Road Research Institute (CSIR-CRRI) commenced its **Platinum Jubilee Celebrations** from **16 July 2026 to 16 July 2027**, marking **75 years of scientific excellence** in road infrastructure research.

As part of the celebrations, CSIR-CRRI launched the **first phase of nationwide implementation** of its advanced indigenous road infrastructure technologies across **16 towns/locations** in India.

The initiative aims to **demonstrate, commercialise, and scale up** innovative road construction and maintenance technologies

through collaboration with industry and implementing agencies.

The celebrations were inaugurated by **Dr. Jitendra Singh, Union Minister of State (Independent Charge) for Science & Technology and Earth Sciences**.

During the event, Dr. Jitendra Singh reviewed indigenous innovations in **road engineering**, **pavement technologies**, **Intelligent Transportation Systems (ITS)**, **road safety**, and **sustainable construction materials**.

The Minister launched the **Automatic Modified Mix Seal Surfacing (MSS+) Smart Mix Pro Mixing Plant**, designed for the large-scale implementation of the indigenous **Modified Mix Seal Surfacing (MSS+)** road technology.

354. Recently, Tata Consultancy Services (TCS) signed a multi-million, multi-year agreement with which company to transform its global network operations using Artificial Intelligence (AI)?

A.ABB

B.Siemens

C.Schneider Electric

D.Hitachi Energy

E.Honeywell

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

Tata Consultancy Services (TCS) signed a **multi-million, multi-year agreement** with **ABB** to transform ABB's global network operations using **Artificial Intelligence (AI)**.

The agreement marks the next phase of the **20-year partnership** between TCS and ABB, expanding TCS's role to deliver **end-to-end AI-driven global network operations**.

The main objective is to transform ABB's global network into a **standardised, centrally managed, AI-driven digital infrastructure** through an integrated **Network-as-a-Service (NaaS)** model.

Detailed Explanation:

Tata Consultancy Services (TCS) signed a **multi-million, multi-year agreement** with **ABB** to transform ABB's global network operations using **Artificial Intelligence (AI)**.

The agreement marks the next phase of the **20-year partnership** between TCS and ABB, expanding TCS's role to deliver **end-to-end AI-driven global network operations**.

The main objective is to transform ABB's global network into a **standardised, centrally managed, AI-driven digital infrastructure** through an integrated **Network-as-a-Service (NaaS)** model.

Under the agreement, TCS will manage end-to-end global network operations using **Service Integration and Management (SIAM)**, a **Global Network Operations Centre (GNOC)**, **advanced cybersecurity**, and modernised **Local Area Network (LAN)**, **Wide Area Network (WAN)**, and **Software-Defined Wide Area Network (SD-WAN)** systems.

The **AI-powered network transformation** will improve **user experience**, **operational efficiency**, **security**, **regulatory compliance**, **scalability**, and **real-time AI-based network monitoring**.

355. Recently, the Ministry of Food Processing Industries (MoFPI), in collaboration with NIFTEM-Thanjavur, launched a pilot Short-Term Skill Training Programme (STSTP) on which certificate programme?

A.Food Safety Supervisor (NSQF Level 4)
B.Assistant Baking Technician (NSQF Level 3)
C.Dairy Processing Technician (NSQF Level 5)
D.Food Packaging Technician (NSQF Level 4)
E.Bakery Production Manager (NSQF Level 5)
Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The **Ministry of Food Processing Industries (MoFPI)**, in collaboration with the **National Institute of Food Technology Entrepreneurship and Management (NIFTEM), Thanjavur**, launched a pilot **Short-Term Skill Training Programme (STSTP)** on the **Assistant Baking Technician (NSQF Level 3) Certificate Programme** at the **ITC – Integrated Consumer Goods Manufacturing and Logistics (ITC-ICML) facility** in **Trichy, Tamil Nadu**.

The programme was inaugurated by **Prof. V. Palanimuthu, Director, NIFTEM-Thanjavur**, in the presence of **Surjeet Singh Roria, General Manager (GM) & Head, ITC-ICML**, and **Padmanabhan T., Senior HR Manager, ITC-ICML**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Ministry of Food Processing Industries (MoFPI)**, in collaboration with the **National Institute of Food Technology Entrepreneurship and Management (NIFTEM), Thanjavur**, launched a pilot **Short-Term Skill Training Programme (STSTP)** on the **Assistant Baking Technician (NSQF Level 3) Certificate Programme** at the **ITC – Integrated Consumer Goods Manufacturing and Logistics (ITC-ICML) facility** in **Trichy, Tamil Nadu**.

The programme was inaugurated by **Prof. V. Palanimuthu, Director, NIFTEM-Thanjavur**, in the presence of **Surjeet Singh Roria, General Manager (GM) & Head, ITC-ICML**, and **Padmanabhan T., Senior HR Manager, ITC-ICML**.

The objective of the STSTP is to **upskill youth in food processing, manufacturing, and allied sectors**, thereby **enhancing employability** and **promoting entrepreneurship** in the food processing industry.

The programme offers **nationally recognised certifications** aligned with the **National Skills Qualifications Framework (NSQF)**, ensuring industry-relevant skill development.

The first batch comprises **18 trainees**, who will undergo **Industry-Integrated Training (IIT)** with practical on-site training at ITC-ICML from **7 July to 20 August 2026**.

356. Recently, researchers from ATREE discovered two new species of rare solitary bees during the Siang Expedition in which Indian state?

A.Assam

B.Sikkim

C.Nagaland

D.Meghalaya

E.Arunachal Pradesh

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

Researchers from the Ashoka Trust for Research in Ecology and the Environment (ATREE), Bengaluru (Karnataka) discovered **two new species of rare solitary bees** during the **Siang Expedition** in the **Siang Valley, Arunachal Pradesh (AR)**.

The newly discovered bee species are **Elaphropoda triangulata** and **Habropoda adi**, and the findings were published in the **European Journal of Taxonomy**.

Detailed Explanation:

Researchers from the Ashoka Trust for Research in Ecology and the Environment (ATREE), Bengaluru (Karnataka) discovered **two new species of rare solitary bees** during the **Siang Expedition** in the **Siang Valley, Arunachal Pradesh (AR)**.

The newly discovered bee species are **Elaphropoda triangulata** and **Habropoda adi**, and the findings were published in the **European Journal of Taxonomy**.

The discovery highlights the **rich biodiversity and ecological importance** of the **Eastern Himalayas**, one of the world's **biodiversity hotspots**.

Elaphropoda triangulata was named after its **distinctive triangular abdominal markings**, while **Habropoda adi** was named in honour of the **indigenous Adi community** of Arunachal Pradesh.

Both newly discovered species are **solitary ground-nesting bees**, which build **individual nests** instead of living in colonies like honeybees.

357. Recently, Union Minister Arjun Ram Meghwal launched which portal to provide digital access to Hindi legal literature?

A.e-Nyay Portal

B.e-VSP (Vidhi Sahitya Prakashan) Portal

C.e-Law India Portal

D.Nyaya Setu Portal

E.Legal India Digital Portal

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Union Minister Arjun Ram Meghwal launched the **e-VSP (Vidhi Sahitya Prakashan) Portal**, developed by the **Legislative Department**, to provide digital access to **Hindi legal literature**.

The **e-VSP Portal** offers **Supreme Court and High Court judgments**, **legal journals**, reference books, **Acts**, **legal publications**, and

other Hindi legal resources on a single digital platform.

Detailed Explanation:

Union Minister Arjun Ram Meghwal launched the **e-VSP (Vidhi Sahitya Prakashan) Portal**, developed by the **Legislative Department**, to provide digital access to **Hindi legal literature**.

The **e-VSP Portal** offers **Supreme Court and High Court judgments**, **legal journals**, reference books, **Acts**, **legal publications**, and other Hindi legal resources on a single digital platform.

The portal aims to make **legal knowledge** easily accessible to **lawyers, judges, law students, teachers, researchers, and citizens** worldwide, thereby promoting **inclusive access to justice**.

The e-VSP Portal has been jointly developed by the **Legislative Department**, **Official Languages Wing**, **Vidhi Sahitya Prakashan (VSP)**, and the **National Informatics Centre (NIC)**.

358. Recently, Nelson Mandela International Day 2026 was observed globally on which date?

A.11 July 2026

B.15 July 2026

C.18 July 2026

D.20 July 2026

E.25 July 2026

Answer: C

Nelson Mandela International Day 2026 was observed globally on **18 July 2026** to honour the life, legacy, and humanitarian contributions of **Nelson Rolihlahla Mandela**, the former **President of South Africa**.

The day, also known as **Mandela Day**, encourages people across the world to **serve their communities** and promote **peace, equality, justice, and human dignity**.

The **first Nelson Mandela International Day** was observed on **18 July 2009** in **New York**.

359. According to the news, NDS-OM (Negotiated Dealing System–Order Matching) was launched by the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) in which year?

A.2002

B.2003

C.2004

D.2005

E.2010

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

NDS-OM (Negotiated Dealing System–Order Matching) is an **anonymous, screen-based electronic order-matching platform** for secondary market trading in **Government Securities (G-Secs)**.

Launched: **2005** by the **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)**.

Operated by: **Clearcorp Dealing Systems (India) Ltd.**, with trade settlement guaranteed by the **Clearing Corporation of India Limited (CCIL)**.

Tradable Instruments: **Central Government Securities (G-Secs)**, **State Development Loans (SDLs)**, and **Treasury Bills (T-Bills)**.

Detailed Explanation:

NDS-OM (Negotiated Dealing System–Order Matching) is an **anonymous, screen-based electronic order-matching platform** for secondary market trading in **Government Securities (G-Secs)**.

Launched: **2005** by the **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)**.

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Tradable Instruments: **Central Government Securities (G-Secs)**, **State Development Loans (SDLs)**, and **Treasury Bills (T-Bills)**.

The platform also provides a **Request for Quote (RFQ)** segment, enabling members to **negotiate bilateral trades electronically**.

Trade Settlement under NDS-OM follows the **T+1 settlement cycle** and is guaranteed by CCIL, ensuring secure and efficient settlement.

Types of NDS-OM Members

Direct Members: Have **current accounts with the RBI** and can **directly settle trades** on NDS-OM.

Indirect Members: Do not have RBI current accounts and **settle transactions through Direct Members**; most Foreign Institutional Investors (FIIs)/FPIs access the platform through this route.

360. Recently, India is the world's _____ largest mobile phone manufacturer.

A.First

B.Second

C.Third

D.Fourth

E.Fifth

Answer: B

Indian mobile phone brands investing in **product design, innovation, and Research & Development (R&D)** may receive an **additional incentive of up to 3%** on eligible sales.

The scheme builds upon the success of the **Production Linked Incentive (PLI) Scheme for Large Scale Electronics Manufacturing**, which helped attract **global smartphone manufacturers**, increase **mobile phone exports**, integrate India into **global electronics supply chains**, and generate large-scale employment.

India is currently the **second-largest mobile phone manufacturer in the world**, with around **99% of mobile phones sold in the domestic market being manufactured in India**.

361. As per the RBI's final prudential norms, what is a Specified Non-Financial Asset (SNFA)?

A.A financial security acquired by banks for investment purposes

B.An immovable asset acquired by a lender in full or partial settlement of its claims against an NPA borrower

C.A movable asset pledged as collateral for a performing loan

D.A government-owned asset transferred to banks during recapitalisation

E.A digital asset acquired under insolvency proceedings

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Reserve Bank of India (RBI) has issued final prudential norms for **Banks, Small Finance Banks (SFBs), and Non-Banking Financial Companies (NBFCs)** regarding **Specified Non-Financial Assets (SNFAs)** acquired while resolving stressed loans or **Non-Performing Assets (NPAs)**.

A **Specified Non-Financial Asset (SNFA)** is an **immovable asset (such as property)** acquired by a lender in full or partial settlement of its claims against a borrower, and can be acquired only when the lender's exposure is classified as a **Non-Performing Asset (NPA)**.

SNFAs may be acquired against **full or partial extinguishment** of a lender's exposure on a **non-recourse basis**.

Detailed Explanation:

Reserve Bank of India (RBI) has issued final prudential norms for **Banks, Small Finance Banks (SFBs), and Non-Banking Financial Companies (NBFCs)** regarding **Specified Non-Financial Assets (SNFAs)** acquired while resolving stressed loans or **Non-Performing Assets (NPAs)**.

A **Specified Non-Financial Asset (SNFA)** is an **immovable asset (such as property)** acquired by a lender in full or partial settlement of its claims against a borrower, and can be acquired only when the lender's exposure is classified as a **Non-Performing Asset (NPA)**.

SNFAs may be acquired against **full or partial extinguishment** of a lender's exposure on a **non-recourse basis**.

If an SNFA is acquired through **partial settlement** of a loan, the remaining outstanding loan will be treated as a **restructured loan** and will be subject to the prudential norms applicable to restructured accounts.

Under the new framework, Banks, SFBs, and NBFCs **cannot sell an SNFA back to the defaulting borrower or its related parties**, and this restriction will continue even if the asset ceases to be classified as an SNFA.

All Banks, SFBs, and NBFCs must formulate **Board-approved policies** governing the acquisition, valuation, management, and disposal of SNFAs.

362. As per the FATF's updated list released after the June 2026 Plenary Meeting, which of the following countries was added to the Grey List (Jurisdictions under Increased Monitoring)?

A.Iran

B.Myanmar

C.Iraq

D.Algeria

E.North Korea

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The Financial Action Task Force (FATF) released its updated **High-Risk Jurisdictions** and **Jurisdictions under Increased Monitoring (Grey List)** following the **FATF Plenary Meeting** held from **17–19 June 2026**.

Under the **Jurisdictions under Increased Monitoring (Grey List)**, **Algeria and Namibia** have been **removed**, while **Bosnia and Herzegovina** and **Iraq** have been **added** after the June 2026 FATF Plenary review.

Detailed Explanation:

The Financial Action Task Force (FATF) released its updated **High-Risk Jurisdictions** and **Jurisdictions under Increased Monitoring (Grey List)** following the **FATF Plenary Meeting** held from **17–19 June 2026**.

Under the **High-Risk Jurisdictions subject to a Call for Action (Black List)**, **North Korea (DPRK)**, **Iran**, and **Myanmar** continue to remain on the list.

Myanmar, which was added to the High-Risk Jurisdictions list in **October 2022**, continues to remain under **enhanced due diligence** requirements as per the latest FATF review.

FATF has advised all member countries to apply **enhanced due diligence** for transactions involving North Korea, Iran, and Myanmar, while ensuring that **humanitarian assistance**, legitimate **Non-Profit Organisation (NPO)** activities, and **remittances** are not disrupted.

Under the **Jurisdictions under Increased Monitoring (Grey List)**, **Algeria and Namibia** have been **removed**, while **Bosnia and Herzegovina** and **Iraq** have been **added** after the June 2026 FATF Plenary review.

363. As per the recent news, Punjab National Bank (PNB) signed an MoU with the Digital India BHASHINI Division (DIBD) to promote multilingual AI solutions under which initiative?

A.BHASHINI for Seva/Sanchalan

B.Digital Bharat Mission

C.AI for Financial Inclusion Programme

D.National Language Computing Mission

E.BharatNet Digital Banking Initiative

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

Digital India BHASHINI Division (DIBD), under the **Digital India Corporation (DIC)**, **Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY)**, signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** with **Punjab National Bank (PNB)** to develop **multilingual Artificial Intelligence (AI) solutions** for inclusive banking

under the **BHASHINI for Seva/Sanchalan** initiative.

The MoU was signed by **Amitabh Nag, Chief Executive Officer (CEO), DIBD**, and **Atish Kumar Rout, Chief General Manager (CGM-Digital)**, Digital Banking Transformation Division, PNB.

Detailed Explanation:

Digital India BHASHINI Division (DIBD), under the **Digital India Corporation (DIC)**, **Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY)**, signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** with **Punjab National Bank (PNB)** to develop **multilingual Artificial Intelligence (AI) solutions** for inclusive banking under the **BHASHINI for Seva/Sanchalan** initiative.

The MoU was signed by **Amitabh Nag, Chief Executive Officer (CEO), DIBD**, and **Atish Kumar Rout, Chief General Manager (CGM-Digital)**, Digital Banking Transformation Division, PNB.

The objective of the partnership is to **integrate BHASHINI's language translation Application Programming Interfaces (APIs)** and reference applications into **PNB's digital banking platform**, enabling **language-inclusive banking services**.

Under the MoU, PNB will integrate **BHASHINI's multilingual AI tools and platforms**, including **Udyat, Mitra, AppMitra, Pravakta, and Bhashadaan**, into its digital banking ecosystem.

The collaboration will enable customers to access banking information, digital platforms, and financial services in their **preferred Indian languages**, thereby improving customer experience, **financial inclusion**, and **AI-driven banking innovation**.

364. As per the recent news, which two digital platforms were launched by the Uttar Pradesh Government on World Youth Skills Day 2026 to modernise vocational training and improve skill development services?

A.Kaushal Setu and Kaushal Sarathi

B.Skill India and e-Shram

C.NCS and DigiLocker

D.PMKVY Connect and Skill Portal

E.Udyam Mitra and Rozgar Setu

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

Uttar Pradesh Government launched two digital platforms, **Kaushal Setu** and **Kaushal Sarathi**, during the celebration of **World Youth Skills Day 2026** to modernise vocational training and improve skill development services in the state.

The platforms aim to bring **vocational training online**, enhance **transparency in skill development programmes**, and strengthen cooperation between **industries, training institutions, and job seekers**.

The two portals have been introduced to improve the functioning of the **Uttar Pradesh Skill Development Mission (UPSDM)**.

Detailed Explanation:

Uttar Pradesh Government launched two digital platforms, **Kaushal Setu** and **Kaushal Sarathi**, during the celebration of **World Youth Skills Day 2026** to modernise vocational training and improve skill development services in the state.

The platforms aim to bring **vocational training online**, enhance **transparency in skill development programmes**, and strengthen cooperation between **industries, training institutions, and job seekers**.

The two portals have been introduced to improve the functioning of the **Uttar Pradesh Skill Development Mission (UPSDM)**.

Kaushal Setu is the official digital portal of the **Uttar Pradesh Skill Development Mission (UPSDM)** that allows training centres and institutions to register and apply online.

The platform replaces manual procedures with a **paperless digital system**, enabling training partners to submit applications and documents electronically.

Kaushal Setu will improve efficiency through **online registration, digital document submission, transparent empanelment of training partners, and faster administrative processing**.

Kaushal Sarathi is a digital platform designed for **students and job seekers**, providing information about **training centres, available courses, and skill development partners** across Uttar Pradesh.

365. As per the recent news, the draft Karnataka Apartment (Ownership and Management) Bill, 2025 (KAOMA) aims to align apartment regulations with which Act?

A.Consumer Protection Act, 2019

B.Companies Act, 2013

C.Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code, 2016

D.Transfer of Property Act, 1882

E.Real Estate (Regulation and Development) Act (RERA), 2016

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

Karnataka Government has released the draft **Karnataka Apartment (Ownership and Management) Bill, 2025 (KAOMA)** to modernise apartment management, strengthen the rights of apartment owners, and resolve long- standing disputes in the state's growing real estate sector.

The proposed Bill aims to introduce **joint ownership of land and common facilities**, create a legal framework for **redevelopment of old apartment buildings**, and align apartment regulations with the **Real Estate (Regulation and Development) Act (RERA), 2016**.

Detailed Explanation:

Karnataka Government has released the draft **Karnataka Apartment (Ownership and Management) Bill, 2025 (KAOMA)** to modernise apartment management, strengthen the rights of apartment owners, and resolve long- standing disputes in the state's growing real estate sector.

The proposed Bill aims to introduce **joint ownership of land and common facilities**, create a legal framework for **redevelopment of old apartment buildings**, and align apartment regulations with the **Real Estate (Regulation and Development) Act (RERA), 2016**.

The Karnataka Government has invited **public feedback until 6 August 2026** and plans to introduce the Bill during the upcoming **Monsoon Session of the Karnataka Legislature**.

The need for a new apartment law has emerged due to rapid urbanisation, especially in **Bengaluru**, which has witnessed a significant increase in apartment-based housing.

366. As per the recent news, the foundation stone for a 150-bed Modern Critical Care Block at PGIMER, Chandigarh was laid under which scheme?

A.Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission (ABDM)

B.National Health Mission (NHM)

C.Pradhan Mantri Ayushman Bharat Health Infrastructure Mission (PM-ABHIM)

D.PM Swasthya Suraksha Yojana (PMSSY)

E.National Medical Commission Mission

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

Prime Minister Narendra Modi inaugurated the **Advanced Mother and Child Centre** and the **Advanced Neurosciences Centre** at the **Post Graduate Institute of Medical Education and Research (PGIMER), Chandigarh**.

Prime Minister also laid the **foundation stone for a 150-bed Modern Critical Care Block** under the **Pradhan Mantri Ayushman Bharat Health Infrastructure Mission (PM-ABHIM)**.

Detailed Explanation:

Prime Minister Narendra Modi inaugurated the **Advanced Mother and Child Centre** and the **Advanced Neurosciences Centre** at the **Post Graduate Institute of Medical Education and Research (PGIMER), Chandigarh**.

Prime Minister also laid the **foundation stone for a 150-bed Modern Critical Care Block** under the **Pradhan Mantri Ayushman Bharat Health Infrastructure Mission (PM-ABHIM)**.

These healthcare projects aim to improve access to **advanced medical facilities**, strengthen **emergency healthcare preparedness**, and promote **medical education and research** in **Northern India**.

The event was attended by the **Governor of Punjab**, **Union Minister for Health and Family Welfare J. P. Nadda**, **Union Minister for Railways, Information and Broadcasting Ashwini Vaishnaw**, and **Chandigarh Member of Parliament Manish Tewari**.

The **Advanced Mother and Child Centre** has been established to provide **comprehensive tertiary healthcare services** for women and children.

367. As per the recent news, the National e-Vidhan Application (NeVA) is a Mission Mode Project under which programme?

A.Smart Cities Mission

B.Digital India Programme

C.National e-Governance Plan

D.PM Gati Shakti

E.BharatNet Programme

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Maharashtra Government is set to implement the **National e-Vidhan Application (NeVA)** programme, a **Mission Mode Project** under the **Digital India Programme** initiated by the **Ministry of Parliamentary Affairs, Government of India**. The implementation of **NeVA** follows the vision of **"One Nation One Application"** and aims to digitise the functioning of the **Maharashtra Legislative Assembly** and **Maharashtra Legislative Council**.

Detailed Explanation:

Maharashtra Government is set to implement the **National e-Vidhan Application (NeVA)** programme, a **Mission Mode Project** under the **Digital India Programme** initiated by the **Ministry of Parliamentary Affairs, Government of India**. The implementation of **NeVA** follows the vision of **"One Nation One Application"** and aims to digitise the functioning of the **Maharashtra Legislative Assembly** and **Maharashtra Legislative Council**.

The initiative will improve **efficiency, transparency, accessibility, and public participation** in legislative processes by reducing dependence on paper-based systems.

A high-level meeting was held at **Vidhan Bhawan, Mumbai** to accelerate the implementation of **National e-Vidhan Application (NeVA)** in Maharashtra.

The meeting was attended by officials from:

Ministry of Parliamentary Affairs, Government of India

Department of Parliamentary Affairs, Government of Maharashtra

Secretariat of Maharashtra Legislature

368. As per the recent news, NITI Aayog's Investment Friendliness Index (IFI) evaluates States and Union Territories based on how many key pillars?

A.6

B.7

C.9

D.8

E.10

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

NITI Aayog has introduced the **Investment Friendliness Index (IFI)** to assess the readiness of **36 States and Union Territories (UTs)** in attracting and sustaining investments based on governance, economic, and infrastructure parameters.

The first edition of the index evaluated States and Union Territories using **84 indicators** grouped under **eight key pillars**.

Detailed Explanation:

NITI Aayog has introduced the **Investment Friendliness Index (IFI)** to assess the readiness of **36 States and Union Territories (UTs)** in attracting and sustaining investments based on governance, economic, and infrastructure parameters.

The index aims to provide policymakers with insights into the **strengths and weaknesses of different States and Union Territories** and support reforms to improve the **investment climate and ease of doing business**.

The **Investment Friendliness Index (IFI)** is not intended as a competition among States but as a **benchmarking mechanism** to provide data-based feedback and encourage policy improvements.

The first edition of the index evaluated States and Union Territories using **84 indicators** grouped under **eight key pillars**.

The eight pillars of the **Investment Friendliness Index (IFI)** are:

Infrastructure

Business Climate

Resources

Government Policy

Regulatory Ease

Financial Health

Institutional Environment

Environmental Resilience

369. Which of the following statements is correct regarding the recent NITI Aayog Investment Friendliness Index (IFI)?

1. **Gujarat emerged as the best-performing large State with a score of 56.6 out of 100.**
2. **Uttarakhand was the top-performing Hilly and North Eastern State.**
3. **Goa emerged as the top-performing City State and Union Territory.**

A.Only 1 and 2

B.Only 2 and 3

C.Only 1 and 3

D.All the above

E.None of the above

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

Gujarat emerged as the **best-performing large State**, securing a score of **56.6 out of 100** among **17 large States**.

Among **Hilly and North Eastern States**, the top performers included:

Uttarakhand – 47.5

Among **City States and Union Territories**, **Goa** emerged as the top performer with a score of **53.1**, followed by **Delhi and Chandigarh**.

Detailed Explanation:

Gujarat emerged as the **best-performing large State**, securing a score of **56.6 out of 100** among **17 large States**.

The top-performing large States in the Investment Friendliness Index are:

Gujarat – 56.6

Maharashtra – Around 53

Tamil Nadu – Around 53

Odisha – 52.4

Gujarat's strong performance was attributed to its **infrastructure development, reliable power supply, and efficient port facilities**, making it one of the most attractive investment destinations.

Among **Hilly and North Eastern States**, the top performers included:

Uttarakhand – 47.5

Assam

Himachal Pradesh

Among **City States and Union Territories**, **Goa** emerged as the top performer with a score of **53.1**, followed by **Delhi and Chandigarh**.

During the launch of the report, **NITI Aayog Vice Chairman Ashok Lahiri** stated that the index is not designed to create competition among States but to provide **evidence-based feedback for reforms**.

He highlighted that while the Central Government frames broad policies, actual investment takes place at the **State level**, making State-level reforms essential for achieving the vision of **Viksit Bharat**.

370. As per the 72nd National Film Awards, which of the following statements is INCORRECT?

Article 370 won the Best Feature Film award.

Yami Gautam won the Best Actress award for Article 370.

Captain Miller won the Best Feature Film Providing Wholesome Entertainment award.

A.Only 1

B.Only 2

C.Only 3

D.All the above

E.None of the above

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

Major Winners:

Best Feature Film: Article 370

Best Actor: Kartik Aaryan (*Chandu Champion*) and **Mammootty** (*Bramayugam*)

Best Actress: Yami Gautam (*Article 370*)

Best Director: Rajkumar Periasamy (*Amaran*)

Best Feature Film Providing Wholesome Entertainment: Kalki 2898 AD

Best Film Promoting National & Social Values: Captain Miller

Detailed Explanation:

The **72nd National Film Awards** were announced in **New Delhi** to honour the best Indian films certified by the **Central Board of Film Certification (CBFC)** between **1 January 2024 and 31 December 2024**.

The awards were selected by a **jury headed by Malayalam filmmaker Jayaraj**.

Major Winners:

Best Feature Film: Article 370

Best Actor: Kartik Aaryan (*Chandu Champion*) and **Mammootty** (*Bramayugam*)

Best Actress: Yami Gautam (*Article 370*)

Best Director: Rajkumar Periasamy (*Amaran*)

Best Feature Film Providing Wholesome Entertainment: Kalki 2898 AD

Best Film Promoting National & Social Values: Captain Miller

Special Mention (Feature Films):

Dhanush (*Captain Miller*)

Suren G (*Meiyazhagan*)

371. As per the recent news, who has assumed charge as the Director (Commercial) of NMDC Limited?

A.Amitava Mukherjee

B.Vivek Nishant Nath

C.Arun Kumar Shukla

D.R. K. Gupta

E.Vinay Kumar

Answer: B

Shri Vivek Nishant Nath has assumed charge as **Director (Commercial)** of **NMDC Limited**, India's largest iron ore producer, following his appointment by the **Ministry of Steel, Government of India (GoI)**.

He has been appointed as Director (Commercial) on the NMDC Board for a **5-year tenure** from the date of assuming charge, or until further orders, whichever is earlier.

The appointment order was issued by the Ministry of Steel on **14 July 2026**, and NMDC officially informed the stock exchanges on **15 July 2026**.

372. As per the recent news, who was sworn in as the 20th Prime Minister of Lithuania?

A.Gitanas Nausėda

B.Inga Ruginienė

C.Gabrielius Landsbergis

D.Saulius Skvernelis

E.Mindaugas Sinkevičius

Answer: E

Mindaugas Sinkevičius, leader of the **Lithuanian Social Democratic Party (LSDP)**, was sworn in as the **20th Prime Minister (PM) of Lithuania**.

He assumed office after the **Lithuanian Parliament (Seimas)** approved the **government manifesto** presented by the **LSDP-led coalition**.

Mindaugas Sinkevičius succeeded **Inga Ruginienė**, who **stepped down on 14 July 2026**.

In the **141-member Seimas**, the government manifesto was approved with **72 votes in favour**, 29 votes against, and 4 abstentions.

373. As per the recent news, who has been appointed as the Brand Ambassador of Policybazaar?

A.Shah Rukh Khan

B.Amitabh Bachchan

C.Aamir Khan

D.Akshay Kumar

E.Anil Kapoor

Answer: B

Policybazaar, India's leading online insurance marketplace, appointed **Amitabh Bachchan** as its **Brand Ambassador** to lead the nationwide

awareness campaign **"Parivaar Sabse Pehle" (Family Comes First)**.

The **"Parivaar Sabse Pehle"** campaign has been developed by **MagicCircle Communications** to promote awareness about **health insurance** and **term insurance** across India.

The campaign aims to encourage Indian families to purchase **health and term insurance** without delaying important **financial protection decisions**.

374. As per the recent news, which company emerged as the preferred bidder to acquire a 60.72% stake in IDBI Bank?

A.Fairfax Financial Holdings Limited

B.Brookfield Asset Management

C.Blackstone Inc.

D.Temasek Holdings

E.Bain Capital

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

Canada-based **Fairfax Financial Holdings Limited (Fairfax)** emerged as the **preferred bidder** to acquire a **60.72% stake** in **IDBI Bank Limited** from the **Government of India (GoI)** and **Life Insurance Corporation of India (LIC)**.

The proposed acquisition is valued at **Rs. 52,932 crore (approximately USD 5.5 billion)**, making it one of the largest banking acquisition deals in India.

If approved, the transaction will become the **largest foreign investment in an Indian bank**, subject to regulatory approvals.

Detailed Explanation:

Canada-based **Fairfax Financial Holdings Limited (Fairfax)** emerged as the **preferred bidder** to acquire a **60.72% stake** in **IDBI Bank Limited** from the **Government of India (GoI)** and **Life Insurance Corporation of India (LIC)**.

The proposed acquisition is valued at **Rs. 52,932 crore (approximately USD 5.5 billion)**, making it one of the largest banking acquisition deals in India.

If approved, the transaction will become the **largest foreign investment in an Indian bank**, subject to regulatory approvals.

The acquisition requires approvals from the **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)**, **Competition Commission of India (CCI)**, and a **SEBI-mandated open offer** to public shareholders.

Under the stake divestment plan, the **Government of India will sell 30.48%**, while **LIC will divest 30.24%**, resulting in a **combined stake sale of 60.72%** in IDBI Bank.

Before the transaction, the **GoI held 45.48%** and **LIC held 49.24%** equity in IDBI Bank.

375. As per the recent news, India's first Artificial Intelligence (AI)-integrated vertical university campus was inaugurated at which institution?

A.VIT University, Vellore

B.SRM Institute of Science and Technology

C.Amrita Vishwa Vidyapeetham

D.Anna University, Chennai

E.VELS Institute of Science, Technology, & Advanced Studies (VISTAS)

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

Padma Shri Sridhar Vembu, Chief Scientist and Co-founder of **Zoho Corporation Pvt. Ltd.**, inaugurated the **Thiruvanmiyur campus** of **VELS Institute of Science, Technology, & Advanced Studies (VISTAS)** in **Chennai, Tamil Nadu**.

The newly inaugurated VISTAS Thiruvanmiyur campus is regarded as **India's first Artificial Intelligence (AI)-integrated vertical university campus**.

The inauguration ceremony was presided over by **Dr. Ishari K. Ganesh, Founder and Chancellor of VISTAS**, along with **Dr. Preetha Ganesh, Vice-President (VP), VELS Group of Institutions**.

Detailed Explanation:

Padma Shri Sridhar Vembu, Chief Scientist and Co-founder of **Zoho Corporation Pvt. Ltd.**, inaugurated the **Thiruvanmiyur campus** of **VELS Institute of Science, Technology, & Advanced Studies (VISTAS)** in **Chennai, Tamil Nadu**.

The newly inaugurated VISTAS Thiruvanmiyur campus is regarded as **India's first Artificial Intelligence (AI)-integrated vertical university campus**.

The inauguration ceremony was presided over by **Dr. Ishari K. Ganesh, Founder and Chancellor of VISTAS**, along with **Dr. Preetha Ganesh, Vice-President (VP), VELS Group of Institutions**.

The campus houses **Industry-Academia Centres of Excellence (CoEs)** established in collaboration with **Intel Unnati, Tata Consultancy Services (TCS) iON, Microsoft, and Oracle Academy**.

During the event, VISTAS signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** with **Aspin Holding LLC Group** and **MH Cockpit**.

The MoU aims to establish a **Flying School in the United Arab Emirates (UAE)** to strengthen **aviation education** and **pilot training**.

The partnership will promote **faculty exchange**, **student internships**, **skill development**, **research collaboration**, and **international career opportunities** in the aviation sector.

376. As per the recent news, pi-labs entered into a strategic partnership with which company to develop secure, scalable, and mission-ready AI solutions for India?

A.Microsoft Azure

B.Amazon Web Services (AWS)

C.Google Cloud

D.Oracle Cloud

E.IBM Cloud

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

pi-labs, an Indian **Artificial Intelligence (AI) and deepfake detection company**, entered

into a **strategic partnership with Google Cloud** to develop secure, scalable, and mission-ready AI solutions for India.

The collaboration aims to strengthen **regional security operations**, **digital governance**, public sector organisations, and **critical enterprise infrastructure** through AI-powered technologies.

Detailed Explanation:

pi-labs, an Indian **Artificial Intelligence (AI) and deepfake detection company**, entered into a **strategic partnership with Google Cloud** to develop secure, scalable, and mission-ready AI solutions for India.

The collaboration aims to strengthen **regional security operations**, **digital governance**, public sector organisations, and **critical enterprise infrastructure** through AI-powered technologies.

Under the partnership, pi-labs will combine its indigenous AI capabilities with the **Google Distributed Cloud Tactical Appliance** to meet the evolving requirements of government institutions and critical infrastructure.

Google Cloud will provide the **secure, scalable, and resilient cloud infrastructure** required to host advanced AI workloads, ensuring reliable and mission-critical AI deployment.

377. As per the recent news, consider the following statements regarding Bharat Tex 2026:

Bharat Tex 2026 is guided by the 5F Vision – Farm → Fibre → Factory → Fashion → Foreign.

Indie Haat 2026 is being organised at the National Crafts Museum, New Delhi alongside Bharat Tex 2026.

Indie Haat 2026 features 48 artisans and weavers along with 12 design-led brands.

A.Only 1 and 2

B.Only 2 and 3

C.Only 1 and 3

D.All the above

E.None of the above

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

Bharat Tex 2026 showcases India's textile ecosystem by bringing together manufacturers, handloom cooperatives, traditional artisans, technology startups, and global buyers under one platform.

The event is guided by the **5F Vision – Farm → Fibre → Factory → Fashion → Foreign**, highlighting India's complete textile value chain from raw material production to global exports.

Running alongside Bharat Tex, **Indie Haat 2026** is being organised at the **National Crafts Museum, New Delhi**, showcasing India's rich handloom and handicraft heritage.

Indie Haat 2026 features **48 artisans and weavers** along with **12 design-led brands**, providing a contemporary platform for promoting regional craftsmanship.

Detailed Explanation:

Bharat Tex 2026 showcases India's textile ecosystem by bringing together manufacturers,

handloom cooperatives, traditional artisans, technology startups, and global buyers under one platform.

The event is guided by the **5F Vision – Farm → Fibre → Factory → Fashion → Foreign**, highlighting India's complete textile value chain from raw material production to global exports.

Indian enterprises are exploring international markets, while overseas companies are assessing investment and business opportunities in India's textile sector.

Bharat Tex 2026 places traditional Indian art forms at the centre of global attention, including **Tikuli Art of Bihar**, renowned for its vibrant colours and intricate enamel work.

Running alongside Bharat Tex, **Indie Haat 2026** is being organised at the **National Crafts Museum, New Delhi**, showcasing India's rich handloom and handicraft heritage.

Indie Haat 2026 features **48 artisans and weavers** along with **12 design-led brands**, providing a contemporary platform for promoting regional craftsmanship.

378. As per the recent news, the M72/AS01E vaccine candidate is being developed to prevent which disease?

A.Pulmonary Tuberculosis (TB)

B.Dengue

C.Malaria

D.Hepatitis B

E.Japanese Encephalitis

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

Serum Institute of India (SII) has entered into an agreement with the **Gates Medical Research Institute (Gates MRI)** to establish manufacturing capacity for the **M72/AS01E Tuberculosis (TB) vaccine candidate**.

Under the partnership, **Serum Institute of India** will manufacture and supply the **M72/AS01E Tuberculosis vaccine candidate** on a large scale, subject to the successful completion of **Phase III clinical trials** and necessary **regulatory approvals**.

The **M72/AS01E vaccine candidate** is one of the most advanced vaccine candidates for preventing **pulmonary Tuberculosis (TB)** among **adults and adolescents**.

Detailed Explanation:

Serum Institute of India (SII) has entered into an agreement with the **Gates Medical Research Institute (Gates MRI)** to establish manufacturing capacity for the **M72/AS01E Tuberculosis (TB) vaccine candidate**.

Under the partnership, **Serum Institute of India** will manufacture and supply the **M72/AS01E Tuberculosis vaccine candidate** on a large scale, subject to the successful completion of **Phase III clinical trials** and necessary **regulatory approvals**.

The agreement aims to strengthen global efforts against **Tuberculosis (TB)**, one of the world's deadliest infectious diseases, and enhance India's position as a leading global centre for **vaccine manufacturing**.

The partnership focuses on:

Establishing **large-scale vaccine manufacturing capacity**

Making the vaccine **affordable and accessible**

Supplying vaccines to **Tuberculosis high-burden countries**

Supporting global efforts towards **Tuberculosis elimination**

Improving vaccine access for **Low and Middle-Income Countries (LMICs)**

The **M72/AS01E vaccine candidate** is one of the most advanced vaccine candidates for preventing **pulmonary Tuberculosis (TB)** among **adults and adolescents**.

379. As per the recent news, Moozhikkal Pankajakshi, who passed away recently, was renowned for which traditional art form?

A.Kathakali

B.Mohiniyattam

C.Koodiyattam

D.Theyyam

E.Nokkuvidya Pavakkali

Answer: E

Padma Shri awardee Moozhikkal Pankajakshi, the renowned **Nokkuvidya Pavakkali exponent**, passed away at the age of 90 in **Koothattukulam (Monippally), Kottayam district, Kerala**.

Born on **14 March 1936** at Urulikunnath, Pala, Kottayam district, Kerala, she was one of the foremost practitioners of Kerala's traditional **Nokkuvidya Pavakkali (puppetry)** art form.

She was conferred the **Padma Shri**, India's fourth-highest civilian award, in **2020** for her outstanding contribution to the field of Arts.

Moozhikkal Pankajakshi began learning Nokkuvidya Pavakkali from her mother, **Paappiyamma**, at the age of **11** and practised the rare folk art for over **eight decades**.

380. As per the recent news, 20 July is observed as which of the following?

A.World Chess Day and International Moon Day

B.World Youth Skills Day and International Moon Day

C.World Chess Day and World Population Day

D.International Moon Day and World Environment Day

E.World Chess Day and International Yoga Day

Answer: A

World Chess Day is observed every year on **20 July** to commemorate the establishment of the **International Chess Federation (FIDE)** in **1924** at **Paris, France**.

Chess is believed to have originated in **India during the 5th century** and was known as **"Chaturanga"**, an ancient board game that later evolved into modern chess.

International Moon Day is observed every year on **20 July** to commemorate the anniversary of the **first human landing on the Moon** during the **Apollo 11 mission** and to promote **international cooperation in space exploration**.

International Moon Day 2026 marks the **57th anniversary of the Apollo 11 Moon landing**, which took place on **20 July 1969**.

On **20 July 1969**, American astronauts **Neil Armstrong** and **Edwin "Buzz" Aldrin** became the first humans to land on the Moon, while **Michael Collins** orbited the Moon as part of the **Apollo 11 mission**.

381. According to the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) Financial Stability Report (FSR), which category of banks recorded the highest loan write-off ratio during FY2025–26?

A.Public Sector Banks (PSBs) – 24.3%

B.Private Sector Banks – 49.7%

C.Foreign Banks – 39.6%

D.Small Finance Banks – 33.2%

E.Regional Rural Banks – 28.5%

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

According to the **Reserve Bank of India (RBI) Financial Stability Report (FSR)**, **Private Sector Banks** wrote off **49.7%** of their **Non-Performing Assets (NPAs)** in **FY2025–26**, compared to **24.3%** by **Public Sector Banks (PSBs)**.

Public Sector Banks (PSBs) held the largest share of bad loans, accounting for **63.2%** of the total NPAs in the **Indian banking system**.

The **Indian banking sector** wrote off approximately **₹1.28 lakh crore** of bad loans during **FY2025–26**, with an overall **write-off ratio of 33.2%**.

Foreign Banks recorded a **write-off ratio of 39.6%** during **FY2025–26**.

Private Sector Banks relied more on **loan write-offs** and **provisioning buffers** to improve their balance sheets due to higher defaults in **unsecured retail loans**, **microfinance**, **personal loans**, **credit cards**, and **unsecured business loans**.

Detailed Explanation:

According to the **Reserve Bank of India (RBI) Financial Stability Report (FSR)**, **Private Sector Banks** wrote off **49.7%** of their **Non-Performing Assets (NPAs)** in **FY2025–26**, compared to **24.3%** by **Public Sector Banks (PSBs)**.

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Foreign Banks recorded a **write-off ratio of 39.6%** during **FY2025–26**.

Private Sector Banks relied more on **loan write-offs** and **provisioning buffers** to improve their balance sheets due to higher defaults in **unsecured retail loans**, **microfinance**, **personal loans**, **credit cards**, and **unsecured business loans**.

Public Sector Banks (PSBs) focused primarily on the **long-term recovery of stressed assets** instead of aggressive write-offs, despite holding the highest share of NPAs.

The **write-off and recovery measures** significantly improved the banking sector's asset quality, reducing the **Gross Non-Performing Assets (GNPA) ratio** to a multi-decade low of **1.8% in March 2026**, compared to **7.3% in March 2021**.

During the period **FY2020–21 to FY2024–25**, **Public Sector Banks** wrote off approximately **₹5.81 lakh crore** of bad loans, while **Private Sector Banks** wrote off around **₹3.09 lakh crore**.

382. Recently, the Board of ICICI Prudential Life Insurance approved a proposal to rename the company, subject to IRDAI approval. What is the proposed new name?

A.ICICI Insurance Limited

B.ICICI Life Insurance Limited

C.ICICI General Insurance Limited

D.ICICI Prudential Financial Services Limited

E.ICICI Assurance Limited

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The Board of **ICICI Prudential Life Insurance** approved a proposal to rename the company as **ICICI Life Insurance Limited**, subject to approval from the **Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (IRDAI)**.

The proposed name change follows **Prudential Corporation Holdings'** decision to acquire a **75% stake** in **Bharti Life Insurance**, requiring it to be reclassified from a **Promoter** to an **Investor** in ICICI Prudential Life Insurance.

The renaming aims to align the company's corporate identity with its **revised promoter structure** after Prudential Corporation Holdings reduces its shareholding from about **22% to below 10%**.

Detailed Explanation:

The Board of **ICICI Prudential Life Insurance** approved a proposal to rename the company as **ICICI Life Insurance Limited**, subject to approval from the **Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (IRDAI)**.

The proposed name change follows **Prudential Corporation Holdings'** decision to acquire a **75% stake** in **Bharti Life Insurance**, requiring it to be reclassified from a **Promoter** to an **Investor** in ICICI Prudential Life Insurance.

The renaming aims to align the company's corporate identity with its **revised promoter structure** after Prudential Corporation Holdings reduces its shareholding from about **22% to below 10%**.

Prudential Corporation Holdings announced the acquisition of a **75% stake** in **Bharti Life Insurance** from **Bharti Enterprises** for **₹3,500 crore**, subject to regulatory approvals.

As part of the reclassification process, **Prudential Corporation Holdings** has agreed to **reduce its stake below 10%**, abstain from voting on special resolutions (except where its rights are affected), and **withdraw its nominee director** from the board until the process is completed.

383. Recently, Shabdalok (Museum of Words), seen in the news, is India's first immersive language museum located at which place?

A.National Museum, New Delhi

B.Salar Jung Museum, Hyderabad

C.National Library, Kolkata

D.Indian Museum, Kolkata

E.Victoria Memorial, Kolkata

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

Shabdalok (Museum of Words), India's **first immersive language museum**, was inaugurated by **Union Home Minister Amit Shah** at the **National Library, Kolkata, West Bengal**.

The museum has been established by the **Ministry of Culture, Government of India** to preserve and showcase India's rich linguistic heritage through modern technology.

Shabdalok aims to educate visitors about the evolution of Indian languages, from **oral traditions to written literature**, through interactive and immersive experiences.

Detailed Explanation:

Shabdalok (Museum of Words), India's **first immersive language museum**, was inaugurated by **Union Home Minister Amit Shah** at the **National Library, Kolkata, West Bengal**.

The museum has been established by the **Ministry of Culture, Government of India** to preserve and showcase India's rich linguistic heritage through modern technology.

Shabdalok aims to educate visitors about the evolution of Indian languages, from **oral traditions to written literature**, through interactive and immersive experiences.

Unlike traditional museums, Shabdalok uses advanced technologies such as:

Artificial Intelligence (AI)

Augmented Reality (AR)

Virtual Reality (VR)

Holograms

Gesture recognition

Interactive displays

Audio-visual storytelling

The museum is located inside **Belvedere House** at the **National Library campus, Kolkata, West Bengal**. **Belvedere House** has been associated with the National Library since **1948**.

384. Recently, who has been appointed as the Chairperson of the National Commission for Minorities (NCM)?

A.Harjit Singh Grewal

B.Iqbal Singh Lalpura

C.Munawari Begum

D.Glenn E. Souza Ticlo

E.Kiren Rijiju

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

Harjit Singh Grewal was appointed as the **Chairperson** of the **National Commission for Minorities (NCM)**, with the appointment notified by the **Ministry of Minority Affairs**.

The Chairperson's post had remained vacant since **April 2025** after the completion of the tenure of **Iqbal Singh Lalpura**.

Harjit Singh Grewal will serve a **3-year tenure** from the date of assuming office or until further orders.

Detailed Explanation:

Harjit Singh Grewal was appointed as the **Chairperson** of the **National Commission for Minorities (NCM)**, with the appointment notified by the **Ministry of Minority Affairs**.

The Chairperson's post had remained vacant since **April 2025** after the completion of the tenure of **Iqbal Singh Lalpura**.

Harjit Singh Grewal will serve a **3-year tenure** from the date of assuming office or until further orders.

Along with him, **Munawari Begum** was appointed as the **Vice-Chairperson**, and **Glenn E. Souza Ticlo** was appointed as a **Member** of the NCM.

The **National Commission for Minorities (NCM)** is a **Statutory Body** constituted under the **National Commission for Minorities Act, 1992**.

The NCM functions at the **Union Government level** and addresses matters concerning **notified minority communities** in India.

385. Recently, the Indian Air Force (IAF) is participating in Exercise Pitch Black 2026, hosted by which country's air force?

A.United States Air Force

B.Royal Canadian Air Force

C.Royal Air Force of the United Kingdom

D.French Air and Space Force

E.Royal Australian Air Force

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

The Indian Air Force (IAF) is participating in **Exercise Pitch Black 2026**, the **Royal Australian Air Force (RAAF)'s** premier **biennial multinational air combat exercise**, scheduled from **20 July to 7 August 2026** at **RAAF Base Darwin, Northern Australia**.

Exercise Pitch Black derives its name from its focus on **night flying** over the vast unpopulated regions of **Northern Australia** and has a **45-year history** as one of the world's leading **multinational air warfare exercises**.

Detailed Explanation:

The Indian Air Force (IAF) is participating in **Exercise Pitch Black 2026**, the **Royal Australian Air Force (RAAF)'s** premier **biennial multinational air combat exercise**, scheduled from **20 July to 7 August 2026** at **RAAF Base Darwin, Northern Australia**.

Exercise Pitch Black derives its name from its focus on **night flying** over the vast unpopulated regions of **Northern Australia** and has a **45-year history** as one of the world's leading **multinational air warfare exercises**.

The **2026 edition** features one of the **largest-ever multinational contingents**, bringing together military personnel for **Large Force**

Employment (LFE)

missions and **multinational air combat operations**.

The **IAF contingent** comprises **pilots, engineers, technicians, controllers**, and **subject-matter experts**, demonstrating India's advanced **operational capabilities**.

The **IAF** is deploying **Rafale multirole fighter aircraft**, supported by **C-17 Globemaster III strategic transport aircraft** and **IL-78 Air-to-Air Refuelling aircraft** in **combat support roles**.

386. Recently, which Indian bank is expected to participate as the only Indian lender in the global consortium financing Sun Pharmaceutical Industries' acquisition of Organon & Co.?

A.Punjab National Bank

B.Bank of Baroda

C.Canara Bank

D.State Bank of India

E.Union Bank of India

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

State Bank of India (SBI) plans to join a consortium of global lenders to finance **Sun Pharmaceutical Industries'** acquisition of US-based **Organon & Co.** in an overseas deal valued at **US$11.75–12 billion**, subject to board approval.

SBI is expected to commit up to **US$1 billion**, becoming the **only Indian bank** participating in the syndicated loan alongside global lenders such as **Citigroup**, **JPMorgan Chase**, and **Mitsubishi UFJ Financial Group (MUFG)**.

Detailed Explanation:

State Bank of India (SBI) plans to join a consortium of global lenders to finance **Sun Pharmaceutical Industries'** acquisition of US-based **Organon & Co.** in an overseas deal valued at **US$11.75–12 billion**, subject to board approval.

SBI is expected to commit up to **US$1 billion**, becoming the **only Indian bank** participating in the syndicated loan alongside global lenders such as **Citigroup**, **JPMorgan Chase**, and **Mitsubishi UFJ Financial Group (MUFG)**.

Around **US$10 billion** of the acquisition cost will be **financed through debt**, while **Sun Pharma** will contribute approximately **US$1.75 billion as equity**.

The transaction is among the first major acquisition financing deals involving a **Public Sector Bank (PSB)** after the **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** permitted domestic banks in **February 2026** to finance corporate takeovers.

The proposed acquisition will significantly strengthen **Sun Pharma's global footprint**, positioning it among the **Top 25 pharmaceutical companies** in the world.

Following the acquisition, **Sun Pharmaceutical Industries** is also expected to become the **7th-largest biosimilars company** globally.

387. Recently, what is the name of the mission under which India's first privately

developed orbital-class launch vehicle, Vikram-1, was successfully launched?

A.Mission Gaganyaan

B.Mission Aagaman

C.Mission Antriksh

D.Mission Udaan

E.Mission Prarambh

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Skyroot Aerospace Private Limited, a **Hyderabad (Telangana)-based** private spacetech company, successfully launched **Vikram-1**, **India's first privately developed orbital-class launch vehicle**, under **Mission Aagaman (Arrival)** from **Satish Dhawan Space Centre (SDSC-SHAR), Sriharikota, Andhra Pradesh**.

With this mission, **India** became the **3rd country** after the **United States (USA)** and **China** to achieve **private orbital launch capability**, following the **Indian Space Policy, 2023**.

Detailed Explanation:

Skyroot Aerospace Private Limited, a **Hyderabad (Telangana)-based** private spacetech company, successfully launched **Vikram-1**, **India's first privately developed orbital-class launch vehicle**, under **Mission Aagaman (Arrival)** from **Satish Dhawan Space Centre (SDSC-SHAR), Sriharikota, Andhra Pradesh**.

With this mission, **India** became the **3rd country** after the **United States (USA)** and **China** to achieve **private orbital launch capability**, following the **Indian Space Policy, 2023**.

Skyroot Aerospace was founded in **2018** and previously created history by launching **Vikram-S**, **India's first private suborbital rocket**, in **November 2022**.

Mission Aagaman marked **India's entry** into the **private orbital launch era** and a major milestone in expanding the country's **commercial space ecosystem**.

Vikram-1 is a **four-stage**, **22-metre (seven-storey) tall**, **1.7-metre diameter** orbital launch vehicle built using an **all-carbon composite structure** for lightweight and high-performance operations.

Vikram-1 successfully injected all payloads into a **450-km Low Earth Orbit (LEO)** at an inclination of **60°**, achieving a successful **maiden orbital launch**.

The rocket has a **payload capacity** of up to **350 kg** to **Low Earth Orbit (LEO)** and completed its maiden mission in approximately **15.46–17 minutes**, covering **14 flight phases**

388. Recently, which organisation granted technical approval to Reliance Jio to deploy a Low Earth Orbit (LEO) satellite constellation of around 1,600 satellites?

A.Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO)

B.Department of Telecommunications (DoT)

C.Indian National Space Promotion and Authorisation Centre (IN-SPACe)

D.Telecom Regulatory Authority of India (TRAI)

E.International Telecommunication Union (ITU)

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

Reliance Jio Infocomm Limited (Jio), the telecom arm of **Reliance Industries Limited (RIL)**, received technical approval from the **Indian National Space Promotion and Authorisation Centre (IN-SPACe)** to deploy a **Low Earth Orbit (LEO) satellite constellation** of around **1,600 satellites**.

The proposal was evaluated in consultation with the **Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO)** and the **Wireless Planning & Coordination (WPC) Wing** of the **Department of Telecommunications (DoT)** under the **Ministry of Communications**.

Detailed Explanation:

Reliance Jio Infocomm Limited (Jio), the telecom arm of **Reliance Industries Limited (RIL)**, received technical approval from the **Indian National Space Promotion and Authorisation Centre (IN-SPACe)** to deploy a **Low Earth Orbit (LEO) satellite constellation** of around **1,600 satellites**.

The proposal was evaluated in consultation with the **Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO)** and the **Wireless Planning & Coordination (WPC) Wing** of the **Department of Telecommunications (DoT)** under the **Ministry of Communications**.

The approval enables **Reliance Jio** to move forward with plans to establish **India's first indigenous satellite broadband constellation**.

Following the clearance, **Jio** will apply for **global orbital slots** through the **International Telecommunication Union (ITU)**, the international body responsible for regulating satellite frequencies and orbital locations.

The proposed satellite network will have a total capacity of **4.5–5 Terabits Per Second (Tbps)**, making it one of the **highest-capacity satellite broadband constellations** planned in India.

389. Recently, India's first-ever geothermal wells have been commissioned at which location?

A.Puga Valley, Ladakh

B.Tawang, Arunachal Pradesh

C.Kutch, Gujarat

D.Munnar, Kerala

E.Spiti Valley, Himachal Pradesh

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

India commissioned its **first-ever geothermal wells** at **Puga Valley, Ladakh**, marking a major milestone in the country's **renewable energy sector**.

The project was inaugurated by **Lieutenant Governor V.K. Saxena** at **Puga Valley, Ladakh**, located at an altitude of **over 14,000 feet**.

Two geothermal wells, each drilled to a depth of **1,000 metres**, have been successfully commissioned, making them the **deepest geothermal wells in India**.

Detailed Explanation:

India commissioned its **first-ever geothermal wells** at **Puga Valley, Ladakh**, marking a major

milestone in the country's **renewable energy sector**.

The project was inaugurated by **Lieutenant Governor V.K. Saxena** at **Puga Valley, Ladakh**, located at an altitude of **over 14,000 feet**.

Two geothermal wells, each drilled to a depth of **1,000 metres**, have been successfully commissioned, making them the **deepest geothermal wells in India**.

The wells were developed by the **ONGC Energy Centre** as part of India's efforts to harness **geothermal energy** for **clean and sustainable power generation**.

The **first well** reached its target depth of **1,000 metres** on **22 May 2026**, while the **second well** was spudded on **3 June 2026** and completed on **8 July 2026**.

A maximum temperature of **135°C** was recorded at a depth of **400 metres**, with further testing underway to evaluate **deeper reservoir temperatures** and **geothermal potential**

390. Recently, the White Rabbit Technology-based Indian Standard Time (IST) Distribution Demonstration Network was launched under which initiative?

A.Digital India Mission

B.One Nation, One Time

C.National Time Grid Mission

D.BharatNet Programme

E.India Stack Initiative

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Union Minister Pralhad Joshi (**Ministry of Consumer Affairs, Food & Public Distribution (MoCAF&PD)** and **Ministry of New and Renewable Energy (MNRE)**) inaugurated the **White Rabbit Technology-based Indian Standard Time (IST) Distribution Demonstration Network** at the **Regional Reference Standards Laboratory (RRSL), Jakkur, Bengaluru, Karnataka**.

The initiative has been launched under the vision of **"One Nation, One Time"** to establish a uniform, highly precise, secure, and indigenous **Indian Standard Time (IST)** network, reducing India's dependence on **foreign GPS-based time sources** and strengthening **digital sovereignty**.

Detailed Explanation:

Union Minister Pralhad Joshi (**Ministry of Consumer Affairs, Food & Public Distribution (MoCAF&PD)** and **Ministry of New and Renewable Energy (MNRE)**) inaugurated the **White Rabbit Technology-based Indian Standard Time (IST) Distribution Demonstration Network** at the **Regional Reference Standards Laboratory (RRSL), Jakkur, Bengaluru, Karnataka**.

The initiative has been launched under the vision of **"One Nation, One Time"** to establish a uniform, highly precise, secure, and indigenous **Indian Standard Time (IST)** network, reducing India's dependence on **foreign GPS-based time sources** and strengthening **digital sovereignty**.

The **Demonstration Network** enables the secure dissemination of **UTC (NPLI)-traceable Indian Standard Time (IST)** using **Precision Time Protocol (PTP)-based White Rabbit Technology**.

White Rabbit Technology is an Ethernet-based precision time synchronisation protocol that combines **Precision Time Protocol (PTP)** with **Synchronous Ethernet (SyncE)** to provide **sub-nanosecond accuracy** over **fibre-optic networks**.

The indigenous **IST distribution system** provides highly accurate, secure, resilient, and reliable time synchronisation for **critical national infrastructure**.

391. Recently, Captain Aman Johri successfully completed a microgravity research flight under which project?

A.Project Gaganyaan
B.Project Astra Farm
C.Project Antriksh Krishi
D.Project Space Harvest
E.Project AgriSat

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Captain Aman Johri, an **Indian Analog Astronaut**, successfully completed a **microgravity research flight** under **Project Astra Farm**, marking a major milestone in **India's space biotechnology** and **sustainable space food systems**.

The mission focused on studying **Maharashtra-grown onions and potatoes**, which were flown aboard a specially designed **passive microgravity payload**.

The research was conducted in collaboration with the **National Research Council Canada (NRC-CNRC)** to analyse the behaviour of agricultural crops under **microgravity conditions**.

Detailed Explanation:

Captain Aman Johri, an **Indian Analog Astronaut**, successfully completed a **microgravity research flight** under **Project Astra Farm**, marking a major milestone in **India's space biotechnology** and **sustainable space food systems**.

The mission focused on studying **Maharashtra-grown onions and potatoes**, which were flown aboard a specially designed **passive microgravity payload**.

The research was conducted in collaboration with the **National Research Council Canada (NRC-CNRC)** to analyse the behaviour of agricultural crops under **microgravity conditions**.

The microgravity experiment exposed **plant tissues and cells** to **reduced-gravity conditions** to understand their **biological and structural responses**.

Project Astra Farm is among **India's first initiatives** integrating **space agriculture**, **food technology**, and **crop resilience** for

supporting **future human space missions** and **long-term food security**.
The findings will help scientists understand how **plant tissues and cellular structures** adapt to microgravity, contributing to the development of **space farming technologies**.

392. Recently, CSIR–Indian Institute of Chemical Technology (CSIR-IICT) developed India's first indigenous process technology for manufacturing which next-generation green refrigerant?

A.HFC-134a
B.HCFC-22
C.HFO-1234yf
D.Ammonia (R-717)
E.Carbon Dioxide (R-744)

Answer: C

Short Explanation:
CSIR–Indian Institute of Chemical Technology (CSIR-IICT), Hyderabad has developed India's first indigenous process technology for manufacturing **Hydrofluoroolefin-1234yf (HFO-1234yf)**, a next-generation **green refrigerant** for refrigeration and air-conditioning systems.
HFO-1234yf is designed to replace **Hydrofluorocarbons (HFCs)** because it has **Zero Ozone Depletion Potential (ODP)**, **Very Low Global Warming Potential (GWP)**, and a short atmospheric lifetime of about **11 days**.
In comparison, **Hydrofluorocarbons (HFCs)** have an atmospheric lifetime of around **13.8 years**, making **HFO-1234yf** a more **environmentally sustainable refrigerant**.

Detailed Explanation:
CSIR–Indian Institute of Chemical Technology (CSIR-IICT), Hyderabad has developed India's first indigenous process technology for manufacturing **Hydrofluoroolefin-1234yf (HFO-1234yf)**, a next-generation **green refrigerant** for refrigeration and air-conditioning systems.
HFO-1234yf is designed to replace **Hydrofluorocarbons (HFCs)** because it has **Zero Ozone Depletion Potential (ODP)**, **Very Low Global Warming Potential (GWP)**, and a short atmospheric lifetime of about **11 days**.
In comparison, **Hydrofluorocarbons (HFCs)** have an atmospheric lifetime of around **13.8 years**, making **HFO-1234yf** a more **environmentally sustainable refrigerant**.
The development supports India's commitment under the **Kigali Amendment to the Montreal Protocol**, which aims to **phase down** the production and consumption of **Hydrofluorocarbons (HFCs)** to reduce **greenhouse gas emissions**.
India will implement the **HFC phase-down** in **four stages**, with **10% reduction in 2032**, **20% in 2037**, **30% in 2042**, and **85% in 2047**.

393. Recently, India's drug regulator (CDSCO) approved Novo Nordisk's Wegovy (Semaglutide Injection 2.4 mg) for the treatment of which disease?

A.Non-Alcoholic Fatty Liver Disease (NAFLD)

B.Wilson's Disease

C.Hepatitis B

D.Liver Cirrhosis

E.Metabolic Dysfunction-Associated Steatohepatitis (MASH)

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

India's drug regulator, the **Central Drugs Standard Control Organization (CDSCO)**, approved **Novo Nordisk's Wegovy (Semaglutide Injection 2.4 mg)** for the treatment of **Metabolic Dysfunction-Associated Steatohepatitis (MASH)**.

The approval covers **noncirrhotic MASH** in adults with **moderate to advanced liver fibrosis**, along with a **reduced-calorie diet** and **increased physical activity**.

Wegovy became the **first and only GLP-1 Receptor Agonist (GLP-1 RA)** approved globally and in India for treating **noncirrhotic MASH** with **moderate to advanced liver fibrosis**.

Detailed Explanation:

India's drug regulator, the **Central Drugs Standard Control Organization (CDSCO)**, approved **Novo Nordisk's Wegovy (Semaglutide Injection 2.4 mg)** for the treatment of **Metabolic Dysfunction-Associated Steatohepatitis (MASH)**.

The approval covers **noncirrhotic MASH** in adults with **moderate to advanced liver fibrosis**, along with a **reduced-calorie diet** and **increased physical activity**.

Wegovy became the **first and only GLP-1 Receptor Agonist (GLP-1 RA)** approved globally and in India for treating **noncirrhotic MASH** with **moderate to advanced liver fibrosis**.

MASH (Metabolic Dysfunction-Associated Steatohepatitis) is a progressive liver disease caused by **fat accumulation in the liver**, leading to **chronic inflammation** and **liver damage**.

MASH is part of the broader **Metabolic Dysfunction-Associated Steatotic Liver Disease (MASLD)** spectrum, which is associated with **obesity**, **type 2 diabetes**, and **dyslipidaemia**.

Wegovy contains **Semaglutide**, a **GLP-1 Receptor Agonist**, widely used for **chronic weight management** and **metabolic disease treatment**.

394. Recently, the Aadhaar App made which Aadhaar-related service free of cost until 31 December 2026?

A.Address update

B.Mobile number update

C.Biometric update

D.Email update

E.Aadhaar enrolment

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The **Aadhaar App** has crossed **40 million (4 crore) downloads**, highlighting the growing trust of residents in **digital-first identity services**.

The **Aadhaar App** serves as a **one-stop digital platform** for **Aadhaar-related services**, including **address update**, **mobile number update**, **email update**, **biometric lock/unlock**, and **e-Aadhaar download**.

Since the launch of the **email update feature** on **1 July 2026**, around **12.5 lakh email addresses** have been added or updated through the **Aadhaar App**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Aadhaar App** has crossed **40 million (4 crore) downloads**, highlighting the growing trust of residents in **digital-first identity services**.

The **Aadhaar App** serves as a **one-stop digital platform** for **Aadhaar-related services**, including **address update**, **mobile number update**, **email update**, **biometric lock/unlock**, and **e-Aadhaar download**.

Since its launch, the **Aadhaar App** has facilitated over **11.65 lakh address updates**, enabling users to update their Aadhaar address from home without visiting an **Aadhaar Centre**.

The app has enabled nearly **49 lakh mobile number updates**, helping residents maintain **accurate contact information** linked with Aadhaar.

Since the launch of the **email update feature** on **1 July 2026**, around **12.5 lakh email addresses** have been added or updated through the **Aadhaar App**.

The **email update service**, previously priced at **₹75**, has been made **free of cost** on the **Aadhaar App** until **31 December 2026**.

395. Recently, which Indian cricketer became the first Indian men's player to score an ODI century at Lord's Cricket Ground, London?

A.Virat Kohli

B.Sachin Tendulkar

C.Rohit Sharma

D.Sourav Ganguly

E.KL Rahul

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

India captain Rohit Sharma became the **first Indian men's cricketer to score an One Day International (ODI) century at Lord's Cricket Ground, London, England**, during the **India–England ODI series**.

Rohit Sharma scored his **34th One Day International century**, helping India chase **387/3** posted by **England**, led by **Ben Duckett's 141-run innings**.

At **39 years and 80 days**, Rohit Sharma became the **oldest Indian cricketer to score an international century across all formats**, surpassing **Sachin Tendulkar's record** of **38 years and 327 days**.

Detailed Explanation:

India captain Rohit Sharma became the **first Indian men's cricketer to score an One Day International (ODI) century at Lord's Cricket**

Ground, London, England, during the **India–England ODI series**.

Rohit Sharma scored his **34th One Day International century**, helping India chase **387/3** posted by **England**, led by **Ben Duckett's 141-run innings**.

At **39 years and 80 days**, Rohit Sharma became the **oldest Indian cricketer to score an international century across all formats**, surpassing **Sachin Tendulkar's record** of **38 years and 327 days**.

Rohit Sharma also became the **visiting batter with the most One Day International centuries in a single foreign country**, scoring **8 centuries in England**, surpassing:

Sachin Tendulkar – 7 centuries (United Arab Emirates)

Saeed Anwar (Pakistan) – 7 centuries (United Arab Emirates)

AB de Villiers (South Africa) – 7 centuries (India)

The century was Rohit Sharma's **46th international century as an opening batter**, overtaking **Sachin Tendulkar's 45 centuries** as an opener for India.

During the match, **Rohit Sharma and Virat Kohli** played their **400th international match together**.

396. Recently, PV Sindhu became the first Indian badminton player to achieve which milestone?

A.Win a BWF Super 100 tournament

B.Win a BWF Super 300 tournament

C.Win a BWF Super 500 tournament

D.Win a BWF Super 750 tournament

E.Win a BWF Super 1000 tournament

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

Pusarla Venkata Sindhu (PV Sindhu) created history by winning the **BWF Japan Open 2026** title, defeating **World No. 3 Akane Yamaguchi (Japan)** in the final by **21-17, 21-17** at **Tokyo, Japan**.

With this victory, **PV Sindhu became the first Indian badminton player to win a BWF Super 750 tournament**.

The victory marked Sindhu's return to a major international title after winning the **BWF World Championships 2019** and ended her long wait for a prestigious title.

She also became the **oldest woman player (31 years)** to win a **BWF Super 750 title**.

Detailed Explanation:

Pusarla Venkata Sindhu (PV Sindhu) created history by winning the **BWF Japan Open 2026** title, defeating **World No. 3 Akane Yamaguchi (Japan)** in the final by **21-17, 21-17** at **Tokyo, Japan**.

With this victory, **PV Sindhu became the first Indian badminton player to win a BWF Super 750 tournament**.

The victory marked Sindhu's return to a major international title after winning the **BWF World Championships 2019** and ended her long wait for a prestigious title.

She also became the **oldest woman player (31 years)** to win a **BWF Super 750 title**.

Before this achievement, Sindhu's last title came at the **Syed Modi International 2024 (BWF Super 300 tournament)**.

The Japan Open 2026 final was the **30th career meeting between PV Sindhu and Akane Yamaguchi**, with Sindhu securing victory in straight games

397. Recently, Lionel Messi became the first footballer to achieve which FIFA World Cup milestone?

A.Play in three different FIFA World Cup finals

B.Captain a team in three FIFA World Cup finals

C.Score in three FIFA World Cup finals

D.Win three FIFA World Cup titles

E.Play in four FIFA World Cups as captain

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

Argentina's Lionel Messi created history by becoming the **first footballer to play in three different FIFA World Cup finals** after featuring in the **2026 FIFA World Cup Final** against **Spain** at **MetLife Stadium, New Jersey, United States**.

At **39 years of age**, Messi also became the **oldest outfield player** to play in **three FIFA World Cup finals**.

Detailed Explanation:

Argentina's Lionel Messi created history by becoming the **first footballer to play in three different FIFA World Cup finals** after featuring in the **2026 FIFA World Cup Final** against **Spain** at **MetLife Stadium, New Jersey, United States**.

At **39 years of age**, Messi also became the **oldest outfield player** to play in **three FIFA World Cup finals**.

Messi's **three FIFA World Cup final appearances**:

2014 FIFA World Cup – Argentina lost to **Germany**.

2022 FIFA World Cup – Argentina defeated **France** to win the title.

2026 FIFA World Cup – Argentina lost **1-0** to **Spain** after extra time.

Messi surpassed the previous record associated with **Cafu (Brazil)**. Although Cafu was part of three consecutive FIFA World Cups (1994, 1998 and 2002), he **did not play in the 1994 final**, making Messi the **first player to appear in three FIFA World Cup finals**.

Spain won its **second FIFA World Cup title** by defeating **Argentina 1-0** after extra time in the **2026 FIFA World Cup Final**.

398. Recently, which edition of the International Biology Olympiad (IBO) was held in Vilnius, Lithuania, where India won 1 Gold and 3 Silver medals?

A.37th

B.36th

C.35th

D.38th

E.39th

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

India created history by winning **1 Gold Medal and 3 Silver Medals** at the **37th International**

Biology Olympiad (IBO) 2026, held in **Vilnius, Lithuania**.

All four members of the Indian team won medals.

Medal Winners:

Bhavya Gunwal (Mahendragarh, Haryana) – Gold Medal

Soumil Maity (Howrah, West Bengal) – Silver Medal

Nishit Kalani (Pali, Rajasthan) – Silver Medal

Anmol Kumar (Mansa, Punjab) – Silver Medal

Detailed Explanation:

India created history by winning **1 Gold Medal and 3 Silver Medals** at the **37th International Biology Olympiad (IBO) 2026**, held in **Vilnius, Lithuania**.

All four members of the Indian team won medals.

Medal Winners:

Bhavya Gunwal (Mahendragarh, Haryana) – Gold Medal

Soumil Maity (Howrah, West Bengal) – Silver Medal

Nishit Kalani (Pali, Rajasthan) – Silver Medal

Anmol Kumar (Mansa, Punjab) – Silver Medal

IBO 2026 witnessed participation from **307 students representing 78 countries**. A total of **31 Gold, 61 Silver, and 91 Bronze Medals** were awarded.

The **6-hour practical examination** covered:

Molecular Biology and Biochemistry – Restriction digestion, gel electrophoresis and enzyme assays.

Animal Physiology – Drug pharmacokinetics and digital methodologies in biochemical research.

Animal Morphology and Systematics – Insect taxonomy, morphological structures and classification.

Plant Computational Biology – Root image analysis, transcriptome analysis and evaluation of plant traits.

399. Recently, India created history by winning four Gold medals at which edition of the International Chemistry Olympiad (IChO) was held in Tashkent, Uzbekistan?

A.55th

B.56th

C.57th

D.58th

E.59th

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

India created history at the **58th International Chemistry Olympiad (IChO) 2026** by winning **four Gold medals**, becoming the **first country** to have **all four participants** win **Gold medals** in a single edition of the competition.

The **58th International Chemistry Olympiad (IChO) 2026** was held in **Tashkent, Uzbekistan**, from **10–19 July 2026**, with the participation of **363 students from 93 countries**, making it the **largest edition** of the Olympiad to date.

India participated in the **International Chemistry Olympiad** for the **27th time** and

finished **joint first** in the overall medal tally along with **China, Vietnam, and Individual Participants Group B (Russia)**.

Detailed Explanation:

India created history at the **58th International Chemistry Olympiad (IChO) 2026** by winning **four Gold medals**, becoming the **first country** to have **all four participants** win **Gold medals** in a single edition of the competition.

The **58th International Chemistry Olympiad (IChO) 2026** was held in **Tashkent, Uzbekistan**, from **10–19 July 2026**, with the participation of **363 students from 93 countries**, making it the **largest edition** of the Olympiad to date.

India participated in the **International Chemistry Olympiad** for the **27th time** and finished **joint first** in the overall medal tally along with **China, Vietnam, and Individual Participants Group B (Russia)**.

India's Gold Medal Winners:

Debadatta Priyadarshi – **Odisha**

Harshit Singla – **Punjab**

Kabeer Chillar – **Delhi**

Sandeep Kuchi – **Telangana**

The **International Chemistry Olympiad (IChO)** is one of the world's most prestigious competitions for **secondary school students**, testing both **theoretical knowledge** and **practical laboratory skills** in chemistry.

The **2026 examination** consisted of **nine advanced chemistry problems** based on **scientific research** and **interdisciplinary applications**.

400. Recently, consider the following statements regarding the 2026 FIFA World Cup:

1. **Spain won the 2026 FIFA World Cup by defeating Argentina in the final.**
2. **Rodri won the FIFA World Cup Golden Ball as the Best Player of the Tournament.**
3. **Lionel Messi finished as Silver Ball.**

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

A.Only 1

B.Only 2

C.Only 1 and 2

D.Only 2 and 3

E.All the above

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

Spain won the **2026 Fédération Internationale de Football Association (FIFA) World Cup**, defeating **Argentina** in the final to secure its **second FIFA World Cup title**.

Rodri (Spain) won the **FIFA World Cup Golden Ball**, awarded to the **Best Player of the Tournament**, for his outstanding performances throughout the competition.

Lionel Messi (Argentina) finished as the runner-up for the **Golden Ball (Silver Ball)**, after scoring **8 goals** and providing **4 assists** during the tournament.

Detailed Explanation:

Spain won the **2026 Fédération Internationale de Football Association (FIFA) World Cup**, defeating **Argentina** in the final to secure its **second FIFA World Cup title**.

Rodri (Spain) won the **FIFA World Cup Golden Ball**, awarded to the **Best Player of the Tournament**, for his outstanding performances throughout the competition.

Lionel Messi (Argentina) finished as the runner-up for the **Golden Ball**, after scoring **8 goals** and providing **4 assists** during the tournament.

Rodri became one of the few players to win both the **FIFA World Cup** and the **Golden Ball** in the same edition.

The **FIFA World Cup Golden Ball**, instituted in **1978**, is presented to the tournament's **Best Player** based on overall performance, with the winner selected by **accredited journalists** from a shortlist prepared by the **FIFA Technical Study Group**.

FIFA also presented the following individual awards:

Golden Ball – Best Player

Golden Boot – Top Goalscorer

Golden Glove – Best Goalkeeper

Best Young Player

FIFA Fair Play Award

401. Recently, the Draft Foreign Exchange Management (Foreign Investment) Rules, 2026 aim to replace which existing regulatory framework governing foreign investment in India?

A.Foreign Exchange Management (Transfer or Issue of Security by a Person Resident Outside India) Regulations, 2017

B.Foreign Exchange Management (Current Account Transactions) Rules, 2000

C.Foreign Exchange Management (Non-Debt Instruments) Rules, 2019

D.Foreign Direct Investment (FDI) Policy, 2020

E.Companies (Foreign Investment) Rules, 2014

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

Foreign Investment in India is currently governed by the **Foreign Exchange Management (Non-Debt Instruments) Rules, 2019 (NDI Rules)**.

The **Union Budget 2026–27** announced a comprehensive review of the NDI Rules to create a modern, simplified and investor-friendly framework for foreign investments.

The **Central Government** constituted a **Committee** to comprehensively review the existing foreign investment regulatory framework, and the **RBI** prepared the draft Rules based on its recommendations and consultations with stakeholders.

Detailed Explanation:

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The **Central Government** constituted a **Committee** to comprehensively review the existing foreign investment regulatory framework, and the **RBI** prepared the draft Rules based on its recommendations and consultations with stakeholders.

The **Draft Foreign Exchange Management (Foreign Investment) Rules, 2026** aim to create a contemporary, transparent and user-friendly regulatory framework aligned with India's evolving economic priorities.

The proposed Rules introduce a **simplified and principle-based framework** through **rationalisation of provisions**, **harmonisation of definitions**, and a **simplified regulatory architecture** to reduce regulatory complexity.

The draft Rules provide clear alignment with the **Foreign Direct Investment (FDI) Policy** by separating procedural **FEMA provisions** from policy and sector-specific requirements, ensuring greater regulatory clarity.

402. Recently, consider the following statements regarding the Unified Payments Interface (UPI):

1. **UPI is operated by the National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI) and is authorised under the Payment and Settlement Systems Act, 2007.**
2. **During FY 2025–26, UPI recorded 24,161.69 crore transactions with a total value of ₹314.23 lakh crore.**
3. **NPCI International Payments Limited (NIPL) was incorporated in April 2020 to expand UPI and RuPay internationally.**

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

A.Only 1

B.Only 2 and 3

C.Only 1 and 3

D.Only 1 and 2

E.All the above

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

Unified Payments Interface (UPI) is a real-time digital payment system operated by the **National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI)** and is authorised under the **Payment and Settlement Systems Act, 2007**.

As of **June 2026**, **55.49 crore users** have been onboarded on the UPI platform, reflecting its rapid adoption across India.

During **FY 2025–26**, UPI recorded **24,161.69 crore transactions** with a total transaction value of **₹314.23 lakh crore**, the highest ever since its launch.

NPCI International Payments Limited (NIPL), a wholly owned subsidiary of NPCI, was incorporated in **April 2020** to expand **UPI** and **RuPay** to international markets.

Detailed Explanation:

Unified Payments Interface (UPI) is a real-time digital payment system operated by the **National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI)** and is authorised under the **Payment and Settlement Systems Act, 2007**.

As of **June 2026**, **55.49 crore users** have been onboarded on the UPI platform, reflecting its rapid adoption across India.

During **FY 2025–26**, UPI recorded **24,161.69 crore transactions** with a total transaction value of **₹314.23 lakh crore**, the highest ever since its launch.

UPI transaction growth over the last five financial years:

FY 2021–22: **4,595.61 crore transactions** | **₹84.16 lakh crore**

FY 2022–23: **8,371.44 crore transactions** | **₹139.15 lakh crore**

FY 2023–24: **13,112.95 crore transactions** | **₹199.95 lakh crore**

FY 2024–25: **18,586.60 crore transactions** | **₹260.56 lakh crore**

FY 2025–26: **24,161.69 crore transactions** | **₹314.23 lakh crore**

NPCI International Payments Limited (NIPL), a wholly owned subsidiary of NPCI, was incorporated in **April 2020** to expand **UPI** and **RuPay** to international markets. **NIPL** enables Indian tourists and the Indian diaspora to make seamless **cross-border payments** while helping partner countries build UPI-like real-time payment systems and RuPay-like domestic card networks.

403. VRecently, consider the following statements:

1. **The Reserve Bank of India's (RBI) Financial Inclusion Index (FI-Index) increased to 70.0 in March 2026 from 67.0 in March 2025.**
2. **The FI-Index was first published by RBI in August 2021 for the financial year ending March 2021.**
3. **Under the revised SNFA Prudential Norms, Regulated Entities (REs) are permitted to sell Specified Non-Financial Assets (SNFAs) back to the defaulting borrower after obtaining RBI approval.**

Which of the above statements is incorrect?

A.Only 1

B.Only 2

C.Only 3

D.Only 1 and 2

E.None of the above

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** released the **Financial Inclusion Index (FI-Index)** for **FY 2025–26**, with the index rising to **70.0 in March 2026** from **67.0 in March 2025**.

The **FI-Index** was first published in **August 2021** for the financial year ending **March 2021**.

The new **SNFA Prudential Norms** have been issued under the **Resolution of Stressed Assets Directions, 2025**.

The revised **SNFA framework** will come into effect from **1 October 2026**.

Under the revised norms, **Regulated Entities (REs)** are prohibited from **selling or transferring Specified Non-Financial Assets (SNFAs)** back to the **defaulting borrower**,

its **promoters**, **related parties**, or entities acting on behalf of the borrower.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** released the **Financial Inclusion Index (FI-Index)** for **FY 2025–26**, with the index rising to **70.0 in March 2026** from **67.0 in March 2025**.

The improvement in the **FI-Index** was mainly driven by an increase in the **Usage sub-index**, reflecting the **deepening of financial inclusion** across India.

Growth was recorded across **all sub-indices** of the **Financial Inclusion Index (FI-Index)** during **FY 2025–26**.

The **RBI** developed the composite **Financial Inclusion Index (FI-Index)** in consultation with the **Government of India (GoI)** and other stakeholders to measure the extent of financial inclusion across the country.

The **FI-Index** was first published in **August 2021** for the financial year ending **March 2021**.

The **RBI** also issued new **"Prudential Norms on Specified Non-Financial Assets (SNFAs) acquired by Regulated Entities (REs)"** to strengthen the framework for **resolving stressed assets**.

The new **SNFA Prudential Norms** have been issued under the **Resolution of Stressed Assets Directions, 2025**.

The revised **SNFA framework** will come into effect from **1 October 2026**.

Under the revised norms, **Regulated Entities (REs)** are prohibited from **selling or transferring Specified Non-Financial Assets (SNFAs)** back to the **defaulting borrower**, its **promoters**, **related parties**, or entities acting on behalf of the borrower.

404. Recently, the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) issued the Framework for Self-Regulatory Organisations in the FinTech Sector (SRO-FT Framework) on which date?

A.30 May 2023

B.30 May 2024

C.30 June 2024

D.30 May 2025

E.30 June 2025

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The **Government of India (GoI)** continuously engages with financial sector regulators and other stakeholders to review issues related to the **FinTech ecosystem**, including **digital lending platforms** and **payment aggregators**

The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** issued the **Framework for Self-Regulatory Organisation(s) in the FinTech Sector (SRO-FT Framework)** on **30 May 2024** to establish regulatory standards, promote **ethical conduct**, ensure **market integrity**, resolve disputes, and enhance **transparency and accountability** among FinTech entities.

The **RBI** issued the **Master Directions on Digital Payment Security Controls** in **February 2021**, mandating banks to implement **minimum security standards** across internet banking, mobile

banking, card payments, and other digital payment channels to combat **cyber threats**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Government of India (GoI)** continuously engages with financial sector regulators and other stakeholders to review issues related to the **FinTech ecosystem**, including **digital lending platforms** and **payment aggregators**.

The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** issued the **Framework for Self-Regulatory Organisation(s) in the FinTech Sector (SRO-FT Framework)** on **30 May 2024** to establish regulatory standards, promote **ethical conduct**, ensure **market integrity**, resolve disputes, and enhance **transparency and accountability** among FinTech entities.

The **RBI** issued the **Master Directions on Digital Payment Security Controls** in **February 2021**, mandating banks to implement **minimum security standards** across internet banking, mobile banking, card payments, and other digital payment channels to combat **cyber threats**.

The **National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI)** provides an **Artificial Intelligence (AI)** and **Machine Learning (ML)** based **fraud monitoring solution** to banks for **Unified Payments Interface (UPI)** transactions, enabling **real-time fraud alerts** and **transaction blocking**.

The **Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY)** notified the **Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 (DPDP Act)** and the **Digital Personal Data Protection Rules, 2025 (DPDP Rules 2025)** to safeguard the **personal data** and **privacy of individuals**.

405. Recently, the National Highways Authority of India (NHAI) launched the Digital Local Pass facility initially at which toll plaza?

A.Kherki Daula Toll Plaza, Haryana

B.Khalapur Toll Plaza, Maharashtra

C.Mundka–Bakkarwala Toll Plaza, Delhi

D.Attibele Toll Plaza, Karnataka

E.Shahjahanpur Toll Plaza, Rajasthan

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The **National Highways Authority of India (NHAI)** launched **Digital Local Pass** and **MargMitra Help Centre** on the **RajmargYatra Mobile App** to enhance digital services for **National Highway** users.

The initiatives support the **Digital India** programme by providing **paperless**, **technology-driven**, and **user-friendly** highway services.

The **Digital Local Pass** enables eligible commuters to apply for and obtain **monthly toll passes online**, eliminating the need to visit toll plazas or submit physical documents.

The facility has been launched initially at the **Mundka–Bakkarwala Toll Plaza** on **Urban Extension Road-II (UER-II), Delhi**, and will be expanded to other toll plazas across the country.

Detailed Explanation:

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The initiatives support the **Digital India** programme by providing **paperless**, **technology-driven**, and **user-friendly** highway services.
The **Digital Local Pass** enables eligible commuters to apply for and obtain **monthly toll passes online**, eliminating the need to visit toll plazas or submit physical documents.
The facility has been launched initially at the **Mundka–Bakkarwala Toll Plaza** on **Urban Extension Road-II (UER-II), Delhi**, and will be expanded to other toll plazas across the country.
Residents living within a **20-kilometre radius** of an eligible toll plaza can apply for the **Digital Local Pass**, which provides **unlimited travel** through the designated toll plaza during the validity period.
The digital verification process integrates **Digital Locker (DigiLocker)** for address verification, **Vehicle Registration Database (VAHAN)** for vehicle registration details, **Fast Tag (FASTag)** for toll account validation, and **Geographic Information System (GIS)** technology to verify the applicant's eligibility.

406. Recently, under the roadmap for "Viksit Krishi and Samruddh Kisan" announced on the 98th Foundation Day of ICAR, what is the name of the initiative that encourages every ICAR institute to develop at least one transformational innovation within two years?

A.Mission ICAR-100
B.One District-One Innovation
C.One Institute-One Grand Innovation
D.National Agri Innovation Mission
E.Climate Smart Agriculture Mission

Answer: C

Short Explanation:
The **Indian Council of Agricultural Research (ICAR)** celebrated its **98th Foundation Day** at the **Bharat Ratna C. Subramaniam Auditorium, NASC Complex, New Delhi**, where **Union Minister for Agriculture and Farmers' Welfare and Rural Development Shivraj Singh Chouhan** presented a roadmap for **"Viksit Krishi and Samruddh Kisan"** under the vision of **Viksit Bharat 2047**.
The Minister announced major targets including development of **100 Climate Smart Villages**, reaching **ICAR technologies to 100 million farmers**, launching **"One Institute-One Grand Innovation"**, establishing an **ICAR Open Digital Knowledge Platform**, strengthening action against **fake seeds and pesticides**, and making ICAR financially self-reliant through technology commercialisation.

Detailed Explanation:
The **Indian Council of Agricultural Research (ICAR)** celebrated its **98th Foundation Day** at the **Bharat Ratna C. Subramaniam Auditorium, NASC Complex, New Delhi**, where **Union Minister for Agriculture and**

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The Minister announced major targets including development of **100 Climate Smart Villages**, reaching **ICAR technologies to 100 million farmers**, launching **"One Institute-One Grand Innovation"**, establishing an **ICAR Open Digital Knowledge Platform**, strengthening action against **fake seeds and pesticides**, and making ICAR financially self-reliant through technology commercialisation.

More than **150 ICAR employees** received **regular appointment letters** for the first time, marking a significant milestone in recognising their long-term contribution to the organisation.

Under the **One Institute-One Grand Innovation** initiative, every **ICAR institute** has been encouraged to develop at least **one transformational innovation within two years** in areas such as **new crop varieties, vaccines, digital tools, and climate-smart solutions**.

The proposed **Mission ICAR-100** aims to transform **Krishi Vigyan Kendras (KVKs)** into **innovation hubs, climate advisory centres, startup support centres, and farmer technology demonstration centres** before ICAR completes 100 years.

407. Recently, the Delhi Cabinet approved the implementation of which scheme to promote cleaner commercial transportation in the National Capital Region (NCR)?

A.FAME India Scheme

B.Parivahan Mitra Scheme

C.Green Mobility Mission

D.Parivartan Scheme

E.EV Adoption Scheme

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The **Delhi Cabinet**, chaired by **Chief Minister Rekha Gupta**, approved the implementation of the **Parivartan Scheme**, a flagship initiative of the **Ministry of Road Transport and Highways (MoRTH)**, to promote cleaner commercial transportation in the **National Capital Region (NCR)**.

Parivartan (Programme for Accelerated Renewal and Incentivization of Vehicle Assets) aims to replace **BS-IV and older commercial vehicles** with **BS-VI-compliant** or **electric vehicles (EVs)** to reduce vehicular emissions and improve air quality.

The scheme covers **Light Goods Vehicles (LGVs)**, **Medium Goods Vehicles (MGVs)**, **Heavy Goods Vehicles (HGVs)**, and **commercial buses** that are **BS-IV or older**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Delhi Cabinet**, chaired by **Chief Minister Rekha Gupta**, approved the implementation of the **Parivartan Scheme**, a flagship initiative of the **Ministry of Road Transport and Highways (MoRTH)**, to promote cleaner commercial transportation in the **National Capital Region (NCR)**.

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The scheme covers **Light Goods Vehicles (LGVs)**, **Medium Goods Vehicles (MGVs)**, **Heavy Goods Vehicles (HGVs)**, and **commercial buses** that are **BS-IV or older**.

Owners purchasing **new electric LGVs** will receive **10-year motor vehicle tax exemption**, **registration fee waiver**, **5% interest subsidy**, **8% Original Equipment Manufacturer (OEM) discount**, and a **one-time fuel voucher**.

Buyers of **used electric LGVs** will be eligible for **50% motor vehicle tax exemption for 10 years**, **5% interest subsidy**, and a **one-time fuel voucher**.

Owners replacing **medium and heavy commercial vehicles** with **BS-VI** or **electric vehicles** will receive **10-year tax exemption**, **registration fee waiver**, **5% interest subsidy**, **8% OEM discount**, and a **one-time fuel voucher**.

408. Recently, the Mukhyamantri Swasth Bastar Abhiyan was launched by which Chief Minister to improve maternal and child healthcare in the Bastar region?

A.Vishnu Deo Sai

B.Bhupesh Baghel

C.Rekha Gupta

D.Mohan Yadav

E.Himanta Biswa Sarma

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

The **Mukhyamantri Swasth Bastar Abhiyan** has significantly improved **maternal and child healthcare** in **Bastar region**, particularly in **Sukma district**, one of **Chhattisgarh's** most **Left-Wing Extremism (LWE)-affected** districts.

The initiative was launched by **Chief Minister Vishnu Deo Sai** on **14 April 2026** in **Sukma** to provide **accessible healthcare services** in remote and tribal areas with limited medical infrastructure.

The campaign focuses on **preventive healthcare**, **maternal and child health**, **early disease detection**, and **timely treatment** through doorstep healthcare services.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Mukhyamantri Swasth Bastar Abhiyan** has significantly improved **maternal and child healthcare** in **Bastar region**, particularly in **Sukma district**, one of **Chhattisgarh's** most **Left-Wing Extremism (LWE)-affected** districts.

The initiative was launched by **Chief Minister Vishnu Deo Sai** on **14 April 2026** in **Sukma** to provide **accessible healthcare services** in remote and tribal areas with limited medical infrastructure.

The campaign focuses on **preventive healthcare**, **maternal and child health**, **early**

disease detection, and **timely treatment** through doorstep healthcare services.
Under the programme, **institutional deliveries** in **Sukma district** have increased to **98.6%**, reflecting improved access to healthcare facilities and greater public confidence in government health services.
The initiative has contributed to a **decline in Maternal Mortality Rate (MMR)** and **Infant Mortality Rate (IMR)** through **early pregnancy registration**, **regular antenatal care**, **vaccination**, and **continuous monitoring of high-risk pregnancies**.

409. Recently, the Supreme Court of India directed the Central Government to constitute a committee to recommend a uniform post-retirement benefits scheme for retired Chief Justices and High Court judges within how many weeks?

A.One week
B.Two weeks
C.Three weeks
D.One month
E.Two months
Answer: B
Short Explanation:
The **Supreme Court of India** directed the **Central Government** to constitute a **committee within two weeks** to recommend a **uniform post-retirement benefits scheme** for **retired Chief Justices and High Court judges** across the country.
The direction was issued while hearing a petition highlighting **unequal post-retirement benefits** provided to retired High Court judges by different **State Governments**.
A **Supreme Court Bench** comprising **Chief Justice of India Surya Kant**, **Justice V. Mohan**, and **Justice Joymalya Bagchi** observed that varying benefits across states violate the principles of **equality** and **dignity**.
Detailed Explanation:
The **Supreme Court of India** directed the **Central Government** to constitute a **committee within two weeks** to recommend a **uniform post-retirement benefits scheme** for **retired Chief Justices and High Court judges** across the country.
The direction was issued while hearing a petition highlighting **unequal post-retirement benefits** provided to retired High Court judges by different **State Governments**.
A **Supreme Court Bench** comprising **Chief Justice of India Surya Kant**, **Justice V. Mohan**, and **Justice Joymalya Bagchi** observed that varying benefits across states violate the principles of **equality** and **dignity**.
The committee has been tasked with preparing **uniform national guidelines**, examining the **financial assistance mechanism** for states, and recommending a **common post-retirement benefits policy**.
The committee has been directed to submit its recommendations to both the **Central**

Government and the **Supreme Court** within **three months** of its constitution.

410. Recently, India approved its first dengue vaccine, QDENGA, developed by which company?

A.Serum Institute of India

B.Bharat Biotech

C.Takeda Biopharmaceuticals

D.Zydus Lifesciences

E.Biological E

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

India has approved its **first dengue vaccine**, **QDENGA**, after receiving marketing authorisation from the **Drug Controller General of India (DCGI)**, marking a major milestone in the country's fight against **dengue**.

QDENGA, developed by **Takeda Biopharmaceuticals (Japan)**, is a **live attenuated tetravalent dengue vaccine** that provides protection against all **four dengue virus serotypes (DENV-1, DENV-2, DENV-3, and DENV-4)**.

The vaccine is approved for individuals aged **4 to 60 years**, irrespective of whether they have had a previous dengue infection.

Detailed Explanation:

India has approved its **first dengue vaccine**, **QDENGA**, after receiving marketing authorisation from the **Drug Controller General of India (DCGI)**, marking a major milestone in the country's fight against **dengue**.

QDENGA, developed by **Takeda Biopharmaceuticals (Japan)**, is a **live attenuated tetravalent dengue vaccine** that provides protection against all **four dengue virus serotypes (DENV-1, DENV-2, DENV-3, and DENV-4)**.

The vaccine is approved for individuals aged **4 to 60 years**, irrespective of whether they have had a previous dengue infection.

QDENGA is administered in a **two-dose schedule** and **does not require pre-vaccination screening**, making it easier to include in immunisation programmes.

The approval is based on **19 Phase I, II, and III clinical trials** involving over **28,000 participants globally**, including a **Phase III clinical study in India**.

In the global **TIDES Phase III Trial**, the vaccine demonstrated **80.2% efficacy** against laboratory-confirmed dengue one year after the second dose and **90.4% efficacy** in preventing dengue-related hospitalisation 18 months after the second dose.

411. Recently, American filmmaker James Gray will be honoured with which prestigious award at the 79th Locarno Film Festival 2026?

A.Golden Lion Award

B.Golden Leopard Award

C.Palme d'Or Award

D.Lifetime Achievement Award

E.Pardo alla Carriera (Honorary Career Leopard Award)

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

American filmmaker James Gray will be honoured with the prestigious **Pardo alla Carriera (Honorary Career Leopard Award)** at the **79th Locarno Film Festival** on **9 August 2026**.

The award will be presented before the screening of his latest film, **Paper Tiger**, at **Piazza Grande**, one of **Europe's largest open-air cinemas**, in **Locarno, Switzerland**.

Detailed Explanation:

American filmmaker James Gray will be honoured with the prestigious **Pardo alla Carriera (Honorary Career Leopard Award)** at the **79th Locarno Film Festival** on **9 August 2026**.

The award will be presented before the screening of his latest film, **Paper Tiger**, at **Piazza Grande**, one of **Europe's largest open-air cinemas**, in **Locarno, Switzerland**.

The **Pardo alla Carriera** recognises filmmakers for their **lifetime contribution to world cinema** and their enduring influence on the global film industry.

As part of the festival, James Gray's acclaimed films **We Own the Night (2007)** and **Two Lovers (2008)** will also be screened.

James Gray made his directorial debut with **Little Odessa (1994)**, which won the **Silver Lion Award** at the **Venice Film Festival**.

He is renowned for films exploring themes such as **family**, **identity**, **immigration**, and **morality**, with notable works including **The Immigrant (2013)**, **The Lost City of Z (2016)**, **Ad Astra (2019)**, and **Armageddon Time (2022)**.

The **79th Locarno Film Festival** will be held from **5 to 15 August 2026** in **Locarno, Switzerland**.

412. Recently, who was appointed as the additional Chairman & Managing Director (CMD) of Indian Railway Catering and Tourism Corporation Limited (IRCTC)?

A.Sanjay Kumar Jain

B.Rahul Himalian

C.Vikas Kumar

D.Ashwini Lohani

E.Alok Kumar

Answer: B

The **Ministry of Railways (MoR)** appointed **Rahul Himalian**, Director (Tourism & Marketing), **Indian Railway Catering and Tourism Corporation Limited (IRCTC)**, as the additional **Chairman & Managing Director (CMD)** of IRCTC.

Rahul Himalian succeeds **Sanjay Kumar Jain**, following his resignation as CMD of IRCTC.

His appointment as additional **CMD of IRCTC** will take effect from **20 July 2026**.

He will continue to hold his existing position as **Director (Tourism & Marketing)**, IRCTC, while serving as additional CMD.

413. Recently, the National Highways Authority of India (NHAI) launched the Digital Local Pass facility first at which toll plaza?

A.Kherki Daula Toll Plaza, Haryana

B.Mundka–Bakkarwala Toll Plaza, Delhi

C.L&T Toll Plaza, Maharashtra

D.Chokhi Dhani Toll Plaza, Rajasthan

E.Electronic City Toll Plaza, Karnataka

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

National Highways Authority of India (NHAI) has introduced two new citizen-centric digital services on the **RajmargYatra Mobile App—Digital Local Pass** and **MargMitra Help Centre**—to strengthen the **Digital India initiative** and enhance **Ease of Living**.

The **Digital Local Pass** enables eligible commuters to purchase **monthly toll passes online** through the **RajmargYatra Mobile App**, eliminating the need to visit toll plazas or submit physical documents.

The first **Digital Local Pass facility** has been launched at the **Mundka–Bakkarwala Toll Plaza** on **Urban Extension Road-II (UER-II), Delhi**, and will be expanded to other toll plazas across the country.

Detailed Explanation:

National Highways Authority of India (NHAI) has introduced two new citizen-centric digital services on the **RajmargYatra Mobile App—Digital Local Pass** and **MargMitra Help Centre**—to strengthen the **Digital India initiative** and enhance **Ease of Living**.

The **Digital Local Pass** enables eligible commuters to purchase **monthly toll passes online** through the **RajmargYatra Mobile App**, eliminating the need to visit toll plazas or submit physical documents.

The first **Digital Local Pass facility** has been launched at the **Mundka–Bakkarwala Toll Plaza** on **Urban Extension Road-II (UER-II), Delhi**, and will be expanded to other toll plazas across the country.

Residents living within a **20 km radius** of an eligible toll plaza can digitally purchase a **Local Pass**, allowing **unlimited travel** through the respective toll plaza for **one month**.

The **Digital Local Pass** uses consent-based integration with **DigiLocker** and **VAHAN** to automatically retrieve **verified address details**, **vehicle registration number**, and **linked FASTag information**.

Eligibility verification for the Local Pass is carried out using **GIS-based verification**, ensuring **transparency**, **accuracy**, and eliminating manual documentation

414. Recently, researchers discovered five new species of lichen-forming fungi belonging to which genus from the Western Ghats of India?

A.Graphis

B.Parmelia

C.Allographa

D.Usnea

E.Cladonia

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

A team of researchers discovered **five new species** of **lichen-forming fungi** belonging to the genus **Allographa** from the **Western Ghats**

of India, a globally significant **biodiversity hotspot**.

The discovery is significant because **Allographa species** are important **bioindicators of forest health** and **environmental quality**, being highly sensitive to **pollution and habitat changes**.

The findings will help identify **ecologically sensitive areas**, strengthen **long-term environmental monitoring**, and support **evidence-based conservation policies** and **sustainable forest management**.

Detailed Explanation:

A team of researchers discovered **five new species** of **lichen-forming fungi** belonging to the genus **Allographa** from the **Western Ghats of India**, a globally significant **biodiversity hotspot**.

The discovery is significant because **Allographa species** are important **bioindicators of forest health** and **environmental quality**, being highly sensitive to **pollution and habitat changes**.

The findings will help identify **ecologically sensitive areas**, strengthen **long-term environmental monitoring**, and support **evidence-based conservation policies** and **sustainable forest management**.

Allographa is a genus of **script lichens** (lichen-forming fungi) in the **Graphidaceae family**, containing more than **200 species worldwide**.

A **lichen** is a **symbiotic association** between a **fungus and algae or cyanobacteria**.

The research was conducted by scientists from the **MACS Agharkar Research Institute (ARI), Pune**, an autonomous institute under the **Department of Science and Technology (DST)**.

415. Dr. Muhamed Jafer Palot, after whom Lestes paloti is named, is associated with which organisation?

A.Botanical Survey of India (BSI)

B.Wildlife Institute of India (WII)

C.Zoological Survey of India (ZSI)

D.Indian Council of Forestry Research and Education (ICFRE)

E.National Biodiversity Authority (NBA)

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

A team of **Indian odonatologists** discovered a new species of spreadwing damselfly, **Lestes paloti**, from the **Western Ghats** in **Kerala**.

Lestes paloti belongs to the **Lestidae family** under the **Order Odonata** (dragonflies and damselflies).

The discovery was published in the **International Journal of Odonatology**, an internationally reputed peer-reviewed journal dedicated to research on dragonflies and damselflies.

Detailed Explanation:

A team of **Indian odonatologists** discovered a new species of spreadwing damselfly, **Lestes paloti**, from the **Western Ghats** in **Kerala**.

Lestes paloti belongs to the **Lestidae family** under the **Order Odonata** (dragonflies and damselflies).

The discovery was published in the **International Journal of Odonatology**, an

internationally reputed peer-reviewed journal dedicated to research on dragonflies and damselflies.

The species was named **Lestes paloti** in honour of **Dr. Muhamed Jafer Palot** of the **Zoological Survey of India (ZSI)**, Kozhikode, recognising his significant contributions to **Indian odonatology** and the documentation of **Western Ghats fauna**.

Lestes paloti has been recorded across **6 districts of Kerala**: **Kannur, Kozhikode, Wayanad, Malappuram, Palakkad, and Ernakulam**.

416. Recently, India's first approved dengue vaccine Qdenga® is manufactured by which company?

A.Bharat Biotech

B.Serum Institute of India

C.Takeda GmbH

D.Zydus Lifesciences

E.Biological E

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The **Central Drugs Standard Control Organisation (CDSCO)**, under the **Ministry of Health and Family Welfare (MoHFW)**, granted **marketing authorisation** for **Qdenga®**, making it **India's first approved dengue vaccine**.

Qdenga® is manufactured by **Takeda GmbH, Germany**, and will be imported into India by **Takeda Biopharmaceuticals India Pvt. Ltd.**

The approval was granted after a **comprehensive scientific evaluation** of the vaccine's **quality, safety, and efficacy** under the provisions of the **Drugs and Cosmetics Act, 1940** and the **Drugs Rules, 1945**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Central Drugs Standard Control Organisation (CDSCO)**, under the **Ministry of Health and Family Welfare (MoHFW)**, granted **marketing authorisation** for **Qdenga®**, making it **India's first approved dengue vaccine**.

Qdenga® is manufactured by **Takeda GmbH, Germany**, and will be imported into India by **Takeda Biopharmaceuticals India Pvt. Ltd.**

The approval was granted after a **comprehensive scientific evaluation** of the vaccine's **quality, safety, and efficacy** under the provisions of the **Drugs and Cosmetics Act, 1940** and the **Drugs Rules, 1945**.

Qdenga® is a **Dengue Tetravalent Vaccine (Live, Attenuated)** designed to provide protection against **all four dengue virus serotypes**.

The vaccine is developed using **recombinant DNA technology** and is produced in **Vero cells**, with **serotype-specific genes** engineered into a **Dengue Virus Type-2 backbone**.

The vaccine contains **Genetically Modified Organisms (GMOs)** and is supplied as a **freeze-dried powder for reconstitution**.

Qdenga® is administered as a **subcutaneous injection**.

The vaccine is approved for individuals aged **4 to 60 years** for the **prevention of dengue disease**.

417. Recently, the National Institute of Electronics & Information Technology (NIELIT) announced the establishment of Centres of Excellence (CoEs) in which cities to strengthen India's semiconductor ecosystem?

A.Bengaluru and Hyderabad

B.Mumbai and Kolkata

C.Pune and Chennai

D.Noida and Mohali

E.Ahmedabad and Guwahati

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

The National Institute of Electronics & Information Technology (NIELIT) announced the establishment of **2 Centres of Excellence (CoEs)** in **Ahmedabad (Gujarat)** and **Guwahati (Assam)** to strengthen **India's semiconductor ecosystem** through **specialised skill development**.

The initiative supports the **India Semiconductor Mission (ISM) 2.0**, approved with an outlay of **₹1.28 lakh crore**, to build a **skilled semiconductor manufacturing workforce**.

The **CoEs** will provide **specialised training** in **Outsourced Semiconductor Assembly and Test (OSAT)** and **Assembly, Testing, Marking and Packaging (ATMP)** technologies.

Detailed Explanation:

The National Institute of Electronics & Information Technology (NIELIT) announced the establishment of **2 Centres of Excellence (CoEs)** in **Ahmedabad (Gujarat)** and **Guwahati (Assam)** to strengthen **India's semiconductor ecosystem** through **specialised skill development**.

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The **CoEs** will provide **specialised training** in **Outsourced Semiconductor Assembly and Test (OSAT)** and **Assembly, Testing, Marking and Packaging (ATMP)** technologies.

NIELIT has partnered with **Tata Electronics**, **Infineon**, and **Semiconductor Complex Limited (SCL), Mohali** to strengthen **semiconductor education** and **industry collaboration**.

The institute will introduce **B.Tech, M.Tech, and Diploma programmes** in **Semiconductor Technology** to develop **industry-ready professionals**.

Under the **India AI Mission**, **NIELIT** has established **28 Artificial Intelligence (AI) Labs** across the country.

NIELIT currently operates **42 AI-focused programmes** to promote **Artificial Intelligence education and research**.

418. Recently, which institute announced the establishment of the Centre of Excellence on

Innovative and Integrated Ecosystem for Green Hydrogen (ECOGEN)?

A.IIT Delhi

B.IIT Bombay

C.IIT Madras

D.IIT Kanpur

E.IIT Kharagpur

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) Kanpur announced the establishment of the **Centre of Excellence on Innovative and Integrated Ecosystem for Green Hydrogen (ECOGEN)** on **20 July 2026**.

The proposal has been approved by the **Government of Uttar Pradesh** and sanctioned by the **Uttar Pradesh New and Renewable Energy Development Agency (UPNEDA)** under the **Uttar Pradesh Green Hydrogen Policy, 2024**.

Detailed Explanation:

The Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) Kanpur announced the establishment of the **Centre of Excellence on Innovative and Integrated Ecosystem for Green Hydrogen (ECOGEN)** on **20 July 2026**.

The proposal has been approved by the **Government of Uttar Pradesh** and sanctioned by the **Uttar Pradesh New and Renewable Energy Development Agency (UPNEDA)** under the **Uttar Pradesh Green Hydrogen Policy, 2024**.

Green Hydrogen is produced through **electrolysis of water** using **renewable energy sources** such as **solar and wind power**, making it a **low-carbon fuel** with no direct **carbon dioxide (CO_2)** emissions during production.

The **ECOGEN Centre of Excellence** will promote **research, innovation**, and **technology development** across the entire **green hydrogen value chain**.

The Centre will focus on **green hydrogen generation, storage, transportation, utilisation, system integration, safety standards, testing, demonstration projects**, and **industrial applications**.

419. Recently, under the Medical Innovations Patent Mitra initiative, ICMR licensed SHetA2, a novel anti-HPV therapeutic candidate, to which pharmaceutical company?

A.Bharat Biotech Ltd.

B.Serum Institute of India

C.Emcure Pharmaceuticals Ltd.

D.Biological E Ltd

E.Zydus Lifesciences Ltd

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The **Indian Council of Medical Research (ICMR)** licensed **three indigenous biomedical technologies** to Indian pharmaceutical and vaccine companies under its **Medical Innovations Patent Mitra** initiative.

The technology transfers aim to **accelerate the commercialisation** of publicly funded research, strengthen **India's biomedical innovation**

ecosystem, and provide **affordable healthcare solutions**.

SHetA2, a novel **anti-HPV therapeutic candidate** for the treatment of **Cervical Intraepithelial Neoplasia (CIN)**, has been licensed to **Emcure Pharmaceuticals Ltd.**

Detailed Explanation:

The **Indian Council of Medical Research (ICMR)** licensed **three indigenous biomedical technologies** to Indian pharmaceutical and vaccine companies under its **Medical Innovations Patent Mitra** initiative.

The technology transfers aim to **accelerate the commercialisation** of publicly funded research, strengthen **India's biomedical innovation ecosystem**, and provide **affordable healthcare solutions**.

SHetA2, a novel **anti-HPV therapeutic candidate** for the treatment of **Cervical Intraepithelial Neoplasia (CIN)**, has been licensed to **Emcure Pharmaceuticals Ltd.**

SHetA2 was jointly developed by **Dr. Showket Hussain** of **ICMR–National Institute of Cancer Prevention and Research (ICMR-NICPR)** and **Dr. Doris M. Benbrook** of the **Stephenson Cancer Center, University of Oklahoma, USA**.

SHetA2 is a **first-in-class targeted therapeutic candidate** that selectively destroys **HPV-induced precancerous and cervical cancer cells** while sparing healthy cells, offering a **safe, affordable, and minimally invasive** treatment option.

Two **next-generation vaccine technologies** developed at **ICMR–National Institute of Research in Bacterial Infections (ICMR-NIRBI), Kolkata** have been licensed to **Biological E Ltd.**

420. Recently, consider the following statements regarding the 23rd Commonwealth Games 2026:

1. **The 23rd Commonwealth Games will be held in Glasgow, Scotland from 23 July to 2 August 2026.**
2. **The Games will feature 10 sports disciplines with six para sports events, making it the largest inclusive para sports programme in Commonwealth Games history.**
3. **India has announced a 120-member contingent across 13 sports disciplines for the Games.**

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

A.Only 1

B.Only 2 and 3

C.Only 1 and 3

D.Only 1 and 2

E.All the above

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

The **23rd Commonwealth Games** will be held in **Glasgow, Scotland** from **23 July to 2 August 2026**, featuring participation from **74 Commonwealth countries** over **11 days**.

The Games will include **10 sports disciplines** with **six para sports events**,

making it the **largest inclusive para sports programme** in Commonwealth Games history.
India has announced a **120-member contingent** across **13 sports disciplines**, with major medal hopes resting on athletes including **Neeraj Chopra (Athletics)**, **Mirabai Chanu (Weightlifting)**, **Lovlina Borgohain (Boxing)**, **Srihari Nataraj (Swimming)**, and **Murali Sreeshankar (Athletics)**.
Detailed Explanation:
The **23rd Commonwealth Games** will be held in **Glasgow, Scotland** from **23 July to 2 August 2026**, featuring participation from **74 Commonwealth countries** over **11 days**.
The Games will include **10 sports disciplines** with **six para sports events**, making it the **largest inclusive para sports programme** in Commonwealth Games history.
India has announced a **120-member contingent** across **13 sports disciplines**, with major medal hopes resting on athletes including **Neeraj Chopra (Athletics)**, **Mirabai Chanu (Weightlifting)**, **Lovlina Borgohain (Boxing)**, **Srihari Nataraj (Swimming)**, and **Murali Sreeshankar (Athletics)**.
The **Indian contingent** will be led by **Mirabai Chanu (Weightlifting)** and **Lovlina Borgohain (Boxing)** as **flag bearers** during the **opening ceremony on 23 July 2026**.
The **10 sports** included in the **Glasgow Commonwealth Games 2026** are **Athletics, Para Athletics, Swimming, Para Swimming, Boxing, Judo, Weightlifting, Track Cycling, Para Track Cycling, Artistic Gymnastics, Netball, Bowls, 3×3 Basketball, 3×3 Wheelchair Basketball, and Para Powerlifting**.
The Games will feature **215 gold medal events** across different sporting categories.

421. Recently, World Brain Day is observed every year on which date to create awareness about brain health and neurological disorders?

A.20 July
B.21 July
C.23 July
D.22 July
E.24 July

Answer: D

World Brain Day is observed every year on **22 July** to create awareness about **brain health**, prevent **neurological disorders**, and promote better treatment, rehabilitation, and care for people affected by brain-related disabilities.
The day was established by the **World Federation of Neurology (WFN)** to highlight the importance of **neurology research**, early diagnosis, and global efforts towards improving brain health.
The **World Federation of Neurology (WFN)** was founded on **22 July 1957 in Belgium** and has emerged as a leading global organisation promoting **neurological education, research, and healthcare awareness**.

422. Recently, Sir Garfield Sobers, the legendary cricketer who passed away at the age of 89, belonged to which cricket team?

A.Australia

B.England

C.India

D.West Indies

E.South Africa

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

Sir Garfield Sobers, the legendary **West Indies cricketer** and widely regarded as one of the **greatest all-rounders** in cricket history, passed away in **Saint Michael, Barbados**, at the age of **89**.

He was born on **28 July 1936** in **Bridgetown, Barbados**.

Sir Garfield Sobers was a **left-handed batter**, **versatile left-arm bowler**, and an **exceptional fielder**, making him one of the **most complete cricketers** in the history of the game.

He represented the **West Indies** in **93 Test matches** between **1954 and 1974**, scoring **8,032 Test runs** at an impressive batting average of **57.78** and claiming **235 Test wickets**.

Detailed Explanation:

Sir Garfield Sobers, the legendary **West Indies cricketer** and widely regarded as one of the **greatest all-rounders** in cricket history, passed away in **Saint Michael, Barbados**, at the age of **89**.

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He represented the **West Indies** in **93 Test matches** between **1954 and 1974**, scoring **8,032 Test runs** at an impressive batting average of **57.78** and claiming **235 Test wickets**.

He is universally recognised as **cricket's greatest all-rounder** due to his outstanding contributions with both bat and ball.

In **1958**, he scored a then **world-record 365 runs** in a Test innings against **Pakistan**, becoming the **youngest player** at that time to hold the record for the highest individual Test score.

In **1968**, he became the **first cricketer** in first-class cricket history to hit **six sixes in a single over**, achieving the feat while playing for **Nottinghamshire** against **Glamorgan**.

Sir Garfield Sobers captained the **West Indies** in **39 Test matches** during **1965–1972**, leading the team in an important era of international cricket.

He was **knighted by Queen Elizabeth II** in **1975** for his outstanding services to cricket.

In **2000**, he was named among **Wisden's Five Cricketers of the 20th Century**, one of the highest recognitions in cricket.

In **2009**, he was inducted into the **International Cricket Council (ICC) Hall of Fame** in recognition of his extraordinary achievements. The prestigious **Sir Garfield Sobers Trophy** is awarded annually to the **ICC Men's Cricketer of the Year**, commemorating his lasting legacy in world cricket.

423. Recently, the 2026 Commonwealth Games were shifted to Glasgow after which country withdrew as the host due to high estimated costs?

A.Australia
B.Canada
C.England
D.New Zealand
E.South Africa

Answer: A

The **2026 Commonwealth Games** have been reduced in scale after **Victoria, Australia**, withdrew as host in **2023** due to estimated costs of around **A$6–7 billion**.

Glasgow adopted a **cost-effective hosting model** by using existing infrastructure, reducing the number of sports from **19 at Birmingham 2022** to **10 sports in 2026**.

424. Recently, the Indian Railway Catering and Tourism Corporation Limited (IRCTC) was established in which year?

A.1997
B.1998
C.1999
D.2000
E.2001

Answer: C

Indian Railway Catering and Tourism Corporation Limited (IRCTC) was established in **1999**.

IRCTC is a **Schedule 'A' Navratna Central Public Sector Enterprise (CPSE)** under the **Ministry of Railways (MoR)**.

IRCTC is responsible for **railway ticketing**, **catering**, **tourism**, and **hospitality services** across Indian Railways.

Headquarters of IRCTC: **New Delhi, Delhi**.

425. Recently, who is the Governor of Chhattisgarh?

A.Anusuiya Uikey
B.Ramen Deka
C.Biswabhusan Harichandan
D.Kalraj Mishra
E.Mangubhai Patel

Answer: B

About Chhattisgarh:

Chief Minister: Vishnu Deo Sai
Governor: Ramen Deka
Capital: Raipur
National Parks: Indravati, Kanger Valley, Guru Ghasidas National Parks
Wildlife Sanctuaries: Achanakmar, Barnawapara, Udanti Wild Buffalo, Sitanadi Wildlife Sanctuaries

426. As per the news, the Department of Land Resources (DoLR) is working with the Reserve Bank of India Innovation Hub (RBIH)

to integrate digital land governance initiatives with which platform to enable secure, consent-based digital lending?

A.Unified Payments Interface (UPI)

B.Unified Lending Interface (ULI)

C.Open Credit Enablement Network (OCEN)

D.Public Credit Registry (PCR)

E.Bharat Bill Payment System (BBPS)

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The **Department of Land Resources (DoLR)** under the **Ministry of Rural Development (MoRD)** held a high-level meeting with the **Reserve Bank of India Innovation Hub (RBIH)** to strengthen the convergence of **Digital Public Infrastructure (DPI)** for **land governance** and **digital lending**.

The meeting was chaired by **Narendra Bhooshan**, Secretary, **DoLR**, who interacted with **Sahil Kini**, Chief Executive Officer (CEO), **RBI Innovation Hub (RBIH)**, along with senior officials from both organisations.

The discussions focused on integrating **DoLR's digital land governance initiatives** with the **Unified Lending Interface (ULI)** to enable **secure, seamless, and consent-based credit delivery**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Department of Land Resources (DoLR)** under the **Ministry of Rural Development (MoRD)** held a high-level meeting with the **Reserve Bank of India Innovation Hub (RBIH)** to strengthen the convergence of **Digital Public Infrastructure (DPI)** for **land governance** and **digital lending**.

The meeting was chaired by **Narendra Bhooshan**, Secretary, **DoLR**, who interacted with **Sahil Kini**, Chief Executive Officer (CEO), **RBI Innovation Hub (RBIH)**, along with senior officials from both organisations.

The discussions focused on integrating **DoLR's digital land governance initiatives** with the **Unified Lending Interface (ULI)** to enable **secure, seamless, and consent-based credit delivery**.

The collaboration is aimed at providing **faster institutional credit** to farmers and rural citizens through **digital land records**.

Key areas of collaboration include **secure access to authenticated digital land records**, faster digital delivery of **Kisan Credit Cards (KCC)**, agricultural loans, **improved loan processing**, **mortgage risk management**, and **greater financial inclusion**

427. As per the news, the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) operationalised the Digital Lending Apps (DLAs) Directory on its official website from which date to help customers verify whether a Digital Lending App is associated with an RBI Regulated Entity (RE)?

A.1 April 2025

B.8 May 2025

C.1 July 2025

D.22 October 2025

E.1 January 2026

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The **Government of India (GoI)** is continuously engaging with the **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** and other regulators/stakeholders to curb the operations of **fake and illegal loan apps** in the country.

The **RBI** operationalised the **Digital Lending Apps (DLAs) Directory** on its official website with effect from **1 July 2025** to help customers verify whether a **Digital Lending App (DLA)** is associated with an **RBI Regulated Entity (RE)**.

The **Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY)** has blocked **87 illegal loan lending applications** under **Section 69A of the Information Technology Act, 2000** after following the prescribed legal process.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Government of India (GoI)** is continuously engaging with the **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** and other regulators/stakeholders to curb the operations of **fake and illegal loan apps** in the country.

The **RBI** operationalised the **Digital Lending Apps (DLAs) Directory** on its official website with effect from **1 July 2025** to help customers verify whether a **Digital Lending App (DLA)** is associated with an **RBI Regulated Entity (RE)**.

The **Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY)** has blocked **87 illegal loan lending applications** under **Section 69A of the Information Technology Act, 2000** after following the prescribed legal process.

The **Information Technology (Intermediary Guidelines and Digital Media Ethics Code) Rules, 2025**, notified on **22 October 2025**, authorised **sectoral regulators** to issue directions for **blocking illegal online content** from public access.

The **RBI** issued the **Reserve Bank of India (Digital Lending) Directions, 2025** on **8 May 2025**, making provisions relating to **loan recovery**, **data privacy**, and **customer grievance redressal** mandatory for **Regulated Entities (REs)**, **Lending Service Providers (LSPs)**, and **Digital Lending Apps (DLAs)**.

428. As per the news, the Pradhan Mantri Jan Dhan Yojana (PMJDY) was launched in which year to promote financial inclusion and provide universal banking services to every unbanked household?

A.2012

B.2013

C.2011

D.2015

E.2014

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

The **Government of India (GoI)** launched the **National Mission for Financial Inclusion (NMFI)**, namely **Pradhan Mantri Jan Dhan Yojana (PMJDY)**, in **August 2014** to promote **financial inclusion** and

provide **universal banking services** to every **unbanked household**.

The **PMJDY** is based on the guiding principles of **"Banking the Unbanked, Securing the Unsecured, and Funding the Unfunded."**

Under **PMJDY**, a total of **58.63 crore Jan Dhan Accounts** have been opened with total **deposits of ₹3,08,333 crore** as on **1 July 2026**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Government of India (GoI)** launched the **National Mission for Financial Inclusion (NMFI)**, namely **Pradhan Mantri Jan Dhan Yojana (PMJDY)**, in **August 2014** to promote **financial inclusion** and provide **universal banking services** to every **unbanked household**.

The **PMJDY** is based on the guiding principles of **"Banking the Unbanked, Securing the Unsecured, and Funding the Unfunded."**

Under **PMJDY**, a total of **58.63 crore Jan Dhan Accounts** have been opened with total **deposits of ₹3,08,333 crore** as on **1 July 2026**.

Out of the total **PMJDY accounts**, **32.68 crore (55.74%)** belong to **women**, while **45.62 crore (77.80%)** accounts have been opened in **rural and semi-urban areas**.

Under the **Pradhan Mantri Jeevan Jyoti Bima Yojana (PMJJBY)**, **27.84 crore cumulative enrolments** have been recorded as on **1 July 2026**, providing a **life insurance cover of ₹2 lakh** for **death due to any reason**.

Under the **Pradhan Mantri Suraksha Bima Yojana (PMSBY)**, **58.78 crore cumulative enrolments** have been completed as on **1 July 2026**, providing **₹2 lakh** insurance for **death or permanent total disability** and **₹1 lakh** for **permanent partial disability**.

429. As per the news, consider the following statements regarding the Windfall Tax:

1. **The revised windfall tax rates came into effect from 16 July 2026.**
2. **The Special Additional Excise Duty (SAED) on diesel exports was increased to ₹15.5 per litre.**
3. **The export duty on petrol was reduced from ₹4 per litre to ₹2.5 per litre.**

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

A.Only 1

B.Only 2

C.Only 1 and 2

D.All the above

E.Only 2 and 3

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The **Special Additional Excise Duty (SAED)** on **diesel exports** was increased from **₹8.5 per litre to ₹15.5 per litre**.

The **SAED** on **Aviation Turbine Fuel (ATF) exports** was increased from **₹7.5 per litre to ₹14.5 per litre**.

The **Government of India** reduced the **export duty on petrol** from **₹4 per litre to ₹2.5 per litre**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Government of India (GoI)** increased the **windfall gains tax** on **diesel** and **Aviation Turbine Fuel (ATF)** exports, while **reducing the tax** on **petrol** exports.

According to the **Ministry of Finance (MoF)** notification, the revised tax rates came into effect from **16 July 2026**.

Windfall Tax is a government-imposed tax on industries that earn **sudden extraordinary profits** due to external factors such as **geopolitical crises**, with the objective of redirecting these gains towards **societal benefits**.

The **Special Additional Excise Duty (SAED)** on **diesel exports** was increased from **₹8.5 per litre to ₹15.5 per litre**.

The **SAED** on **Aviation Turbine Fuel (ATF) exports** was increased from **₹7.5 per litre to ₹14.5 per litre**.

The **Government of India** reduced the **export duty on petrol** from **₹4 per litre to ₹2.5 per litre**.

Merchandise exports grew by **15.92%** to **USD 129.32 billion**, reflecting strong performance in **manufacturing and value-added sectors**.

Non-petroleum exports increased by **12.44%** to **USD 106.30 billion**, indicating **broad-based export growth** beyond petroleum products.

Services exports remained robust at **USD 103.41 billion** during **April–June FY2026–27**, supporting **India's overall export performance**.

During **June 2026**, **total exports** reached **USD 73.45 billion**, registering a **9.48% year-on-year growth** over June 2025.

Merchandise exports in **June 2026** stood at **USD 40.41 billion**, contributing significantly to the overall export growth.

Total imports (Merchandise + Services) during **June 2026** were estimated at **USD 88.76 billion**, recording a growth of **over 26%** compared to the same month of the previous year.

India's overall trade deficit for **June 2026** stood at **USD 15.32 billion** (**Imports: USD 88.76 billion – Exports: USD 73.45 billion**).

The **major drivers** of **merchandise export growth** in **June 2026** were **Engineering Goods, Electronic Goods, Gems & Jewellery, Organic & Inorganic Chemicals, and Rice**.

430. As per the news, consider the following statements regarding the Urban Challenge Fund (UCF):

1. **The Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs (MoHUA) approved five urban development projects for Ahmedabad under the Urban Challenge Fund.**
2. **The total approved cost of these projects is ₹2,719.80 crore.**
3. **The approved projects include the Intelligent Water Management System (IWMS) and Intelligent Traffic Management System (ITMS).**

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

A.Only 1

B.Only 2

C.Only 1 and 3

D.All the above

E.Only 2 and 3

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

The **Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs (MoHUA)** approved **six transformative urban development projects** worth **₹2,719.80 crore** for **Ahmedabad, Gujarat** under the **Urban Challenge Fund (UCF)**.

The projects aim to **modernise urban infrastructure**, implement **smart city solutions**, improve **water and sanitation facilities**, and enhance **citizen services** in Ahmedabad.

The approved projects include **sewerage network rehabilitation, Intelligent Water Management System (IWMS), Integrated Sludge Management Facility, Intelligent Traffic Management System (ITMS), and Automatic Fare Collection System (AFCS)**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs (MoHUA)** approved **six transformative urban development projects** worth **₹2,719.80 crore** for **Ahmedabad, Gujarat** under the **Urban Challenge Fund (UCF)**.

The projects aim to **modernise urban infrastructure**, implement **smart city solutions**, improve **water and sanitation facilities**, and enhance **citizen services** in Ahmedabad.

The approved projects include **sewerage network rehabilitation, Intelligent Water Management System (IWMS), Integrated Sludge Management Facility, Intelligent Traffic Management System (ITMS), and Automatic Fare Collection System (AFCS)**.

The major project allocations include:

₹852.93 crore for rehabilitation of the **main sewerage network in West Ahmedabad**.

₹551.35 crore for strengthening the **East Ahmedabad sewerage network**.

₹290.24 crore for upgrading **old sewerage networks across Ahmedabad**.

₹215 crore for implementing an **Intelligent Water Management System (IWMS)**.

₹479.25 crore for establishing a **125 Tonnes Per Day (TPD) Integrated Sludge Management Facility**.

₹331.03 crore for implementing an **Intelligent Traffic Management System (ITMS)** and **Automatic Fare Collection System (AFCS)**.

431. As per the news, VISHWAS 2026, the one-time dispute resolution scheme launched by the Employees' Provident Fund Organisation (EPFO), will remain operational for how long from the date of its notification?

A.Three months

B.Six months

C.Nine months

D.One year

E.Two years

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The **Employees' Provident Fund Organisation (EPFO)** under the **Ministry of Labour and Employment (MoL&E)** launched **VISHWAS 2026**, a **one-time dispute resolution scheme** for the amicable settlement of damages and penalty-related disputes.

The scheme is applicable to disputes under **Section 14B of the Employees' Provident Funds and Miscellaneous Provisions Act, 1952** and **Section 128 of the Code on Social Security, 2020**.

VISHWAS 2026 aims to promote **voluntary compliance, reduce litigation, and ensure faster settlement of pending disputes** through a **transparent, fully digital, and time-bound process**.

The scheme was notified through **G.S.R. 525(E) on 29 June 2026** under the **Employees' Provident Fund Scheme, 2026** and will remain operational for **six months** from the date of notification.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Employees' Provident Fund Organisation (EPFO)** under the **Ministry of Labour and Employment (MoL&E)** launched **VISHWAS 2026**, a **one-time dispute resolution scheme** for the amicable settlement of damages and penalty-related disputes.

The scheme is applicable to disputes under **Section 14B of the Employees' Provident Funds and Miscellaneous Provisions Act, 1952** and **Section 128 of the Code on Social Security, 2020**.

VISHWAS 2026 aims to promote **voluntary compliance, reduce litigation, and ensure faster settlement of pending disputes** through a **transparent, fully digital, and time-bound process**.

The scheme was notified through **G.S.R. 525(E) on 29 June 2026** under the **Employees' Provident Fund Scheme, 2026** and will remain operational for **six months** from the date of notification.

Employers can apply through the **Employees' Provident Fund Organisation Employer Portal** using **Digital Signature Certificate (DSC)** or **electronic signature (e-Sign)** for digital verification and processing.

The scheme covers:

Damages and penalty orders under judicial challenge

Final orders with pending or partial recovery

Revenue Recovery Certificate (RRC) cases

Cases where notices have been issued but final orders are pending.

Employees' Provident Fund Organisation (EPFO) has established **VISHWAS Cells** to ensure smooth implementation of the scheme.

432. As per the news, India's first two 1,000-metre-deep geothermal wells have been commissioned at which location?

A.Tawang, Arunachal Pradesh

B.Manikaran, Himachal Pradesh

C.Kutch, Gujarat

D.Puga Valley, Ladakh

E.Dehradun, Uttarakhand

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

Lieutenant Governor of Ladakh V. K. Saxena commissioned **India's first two 1,000-metre-deep geothermal wells** at **Puga Valley, Ladakh**, developed by **Oil and Natural Gas Corporation Limited (ONGC) Energy Centre**. The geothermal wells will support the development of India's first **1 Megawatt (MW) demonstration-scale geothermal power plant** at **Puga Valley**, located at an altitude of over **14,000 feet above sea level**.

Detailed Explanation:

Lieutenant Governor of Ladakh V. K. Saxena commissioned **India's first two 1,000-metre-deep geothermal wells** at **Puga Valley, Ladakh**, developed by **Oil and Natural Gas Corporation Limited (ONGC) Energy Centre**. The geothermal wells will support the development of India's first **1 Megawatt (MW) demonstration-scale geothermal power plant** at **Puga Valley**, located at an altitude of over **14,000 feet above sea level**.

These wells are the first operational geothermal wells in India aimed at **clean energy generation** and will help evaluate the region's geothermal potential for future commercial projects.

The wells recorded a maximum temperature of **135°C at a depth of 400 metres**, providing important data on **thermal profiles, reservoir characteristics, and energy conversion mechanisms**.

433. As per the news, the "Roadmap for Building India as a Leading Bioeconomy Powerhouse by 2035" aims to expand India's bioeconomy to what value by 2035?

A.USD 250 billion

B.USD 400 billion

C.USD 500 billion

D.USD 691 billion

E.USD 2.6 trillion

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The **National Institution for Transforming India (NITI Aayog)** launched the **"Roadmap for Building India as a Leading Bioeconomy Powerhouse by 2035"** at the **National Media Centre, New Delhi**.

The roadmap was formally launched by **Union Minister of State (Independent Charge) for Science and Technology, Dr. Jitendra Singh**, in the presence of **Prof. Gobardhan Das, Member, NITI Aayog**, and **Nidhi Chhibber, Chief Executive Officer (CEO), NITI Aayog**.

The roadmap aims to expand India's **bioeconomy** to **USD 691 billion by 2035** and **USD 2.6 trillion by 2047**, generate over **30 million high-value jobs**, and position India among the **world's top three biotechnology powers by 2035**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **National Institution for Transforming India (NITI Aayog)** launched the **"Roadmap for Building India as a Leading Bioeconomy Powerhouse by 2035"** at the **National Media Centre, New Delhi**.

The roadmap was formally launched by **Union Minister of State (Independent Charge) for Science and Technology, Dr. Jitendra Singh**, in the presence of **Prof. Gobardhan Das, Member, NITI Aayog**, and **Nidhi Chhibber, Chief Executive Officer (CEO), NITI Aayog**.

The roadmap has been developed by the **NITI Frontier Tech Hub (NITI-FTH)** in consultation with the **Department of Biotechnology (DBT)** under the **Ministry of Science and Technology (MoST)**, **Association of Biotechnology Led Enterprises (ABLE)**, industry, academia, and other stakeholders.

The roadmap aims to expand India's **bioeconomy** to **USD 691 billion by 2035** and **USD 2.6 trillion by 2047**, generate over **30 million high-value jobs**, and position India among the **world's top three biotechnology powers by 2035**.

India's bioeconomy has grown **16 times in the last decade**, increasing from **USD 10 billion in 2014** to **USD 195.3 billion in 2025**, contributing around **4.8% of India's Gross Domestic Product (GDP)**.

The roadmap recommends the establishment of **six National BioMissions — GeneIndia, AgriBio 2.0, BioX Foundry, One Health Grid, Marine Biotechnology, and BioPharmaNext** — to accelerate innovation in healthcare, agriculture, synthetic biology, marine biotechnology, and biopharmaceuticals.

GeneIndia will be led by the **Department of Biotechnology (DBT)** in partnership with the **Indian Council of Medical Research (ICMR)** to expand affordable **gene therapies, cell therapies, and precision diagnostics**.

AgriBio 2.0 will be led by **Department of Biotechnology (DBT)**, **Indian Council of Agricultural Research (ICAR)**, and **Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers' Welfare (MoA&FW)** to develop **climate-resilient crop varieties** and quality-assured **bio-inputs**.

434. As per the news, the Government of Andhra Pradesh signed a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with UN-Habitat to establish a Centre of Excellence (CoE) for Urban Affairs in which city?

A.Visakhapatnam

B.Vijayawada

C.Kurnool

D.Tirupati

E.Amaravati

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

The **Government of Andhra Pradesh (AP)** signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** with the **United Nations Human Settlements Programme (UN-Habitat)** to establish a long-term partnership for promoting **sustainable, inclusive, and climate-resilient urban development** in the state.

The partnership aims to establish a **Centre of Excellence (CoE) for Urban Affairs** in **Amaravati, Andhra Pradesh**, which will support urban planning, climate-resilient cities, digital governance, municipal finance, and

implementation of **Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs)**.

The **Municipal Administration Department, Government of Andhra Pradesh** signed the MoU with **United Nations Human Settlements Programme (UN-Habitat)** to strengthen urban development initiatives across the state.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Government of Andhra Pradesh (AP)** signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** with the **United Nations Human Settlements Programme (UN-Habitat)** to establish a long-term partnership for promoting **sustainable, inclusive, and climate-resilient urban development** in the state.

The partnership aims to establish a **Centre of Excellence (CoE) for Urban Affairs** in **Amaravati, Andhra Pradesh**, which will support urban planning, climate-resilient cities, digital governance, municipal finance, and implementation of **Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs)**.

The **Municipal Administration Department, Government of Andhra Pradesh** signed the MoU with **United Nations Human Settlements Programme (UN-Habitat)** to strengthen urban development initiatives across the state.

The collaboration will support key initiatives including:

Sustainable Urban Revitalisation and Growth Enhancement Andhra Pradesh (SURGE AP)

Resilient, Inclusive and Sustainable Environment Andhra Pradesh (RISE AP)

UPLIFT Andhra Pradesh

Zero Poverty vision through the P4 Programme

The MoU was signed in the presence of **N. Chandrababu Naidu, Chief Minister of Andhra Pradesh**, and **Anacláudia Rossbach, Executive Director, United Nations Human Settlements Programme (UN-Habitat)**, who participated virtually from Singapore.

435. As per the news, the Office of the Controller General of Patents, Designs and Trade Marks (CGPDTM) signed an MoU with CSIR-NIScPR to participate in which initiative?

A.National Digital Library of India (NDLI)

B.National Knowledge Resource Consortium (NKRC)

C.National Research Foundation (NRF)

D.One Nation One Subscription (ONOS)

E.National Intellectual Property Mission (NIPM)

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The **Office of the Controller General of Patents, Designs and Trade Marks (CGPDTM)** and the **Council of Scientific and Industrial Research- National Institute of Science Communication and Policy Research (CSIR-NIScPR)** signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** to enable CGPDTM's participation in the **National Knowledge Resource Consortium (NKRC)**.

The MoU was signed by **Prof. (Dr.) Unnat P. Pandit, Controller General of Patents, Designs and Trade Marks (CGPDTM)**, and **Dr.**

Geeta Vani Rayasam, Director, Council of Scientific and Industrial Research-National Institute of Science Communication and Policy Research (CSIR-NIScPR) at **Saraswati Hall, Bouddhik Sampada Bhawan, New Delhi**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Office of the Controller General of Patents, Designs and Trade Marks (CGPDTM)** and the **Council of Scientific and Industrial Research- National Institute of Science Communication and Policy Research (CSIR-NIScPR)** signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** to enable CGPDTM's participation in the **National Knowledge Resource Consortium (NKRC)**.

The MoU was signed by **Prof. (Dr.) Unnat P. Pandit, Controller General of Patents, Designs and Trade Marks (CGPDTM)**, and **Dr. Geeta Vani Rayasam, Director, Council of Scientific and Industrial Research-National Institute of Science Communication and Policy Research (CSIR-NIScPR)** at **Saraswati Hall, Bouddhik Sampada Bhawan, New Delhi**.

Under the agreement, **Controller General of Patents, Designs and Trade Marks (CGPDTM)** will receive access to the **National Knowledge Resource Consortium (NKRC) digital knowledge platform**, which provides international scientific journals, e-books, databases, patents, and other academic resources.

The partnership aims to strengthen **scientific research, innovation, and intellectual property administration** by providing patent professionals and researchers access to high-quality global knowledge resources.

436. As per the news, who was elected as the new Chairman of the Economic Community of West African States (ECOWAS) during the 69th Ordinary Session of the ECOWAS Authority of Heads of State and Government?

A.Bassirou Diomaye Diakhar Faye

B.Julius Maada Bio

C.Bola Ahmed Tinubu

D.Patrice Talon

E.John Dramani Mahama

Answer: A

Bassirou Diomaye Diakhar Faye, **President of Senegal**, was elected as the new **Chairman** of the **Economic Community of West African States (ECOWAS)** during the **69th Ordinary Session** of the **ECOWAS Authority of Heads of State and Government** held in **Freetown, Sierra Leone**.

Bassirou Diomaye Diakhar Faye will serve a **mandatory one-year term** as **ECOWAS Chairman** and succeeded **President Julius Maada Bio of Sierra Leone**, who had served as ECOWAS Chairman since **June 2025**.

437. As per the news, who became the 59th Prime Minister of the United Kingdom (UK) after Keir Starmer resigned from the post?

A.Keir Starmer

B.Rishi Sunak

C.Robert Kenyon

D.Andy Burnham

E.David Lammy

Answer: D

Andy Burnham became the **59th Prime Minister (PM)** of the **United Kingdom (UK)** after **Keir Starmer** resigned from the post.

King Charles III invited **Andy Burnham** to **Buckingham Palace** to form the new government through the traditional **"kissing hands"** ceremony.

Andy Burnham secured nearly **55% of the vote** in the **Labour Party leadership election**, defeating **Reform UK's Robert Kenyon** by a margin of more than **9,000 votes**.

438. As per the news, India signed a Foreign Military Sales (FMS) Agreement with the United States to procure 24 MH-60R Seahawk helicopters in which year?

A.2018

B.2019

C.2020

D.2021

E.2022

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The **United States of America (USA)** delivered the **21st MH-60R Seahawk multi-role maritime helicopter** to the **Indian Navy (IN)** at **Kochi, Kerala**, further strengthening the **India–USA defence partnership** and enhancing India's **maritime security capabilities**.

India signed a **Foreign Military Sales (FMS) Agreement** with the **USA** in **February 2020** to procure **24 MH-60R Seahawk helicopters** at a total cost of **USD 2.6 billion**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **United States of America (USA)** delivered the **21st MH-60R Seahawk multi-role maritime helicopter** to the **Indian Navy (IN)** at **Kochi, Kerala**, further strengthening the **India–USA defence partnership** and enhancing India's **maritime security capabilities**.

The induction of the **MH-60R Seahawk** will enhance the **Indian Navy's operational readiness**, strengthen its **Anti-Submarine Warfare (ASW)** capabilities, and improve **interoperability** with the **United States Navy (US Navy)** in the **Indian Ocean Region (IOR)**.

India signed a **Foreign Military Sales (FMS) Agreement** with the **USA** in **February 2020** to procure **24 MH-60R Seahawk helicopters** at a total cost of **USD 2.6 billion**.

The procurement aims to replace the ageing **Sea King fleet** and significantly strengthen the **Indian Navy's naval aviation capabilities**.

439. As per the World Directory of Modern Military Aircraft (WDMMA) 2026 Global Air Power Rankings, the Indian Air Force (IAF) has retained which position among the world's independent air forces?

A.1st

B.2nd

C.3rd

D.5th

E.6th

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The **Indian Air Force (IAF)** has retained its position as the **World's 3rd Most Powerful Independent Air Force** for the **5th consecutive year** in the **World Directory of Modern Military Aircraft (WDMMA) 2026 Global Air Power Rankings**.

In the **Independent Air Force Rankings**, only the **United States** and **Russia** rank above the **Indian Air Force (IAF)**, placing **India at 3rd position globally**.

The **World Directory of Modern Military Aircraft (WDMMA)** assessed **129 air services** across **103 countries** using its **True Value Rating (TVR)** system.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Indian Air Force (IAF)** has retained its position as the **World's 3rd Most Powerful Independent Air Force** for the **5th consecutive year** in the **World Directory of Modern Military Aircraft (WDMMA) 2026 Global Air Power Rankings**.

In the **Independent Air Force Rankings**, only the **United States** and **Russia** rank above the **Indian Air Force (IAF)**, placing **India at 3rd position globally**.

The **World Directory of Modern Military Aircraft (WDMMA)** assessed **129 air services** across **103 countries** using its **True Value Rating (TVR)** system.

The **True Value Rating (TVR)** evaluates **fleet quality, technology, modernisation, logistics**, and **operational capability**, rather than simply counting the number of aircraft.

When all **military aviation branches** (Air Force, Navy and Army) are considered together, the **Indian Air Force (IAF)** ranks **6th globally**, behind the **US Air Force, US Navy, Russian Air Force, US Army, and US Marines**.

In the **combined military aviation rankings**, **China's Air Force** is placed at **7th position**, immediately after the **Indian Air Force (IAF)**.

440. As per the news, Jammu & Kashmir (J&K) Bank signed a Share Purchase Agreement (SPA) to sell its 0.5% stake in PNB MetLife India Insurance Company to which entity?

A.Punjab National Bank

B.Life Insurance Corporation of India (LIC)

C.MetLife International Holdings, LLC

D.HDFC Life Insurance Company

E.SBI Life Insurance Company

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

Jammu & Kashmir (J&K) Bank signed a **Share Purchase Agreement (SPA)** to sell its **0.5% stake** in **PNB MetLife India Insurance Company** to **MetLife International Holdings, LLC** for approximately **₹120.1 crore**.

Under the transaction, **J&K Bank** will divest **10.25 million equity shares** in **PNB MetLife** at a price of **₹117.20 per share**, taking the total transaction value to **₹120.1 crore**.

Detailed Explanation:

Jammu & Kashmir (J&K) Bank signed a **Share Purchase Agreement (SPA)** to sell its **0.5% stake** in **PNB MetLife India Insurance Company** to **MetLife International Holdings, LLC** for approximately **₹120.1 crore**.

Under the transaction, **J&K Bank** will divest **10.25 million equity shares** in **PNB MetLife** at a price of **₹117.20 per share**, taking the total transaction value to **₹120.1 crore**.

After completion of the deal, **J&K Bank's shareholding** in **PNB MetLife** will reduce from **3.034% to 2.534%** (approximately **3% to 2.5%**).

MetLife International Holdings, LLC, an existing promoter and shareholder of **PNB MetLife India Insurance Company**, is acquiring the **additional stake** from **J&K Bank**.

441. As per the news, the YFQ-44A Fury, which successfully conducted the first live missile launch by a Collaborative Combat Aircraft (CCA), was developed by which company?

A.Lockheed Martin

B.Boeing

C.Northrop Grumman

D.Anduril Industries

E.General Atomics

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The **United States Air Force (USAF)** successfully conducted the **first live missile launch** by a **Collaborative Combat Aircraft (CCA)** using the **YFQ-44A Fury drone** at **Edwards Air Force Base, California, USA**.

The **YFQ-44A Fury** fired a live **AIM-120 Advanced Medium-Range Air-to-Air Missile (AMRAAM)** at a digital target over the **Mojave Desert**.

The successful test marked the **first-ever live Air Intercept Missile launch** by a **US Collaborative Combat Aircraft (CCA)**.

The **YFQ-44A Fury** is an advanced **semi-autonomous Unmanned Combat Aerial Vehicle (UCAV)** developed by **Anduril Industries**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **United States Air Force (USAF)** successfully conducted the **first live missile launch** by a **Collaborative Combat Aircraft (CCA)** using the **YFQ-44A Fury drone** at **Edwards Air Force Base, California, USA**.

The **YFQ-44A Fury** fired a live **AIM-120 Advanced Medium-Range Air-to-Air Missile (AMRAAM)** at a digital target over the **Mojave Desert**.

The successful test marked the **first-ever live Air Intercept Missile launch** by a **US Collaborative Combat Aircraft (CCA)**.

The live-fire test was conducted in coordination with the **412th Test Wing's Air Dominance Combined Test Force**, comprising active-duty military personnel, government civilians, and government contractors.

The **YFQ-44A Fury** is an advanced **semi-autonomous Unmanned Combat Aerial**

Vehicle (UCAV) developed by **Anduril Industries**.

The **YFQ-44A Fury** is designed to operate alongside **crewed fighter aircraft** such as the **F-35** and **F-22**, providing additional sensors, weapons, and operational support during combat missions.

442. As per the news, the newly discovered exoplanet Beta Pictoris d was discovered using which space telescope?

A.Hubble Space Telescope

B.Chandra X-ray Observatory

C.James Webb Space Telescope (JWST)

D.Spitzer Space Telescope

E.Kepler Space Telescope

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

Astronomers using National Aeronautics and Space Administration **(NASA)'s James Webb Space Telescope (JWST)** discovered a new giant exoplanet, **Beta Pictoris d**, located **63 light-years** from Earth and estimated to be about **23 million years old**.

With the discovery of **Beta Pictoris d**, the **Beta Pictoris system** has become only the **second known planetary system** with at least **three directly imaged planets**.

Detailed Explanation:

Astronomers using National Aeronautics and Space Administration **(NASA)'s James Webb Space Telescope (JWST)** discovered a new giant exoplanet, **Beta Pictoris d**, located **63 light-years** from Earth and estimated to be about **23 million years old**.

With the discovery of **Beta Pictoris d**, the **Beta Pictoris system** has become only the **second known planetary system** with at least **three directly imaged planets**.

Beta Pictoris d orbits the nearby star **Beta Pictoris**, which already hosts **Beta Pictoris b** and **Beta Pictoris c**.

Beta Pictoris b is notable as one of the **first exoplanets ever directly imaged**, making the **Beta Pictoris system** historically significant in exoplanet research.

JWST's Near-Infrared Spectrograph (NIRSpec) detected the unique **chemical fingerprint** of **Beta Pictoris d's atmosphere**, enabling its discovery.

Beta Pictoris d is estimated to have at least **twice the mass of Jupiter**, making it the **smallest of the three known giant planets** in the Beta Pictoris system.

443. As per the news, Tata Consultancy Services (TCS), in collaboration with Google Cloud, launched the Gemini Experience Centre (GEC) in which city?

A.Bengaluru

B.Chennai

C.Hyderabad

D.Kolkata

E.Pune

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

Tata Consultancy Services (TCS), in collaboration with **Google Cloud**, launched a **Gemini Experience Centre (GEC)** in **Kolkata, West Bengal**, to showcase **Artificial Intelligence (AI)**-driven innovations for **consumer businesses**.

The **Kolkata Gemini Experience Centre** is the **3rd GEC in India**, following the centres established in **Chennai** and **Bengaluru**.

TCS plans to establish **10 Gemini Experience Centres (GECs)** globally by the **end of 2026**, including **4 centres in India**.

Detailed Explanation:

Tata Consultancy Services (TCS), in collaboration with **Google Cloud**, launched a **Gemini Experience Centre (GEC)** in **Kolkata, West Bengal**, to showcase **Artificial Intelligence (AI)**-driven innovations for **consumer businesses**.

The **Kolkata Gemini Experience Centre** is the **3rd GEC in India**, following the centres established in **Chennai** and **Bengaluru**.

TCS plans to establish **10 Gemini Experience Centres (GECs)** globally by the **end of 2026**, including **4 centres in India**.

The **Gemini Experience Centre (GEC)** is built using **Google Cloud** infrastructure and **Google's Gemini AI models** to accelerate enterprise AI adoption.

The centre will enable businesses in **Retail**, **Consumer Packaged Goods (CPG)**, **Travel**, **Tourism**, and **Hospitality** to **co-create**, **test**, and **scale AI-powered solutions**

444. As per the news, the official mascot unveiled for the Badminton World Federation (BWF) World Championships 2026 is named_____

A.Peacko

B.Shera

C.Shuttle

D.Vikram

E.Champ

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

Union Minister for Youth Affairs and Sports Mansukh Mandaviya and **Dr. Himanta Biswa Sarma, President of Badminton Association of India and Chief Minister of Assam**, unveiled the official **mascot 'Peacko'** and launched the championship anthem for the **Badminton World Federation (BWF) World Championships 2026** in **New Delhi, Delhi**.

The **30th edition of the Badminton World Federation World Championships** will be held from **17–23 August 2026** at the **Indira Gandhi Indoor Stadium, New Delhi**.

Detailed Explanation:

Union Minister for Youth Affairs and Sports Mansukh Mandaviya and **Dr. Himanta Biswa Sarma, President of Badminton Association of India and Chief Minister of Assam**, unveiled the official **mascot 'Peacko'** and launched the championship anthem for the **Badminton World Federation (BWF) World Championships 2026** in **New Delhi, Delhi**.

The **30th edition of the Badminton World Federation World Championships** will be held

from **17–23 August 2026** at the **Indira Gandhi Indoor Stadium, New Delhi**.

The championship will witness participation from more than 400 badminton players from over 50 countries.

The official mascot **'Peacko'** is inspired by the **Indian Peafowl (Peacock)** and represents the **pride, vibrancy, and sporting spirit of India**.

The championship anthem features India's **16-member Badminton World Federation World Championships contingent**, highlighting the **energy, ambition, and unity of Indian badminton**.

445. As per the news, National Broadcasting Day is observed every year in India on which date?

A.15 August

B.23 July

C.26 January

D.14 November

E.2 October

Answer: B

National Broadcasting Day is observed every year on **23 July** in India to commemorate the **first-ever radio broadcast in the country**, which took place on **23 July 1927**.

National Broadcasting Day 2026 marks the beginning of organised radio broadcasting in India and highlights the role of broadcasting in **information dissemination, education, entertainment, and national development**.

446. According to the provisional data released by the Reserve Bank of India (RBI), India's Outward Foreign Direct Investment (FDI) stood at approximately how much in June 2026?

A.USD 1.5 billion

B.USD 2.0 billion

C.USD 3.0 billion

D.USD 4.5 billion

E.USD 5.74 billion

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

According to provisional data released by the **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)**, India's **Outward Foreign Direct Investment (FDI)** declined by **47.9% Year-on-Year (Y-o-Y)** to **USD 3 billion** in **June 2026**, compared to **USD 5.74 billion** in **June 2025**.

On a **month-on-month basis**, Outward FDI also declined from **USD 4.5 billion in May 2026** to **USD 3 billion in June 2026**.

Detailed Explanation:

According to provisional data released by the **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)**, India's **Outward Foreign Direct Investment (FDI)** declined by **47.9% Year-on-Year (Y-o-Y)** to **USD 3 billion** in **June 2026**, compared to **USD 5.74 billion** in **June 2025**.

On a **month-on-month basis**, Outward FDI also declined from **USD 4.5 billion in May 2026** to **USD 3 billion in June 2026**.

Outward FDI comprises three components: **Equity Commitments**, **Debt**

(Loans) Commitments, and **Guarantees**, all of which recorded a decline in June 2026.

Equity Commitments declined sharply to **USD 738 million** in June 2026, compared to **USD 2.2 billion** in June 2025 and **USD 1.25 billion** in May 2026.

Debt Commitments decreased to **USD 469.87 million** in June 2026, from **USD 568.54 million** in June 2025 and **USD 645.75 million** in May 2026.

Guarantees issued by Indian entities to overseas subsidiaries and ventures declined to **USD 1.78 billion** in June 2026, compared to **USD 2.97 billion** in June 2025 and **USD 2.61 billion** in May 2026.

447. As per the news, Electronic Gold Receipts (EGRs), recently in the news, are traded on stock exchanges and represent ownership of gold stored in whose regulated vaults?

A.Reserve Bank of India (RBI)

B.Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI)

C.Ministry of Finance

D.National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI)

E.Small Industries Development Bank of India (SIDBI)

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Electronic Gold Receipts (**EGRs**) are **exchange-traded securities** introduced by the **National Stock Exchange (NSE)** that represent ownership of **physical gold** stored in **SEBI-regulated vaults**.

The **NSE** launched the **Electronic Gold Receipts (EGR) Segment** in **May 2026** to provide a **regulated, transparent and secure platform** for buying and selling gold in electronic form.

Detailed Explanation:

Electronic Gold Receipts (**EGRs**) are **exchange-traded securities** introduced by the **National Stock Exchange (NSE)** that represent ownership of **physical gold** stored in **SEBI-regulated vaults**.

The **NSE** launched the **Electronic Gold Receipts (EGR) Segment** in **May 2026** to provide a **regulated, transparent and secure platform** for buying and selling gold in electronic form.

Gold backing every **EGR** is stored in **SEBI-regulated vaults**, allowing investors to own **physical gold** without storing it at home or in bank lockers.

EGRs are held in **demat form**, can be bought and sold like **shares on stock exchanges**, and follow a **T+1 settlement cycle**, with receipts credited to the buyer's **demat account** on the next trading day.

Eligible participants include **retail investors**, **jewellers**, **bullion traders**, **refiners** and **institutional investors**.

Electronic Gold Receipts are available in two purity standards: **999 (99.9% pure gold)** and **995 (99.5% pure gold)**.

448. As per the news, the Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) has cautioned regulated entities against which cyber fraud that involves impersonation of senior company executives to trick employees into transferring funds?

A.Phishing Scam

B.Ransomware Attack

C.Boss Scam

D.SIM Swap Fraud

E.QR Code Scam

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The **Securities and Exchange Board of India** (**SEBI**) has warned regulated entities and listed companies against the rising "**Boss Scam**", a cyber fraud primarily targeting **finance and accounts departments**.

In a **Boss Scam**, fraudsters impersonate **Chief Executive Officers (CEOs)**, **Managing Directors (MDs)**, or other **senior executives** to deceive employees into making **unauthorised fund transfers**.

SEBI issued the advisory after receiving inputs from the **Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre (I4C)** regarding the increasing number of **Boss Scam** incidents.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Securities and Exchange Board of India** (**SEBI**) has warned regulated entities and listed companies against the rising "**Boss Scam**", a cyber fraud primarily targeting **finance and accounts departments**.

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SEBI issued the advisory after receiving inputs from the **Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre (I4C)** regarding the increasing number of **Boss Scam** incidents.

Cybercriminals contact employees through **emails**, **WhatsApp**, **Microsoft Teams**, and **social media platforms**, pretending to be **senior company officials** and directing them to transfer funds to fraud-controlled bank accounts (**mule accounts**).

Fraudsters use **Artificial Intelligence (AI)-based deepfake technology**, including **voice cloning**, **fake video calls**, and **fake social media groups**, to create convincing identities of **CEOs** and **senior executives**.

In some cases, fraudsters falsely claim that the payment is related to **Unpublished Price Sensitive Information (UPSI)** and instruct employees to maintain **strict secrecy**, increasing the chances of **successful fraud**.

449. As per the news, the Mini Nandi Farmer Prosperity Scheme launched by the Government of Uttar Pradesh provides what percentage of subsidy for establishing a 10-cow dairy unit?

A.25%

B.35%

C.40%

D.50%

E.75%

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The **Government of Uttar Pradesh** launched the **Mini Nandi Farmer Prosperity Scheme** to promote **scientific dairy farming** using **high-yielding indigenous cattle breeds** and enhance farmers' income through financial assistance.

The scheme provides **50% subsidy up to ₹11.80 lakh** for establishing a **10-cow dairy unit** with an estimated project cost of **₹23.60 lakh**.

The funding pattern includes **50% government subsidy**, **15% beneficiary contribution**, and **35% bank loan**.

Beneficiaries may also use their own funds instead of a bank loan by providing proof of sufficient financial resources.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Government of Uttar Pradesh** launched the **Mini Nandi Farmer Prosperity Scheme** to promote **scientific dairy farming** using **high-yielding indigenous cattle breeds** and enhance farmers' income through financial assistance.

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The funding pattern includes **50% government subsidy**, **15% beneficiary contribution**, and **35% bank loan**.

Beneficiaries may also use their own funds instead of a bank loan by providing proof of sufficient financial resources.

The subsidy is released in **two instalments**: **First instalment (25%)** after creation of dairy infrastructure.

Second instalment (25%) after purchase and verification of eligible indigenous cattle.

The subsidy is transferred through the **Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT)** system.

Eligible indigenous cattle breeds under the scheme include **Gir, Sahiwal, and Tharparkar**, with preference for animals procured from recognised breeding centres.

Only cows in their **first or second lactation** and within **45 days of lactation** are eligible. The animals must be **ear-tagged** and **insured**.

450. As per the news, the Common Service Centres (CSC) Scheme is being implemented under which flagship programme of the Government of India?

A.Skill India Programme

B.Startup India Programme

C.Digital India Programme

D.Make in India Programme

E.Stand-Up India Programme

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The **Common Service Centres (CSC) Scheme**, launched under the **Digital India Programme**, has expanded digital public service delivery through **CSC 4.0**, enabling citizens in **rural and semi-urban areas** to

access government, financial, and digital services.

Common Service Centres are operated by **Village Level Entrepreneurs (VLEs)**, who act as the link between citizens and government services while promoting **self-employment and digital inclusion**.

Under **CSC 4.0**, centres are being connected through **BharatNet** to provide high-speed internet connectivity and improve access to digital services in remote areas.

Detailed Explanation:

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Under **CSC 4.0**, centres are being connected through **BharatNet** to provide high-speed internet connectivity and improve access to digital services in remote areas.

CSCs provide more than **500 online services**, including **Ayushman Bharat Card registration, Permanent Account Number (PAN) Card services, electronic Know Your Customer (e-KYC) for Pradhan Mantri Kisan Samman Nidhi (PM-KISAN), passport application support, Aadhaar-related services, banking, insurance, pension, utility bill payments, and government certificate services**.

To become a **Village Level Entrepreneur (VLE)**, an applicant must be an **Indian citizen**, have passed at least the **10th standard**, possess basic computer knowledge, and have a **computer/laptop, internet connection, and smartphone**.

451. As per the news, which village has been recognised as Tamil Nadu's first Climate-Resilient Village?

A.Mamallapuram

B.Dhanushkodi

C.Kumbakonam

D.Velankanni

E.Killai

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

Killai village in **Cuddalore district, Tamil Nadu**, has been recognised as the **first Climate-Resilient Village** in the State.

Located near the **Pichavaram Mangrove Forest**, the village has adopted a **community-based climate adaptation model** to address challenges such as **cyclones, floods, coastal erosion, sea-level rise, and saltwater intrusion**.

Detailed Explanation:

Killai village in **Cuddalore district, Tamil Nadu**, has been recognised as the **first Climate-Resilient Village** in the State.

Located near the **Pichavaram Mangrove Forest**, the village has adopted a **community-based climate adaptation model** to address challenges such as **cyclones, floods, coastal erosion, sea-level rise, and saltwater intrusion**.

The initiative integrates scientific planning, ecosystem conservation, climate-resilient infrastructure, sustainable water management, and community participation to strengthen resilience against climate change.

The project focuses on **climate adaptation** by improving preparedness, reducing disaster risks, protecting livelihoods, and promoting sustainable development.

452. As per the news, which country has the most electrified railway system in the world, ahead of India?

A.Japan

B.France

C.China

D.Switzerland

E.Spain

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

Indian Railways has achieved **99.6% electrification of its Broad Gauge (BG) railway network**, becoming the **second most electrified railway system in the world** after **Switzerland (100%)**.

According to the **International Union of Railways (UIC)** report (June 2025), **India (99.6%)** ranks ahead of **China (82%)**, **Spain (67%)**, **Japan (64%)**, **France (60%)**, and the **United Kingdom (39%)** in railway electrification.

Detailed Explanation:

Indian Railways has achieved **99.6% electrification of its Broad Gauge (BG) railway network**, becoming the **second most electrified railway system in the world** after **Switzerland (100%)**.

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Since **2014**, Indian Railways has electrified **48,072 route kilometres**, compared to **21,801 route kilometres** electrified during the previous six decades, making it one of the world's fastest railway electrification programmes.

All newly constructed railway lines and multi-tracking projects are now being developed with **electrification from the initial stage**.

Railway electrification has significantly reduced dependence on diesel. **Diesel consumption** declined from **293 crore litres (2015–16)** to **108 crore litres (2024–25)**, saving fuel costs, reducing crude oil imports, and lowering greenhouse gas emissions.

453. As per the news, President Droupadi Murmu inaugurated a statue of Mahatma

Gandhi during her visit to which European country?

A.Serbia

B.Albania

C.North Macedonia

D.Bulgaria

E.Croatia

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

President Droupadi Murmu inaugurated a **statue of Mahatma Gandhi** at the **Museum of the City of Skopje**, **Skopje, North Macedonia**, during her **three-nation visit to Europe**.

The event was attended by **President Gordana Siljanovska-Davkova of North Macedonia**, highlighting the strengthening of **India–North Macedonia bilateral relations**.

The statue symbolises India's commitment to promoting **peace, non-violence (Ahimsa), truth (Satya), and humanity**, reflecting the universal values advocated by **Mahatma Gandhi**.

Detailed Explanation:

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The statue symbolises India's commitment to promoting **peace, non-violence (Ahimsa), truth (Satya), and humanity**, reflecting the universal values advocated by **Mahatma Gandhi**.

Addressing the gathering, **President Droupadi Murmu** stated that Mahatma Gandhi's ideals of **truth, non-violence, justice, dignity, dialogue, empathy, and peaceful coexistence** continue to inspire people across the world.

She noted that Gandhi's philosophy remains relevant in addressing **global conflicts, intolerance, and social challenges** through peaceful means.

The newly unveiled statue will serve as a symbol of:

Friendship between India and North Macedonia

Cultural and diplomatic cooperation

Mutual commitment to peace and tolerance

Shared humanitarian values

During her visit, **President Droupadi Murmu**, along with **President Gordana Siljanovska-Davkova**, also visited the **Memorial House of Mother Teresa** in **Skopje**.

454. As per the news, the Uniform Civil Code (UCC) is based on which Article of the Constitution of India?

A.Article 44

B.Article 39A

C.Article 42

D.Article 51A

E.Article 370

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

The **Madhya Pradesh Cabinet** approved the **Uniform Civil Code (UCC) Bill, 2026**, making **Madhya Pradesh** the **fourth state** after **Uttarakhand, Gujarat, and Assam** to adopt a **Uniform Civil Code** framework.

The **Uniform Civil Code** is based on **Article 44** of the **Directive Principles of State Policy (DPSP)** in the **Constitution of India**, which directs the State to endeavour to secure a uniform civil code for all citizens.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Madhya Pradesh Cabinet** approved the **Uniform Civil Code (UCC) Bill, 2026**, making **Madhya Pradesh** the **fourth state** after **Uttarakhand, Gujarat, and Assam** to adopt a **Uniform Civil Code** framework.

The Bill seeks to establish **uniform civil laws** for all citizens in matters relating to **marriage, divorce, inheritance, adoption, maintenance, succession, and live-in relationships**, irrespective of religion.

The Bill was approved during a **special Cabinet meeting in Bhopal** and will be introduced in the **Madhya Pradesh Legislative Assembly** during the **Monsoon Session**.

The **Uniform Civil Code** is based on **Article 44** of the **Directive Principles of State Policy (DPSP)** in the **Constitution of India**, which directs the State to endeavour to secure a uniform civil code for all citizens.

455. As per the news, India's first Artificial Intelligence (AI)-powered bird sanctuary will be developed at which sanctuary in Maharashtra?

A.Karnala Bird Sanctuary

B.Bhigwan Bird Sanctuary

C.Thane Creek Flamingo Sanctuary

D.Nagzira Wildlife Sanctuary

E.Radhanagari Wildlife Sanctuary

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The **Government of Maharashtra** approved the development of **India's first Artificial Intelligence (AI)-powered bird sanctuary** at the **Thane Creek Flamingo Sanctuary (TCFS)** with an investment of **₹45 crore**.

The project will establish the country's **first Artificial Intelligence-based bird detection and monitoring centre**, integrating advanced technology with **wildlife conservation** and **eco-tourism**.

Thane Creek Flamingo Sanctuary (TCFS) is located between **Mumbai and Navi Mumbai, Maharashtra**, and was declared **India's first flamingo sanctuary** in **2015**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Government of Maharashtra** approved the development of **India's first Artificial Intelligence (AI)-powered bird sanctuary** at the **Thane Creek Flamingo Sanctuary (TCFS)** with an investment of **₹45 crore**.

The project will establish the country's **first Artificial Intelligence-based bird detection and monitoring centre**, integrating advanced technology with **wildlife conservation** and **eco-tourism**.

Thane Creek Flamingo Sanctuary (TCFS) is located between **Mumbai and Navi Mumbai, Maharashtra**, and was declared **India's first flamingo sanctuary** in **2015**.

The sanctuary is an important **coastal wetland ecosystem** situated along the **Central Asian Flyway**, a major migratory route connecting **Europe, Central Asia, and the Indian subcontinent**.

The project will use **Artificial Intelligence-enabled cameras** to:

Identify bird species automatically.

Monitor migratory bird movements in real time.

Collect scientific data for long-term research.

Provide interactive digital displays for visitors.

The Artificial Intelligence-based monitoring system will cover **1.5 kilometres** of the sanctuary.

456. As per the news, which organisation is the nodal laboratory of DRDO for the Airborne Early Warning & Control (AEW&C) Mk-II Programme?

A.Defence Electronics Research Laboratory (DLRL)

B.Centre for Air Borne Systems (CABS)

C.Aeronautical Development Establishment (ADE)

D.Electronics and Radar Development Establishment (LRDE)

E.Defence Avionics Research Establishment (DARE)

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Centre for Air Borne Systems (CABS), Defence Research and Development Organisation **(DRDO)** signed a contract with **AI Engineering Services Limited (AIESL), New Delhi** for the conversion of **six Airbus A321 aircraft** from commercial to **green configuration** under the **Airborne Early Warning & Control (AEW&C) Mk-II Programme**.

CABS, DRDO also signed a separate contract with **Adani Defence Systems and Technologies Limited (ADSTL), Ahmedabad** to serve as the **Development-cum-Production Partner (DcPP)** for the **Mission Systems** of the **AEW&C Mk-II Programme**.

Detailed Explanation:

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CABS, DRDO also signed a separate contract with **Adani Defence Systems and**

Technologies Limited (ADSTL), Ahmedabad to serve as the **Development-cum-Production Partner (DcPP)** for the **Mission Systems** of the **AEW&C Mk-II Programme**.

The contracts were signed on **22 July 2026** in **New Delhi** in the presence of Defence Secretary, Secretary, Department of Defence R&D, and Chairman, DRDO, **Shri Rajesh Kumar Singh**.

The agreements were signed by the **Director, CABS** with the **CEO of AIESL** and the **Head-Airborne Platform of ADSTL**.

AIESL will undertake the conversion of **six A321 aircraft** into green configuration, preparing them for the installation of advanced **AEW&C mission systems**.

CABS is the **nodal laboratory of DRDO** for the AEW&C Mk-II Programme and is responsible for the **integration of mission systems** on the modified aircraft.

ADSTL, as the Development-cum-Production Partner (DcPP), will support CABS in the **development, integration, and production** of the Mission Systems

457. NAs per the news, what is the name of India's first-ever Tri-Service all-women circumnavigation sailing expedition?

A.Samudra Pradakshina

B.Sagar Parikrama

C.Samudra Shakti

D.Sagar Kavach

E.Triveni Yatra

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

Raksha Mantri Shri Rajnath Singh flagged-in **'Samudra Pradakshina'**, the **first-ever Tri-Service all-women circumnavigation sailing expedition**, through **video conferencing** on **22 July 2026**.

The expedition was carried out aboard the **Indian Army Sailing Vessel (IASV) Triveni**, with **9 women officers** from the **Indian Army, Indian Navy, and Indian Air Force** successfully completing the historic mission.

The expedition lasted **314 days**, covered nearly **25,500 nautical miles**, and traversed **4 oceans**, making it one of India's most significant **Tri-Service maritime expeditions**.

Detailed Explanation:

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The expedition lasted **314 days**, covered nearly **25,500 nautical miles**, and traversed **4 oceans**, making it one of India's most significant **Tri-Service maritime expeditions**.

The mission was **virtually flagged-off** by **Rajnath Singh** on **11 September 2025** from **Mumbai, Maharashtra**.

Rajnath Singh described the expedition as a symbol of **Nari Shakti**, **Tri-Service synergy**, **jointness**, and the spirit of **New India**, demonstrating courage, resilience, and national capability.

The expedition was accomplished through **nearly two years of intensive training**, **meticulous planning**, **24×7 shore-based support**, and coordinated efforts of multiple organisations.

458. As per the news, the Yantur 4.5 kN Turbofan Engine is being developed by Paninian India Private Limited to power which autonomous platform?

A.Svayatt L1

B.Archer-NG

C.TAPAS UAV

D.Ghatak UCAV

E.Rustom-II

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

Paninian India Private Limited, a deep-tech and aerospace startup, launched the **Yantur 4.5 kilo-Newton (kN) Turbofan Engine Programme**, envisioned as India's first privately developed turbofan engine in its class.

The **Yantur Engine Programme** marks a significant milestone in developing indigenous private-sector capability in **compact aerospace propulsion** for **next-generation autonomous systems**.

The **Yantur 4.5 kN Turbofan Engine** is being developed to power **Svayatt L1**, Paninian India's **long-range autonomous cruise missile platform**.

Detailed Explanation:

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The **Yantur Engine Programme** marks a significant milestone in developing indigenous private-sector capability in **compact aerospace propulsion** for **next-generation autonomous systems**.

The **Yantur 4.5 kN Turbofan Engine** is being developed to power **Svayatt L1**, Paninian India's **long-range autonomous cruise missile platform**.

The **Svayatt L1 platform** is designed to meet the operational requirements of the **Ministry of Defence (MoD)** under the **Make-I Programme** for the **Long-Range Land Attack Cruise Missile (LRLACM)**.

The Yantur Engine has the potential to be upgraded from **4.5 kN to 12.5 kN**, enabling it to power the **Svayatt Collaborative Combat Aerial Vehicle (CCAV)** platform.

459. As per the news, which CSIR laboratory organised the Technology Transfer Event to promote technology commercialisation and industry collaboration?

A.CSIR–National Aerospace Laboratories (CSIR-NAL)

B.CSIR–Central Scientific Instruments Organisation (CSIR-CSIO)

C.CSIR–Central Electronics Engineering Research Institute (CSIR-CEERI)

D.CSIR–National Physical Laboratory (CSIR-NPL)

E.CSIR–Indian Institute of Chemical Technology (CSIR-IICT)

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The **Council of Scientific and Industrial Research (CSIR)** organized a **Technology Transfer Event** at **CSIR Headquarters, New Delhi**, to promote **technology commercialization**, **industry collaboration**, and **indigenous innovation**.

The event was organized by **CSIR–Central Scientific Instruments Organisation (CSIR-CSIO), Chandigarh**, bringing together **scientists**, **industry partners**, **technology adopters**, and **strategic stakeholders**.

During the event, **4 indigenous technologies** were transferred to industry, an **IoT-enabled rural water monitoring system** was commercially launched, and **royalty received from Bharat Electronics Limited (BEL)** for defence technologies was recognized.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Council of Scientific and Industrial Research (CSIR)** organized a **Technology Transfer Event** at **CSIR Headquarters, New Delhi**, to promote **technology commercialization**, **industry collaboration**, and **indigenous innovation**.

The event was organized by **CSIR–Central Scientific Instruments Organisation (CSIR-CSIO), Chandigarh**, bringing together **scientists**, **industry partners**, **technology adopters**, and **strategic stakeholders**.

During the event, **4 indigenous technologies** were transferred to industry, an **IoT-enabled rural water monitoring system** was commercially launched, and **royalty received from Bharat Electronics Limited (BEL)** for defence technologies was recognized.

Prof. Shantanu Bhattacharya, **Director, CSIR-CSIO**, presented the laboratory's achievements in **technology transfer**, **innovation**, and **commercialization**.

Three technologies—Induction Motor Stethoscope (MSCOPE), **Portable & Universal Motor-cum-Pump Performance Monitor (PU-MPPM)**, and **i-Power Quality Analyser (IPQA)**—were licensed to **M/s Pump Academy Private Limited, Bengaluru**.

460. As per the news, scientists from the Institute of Advanced Study in Science and Technology (IASST), Guwahati, demonstrated the first-ever use of Borophene as a high-performance lubricant additive in which oil?

A.Coconut oil

B.Castor oil

C.Mustard oil

D.Sunflower oil

E.Palm oil

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Scientists from the **Institute of Advanced Study in Science and Technology (IASST), Guwahati**, an autonomous institute under the **Department of Science and Technology (DST)**, achieved a major breakthrough by demonstrating the first-ever use of **Borophene (2D nanomaterial)** as a high-performance **lubricant additive in castor oil**.

The research is considered a significant advancement in **sustainable lubrication technology** and has the potential to transform **renewable energy systems**, marine applications, **green lubrication technologies**, and sustainable manufacturing.

Friction and wear are major causes of **energy loss** and equipment failure in industries, making the development of advanced lubricants an important scientific and technological objective.

Castor oil is a **renewable, biodegradable, and environment-friendly** lubricant, whose performance can be significantly enhanced using **Borophene as an additive**.

Detailed Explanation:

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Castor oil is a **renewable, biodegradable, and environment-friendly** lubricant, whose performance can be significantly enhanced using **Borophene as an additive**.

The researchers found that adding only **0.1 wt.% Borophene** to castor oil **reduced friction by approximately 42%** compared to pure castor oil.

The research was conducted under the guidance of **Prof. Devasish Chowdhury**, with **Mr. Ujjibit Boruah**, INSPIRE Senior Research Fellow (SRF), serving as the first author of the study.

Borophene dispersed uniformly in castor oil **without requiring any chemical modification**, making it suitable for practical lubricant applications.

461. As per the news, the INSPIRE-MANAK component of the Department of Science and Technology (DST) is aimed at promoting

scientific creativity and innovation among students of which classes?

A.Classes I to V

B.Classes VI to XII

C.Classes IX to XII only

D.Undergraduate students only

E.Postgraduate students only

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The **Government of India** reaffirmed its commitment to nurturing scientific talent through the **Department of Science and Technology (DST)** flagship **Innovation in Science Pursuit for Inspired Research (INSPIRE) Programme**, which has supported **more than 3.75 lakh students and researchers** over the last five years.

The information was shared by Union Minister of State (Independent Charge) for Science & Technology, **Dr. Jitendra Singh**, in a written reply in the **Lok Sabha**.

The INSPIRE Programme develops scientific talent through four major components: **INSPIRE-MANAK**, **INSPIRE Scholarship for Higher Education (SHE)**, **INSPIRE Fellowship**, and **INSPIRE Faculty Fellowship**.

INSPIRE-MANAK encourages scientific creativity and innovation among students of **Classes VI to XII** by promoting original ideas and innovations.

INSPIRE-SHE (Scholarship for Higher Education) provides **12,000 scholarships every year**, each worth **₹80,000**, to meritorious undergraduate and postgraduate students pursuing **natural and basic sciences**.

Detailed Explanation:

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INSPIRE-SHE (Scholarship for Higher Education) provides **12,000 scholarships every year**, each worth **₹80,000**, to meritorious undergraduate and postgraduate students pursuing **natural and basic sciences**.

INSPIRE Fellowship provides financial assistance for **doctoral (PhD) research** for up to **five years**, supporting research scholars across India.

INSPIRE Faculty Fellowship enables outstanding **postdoctoral researchers** to undertake independent research through fellowship support and research grants.

During **2025–26**, **49,805 students** were supported under INSPIRE-MANAK, **24,276 students** received INSPIRE-SHE scholarships, **3,364 researchers** benefited under INSPIRE Fellowship, and **477 researchers** received support through the INSPIRE Faculty Fellowship.

Collectively, the four INSPIRE components have benefited **over 3.75 lakh students and researchers** across India during the **last five years**.

462. As per the news, the Senior Citizen Re-employment Initiative has been launched under which Government platform?

A.National Skill Development Portal

B.Skill India Digital Portal

C.e-Shram Portal

D.PM Gati Shakti Portal

E.National Career Service (NCS) Portal

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

The **Central Government** reaffirmed its commitment to promote **active ageing** and enhance employment opportunities for senior citizens through the **National Career Service (NCS) Portal**.

The **Senior Citizen Re-employment Initiative** under the NCS Portal has recorded significant growth in **registrations, employer participation, and job opportunities**, enabling experienced professionals to remain part of the workforce.

The Government has taken note of the **UNFPA-India's India Ageing Report 2023**, which projects a sharp increase in India's **elderly population** in the coming decades.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Central Government** reaffirmed its commitment to promote **active ageing** and enhance employment opportunities for senior citizens through the **National Career Service (NCS) Portal**.

The **Senior Citizen Re-employment Initiative** under the NCS Portal has recorded significant growth in **registrations, employer participation, and job opportunities**, enabling experienced professionals to remain part of the workforce.

The Government has taken note of the **UNFPA-India's India Ageing Report 2023**, which projects a sharp increase in India's **elderly population** in the coming decades.

According to the **India Ageing Report 2023**, the population aged **60 years and above** is projected to increase from **10.4% in 2022** to **20.8% by 2050**, and further rise to **36% by the end of the century**.

The report highlights the need for **livelihood opportunities**, structured **re-employment avenues**, and **income security**, especially for elderly persons working in the **unorganised sector**.

Under the **National Career Service (NCS) Project**, the Government has approved **407 Model Career Centres (MCCs)** in collaboration with States and other institutions

463. As per the news, the Mission Vatsalya Portal has been integrated with which Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA) system to help trace and identify missing children?

A.National Crime Records Bureau (NCRB) Portal

B. Inter-Operable Criminal Justice System (ICJS)

C.National Automated Fingerprint Identification System (NAFIS)

D.Integrated Criminal Justice Portal (ICJP)

E.Crime and Criminal Tracking Network & Systems (CCTNS)

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

Mission Vatsalya is a **Centrally Sponsored Scheme (CSS)** implemented by States and Union Territories (UTs) for the care, protection, rehabilitation, and reintegration of **Children in Need of Care and Protection (CNCP)** and **Children in Conflict with Law (CCL)**.

The primary objective of Mission Vatsalya is to ensure care, protection, rehabilitation, and reintegration of children in difficult circumstances, including **missing, abandoned, and vulnerable children**.

The **Ministry of Women and Child Development (MoWCD)** has developed an integrated unified **Mission Vatsalya Portal** in consultation and coordination with States and UTs.

The **TrackChild Portal** for Missing/Found Children and the **Khoya-Paya Application** for Missing/Sighted Children have been integrated into the Mission Vatsalya Portal.

Detailed Explanation:

Mission Vatsalya is a **Centrally Sponsored Scheme (CSS)** implemented by States and Union Territories (UTs) for the care, protection, rehabilitation, and reintegration of **Children in Need of Care and Protection (CNCP)** and **Children in Conflict with Law (CCL)**.

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The **TrackChild Portal** for Missing/Found Children and the **Khoya-Paya Application** for Missing/Sighted Children have been integrated into the Mission Vatsalya Portal.

The TrackChild Module is implemented with the support of multiple stakeholders, including the **Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA)**, **Ministry of Railways**, State Governments, UT Administrations, **Child Welfare Committees**

(CWCs), **Juvenile Justice Boards (JJBs)**, and the **National Legal Services Authority (NALSA)**.

The Government has issued **Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs)** and advisories to all States, UTs, Directors General of Police (DGPs), and other stakeholders for effective implementation of the Mission Vatsalya Portal.

The Mission Vatsalya Portal is integrated with the **Crime and Criminal Tracking Network & Systems (CCTNS)** of the Ministry of Home Affairs, enabling interoperability for matching **FIRs of missing children** with the portal database to trace and identify missing children.

464. As per the news, the Competition Commission of India (CCI) has approved the acquisition of NCR Atleos Corporation by which company?

A.Diebold Nixdorf

B.Hitachi Payment Services

C.The Brink's Company

D.Fidelity National Information Services (FIS)

E.NCR Voyix Corporation

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The **Competition Commission of India (CCI)** has approved the acquisition of **100% equity share capital** of **NCR Atleos Corporation** by **The Brink's Company**.

The **Proposed Combination** involves the acquisition of **100% ownership** of **NCR Atleos Corporation (Target)** by **The Brink's Company (Acquirer)**.

After completion of the transaction, **NCR Atleos Corporation** will become a **wholly owned and controlled subsidiary** of **The Brink's Company**.

The Brink's Company is a global provider of **cash and valuables management**, **digital retail solutions**, and **ATM managed services**, operating in **over 100 countries**.

Detailed Explanation:

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After completion of the transaction, **NCR Atleos Corporation** will become a **wholly owned and controlled subsidiary** of **The Brink's Company**.

The Brink's Company is a global provider of **cash and valuables management**, **digital retail solutions**, and **ATM managed services**, operating in **over 100 countries**.

In India, **The Brink's Company** primarily provides **cash replenishment services** and ancillary **first-line maintenance services** through its subsidiary **Brink's India Private Limited**.

NCR Atleos Corporation is a financial technology (**FinTech**) company that

provides **self-directed banking solutions** globally.

465. As per the news, the Go Home and Re-Unite (GHAR) Portal has been integrated with which portal to facilitate the restoration and reunification of children with their families?

A.TrackChild Portal

B.Mission Shakti Portal

C.Poshan Tracker

D.Mission Vatsalya Portal

E.e-Baal Nidan Portal

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The **Go Home and Re-Unite (GHAR) Portal** has also been integrated with the Mission Vatsalya Portal to facilitate the **restoration and reunification** of children with their families.

The Ministry of Women and Child Development has directed all States and UT Administrations to appoint **Designated Nodal Officers for Missing Children** at both the State Level and District Level.

All States and UTs have appointed the required **Nodal Officers**, and their details have been uploaded on the Mission Vatsalya Portal.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Go Home and Re-Unite (GHAR) Portal** has also been integrated with the Mission Vatsalya Portal to facilitate the **restoration and reunification** of children with their families.

The Ministry of Women and Child Development has directed all States and UT Administrations to appoint **Designated Nodal Officers for Missing Children** at both the State Level and District Level.

All States and UTs have appointed the required **Nodal Officers**, and their details have been uploaded on the Mission Vatsalya Portal.

The Ministry has issued guidelines and advisories to ensure **timely data entry** and regular updating of information on the Mission Vatsalya Portal by **Child Welfare Committees (CWCs)** and **Juvenile Justice Boards (JJBs)**.

Continuous efforts are being made to **strengthen monitoring mechanisms**, improve **real-time digital reporting**, and ensure the timely tracking, protection, rehabilitation, and reintegration of children requiring care and protection.

466. As per the news, the Reserve Bank of India's Commercial Banks–Governance Amendment Directions, 2026 will come into effect from which date?

A.1 July 2026

B.1 August 2026

C.1 September 2026

D.1 October 2026

E.1 January 2027

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** has issued the **Commercial Banks–Governance Amendment Directions, 2026**, which will come into effect from **1 October 2026**.

The **Amendment Directions** aim to **strengthen board governance**, improve **decision-making**,

and enhance **corporate governance** in the Indian banking sector.

The revised framework shifts from a **prescriptive, theme-based approach** to a **principle-based governance framework**, providing greater flexibility to bank boards.

Under the new framework, **Boards of Directors** will devote more attention to **business strategy**, **risk management**, **financial resilience**, and **corporate governance**.

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Under the new framework, **Boards of Directors** will devote more attention to **business strategy**, **risk management**, **financial resilience**, and **corporate governance**.

The **Board** will primarily oversee **business strategy**, **risk management**, **governance standards**, **regulatory compliance**, **internal controls**, and **exposures to related entities**.

Routine operational matters may be delegated to **Board Committees** or **Management Committees**, enabling the Board to focus on strategic oversight.

The **Chairperson of the Board** has been assigned the primary responsibility for **setting the Board agenda**, while the **management** must provide **timely and adequate information** for informed decision-making.

The **Amendment Directions** apply to **Commercial Banks** and, with suitable modifications, also to **Private Sector Banks**, **Small Finance Banks (SFBs)**, **Payments Banks**, and **Local Area Banks (LABs)**.

467. As per the news, which company became the first Authorised Dealer Category-II (AD-II) entity in India to receive RBI authorisation to offer both Trade Remittances and Family Maintenance Remittances?

A.Paytm Payments Bank

B.EbixCash World Money Limited

C.Western Union India

D.Thomas Cook India

E.Muthoot Finance

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

EbixCash World Money Limited became the **first Authorised Dealer Category-II (AD-II) entity in India** to receive **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** authorisation to offer **Trade**

Remittances and **Family Maintenance Remittances**, a segment previously dominated by **banks**.

The **RBI approval** marks a significant expansion of the role of **AD-II entities** in India's **foreign exchange and remittance ecosystem**.

Under the enhanced licence, **EbixCash** can facilitate **Trade Remittances up to ₹25 lakh per transaction**.

Detailed Explanation:

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Under the enhanced licence, **EbixCash** can facilitate **Trade Remittances up to ₹25 lakh per transaction**.

The company is also authorised to process **Family Maintenance Remittances** under the updated **Foreign Exchange Management Act (FEMA), 1999** framework introduced in **May 2026**.

The new licence will help **Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises (MSMEs)** engaged in **import and export activities** by providing **direct trade-related remittance services**

468. As per the news, what Real GDP growth has ICRA projected for India in Q1 (April–June) of FY2026–27?

A.5.8–6.0%

B.6.0–6.2%

C.6.4–6.6%

D.6.8–7.0%

E.7.2–7.4%

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

ICRA Limited, a domestic credit rating agency, has projected **India's Real Gross Domestic Product (GDP) Growth** at **6.4–6.6%** for **Q1 (April–June) FY2026–27 (FY27)**.

The projected growth is driven by **broad-based economic activity**, despite **elevated energy prices** and **limited input availability**, which continue to put pressure on **manufacturing margins**.

India's Real GDP had grown by **7.8%** in **Q4 (January–March) FY2025–26 (FY26)**.

Detailed Explanation:

ICRA Limited, a domestic credit rating agency, has projected **India's Real Gross Domestic Product (GDP) Growth** at **6.4–6.6%** for **Q1 (April–June) FY2026–27 (FY27)**.

The projected growth is driven by **broad-based economic activity**, despite **elevated energy prices** and **limited input availability**, which continue to put pressure on **manufacturing margins**.

India's Real GDP had grown by **7.8%** in **Q4 (January–March) FY2025–26 (FY26)**.

ICRA's Business Activity Monitor (BAM) recorded **12% Year-on-Year (YoY) growth** in **June 2026**, the **highest growth in the last 32 months**, compared to **9.4% YoY in May 2026**.

Out of **16 High-Frequency Indicators**, **13 indicators** showed **faster growth in June 2026**, reflecting **strong economic momentum**.

The growth was supported by the **temporary USA–Iran ceasefire**, a **40% rainfall deficit** that extended **construction and mining activities**, and a **favourable base effect**.

469. As per the news, which company became the first in India to launch a UPI-enabled Meal Card?

A.EnKash

B.Razorpay

C.PhonePe

D.BharatPe

E.MobiKwik

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

EnKash, India's leading **business payments and spend management platform**, became the **first company in India** to launch a **Unified Payments Interface (UPI)-enabled Meal Card**.

The **UPI-based Meal Card** enables employees to make **direct payments** from their **meal balance** by scanning **eligible UPI QR Codes** at **food and grocery merchants**.

Detailed Explanation:

EnKash, India's leading **business payments and spend management platform**, became the **first company in India** to launch a **Unified Payments Interface (UPI)-enabled Meal Card**.

The **UPI-based Meal Card** enables employees to make **direct payments** from their **meal balance** by scanning **eligible UPI QR Codes** at **food and grocery merchants**.

The **UPI-enabled Meal Card** is supported by **EnKash's existing payments and prepaid infrastructure**, ensuring **seamless digital transactions**.

EnKash's payment ecosystem offers businesses a **comprehensive suite of services**, including **Prepaid Cards**, **Employee Benefits**, **Expense Management**, and **Business Payment Solutions**.

The initiative provides **Meal Benefits of up to ₹200 per meal** under both the **Old Tax Regime** and the **Revised Tax Regime**.

The **maximum annual tax savings** available through the **Meal Card** is **₹1,05,600**.

470. As per the news, according to the Economic Advisory Council to the Prime Minister (EAC-PM), what was India's share of the world's Gross Domestic Product (GDP) in 2025 based on Purchasing Power Parity (PPP)?

A.6.5%

B.7.4%

C.8.2%

D.9.0%

E.10.1%

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

According to a working paper published by the **Economic Advisory Council to the Prime Minister (EAC-PM)**, **India** accounted for **8.2% of the world's Gross Domestic Product (GDP)** in **2025** based on **Purchasing Power Parity (PPP)**.

The report highlights that **India contributes more than 10%** of **global savings** and **global investment**, reflecting its increasing importance in the world economy.

The **International Monetary Fund (IMF)** projects **India's share of global GDP** to rise to **9.7% by 2030**, indicating sustained economic growth over the decade.

Detailed Explanation:

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The **International Monetary Fund (IMF)** projects **India's share of global GDP** to rise to **9.7% by 2030**, indicating sustained economic growth over the decade.

The working paper is titled **"The World in Purchasing Power Parity (PPP): Trends since 1992"**.

The report was prepared by **EAC-PM members Sanjeev Sanyal**, **Akash Arora**, and **Payal Sharma**.

The paper identifies **China's economic rise since 1992** as the **largest global economic transformation**, with **China accounting for nearly 20% of global GDP**, **32% of world savings**, and **30% of world investment**.

471. As per the news, the Government of Maharashtra launched Bharat Taxi, a cooperative taxi service platform, at which airport?

A.Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj International Airport

B.Pune International Airport

C.Dr. Babasaheb Ambedkar International Airport

D.Navi Mumbai International Airport

E.Shirdi International Airport

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The **Government of Maharashtra** launched **Bharat Taxi**, a **cooperative taxi service platform**, at the **Navi Mumbai International Airport, Maharashtra**, to provide **affordable, transparent, and reliable transportation services**.

The service was inaugurated by **Devendra Fadnavis, Chief Minister of Maharashtra**, along with **Murlidhar Mohol, Union Minister of State for Cooperation**.

Bharat Taxi is based on the vision of **Prime Minister Narendra Modi's "Sahakar Se Samriddhi" (Prosperity through**

Cooperation), aiming to strengthen the cooperative model in the transport sector.

Detailed Explanation:

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Bharat Taxi is based on the vision of **Prime Minister Narendra Modi's "Sahakar Se Samriddhi" (Prosperity through Cooperation)**, aiming to strengthen the cooperative model in the transport sector.

Unlike traditional ride-hailing platforms, **Bharat Taxi follows a driver-centric cooperative model**, where drivers, known as **Sarathis**, become **owners and members of the cooperative**.

The platform aims to provide drivers with **regular income opportunities, ownership benefits, and profit-sharing**, while offering passengers **fixed pricing without surge charges or hidden fees**.

Key features of Bharat Taxi include:

No surge pricing

Transparent fare system

No hidden charges

Fixed service charge model

Improved safety and service quality

Bharat Taxi was first introduced in **Delhi and Gujarat** and has now expanded to **Maharashtra**, beginning operations from the **Navi Mumbai International Airport**.

472. As per the news, which city will host the International Type 1 Diabetes Summit 2026 from 30 July to 1 August 2026?

A.Jodhpur

B.New Delhi

C.Jaipur

D.Udaipur

E.Ahmedabad

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

India will host the **International Type 1 Diabetes Summit 2026** from **30 July to 1 August 2026** in **Jodhpur, Rajasthan**, bringing together **leading medical experts, researchers, government officials, healthcare professionals, and patient representatives** from across the world.

The summit is being organised by **Friends of Mewar**, **Breakthrough T1D**, and the **William J. Clinton Foundation** to promote **global collaboration** in **Type 1 diabetes research, treatment, technology, and patient care**.

The official announcement of the summit was made at the **Constitution Club of India, New Delhi**.

Detailed Explanation:

India will host the **International Type 1 Diabetes Summit 2026** from **30 July to 1**

August 2026 in **Jodhpur, Rajasthan**, bringing together **leading medical experts, researchers, government officials, healthcare professionals, and patient representatives** from across the world.

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The official announcement of the summit was made at the **Constitution Club of India, New Delhi**.

The summit will focus on improving **access to affordable insulin**, **equitable treatment**, **medical innovation**, and **quality of life** for people living with **Type 1 Diabetes**.

Key discussion areas include **Continuous Glucose Monitoring (CGM)**, **insulin pump therapy**, **digital health solutions**, **psychological support**, **public health policies**, **diabetes technologies**, and **international research collaboration**.

Experts from **India**, the **United States of America (USA)**, **Australia**, and several other countries are expected to participate.

473. As per the news, Mission Golden Spice – Integrated Lakadong Turmeric Value Chain Enhancement Project has been launched under which initiative?

A.PM Gati Shakti

B.Atmanirbhar Bharat Abhiyan

C.Unlock the Economic Potential of India's Northeast (USP)

D.National Mission on Spices

E.One District One Product (ODOP)

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

Union Minister for Communications and Development of North Eastern Region, Jyotiraditya M. Scindia, along with **Meghalaya Chief Minister Conrad K. Sangma**, launched the **Mission Golden Spice – Integrated Lakadong Turmeric Value Chain Enhancement Project** at **Sanchar Bhavan, New Delhi**.

The mission is a **₹175.45 crore convergence-led initiative** to transform **Lakadong turmeric** into a **globally recognised premium spice** by strengthening its entire value chain.

The project has been launched under the **"Unlock the Economic Potential of India's Northeast (USP)"** initiative of the **Ministry of Development of North Eastern Region**.

Detailed Explanation:

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The mission is a **₹175.45 crore convergence-led initiative** to transform **Lakadong**

turmeric into a **globally recognised premium spice** by strengthening its entire value chain.

The project has been launched under the **"Unlock the Economic Potential of India's Northeast (USP)"** initiative of the **Ministry of Development of North Eastern Region**.

The mission will be implemented over **five years (2025–2030)** in **two phases**:

Phase I: Value Chain Strengthening

Phase II: Expansion and Scale-up

The initiative is being implemented by the **Ministry of Development of North Eastern Region** in collaboration with the **North Eastern Council**.

477. As per the news, India became the 123rd member to formally accept which World Trade Organization (WTO) agreement?

A.Trade Facilitation Agreement

B.Agreement on Agriculture

C.Agreement on Government Procurement

D.Information Technology Agreement

E.Agreement on Fisheries Subsidies

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

India formally accepted the **World Trade Organization (WTO) Agreement on Fisheries Subsidies**, becoming the **123rd member** to join the global agreement.

Commerce Secretary Rajesh Agrawal deposited India's **Instrument of Acceptance** with **World Trade Organization Director-General Ngozi Okonjo-Iweala** at the **World Trade Organization Headquarters in Geneva, Switzerland**.

The **Agreement on Fisheries Subsidies** was adopted by consensus during the **12th World Trade Organization Ministerial Conference** held in **Geneva, Switzerland**, in **June 2022** and entered into force on **15 September 2025** after acceptance by **two-thirds of World Trade Organization members**.

Detailed Explanation:

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It is the **first multilateral agreement of the World Trade Organization** with an **environmental sustainability objective**.

475. As per the news, which United Nations agency released the State of Food Security and Nutrition in the World (SOFI) 2026 report?

A.United Nations Development Programme (UNDP)
B.Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO)
C.United Nations Environment Programme (UNEP)
D.United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization (UNESCO)
E.International Labour Organization (ILO)
Answer: B
Short Explanation:
The **United Nations (UN) Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO)** released the **State of Food Security and Nutrition in the World (SOFI) 2026 report** titled **"Understanding and Addressing the High Cost of a Healthy Diet."**
The report estimated that **645 million people** (**7.8% of the global population**) faced hunger in **2025**, showing a slight improvement from **8.1%** in the previous year.
Despite this progress, the world remains off track to achieve **Sustainable Development Goal (SDG)-2: Zero Hunger by 2030**.
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Despite this progress, the world remains off track to achieve **Sustainable Development Goal (SDG)-2: Zero Hunger by 2030**.
The **SOFI Report** is jointly prepared by **five UN specialized agencies**:
Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO)
International Fund for Agricultural Development (IFAD)
United Nations Children's Fund (UNICEF)
World Food Programme (WFP)
World Health Organization (WHO)
The number of hungry people in **2025** remained **61 million higher** than pre-COVID-19 (**2019**) levels.
The global prevalence of hunger declined to **7.8% in 2025**, compared to **8.0% in 2015**, when the **2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development** was adopted.
Under a **quick-recovery scenario**, the report projects the number of chronically undernourished people to decline to about **511 million by 2030**.
If disruptions in **oil, gas, and fertilizer supplies** continue, the number of chronically undernourished people could remain as high as **522 million by 2030**.

476. As per the news, the President of Zanzibar, Hussein Ali Mwinyi, visited India at the invitation of which Indian dignitary?
A.President Droupadi Murmu
B.Prime Minister Narendra Modi
C.Vice President C. P. Radhakrishnan
D.External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar

E.Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

President of Zanzibar and **Chairman of the Revolutionary Council**, **Hussein Ali Mwinyi**, paid an **official visit to India** from **17–20 July 2026** at the invitation of **Vice President C. P. Radhakrishnan**.

The delegation included **First Lady Mariyam Mwinyi**, along with **ministers** and **senior government officials** from Zanzibar.

Both sides welcomed the expansion of **bilateral trade**, **investment**, and **capacity-building initiatives**, further strengthening the **India–Tanzania Strategic Partnership**.

Detailed Explanation:

President of Zanzibar and **Chairman of the Revolutionary Council**, **Hussein Ali Mwinyi**, paid an **official visit to India** from **17–20 July 2026** at the invitation of **Vice President C. P. Radhakrishnan**.

The delegation included **First Lady Mariyam Mwinyi**, along with **ministers** and **senior government officials** from Zanzibar.

Both sides welcomed the expansion of **bilateral trade**, **investment**, and **capacity-building initiatives**, further strengthening the **India–Tanzania Strategic Partnership**.

During **bilateral talks**, **President Hussein Ali Mwinyi** and **Vice President C. P. Radhakrishnan** reviewed **India–Tanzania relations** and discussed enhancing cooperation in the **Blue Economy**, **Tourism**, **Technology**, **Healthcare**, **Education**, **Trade**, and **Investment**.

President Hussein Ali Mwinyi invited **Vice President C. P. Radhakrishnan** to undertake an official visit to **Tanzania**.

477. As per the news, who has been appointed as the new Chief Executive Officer (CEO) of NITI Aayog?

A.B. V. R. Subrahmanyam

B.Nidhi Chhibber

C.Amitabh Kant

D.Anurag Jain

E.Rajesh Kumar Singh

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The **Government of India (GoI)** appointed **Anurag Jain** as the new **Chief Executive Officer (CEO)** of **NITI (**National Institution for Transforming India**) Aayog**, with the appointment approved by the **Appointments Committee of the Cabinet (ACC)** through the **Department of Personnel and Training (DoPT)**.

Anurag Jain assumed charge **with immediate effect** for a **tenure of two years or until further orders, whichever is earlier**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Government of India (GoI)** appointed **Anurag Jain** as the new **Chief Executive Officer (CEO)** of **NITI (**National Institution for Transforming India**) Aayog**, with the appointment approved by the **Appointments Committee of the Cabinet**

(ACC) through the **Department of Personnel and Training (DoPT)**.

Anurag Jain assumed charge **with immediate effect** for a **tenure of two years or until further orders, whichever is earlier**.

Anurag Jain is a **1989-batch Indian Administrative Service (IAS) officer** of the **Madhya Pradesh (MP) cadre**, with **nearly four decades of administrative experience**.

Before becoming **CEO of NITI Aayog**, **Anurag Jain** served as the **Chief Secretary of Madhya Pradesh**.

He also held important positions as **Secretary, Ministry of Road Transport & Highways** and **Secretary, Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT)**.

Anurag Jain succeeded **Nidhi Chhibber**, **Director General (DG)** of the **Development Monitoring and Evaluation Office (DMEO)**, who had been holding the **additional/interim charge of CEO** since **24 February 2026**.

Nidhi Chhibber took charge after the completion of the tenure of **B. V. R. Subrahmanyam**, the former **CEO of NITI Aayog**.

478. As per the news, who has been selected for the 44th Lokmanya Tilak National Award 2026?

A.Amit Shah

B.Ajit Doval

C.Devendra Fadnavis

D.Eknath Shinde

E.Rajnath Singh

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

National Security Advisor (NSA) Ajit Doval has been selected for the **44th Lokmanya Tilak National Award 2026** for his outstanding contribution to **India's national security, counter-terrorism strategy, covert operations, and border management**.

The award will be presented by **Union Minister of Home Affairs Amit Shah** at a ceremony in **Pune, Maharashtra on 1 August 2026**, marking the **106th death anniversary of freedom fighter Bal Gangadhar Tilak**.

The award comprises a **memento, citation, and cash prize of ₹1 lakh**.

Detailed Explanation:

National Security Advisor (NSA) Ajit Doval has been selected for the **44th Lokmanya Tilak National Award 2026** for his outstanding contribution to **India's national security, counter-terrorism strategy, covert operations, and border management**.

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The award comprises a **memento, citation, and cash prize of ₹1 lakh**.

The announcement was made by **Dr Rohit Tilak, President of Lokmanya Tilak Smarak Trust**, in Pune in the presence of **Maharashtra**

Chief Minister Devendra Fadnavis and **Deputy Chief Minister Eknath Shinde**.

Ajit Doval has been serving as India's **National Security Advisor since 2014** and is the **longest-serving NSA of India**.

479. As per the news, Paras Semiconductors Private Limited will establish a greenfield Advanced IC Packaging and OSAT facility with an investment of approximately how much?

A.₹3,200 crore

B.₹4,500 crore

C.₹5,000 crore

D.₹6,200 crore

E.₹7,500 crore

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

Paras Semiconductors Private Limited, a subsidiary of **Paras Defence and Space Technologies Limited**, signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** with the **Department of Science and Technology, Government of Madhya Pradesh**, through the **Madhya Pradesh State Electronics Development Corporation Limited (MPSeDC)**.

The **Memorandum of Understanding** aims to establish a **greenfield Advanced Integrated Circuit (IC) Packaging and Outsourced Semiconductor Assembly and Test (OSAT) facility** in the **Indore–Ujjain region of Madhya Pradesh**.

Paras Semiconductors will invest approximately **₹6,200 crore** to develop the advanced semiconductor packaging facility.

Detailed Explanation:

Paras Semiconductors Private Limited, a subsidiary of **Paras Defence and Space Technologies Limited**, signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** with the **Department of Science and Technology, Government of Madhya Pradesh**, through the **Madhya Pradesh State Electronics Development Corporation Limited (MPSeDC)**.

The **Memorandum of Understanding** aims to establish a **greenfield Advanced Integrated Circuit (IC) Packaging and Outsourced Semiconductor Assembly and Test (OSAT) facility** in the **Indore–Ujjain region of Madhya Pradesh**.

Paras Semiconductors will invest approximately **₹6,200 crore** to develop the advanced semiconductor packaging facility.

The proposed facility will support advanced semiconductor packaging technologies, including:

Three-Dimensional (3D) Heterogeneous Integration

2.5D/3D Advanced Packaging

Hybrid Bonding

Ultra-High-Density Fan-Out Packaging

Chiplet Integration

Wafer Bumping

Flip-Chip Assembly

Semiconductor Testing and Reliability

The collaboration aims to strengthen **India's domestic semiconductor manufacturing ecosystem**, reduce dependence on imports, and enhance capabilities in **advanced Integrated Circuit packaging and semiconductor testing**.

480. As per the news, India strengthened its Double Taxation Avoidance Agreement (DTAA) with Sri Lanka by incorporating which internationally recognised anti-abuse provision?

A.General Anti-Avoidance Rules (GAAR)

B.Significant Economic Presence (SEP)

C.Principal Purpose Test (PPT)

D.Equalisation Levy

E.Safe Harbour Rules

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

India has strengthened its **Double Taxation Avoidance Agreement (DTAA) with Sri Lanka** by incorporating the **Principal Purpose Test (PPT)**, an internationally recognised anti-abuse provision under the **Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD) Base Erosion and Profit Shifting (BEPS) framework**.

The amendment was introduced through a **Protocol notified by the Ministry of Finance** and came into force on **19 June 2026** after completion of domestic legal procedures by both countries.

The revised provisions will apply in **India for income derived from 1 April 2027**.

Detailed Explanation:

India has strengthened its **Double Taxation Avoidance Agreement (DTAA) with Sri Lanka** by incorporating the **Principal Purpose Test (PPT)**, an internationally recognised anti-abuse provision under the **Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD) Base Erosion and Profit Shifting (BEPS) framework**.

The amendment was introduced through a **Protocol notified by the Ministry of Finance** and came into force on **19 June 2026** after completion of domestic legal procedures by both countries.

The revised provisions will apply in **India for income derived from 1 April 2027**.

The **Principal Purpose Test (PPT)** allows tax authorities of both countries to deny treaty benefits if one of the main purposes of a transaction or investment is found to be obtaining an undue tax advantage rather than carrying out genuine commercial activities.

The amendment aims to:

Prevent **treaty shopping arrangements**.

Avoid **double non-taxation**.

Ensure fair taxation while continuing to eliminate **double taxation** for genuine taxpayers.

The amendment does **not change the existing tax rates** under the India–Sri Lanka DTAA.

481. As per the news, which DRDO laboratory developed India's first indigenous Expendable Turbojet Engine in the 350 kg thrust class?

A.Aeronautical Development Establishment (ADE)
B.Defence Metallurgical Research Laboratory (DMRL)
C.Gas Turbine Research Establishment (GTRE)
D.Defence Research and Development Laboratory (DRDL)
E.Centre for Airborne Systems (CABS)
Answer: C
Short Explanation:
India achieved a major milestone in **indigenous aero-engine technology** with the successful development of the country's **first indigenous Expendable Turbojet Engine** in the **350 kg thrust class**.
The engine was designed and developed by the **Gas Turbine Research Establishment (GTRE)** under the **Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO)**.
Azad Engineering, Hyderabad, was selected by GTRE as the **industry partner** for the **manufacturing and assembly** of the engine.
On **22 July 2026**, **Azad Engineering** successfully **manufactured, realised, and delivered** the engine to GTRE, marking a landmark achievement for **India's aerospace and defence ecosystem**.
Detailed Explanation:
India achieved a major milestone in **indigenous aero-engine technology** with the successful development of the country's **first indigenous Expendable Turbojet Engine** in the **350 kg thrust class**.
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Azad Engineering, Hyderabad, was selected by GTRE as the **industry partner** for the **manufacturing and assembly** of the engine.
On **22 July 2026**, **Azad Engineering** successfully **manufactured, realised, and delivered** the engine to GTRE, marking a landmark achievement for **India's aerospace and defence ecosystem**.
The successful development is the result of years of **precision engineering**, **advanced manufacturing**, and close collaboration between **India's scientific and industrial communities**.
Jet engine technology is mastered by only a **handful of countries** and is regarded as one of the **most complex engineering technologies**, requiring **exceptional precision**, **advanced metallurgy**, and **stringent manufacturing standards**.
The achievement demonstrates the **growing technological capabilities** of the **Indian defence industry** in designing and manufacturing **highly sophisticated propulsion systems**.

482. As per the news, the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) approved Areion Group's acquisition of Aviom India Housing Finance for how much?

A.₹750 crore

B.₹936 crore

C.₹950 crore

D.₹977.5 crore

E.₹1,050 crore

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** approved **Areion Group's ₹936 crore acquisition** of **Aviom India Housing Finance**, marking a major step in the company's **insolvency resolution process**.

The **RBI** also granted **'Fit-and-Proper'** approval to **Manish Lalwani**, promoter of **Areion Group**, which is mandatory for a **change in control** of a **regulated financial institution**.

Aviom India Housing Finance entered the **Corporate Insolvency Resolution Process (CIRP)** in **February 2025** due to **debt defaults** and **accounting irregularities**.

Areion Group emerged as the **successful resolution applicant** with an **unconditional resolution plan** worth **₹936 crore**.

The approved **resolution plan** is expected to provide approximately **65% recovery** to the lenders.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** approved **Areion Group's ₹936 crore acquisition** of **Aviom India Housing Finance**, marking a major step in the company's **insolvency resolution process**.

The **RBI** also granted **'Fit-and-Proper'** approval to **Manish Lalwani**, promoter of **Areion Group**, which is mandatory for a **change in control** of a **regulated financial institution**.

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Areion Group emerged as the **successful resolution applicant** with an **unconditional resolution plan** worth **₹936 crore**.

The approved **resolution plan** is expected to provide approximately **65% recovery** to the lenders.

Although **Unity Small Finance Bank** submitted a higher bid of **₹977.5 crore**, **secured lenders** holding **98.2% voting share** unanimously approved **Areion Group's proposal** due to its **greater execution certainty**.

Areion Group operates in the **financial services sector** through **Areion Asset Management Company (AMC)** and **Omkara Asset Reconstruction Company (ARC)**.

483. As per the news, the 'BHASHINI Rajyam: State Engagement Workshop' was organised in which city?

A.Panaji

B.Bengaluru

C.Hyderabad

D.Kochi

E.Bhubaneswar

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

The **Digital India BHASHINI (BHASHa INterface for India) Division (DIBD)** under the **Digital India Corporation (DIC)**, **Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY)**, in collaboration with the **Department of Information Technology (IT), Electronics & Communications (EC)**, **Government of Goa**, organised the **'BHASHINI Rajyam: State Engagement Workshop'** in **Panaji, Goa**.

The workshop was attended by **Goa Chief Minister Dr. Pramod Sawant** and **Rohan A. Khaunte**, Minister for IT, Electronics & Communications, Tourism, and Printing & Stationery, Government of Goa.

The primary objective of the workshop was to promote **multilingual Artificial Intelligence (AI)**, strengthen the **Konkani language ecosystem**, and expand **AI-powered multilingual access** to **citizen-centric government services**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Digital India BHASHINI (BHASHa INterface for India) Division (DIBD)** under the **Digital India Corporation (DIC)**, **Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY)**, in collaboration with the **Department of Information Technology (IT), Electronics & Communications (EC)**, **Government of Goa**, organised the **'BHASHINI Rajyam: State Engagement Workshop'** in **Panaji, Goa**.

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The primary objective of the workshop was to promote **multilingual Artificial Intelligence (AI)**, strengthen the **Konkani language ecosystem**, and expand **AI-powered multilingual access** to **citizen-centric government services**.

The event featured live demonstrations of **BHASHINI App Mitra**, **BHASHINI Mitra**, and **BHASHINI Pravakta**, showcasing advanced **AI-enabled language technologies**.

The AI solutions demonstrated included **translation**, **speech recognition**, **transcription**, **text-to-speech**, **transliteration**, **multilingual Application Programming Interfaces (APIs)**, and a **voice-enabled citizen service journey**.

The **Digital India BHASHINI Division (DIBD)** was established in **2022** under the **Digital India Corporation (DIC)** functioning under **MeitY**.

DIBD serves as **India's national platform** for **AI-powered multilingual digital inclusion**, enabling seamless communication across multiple **Indian and international languages**.

484. As per the news, Microsoft India launched UNNATI AI 2.0 in collaboration with which institution?

A.Indian Institute of Science (IISc), Bengaluru

B.IIT Bombay

C.Centre for Development of Advanced Computing (C-DAC)

D.NITI Aayog

E.IIT Delhi's Foundation for Innovation and Technology Transfer (FITT)

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

Microsoft India, in collaboration with the **Foundation for Innovation and Technology Transfer (FITT)**, **Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) Delhi**, launched **UNNATI AI 2.0**, the second phase of its flagship **Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR)** initiative.

UNNATI AI stands for **"Unnati se Pragati"**, meaning **"Progress through Growth."**

UNNATI AI 2.0 aims to strengthen India's **Artificial Intelligence (AI) talent pipeline** by **democratizing AI access**, **promoting innovation**, and **expanding opportunities in Tier 2 and Tier 3 cities**.

Detailed Explanation:

Microsoft India, in collaboration with the **Foundation for Innovation and Technology Transfer (FITT)**, **Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) Delhi**, launched **UNNATI AI 2.0**, the second phase of its flagship **Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR)** initiative.

UNNATI AI stands for **"Unnati se Pragati"**, meaning **"Progress through Growth."**

UNNATI AI 2.0 aims to strengthen India's **Artificial Intelligence (AI) talent pipeline** by **democratizing AI access**, **promoting innovation**, and **expanding opportunities in Tier 2 and Tier 3 cities**.

The initiative focuses on **AI skill development** for developers, entrepreneurs, researchers, students, innovators, and startups through **mentorship**, **startup enablement**, and **real-world pilot deployments**.

It seeks to build a **responsible, inclusive, and scalable AI ecosystem** to support **technology-led national development**.

The programme promotes **AI-driven solutions** across key sectors such as **Healthcare**, **Education**, **Agriculture**, and **Sustainability**.

The **first edition**, launched in **April 2025**, accelerated **AI startups** while providing **nationwide AI skilling opportunities**.

485. As per the news, which institution has been granted Awarding Body (AB-Dual) recognition by the National Council for Vocational Education and Training (NCVET)?

A.National Skill Development Corporation (NSDC)

B.National Institute of Rural Development and Panchayati Raj (NIRDPR)

C.Indian Institute of Entrepreneurship (IIE)

D.National Institute of Open Schooling (NIOS)

E.National Productivity Council (NPC)

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The **National Council for Vocational Education and Training (NCVET)** signed an agreement with the **National Institute of Rural**

Development and Panchayati Raj (NIRDPR) under the **Ministry of Rural Development (MoRD)**, granting NIRDPR recognition as an **Awarding Body (AB-Dual)**.

The agreement-signing ceremony was chaired by **Niranjan Kumar Sudhansu**, **Additional Secretary, Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship (MSDE)** and **Executive Member of NCVET**, in the presence of officials from NCVET and NIRDPR.

The **AB-Dual recognition** authorises NIRDPR to **assess, certify, and award National Skills Qualifications Framework (NSQF)-aligned qualifications** through its own and affiliated training centres.

The recognition aims to strengthen **rural skilling**, **vocational education**, **entrepreneurship development**, and **capacity building** across rural India.

Detailed Explanation:

The **National Council for Vocational Education and Training (NCVET)** signed an agreement with the **National Institute of Rural Development and Panchayati Raj (NIRDPR)** under the **Ministry of Rural Development (MoRD)**, granting NIRDPR recognition as an **Awarding Body (AB-Dual)**.

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The recognition aims to strengthen **rural skilling**, **vocational education**, **entrepreneurship development**, and **capacity building** across rural India.

Under the initial rollout, **NCVET approved two NSQF-aligned qualifications**: **Industrial General Pest Management Technician** and a **Micro-Credential on Generation and Mobilisation of Own Source Revenue by Panchayats**.

NIRDPR will introduce additional **NCVET-approved programmes** for **rural youth**, **Self-Help Groups (SHGs)**, and **Panchayati Raj functionaries**, focusing on **industry-relevant skills**, **entrepreneurship**, and **institutional capacity building**.

NCVET-recognised Awarding Bodies certify **NSQF-aligned qualifications** under two categories: **Standard Awarding Body** (certificate awarding only) and **Dual Awarding Body** (assessment, certification, and awarding).

As of **July 2026**, NCVET has recognised **52 Standard Awarding Bodies** and **107 Dual Awarding Bodies** across India.

486. As per the news, who secured India's first medal at the Commonwealth Games 2026 even before the opening ceremony?

A.Nikhat Zareen
B.Mary Kom
C.Lovlina Borgohain
D.Nitu Ghanghas
E.Parveen Hooda
Answer: C
Short Explanation:
Lovlina Borgohain, India's **Tokyo Olympic bronze medallist**, secured **India's first medal at the Commonwealth Games 2026** even before the **opening ceremony** of the event held in **Glasgow, Scotland**.
Lovlina received a **direct entry into the semifinals** of the **women's 75 kg boxing event** due to the absence of seven participants in the category, confirming her medal position as per the **Commonwealth Games boxing rules**, where all semifinalists are assured of medals.
Detailed Explanation:
Lovlina Borgohain, India's **Tokyo Olympic bronze medallist**, secured **India's first medal at the Commonwealth Games 2026** even before the **opening ceremony** of the event held in **Glasgow, Scotland**.
Lovlina received a **direct entry into the semifinals** of the **women's 75 kg boxing event** due to the absence of seven participants in the category, confirming her medal position as per the **Commonwealth Games boxing rules**, where all semifinalists are assured of medals.
The **women's 75 kg boxing category** featured only **five boxers**, allowing Lovlina to qualify directly for the last four stage without participating in the quarterfinals.
This marks **Lovlina Borgohain's first Commonwealth Games medal**. Earlier, she had reached the **quarterfinals** at:
Gold Coast Commonwealth Games 2018
Birmingham Commonwealth Games 2022
Lovlina will compete in the **semifinal against Tarona (T.K.B.P.) Taafaki** at the **Scottish Event Campus, Glasgow**. A victory would help her progress to the final and upgrade her medal colour.

487. As per the news, who became the youngest batter to score a half-century in Twenty20 International (T20I) cricket?
A.Yashasvi Jaiswal
B.Riyan Parag
C.Shubman Gill
D.Vaibhav Sooryavanshi
E.Sachin Tendulkar
Answer: D
Short Explanation:
Vaibhav Sooryavanshi became the **youngest batter to score a half-century in Twenty20 International (T20I) cricket**, achieving the feat during the **first T20I against Zimbabwe** in **Harare, Zimbabwe**.
At the age of **15 years and 118 days**, he reached his **fifty in just 19 balls**, becoming the **youngest player to score a fifty in international cricket**.
The left-handed batter played an explosive innings of **50 runs**, including **4 fours and 4 sixes**, with a **strike rate of over 263**, in only his **fourth T20I match** for India.

Detailed Explanation:

Vaibhav Sooryavanshi became the **youngest batter to score a half-century in Twenty20 International (T20I) cricket**, achieving the feat during the **first T20I against Zimbabwe** in **Harare, Zimbabwe**.

At the age of **15 years and 118 days**, he reached his **fifty in just 19 balls**, becoming the **youngest player to score a fifty in international cricket**.

The left-handed batter played an explosive innings of **50 runs**, including **4 fours and 4 sixes**, with a **strike rate of over 263**, in only his **fourth T20I match** for India.

He broke the previous record held by **Louis Bruce (Gibraltar)**, who scored a T20I fifty at the age of **16 years and 56 days** against **Malta** in **August 2021**.

With this achievement, Vaibhav Sooryavanshi also became:

Youngest player from an International Cricket Council (ICC) Full Member nation to score a T20I fifty.

Youngest Indian to score a **fifty in international cricket**, surpassing **Sachin Tendulkar**.

Youngest Indian to score a **fifty in Twenty20 International cricket**, surpassing **Rohit Sharma**.

488. As per the news, in which year was EbixCash initially established as a Full Fledged Money Changer (FFMC)?

A.1997

B.1998

C.1999

D.2000

E.2001

Answer: C

EbixCash was initially established as a **Full Fledged Money Changer (FFMC)** in **1999**.

It was later upgraded to an **RBI-regulated Authorised Dealer Category-II (AD-II) entity**.

Corporate Headquarters: Noida, Uttar Pradesh (UP).

489. As per the news, in which year was EnKash established?

A.2016

B.2017

C.2019

D.2018

E.2020

Answer: D

EnKash was established in **2018** and is recognized as **India's first full-stack payments and spend management platform**.

EnKash holds the following key regulatory licences:

Payment Aggregator (PA) Licence

Prepaid Payment Instrument (PPI) Licence

Bharat Connect (BBPOU) Licence

Headquarters: Mumbai, Maharashtra.

490. As per the news, Bharat Taxi first began operations in which two places before expanding to Maharashtra?

A.Karnataka and Telangana

B.Delhi and Gujarat

C.Maharashtra and Goa

D.Uttar Pradesh and Rajasthan

E.Punjab and Haryana

Answer: B

Bharat Taxi was first introduced in **Delhi and Gujarat** and has now expanded to **Maharashtra**, beginning operations from the **Navi Mumbai International Airport**.

Maharashtra, with more than **2.5 lakh cooperative societies**, provides a strong ecosystem for expanding the cooperative transport model across cities and towns.

The initiative aims to strengthen **cooperative entrepreneurship**, generate **employment opportunities**, improve **driver welfare**, and provide a sustainable alternative in the urban mobility sector.

491. As per the news, which asset management company received SEBI approval in 2026 to launch its Mutual Fund (MF) business?

A.Zerodha Fund House

B.Carnelian Asset Management & Advisors Pvt. Ltd.

C.NJ Asset Management

D.WhiteOak Capital Asset Management

E.Bajaj Finserv Asset Management

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The **Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI)** approved **Carnelian Asset Management & Advisors Private Limited** to launch its **Mutual Fund (MF) business**.

The approval enables **Carnelian Asset Management** to offer **active and passive mutual fund schemes** across **equity**, **debt**, and **hybrid asset classes** to **retail investors**.

With this approval, the company can expand its **integrated wealth management platform** by providing **SEBI-regulated mutual fund products**.

The approval allows **Carnelian** to diversify beyond its existing businesses of **Portfolio Management Services (PMS)**, **Alternative Investment Funds (AIFs)**, and **offshore investment strategies**.

The company plans to introduce a wide range of **active and passive mutual fund schemes** to cater to the investment needs of a **broader retail investor base**.

Detailed Explanation:

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Investment Funds (AIFs), and **offshore investment strategies**.

The company plans to introduce a wide range of **active and passive mutual fund schemes** to cater to the investment needs of a **broader retail investor base**.

Carnelian Asset Management aims to deepen **mutual fund penetration** by expanding its presence across **Tier-II**, **Tier-III**, and **rural India** through **enhanced financial awareness** and **investor education**.

Carnelian Asset Management & Advisors Private Limited is a **Mumbai, Maharashtra-based** asset management company established in **2019**.

The company was founded by **Vikas Khemani**, **Manoj Bahety**, and **Swati Khemani**.

As of **30 June 2026**, **Carnelian Asset Management** managed assets worth over **₹18,300 crore**.

492. As per the news, the RBI Monetary Museum, temporarily closed for renovation in July 2026, is located in which city?

A.New Delhi

B.Kolkata

C.Chenna

D.Mumbai

E.Hyderabad

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** announced the **temporary closure** of the **RBI Monetary Museum** in **Mumbai** from **22 July 2026** for **renovation work** until further notice.

The **RBI Monetary Museum** was established by the **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** and is **India's first museum** dedicated to documenting, preserving, and showcasing the country's **monetary heritage**.

The museum also promotes **research on the evolution of money in India**, highlighting the **historical development** of the nation's monetary system.

The **RBI Monetary Museum** is located in the **Amar Building**, **Fort area**, **Mumbai, Maharashtra**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** announced the **temporary closure** of the **RBI Monetary Museum** in **Mumbai** from **22 July 2026** for **renovation work** until further notice.

The **RBI Monetary Museum** was established by the **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** and is **India's first museum** dedicated to documenting, preserving, and showcasing the country's **monetary heritage**.

The museum also promotes **research on the evolution of money in India**, highlighting the **historical development** of the nation's monetary system.

The **RBI Monetary Museum** is located in the **Amar Building**, **Fort area**, **Mumbai, Maharashtra**.

The museum houses **more than 10,000 exhibits**, making it one of India's

most **comprehensive collections** of monetary artefacts.

Around **1,500 exhibits** are displayed for **public viewing**, while the remaining collections are preserved for **research and archival purposes**.

The exhibits include **ancient coins**, **modern coins**, **paper currency**, **financial instruments**, **commemorative issues**, and other **monetary artefacts**.

The museum presents the **complete history and evolution of money in India**, beginning with the **barter system**.

493. As per the news, which bank signed an MoU with the Government of Andhra Pradesh to establish India's first bank-led Quantum Finance Hub at Amaravati Quantum Valley (AQV)?

A.State Bank of India

B.Bank of Baroda

C.Punjab National Bank

D.Canara Bank

E.Union Bank of India

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

Punjab National Bank (PNB) signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** with the **Government of Andhra Pradesh (AP)** to establish the **PNB Quantum Finance Hub** at the **Amaravati Quantum Valley (AQV)** in **Amaravati, Andhra Pradesh**.

The **PNB Quantum Finance Hub** is **India's first bank-led Quantum Finance Hub**, marking a major milestone in the adoption of **Quantum Computing (QC)** in the banking and financial services sector.

Detailed Explanation:

Punjab National Bank (PNB) signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** with the **Government of Andhra Pradesh (AP)** to establish the **PNB Quantum Finance Hub** at the **Amaravati Quantum Valley (AQV)** in **Amaravati, Andhra Pradesh**.

The **PNB Quantum Finance Hub** is **India's first bank-led Quantum Finance Hub**, marking a major milestone in the adoption of **Quantum Computing (QC)** in the banking and financial services sector.

With this collaboration, **PNB** became the **first bank in India** to partner with a **state government** for establishing a dedicated **Quantum Finance Facility**.

The hub aims to develop **secure, intelligent, and future-ready banking solutions** by leveraging **Quantum Computing (QC)** and **Artificial Intelligence (AI)**.

The initiative will promote **collaborative research**, **technological innovation**, **cybersecurity**, **advanced financial technologies**, and **skill development** in the banking ecosystem.

494. As per the 2026 Global Bank Awards by Global Finance magazine, which bank was named the World's Best Corporate Bank?

A.DBS Bank Limited

B.JPMorgan Chase & Co

C.HSBC Holdings Plc

D.Standard Chartered Bank

E.Bank of Singapore

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

DBS Bank Limited, a **Singapore-based** multinational banking and financial services corporation, was named the **World's Best Corporate Bank** at the **2026 Global Bank Awards** presented by **Global Finance magazine**.

DBS Bank became the **first Southeast Asian bank** to win the **World's Best Corporate Bank** title since the award category was introduced in **2005**.

The recognition highlights **DBS Bank's** leadership in **corporate banking**, **innovation**, **customer service**, and **financial excellence**.

DBS Bank also held the title of **"Safest Bank in Asia"** by **Global Finance magazine** for **17 consecutive years (2009–2025)**.

Detailed Explanation:

DBS Bank Limited, a **Singapore-based** multinational banking and financial services corporation, was named the **World's Best Corporate Bank** at the **2026 Global Bank Awards** presented by **Global Finance magazine**.

DBS Bank became the **first Southeast Asian bank** to win the **World's Best Corporate Bank** title since the award category was introduced in **2005**.

The recognition highlights **DBS Bank's** leadership in **corporate banking**, **innovation**, **customer service**, and **financial excellence**.

DBS Bank also held the title of **"Safest Bank in Asia"** by **Global Finance magazine** for **17 consecutive years (2009–2025)**.

The **2026 Global Bank Awards** winners were selected by the **editorial board of Global Finance magazine**, with inputs from **corporate financial executives**, **bankers**, and **financial analysts** from around the world.

The evaluation was based on key parameters such as **annual financial performance**, **reputation**, **management excellence**, and **overall banking achievements**.

495. As per the news, what are the trading hours of the London Stock Exchange's new after-hours trading platform LSE 24 (London Time)?

A.6:00 PM to 6:00 AM

B.5:00 PM to 7:50 AM

C.4:00 PM to 8:00 AM

D.7:00 PM to 9:00 AM

E.8:00 PM to 8:00 AM

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The **London Stock Exchange (LSE)** announced the launch of **LSE 24**, a new **after-hours trading platform** designed to provide **near-continuous trading** for global investors.

LSE 24 will offer trading from **5:00 PM to 7:50 AM (London Time)**, significantly extending the exchange's **trading hours**.

Client testing of the **LSE 24** platform is expected to begin by the **end of 2026**.

The **commercial launch** of **LSE 24** is planned for the **first half (H1) of 2027**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **London Stock Exchange (LSE)** announced the launch of **LSE 24**, a new **after-hours trading platform** designed to provide **near-continuous trading** for global investors.

LSE 24 will offer trading from **5:00 PM to 7:50 AM (London Time)**, significantly extending the exchange's **trading hours**.

Client testing of the **LSE 24** platform is expected to begin by the **end of 2026**.

The **commercial launch** of **LSE 24** is planned for the **first half (H1) of 2027**.

In its initial phase, **LSE 24** will facilitate trading in **Exchange-Traded Products (ETPs)**, including **Exchange-Traded Funds (ETFs)**.

The **London Stock Exchange** plans to expand the platform in the future to include **equity trading**.

The initiative aims to provide **greater flexibility** for global investors, improve **market liquidity**, and meet the increasing demand for **extended trading hours**.

The concept of **LSE 24** is inspired by the **24×7 trading model** of **cryptocurrency markets**, reflecting evolving **global investment trends**.

496. As per the news, under the proposed amendments to the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024, the minimum imprisonment for offences related to exam paper leaks has been increased to_____

A.3 years

B.4 years

C.1 year

D.5 years

E.10 years

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The **Union Cabinet** approved amendments to the **Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024** to impose **stricter penalties** for **exam paper leaks** and other organised examination malpractices.

Under the proposed amendments, the **minimum imprisonment** for offences related to **exam paper leaks** has been increased from **3 years to 5 years**.

The **maximum imprisonment** remains **10 years**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Union Cabinet** approved amendments to the **Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024** to impose **stricter penalties** for **exam paper leaks** and other organised examination malpractices.

The proposed amendments aim to strengthen the legal framework to **prevent organised cheating**, ensure **fair and transparent public**

examinations, and restore public confidence in the examination system.

The amended Bill will be introduced in **Parliament** for approval.

Under the proposed amendments, the **minimum imprisonment** for offences related to **exam paper leaks** has been increased from **3 years to 5 years**.

The **maximum imprisonment** remains **10 years**.

The **maximum monetary penalty** has been enhanced from **₹1 crore** to **₹10 crore** for serious offences involving organised examination fraud.

The Government also proposes to **speed up investigations and trials** through **special courts** and fast-track judicial mechanisms.

497. As per the news, Bitchat, the decentralised peer-to-peer messaging application, was developed by whom?

A.Sundar Pichai

B.Satya Nadella

C.Pavel Durov

D.Elon Musk

E.Jack Dorsey

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

The **Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre (I4C)**, under the **Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA)**, directed **GitHub** to remove repositories related to **Bitchat**, a **decentralised peer-to-peer messaging application**, citing **national security** and **law enforcement concerns**.

The directive was issued on **23 July 2026** under:

Section 79(3)(b) of the Information Technology Act, 2000

Rule 3(1)(d) of the Information Technology (Intermediary Guidelines and Digital Media Ethics Code) Rules, 2021

The order sought the removal of **three Bitchat repositories**, including the **Android application repository**, from **GitHub**.

Detailed Explanation:

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Rule 3(1)(d) of the Information Technology (Intermediary Guidelines and Digital Media Ethics Code) Rules, 2021

The order sought the removal of **three Bitchat repositories**, including the **Android application repository**, from **GitHub**.

Bitchat is an **open-source, decentralised messaging application** developed by **Jack Dorsey**, former **Chief Executive Officer (CEO) of Twitter**, and uses **Bluetooth Low Energy (BLE) mesh networking** instead of the internet or mobile networks.

The application enables **peer-to-peer encrypted messaging** without requiring:

Internet or mobile data

Centralised servers

Mobile number or email registration

Messages are transmitted through **nearby Bluetooth-enabled devices**, allowing communication over approximately **30–100 metres**, depending on network conditions, with the **mesh network** extending communication beyond the normal Bluetooth range.

498. As per the factsheet released by the Government of India on "White Gold" (Cotton), consider the following statements:

1. **India ranks 1st globally in cotton cultivation area.**
2. **India is the 2nd largest producer of cotton in the world.**
3. **Cotton exports were valued at USD 12.49 billion during Financial Year 2024–25 (FY25).**

A.Only 1 and 2

B.Only 2 and 3

C.Only 1 and 3

D.All the above

E.Only 1

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

The **Government of India (GoI)** released a **factsheet** describing **Cotton** as India's **"White Gold"**, highlighting its significant contribution to the **agriculture, textile, and export sectors**.

India ranks 1st globally in **cotton cultivation area**, with **114.84 lakh hectares**, accounting for nearly **38% of the world's cotton cultivation area**.

India is the **2nd largest producer** and **2nd largest consumer** of cotton globally.

Cotton exports were valued at **USD 11.49 billion** during **Financial Year 2024–25 (FY25)**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Government of India (GoI)** released a **factsheet** describing **Cotton** as India's **"White Gold"**, highlighting its significant contribution to the **agriculture, textile, and export sectors**.

Cotton supports the livelihoods of nearly **6 million farmers** and **40–50 million people** across the **textile value chain**.

India ranks 1st globally in **cotton cultivation area**, with **114.84 lakh hectares**, accounting for nearly **38% of the world's cotton cultivation area**.

India is the **2nd largest producer** and **2nd largest consumer** of cotton globally.

Cotton production for **2025–26 (Provisional)** is estimated at **290.91 lakh bales (4.95 million tonnes)**.

Domestic cotton consumption for **2025–26 (Provisional)** is estimated at **328 lakh bales (5.58 million tonnes)**.

During **2024–25**, India exported **18 lakh bales (0.31 million metric tonnes)** of cotton, accounting for nearly **3.37% of global cotton exports**.

Cotton exports were valued at **USD 11.49 billion** during **Financial Year 2024–25 (FY25)**.

The **top export destinations** for India's cotton fabrics and made-ups were:

United States of America (USA)

Bangladesh

Sri Lanka

499. As per the news, which mobile application enables cotton farmers to self-register and book procurement slots under the MSP system?

A.e-NAM App

B.Kisan Suvidha App

C.Kapas Kisan Mobile Application

D.AgriStack App

E.PM-KISAN Mobile App

Answer: C

The **Kapas Kisan Mobile Application** enables cotton farmers to **self-register** and **book procurement slots** under the **MSP** system.

More than **41 lakh farmers** have registered on the **Kapas Kisan App**.

The **Kasturi Cotton Bharat (KCB)** initiative, launched by the **Ministry of Textiles (MoT)** in partnership with the **Cotton Corporation of India Limited (CCI)** and the **Cotton Textiles Export Promotion Council (TEXPROCIL)**, promotes **traceability, certification, and global branding** of Indian cotton.

As of **30 June 2026**, **3,29,550 cotton bales** had been certified under the **Kasturi Cotton Bharat (KCB)** initiative.

500. As per the news, what is the name of the mine repurposing tool highlighted in India's first comprehensive report on scientific coal mine closure?

A.RECLAIM

B.L.I.V.E.S

C.SUVIKALP

D.GreenMine Portal

E.Coal Vision 2047

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The report, prepared by the **Coal Controller Organisation (CCO)**, is **India's first comprehensive documentation** of **scientific coal mine closure and mine repurposing practices**.

The report documents the successful scientific closure of **42 coal mines**, including **33 mines closed during the last year**, and serves as a **knowledge repository** for future mine closure and reclamation projects.

The report highlights key mine closure initiatives, including:

RECLAIM (Reviving Environment, Communities, Livelihoods Around Impacted Mines) Framework

L.I.V.E.S. (Land Repurposing, Institutional Convergence, Village-level Participatory Planning, Ecosystem Regeneration, and Sustainable Livelihoods) Framework

SUVIKALP (Sustainable Utilisation of Vast Land Resources through Intelligent Planning) Mine Repurposing Tool

SUVIKALP Samvaad

Detailed Explanation:

The report, prepared by the **Coal Controller Organisation (CCO)**, is **India's first comprehensive documentation** of **scientific coal mine closure and mine repurposing practices**.

The report documents the successful scientific closure of **42 coal mines**, including **33 mines closed during the last year**, and serves as a **knowledge repository** for future mine closure and reclamation projects.

The **Ministry of Coal** has set a target to **scientifically close 147 additional coal mines** over the next **2–3 years**.

The report highlights key mine closure initiatives, including:

RECLAIM (Reviving Environment, Communities, Livelihoods Around Impacted Mines) Framework

L.I.V.E.S. (Land Repurposing, Institutional Convergence, Village-level Participatory Planning, Ecosystem Regeneration, and Sustainable Livelihoods) Framework

SUVIKALP (Sustainable Utilisation of Vast Land Resources through Intelligent Planning) Mine Repurposing Tool

SUVIKALP Samvaad

For the first time, **25% of the approved mine closure cost** has been earmarked for **community development**, creating an estimated investment potential of nearly **₹10,000 crore** over the next decade.

The Government has created a dedicated **corpus of over USD 5 billion (approximately ₹40,000 crore)** to support **scientific and progressive mine closure** across the country.

501. As per the news, which European country became the first to approve a law banning children below the age of 15 from accessing social media platforms?

A.Germany

B.Italy

C.Netherlands

D.Spain

E.France

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

France became the **first country in Europe** to approve a law **banning children below the age of 15** from accessing **social media platforms**, aiming to protect minors from **harmful online content**, **digital addiction**, **cyberbullying**, and **online abuse**.

The legislation was passed by both chambers of the **French Parliament** as a flagship initiative of **President Emmanuel Macron's government**.

The law is part of France's broader strategy to strengthen **child safety**, **mental well-being**, and **responsible digital usage**.

Under the new law, **children under 15 years of age** will not be allowed to access **online social networking services**, including major platforms such as **Facebook**, **Instagram**, **TikTok**, and **Snapchat**.

Detailed Explanation:

France became the **first country in Europe** to approve a law **banning children below the age of 15** from accessing **social media platforms**, aiming to protect minors from **harmful online content**, **digital addiction**, **cyberbullying**, and **online abuse**.

The legislation was passed by both chambers of the **French Parliament** as a flagship initiative of **President Emmanuel Macron's government**.

The law is part of France's broader strategy to strengthen **child safety**, **mental well-being**, and **responsible digital usage**.

Under the new law, **children under 15 years of age** will not be allowed to access **online social networking services**, including major platforms such as **Facebook**, **Instagram**, **TikTok**, and **Snapchat**.

The legislation also **prohibits the use of mobile phones in French high schools**, complementing earlier measures aimed at reducing **digital distractions** and improving the **learning environment**.

The issue gained national attention after several French families filed **lawsuits against TikTok**, alleging that **harmful content** on the platform contributed to **teenage suicides** and **serious mental health problems**.

The legislation is the culmination of a campaign led by **President Emmanuel Macron since 2017**, during which he repeatedly highlighted the dangers of **anonymous social media accounts** and **online abuse**.

The **Senate** approved the compromise bill by **243 votes to 2**, while the **National Assembly** passed it by **279 votes to 81**.

502. As per the news, who has been appointed as the United Kingdom's first Minister for Artificial Intelligence (AI)?

A.Rishi Sunak

B.Kanishka Narayan

C.Keir Starmer

D.Priti Patel

E.Suella Braverman

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Kanishka Narayan, a Bihar-born British-Indian **Labour Member of Parliament (MP)**, has been appointed as the United Kingdom's **first Minister for Artificial Intelligence (AI)** under the government led by **Prime Minister Andy Burnham**.

The appointment marks the creation of the United Kingdom's **first dedicated ministerial portfolio for Artificial Intelligence (AI)**, reflecting the country's growing focus on **AI governance** and **technological innovation**.

Detailed Explanation:

Kanishka Narayan, a Bihar-born British-Indian **Labour Member of Parliament (MP)**, has been appointed as the United Kingdom's **first Minister for Artificial Intelligence (AI)** under the government led by **Prime Minister Andy Burnham**.

The appointment marks the creation of the United Kingdom's **first dedicated ministerial**

portfolio for Artificial Intelligence (AI), reflecting the country's growing focus on **AI governance** and **technological innovation**.

The **Artificial Intelligence (AI) portfolio** will function jointly under the **Cabinet Office** and the **Department for Business, Innovation, Science and Trade**.

The new ministry aims to strengthen the United Kingdom's **AI policy**, **digital transformation**, **innovation ecosystem**, and the development of **emerging technologies**.

503. As per the news, what is the name of the indigenously developed long-range air defence missile system whose maiden flight test was successfully conducted by DRDO?

A.Akash Prime

B.QRSAM

C.Trishul

D.Astra Mk-II

E.Kusha

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

The **Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO)** successfully conducted the maiden flight test of the **'Kusha' Long-Range Surface-to-Air Missile (LR-SAM)** from **APJ Abdul Kalam Island** off the coast of **Odisha**.

During the flight test, the **Kusha LR-SAM** successfully intercepted an **electronic target** simulating a **high-speed, high-altitude aerial threat**, demonstrating its **precision**, **accuracy**, and **operational readiness**.

The **Kusha** is an **indigenously developed long-range air defence missile system** designed to provide **multi-layered aerial defence** against a wide range of airborne threats.

Detailed Explanation:

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During the flight test, the **Kusha LR-SAM** successfully intercepted an **electronic target** simulating a **high-speed, high-altitude aerial threat**, demonstrating its **precision**, **accuracy**, and **operational readiness**.

The **Kusha** is an **indigenously developed long-range air defence missile system** designed to provide **multi-layered aerial defence** against a wide range of airborne threats.

The missile system is capable of intercepting and neutralising **fighter aircraft**, **stealth aircraft**, **Unmanned Aerial Vehicles (UAVs)**, **cruise missiles**, **Precision-Guided Munitions (PGMs)**, and selected classes of **ballistic missiles** over an **extended range and altitude**.

All major components of the **Kusha weapon system**, including

the **missiles**, **radars**, **command and control centre**, and other subsystems, have been **indigenously developed** by various **DRDO laboratories** in collaboration with **Indian industry partners**.

The **Kusha air defence system** employs a **multi-tier interceptor architecture** with **three different interceptor missile variants** to engage aerial threats at varying distances.

504. As per the news, Raghu Vamsi Aerospace Group announced an investment of over ₹600 crore to establish an integrated manufacturing facility for which of the following?

A.Titanium alloys

B.Nickel-based superalloys

C.Lithium-ion batteries

D.Semiconductor chips

E.Carbon fibre composites

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Raghu Vamsi Aerospace Group announced an investment of **over ₹600 crore** to establish an **integrated nickel-based superalloy manufacturing facility** in **Telangana**.

The announcement was made during the **Farnborough International Airshow 2026** held in the **United Kingdom (UK)**, one of the world's leading **aerospace and defence exhibitions**.

The project aims to strengthen **India's domestic manufacturing capabilities** for **high-performance nickel-based superalloys** and reduce the country's **dependence on imports**.

Detailed Explanation:

Raghu Vamsi Aerospace Group announced an investment of **over ₹600 crore** to establish an **integrated nickel-based superalloy manufacturing facility** in **Telangana**.

The announcement was made during the **Farnborough International Airshow 2026** held in the **United Kingdom (UK)**, one of the world's leading **aerospace and defence exhibitions**.

The project aims to strengthen **India's domestic manufacturing capabilities** for **high-performance nickel-based superalloys** and reduce the country's **dependence on imports**.

The project will be led by **Dr. S. K. Jha**, former Chairman and Managing Director (CMD) of **Mishra Dhatu Nigam Limited (MIDHANI)**, India's premier **special metals manufacturer**.

Raghu Vamsi Aerospace Group will establish the **50-acre manufacturing facility** near **Hyderabad, Telangana**.

The **integrated plant** will have an **annual production capacity** of approximately **5,000 tonnes**.

The facility will manufacture **nickel-based superalloys**, **round bars**, **wires**, **forgings**, **castings**, **tungsten carbide powders**, and other **specialised engineering products**.

505. As per the news, which Chinese commercial aerospace company successfully launched the

Gravity-1 Y4 carrier rocket from a sea-based launch platform in the East China Sea?

A.iSpace

B.Galactic Energy

C.Orienspace (ORIENSPACE)

D.LandSpace

E.CAS Space

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

Chinese commercial aerospace company **Orienspace (ORIENSPACE)** successfully launched the **Gravity-1 Y4 carrier rocket** from a **sea-based launch platform** in the **East China Sea**, placing **9 satellites** into their designated orbits.

The mission marked the **3rd flight** of the **Gravity-1 rocket** and its **first long-range (far-sea) maritime launch**, representing a major milestone in **China's commercial space programme**.

The launch took place from a launch vessel operated by the **Oriental Aerospace Port** in **Haiyang, Yantai, Shandong Province**, **China's only commercial maritime launch base**.

Detailed Explanation:

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The mission marked the **3rd flight** of the **Gravity-1 rocket** and its **first long-range (far-sea) maritime launch**, representing a major milestone in **China's commercial space programme**.

The launch took place from a launch vessel operated by the **Oriental Aerospace Port** in **Haiyang, Yantai, Shandong Province**, **China's only commercial maritime launch base**.

The mission was conducted under the direction of the **Taiyuan Satellite Launch Center**, while the rocket was assembled at the **Oriental Aerospace Port**.

The launch primarily tested the rocket's capability to operate under **far-sea conditions**, validating its **solid-propellant booster configuration**, **long-duration launch readiness**, and adaptability to **complex maritime environments**.

Gravity-1 is the world's first **medium-lift launch vehicle** equipped with **strap-on boosters** powered entirely by **solid-propellant motors**, showcasing advanced launch vehicle technology.

506. As per the news, which platform will make India's indigenous 1.2 µm Process Design Kit (PDK) available under the MoU between NIELIT and the Semi-Conductor Laboratory (SCL)?

A.eChipHub

B.DigiLocker

C.IndiaStack

D.BharatNet

E.Semiconductor India Portal

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

The **National Institute of Electronics and Information Technology (NIELIT)**, an Autonomous Scientific Society under the **Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY)**, signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** with the **Semi-Conductor Laboratory (SCL), Mohali, Punjab**, an autonomous organisation under **MeitY**, to make India's indigenous **1.2 micrometre (µm) Process Design Kit (PDK)** available through the **eChipHub platform**.

The collaboration aims to strengthen **India's semiconductor ecosystem** and accelerate the objectives of the **India Semiconductor Mission (ISM)** by promoting **indigenous semiconductor technology**, **innovation**, and **skill development**.

The initiative provides **students**, **researchers**, **faculty members**, **startups**, **Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises (MSMEs)**, **academic institutions**, and **industry professionals** with access to **indigenous semiconductor process technology** for **Integrated Circuit (IC) design and prototyping**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **National Institute of Electronics and Information Technology (NIELIT)**, an Autonomous Scientific Society under the **Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY)**, signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** with the **Semi-Conductor Laboratory (SCL), Mohali, Punjab**, an autonomous organisation under **MeitY**, to make India's indigenous **1.2 micrometre (µm) Process Design Kit (PDK)** available through the **eChipHub platform**.

The collaboration aims to strengthen **India's semiconductor ecosystem** and accelerate the objectives of the **India Semiconductor Mission (ISM)** by promoting **indigenous semiconductor technology**, **innovation**, and **skill development**.

The initiative provides **students**, **researchers**, **faculty members**, **startups**, **Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises (MSMEs)**, **academic institutions**, and **industry professionals** with access to **indigenous semiconductor process technology** for **Integrated Circuit (IC) design and prototyping**.

The **SCL 1.2 µm Process Design Kit (PDK)** has been integrated into **eChipHub** through a **secure Aadhaar-authenticated download mechanism**, ensuring **secure and responsible access** to **semiconductor design resources**.

The integration establishes one of India's first **indigenous design-to-fabrication learning pathways**, enabling learners to complete the entire **Integrated Circuit (IC) design workflow** using **indigenous semiconductor process technology**.

The **learning pathway** covers **Register Transfer Level (RTL) design**, **simulation**, **synthesis**, **physical**

implementation, and **fabrication-oriented chip design**, providing **hands-on semiconductor design experience**.

507. As per the news, Visvesvaraya Technological University (VTU) signed an MoU with which company to enhance skill development and employment opportunities for engineering students?

A.Microsoft

B.Amazon Web Services (AWS)

C.Oracle

D.IBM

E.Google

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

Visvesvaraya Technological University (VTU) entered into an **academic partnership** with **Google** through a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** to enhance **skill development, practical learning, and employment opportunities** for engineering students.

The **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** was signed by **S. Vidyashankar**, **Vice-Chancellor of Visvesvaraya Technological University (VTU)**, **Prasad B. Rampure**, **Registrar (Administration) of VTU**, and **Sanjay Jain**, **Head of Google for Education India**.

The partnership aims to provide training in key technology areas, including:

Artificial Intelligence (AI)

Cloud Computing

Data Science

Cybersecurity

Faculty Skill Development

Detailed Explanation:

Visvesvaraya Technological University (VTU) entered into an **academic partnership** with **Google** through a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** to enhance **skill development, practical learning, and employment opportunities** for engineering students.

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The partnership aims to provide training in key technology areas, including:

Artificial Intelligence (AI)

Cloud Computing

Data Science

Cybersecurity

Faculty Skill Development

The initiative focuses on preparing students according to **industry requirements** and improving their **job readiness** after completion of engineering education.

Visvesvaraya Technological University (VTU) has **220 engineering colleges** with around **3 lakh students**, making the partnership significant for large-scale skill enhancement.

The programme will introduce learning models aligned with the **National Education Policy (NEP)** and **State Education Policy (SEP)** to strengthen technology-based education.

508. As per the news, India is preparing to bid for hosting which international multi-sport event for athletes with disabilities in 2029?

A.Asian Para Games

B.Paralympic Games

C.World Abilitysport Games

D.IWAS World Games

E.Commonwealth Para Games

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The **Paralympic Committee of India (PCI)** and the **Cerebral Palsy Sports Federation of India (CPSFI)** signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** in **New Delhi, Delhi** to jointly pursue **India's bid** to host the **2029 World Abilitysport Games**.

India previously hosted the **International Wheelchair and Amputee Sports Federation (IWAS) World Games** in **Bengaluru, Karnataka**, in **2009**.

Chennai (Tamil Nadu) and **Bhubaneswar (Odisha)** are being considered as the **potential host cities** for the **2029 World Abilitysport Games**, based on their **sports infrastructure, accessibility, and event readiness**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Paralympic Committee of India (PCI)** and the **Cerebral Palsy Sports Federation of India (CPSFI)** signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** in **New Delhi, Delhi** to jointly pursue **India's bid** to host the **2029 World Abilitysport Games**.

The partnership aims to prepare and submit a **competitive bid** to bring the **international multi-sport event for athletes with disabilities** to India, strengthening the country's role in the **global Paralympic movement**.

India previously hosted the **International Wheelchair and Amputee Sports Federation (IWAS) World Games** in **Bengaluru, Karnataka**, in **2009**.

Chennai (Tamil Nadu) and **Bhubaneswar (Odisha)** are being considered as the **potential host cities** for the **2029 World Abilitysport Games**, based on their **sports infrastructure, accessibility, and event readiness**.

The **2029 World Abilitysport Games** are expected to feature **more than 1,500 participants** competing in various **Para sports**, including:

Para Athletics

Para Swimming

Para Badminton

Para Fencing

Cerebral Palsy Football (CP Football)

Para Table Tennis

3-a-side Para Wheelchair Basketball

509. As per the news, Kargil Vijay Diwas is observed every year on which date?

A.15 August

B.26 July

C.27 July

D.15 January

E.16 December

Answer: B

Kargil Vijay Diwas is observed every year on **26 July** to honour the **bravery, courage, and supreme sacrifice of Indian Armed Forces personnel** during the **Kargil War of 1999**.

Kargil Vijay Diwas 2026 marks the **27th anniversary** of India's victory in the **Kargil War**, which was fought between **India and Pakistan from May to July 1999**.

The day commemorates the successful completion of **Operation Vijay**, launched by the **Indian Armed Forces** to recapture strategic locations occupied by Pakistani forces in the **Kargil sector**.

The **Kargil War** was an armed conflict between **India and Pakistan** in the **Kargil district of Jammu and Kashmir (now part of Ladakh)** along the **Line of Control (LoC)**.

510. As per the recent news, who is the Managing Director (MD) and Chief Executive Officer (CEO) of Punjab National Bank (PNB)?

A.Challa Sreenivasulu Setty

B.Debadatta Chand

C.A. Manimekhalai

D.Swarup Kumar Saha

E.Ashok Chandra

Answer: E

About Punjab National Bank (PNB) :

Established : **19 May 1894** and commenced operations on **12 April 1895**.

PNB is **India's second-largest Public Sector Bank (PSB)** after the **State Bank of India (SBI)**.

Headquarters : **Dwarka, New Delhi, Delhi**.

Managing Director (MD) and **Chief Executive Officer (CEO)** : **Ashok Chandra**

511. As per Press Note 3 of 2026, the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT) relaxed the FDI policy to allow foreign-funded e-commerce companies to operate an inventory-based model exclusively for:

A.Domestic retail sales in India

B.Import of foreign goods into India

C.Export of goods manufactured or produced in India

D.Wholesale trading of agricultural products

E.Government procurement of goods

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The **Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT)** under the **Ministry of Commerce and Industry (MoC&I)** relaxed the **Foreign Direct Investment (FDI) Policy** by allowing foreign-funded e-commerce companies to operate an **inventory-based model** exclusively for the **export of goods manufactured or produced in Indi(a)**

The policy amendment is intended to **strengthen India's manufacturing ecosystem**, expand the country's **global export**

footprint, and improve the **competitiveness of Indian manufacturers** in international markets.
The revised provisions were notified through **Press Note 3 of 2026** issued by the **Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT)**.
Detailed Explanation:
The **Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT)** under the **Ministry of Commerce and Industry (MoC&I)** relaxed the **Foreign Direct Investment (FDI) Policy** by allowing foreign-funded e-commerce companies to operate an **inventory-based model** exclusively for the **export of goods manufactured or produced in Indi(a)**
The policy change aims to **boost India's exports** by enabling foreign-invested e-commerce platforms to **procure, stock, warehouse, and export** Indian-made products directly to overseas consumers, thereby **improving global market access** for domestic manufacturers and sellers.
Under the previous FDI policy, foreign investment was permitted only in **Business-to-Business (B2B)** e-commerce and the **marketplace model**, while **Business-to-Consumer (B2C)** e-commerce and the **inventory-based model** were **prohibited** for foreign-funded entities to protect domestic retailers.
Under the revised FDI policy, the restrictions on the inventory-based model and B2C e-commerce **will not apply** when the goods being sold are **manufactured or produced in India** and are **exported to foreign markets**.
The updated policy permits foreign-funded e-commerce entities to **own inventory, purchase, warehouse, and directly export** domestically manufactured products to customers outside Indi(a)
The policy amendment is intended to **strengthen India's manufacturing ecosystem**, expand the country's **global export footprint**, and improve the **competitiveness of Indian manufacturers** in international markets.
The revised provisions were notified through **Press Note 3 of 2026** issued by the **Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT)**.

512. As per the news, SBI Life Insurance Company Limited has become the Principal Partner of the Indian Contingent for which event?

A.2026 Para Sport Season
B.Asian Games 2026
C.Olympic Games 2028
D.Khelo India Para Games 2026
E.National Para Athletics Championship 2026
Answer: A
Short Explanation:
SBI Life Insurance Company Limited, one of India's leading private life insurers, entered into a **strategic partnership** with the **Paralympic Committee of India (PCI)**.
Under the partnership, **SBI Life Insurance** became the **Principal Partner** of

the **Indian Contingent** for the **2026 Para Sport Season**.

The collaboration aims to **recognise, encourage, and highlight** the achievements of India's **para-athletes**, celebrating their **dedication, resilience, and high performanc(e)**

Detailed Explanation:

SBI Life Insurance Company Limited, one of India's leading private life insurers, entered into a **strategic partnership** with the **Paralympic Committee of India (PCI)**.

Under the partnership, **SBI Life Insurance** became the **Principal Partner** of the **Indian Contingent** for the **2026 Para Sport Season**.

The collaboration aims to **recognise, encourage, and highlight** the achievements of India's **para-athletes**, celebrating their **dedication, resilience, and high performanc(e)**

SBI Life Insurance will also serve as the **Official Life Insurance Partner** of the **Indian Contingent** at the **Commonwealth Para Games 2026**.

The **Commonwealth Para Games 2026** will be held in **Glasgow, Scotlan(d)**

SBI Life Insurance will further act as the **Official Life Insurance Partner** for the **Asian Para Games 2026**.

513. As per the news, the Gross Non-Performing Assets (GNPAs) of Scheduled Commercial Banks (SCBs) declined to what percentage as of March 2026?

A.1.73%

B.2.25%

C.2.75%

D.3.10%

E.3.50%

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

Gross Non-Performing Assets (GNPAs) of **Scheduled Commercial Banks (SCBs)** declined to **1.73% as of March 2026**, compared to **2.75% in March 2024**, indicating a significant improvement in the **asset quality** of India's banking sector.

Minister of State (MoS) for Finance Pankaj Chaudhary informed the **Rajya Sabha** that the decline in NPAs reflects the impact of sustained **Government and Reserve Bank of India (RBI) reforms**.

Public Sector Banks (PSBs) reduced their **Gross NPAs** from **₹6.16 lakh crore in March 2021 to ₹2.45 lakh crore in March 2026**, showing a substantial improvement in financial health.

Detailed Explanation:

Gross Non-Performing Assets (GNPAs) of **Scheduled Commercial Banks (SCBs)** declined to **1.73% as of March 2026**, compared to **2.75% in March 2024**, indicating a significant improvement in the **asset quality** of India's banking sector.

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decline in NPAs reflects the impact of sustained **Government and Reserve Bank of India (RBI) reforms**.

Public Sector Banks (PSBs) reduced their **Gross NPAs** from **₹6.16 lakh crore in March 2021 to ₹2.45 lakh crore in March 2026**, showing a substantial improvement in financial health.

Private Sector Banks also improved asset quality by reducing NPAs from **₹2.02 lakh crore in March 2021 to ₹1.26 lakh crore in March 2026**.

Foreign Banks operating in India reduced their NPAs from **₹10,199 crore to ₹3,990 crore** between **March 2021 and March 2026**.

Small Finance Banks (SFBs) recorded an increase in NPAs, rising from **₹5,971 crore in March 2021 to ₹10,448 crore in March 2026**.

The **Government** clarified that **loan write-offs** are only an **accounting exercise** carried out to clean bank balance sheets and **do not amount to loan waivers**.

514. As per the news, Nepal has permitted Indian and Nepali citizens to carry eligible Indian currency notes across the border up to a maximum limit of_____

A.₹10,000 per person

B.₹15,000 per person

C.₹20,000 per person

D.₹25,000 per person

E.₹50,000 per person

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

Nepal has permitted **Indian and Nepali citizens** to carry **Indian currency notes of ₹200 and ₹500 denominations** (issued on or after **9 November 2016**) into or out of Nepal up to a **maximum limit of ₹25,000 per person**.

The decision was notified by the **Nepal Rastra Bank (NRB)**, the central bank of Nepal, to facilitate smoother **cross-border travel, tourism, trade, and business** between **India and Nepal**.

Indian ₹500 and ₹1,000 notes issued before **9 November 2016** continue to remain **prohibited** in Nepal.

Nepali citizens are permitted to bring Indian currency into Nepal **only from India** and can carry Indian currency out of Nepal **only to India**, not to any third country.

Detailed Explanation:

Nepal has permitted **Indian and Nepali citizens** to carry **Indian currency notes of ₹200 and ₹500 denominations** (issued on or after **9 November 2016**) into or out of Nepal up to a **maximum limit of ₹25,000 per person**.

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Indian ₹500 and ₹1,000 notes issued before **9 November 2016** continue to remain **prohibited** in Nepal.

Nepali citizens are permitted to bring Indian currency into Nepal **only from India** and can

carry Indian currency out of Nepal **only to India**, not to any third country.

The revised regulations strengthen the long-standing **open-border arrangement** and promote **economic, commercial, and cultural ties** between **India and Nepal**.

The **maximum permissible limit** for carrying eligible Indian currency notes across the border is **₹25,000 per person**.

The eligible Indian currency includes only **₹200 and ₹500 denomination notes** issued after **India's demonetisation on 9 November 2016**.

India had demonetised the old **₹500 and ₹1,000 banknotes** on **8 November 2016**, after which a new series of currency notes was introduce(d)

515. As per the news, who has been appointed as the Chairperson of the High-Powered Exam Security Task Force constituted by the Government of India?

A.Nandan Nilekani

B.N. Chandrasekaran

C.Kris Gopalakrishnan

D.Sam Pitroda

E.Rajeev Chandrasekhar

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

The **Government of India** has constituted a **High-Powered Exam Security Task Force** to strengthen the country's examination system and prevent **paper leaks, impersonation, and examination malpractices**.

The **six-member task force** will be chaired by **Infosys Co-founder Nandan Nilekani**.

The committee has been formed to recommend **technology-driven reforms** for making **competitive examinations more secure, transparent, and credibl(e)**

Detailed Explanation:

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The **six-member task force** will be chaired by **Infosys Co-founder Nandan Nilekani**.

The committee has been formed to recommend **technology-driven reforms** for making **competitive examinations more secure, transparent, and credibl(e)**

The task force will focus on:

Preventing **paper leaks** and examination frau(d)

Strengthening **digital infrastructure** for national-level examinations.

Improving **transparency and accountability** in recruitment and entrance examinations.

Recommending **long-term reforms** for examination security.

Restoring **public confidence** in India's examination system.

The committee comprises experts from the fields of **education, technology, administration, science, and internal security**.

516. As per the news, the Uttarakhand Forest Department, in collaboration with the Wildlife

Institute of India (WII), launched a radio-collaring project to monitor which animal ahead of the Haridwar Kumbh Mela 2027?

A.Bengal Tiger

B.Wild Elephant

C.Indian Leopard

D.One-horned Rhinoceros

E.Sloth Bear

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The **Uttarakhand Forest Department**, in collaboration with the **Wildlife Institute of India (WII)**, has launched a **radio-collaring project** to monitor wild elephants ahead of the **Haridwar Kumbh Mela 2027**.

The initiative aims to **minimise human-elephant conflict**, ensure the **safety of pilgrims**, and conserve wildlife by enabling **real-time tracking of elephant herds**.

Under the project, **radio collars** will be fitted on the **lead elephants** of selected herds, allowing forest officials to monitor the movement of the entire herd, as elephants generally move together.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Uttarakhand Forest Department**, in collaboration with the **Wildlife Institute of India (WII)**, has launched a **radio-collaring project** to monitor wild elephants ahead of the **Haridwar Kumbh Mela 2027**.

The initiative aims to **minimise human-elephant conflict**, ensure the **safety of pilgrims**, and conserve wildlife by enabling **real-time tracking of elephant herds**.

Under the project, **radio collars** will be fitted on the **lead elephants** of selected herds, allowing forest officials to monitor the movement of the entire herd, as elephants generally move together.

Since **May 2026**, the **Wildlife Institute of India (WII)** has been conducting field studies to identify:

Elephant herd sizes

Migration routes

Movement patterns

Frequently visited locations

The **Wildlife Institute of India (WII)** has provided **four radio collars** for the project.

Real-time tracking will enable forest authorities to:

Issue **early warnings** to nearby residents.

Deploy **rapid response teams** to conflict-prone areas.

Guide elephants safely back into forest habitats.

Improve wildlife management during the **Haridwar Kumbh Mela 2027**.

The proposal was reviewed by the **State Wildlife Board** and the **State-Level Tiger Steering Committee**, chaired by **Uttarakhand Chief Minister Pushkar Singh Dhami**.

517. As per the news, HCL Technologies (HCLTech) announced plans to establish an AI-optimised Data Centre and a Global Technology Centre in which state?

A.Telangana

B.Karnataka

C.Gujarat

D.Odisha

E.Tamil Nadu

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

HCL Technologies (HCLTech) announced plans to establish an **Artificial Intelligence (AI)-optimised Data Centre** and a **Global Technology Centre** in **Bhubaneswar, Odish(a)**

The project will be developed in collaboration with the **Government of Odisha** and **Sarvam AI**, with an estimated investment of **₹15,000 cror(e)**

The facilities will be established at the proposed **Odisha Sovereign Artificial Intelligence Park**, which aims to strengthen **India's sovereign Artificial Intelligence capabilities**.

Detailed Explanation:

HCL Technologies (HCLTech) announced plans to establish an **Artificial Intelligence (AI)-optimised Data Centre** and a **Global Technology Centre** in **Bhubaneswar, Odish(a)**

The project will be developed in collaboration with the **Government of Odisha** and **Sarvam AI**, with an estimated investment of **₹15,000 cror(e)**

The facilities will be established at the proposed **Odisha Sovereign Artificial Intelligence Park**, which aims to strengthen **India's sovereign Artificial Intelligence capabilities**.

The initiative will provide **secure, scalable, and indigenous Artificial Intelligence infrastructure** for:

Government organisations

Enterprises

Research institutions

Startups

The **Artificial Intelligence Data Centre** marks **HCL Technologies' first entry into the Artificial Intelligence infrastructure sector** in Indi(a)

518. As per the news, the 'BHASHINI Rajyam: State Engagement Workshop' organised in Panaji, Goa had a special focus on which language?

A.Marathi

B.Kannada

C.Konkani

D.Gujarati

E.Malayalam

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The **Digital India BHASHINI Division (DIBD)**, under the **Digital India Corporation** and the **Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY)**, in collaboration with the **Department of Information Technology, Electronics and Communications, Government of Goa**, organised the **'BHASHINI Rajyam: State Engagement Workshop'** in **Panaji, Go(a)**

The workshop aimed to **advance multilingual Artificial Intelligence (AI)** and strengthen **language-first Digital Public Infrastructure (DPI)**, with a special focus on the **Konkani languag(e)**

Detailed Explanation:

The **Digital India BHASHINI Division (DIBD)**, under the **Digital India Corporation** and the **Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY)**, in collaboration with the **Department of Information Technology, Electronics and Communications, Government of Goa**, organised the **'BHASHINI Rajyam: State Engagement Workshop'** in **Panaji, Go(a)**

The workshop aimed to **advance multilingual Artificial Intelligence (AI)** and strengthen **language-first Digital Public Infrastructure (DPI)**, with a special focus on the **Konkani languag(e)**

The event was attended by **Goa Chief Minister Dr. Pramod Sawant**, **Chief Executive Officer (CEO) of Digital India BHASHINI Division Amitabh Nag**, policymakers, senior government officials, industry leaders, academicians, startups, and language experts.

The workshop showcased the progress of the **Konkani Large Language Model (LLM)** currently under development to enhance digital services in the **Konkani languag(e)**

A live demonstration highlighted real-time English-to-Konkani speech transcription, translation, and speech synthesis, showcasing the capabilities of multilingual Artificial Intelligenc(e)

519. As per the news, consider the following statements about the "Gems of India" Challenge:

1. **It has been launched by the Ministry of Information and Broadcasting.**
2. **The challenge is implemented through the MyWAVES platform under the WAVES OTT ecosystem.**
3. **The pilot phase will initially be conducted in six States and Union Territories.**

A.Only 1 and 2

B.Only 2 and 3

C.Only 1 and 3

D.All the above

E.Only 1

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The **Ministry of Information and Broadcasting (MIB)** has launched the **Pilot Phase of the "Gems of India" Challenge**, a national initiative aimed at **identifying, nurturing and promoting grassroots digital creators** across Indi(a)

The challenge is implemented through **MyWAVES**, the citizen creator platform available under the **WAVES Over-The-Top (OTT) platform**, which enables users to create, upload and share original content.

Under the challenge, participants can submit **original videos of 1 to 3 minutes duration** through the MyWAVES section of the WAxVES OTT platform.

The **submission period** for the pilot phase will remain open from **1st August to 31st August 2026**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Ministry of Information and Broadcasting (MIB)** has launched the **Pilot Phase of the**

"Gems of India" Challenge, a national initiative aimed at **identifying, nurturing and promoting grassroots digital creators** across Indi(a)

The initiative focuses on strengthening India's **creative economy (Orange Economy)** by encouraging citizens to showcase the culture, heritage, tourism, traditions, history and unique achievements of their districts through digital storytelling.

The challenge is implemented through **MyWAVES**, the citizen creator platform available under the **WAVES Over-The-Top (OTT) platform**, which enables users to create, upload and share original content.

Under the challenge, participants can submit **original videos of 1 to 3 minutes duration** through the MyWAVES section of the WAxVES OTT platform.

The **submission period** for the pilot phase will remain open from **1st August to 31st August 2026**.

The pilot phase will be conducted in:

Andaman and Nicobar Islands

Arunachal Pradesh

Chandigarh

Dadra and Nagar Haveli and Daman and Diu

Goa

Ladakh

520. As per the news, who has assumed charge as the Secretary of the Ministry of Mines, Government of India?

A.Piyush Goyal

B.Keshav Chandra

C.V. L. Kantha Rao

D.Rajesh Kumar Singh

E.T. V. Somanathan

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Shri Keshav Chandra, a 1995-batch **Indian Administrative Service (IAS)** officer of the **AGMUT cadre**, assumed charge as the **Secretary, Ministry of Mines**, Government of Indi(a)

Keshav Chandra succeeded **Piyush Goyal**, who was appointed as the **Secretary General** of the **National Human Rights Commission (NHRC)**.

Detailed Explanation:

Shri Keshav Chandra, a 1995-batch **Indian Administrative Service (IAS)** officer of the **AGMUT cadre**, assumed charge as the **Secretary, Ministry of Mines**, Government of Indi(a)

Keshav Chandra succeeded **Piyush Goyal**, who was appointed as the **Secretary General** of the **National Human Rights Commission (NHRC)**.

Before assuming his new role, **Keshav Chandra** served as the **Chairperson** of the **New Delhi Municipal Council (NDMC)**.

Soon after taking charge, **Secretary Keshav Chandra** chaired a review meeting with senior officials of the **Ministry of Mines** to assess the Ministry's **key initiatives and ongoing activities**.

521. As per the news, who has been appointed as the Chief Executive Officer (CEO) Designate of Infosys Limited?

A.Salil Parekh

B.Ashiss Kumar Dash

C.Nandan Nilekani

D.Nilanjan Roy

E.Mohit Joshi

Answer: B

Infosys Limited, **India's second-largest Information Technology (IT) services company**, appointed **Ashiss Kumar Dash** as its **Chief Executive Officer (CEO) Designat(e)**

Ashiss Kumar Dash will assume charge as the **Managing Director (MD) & CEO** of **Infosys** from **1 April 2027**, following the completion of **Salil Parekh's second term**.

Ashiss Kumar Dash has been appointed for a **five-year term (2027–2032)**, subject to **shareholders' approval**.

Salil Parekh will continue as **Managing Director (MD) & CEO** until **31 March 2027** to ensure a **smooth leadership transition**.

522. As per the news, who has assumed charge as the Interim President of the International Chess Federation (FIDE)?

A.Arkady Dvorkovich

B.Magnus Carlsen

C.Viswanathan Anand

D.Jan Henric Buettner

E.Wadim Rosenstein

Answer: C

Viswanathan Anand, **India's five-time World Chess Champion** and **Deputy President of the International Chess Federation (FIDE)**, assumed charge as the **Interim President of FID(e)**

Viswanathan Anand took over as **Interim President** after **FIDE President Arkady Vladimirovich**

Dvorkovich voluntarily **suspended his duties**.

Arkady Dvorkovich stepped aside following **sanctions imposed by the European Union (EU)** and **Switzerland** over **Russia's war against Ukrain(e)**

523. As per the news, Simonia lawbah, the newly discovered spider species by scientists from the Zoological Survey of India (ZSI), was discovered in which state?

A.Arunachal Pradesh

B.Odisha

C.Andhra Pradesh

D.Meghalaya

E.Sikkim

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

Scientists from the **Zoological Survey of India (ZSI)** discovered and documented **two new spider species—Simonia lawbah** from **Meghalaya** and **Hamataliwa papikonda** from **Andhra Pradesh (AP)**—highlighting **India's rich and underexplored biodiversity**.

The discoveries were published in the peer-reviewed journals **Zootaxa** and **Records of the**

Zoological Survey of India (ZSI), marking significant additions to **India's arachnological records**.

Detailed Explanation:

Scientists from the **Zoological Survey of India (ZSI)** discovered and documented **two new spider species—Simonia lawbah** from **Meghalaya** and **Hamataliwa papikonda** from **Andhra Pradesh (AP)**—highlighting **India's rich and underexplored biodiversity**.

The discoveries were published in the peer-reviewed journals **Zootaxa** and **Records of the Zoological Survey of India (ZSI)**, marking significant additions to **India's arachnological records**.

Simonia lawbah was discovered in **Krem Lawbah Cave, Meghalaya**, and belongs to the **Theridiosomatidae family** of **ray spiders**.

Simonia lawbah is the **first recorded species of the genus Simonia in India**, making it an important discovery for the country's biodiversity records.

The spider is **less than 2 millimetres (mm)** in size and is **troglophilic**, meaning it is adapted to living in **cave environments**.

Simonia lawbah constructs a distinctive **cone-shaped ray web** to capture flying insects.

524. As per the news, DeepDATA, launched by ICAR–Central Marine Fisheries Research Institute (ICAR-CMFRI), was developed under which mission?

A.National Fisheries Mission

B.Deep Ocean Mission

C.Blue Revolution Mission

D.Sagarmala Programme

E.National Marine Biodiversity Mission

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The **Indian Council of Agricultural Research – Central Marine Fisheries Research Institute (ICAR-CMFRI)** launched **DeepDATA**, a mobile application developed under the **Deep Ocean Mission** of the **Ministry of Earth Sciences (MoES)** in **Kochi, Keral(a)**

DeepDATA aims to provide **scientifically verified information** on deep-sea fish species while enabling users to **contribute field observations** for building a **national digital repository** of India's deep-sea biodiversity.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Indian Council of Agricultural Research – Central Marine Fisheries Research Institute (ICAR-CMFRI)** launched **DeepDATA**, a mobile application developed under the **Deep Ocean Mission** of the **Ministry of Earth Sciences (MoES)** in **Kochi, Keral(a)**

DeepDATA aims to provide **scientifically verified information** on deep-sea fish species while enabling users to **contribute field observations** for building a **national digital repository** of India's deep-sea biodiversity.

The launch was attended by **Dr. Grinson George**, Director, ICAR-CMFRI; **Dr. Eldho Varghese**, In-charge, IT Unit and Lead Developer of DeepDATA; and **Dr. Rekha J. Nair**, Principal Scientist, ICAR-CMFRI.

DeepDATA serves as a **digital learning and documentation platform**, offering verified information on **taxonomy, distinguishing characteristics, distribution, and conservation status** of deep-sea fish species.

525. As per the news, which organisation commercially launched the Internet of Things (IoT)-enabled Rural Water Service Delivery, Measurement and Monitoring System?

A.CSIR–Central Scientific Instruments Organisation (CSIR-CSIO)

B.Centre for Development of Advanced Computing (C-DAC)

C.National Informatics Centre (NIC)

D.Bharat Electronics Limited (BEL)

E.Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) Delhi

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

The **Council of Scientific and Industrial Research (CSIR)** transferred four indigenous technologies to industry and commercially launched an **Internet of Things (IoT)-enabled Rural Water Service Delivery, Measurement and Monitoring System** during the Technology Transfer Event held at **CSIR Headquarters, New Delhi, Delhi**.

The event was organized by the **CSIR–Central Scientific Instruments Organisation (CSIR-CSIO), Chandigarh**, to promote **technology commercialization, industry collaboration, and innovation-led manufacturing**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Council of Scientific and Industrial Research (CSIR)** transferred four indigenous technologies to industry and commercially launched an **Internet of Things (IoT)-enabled Rural Water Service Delivery, Measurement and Monitoring System** during the Technology Transfer Event held at **CSIR Headquarters, New Delhi, Delhi**.

The event was organized by the **CSIR–Central Scientific Instruments Organisation (CSIR-CSIO), Chandigarh**, to promote **technology commercialization, industry collaboration, and innovation-led manufacturing**.

The programme was presided over by **Dr. N. Kalaiselvi**, Director General (DG), CSIR and Secretary, **Department of Scientific and Industrial Research (DSIR)**.

CSIR-CSIO transferred three indigenous technologies to **Pump Academy Private Limited, Bengaluru, Karnataka**, to strengthen **industrial instrumentation and equipment monitoring**.

The technologies licensed to Pump Academy Private Limited include the **Induction Motor Stethoscope (MSCOPE)**, **Portable & Universal Motor-cum-Pump Performance Monitor (PU-MPPM)**, and **i-Power Quality Analyser (IPQA)**.

526. As per the news, Mirabai Chanu became the first Indian weightlifter to achieve which of the following feats at the Commonwealth Games 2026?

A.Win two consecutive Commonwealth Games gold medals

B.Win three consecutive Commonwealth Games gold medals

C.Win five Commonwealth Games medals

D.Win India's first Commonwealth Games silver medal in weightlifting

E.Set a new Commonwealth Games record in the Clean and Jerk event

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

India's Mirabai Chanu won the **Gold Medal** in the **Women's 48 kg weightlifting event** at the **Commonwealth Games 2026** held in **Glasgow, Scotlan(d)**

Mirabai Chanu lifted a **total of 190 kg** (**85 kg in Snatch + 105 kg in Clean and Jerk**) to successfully defend her titl(e)

With this victory, she became the **first Indian weightlifter to win three consecutive Commonwealth Games Gold Medals**.

Detailed Explanation:

India's Mirabai Chanu won the **Gold Medal** in the **Women's 48 kg weightlifting event** at the **Commonwealth Games 2026** held in **Glasgow, Scotlan(d)**

Mirabai Chanu lifted a **total of 190 kg** (**85 kg in Snatch + 105 kg in Clean and Jerk**) to successfully defend her titl(e)

With this victory, she became the **first Indian weightlifter to win three consecutive Commonwealth Games Gold Medals**.

She also secured **India's first Gold Medal** at the **Commonwealth Games 2026**.

Ruth Asuquo Nyong (Nigeria) won the **Silver Medal**, while **Irene Jane Henry (Malaysia)** secured the **Bronze Medal** in the Women's 48 kg event.

India's Raja Muthupandi won the **Silver Medal** in the **Men's 65 kg weightlifting event**.

527. As per the news, who became the first Indian to win the Girls' Singles title at the World Squash Junior Championships 2026?

A.Joshna Chinappa

B.Dipika Pallikal

C.Anahat Singh

D.Akanksha Salunkhe

E.Tanvi Khanna

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

India's Anahat Singh won the **Girls' Singles title** at the **World Squash Junior Championships 2026**, becoming the **first Indian** to win the prestigious championship.

In the final, **18-year-old Anahat Singh** defeated **Ruqayya Salem of Egypt** in **straight games (11–3, 11–7, 11–9)** to clinch the titl(e)

With this victory, **Anahat Singh** became the **first non-Egyptian player** to win the **Girls' Singles title** since **Amanda Sobhy (United States of America)** won it in **2010**.

The triumph also ended **Egypt's 13-year winning streak**, as Egyptian players had won the **Girls' Singles title consecutively from 2011 to 2025**.

Detailed Explanation:

India's Anahat Singh won the **Girls' Singles title** at the **World Squash Junior**

Championships 2026, becoming the **first Indian** to win the prestigious championship.

In the final, **18-year-old Anahat Singh** defeated **Ruqayya Salem of Egypt** in **straight games (11–3, 11–7, 11–9)** to clinch the titl(e)

With this victory, **Anahat Singh** became the **first non-Egyptian player** to win the **Girls' Singles title** since **Amanda Sobhy (United States of America)** won it in **2010**.

The triumph also ended **Egypt's 13-year winning streak**, as Egyptian players had won the **Girls' Singles title consecutively from 2011 to 2025**.

During the tournament, **Anahat Singh** lost only **two games in six matches**, showcasing a dominant performance throughout the championship.

In the **quarter-finals**, she defeated **Habiba Rizk (Egypt) 3–1**.

In the **semi-finals**, she defeated **Barb Sameh (Egypt) 3–1**.

In the **final**, she overcame **Ruqayya Salem (Egypt) 3–0** to secure the championship

528. As per the news, who won the gold medal at the inaugural Menuires International Chess Open – Masters Tournament 2026 held in France?

A.Raja Rithvik R

B.Rohith Krishna S

C.Artem Omelja

D.Arjun Erigaisi

E.R. Praggnanandhaa

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Indian Grandmasters Rohith Krishna S and Raja Rithvik R secured the **gold and silver medals respectively** at the inaugural **Menuires International Chess Open - Masters Tournament 2026** held in **Les Ménuires, Franc(e)**

Both Indian players finished **jointly at the top of the leaderboard** with **7 points from 9 rounds** and remained **unbeaten throughout the tournament**.

Rohith Krishna S won the **gold medal** by securing a superior **tie-break score of 43 points**, while **Raja Rithvik R** finished second with a **tie-break score of 41.5 points**.

Grandmaster Artem Omelja of Ukraine won the **bronze medal** by scoring **6.5 points**.

Detailed Explanation:

Indian Grandmasters Rohith Krishna S and Raja Rithvik R secured the **gold and silver medals respectively** at the inaugural **Menuires International Chess Open - Masters Tournament 2026** held in **Les Ménuires, Franc(e)**

Both Indian players finished **jointly at the top of the leaderboard** with **7 points from 9 rounds** and remained **unbeaten throughout the tournament**.

Rohith Krishna S won the **gold medal** by securing a superior **tie-break score of 43 points**, while **Raja Rithvik R** finished second with a **tie-break score of 41.5 points**.

Grandmaster Artem Omelja of Ukraine won the **bronze medal** by scoring **6.5 points**.

The tournament witnessed participation from **86 players** representing countries including:

France

India

China

Germany

Poland

Netherlands

Italy

The tournament carried a total **prize fund of €20,000**.

Gold Medal Winner: €3,000

Silver Medal Winner: €2,000

Bronze Medal Winner: €1,500

Rohith Krishna S, a chess player from **Chennai, Tamil Nadu**, became **India's 89th Grandmaster in August 2025**.

Rohith Krishna S is pursuing an **engineering degree at SSN College of Engineering, Chennai**.

529. As per the news, World Nature Conservation Day is observed every year on_____

A.22 April

B.5 June

C.28 July

D.22 May

E.16 September

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

World Nature Conservation Day 2026 is observed on **28 July 2026** across the world to create awareness about the importance of conserving nature, protecting biodiversity, and preserving natural resources.

In **2018**, the **European Union (EU)** completely restricted the **outdoor use of three neonicotinoids**, a type of pesticide, due to concerns regarding their harmful impact on **bees and other pollinators**.

Detailed Explanation:

World Nature Conservation Day 2026 is observed on **28 July 2026** across the world to create awareness about the importance of conserving nature, protecting biodiversity, and preserving natural resources.

In **2018**, the **European Union (EU)** completely restricted the **outdoor use of three neonicotinoids**, a type of pesticide, due to concerns regarding their harmful impact on **bees and other pollinators**.

Between **1995 and 1996**, **31 gray wolves** from **Western Canada** were reintroduced into **Yellowstone National Park, United States of America**, around **40 years after their disappearance due to human activities**.

In **1973**, the **Endangered Species Act (ESA)** was enacted to promote the conservation of **threatened and endangered species** and protect the ecosystems essential for their survival.

530. As per the news, Shabd Udyan is associated with which of the following?

A.National Hub for Language Technology (NHLT)

B.National Digital Library of India

C.Digital India Bhasha Portal

D.National Translation Mission

E.BharatNet Project

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

The event also demonstrated **BHASHINI's Artificial Intelligence tools**, including:

Chitraanuvaad – Image Translation

Vaanianuvaad – Speech Translation

Lekhaanuvaad – Text Translation

Participants were introduced to the **National Hub for Language Technology (NHLT) – Shabd Udyan**, which supports the development of India's language technology ecosystem.

The workshop highlighted the **BHASHINI website plug-in**, which enables websites to support **22 Indian languages**, improving accessibility and citizen-centric digital governanc(e)

Detailed Explanation:

The **Digital India BHASHINI Division (DIBD)**, under the **Digital India Corporation** and the **Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY)**, in collaboration with the **Department of Information Technology, Electronics and Communications, Government of Goa**, organised the **'BHASHINI Rajyam: State Engagement Workshop'** in **Panaji, Go(a)**

The event also demonstrated **BHASHINI's Artificial Intelligence tools**, including:

Chitraanuvaad – Image Translation

Vaanianuvaad – Speech Translation

Lekhaanuvaad – Text Translation

Participants were introduced to the **National Hub for Language Technology (NHLT) – Shabd Udyan**, which supports the development of India's language technology ecosystem.

The workshop highlighted the **BHASHINI website plug-in**, which enables websites to support **22 Indian languages**, improving accessibility and citizen-centric digital governanc(e)

531. As per the news, which exchange launched India's first exchange-traded energy derivative, the Indian Natural Gas Futures contract?

A.Bombay Stock Exchange (BSE)

B.National Stock Exchange (NSE)

C.Multi Commodity Exchange (MCX)

D.Indian Commodity Exchange (ICEX)

E.National Commodity & Derivatives Exchange (NCDEX)

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The National Stock Exchange (NSE) announced the launch of **India's first exchange-traded energy derivative**, the **Indian Natural Gas Futures**, with trading commencing from **27 July 2026**.

The **Indian Natural Gas Futures** contract is linked to a **domestic benchmark**, providing India's first exchange-traded natural gas derivative based on domestic gas prices.

The contract was launched under the trading symbol **NATGASIND** after receiving approval

from the **Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI)** for trading in the **Commodity Derivatives Segment**.

Detailed Explanation:

The National Stock Exchange (NSE) announced the launch of **India's first exchange-traded energy derivative**, the **Indian Natural Gas Futures**, with trading commencing from **27 July 2026**.

The **Indian Natural Gas Futures** contract is linked to a **domestic benchmark**, providing India's first exchange-traded natural gas derivative based on domestic gas prices.

The contract was launched under the trading symbol **NATGASIND** after receiving approval from the **Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI)** for trading in the **Commodity Derivatives Segment**.

The **cash-settled contract** is benchmarked to the **Indian Gas Exchange (IGX) Gujarat (Dahej) Hub** price.

The contract price is quoted in **Rs. per mmBtu (Metric Million British Thermal Units)**, with the **final settlement** based on the **monthly weighted average price of actual IGX deliveries**.

The **trading unit** of the contract is **250 mmBtu**, and trading is available from **Monday to Friday**.

NSE Clearing is responsible for the **clearing, settlement, and margin management** of the contract.

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532. As per the news, VIYONA Fintech received approval from Bharat Connect (formerly BBPS) to operate in which capacity?

A.Bharat Connect Settlement Bank

B.Central Unit (CU)

C.Payment Aggregator (PA)

D.Account Aggregator (AA)

E.Customer Operating Unit (COU)

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

VIYONA Fintech, a **Hyderabad, Telangana-based fintech infrastructure startup**, received approval from the **Bharat Bill Payment System (BBPS)**, now known as **Bharat Connect**, to operate as a **Customer Operating Unit (COU)**.

The **COU certification** enables **VIYONA Fintech** to provide **interoperable digital bill payment services** across India through the **Bharat Connect platform**.

Detailed Explanation:

VIYONA Fintech, a **Hyderabad, Telangana-based fintech infrastructure startup**, received approval from the **Bharat Bill Payment System (BBPS)**, now known as **Bharat Connect**, to operate as a **Customer Operating Unit (COU)**.

The **COU certification** enables **VIYONA Fintech** to provide **interoperable digital bill payment services** across India through the **Bharat Connect platform**.

Under the approval, **VIYONA** can offer **Bharat Connect-powered bill payment services** for **electricity, water, gas, broadband, mobile recharges, Direct-to-**

Home (DTH) subscriptions, insurance premiums, loan EMIs, educational fees, and other approved bill payments.

The approval also enables **Non-Banking Financial Companies (NBFCs), banks, fintech companies, enterprises, and government organisations** to integrate **Bharat Connect services** through **VIYONA's digital platform**.

533. As per the news, which authority granted the final approval to Vizhinjam International Seaport Limited (VISL) to commence Export-Import (EXIM) cargo operations from 18 August 2026?

A.Central Board of Indirect Taxes and Customs (CBIC)

B.Directorate General of Foreign Trade (DGFT)

C.Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways (MoPSW)

D.Inland Waterways Authority of India (IWAI)

E.Shipping Corporation of India (SCI)

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

Vizhinjam International Seaport Limited (VISL), Thiruvananthapuram, Kerala, received final approval from the **Central Board of Indirect Taxes and Customs (CBIC)** to commence **Export-Import (EXIM) cargo operations** from **18 August 2026**.

The **CBIC** notified **VISL** as a **Customs Port** under the **Customs Act, 1962**, enabling the port to handle **direct EXIM cargo operations**.

The customs approval will reduce India's dependence on **foreign transshipment hubs**, improve **international trade efficiency**, and strengthen the country's **maritime logistics ecosystem**.

Detailed Explanation:

Vizhinjam International Seaport Limited (VISL), Thiruvananthapuram, Kerala, received final approval from the **Central Board of Indirect Taxes and Customs (CBIC)** to commence **Export-Import (EXIM) cargo operations** from **18 August 2026**.

The **CBIC** notified **VISL** as a **Customs Port** under the **Customs Act, 1962**, enabling the port to handle **direct EXIM cargo operations**.

The customs approval will reduce India's dependence on **foreign transshipment hubs**, improve **international trade efficiency**, and strengthen the country's **maritime logistics ecosystem**.

The **CBIC** will coordinate **EXIM cargo regulation** in collaboration with **Vizhinjam International Seaport Limited (VISL)**, **Adani Vizhinjam Port Private Limited (AVPPL)**, and other concerned agencies.

Vizhinjam International Seaport has been developed under the **Public-Private Partnership (PPP) model** by the **Government of Kerala** in collaboration with **Adani Ports and Special Economic Zone (APSEZ)**.

534. As per the news, which bank is set to become the first Indian bank to issue Basel

III-compliant Additional Tier-I (AT-1) Perpetual Bonds in 2026?

A.Punjab National Bank (PNB)

B.Bank of Baroda (BoB)

C.Canara Bank

D.State Bank of India (SBI)

E.Union Bank of India

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

State Bank of India (SBI) is set to become the first Indian bank to issue **Basel III-compliant Additional Tier-I (AT-1) Perpetual Bonds** in **2026**.

SBI plans to raise **₹5,000 crore** through the issuance of **AT-1 Perpetual Bonds**, with the issue expected within the next two weeks.

The proposed AT-1 Perpetual Bonds will carry a **five-year call option**, allowing SBI to redeem the bonds after five years, subject to **regulatory approval**.

The bond issue is part of SBI's broader plan to raise up to **₹60,000 crore** during the financial year through **Infrastructure Bonds, Basel III-compliant AT-1 Bonds, and Tier-II Bonds**.

Detailed Explanation:

State Bank of India (SBI) is set to become the first Indian bank to issue **Basel III-compliant Additional Tier-I (AT-1) Perpetual Bonds** in **2026**.

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Basel III-compliant AT-1 Perpetual Bonds are capital instruments that help banks **strengthen their capital base, improve the Capital Adequacy Ratio (CAR), and comply with Basel III regulatory norms**.

Perpetual Bonds have **no fixed maturity date**, but they may include a **call option**, enabling the issuer to redeem them after a specified period.

Canara Bank was the last Indian bank to issue AT-1 Perpetual Bonds, raising **₹3,500 crore in November 2025** at a **7.55% coupon rate**.

535. As per the news, which state government launched the e-Zero FIR System to enable victims of cyber financial fraud to lodge complaints without visiting a police station?

A.Maharashtra

B.Karnataka

C.Telangana

D.Gujarat

E.Tamil Nadu

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The **Government of Gujarat** launched the **e-Zero First Information Report (e-Zero FIR) System** to enable victims of **cyber financial fraud** to lodge complaints **without visiting a police station**.

The system was launched by **Harsh Sanghavi**, **Minister of State for Home, Industries, Transport, Youth and Sports, Government of Gujarat**, in **Gandhinagar, Gujarat**.

The initiative aims to **speed up cybercrime investigations**, **improve the chances of recovering defrauded money**, and make the **cybercrime reporting process faster and more citizen-friendly**.

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The **Government of Gujarat** launched the **e-Zero First Information Report (e-Zero FIR) System** to enable victims of **cyber financial fraud** to lodge complaints **without visiting a police station**.

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The initiative aims to **speed up cybercrime investigations**, **improve the chances of recovering defrauded money**, and make the **cybercrime reporting process faster and more citizen-friendly**.

The **e-Zero FIR System** has been developed in collaboration with the **Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre (I4C)** under the **Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA)**.

Under the new system, **cyber financial fraud complaints registered through the 1930 National Cyber Crime Helpline** are **automatically converted into e-Zero FIRs**.

The **e-Zero FIR** is **electronically transmitted** to the concerned police station, where the investigating officer contacts the complainant to verify details and complete the required legal formalities.

536. As per the news, the 2nd BRICS Science Academies Forum Meeting 2026 focused on which of the following 3C approaches for Artificial Intelligence (AI)?

A.Connectivity, Commerce and Cooperation

B.Collective, Collaborative and Context-sensitive

C.Creativity, Competitiveness and Capacity-building

D.Communication, Coordination and Compliance

E.Cooperation, Convergence and Competence

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The **2nd BRICS (Brazil, Russia, India, China and South Africa) Science Academies Forum Meeting 2026** was held at the **Indian Institute of Technology Hyderabad (IIT Hyderabad), Telangana**.

The theme of the forum was **"Harnessing Artificial Intelligence for Sustainable Development and Strengthening Global South Cooperation"**.

The meeting brought together representatives from **BRICS member countries and partner countries** to discuss the role of **Artificial**

Intelligence (AI) in sustainable development and global cooperation.

The forum focused on the **3C approach of Artificial Intelligence (AI)**:

Collective approach

Collaborative approach

Context-sensitive approach

Detailed Explanation:

The **2nd BRICS (Brazil, Russia, India, China and South Africa) Science Academies Forum Meeting 2026** was held at the **Indian Institute of Technology Hyderabad (IIT Hyderabad), Telangana**.

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The forum focused on the **3C approach of Artificial Intelligence (AI)**:

Collective approach

Collaborative approach

Context-sensitive approach

The event was hosted by the **Indian National Science Academy (INSA)** as India holds the **BRICS Presidency 2026** under the theme **"Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability"**.

The forum identified **five priority areas** for **Artificial Intelligence-driven interventions**:

Advanced Materials and Manufacturing

Healthcare

Climate Change and Environmental Sustainability

Agriculture and Food Security

Disaster Prediction and Management

537. As per the news, President Droupadi Murmu's visit to which country marked the first-ever visit by an Indian President?

A.Moldova

B.Romania

C.North Macedonia

D.Serbia

E.Bulgaria

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

President Droupadi Murmu undertook a week-long **State Visit** to **Moldova, North Macedonia, and Romania** from **19–25 July 2026** to strengthen **bilateral cooperation** in **trade, technology, tourism, education, innovation, and strategic partnerships**.

President Droupadi Murmu visited North Macedonia from **21–22 July 2026**, marking the **first-ever visit by an Indian President** to the country.

She held bilateral talks with President **Gordana Siljanovska-Davkova** and met Prime Minister **Hristijan Mickoski** to discuss expanding bilateral cooperation.

She addressed the **Assembly of North Macedonia** and the **India–North Macedonia Business Forum** in Skopje, highlighting opportunities for **economic and business collaboration**.

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Moldova

President Droupadi Murmu received a **ceremonial welcome** and **Guard of Honour** at the **Presidential Palace** and held bilateral talks with **Maia Sandu**, President of the Republic of Moldova.

India and Moldova agreed to enhance cooperation in **agriculture, logistics, infrastructure, healthcare, pharmaceuticals, Renewable Energy (RE), Digital Public Infrastructure (DPI), Artificial Intelligence (AI), and innovation**.

India unveiled the **3Ts Roadmap (Trade, Technology, and Talent)** to strengthen long-term bilateral relations with Moldova.

North Macedonia

President Droupadi Murmu visited North Macedonia from **21–22 July 2026**, marking the **first-ever visit by an Indian President** to the country.

She held bilateral talks with President **Gordana Siljanovska-Davkova** and met Prime Minister **Hristijan Mickoski** to discuss expanding bilateral cooperation.

She addressed the **Assembly of North Macedonia** and the **India–North Macedonia Business Forum** in Skopje, highlighting opportunities for **economic and business collaboration**.

President Droupadi Murmu and North Macedonian leaders jointly unveiled a **bust of Mahatma Gandhi** at the **Museum of the City of Skopje**, symbolizing the strong **cultural ties** between the two nations.

Romania

President Droupadi Murmu visited Romania from **23–25 July 2026** at the invitation of President **Nicușor Dan**, marking the **first State Visit by an Indian President to Romania in nearly 30 years**.

She was conferred the prestigious **Doctor Honoris Causa** by the **Bucharest University of Economic Studies (BUES)**.

India and Romania signed **three Memoranda of Understanding (MoUs)** in the fields of **Science & Technology, Education, and Sports**.

Both countries jointly declared **2028** as the **"India–Romania Year of Innovation"** to commemorate **80 years of diplomatic relations** between India and Romania.

538. As per the news, the Ancient Buddhist Site of Sarnath became India's which UNESCO World Heritage Site after its inscription during the 48th Session of the World Heritage Committee?

A.42nd

B.43rd

C.44th

D.45th

E.46th

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The Ancient Buddhist Site of **Sarnath in Uttar Pradesh (UP)** was inscribed on the **United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization** (**UNESCO) World Heritage List** during the **48th Session of the World Heritage Committee (WHC)** held in **Busan, South Korea**.

With this inscription, Sarnath became **India's 45th UNESCO World Heritage Site (WHS)** and the **4th UNESCO World Heritage Site in Uttar Pradesh**, after the **Taj Mahal, Agra Fort, and Fatehpur Sikri**.

Detailed Explanation:

The Ancient Buddhist Site of **Sarnath in Uttar Pradesh (UP)** was inscribed on the **United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization** (**UNESCO) World Heritage List** during the **48th Session of the World Heritage Committee (WHC)** held in **Busan, South Korea**.

With this inscription, Sarnath became **India's 45th UNESCO World Heritage Site (WHS)** and the **4th UNESCO World Heritage Site in Uttar Pradesh**, after the **Taj Mahal, Agra Fort, and Fatehpur Sikri**.

Sarnath was included in UNESCO's **Tentative List in 1998**, and India submitted its nomination dossier in **January 2025** for the **2025–26 World Heritage cycle**.

The inscription recognizes the **Outstanding Universal Value (OUV)** of Sarnath as one of the world's holiest **Buddhist pilgrimage centres**, where Gautama Buddha (Lord Buddha) delivered his first sermon (**Dhammacakkappavattana Sutta/Dharmachakra Pravartana**) after attaining enlightenment.

Sarnath marks the beginning of the spread of **Buddhist teachings** and remains one of the most important **Buddhist pilgrimage sites** in the world.

539. As per the news, the EU–India Textile and Apparel Dialogue (TAD) was jointly launched by the Confederation of Indian Textile Industry (CITI) and which organisation?

A.European Commission (EC)

B.European Free Trade Association (EFTA)

C.European Apparel and Textile Confederation (EURATEX)

D.European Investment Bank (EIB)

E.European Trade Union Confederation (ETUC)

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The **Confederation of Indian Textile Industry (CITI)** and the **European Apparel and Textile Confederation (EURATEX)** jointly launched the **EU–India Textile and Apparel Dialogue (TAD)** to strengthen bilateral cooperation and

support the effective implementation of the **India–EU Free Trade Agreement (FTA)**.

The **mandate for the EU–India Textile and Apparel Dialogue (TAD)** was signed on **14 July 2026** during **Bharat Tex 2026** in **New Delhi** by **Ashwin Chandran**, **Chairman of CITI**, and **Mario Jorge Machado**, **President of EURATEX**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Confederation of Indian Textile Industry (CITI)** and the **European Apparel and Textile Confederation (EURATEX)** jointly launched the **EU–India Textile and Apparel Dialogue (TAD)** to strengthen bilateral cooperation and support the effective implementation of the **India–EU Free Trade Agreement (FTA)**.

The **mandate for the EU–India Textile and Apparel Dialogue (TAD)** was signed on **14 July 2026** during **Bharat Tex 2026** in **New Delhi** by **Ashwin Chandran**, **Chairman of CITI**, and **Mario Jorge Machado**, **President of EURATEX**.

The **EU–India Textile and Apparel Dialogue (TAD)** provides a **structured bilateral industry platform** for continuous dialogue between **Indian and European textile and apparel industries**.

The platform aims to promote **reciprocal market access**, **resilient value chains**, **industrial competitiveness**, and **sustainable growth** in the textile and apparel sector.

The **TAD Monitoring Committee** will monitor the implementation of the **India–EU FTA**, address issues related to **customs procedures**, **regulatory barriers**, **rules of origin**, **trade flows**, **investment**, and **market access**, and recommend practical solutions to facilitate trade.

540. As per the news, who assumed additional charge as the 10th Union Minister of Education of India following the resignation of Dharmendra Pradhan?

A.Ashwini Vaishnaw

B.Vineet Joshi

C.Pralhad Venkatesh Joshi

D.Shivraj Singh Chouhan

E.Hardeep Singh Puri

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

Union Minister Pralhad Venkatesh Joshi, currently heading the **Ministry of Consumer Affairs, Food & Public Distribution (MoCAF&PD)** and the **Ministry of New and Renewable Energy (MNRE)**, was assigned additional charge as the **10th Union Minister of Education**.

Pralhad Venkatesh Joshi assumed the additional responsibility following the resignation of **Dharmendra Pradhan** at **Kartavya Bhavan, New Delhi, Delhi**.

President Droupadi Murmu, acting on the advice of **Prime Minister Narendra Modi**, accepted the resignation of **Dharmendra Pradhan** with immediate effect under **Clause (2) of Article 75 of the Constitution of India**.

Detailed Explanation:

Union Minister Pralhad Venkatesh Joshi, currently heading the **Ministry of Consumer Affairs, Food & Public Distribution (MoCAF&PD)** and the **Ministry of New and Renewable Energy (MNRE)**, was assigned additional charge as the **10th Union Minister of Education**.

Pralhad Venkatesh Joshi assumed the additional responsibility following the resignation of **Dharmendra Pradhan** at **Kartavya Bhavan, New Delhi, Delhi**.

President Droupadi Murmu, acting on the advice of **Prime Minister Narendra Modi**, accepted the resignation of **Dharmendra Pradhan** with immediate effect under **Clause (2) of Article 75 of the Constitution of India**.

Dharmendra Pradhan resigned by taking moral responsibility for the **NEET-UG 2026 paper leak controversy** and the **nationwide student protests** that followed.

With this appointment, **Pralhad Venkatesh Joshi** became the **10th Union Minister of Education** of India while continuing to hold his existing **ministerial portfolios**.

In the **Ministry of Education (MoE)**, **Naresh Pal Gangwar**, a 1994-batch **IAS officer**, assumed charge as **Secretary, Department of Higher Education**, replacing **Vineet Joshi**.

541. As per the news, who assumed charge as the Acting President of Bangladesh following the resignation of President Mohammed Shahabuddin?

A.Muhammad Yunus

B.Hafiz Uddin Ahmad

C.Sheikh Hasina

D.Obaidul Quader

E.Asaduzzaman Khan

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Bangladesh President Mohammed Shahabuddin resigned from office nearly **two years before completing his five-year term**, citing serious health problems, including **autonomic neuropathy**, which occasionally causes loss of consciousness.

Mohammed Shahabuddin, a former judge and veteran of **Bangladesh's 1971 Liberation War**, assumed office as the **22nd President of Bangladesh in April 2023**.

Parliament Speaker Hafiz Uddin Ahmad accepted the resignation and, under **Article 54 of the Constitution of Bangladesh**, assumed charge as the **Acting President**.

Detailed Explanation:

Bangladesh President Mohammed Shahabuddin resigned from office nearly **two years before completing his five-year term**, citing serious health problems, including **autonomic neuropathy**, which occasionally causes loss of consciousness.

Mohammed Shahabuddin, a former judge and veteran of **Bangladesh's 1971 Liberation War**, assumed office as the **22nd President of Bangladesh in April 2023**.

Parliament Speaker Hafiz Uddin Ahmad accepted the resignation and,

under **Article 54 of the Constitution of Bangladesh**, assumed charge as the **Acting President**.

Under **Article 54 of the Constitution of Bangladesh**, the **Acting President** will discharge presidential duties until a **new President is elected by Parliament**.

Under Bangladesh's **parliamentary system**, the President serves as the constitutional **Head of State** and **Supreme Commander of the Armed Forces**, while executive powers are exercised by the **Prime Minister and the Council of Ministers**.

542. As per the news, during its 13th integrated test flight, SpaceX's Starship successfully deployed how many next-generation Starlink Version 3 (V3) satellites into orbit?

A.10

B.12

C.16

D.20

E.24

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

SpaceX successfully completed the **13th integrated test flight** of its **Starship launch system** from **Starbase, Texas, United States of America (USA)**.

During the mission, **Starship** successfully deployed **20 next-generation Starlink Version 3 (V3) satellites** into orbit, marking the **first-ever deployment of Starlink V3 satellites**.

The mission marked the **second test flight of Starship Version 3 (V3)** and represented another major milestone in **SpaceX's reusable launch vehicle programme**.

Detailed Explanation:

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The mission marked the **second test flight of Starship Version 3 (V3)** and represented another major milestone in **SpaceX's reusable launch vehicle programme**.

The **124-metre (m) Starship rocket** successfully launched from **Starbase, Texas**, demonstrating the performance of its upgraded launch and flight systems.

The **Starlink V3 satellites** are equipped with **advanced communication capabilities** and **laser-link technology** to enhance global satellite-based internet connectivity.

After completing satellite deployment, the **Starship upper stage** successfully performed **atmospheric re-entry** followed by a **controlled soft splashdown in the Indian Ocean**.

543. As per the news, in which district of Bihar will the permanent National Skill

Training Institute for Women (NSTI-W) Patna campus be developed?

A.Gaya

B.Muzaffarpur

C.Bhagalpur

D.Darbhanga

E.Bihta

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

The **Government of Bihar** and the **Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship (MSDE)** announced the establishment of the **permanent National Skill Training Institute for Women (NSTI-W), Patna campus** and the **Skill India International Centre (SIIC), Bihar** to strengthen **women's skilling** and **global employment opportunities**.

The **permanent NSTI-W Patna campus** will be developed at **Bihta, Bihar** with an investment of **₹99.97 crore** to provide **modern infrastructure** and **industry-aligned skill training** for women.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Government of Bihar** and the **Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship (MSDE)** announced the establishment of the **permanent National Skill Training Institute for Women (NSTI-W), Patna campus** and the **Skill India International Centre (SIIC), Bihar** to strengthen **women's skilling** and **global employment opportunities**.

The initiative was announced by **Samrat Choudhary**, **Chief Minister (CM) of Bihar**, and **Jayant Chaudhary**, **Minister of State (Independent Charge), MSDE** and **Minister of State for Education**, Government of India.

The **foundation stone** for the projects was laid by **Dilip Kumar**, **Director General (DG), Directorate General of Training (DGT)**.

The **permanent NSTI-W Patna campus** will be developed at **Bihta, Bihar** with an investment of **₹99.97 crore** to provide **modern infrastructure** and **industry-aligned skill training** for women.

The **Skill India International Centre (SIIC), Bihar** will be established with an investment of **₹7 crore** to promote **global employment** through **language training, international certification, and safe migration assistance**.

544. As per the news, under which section of the Information Technology (IT) Act, 2000 was the Digital Forensics Laboratory at NFSU Goa notified as an Examiner of Electronic Evidence?

A.Section 43A

B.Section 66

C.Section 69A

D.Section 79A

E.Section 85

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The **Digital Forensics Laboratory at the National Forensic Sciences University**

(NFSU), Goa Campus has been notified as an **Examiner of Electronic Evidence under Section 79A of the Information Technology (IT) Act, 2000** by the **Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY)**.

The recognition authorizes the **NFSU Goa Digital Forensics Laboratory** to examine and certify electronic evidence in **Computer (Media) Forensics** and **Mobile Device Forensics**, ensuring the legal admissibility of digital evidence in courts.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Digital Forensics Laboratory at the National Forensic Sciences University (NFSU), Goa Campus** has been notified as an **Examiner of Electronic Evidence under Section 79A of the Information Technology (IT) Act, 2000** by the **Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY)**.

The recognition authorizes the **NFSU Goa Digital Forensics Laboratory** to examine and certify electronic evidence in **Computer (Media) Forensics** and **Mobile Device Forensics**, ensuring the legal admissibility of digital evidence in courts.

NFSU Goa has become the **second laboratory under NFSU** and one of only **21 notified forensic laboratories in India** to receive this recognition.

NFSU Goa is also the **fourth notified forensic laboratory in Western India** authorized as an **Examiner of Electronic Evidence**.

The notification under **Section 79A of the IT Act, 2000** strengthens the credibility of digital forensic investigations and supports the **judicial system through authenticated electronic evidence**.

545. As per the news, Sharmila Dhankar won India's first-ever Commonwealth Games Para Athletics Gold Medal in which event?

A.Women's F56 Discus Throw

B.Women's F42 Shot Put

C.Women's T12 100m

D.Women's F55 Javelin Throw

E.Women's F57 Shot Put

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

Sharmila Dhankar won the **Gold Medal** and **Shilpa Shyla** secured the **Bronze Medal** in the **Women's F57 Shot Put** event at the **Commonwealth Games 2026**.

The achievement marked a **historic milestone for India's Para Athletics**, as it became **India's first-ever Gold Medal in Para Athletics at the Commonwealth Games**.

India also created history by winning **two medals in the same Para Athletics event for the first time** at the **Commonwealth Games**.

Sharmila Dhankar produced her season-best performance with a throw of **9.81 metres** to clinch the **Gold Medal**.

Detailed Explanation:

Sharmila Dhankar won the **Gold Medal** and **Shilpa Shyla** secured the **Bronze Medal** in the **Women's F57 Shot Put** event at the **Commonwealth Games 2026**.

The achievement marked a **historic milestone for India's Para Athletics**, as it became **India's first-ever Gold Medal in Para Athletics at the Commonwealth Games**.

India also created history by winning **two medals in the same Para Athletics event for the first time** at the **Commonwealth Games**.

Sharmila Dhankar produced her season-best performance with a throw of **9.81 metres** to clinch the **Gold Medal**.

Her victory ended India's **20-year wait for a Para Athletics medal** at the **Commonwealth Games**.

Sharmila Dhankar became the first Indian athlete to win a medal in Para Athletics at the Commonwealth Games.

Shilpa Shyla won the **Bronze Medal** with a personal best throw of **7.26 metres** in the **Women's F57 Shot Put** event.

546. As per the news, Sarvesh Anil Kushare won the Silver Medal in which event at the Commonwealth Games 2026?

A.Men's Long Jump

B.Men's Triple Jump

C.Men's High Jump

D.Men's Pole Vault

E.Men's Decathlon

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

Sarvesh Anil Kushare won the **Silver Medal** in the **Men's High Jump** event at the **Commonwealth Games 2026** held in **Glasgow, Scotland**.

The **Indian national record holder** cleared a **best height of 2.25 metres**, securing his **first-ever medal at a major multi-sport event**.

Romaine Beckford (Jamaica) won the **Gold Medal**, while **Jack Kimani (Scotland)** secured the **Bronze Medal** with a best jump of **2.20 metres**.

Detailed Explanation:

Sarvesh Anil Kushare won the **Silver Medal** in the **Men's High Jump** event at the **Commonwealth Games 2026** held in **Glasgow, Scotland**.

The **Indian national record holder** cleared a **best height of 2.25 metres**, securing his **first-ever medal at a major multi-sport event**.

Romaine Beckford (Jamaica) won the **Gold Medal**, while **Jack Kimani (Scotland)** secured the **Bronze Medal** with a best jump of **2.20 metres**.

Both **Sarvesh Kushare** and **Romaine Beckford** cleared **2.25 metres** and failed to clear **2.28 metres**. However, **Romaine Beckford** was awarded the **Gold Medal** based on the **countback rule**, having cleared **2.25 metres** with fewer failed attempts.

Sarvesh successfully cleared **2.25 metres** on his **third and final attempt**, displaying remarkable composure under pressure.

547. As per the news, Ajaya Babu set a Commonwealth Record in which discipline during the Men's 79 kg Weightlifting event at the Commonwealth Games 2026?

A.Snatch

B.Clean and Jerk

C.Total Lift

D.Combined Weight

E.Power Lift

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

Ajaya Babu won the **Silver Medal** in the **Men's 79 Kilogram Weightlifting** event at the **Commonwealth Games 2026** held in **Glasgow, Scotland**.

Representing **India**, the weightlifter from **Vizianagaram district, Andhra Pradesh**, lifted a **combined total of 330 kilograms**, missing the **Gold Medal** by just **1 kilogram**.

Ajaya Babu successfully lifted **149 kilograms in the Snatch** and **181 kilograms in the Clean and Jerk**, finishing with a total lift of **330 kilograms**.

Detailed Explanation:

Ajaya Babu won the **Silver Medal** in the **Men's 79 Kilogram Weightlifting** event at the **Commonwealth Games 2026** held in **Glasgow, Scotland**.

Representing **India**, the weightlifter from **Vizianagaram district, Andhra Pradesh**, lifted a **combined total of 330 kilograms**, missing the **Gold Medal** by just **1 kilogram**.

Ajaya Babu successfully lifted **149 kilograms in the Snatch** and **181 kilograms in the Clean and Jerk**, finishing with a total lift of **330 kilograms**.

Erry Hidayat Muhammad (Malaysia) won the **Gold Medal** with a **Games Record** total lift of **331 kilograms** (**147 kilograms Snatch + 184 kilograms Clean and Jerk**).

Chris Murray (England) secured the **Bronze Medal** with a total lift of **325 kilograms**.

During the competition, **Ajaya Babu** set a **Commonwealth Record** in the **Snatch** by lifting **149 kilograms** on his third attempt.

548. As per the news, by winning the Gold Medal in the Women's 25 Metre Pistol event at the ISSF World Cup 2026, Esha Singh secured direct qualification for which competition?

A.Asian Games 2026

B.ISSF World Championships 2026

C.ISSF World Cup Final 2026

D.Olympic Games 2028

E.Commonwealth Games 2026

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

Esha Singh won the **Gold Medal** in the **Women's 25 Metre Pistol** event at the **International Shooting Sport Federation (ISSF) World Cup 2026** held in **Hangzhou, China**.

Manu Bhaker won the **Bronze Medal** in the same event, giving **India two medals** in the competition.

In the final, **Esha Singh** scored **40 hits** to defeat **Zhang Yueyue (China)**, who secured the **Silver Medal** with **37 hits**.

Detailed Explanation:

Esha Singh won the **Gold Medal** in the **Women's 25 Metre Pistol** event at

the **International Shooting Sport Federation (ISSF) World Cup 2026** held in **Hangzhou, China**.

Manu Bhaker won the **Bronze Medal** in the same event, giving **India two medals** in the competition.

In the final, **Esha Singh** scored **40 hits** to defeat **Zhang Yueyue (China)**, who secured the **Silver Medal** with **37 hits**.

Esha had earlier finished **second in the qualification round**, before delivering a dominant performance in the final to clinch the title.

Manu Bhaker secured the **Bronze Medal** after winning a **shoot-off** with **28 hits**, adding another international medal to her career.

By winning the **Gold Medal**, **Esha Singh** earned **direct qualification** for the **International Shooting Sport Federation World Cup Final 2026**, scheduled to be held in **Rome, Italy**, in **December 2026**.

549. As per the news, what is India's global rank in terms of the highest number of UNESCO World Heritage Sites after the inscription of Sarnath?

A.4th

B.5th

C.6th

D.7th

E.8th

Answer: C

The UNESCO recognition enhances Sarnath's global importance as a centre of **Buddhist heritage, culture, archaeology, spirituality, and religious tourism**.

With this inscription, India now ranks **6th globally and 2nd in the Asia-Pacific region** in terms of the highest number of UNESCO World Heritage Sites, with **45 World Heritage Sites** and **69 properties on the UNESCO Tentative List**.

India's 45 UNESCO World Heritage Sites comprise **37 Cultural Sites, 7 Natural Sites, and 1 Mixed Site (Khangchendzonga National Park)**.

550. As per the news, what is the currency of Moldova?

A.Euro

B.Romanian Leu

C.Moldovan Leu

D.Moldovan Ruble

E.Hryvnia

Answer: C

About Moldova :

President : Maia Sandu

Prime Minister : Vasile Tofan

Capital : Chișinău

Currency : Moldovan leu

551. As per the news, which of the following statements about the proposed polymer banknotes is incorrect?

A.The field trials will be conducted for ₹10 and ₹20 polymer banknotes.

B.Polymer banknotes are printed on a polymer (plastic) substrate instead of paper.

C.The Government has decided to completely replace all paper currency with polymer banknotes

D.The RBI will conduct field trials under different climatic and usage conditions

E.India first proposed polymer banknotes in 2012

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The **Government of India (GoI)** has approved the **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** proposal to conduct field trials of **1 billion (100 crore)** polymer banknotes each in the **₹10 and ₹20 denominations**, marking a major step towards introducing more durable and secure currency notes in India.

The proposal was submitted by the **RBI**, with the recommendation of its **Central Board**, under **Section 25 of the Reserve Bank of India Act, 1934**, seeking approval for **field trials** and the **regular issuance** of ₹10 and ₹20 polymer banknotes after successful completion of the trials.

The proposed field trial covers **₹3,000 crore worth of polymer banknotes** (₹10 and ₹20 denominations) to evaluate their performance under real-world conditions.

The **Government has clarified** that there is **no proposal to completely replace paper currency**, and polymer banknotes will **circulate alongside existing paper banknotes** as an additional option.

India first proposed polymer banknotes in 2012, but the initiative was **deferred due to technological challenges**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Government of India (GoI)** has approved the **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** proposal to conduct field trials of **1 billion (100 crore)** polymer banknotes each in the **₹10 and ₹20 denominations**, marking a major step towards introducing more durable and secure currency notes in India.

The proposal was submitted by the **RBI**, with the recommendation of its **Central Board**, under **Section 25 of the Reserve Bank of India Act, 1934**, seeking approval for **field trials** and the **regular issuance** of ₹10 and ₹20 polymer banknotes after successful completion of the trials.

The proposed field trial covers **₹3,000 crore worth of polymer banknotes** (₹10 and ₹20 denominations) to evaluate their performance under real-world conditions.

The **RBI** has been authorised to conduct field trials under **different climatic and usage conditions** to assess the **durability, security features, lifespan, and public acceptance** of polymer banknotes.

Regular issuance of ₹10 and ₹20 polymer banknotes will commence only after the **successful completion and evaluation of the field trials**.

Polymer banknotes are printed on a **non-fibrous, non-porous polymer (plastic) substrate** instead of conventional paper

substrate, making them **longer-lasting**, more **resistant to wear and tear, dirt, moisture, and contamination**, and **more secure against counterfeiting**.

The **Government has clarified** that there is **no proposal to completely replace paper currency**, and polymer banknotes will **circulate alongside existing paper banknotes** as an additional option.

India first proposed polymer banknotes in 2012, but the initiative was **deferred due to technological challenges**.

552. As per the news, the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) has proposed that all Securitisation Notes (SNs) must be issued, held, and transferred in which form?

A.Physical certificate form

B.Bearer form

C.Paper-based form

D.Digital Rupee (CBDC) form

E.Dematerialised (demat) form

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** has released draft amendments proposing that all **Securitisation Notes (SNs)** must be issued, held, and transferred only in **dematerialised (demat) form** to enhance **transparency, efficiency, liquidity, and investor protection** in the securitisation market.

Securitisation Notes (SNs) are financial instruments created by **pooling assets** such as home loans, vehicle loans, and other retail loans, which are then sold to investors, enabling **banks and Non-Banking Financial Companies (NBFCs)** to raise fresh funds for further lending.

The RBI has proposed to retain the **minimum investment size of ₹1 crore**, which will apply both at the time of **issuance** and for **every subsequent transfer** of Securitisation Notes.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** has released draft amendments proposing that all **Securitisation Notes (SNs)** must be issued, held, and transferred only in **dematerialised (demat) form** to enhance **transparency, efficiency, liquidity, and investor protection** in the securitisation market.

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The RBI has proposed to retain the **minimum investment size of ₹1 crore**, which will apply both at the time of **issuance** and for **every subsequent transfer** of Securitisation Notes.

The draft framework requires agreements between **lenders and Special Purpose Entities (SPEs)** to ensure **continuous compliance** with the ₹1 crore minimum investment requirement throughout the life cycle of the securities.

According to the proposal, an issue of Securitisation Notes (SNs) will be treated as a **public issue** if it is offered to the number of investors specified under the **Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) regulations**.

The proposed amendments aim to **strengthen the regulatory framework** for securitisation, improve market transparency, facilitate efficient trading, and enhance the overall functioning of **India's debt and securitisation market**.

The RBI has invited **public comments and stakeholder feedback** on the draft proposals until **27 August 2026**.

553. As per the news, following the cancellation of Paytm Payments Bank's licence, how many active Payments Banks remain in India?

A.4

B.5

C.6

D.7

E.8

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** cancelled the banking licence of **Paytm Payments Bank Limited (PPBL)** with effect from **24 April 2026** under **Section 22(4) of the Banking Regulation Act, 1949**.

Following the licence cancellation, the RBI approached the **Delhi High Court** seeking the winding up of Paytm Payments Bank Limited (PPBL) and the appointment of an **Official Liquidator**.

On **8 July 2026** (read with the **22 July 2026 order**), the Delhi High Court ordered the **winding up of PPBL** under the **Banking Regulation Act, 1949** and the **Companies Act, 2013**.

The **five active Payments Banks in India** are **Airtel Payments Bank, India Post Payments Bank (IPPB), Fino Payments Bank, Jio Payments Bank, and NSDL Payments Bank**.

Detailed Explanation:

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On **8 July 2026** (read with the **22 July 2026 order**), the Delhi High Court ordered the **winding up of PPBL** under the **Banking Regulation Act, 1949** and the **Companies Act, 2013**.

The Delhi High Court appointed **Shri Girikumar M. Nair**, former Chief General Manager (CGM) of the **State Bank of India (SBI)**, as the **Official Liquidator** to supervise the bank's liquidation process.

The Official Liquidator is responsible for **managing the liquidation proceedings**, protecting the interests of **depositors,**

creditors, and other stakeholders, and ensuring an **orderly closure** of the bank.

The winding-up order marks the **formal closure of Paytm Payments Bank's banking operations** in accordance with the applicable banking and company laws.

After the cancellation of Paytm Payments Bank's licence, the number of active **Payments Banks in India has reduced to five**.

The **five active Payments Banks in India** are **Airtel Payments Bank, India Post Payments Bank (IPPB), Fino Payments Bank, Jio Payments Bank, and NSDL Payments Bank**.

554. As per the news, which Free Trade Agreement (FTA) partner emerged as India's largest merchandise export destination in FY 2025–26?

A.United Arab Emirates (UAE)

B.United Kingdom (UK)

C.Singapore

D.ASEAN

E.SAFTA

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

India's total exports reached a record **US$863.1 billion in FY 2025–26**,

comprising **Merchandise Exports of US$441.8 billion** and **Services Exports of US$421.3 billion**, reflecting strong growth in India's external trade.

The Government of India stated that **Free Trade Agreements (FTAs)** with the United Arab Emirates (**UAE), United Kingdom (UK), Australia, Oman, New Zealand, Mauritius, and EFTA member countries** have expanded market access, diversified export destinations, and boosted export growth.

Among FTA partners, **ASEAN** emerged as India's largest merchandise export destination with exports worth **US$38.42 billion**, followed by the **United Arab Emirates (UAE) at US$37.36 billion**, **SAFTA countries at US$25.77 billion**, the **United Kingdom (UK)**, and **Singapore**.

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Among FTA partners, **ASEAN** emerged as India's largest merchandise export destination with exports worth **US$38.42 billion**, followed by the **United Arab Emirates (UAE) at US$37.36 billion**, **SAFTA countries at US$25.77 billion**, the **United Kingdom (UK)**, and **Singapore**.

The **India–UK Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement (CETA)** came into force

on **15 July 2026**, with merchandise exports worth **US$13.44 billion** during FY26.

Under the **India–UAE Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement (CEPA)**, operational since May 2022, more than **4.45 lakh Certificates of Origin** have been issued, while the number of tariff lines exported increased from 7,546 in FY22 to **8,053 in FY26**, with exports reaching **US$37.3 billion**.

555. As per the news, what is the name of the in-house Business Rules Engine (BRE) launched by Axis Finance Limited (AFL)?

A.Axis Finance Drishti

B.Axis Finance Vision

C.Axis Credit Connect

D.Axis SmartLend

E.Axis RiskPro

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

Axis Finance Limited (AFL) launched **'Axis Finance Drishti'**, an in-house **Business Rules Engine (BRE)** and configurable digital platform to strengthen **credit decision-making, risk management, and lending efficiency** across **Retail and Micro, Small and Medium Enterprise (MSME) lending**.

The platform aims to enable **faster, data-driven, scalable, and consistent credit assessments**, while **enhancing customer experience** and improving the overall **loan approval process**.

Detailed Explanation:

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The platform aims to enable **faster, data-driven, scalable, and consistent credit assessments**, while **enhancing customer experience** and improving the overall **loan approval process**.

Axis Finance Drishti is an internally developed BRE that **automates and standardises credit underwriting** by leveraging **advanced analytics, underwriting workflows, statistical scorecards, and multiple data sources**.

In **Phase-I**, the platform has been deployed for **Personal Loans, Business Loans, Loan Against Property (LAP), and Disha Home Loans**, enabling quicker and policy-based credit decisions.

556. As per the news, which company launched India's first Flexi Benefits Basket on the Unified Payments Interface (UPI)?

A.Razorpay

B.BharatPe

C.Paytm

D.PhonePe

E.OmniCard Platform

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

OmniCard Platform, developed by **Eroute Technologies Private Limited**, launched India's first **Flexi Benefits Basket** on the **Unified Payments Interface (UPI)**, providing a single employee-controlled digital wallet for **tax-efficient employee benefits**.

The **Flexi Benefits Basket** is built on OmniCard's **RBI-licensed Prepaid Payment Instrument (PPI) platform** and can be used at nearly **60 million UPI-accepting merchants** across India.

The platform enables employees to allocate benefit allowances across multiple tax-efficient categories, including **Meals, Fuel, Telecom, Books & Periodicals, Gadgets, and other eligible benefits**.

Detailed Explanation:

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The platform enables employees to allocate benefit allowances across multiple tax-efficient categories, including **Meals, Fuel, Telecom, Books & Periodicals, Gadgets, and other eligible benefits**.

The wallet uses **Merchant Category Code (MCC)-based spending controls** to ensure that benefits are spent only at eligible merchants, improving **tax compliance and benefit administration**.

The platform allows employees to make payments through simple **UPI Scan-and-Pay**, eliminating the need for separate meal cards or multiple benefit wallets.

Under the **Income-tax Rules, 2026**, notified by the **Central Board of Direct Taxes (CBDT)** and effective from **1 April 2026**, the tax-free limit for employer-provided meals has been increased from **₹50 to ₹200 per meal**, applicable under both the **Old Tax Regime and the New Tax Regime**, subject to prescribed conditions.

The revised meal benefit limit allows employees to receive up to **₹1,05,600 annually** as a **tax-free meal benefit**.

557. As per the news, which mutual fund launched India's first REITs-oriented open-ended passive index fund?

A.SBI Mutual Fund

B.HDFC Mutual Fund

C.Nippon India Mutual Fund

D.Edelweiss Mutual Fund

E.ICICI Prudential Mutual Fund

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

Edelweiss Mutual Fund (MF) launched the **Edelweiss Nifty REITs & Realty Index Fund**, India's first Real Estate Investment

Trusts **(REITs)-oriented open-ended passive index fund**.

The fund tracks the **Nifty REITs & Realty Total Return Index (TRI)** and aims to provide low-cost, long-term capital appreciation through **diversified exposure to listed REITs and listed real estate companies**.

The benchmark index currently allocates around **60% to listed REITs and 40% to listed real estate companies**, with the REIT allocation expected to increase as more REITs are listed.

Detailed Explanation:

Edelweiss Mutual Fund (MF) launched the **Edelweiss Nifty REITs & Realty Index Fund**, India's first Real Estate Investment Trusts **(REITs)-oriented open-ended passive index fund**.

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The benchmark index currently allocates around **60% to listed REITs and 40% to listed real estate companies**, with the REIT allocation expected to increase as more REITs are listed.

The fund enables investors to gain **diversified exposure to India's real estate sector** through a single **passive investment vehicle**.

Under **SEBI regulations**, **Real Estate Investment Trusts (REITs)** were reclassified as **equity instruments** with effect from **1 January 2026**.

REITs became **eligible for inclusion in equity indices** from **1 July 2026**, paving the way for dedicated REIT-based passive index funds.

558. As per the news, which index will replace the Wholesale Price Index (WPI) as the GDP deflator for quarterly and annual GDP estimates, wherever applicable?

A. Output Producer Price Index (PPI)

B.Retail Price Index (RPI)

C.Consumer Price Index (CPI)

D.Industrial Production Index (IIP)

E.GDP Price Index (GPI)

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

The **Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI)** announced that the **Output Producer Price Index (PPI)** will replace the **Wholesale Price Index (WPI)** as the **GDP deflator** for quarterly and annual **Gross Domestic Product (GDP)** estimates, wherever applicable.

The **Producer Price Index (PPI) series** was released by the **Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT)** in **June 2026** to improve GDP measurement and align **India's National Accounts** with international statistical standards.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI)** announced that the **Output Producer Price Index (PPI)** will replace the **Wholesale Price Index (WPI)** as the **GDP deflator** for quarterly and

annual **Gross Domestic Product (GDP)** estimates, wherever applicable.

The **Producer Price Index (PPI) series** was released by the **Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT)** in **June 2026** to improve GDP measurement and align **India's National Accounts** with international statistical standards.

The **Output PPI** will be used for **GDP deflation**, improving the accuracy of **real GDP growth estimates** by reducing distortions caused by the earlier methodology.

Under the revised GDP series, the **base year has been updated from 2011–12 to 2022–23**, reflecting the latest **economic structure and production patterns**.

The revised methodology adopts the **Double Deflation approach**, which separately adjusts **output prices and input prices**, providing a more accurate measure of **real value added**.

The earlier **Single Deflation method**, which used the **Wholesale Price Index (WPI)** for both output and input prices, is being replaced due to its tendency to **distort GDP growth estimates**.

559. As per the news, Indian Railways has approved the upgradation of the electric traction system on the Parbhani–Mudkhed section from 1×25 kV to which system?

A.1×50 kV

B.2×25 kV

C.2×50 kV

D.25×2 kV AC

E.3×25 kV

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Indian Railways has sanctioned a **₹163 crore** project to upgrade the **electric traction system** on the **Parbhani–Mudkhed double line section** in the **Nanded Division** of the **South-Central Railway (SCR)**.

The project includes the upgradation of the existing **1×25 Kilovolt (kV) electric traction system** to the **2×25 kV electric traction system** along **164 Track Kilometres (TKM)**, along with associated **power supply infrastructure**.

The upgraded **2×25 kV traction system** will provide a more reliable and efficient power supply, enabling the section to handle **higher freight and passenger traffic**.

Detailed Explanation:

Indian Railways has sanctioned a **₹163 crore** project to upgrade the **electric traction system** on the **Parbhani–Mudkhed double line section** in the **Nanded Division** of the **South-Central Railway (SCR)**.

The project includes the upgradation of the existing **1×25 Kilovolt (kV) electric traction system** to the **2×25 kV electric traction system** along **164 Track Kilometres (TKM)**, along with associated **power supply infrastructure**.

The upgraded **2×25 kV traction system** will provide a more reliable and efficient power supply, enabling the section to handle **higher freight and passenger traffic**.

The **Parbhani–Mudkhed** section is part of the strategically important **Highly Utilised Network (HUN) Route-9**, connecting:

Ajmer
Indore
Khandwa
Akola
Purna
Mudkhed
Secunderabad
Mahbubnagar
Dhone

560. As per the news, which ice cream brand became the first value-added dairy product from Assam to be exported internationally?

A.Amul Ice Cream
B.Mother Dairy Ice Cream
C.Verka Ice Cream
D.Purabi Ice Cream
E.Nandini Ice Cream

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

Assam achieved a major milestone in its dairy sector by exporting the **first international consignment of 5,627 litres of Purabi Ice Cream** to **Bhutan**, marking the beginning of **value-added dairy exports** from the **North Eastern Region**.

The export consignment was flagged off by **Chief Minister of Assam, Himanta Biswa Sarma**, in **Guwahati** on **28th July 2026**.

The consignment was exported by **North East Dairy and Foods Limited (NEDFL)** and will be supplied to major markets in **Bhutan**, including:

Thimphu
Paro
Phuentsholing
Wangdue

Detailed Explanation:

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Thimphu
Paro
Phuentsholing
Wangdue

Purabi Ice Cream is manufactured by the **West Assam Milk Producers' Cooperative Union Limited (WAMUL)** and marketed by **North East Dairy and Foods Limited (NEDFL)**.

The ice cream is produced using milk procured through **Purabi Dairy's cooperative network of dairy farmers across Assam**.

The inaugural export consignment included a variety of products such as:

Ice cream cups

Family packs
Cones
Gallon packs

561. As per the news, under the Viksit Bharat – Guarantee for Rozgar and Aajeevika Mission (Gramin) [VB-G RAM (G)] Act, 2025, how many days of wage employment are guaranteed to every willing rural household in a financial year?

A.100 days
B.110 days
C.120 days
D.125 days
E.150 days

Answer: D

Short Explanation:

The **Government of India** has allocated **₹95,692 crore** for the **Viksit Bharat – Guarantee for Rozgar and Aajeevika Mission (Gramin) [VB-G RAM (G)] Act, 2025** during the **Financial Year 2026–27**.

Union Minister for Rural Development, Shivraj Singh Chouhan, informed the **Lok Sabha** that this is the **highest-ever Budget Estimate allocation** made for any **rural employment programme** in India.

The **VB-G RAM (G) Act, 2025** provides a **statutory guarantee of 125 days of wage employment** in a financial year to every **willing rural household demanding work**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Government of India** has allocated **₹95,692 crore** for the **Viksit Bharat – Guarantee for Rozgar and Aajeevika Mission (Gramin) [VB-G RAM (G)] Act, 2025** during the **Financial Year 2026–27**.

Union Minister for Rural Development, Shivraj Singh Chouhan, informed the **Lok Sabha** that this is the **highest-ever Budget Estimate allocation** made for any **rural employment programme** in India.

The **VB-G RAM (G) Act, 2025** provides a **statutory guarantee of 125 days of wage employment** in a financial year to every **willing rural household demanding work**.

The new Act replaces the earlier provision of **100 days of guaranteed wage employment** under the **Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Scheme (MGNREGS)**.

The scope of permissible works has been significantly expanded with emphasis on:

Water security
Core rural infrastructure
Livelihood infrastructure
Mitigation of extreme weather events

The Act also promotes **convergence with Central and State Government schemes** through a **whole-of-government approach** to improve implementation and resource utilisation.

562. As per the news, how many Tiger Reserves does India have as highlighted during the Global Tiger Day 2026 celebrations?

A.54

B.56

C.58

D.60

E.62

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

Global Tiger Day was celebrated on **29th July 2026** by the **National Tiger Conservation Authority (NTCA)** in **New Delhi** to promote **tiger conservation** and strengthen public awareness about protecting wildlife and natural habitats.

Union Minister for Environment, Forest and Climate Change, Bhupender Yadav, addressed the event and called for a **conservation-oriented lifestyle** and a stronger societal connection with nature.

India's achievements in tiger conservation, that the country now has **3,682 tigers** and **58 Tiger Reserves**, reflecting significant progress over the last 12 years.

Detailed Explanation:

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Union Minister for Environment, Forest and Climate Change, Bhupender Yadav, addressed the event and called for a **conservation-oriented lifestyle** and a stronger societal connection with nature.

The event was attended by **Union Minister of State for Environment, Forest and Climate Change Kirti Vardhan Singh**, senior government officials, wildlife experts, forest personnel, students, and other stakeholders.

India's achievements in tiger conservation, that the country now has **3,682 tigers** and **58 Tiger Reserves**, reflecting significant progress over the last 12 years.

During the event, **Bhupender Yadav** launched the **NTCA Eco-Tourism Webpage**, which provides **direct links to the official websites of all Tiger Reserves** for **safari and accommodation bookings**, promoting **responsible and sustainable eco-tourism**.

Five publications were released during the celebrations:

NTCA Outreach Journal – STRIPES (July 2026 Edition)

Security Audit Report of 24 Tiger Reserves

Habitat Suitability Assessment for Sloth Bears across Tiger Landscapes in India

Tigers of the World (published by **International Big Cat Alliance (IBCA)** and **Global Tiger Forum (GTF)**)

The Rehman Khera Tiger.

563. As per the news, the Gulf of Khambhat Project is also popularly known by which name?

A.Sardar Sarovar Project

B.Kalpasar Project

C.Par-Tapi-Narmada Project

D.Ken–Betwa Project

E.Sujalam Sufalam Project

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The **Government of Gujarat** has proposed the ambitious **Gulf of Khambhat Project, also known as the Kalpasar Project**, as a major **water resources development initiative**.

The project aims to create one of the world's largest **coastal freshwater reservoirs** through the construction of a dam across the **Gulf of Khambhat, Gujarat**.

The information regarding the project was provided by **Minister of State for Jal Shakti Raj Bhushan Choudhary** in a written reply to a question in the **Rajya Sabha**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Government of Gujarat** has proposed the ambitious **Gulf of Khambhat Project, also known as the Kalpasar Project**, as a major **water resources development initiative**.

The project aims to create one of the world's largest **coastal freshwater reservoirs** through the construction of a dam across the **Gulf of Khambhat, Gujarat**.

The information regarding the project was provided by **Minister of State for Jal Shakti Raj Bhushan Choudhary** in a written reply to a question in the **Rajya Sabha**.

The Kalpasar Project is expected to:

Enhance **freshwater availability** in the **Saurashtra region**.

Address regional **water scarcity** by providing a reliable source of water for irrigation and other requirements.

Support agricultural development through improved water management.

The project includes the construction of a **highway-cum-rail corridor** over the dam across the **Gulf of Khambhat**.

564. As per the BIMCO-ICS Seafarer Workforce Report 2026, India ranks as the world's _____ largest supplier of seafarers.

A.Second

B.First

C.Third

D.Fourth

E.Fifth

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

According to the **BIMCO-ICS Seafarer Workforce Report 2026**, **India** has become the **world's second-largest supplier of seafarers**, contributing **311,936 maritime professionals** to the global shipping industry.

India now accounts for **12.16% of the global seafaring workforce**, ranking **second** after the **Philippines**, and ahead of **China**, the **Russian Federation**, and **Indonesia**.

The report estimates the **global seafaring workforce** at **2.57 million**, while the global demand stands at **2.55 million**, highlighting a **shortage of qualified officers** in the maritime industry.

Detailed Explanation:

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The report estimates the **global seafaring workforce** at **2.57 million**, while the global demand stands at **2.55 million**, highlighting a **shortage of qualified officers** in the maritime industry.
India's share of the global seafaring workforce has increased significantly:
2015: 5.2% (Ranked **5th** globally)
2021: 6% (Ranked **5th** globally)
2026: 12.16% (Ranked **2nd** globally)
India currently supplies:
140,718 Officers, accounting for **13.41%** of the global officer workforce.
171,218 Ratings, accounting for **11.29%** of the global ratings serving on merchant vessels.
Union Minister of Ports, Shipping and Waterways, Sarbananda Sonowal, announced the **Mission 20%** initiative, which aims to increase **India's share of the global seafaring workforce from 12.16% to 20%**.

565. As per the news, which of the following statements about the Delhi Lakshmi Yojana is correct?

A.Eligible women will receive financial assistance of ₹2,500 per month.
B.The Delhi Government has allocated ₹5,210 crore for the implementation of the scheme in the 2026–27 Budget.
C.The scheme is open only to women above 60 years of age
D.The registration portal opened on 1 July 2026.
E.The scheme has been launched by the Government of Haryana
Answer: A
Short Explanation:
The **Delhi Government** approved the **Delhi Lakshmi Yojana**, a welfare scheme aimed at the **economic empowerment and social security of women**.
The decision was taken at a **Cabinet meeting** chaired by **Chief Minister Rekha Gupta** at the **Delhi Secretariat**.
Under the scheme, **eligible women** will receive **financial assistance of ₹2,500 per month**.
The **Delhi Government** has allocated **₹5,110 crore** for the implementation of the scheme in the **2026–27 Budget**.
The **registration portal** for the scheme will open on **1st August 2026**.
Women aged between 21 and 60 years with an **annual family income of up to ₹2.5 lakh** will be eligible to avail the benefits under the scheme.
Detailed Explanation:
The **Delhi Government** approved the **Delhi Lakshmi Yojana**, a welfare scheme aimed at

the **economic empowerment and social security of women**.

The decision was taken at a **Cabinet meeting** chaired by **Chief Minister Rekha Gupta** at the **Delhi Secretariat**.

Under the scheme, **eligible women** will receive **financial assistance of ₹2,500 per month**.

The **Delhi Government** has allocated **₹5,110 crore** for the implementation of the scheme in the **2026–27 Budget**.

The **registration portal** for the scheme will open on **1st August 2026**.

Women aged between 21 and 60 years with an **annual family income of up to ₹2.5 lakh** will be eligible to avail the benefits under the scheme.

The scheme aims to promote:

Financial security

Education

Healthcare

Skill development

Savings

Greater social participation of women

The scheme is expected to benefit **more than 17 lakh women** across **Delhi**, helping them become **self-reliant and economically empowered**.

566. As per the news, the Government of Odisha has initiated land acquisition for Indian Oil Corporation's (IOC) Paradip Petrochemical Complex, which is centred around a _____.

A.2.0 MTPA ethylene cracker

B.1.5 MTPA dual-feed naphtha cracker

C.1.0 MTPA gas cracker

D.3.0 MTPA refinery expansion unit

E.2.5 MTPA polypropylene unit

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The **Government of Odisha** has initiated the **land acquisition process** for **Indian Oil Corporation (IOC)'s ₹61,077 crore Paradip Petrochemical Complex**, marking **IOC's largest-ever single-location investment**.

The **Paradip Petrochemical Complex** will be developed around a **1.5 Million Tonnes Per Annum (MTPA) dual-feed naphtha cracker**, supported by multiple **downstream petrochemical units** and the proposed **Paradip Plastic Park**.

The **Odisha Government** has started the mandatory **Social Impact Assessment (SIA)** for acquiring approximately **220 acres of private land**, which forms part of the total **2,200 acres required** for the integrated project.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Government of Odisha** has initiated the **land acquisition process** for **Indian Oil Corporation (IOC)'s ₹61,077 crore Paradip Petrochemical Complex**, marking **IOC's largest-ever single-location investment**.

The **Paradip Petrochemical Complex** will be developed around a **1.5 Million Tonnes Per Annum (MTPA) dual-feed naphtha cracker**, supported by multiple **downstream**

petrochemical units and the proposed **Paradip Plastic Park**.

The **Odisha Government** has started the mandatory **Social Impact Assessment (SIA)** for acquiring approximately **220 acres of private land**, which forms part of the total **2,200 acres required** for the integrated project.

The private land identified for acquisition is located at **Badakantakandha village, Erasama Tehsil, Jagatsinghpur district**, adjacent to **IOC's existing Paradip Refinery**.

The land acquisition will be carried out through the **Odisha Industrial Infrastructure Development Corporation (IDCO)**.

The project is based on a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** signed in **April 2025** between **Indian Oil Corporation (IOC)** and the **Government of Odisha** in the presence of **Union Minister Hardeep Singh Puri** and **Odisha Chief Minister Mohan Charan Majhi**.

567. As per the news, what is the name of the mobile application launched by ICAR-CMFRI to enhance awareness and conservation of protected sharks and rays in India?

A.Ocean Watch

B.Marine Shield

C.Shark Aware

D.Blue Ocean India

E.Aqua Protect

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

Indian Council of Agricultural Research–Central Marine Fisheries Research Institute (ICAR-CMFRI) launched the **"Shark Aware" mobile application** and an **interactive e-learning module** to enhance awareness, identification, and conservation of **protected and endangered sharks and rays** in India.

The digital tools were released by **Kerala Fisheries Minister V. E. Abdul Gafoor** and developed by a scientific team led by **Dr. Livi Wilson**, Senior Scientist, Finfish Fisheries Division, ICAR-CMFRI, with financial support from the **National Fisheries Development Board (NFDB)**.

Detailed Explanation:

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The **"Shark Aware" mobile app** enables users to identify **legally protected sharks and rays** and provides scientific, legal, conservation, and species identification information in a user-friendly format.

The app includes details of species protected under **Schedules I, II, and IV of the Wild Life (Protection) Act, 1972, as amended in 2022**, along with information on legal protection status, international trade regulations, and their conservation significance.

568. As per the news, what is the name of NASA's proposed AI-powered mission concept for the first-ever direct collection and in-situ analysis of particles from Saturn's rings?

A.CASSINI-II

B.ORION-RING

C.RINGEX

D.SATEX

E.PRAXIS

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

The **National Aeronautics and Space Administration (NASA)** has proposed an **Artificial Intelligence (AI)-powered mission concept** named **PRAXIS (Planetary Rings Autonomous EXploration with In-situ Sampling)** under **Phase I of the NASA Innovative Advanced Concepts (NIAC) 2026 Program**.

The **PRAXIS mission** aims to achieve the **first-ever direct collection and in-situ analysis of particles from Saturn's rings**, addressing one of the highest priorities in **planetary science decadal surveys**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **National Aeronautics and Space Administration (NASA)** has proposed an **Artificial Intelligence (AI)-powered mission concept** named **PRAXIS (Planetary Rings Autonomous EXploration with In-situ Sampling)** under **Phase I of the NASA Innovative Advanced Concepts (NIAC) 2026 Program**.

The **PRAXIS mission** aims to achieve the **first-ever direct collection and in-situ analysis of particles from Saturn's rings**, addressing one of the highest priorities in **planetary science decadal surveys**.

The project is being led by **Dr. B. Marco Quadrelli**, Principal and Group Supervisor of the **Robotics Modelling and Simulation Group** at **NASA's Jet Propulsion Laboratory (JPL)** in California, United States (USA).

The primary objective of PRAXIS is to provide the **first direct observations of millimetre- to centimetre-sized (mm–cm) ring particles**, which were not directly studied by **NASA's Cassini mission**.

Saturn's rings are composed mainly of **water ice** and contain particles ranging from **tiny grains to house-sized boulders**, which continuously collide, merge, and break apart.

The mission will use an **AI-powered, bio-inspired robotic explorer** equipped with **robotic autonomy, collision avoidance, precision sampling, and real-time in-situ scientific analysis** to safely collect and study ring particles.

569. As per the news, Engineers India Limited (EIL) signed an MoU with which organisation to collaborate in mineral processing, extractive metallurgy, and the critical minerals value chain?

A.CSIR–Institute of Minerals and Materials Technology (CSIR-IMMT)

B.Indian Bureau of Mines (IBM)

C.CSIR–National Metallurgical Laboratory (CSIR-NML)

D.Geological Survey of India (GSI)

E.National Mineral Development Corporation (NMDC)

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

Engineers India Limited (EIL), a public sector engineering consultancy company, signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** with **Council of Scientific and Industrial Research-Institute of Minerals and Materials Technology (CSIR-IMMT), Bhubaneswar**, to strengthen collaboration in:

Mineral processing

Extractive metallurgy

Critical and strategic minerals value chain

Detailed Explanation:

Engineers India Limited (EIL), a public sector engineering consultancy company, signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** with **Council of Scientific and Industrial Research-Institute of Minerals and Materials Technology (CSIR-IMMT), Bhubaneswar**, to strengthen collaboration in:

Mineral processing

Extractive metallurgy

Critical and strategic minerals value chain

The **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** was signed by:

Rajiv Agarwal – Director (Technical), **Engineers India Limited (EIL)**

Ramanuj Narayan – Director, **Council of Scientific and Industrial Research-Institute of Minerals and Materials Technology (CSIR-IMMT)**

Under the agreement, **Engineers India Limited (EIL)** and **Council of Scientific and Industrial Research-Institute of Minerals and Materials Technology (CSIR-IMMT)** will jointly:

Identify, evaluate and undertake **Research and Development (R&D)** initiatives in **critical and strategic minerals**.

Facilitate the exchange of **technical expertise**.

Conduct **capacity-building programmes**.

Support **technology scale-up** and commercial deployment of innovative solutions.

Execute **pilot-scale and commercial projects** in the minerals and metallurgy sector.

570. As per the news, Gulveer Singh became the first Indian athlete to win a Commonwealth Games medal in which event?

A.Men's 5,000 Metre Race

B.Men's Marathon

C.Men's 10,000 Metre Race

D.Men's 3,000 Metre Steeplechase

E.Men's 1,500 Metre Race

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

Gulveer Singh created history by becoming the **first Indian athlete to win a medal in the Men's 10,000 Metre race** at the **Commonwealth Games**, securing the **Silver Medal** at the **Commonwealth Games 2026** in **Glasgow, Scotland**.

The **reigning Asian champion** clocked **27 minutes 49.78 seconds** to finish second behind **Ky Robinson (Australia)**, who won the **Gold Medal**.

Detailed Explanation:

Gulveer Singh created history by becoming the **first Indian athlete to win a medal in the Men's 10,000 Metre race** at the **Commonwealth Games**, securing the **Silver Medal** at the **Commonwealth Games 2026** in **Glasgow, Scotland**.

The **reigning Asian champion** clocked **27 minutes 49.78 seconds** to finish second behind **Ky Robinson (Australia)**, who won the **Gold Medal**.

Harjinder Kaur won the **Silver Medal** in the **Women's 69 Kilogram Weightlifting** event with a **combined lift of 227 kilograms**.

The medal marked **Harjinder Kaur's second consecutive Commonwealth Games medal**, having won the **Bronze Medal** at the **Commonwealth Games 2022** in **Birmingham, England**.

Harjinder Kaur's achievement became **India's seventh medal in weightlifting** from **eight weightlifting events** at the **Commonwealth Games 2026**.

571. As per the news, the Asian Development Bank (ADB) approved an USD 850 million loan to support rooftop solar adoption under which Government of India scheme?

A.PM-KUSUM

B.National Solar Mission

C.PM Surya Ghar: Muft Bijli Yojana (PMSG-MBY)

D.UJALA Scheme

E.Green Energy Corridor Scheme

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The **Asian Development Bank (ADB)** approved an **USD 850 million loan** to support the **Government of India (GoI)** in accelerating rooftop solar adoption under the **Prime Minister Surya Ghar: Muft Bijli Yojana (PMSG-MBY)**.

The funding is provided under **Subprogram 2** of the **Accelerating Affordable and Inclusive Rooftop Solar Systems Development Program**, which builds on **Subprogram 1** approved in **November 2025** that established the policy, institutional, digital, financing, and market framework for large-scale rooftop solar deployment.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Asian Development Bank (ADB)** approved an **USD 850 million loan** to support the **Government of India (GoI)** in accelerating rooftop solar adoption under the **Prime Minister Surya Ghar: Muft Bijli Yojana (PMSG-MBY)**.

The funding is provided under **Subprogram 2** of the **Accelerating Affordable and Inclusive**

Rooftop Solar Systems Development Program, which builds on **Subprogram 1** approved in **November 2025** that established the policy, institutional, digital, financing, and market framework for large-scale rooftop solar deployment.

The **Pradhan Mantri Surya Ghar: Muft Bijli Yojana (PMSG-MBY)** aims to install rooftop solar systems for **10 million low- and middle-income households** and achieve **30 Giga-Watt (GW)** of cumulative residential rooftop solar capacity by **FY 2026–27 (FY27)**.

The **ADB financing** will accelerate rooftop solar adoption by improving **financial incentives, affordable financing, grid readiness, distribution company (DISCOM) participation, private sector investment, digital application and monitoring systems, and utility engagement**.

572. As per the news, which company was fined ₹5.80 lakh by the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) for non-compliance with RBI regulations?

A.Muthoot Finance

B.Satya MicroCapital

C.Avail Financial Services

D.PAN Emami Cosmed

E.Dhani Loans and Services

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** imposed **monetary penalties on six companies**, including **Muthoot Finance**, for non-compliance with various provisions of the **RBI Act** and **Non-Banking Financial Company (NBFC)** regulations.

Muthoot Finance was fined **₹5.80 lakh** for failing to **periodically review the risk categorisation** of customer accounts and for not deploying **robust software** to effectively identify and report **suspicious financial transactions**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** imposed **monetary penalties on six companies**, including **Muthoot Finance**, for non-compliance with various provisions of the **RBI Act** and **Non-Banking Financial Company (NBFC)** regulations.

Muthoot Finance was fined **₹5.80 lakh** for failing to **periodically review the risk categorisation** of customer accounts and for not deploying **robust software** to effectively identify and report **suspicious financial transactions**.

Avail Financial Services was penalised **₹6.20 lakh** because its **Managing Director** held **directorships in two other Middle Layer NBFCs**, and the company violated the prescribed **single-party exposure limit**.

Satya MicroCapital was fined **₹3.10 lakh** for failing to classify certain **restructured accounts** as **Non-Performing Assets (NPAs)** in accordance with RBI regulations.

PAN Emami Cosmed was also fined **₹3.10 lakh** for non-compliance with **RBI regulatory provisions**.

Dhani Loans and Services and **Muthoot Vehicle and Asset Finance** were each penalised **₹2.70 lakh** for violating **RBI's regulatory norms**.

573. As per the news, Piramal Finance entered into a co-lending partnership with which company to expand affordable housing finance and Loan Against Property (LAP) solutions?

A.Manappuram Finance

B.Muthoot Fincorp

C.Bajaj Finance

D.Shriram Finance

E.L&T Finance

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Piramal Finance entered into a **co-lending partnership** with **Muthoot Fincorp** to expand access to **affordable housing finance** and **Loan Against Property (LAP)** solutions across India.

The partnership aims to improve the availability of **formal credit** for **aspiring homeowners, self-employed professionals, small business owners, and underserved borrowers**, particularly in **Tier-2, Tier-3, semi-urban, and rural areas**.

Detailed Explanation:

Piramal Finance entered into a **co-lending partnership** with **Muthoot Fincorp** to expand access to **affordable housing finance** and **Loan Against Property (LAP)** solutions across India.

The partnership aims to improve the availability of **formal credit** for **aspiring homeowners, self-employed professionals, small business owners, and underserved borrowers**, particularly in **Tier-2, Tier-3, semi-urban, and rural areas**.

Under the **co-lending model**, both **Non-Banking Financial Companies (NBFCs)** will **jointly finance** eligible borrowers, enabling **wider credit outreach, faster loan disbursal, better risk sharing**, and **improved access to organised financing**.

The collaboration combines the strengths of **Piramal Finance** and **Muthoot Fincorp** to strengthen **housing finance**, expand **Loan Against Property (LAP) lending**, and promote **financial inclusion** in underserved markets.

574. As per the news, Revolut received a full Authorised Deposit-taking Institution (ADI) licence from which regulatory authority?

A.Reserve Bank of Australia (RBA)

B.Australian Securities and Investments Commission (ASIC)

C.Australian Prudential Regulation Authority (APRA)

D.Australian Competition and Consumer Commission (ACCC)

E.Australian Treasury

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

Global fintech company **Revolut** received a full **Authorised Deposit-taking Institution (ADI) licence** from the **Australian Prudential Regulation Authority (APRA)**, officially launching as **Revolut Bank Australia**.

With this approval, Revolut became the **first global fintech** to secure a full unrestricted ADI licence in **Australia**, marking its **first banking entity** in the **Asia-Pacific (APAC)** region.

Revolut Bank Australia plans to invest approximately **AUD 400 million** over the next **five years** to support **product innovation**, **business growth**, **technology development**, and the **expansion of its local workforce**.

Detailed Explanation:

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Revolut Bank Australia plans to invest approximately **AUD 400 million** over the next **five years** to support **product innovation**, **business growth**, **technology development**, and the **expansion of its local workforce**.

As an **APRA-authorised bank**, Revolut Bank Australia will provide customers with protection under Australia's **Financial Claims Scheme (FCS)**, which insures eligible deposits up to **AUD 250,000** per account holder.

The new banking licence enables Revolut to transition its **more than 1 million Australian retail customers** and **thousands of businesses** into a **fully regulated banking ecosystem**.

575. As per the news, where will India's first Telecom Manufacturing Zone (TMZ) be established?

A.Gwalior, Madhya Pradesh

B.Bhopal, Madhya Pradesh

C.Indore, Madhya Pradesh

D.Nagpur, Maharashtra

E.Hyderabad, Telangana

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

Union Minister for Communications and Development of North Eastern Region, Jyotiraditya M. Scindia, announced that **India's first Telecom Manufacturing Zone (TMZ)** will be established in **Gwalior, Madhya Pradesh**.

The **Department of Telecommunications (DoT), Ministry of Communications**, and the **Government of Madhya Pradesh** signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** for **Phase I** of the project at **Vigyan Bhawan, New Delhi**, in the presence of **Chief Minister Mohan Yadav**.

Detailed Explanation:

Union Minister for Communications and Development of North Eastern Region, Jyotiraditya M. Scindia, announced that **India's first Telecom Manufacturing Zone (TMZ)** will be established in **Gwalior, Madhya Pradesh**.

The **Department of Telecommunications (DoT), Ministry of Communications**, and the **Government of Madhya Pradesh** signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** for **Phase I** of the project at **Vigyan Bhawan, New Delhi**, in the presence of **Chief Minister Mohan Yadav**.

The **Telecom Manufacturing Zone (TMZ)** will be developed over **350 acres** on a **plug-and-play model**, with the **Central Government** providing **₹493 crore** as **100% financial assistance** for developing core infrastructure during the first phase.

The zone will serve as a dedicated manufacturing ecosystem for **telecommunications equipment, data centres, semiconductor manufacturing, fibre optic products, mobile phones, and fifth-generation (5G) and sixth-generation (6G) technologies**, promoting indigenous design and manufacturing.

576. As per the news, what is the name of the fare-free electric bus service launched by President Droupadi Murmu at the President's Estate?

A.SARATHI

B.RAAHI

C.E-MARG

D.PRERNA

E.SAFAR

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

President Droupadi Murmu completed **four years in office**.

To mark the occasion, she inaugurated and laid the foundation stones for several citizen-centric and sustainable initiatives at **Rashtrapati Bhavan** and the **President's Estates** on **28 July 2026**.

She launched **RAAHI (Rashtrapati Bhavan Access And Heritage Interconnector)**, a **fare-free electric bus service** operated by **women drivers and conductors**, promoting **green, safe and inclusive mobility** for staff and residents of the President's Estate.

Detailed Explanation:

President Droupadi Murmu completed **four years in office**.

To mark the occasion, she inaugurated and laid the foundation stones for several citizen-centric and sustainable initiatives at **Rashtrapati Bhavan** and the **President's Estates** on **28 July 2026**.

The President launched an **e-Audio Guide** for visitors to **Rashtrapati Bhavan**, available in **Hindi, English and 14 other Indian languages**, along with a **sign language module** to improve accessibility for visitors.

She launched the **third edition of e-Upahaar**, featuring **300 curated Presidential gifts** for

public auction. The auction will be conducted from **5 August to 5 September 2026**.

The President inaugurated **Bachpan 'Bal Parisar'**, comprising **'Kilkari'** (a children's play zone) and **'Samarth Anganwadi-cum-Palna'**, to provide a safe and nurturing environment for children in the President's Estate.

She launched **RAAHI (Rashtrapati Bhavan Access And Heritage Interconnector)**, a **fare-free electric bus service** operated by **women drivers and conductors**, promoting **green, safe and inclusive mobility** for staff and residents of the President's Estate

577. As per the news, what is the name of India's first women-led distributed renewable energy policy launched by Chhattisgarh?

A.UJALA Shakti Yojana

B.Surya Sakhi Yojana

C.Green Shakti Abhiyan

D.Urja Nari Mission

E.DWEEPTI Yojana

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

Chhattisgarh has launched the **DWEEPTI Yojana (Decentralised Women Empowerment on Energy and Policy for Transformative Inclusion)**, the country's **first women-led distributed renewable energy policy**, aimed at empowering **rural women Self-Help Groups (SHGs)** in the solar energy sector.

The scheme has been developed by the **Panchayat and Rural Development Department, Government of Chhattisgarh**, in collaboration with **Transform Rural India**, under the **Green Economy Transition Mission**.

Detailed Explanation:

Chhattisgarh has launched the **DWEEPTI Yojana (Decentralised Women Empowerment on Energy and Policy for Transformative Inclusion)**, the country's **first women-led distributed renewable energy policy**, aimed at empowering **rural women Self-Help Groups (SHGs)** in the solar energy sector.

The scheme has been developed by the **Panchayat and Rural Development Department, Government of Chhattisgarh**, in collaboration with **Transform Rural India**, under the **Green Economy Transition Mission**.

The initiative enables **women SHGs** to work as **authorised solar vendors, technicians, managers and entrepreneurs**, promoting sustainable livelihoods and clean energy adoption.

As part of the initial implementation, **13 Cluster Level Federations (CLFs)** across **12 districts** have been registered as **authorised vendors** under the **Pradhan Mantri Surya Ghar Muft Bijli Yojana**, in partnership with the **Chhattisgarh State Power Distribution Company Limited (CSPDCL)**.

578. As per the news, the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Amendment Bill, 2026 strengthens the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act of which year?

A.2022

B.2023

C.2024

D.2025

E.2026

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The **Lok Sabha** passed the **Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Amendment Bill, 2026** by a **voice vote** to strengthen the legal framework against the use of unfair means in public examinations and protect the interests of students and job aspirants.

The Amendment Bill strengthens the **Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024**, which applies to examinations conducted by major recruitment agencies such as:

Union Public Service Commission (UPSC)
Staff Selection Commission (SSC)
Railway Recruitment Boards (RRBs)
Institute of Banking Personnel Selection (IBPS)
National Testing Agency (NTA)

Detailed Explanation:

The **Lok Sabha** passed the **Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Amendment Bill, 2026** by a **voice vote** to strengthen the legal framework against the use of unfair means in public examinations and protect the interests of students and job aspirants.

Replying to the debate, **Union Minister of State (Independent Charge) for Science and Technology and Earth Sciences, and Minister of State in the Prime Minister's Office, Personnel, Public Grievances and Pensions, Atomic Energy and Space, Dr. Jitendra Singh**, stated that the amendments aim to enhance the **integrity, transparency, and credibility** of the public examination system while effectively tackling organised examination-related crimes.

The Amendment Bill strengthens the **Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024**, which applies to examinations conducted by major recruitment agencies such as:

Union Public Service Commission (UPSC)
Staff Selection Commission (SSC)
Railway Recruitment Boards (RRBs)
Institute of Banking Personnel Selection (IBPS)
National Testing Agency (NTA)

579. As per the news, what is the theme of the 10th India Mobile Congress (IMC) 2026?

A.Digital India for All

B.Scale without Boundaries

C.Connecting the Future

D.Empowering Digital Ecosystems

E.Technology for Inclusive Growth

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Union Minister for Communications and Development of North Eastern Region Jyotiraditya M. Scindia unveiled the theme **"Scale without Boundaries"** for the **10th edition of the India Mobile Congress (IMC) 2026**, which will be held from **7–10**

October 2026 at **Yashobhoomi (India International Convention and Expo Centre), New Delhi**.

Organised by the **Department of Telecommunications (DoT), Ministry of Communications**, and the **Cellular Operators Association of India (COAI)**, **India Mobile Congress (IMC)** is Asia's largest digital technology forum that brings together global technology companies, telecom operators, policymakers, startups, investors, researchers, and innovators.

Detailed Explanation:

Union Minister for Communications and Development of North Eastern Region Jyotiraditya M. Scindia unveiled the theme **"Scale without Boundaries"** for the **10th edition of the India Mobile Congress (IMC) 2026**, which will be held from **7–10 October 2026** at **Yashobhoomi (India International Convention and Expo Centre), New Delhi**.

Organised by the **Department of Telecommunications (DoT), Ministry of Communications**, and the **Cellular Operators Association of India (COAI)**, **India Mobile Congress (IMC)** is Asia's largest digital technology forum that brings together global technology companies, telecom operators, policymakers, startups, investors, researchers, and innovators.

The theme **"Scale without Boundaries"** reflects India's vision of expanding digital transformation by enabling technology, innovation, and connectivity to reach every sector, community, and region through greater collaboration among industry, academia, startups, infrastructure providers, policymakers, and consumers.

The **10th India Mobile Congress (IMC) 2026** is centred around four key pillars:

Srishti – Building the Future: Focus on innovation, emerging technologies, and next-generation digital infrastructure.

Suraksha – Strengthening Trust: Promote secure, resilient, and trusted digital ecosystems.

Sashakt – Expanding Opportunities: Expand digital opportunities for citizens, businesses, startups, and communities.

Samvardhan – Fueling Growth: Drive economic growth, entrepreneurship, investments, job creation, and India's emergence as a global technology leader.

580. As per the news, who has been appointed as the Director of the Financial Intelligence Unit–India (FIU-IND)?

A.Pankaj Kumar Mishra

B.Satya Pal Kumar

C.T. Rabi Sankar

D.Rajeshwar Rao

E.Vivek Joshi

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

The **Appointments Committee of the Cabinet (ACC)** appointed **Satya Pal Kumar**, a **2005-batch Indian Revenue Service (IRS)** officer of the Income Tax cadre, as the **Director of the**

Financial Intelligence Unit–India (FIU-IND) under the **Department of Revenue (DoR), Ministry of Finance (MoF)**.

The appointment was made as part of a **Joint Secretary-level reshuffle**, and **Satya Pal Kumar** succeeded **Pankaj Kumar Mishra** (IRS, 1989 batch), who had served as Director of FIU-IND since **May 2016**.

Satya Pal Kumar has been appointed for a **5-year tenure** at the rank of **Joint Secretary to the Government of India (GoI)**.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Appointments Committee of the Cabinet (ACC)** appointed **Satya Pal Kumar**, a **2005-batch Indian Revenue Service (IRS)** officer of the Income Tax cadre, as the **Director of the Financial Intelligence Unit–India (FIU-IND)** under the **Department of Revenue (DoR), Ministry of Finance (MoF)**.

The appointment was made as part of a **Joint Secretary-level reshuffle**, and **Satya Pal Kumar** succeeded **Pankaj Kumar Mishra** (IRS, 1989 batch), who had served as Director of FIU-IND since **May 2016**.

Satya Pal Kumar has been appointed for a **5-year tenure** at the rank of **Joint Secretary to the Government of India (GoI)**.

Before this appointment, **Satya Pal Kumar** served as the **Commissioner of Income Tax (Appeals), Mumbai, Maharashtra**.

The appointment is expected to strengthen India's **financial intelligence framework** for combating **Money Laundering, Terror Financing, and Suspicious Financial Transactions**, reinforcing the country's **Anti-Money Laundering (AML)** and **Combating Financing of Terrorism (CFT)** framework.

581. As per the news, the Competition Commission of India (CCI) approved the merger of Go Digit Infoworks Services Private Limited with which company?

A.ICICI Lombard General Insurance

B.HDFC ERGO General Insurance

C.Go Digit General Insurance Limited

D.Bajaj Allianz General Insurance

E.Reliance General Insurance

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

The **Competition Commission of India (CCI)**, under the **Ministry of Corporate Affairs (MoCA)**, approved the proposed merger of **Go Digit Infoworks Services Private Limited (Infoworks)** with **Go Digit General Insurance Limited (GDGIL)**.

The merger is the **first-ever merger** between an insurance company and a non-insurance holding company under the **Sabka Bima Sabki Raksha (Amendment of Insurance Laws) Act, 2025**, making it an important milestone in **India's insurance sector**.

Detailed Explanation:

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The merger is the **first-ever merger** between an insurance company and a non-insurance holding company under the **Sabka Bima Sabki Raksha (Amendment of Insurance Laws) Act, 2025**, making it an important milestone in **India's insurance sector**.

Go Digit General Insurance Limited (GDGIL) is a public limited company engaged in providing **general insurance and health insurance** products and services across India.

Under the approved merger scheme, **Go Digit Infoworks Services Private Limited** will be merged into **Go Digit General Insurance Limited**, thereby **eliminating the holding company structure** and enabling shareholders to **hold shares directly** in the insurance company.

582. As per the news, Kotak Mahindra Mutual Fund (KMMF) increased its stake to more than 5% in which bank through an open market purchase?

A.Federal Bank

B.Karnataka Bank

C.Dhanlaxmi Bank

D.City Union Bank

E.South Indian Bank

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

Kotak Mahindra Asset Management Company (KMAMC) announced that **Kotak Mahindra Mutual Fund (KMMF)** increased its stake in **South Indian Bank** to **more than 5%** through an **open market purchase**.

Before the acquisition, **KMMF** held **12.04 crore shares (4.5981%)** in South Indian Bank and acquired an additional **1.47 crore shares (0.5614%)**, increasing its total holding to **13.51 crore shares (5.1595%)**.

The acquisition involved **14,694,332 equity shares**, resulting in KMMF crossing the **5% substantial acquisition threshold** prescribed under **SEBI (Substantial Acquisition of Shares and Takeovers) Regulations, 2011 (SAST Regulations)**.

Detailed Explanation:

Kotak Mahindra Asset Management Company (KMAMC) announced that **Kotak Mahindra Mutual Fund (KMMF)** increased its stake in **South Indian Bank** to **more than 5%** through an **open market purchase**.

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The acquisition involved **14,694,332 equity shares**, resulting in KMMF crossing the **5% substantial acquisition threshold** prescribed under **SEBI (Substantial Acquisition of Shares and Takeovers) Regulations, 2011 (SAST Regulations)**.

The transaction was executed entirely through **open market purchases**, with no involvement of **warrants, convertible securities, or encumbered shares**, and KMMF is **not part of the promoter or promoter group** of South Indian Bank.

South Indian Bank disclosed the acquisition on **23 July 2026** in compliance with **Regulation 30** of the **SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 (LODR Regulations)** and **Regulation 29(1)** of the **SEBI (SAST) Regulations, 2011**.

583. As per the news, what is the name of the newly discovered polypore (bracket) fungus species found in Kolhapur, Maharashtra?

A.Microporellus kolhapurensis

B.Microporellus maharashtraensis

C.Microporellus indicus

D.Polyporus kolhapurensis

E.Trametes kolhapurensis

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

Researchers from **Maharashtra** discovered a new **polypore (bracket) fungus species** named **Microporellus kolhapurensis** in **Bhudargad taluka, Kolhapur district, Maharashtra**, growing on **rotting wood** in the **Bediv area near the Ajra border**.

The newly discovered fungus was named **Microporellus kolhapurensis** after **Kolhapur district** in recognition of the region's **rich biodiversity**.

The discovery was made by **Dr. Anjali Patil**, Head, Department of Botany, **Rajaram College, Kolhapur**, along with research scholar **Yogesh Patil** during field studies in the **Bediv area of Bhudargad taluka**.

Detailed Explanation:

Researchers from **Maharashtra** discovered a new **polypore (bracket) fungus species** named **Microporellus kolhapurensis** in **Bhudargad taluka, Kolhapur district, Maharashtra**, growing on **rotting wood** in the **Bediv area near the Ajra border**.

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The discovery was made by **Dr. Anjali Patil**, Head, Department of Botany, **Rajaram College, Kolhapur**, along with research scholar **Yogesh Patil** during field studies in the **Bediv area of Bhudargad taluka**.

The research describing the new species was published in **Nelumbo**, the official research journal of the **Botanical Survey of India (BSI)**.

Microporellus kolhapurensis is a **polypore (bracket) fungus** that generally grows singly on **rotting wood** and has a **fruiting period from July to September**.

The fungus is distinguished by its **yellowish-orange to grayish-brown colour**, **umbrella-shaped structure**, **lateral stalk**, **ground-growing habit**, **large pores**, **teardrop-shaped spores**, and **unique thick-walled cystidia**, making it different from other closely related species

584. As per the news, what is the name of the alliance launched by NVIDIA, Microsoft, IBM, and other technology companies to

strengthen the security of Artificial Intelligence (AI) systems?

A.Global AI Security Network (GAISN)

B.Open Secure AI Alliance (OSAA)

C.AI Trust and Safety Consortium (AITSC)

D.Secure AI Collaboration Forum (SACF)

E.International AI Security Alliance (IASA)

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

NVIDIA, **Microsoft Corporation**, **IBM (International Business Machines Corporation)**, along with leading **technology companies** and **research institutions**, launched the **Open Secure AI Alliance (OSAA)** to strengthen the **security, trustworthiness, and resilience** of **Artificial Intelligence (AI)** systems through **open collaboration** and **shared security standards**. The **Open Secure AI Alliance (OSAA)** aims to promote **secure-by-design AI development**, improve the **security, transparency, and reliability** of AI systems, facilitate **information sharing** on **AI-related threats and vulnerabilities**, and encourage the adoption of **common AI security standards** across the global AI ecosystem.

Detailed Explanation:

NVIDIA, **Microsoft Corporation**, **IBM (International Business Machines Corporation)**, along with leading **technology companies** and **research institutions**, launched the **Open Secure AI Alliance (OSAA)** to strengthen the **security, trustworthiness, and resilience** of **Artificial Intelligence (AI)** systems through **open collaboration** and **shared security standards**. The **Open Secure AI Alliance (OSAA)** aims to promote **secure-by-design AI development**, improve the **security, transparency, and reliability** of AI systems, facilitate **information sharing** on **AI-related threats and vulnerabilities**, and encourage the adoption of **common AI security standards** across the global AI ecosystem.

The alliance was launched shortly after a **cybersecurity incident at Hugging Face**, where the company's infrastructure was **breached during an AI system security evaluation**, highlighting the growing need for stronger AI security frameworks.

The **OSAA** consists of **more than 35 inaugural members** representing the fields of **Artificial Intelligence (AI)**, **cybersecurity**, **enterprise software**, and **cloud computing**.

585. As per the news, what is the name of the advanced platform launched by the India Meteorological Department (IMD) for thunderstorm nowcast monitoring and real-time severe weather forecasting?

A.IMD VARSHA

B.IMD SURAKSHA

C.IMD VAYU

D.IMD PRITHVI

E.IMD NOVA

Answer: E

Short Explanation:

The **Ministry of Earth Sciences (MoES)** celebrated its **20th Foundation Day** at **Prithvi Bhawan, New Delhi, Delhi**, marking 20 years of contributions in **weather forecasting, earth system science, oceanography, seismology, and polar research**.

The 20th Foundation Day celebrations were presided over by **Dr. N. Kalaiselvi**, Secretary, **Ministry of Earth Sciences (MoES)**.

The **IMD** launched **IMD NOVA**, an advanced platform for **thunderstorm nowcast monitoring** and real-time severe weather forecasting.

The **IMD** signed an MoU with the **Indian Council of Agricultural Research–National Institute of Veterinary Epidemiology and Disease Informatics (ICAR-NIVEDI)** to establish the **Weather Driven Animal Disease Risk Forecasting Unit (WAADRU)** for district-level livestock disease forecasting based on weather conditions.

Detailed Explanation:

The **Ministry of Earth Sciences (MoES)** celebrated its **20th Foundation Day** at **Prithvi Bhawan, New Delhi, Delhi**, marking 20 years of contributions in **weather forecasting, earth system science, oceanography, seismology, and polar research**.

The 20th Foundation Day celebrations were presided over by **Dr. N. Kalaiselvi**, Secretary, **Ministry of Earth Sciences (MoES)**.

The **India Meteorological Department (IMD)** established **13 Centres of Excellence (CoEs)** to strengthen specialised meteorological research and enhance India's weather forecasting capabilities.

The **IMD** upgraded the **Thiruvananthapuram Cyclone Warning Centre** into an **Area Cyclone Warning Centre (ACWC)** to improve cyclone monitoring, forecasting, and early warning services.

The **IMD** launched **IMD NOVA**, an advanced platform for **thunderstorm nowcast monitoring** and real-time severe weather forecasting.

The **IMD** signed an MoU with the **Indian Council of Agricultural Research–National Institute of Veterinary Epidemiology and Disease Informatics (ICAR-NIVEDI)** to establish the **Weather Driven Animal Disease Risk Forecasting Unit (WAADRU)** for district-level livestock disease forecasting based on weather conditions.

586. As per the news, what is the name of India's first unified digital platform for end-to-end management of Panchayat Own Source Revenue (OSR)?

A.e-Gram Swaraj Portal

B.Panchayat Darpan Portal

C.SAMARTH Panchayat Portal

D.Gram Shakti Portal

E.Panchayat Mitra Portal

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

Union Minister Rajiv Ranjan Singh, heading the **Ministry of Panchayati Raj (MoPR)** and the **Ministry of Fisheries, Animal Husbandry and Dairying (MoFAHD)**, launched the **Atmanirbhar Panchayat Programme**, **SAMARTH Panchayat Portal**, and released the **Model Own Source of Revenue (OSR) Rules** at **Krishi Bhawan, New Delhi, Delhi**.

The initiatives aim to strengthen the **financial autonomy, digital governance, and revenue generation capacity** of **Panchayati Raj Institutions (PRIs)** in line with the vision of **Viksit Bharat @2047**.

The **Atmanirbhar Panchayat Programme**, launched by the **Ministry of Panchayati Raj (MoPR)**, enables **Gram Panchayats (GPs) and Block Panchayats** to identify local assets and convert them into **sustainable revenue-generating projects**, thereby enhancing their **Own Source Revenue (OSR)** and promoting **financial self-reliance**.

Detailed Explanation:

Union Minister Rajiv Ranjan Singh, heading the **Ministry of Panchayati Raj (MoPR)** and the **Ministry of Fisheries, Animal Husbandry and Dairying (MoFAHD)**, launched the **Atmanirbhar Panchayat Programme**, **SAMARTH Panchayat Portal**, and released the **Model Own Source of Revenue (OSR) Rules** at **Krishi Bhawan, New Delhi, Delhi**.

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The **Atmanirbhar Panchayat Programme**, launched by the **Ministry of Panchayati Raj (MoPR)**, enables **Gram Panchayats (GPs) and Block Panchayats** to identify local assets and convert them into **sustainable revenue-generating projects**, thereby enhancing their **Own Source Revenue (OSR)** and promoting **financial self-reliance**.

The **SAMARTH Panchayat Portal** is India's **first unified digital platform** developed by the **MoPR** for end-to-end management of **Panchayat Own Source Revenue (OSR)**, improving **transparency, efficiency, and digital governance**.

The **Model Own Source of Revenue (OSR) Rules** provide an **advisory framework** for **States and Union Territories (UTs)** to strengthen the **assessment, collection, and management of Panchayat revenues**, including **property tax, user charges, fees, and other non-tax revenues**.

587. As per the news, Sonam Uttam Maskar and Himanshu Dhillon won the bronze medal in which event at the ISSF World Cup?

A.10m Air Rifle Mixed Team

B.25m Pistol Mixed Team

C.10m Air Pistol Mixed Team

D.50m Rifle 3 Positions Mixed Team

E.Skeet Mixed Team

Answer: A

Short Explanation:

India's Sonam Uttam Maskar and Himanshu Dhillon won the **bronze medal** in the **10m Air Rifle Mixed Team** event at the **International Shooting Sport Federation (ISSF) World Cup**.

With this achievement, **India's overall medal tally** at the tournament reached **4 medals**, comprising **1 Gold, 1 Silver and 2 Bronze**.

In the qualification round, **Sonam Uttam Maskar (317.2)** and **Himanshu Dhillon (317.4)** registered a combined score of **634.6** to qualify for the medal round.

Another Indian pair, **Elavenil Valarivan (316.8)** and **Parth Rakesh Mane (317.4)**, also qualified for the final with a combined score of **634.2** and eventually finished **fourth**.

Detailed Explanation:

India's Sonam Uttam Maskar and Himanshu Dhillon won the **bronze medal** in the **10m Air Rifle Mixed Team** event at the **International Shooting Sport Federation (ISSF) World Cup**.

With this achievement, **India's overall medal tally** at the tournament reached **4 medals**, comprising **1 Gold, 1 Silver and 2 Bronze**.

In the qualification round, **Sonam Uttam Maskar (317.2)** and **Himanshu Dhillon (317.4)** registered a combined score of **634.6** to qualify for the medal round.

Another Indian pair, **Elavenil Valarivan (316.8)** and **Parth Rakesh Mane (317.4)**, also qualified for the final with a combined score of **634.2** and eventually finished **fourth**.

In the bronze medal match, **Sonam Uttam Maskar and Himanshu Dhillon** scored **441.2 points** (220.6 each) to secure the **bronze medal**, finishing behind **China-1** and **China-2**.

The medal marked **Himanshu Dhillon's first senior ISSF World Cup medal**, while **Sonam Uttam Maskar** added another international medal to her career after winning **silver medals** at the **ISSF World Cup Cairo** and the **ISSF World Cup Final, New Delhi (2024)**.

588. As per the news, how many Test matches did Ajinkya Rahane play for India during his international career?

A.75

B.80

C.85

D.90

E.95

Answer: C

Short Explanation:

Senior Indian cricketer Ajinkya Rahane has announced his **retirement from international cricket with immediate effect**, bringing an end to his international career across all formats.

During his international career, **Ajinkya Rahane** played:

85 Test matches

90 One Day Internationals (ODIs)

20 Twenty20 Internationals (T20Is)

Detailed Explanation:

Senior Indian cricketer Ajinkya Rahane has announced his **retirement from international cricket with immediate effect**, bringing an end to his international career across all formats.

In a social media post, **Ajinkya Rahane** stated that the time was right for him to move on from international cricket after representing India for over a decade.

Rahane last represented **India** in **2023** during the **Test series against the West Indies**, while his final **One Day International (ODI)** appearance came in **2018** against **England**.

During his international career, **Ajinkya Rahane** played:

85 Test matches

90 One Day Internationals (ODIs)

20 Twenty20 Internationals (T20Is)

589. As per the news, who won the Gold Medal in the Men's 100-metre T47 Para Athletics event at the Commonwealth Games 2026?

A.Mohammed Basil Morssinganakath

B.Dilip Mahadu Gavit

C.Murali Sreeshankar

D.Kevin Santos

E.Sarvesh Anil Kushare

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

India created history at the Commonwealth Games 2026 in Glasgow by securing a **historic one-two finish** in the **Men's 100-metre T47 Para Athletics event**.

Dilip Mahadu Gavit won the **gold medal**, clocking a **Games record and season-best time of 10.71 seconds**, while **Mohammed Basil Morssinganakath** claimed the **silver medal** with a **season-best time of 10.83 seconds**.

Detailed Explanation:

India created history at the Commonwealth Games 2026 in Glasgow by securing a **historic one-two finish** in the **Men's 100-metre T47 Para Athletics event**.

Dilip Mahadu Gavit won the **gold medal**, clocking a **Games record and season-best time of 10.71 seconds**, while **Mohammed Basil Morssinganakath** claimed the **silver medal** with a **season-best time of 10.83 seconds**.

Kevin Santos (England) won the **bronze medal** with a timing of **10.85 seconds**.

The medals were **India's third and fourth medals** after **Murali Sreeshankar** won **silver** in the **Men's Long Jump** event.

Murali Sreeshankar also became the **first Indian male long jumper to win two Commonwealth Games medals**.

590. As per the news, what is the theme of World Day Against Trafficking in Persons on 30 July 2026?

A.Human Trafficking: No Place for Exploitation

B.End Human Trafficking, Protect Human Rights

C.Stop Exploitation, Save Lives

D.Together Against Trafficking

E.Trapped Behind the Scam

Answer: E

World Day Against Trafficking in Persons is observed every year on **30 July** to raise awareness about **human trafficking**, highlight

the challenges faced by victims, and promote the protection of their rights.

The **theme for World Day Against Trafficking in Persons 2026** is **"Trapped Behind the Scam"**, focusing on the exploitation of victims through fraudulent schemes and organised trafficking networks.

In **2010**, the **United Nations General Assembly (UNGA)** adopted the **United Nations Global Plan of Action to Combat Trafficking in Persons** to encourage coordinated international efforts against human trafficking.

591. As per the news, International Friendship Day is observed every year on which date?

A.20 July

B.25 July

C.30 July

D.2 August

E.5 August

Answer: C

International Friendship Day is observed every year on **30 July** across the world to highlight the importance of **friendship, peace, solidarity and mutual understanding** among people and communities.

The day is celebrated by the **United Nations (UN)** to promote the idea that friendship between individuals, cultures and nations can contribute to **building peace and strengthening global cooperation**.

In **India**, Friendship Day is generally celebrated on the **first Sunday of August**. In **2026**, it will be observed on **2 August**.

592. As per the latest information, who is the Governor of Madhya Pradesh?

A.Lalji Tandon

B.Anandiben Patel

C.Ramesh Bais

D.Hari Babu Kambhampati

E.Mangubhai Chhaganbhai Patel

Answer: E

About Madhya Pradesh:

Chief Minister: Mohan Yadav

Governor: Mangubhai Chhaganbhai Patel

Capital: Bhopal

National Parks: Kanha National Park, Bandhavgarh National Park, Pench National Park, Panna National Park, Satpura National Park, Sanjay National Park, Madhav National Park, Van Vihar National Park, Mandla Plant Fossils National Park

Wildlife Sanctuaries: Gandhi Sagar Wildlife Sanctuary, National Chambal Wildlife Sanctuary, Kuno Wildlife Sanctuary, Pachmarhi Wildlife Sanctuary, Pench Wildlife Sanctuary, Panna Wildlife Sanctuary, Nauradehi Wildlife Sanctuary, Singhori Wildlife Sanctuary, Bori Wildlife Sanctuary

593. As per the news, what title was given to the women from Self-Help Groups (SHGs) who received training in rooftop solar installation under the DWEEPTI Yojana?

A.Urja Sakhis
B.Solar Didis
C.Solar Mitras
D.Surya Shaktis
E.Green Sakhis

Answer: B

Short Explanation:

Kabirdham district has become the **flagship district** for the scheme's implementation, where the **Vande Mataram Cluster Level Federation** was registered as an authorised solar vendor.

With technical support from **Tata**, around **35 women** from local SHGs received practical training in **rooftop solar installation**, becoming the state's first **"Solar Didis"**.

Detailed Explanation:

Kabirdham district has become the **flagship district** for the scheme's implementation, where the **Vande Mataram Cluster Level Federation** was registered as an authorised solar vendor.

With technical support from **Tata**, around **35 women** from local SHGs received practical training in **rooftop solar installation**, becoming the state's first **"Solar Didis"**.

The **first rooftop solar system** under the **DWEEPTI Yojana** was successfully installed in **Samnapur village, Kabirdham district**.

Following the successful pilot, the **Government of Chhattisgarh** plans to expand the **DWEEPTI Yojana** to all districts of the state, creating a scalable model of **women-led renewable energy development**.

594. As per the news, which of the following statements about the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Amendment Bill, 2026 is correct?

A.The maximum fine for organised examination-related crimes has been increased to ₹10 crore
B.The maximum imprisonment for organised examination-related crimes has been reduced to 5 years.
C.The debarment period for service providers has been reduced from 4 years to 2 years
D.The maximum fine for individuals using unfair means remains ₹10 lakh
E.The Bill does not provide for Special Fast Track Courts

Answer: A

The **Lok Sabha** passed the **Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Amendment Bill, 2026** by a **voice vote** to strengthen the legal framework against the use of unfair means in public examinations and protect the interests of students and job aspirants.

Punishment for individuals using unfair means has been increased from **3–5 years** to **5–10 years** imprisonment, with the maximum fine raised from **₹10 lakh to ₹50 lakh**.

For **service providers** involved in examination malpractices, the maximum fine has been increased from **₹1 crore to ₹5 crore**, and the debarment period from conducting public examinations has been extended from **4 years to 8 years**.

Punishment for **directors and senior management** of service providers has been enhanced to **5–10 years' imprisonment**, along with a maximum fine of **₹5 crore**.

Punishment for **organised examination-related crimes** has been increased from **5–10 years** to **7–10 years' imprisonment**, while the maximum fine has been enhanced from **₹1 crore to ₹10 crore**.

The Bill also provides for the establishment of **Special Fast Track Courts** for offences related to public examinations, with investigations to be completed within **2 months** and trials within **3 months** from the filing of the charge sheet.

595. As per the news, Financial Intelligence Unit–India (FIU-IND) was established in which year?

A.2002

B.2003

C.2004

D.2005

E.2006

Answer: C

The **Financial Intelligence Unit–India (FIU-IND)** is the national financial intelligence agency responsible for **receiving, processing, analysing, and disseminating** information relating to **suspect financial transactions** to various law enforcement and regulatory agencies.

FIU-IND was established in **2004**, functions under the **Department of Revenue (DoR), Ministry of Finance (MoF)**, and is headquartered in **New Delhi, Delhi**.